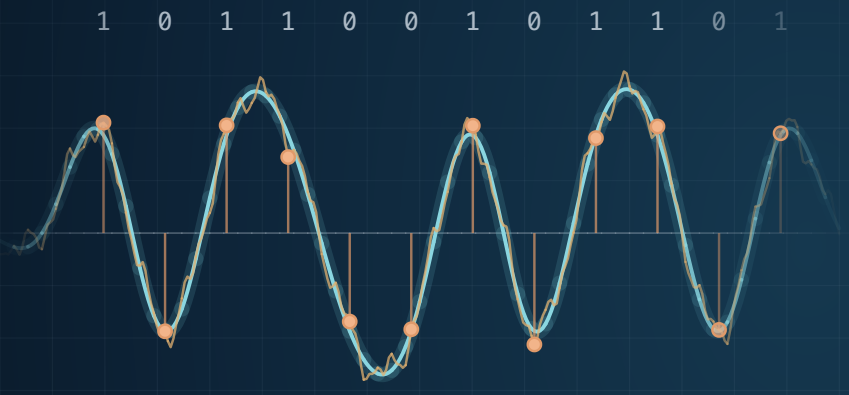
SAMPLING · DETECTION · MODULATION · CODING

Digital Communications

Lecture Notes





Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız

IEEE Senior Member
Associate Professor of Electrical and Electronics Engineering
TED University, Ankara, Türkiye

CHAPTERS 1–6 · APPENDIX A

© 2026 huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Contents

List of Figures 5

List of Tables 13

1 The transition from analog to digital PS CH7.1–7.7 14

The Fourier transform in f. Impulse-train sampling, the spectral replicas and the sampling theorem. The reconstruction filter and the interpolation formula. Uniform quantization, mid-rise and mid-tread, overload and granular noise. Quantization noise, the signal-to-quantization-noise ratio. Non-uniform quantization and A-law and μ-law companding. Encoding, line codes, the bandwidth and bit errors of PCM, DPCM and delta modulation. Vector quantization. Linear predictive coding, T1, sigma-delta conversion and JPEG.

1.1 The sampling theorem 14

1.2 Reconstruction 21

1.3 Quantization 27

1.4 Quantization noise and SQNR 32

1.5 Non-uniform quantization 43

1.6 PCM, DPCM and delta modulation 47

1.7 Coding in practice 54

1.8 Summary 59

2 Baseband transmission of digital signals PS CH8.2–8.3, 10.1–10.3, 10.5 64

The matched filter and the peak signal-to-noise ratio. Antipodal signalling, and correlator and matched-filter demodulators. The decision statistic, the optimal threshold, the Q function and the bit error probability. Intersymbol interference and the eye diagram. Nyquist's criterion, the minimum bandwidth and the raised cosine.

2.1 Random signals 64

2.2 The matched filter 82

2.3 The demodulator 98

2.4 The decision and its error 112

2.5 Intersymbol interference 120

2.6 Nyquist and the raised cosine 129

2.7 Summary 140

3 Geometric representation of signal waveforms PS CH8.1–8.2, 8.6.1, 8.7.1 144

Signals as vectors: orthonormal bases, coordinates, inner products, energy and distance. The constellation diagram, a cosine and a sine as axes, and points on a circle. The Gram–Schmidt procedure and the choice of basis.

3.1 Signals as vectors 144

3.2 Constellations 152

3.3 The Gram–Schmidt procedure 158

3.4 Summary 165

4 The optimal receiver in additive white Gaussian noise PS CH8.3.3, 8.4 169

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The observation vector and the noise outside the signal space. The MAP and ML rules, minimum-distance detection and the correlation metric. Decision regions and the binary error probability. The union bound, its intelligent form and the nearest-neighbour approximation.

4.1 The observation 169

4.2 The decision rule 177

4.3 Decision regions 185

4.4 Error probability and the union bound 190

4.5 Summary 199

5 Digital modulation methods — PS CH6.4, 8.5–8.7, 9.1, 9.5–9.7, 10.2, 14.5 — 202

Bits on a carrier and the IQ modulator. BPSK, BFSK and BASK compared. M-ary phase-shift keying, QPSK as two BPSK links, Gray labels, carrier phase error and differential PSK. M-ary amplitude-shift keying, quadrature amplitude modulation, eight-point constellations and QAM against PSK. M-ary frequency-shift keying, orthogonal signals and noncoherent detection. Bandwidth, offset QPSK and MSK, and the bandwidth-efficiency plane. Adaptive modulation, the receiver noise floor and the link budget.

5.1 Putting bits on a carrier 202

5.2 Phase-shift keying 208

5.3 Amplitude and quadrature 217

5.4 Frequency-shift keying and orthogonal signals 223

5.5 Bandwidth and the choice of scheme 226

5.6 Summary 233

6 An introduction to information theory — PS CH12.1–12.6 — 237

Self-information, entropy and extended sources. Typical sequences, the source coding theorem, prefix codes, the Kraft inequality, and rate and distortion. Huffman, arithmetic and Lempel–Ziv coding. The discrete memoryless channel, joint and conditional entropy, and mutual information. Channel capacity, the binary symmetric and erasure channels, repetition codes, the channel coding theorem and the Hamming code. The Gaussian channel, the Shannon limit and water-filling.

6.1 Information and entropy 237

6.2 The limits of compression 242

6.3 Huffman and Lempel–Ziv coding 249

6.4 Channels and mutual information 256

6.5 Channel capacity 262

6.6 The Gaussian channel 271

6.7 Summary 276

A Summary of formulas — – — 280

The results each chapter carries forward, as question and answer, one table a chapter, in course order and without derivations.

A.1 The transition from analog to digital — Chapter 1 280

A.2 Baseband transmission of digital signals — Chapter 2 281

A.3 Geometric representation of signal waveforms — Chapter 3 282

A.4 The optimal receiver in additive white Gaussian noise — Chapter 4 283

A.5 Digital modulation methods — Chapter 5 284

A.6 An introduction to information theory — Chapter 6 285

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Course conventions

These notes are written for undergraduates. They assume Fourier analysis, probability and random processes. Read the plain explanation before the mathematics. Worked examples use five headings: Given, Find, Method, Solution, and Check.

Noise is white and Gaussian with **two-sided** power spectral density $N_0/2$ watts per hertz. The Gaussian tail is $Q(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int_x^\infty e^{-t^2/2}\, dt$. Energy and power use $R = 1\ \Omega$.

A **PS** marker points to the related section of Proakis and Salehi, *Fundamentals of Communication Systems*, second edition. The textbook chapter numbers differ from the course chapter numbers.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

List of Figures

CHAPTER 1 · THE TRANSITION FROM ANALOG TO DIGITAL

1.1 Impulse-train sampling. 16
1.2 The spectrum before and after sampling. 17
1.3 The spectral replicas. 18
1.4 $f_s = 3W$: a guard band separates the copies. 18
1.5 $f_s = 1.5W$: the copies overlap, and the overlaps (red) are aliasing. 18
1.6 Sampling at the Nyquist rate. 19
1.7 Aliasing in an image. 20
1.8 CD audio is sampled at 44.1 kHz. 21
1.9 Telephone speech is filtered to 3.4 kHz and sampled at 8 kHz, which leaves a 1.2 kHz guard band. 21
1.10 Film samples at 24 frames a second. 21
1.11 An electrocardiograph samples at 500 Hz. 21
1.12 The reconstruction filter. 22
1.13 The impulse response of the reconstruction filter. 23
1.14 The interpolation formula as a sum of sinc pulses. 24
1.15 A partial sum of the interpolation formula. 25
1.16 Parts (a) and (b): the sampled spectrum at $f_s = 90$ kHz. 26
1.17 Part (c): $X(f)$ (dashed) and the two half-height copies that make $Y(f)$. 26
1.18 A zero-order hold keeps each sample until the next one. 27
1.19 The hold is a filter with gain $|\operatorname{sinc}(f/f_s)|$. 27
1.20 Joining the samples by straight lines is a filter with a triangular impulse response. 27
1.21 Oversampling CD audio by four moves the first copy to 156.4 kHz. 27
1.22 A mid-rise quantizer. 28
1.23 A mid-tread quantizer. 28
1.24 A sampled signal through the quantizer. 29
1.25 The optimal four-level quantizer for a Gaussian input. 30
1.26 Overload and granular noise. 31
1.27 A clinical thermometer shows $0.1\ ^\circ$C steps. 31
1.28 A 10-bit converter over 3.3 V has $\Delta = 3.3/1024 = 3.22$ mV. 31
1.29 A kitchen scale reads in 1 g steps and rounds. 32
1.30 A language model with 70×10^9 weights needs 140 GB at 16 bits. 32
1.31 The quantization error and its bound. 34
1.32 The uniform error density. 35
1.33 Quantization noise in bits. 36
1.34 SQNR against the number of bits. 37
1.35 SQNR as a ratio of two time averages. 38
1.36 Example 1.2: a sinusoid and its quantization error. 39
1.37 Example 1.3: the 256-level quantizer. 40
1.38 Example 1.4: the power spectral density of the source. 41
1.39 Example 1.4: the quantizer input-output staircase. 41
1.40 Example 1.4: the error integrand region by region. 41
1.41 SQNR of three sources against the number of bits. 42
1.42 CD audio uses 16 bits: 98.1 dB at full scale, and 58.1 dB for a passage 40 dB quieter. 43
1.43 By $\alpha + 6.02R$, uniform 8-bit PCM gives 49.9 dB at full scale but only 19.9 dB for a signal 30 dB below it. 43
1.44 A row of an image at 8 levels shows bands where the 256-level row is smooth. 43
1.45 A full-scale sinusoid at common word lengths: 49.9, 74.0, 98.1 and 146.3 dB. 43

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

1.46 A non-uniform quantizer. 44
1.47 The compander. 45
1.48 A-law and μ-law companding. 46
1.49 Two 8-bit quantizers on a sinusoid. 47
1.50 Near zero the laws differ: A-law is a straight line up to $1/A = 0.0114$, and μ-law is curved all the way. 47
1.51 A decaying burst (cyan) and its μ-law compressed form (violet). 47
1.52 A 3-bit μ-law quantizer drawn against its input: narrow steps near zero, wide steps near the peak. 47
1.53 Four line codes. 49
1.54 The message (cyan), its samples every 0.6 s, and the selected levels (violet). 50
1.55 The seven code words as one polar NRZ stream. 50
1.56 The bandwidth of PCM. 51
1.57 A bit error in PCM. 51
1.58 Differential PCM. 52
1.59 Delta modulation. 53
1.60 CD audio: two channels of 16 bits at 44.1 kHz give $2(16)(44\,100) = 1.4112$ Mb/s. 54
1.61 A telephone call sends one 8-bit word every 125 μs, which is 64 kb/s. 54
1.62 Ten-megabit Ethernet over twisted pair uses Manchester coding: a transition in the middle of every bit. 54
1.63 A shaft encoder prints a Gray code on three tracks. 54
1.64 The pairs a vector quantizer must name. 55
1.65 Image quantization. 55
1.66 Linear predictive coding. 56
1.67 Time-division multiplexing and the T1 frame. 57
1.68 Sigma-delta conversion. 58
1.69 Transform coding and JPEG. 59
1.70 From sound to bits. 60

CHAPTER 2 · BASEBAND TRANSMISSION OF DIGITAL SIGNALS

2.1 One recording is a sample function. 64
2.2 The recordings fluctuate while their ensemble mean is zero. 65
2.3 Each dot contains two readings from one trial, separated by 0.5 ms. 66
2.4 The autocorrelation at a gap of 1 ms is $0.37\ \mathrm{V}^2$. 67
2.5 Three recordings read at $t = 1$ ms and $t + \tau = 2$ ms. 68
2.6 Each dot holds two readings, at $t = 1$ ms and $t + \tau = 2$ ms, from one of 300 recordings. 69
2.7 The real WSS autocorrelation is even, has value $4\ \mathrm{V}^2$ at zero, and remains bounded by that magnitude. 70
2.8 Example 2.1: one recording with $\theta = 3\pi/2$. 71
2.9 With $\tau_c = 0.3$ ms, the PSD spreads around zero frequency. 72
2.10 The two-sided spectrum has height 10^{-3} W/Hz and total width 10 kHz. 73
2.11 The flat spectrum occupies $|f| < 2$ kHz. 74
2.12 At $B = 2$ kHz, the first zeros are at $\tau = \pm 0.25$ ms. 75
2.13 At $B = 4$ kHz the peak is $2B = 8$ kHz and the lobe is narrow, while the area stays 1. 76
2.14 An illustrative input recording and its RC-filtered output. 77
2.15 The output PSD equals the input PSD multiplied by $\|H(f)\|^2$. The RC filter passes low frequencies more strongly than high frequencies. 78
2.16 The filter gain $|H(f)|^2$ shapes the flat input PSD. 79
2.17 A lowpass filter and the dashed ideal filter have equal peak gain and equal total spectral area, including tails beyond the plotted range. 80
2.18 The sum of thirty independent uniform sources, scaled to unit variance, closely follows a Gaussian density. 81
2.19 A zero-mean Gaussian sample with standard deviation 2 mV. 82
2.20 Five polar bits under noise of standard deviation 0.1, 0.5 and 1. 83
2.21 One rectangular pulse $g(t)$ (cyan) on $[0, T]$, buried in white noise. 84

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

2.22 RC, $\tau = T/10$: the pulse passes, and so does much noise. 84
2.23 RC, $\tau = 2T$: little noise passes, and the pulse is smoothed away. 84
2.24 The matched filter: a clear peak at $t = T$, with η at its bound. 84
2.25 The receiver model. 85
2.26 The filter output split into its signal part and its noise part. 86
2.27 The RC filter at its best, $T/\tau = 1.26$. 87
2.28 The output noise density of an RC filter and the area under it. 88
2.29 The signal spectrum $|G(f)|$ (cyan) and a filter $|H(f)|$ (amber, dashed) of twice its width, $b = 2$. 89
2.30 The SNR of the filter of width b as a fraction of the bound, $2b/(1 + b^2)$. 90
2.31 The matched filter of the ramp $g(t) = t/T$, built in two moves. 91
2.32 The magnitudes for the ramp $g(t) = \sqrt{3}\,t/T$ with $E = 1$ and $k = 1$. 91
2.33 The phases over π: $\angle G$ (cyan), $\angle H$ (amber, dashed) and their sum $-2\pi fT$ (violet), a straight line. 91
2.34 The overlap at $t = T/2$. 92
2.35 The output $y(t)/E$, the area of that product, drawn up to $t = T/2$. 92
2.36 The ramp output with and without the reversal. 93
2.37 The correlator and the matched filter for the ramp. 93
2.38 The matched filter of the noisy rectangular pulse with $k = 0.5$. 94
2.39 The same filter with $k = 2$. 94
2.40 A rectangular pulse and a half-sine pulse of the same energy E, each through its own matched filter. 95
2.41 The SNR at the sampling instant t_0 for the rectangular pulse, as a fraction of $2E/N_0$. 96
2.42 Histograms of the matched-filter sample for polar bits. 96
2.43 Example 2.3: the pulse $g(t)/A$ (dashed) and the output of its matched filter, $y(t)/(A^2T)$. 97
2.44 The pulse $\psi(t)$ (amber, dashed) and its square $\psi^2(t)$ (violet). 98
2.45 The basis $\psi(t)$ (amber) and the two waveforms of polar signalling, $s_1(t)$ (cyan) and $s_0(t)$ (cyan, dashed), drawn with $T_b = 1$ and $A = 1.5$. 99
2.46 The two waveforms of polar signalling, $s_1(t)$ (solid) and $s_0(t)$ (dashed). 100
2.47 The same two waveforms as points on the axis of $\psi(t)$. 100
2.48 The matched-filter output split into signal and noise parts. 101
2.49 The matched-filter demodulator as a convolution. 102
2.50 The filter matched to $\psi(t)$, and what it does to one noisy bit with $s_m = +1$. 103
2.51 Matched-filter outputs for three pulse shapes. 104
2.52 Ten polar bits through the matched-filter demodulator. 105
2.53 Correlator and matched filter for a Manchester bit. 106
2.54 One noiseless bit with $s_m = 1$ and the rectangular ψ. 107
2.55 The square of the double integral of the noise variance. 108
2.56 The line t = u that white noise leaves in the double integral. 110
2.57 Measured noise values against the Gaussian density. 111
2.58 Signal points of binary orthogonal signalling. 112
2.59 The density of y for each symbol, drawn with $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$. 113
2.60 The two conditional densities with $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$, and the threshold at $\lambda = 0.3$. 114
2.61 The two densities weighted by their priors, for $p_0 = 0.7$, $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$. 116
2.62 The weighted densities for $p_0 = 0.7$ at $E_b/N_0 = 0$ dB, with $E_b = 1$. 116
2.63 $Q(x)$ falls from 1 to 0 and passes 0.5 at $x = 0$. 117
2.64 Bit error probability of polar signalling against E_b/N_0. 118
2.65 Example 2.4: the two weighted densities on a logarithmic scale, where each is a parabola. 119
2.66 Example 2.5: P_e against the threshold for the same link. 119
2.67 The baseband link. 120
2.68 Ideal and band-limited channel outputs. 121
2.69 From bits to the transmitted signal. 122

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

2.70 The channel output as a convolution. 123
2.71 Six bits through an RC channel. 124
2.72 The three parts of a sample. 125
2.73 How the eye diagram is built. 126
2.74 Reading the eye diagram. 127
2.75 The eye of the Gaussian channel at $BT_b = 0.25$, where $q = 0.173$ and the opening has shrunk to 0.618. 128
2.76 The eye of the Gaussian channel at $BT_b = 0.5$ with noise of standard deviation $\sigma = 0.2$. 129
2.77 Zero interference at the sampling instants. 130
2.78 The sampled pulse and its spectrum. 131
2.79 Nyquist's criterion in frequency. 132
2.80 The ideal Nyquist channel. 133
2.81 A late reading on the ideal pulse and the raised cosine. 134
2.82 The raised-cosine spectrum. 135
2.83 The copies of the raised cosine add to a constant. 136
2.84 The sinc factor (dashed), the second factor for $\alpha = 0.5$ (violet) and their product $p(t)$ (cyan). 137
2.85 The pulses of $\alpha = 0$ (dashed), $\alpha = 0.5$ (cyan) and $\alpha = 1$ (violet). 137
2.86 Choosing the roll-off. 138
2.87 Example 2.6: the ideal rectangle of width $2W$ (dashed) and the raised-cosine spectrum with $\alpha = 0.5$, which reaches $B_T = 15$ kHz. 138
2.88 The link with split filters. 139
2.89 The raised cosine with $\alpha = 0.5$ (cyan) and its square root (amber, dashed). 139
2.90 Eight bits through the link. 141

CHAPTER 3 · GEOMETRIC REPRESENTATION OF SIGNAL WAVEFORMS

3.1 A vector written against two unit axes. 144
3.2 Two unit pulses that form an orthonormal pair. 146
3.3 The waveform $x_1\psi_1(t) + x_2\psi_2(t)$ and its point. 147
3.4 Two waveforms, their basis pulses, and the same two signals as vectors. 148
3.5 The synthesizer: each coordinate s_{ij} scales its basis function, and the products are added to give $s_i(t)$. 149
3.6 The analyzer: one correlator for each basis function. 149
3.7 Two points of energy 2 and their distance. 150
3.8 The four signals of Example 3.1, each constant on $[0, 1)$ and on $[1, 2)$, and their four points. 151
3.9 IS-95 phones share one band, each call with its own Walsh code at 1.2288 Mchip/s. 152
3.10 Wi-Fi spaces its subcarriers $\Delta f = 312.5$ kHz apart. 152
3.11 JPEG writes each row of 8 pixels against the DCT basis $c_k[n] = \frac{1}{2}\cos\big(\pi(2n+1)k/16\big)$, $k \geq 1$. 152
3.12 The Kansas City standard stored bits on cassette tape at 300 baud: 4 cycles of 1200 Hz for a 0, 8 cycles of 2400 Hz for a 1. 152
3.13 The four signals of Example 3.1 as a constellation. 153
3.14 Three binary signal sets as points. 153
3.15 A carrier with phase θ and its point. 155
3.16 The pulse set and the carrier set share one constellation. 156
3.17 $M = 8$ points on the circle of radius $\sqrt{E}$, here $E = 1$, and the nearest pair. 157
3.18 GPS satellites send their C/A code with BPSK on 1575.42 MHz. 158
3.19 Satellite television (DVB-S2) can use 8PSK: 3 bits a symbol on one circle, with $d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E}\sin(\pi/8) = 0.765\sqrt{E}$. 158
3.20 Wi-Fi at 36 Mb/s uses 16-QAM, 4 bits a symbol. 158
3.21 At 54 Mb/s Wi-Fi uses 64-QAM, 6 bits a symbol. 158
3.22 The procedure on two signals. 159
3.23 Gram–Schmidt for three pulses. 160
3.24 The three vectors of Example 3.3. 161

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

3.25 Four signals need three axes. 162
3.26 Eight phases need two axes. 163
3.27 The eight-point constellation of Example 3.5. 164
3.28 The square against a turned basis. 164
3.29 A receiver whose sine branch is 10° off reads QPSK as a sheared square, $y_Q = y\cos 10^\circ + x \sin 10^\circ$. 165
3.30 A two-antenna Wi-Fi receiver orthogonalizes the channel columns $\mathbf{h}_1 = (1, 0.3)$ and $\mathbf{h}_2 = (0.8, 0.9)$ before detection. 165
3.31 A hum filter projects the microphone signal $m(t)$ on a 50 Hz reference $r(t)$ over 20 ms. 165
3.32 A sensor fit over 0 to 100 °C uses $u = (T - 50)/50$. 165
3.33 From a waveform to its point. 166

CHAPTER 4 · THE OPTIMAL RECEIVER IN ADDITIVE WHITE GAUSSIAN NOISE

4.1 Four signal points and their decision regions. 169
4.2 Twelve bits read in blocks of $k = 2$, so $M = 2^k = 4$ and $T = kT_b = 2T_b$. 170
4.3 Top: $r(t)$, green, is $s_i(t)$, cyan, plus noise. 171
4.4 Solid: the matched filter output $y(t)$. 172
4.5 The amber sheet is the signal space, spanned by ψ_1 and ψ_2. 173
4.6 $\rho = 0$: independent components and a round cloud. 174
4.7 $\rho = 0.8$: n_2 follows n_1, and the cloud stretches along the line $n_1 = n_2$. 174
4.8 The four conditional densities of Example 4.1, drawn for $N_0 = 0.1$. 175
4.9 The four correlator outputs of Example 4.2 when $\mathbf{s}_1$ is sent. 176
4.10 A GPS receiver correlates the C/A code with a local copy. 176
4.11 802.11b Wi-Fi spreads each bit with the 11-chip Barker code. 176
4.12 A $50\ \Omega$ resistor at 290 K, over 20 MHz, gives noise with $\sigma = \sqrt{4kTRB} = 4.0\ \mu$V. 176
4.13 Aircraft ADS-B sends a 1 as a $0.5\ \mu$s pulse in the first half of the bit, a 0 in the second. 176
4.14 $s_1 = +1$ and $s_2 = -1$, with $N_0 = 1$, drawn for $P(s_1) = 0.7$. 178
4.15 The received point $\mathbf{r} = (0.5, 0.3)$ and the points $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$, $\mathbf{s}_2 = (-1, 1)$, $\mathbf{s}_3 = (-1, -1)$ and $\mathbf{s}_4 = (1, -1)$. 179
4.16 The correlation rs_i alone. 180
4.17 The metric $rs_i - s_i^2/2$. 180
4.18 Top: Method I correlates with the N basis functions, then forms M metrics. 181
4.19 Drawn for $\tau = 0.6$. 182
4.20 Example 4.3. 183
4.21 Example 4.4. 184
4.22 A smoke alarm reads 10 mV in clean air and 40 mV in smoke, with $\sigma = 6$ mV. 185
4.23 An optical receiver sees 0 or $20\ \mu$A. 185
4.24 Caller ID sends 1200 Hz for a 1 and 2200 Hz for a 0. 185
4.25 Bluetooth Low Energy shifts the carrier by about ± 250 kHz. 185
4.26 Five equally likely points and their regions. 186
4.27 Three points with $N_0 = 1$, drawn for $P(\mathbf{s}_3) = 0.6$ and $P(\mathbf{s}_1) = P(\mathbf{s}_2) = 0.2$. 187
4.28 Two equally likely points $d = 2$ apart, with $N_0 = 1$. 188
4.29 $s_0 = -1$ and $s_1 = +1$, so $d = 2$, with $N_0 = 0.5$, drawn for $P(s_1) = 0.9$. 189
4.30 Satellite television can use 8PSK. 189
4.31 Wi-Fi 16-QAM at unit average energy has square regions of side $d_{\min} = 2/\sqrt{10} = 0.632$. 189
4.32 PAM4 in data-centre links sends ± 100 and ± 300 mV. 189
4.33 A phone key sends one low and one high tone. 189
4.34 The centre point of the five-point set is sent with $\sigma = 0.4$, drawn for 1000 draws. 191
4.35 $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$ is sent, and the grey dots are received points. 192
4.36 8-PSK. 193

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

4.37 Solid: $Q(x)$. 193
4.38 The region of $\mathbf{s}_1$ is the first quadrant. 194
4.39 16-QAM on the grid $\pm 1, \pm 3$. 195
4.40 Example 4.5 from $\mathbf{s}_1$. 196
4.41 Example 4.6. 197
4.42 16-QAM with $E_s = 10$, marked at $E_s/N_0 = 6$ dB. 198
4.43 Wi-Fi 16-QAM has $d^2_{\min} = 0.4E_s$ and $\bar{N}_{\min} = 3$. 198
4.44 LTE control channels use QPSK. 198
4.45 A 5G phone picks its modulation from the channel. 198
4.46 A bit-error-rate tester divides the errors by the bits sent. 198
4.47 One symbol through the receiver: $r(t)$, the correlator outputs c_1 and c_2, and the regions of four points $(\pm 1, \pm 0.6)$. 199

CHAPTER 5 · DIGITAL MODULATION METHODS

5.1 A baseband pulse stream $s(t)$ with band $W = 5$ kHz, and its product $u(t)$ with a 40 kHz carrier (top). 203
5.2 The IQ modulator sending four QPSK symbols. 204
5.3 BPSK for the bits $1\,1\,0\,1$, two carrier cycles a bit, over the faint unmodulated carrier. 205
5.4 Two BFSK tones and their correlation against the spacing. 206
5.5 On-off keying of $1\,0\,1\,1\,0$ with peak energy $E = 2$ a bit (top). 207
5.6 Bit error of the three binary schemes. 207
5.7 8-PSK with $E_s = 1$ and its wedges. 209
5.8 The QPSK burst of the IQ modulator (top) and its two halves. 210
5.9 8-PSK and its wedges, with received points at $\theta = 50^\circ$, 160° and -100°. 211
5.10 Symbol error of M-PSK. 212
5.11 8-PSK with natural labels. 213
5.12 8-PSK with Gray labels. 213
5.13 Example 5.2: the sent point $\mathbf{s}_0$ and its wedge of $\pm 22.5^\circ$. 214
5.14 QPSK with a carrier phase error of 20 degrees. 215
5.15 Differential encoding of the bits $1\,0\,1\,1$ from $\theta_0 = 0$. 216
5.16 Bit error of binary DPSK against BPSK. 216
5.17 4-ASK on one axis at unit average energy, with its thresholds halfway between levels. 218
5.18 Example 5.3: four levels at $\pm A$, $\pm 3A$ with the neighbour count of each point, 1, 2, 2, 1, and their average 1.5. 218
5.19 16-QAM as 4-ASK on the cosine and 4-ASK on the sine, with Gray labels on each axis. 219
5.20 The neighbours of each 16-QAM point: 2 at a corner, 3 on an edge, 4 inside. 219
5.21 Symbol error of square QAM. 220
5.22 Four eight-point constellations. 221
5.23 Example 5.4: 16-QAM on the grid ± 1, ± 3 with its decision boundaries at 0 and ± 2 on each axis. 221
5.24 16-PSK (rings) and 16-QAM (dots) at the same $E_s = 1$. 222
5.25 Three orthogonal signals and a decision. 223
5.26 Bit error of M orthogonal signals. 224
5.27 Noncoherent detection of FSK and its price. 225
5.28 Spectrum and band at two bits a symbol. 226
5.29 QPSK: the path of (I, Q) crosses the origin, and the envelope drops to zero. 227
5.30 Offset QPSK: one axis moves at a time, and the envelope stays above $1/\sqrt{2}$. 227
5.31 MSK: the path stays on the circle, and the envelope is constant. 227
5.32 Spectra of offset QPSK and MSK. 227
5.33 The bandwidth-efficiency plane. 228
5.34 Energy per bit of each family against bits a symbol. 229
5.35 Adaptive modulation against the signal-to-noise ratio. 230

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

5.36 The receiver noise floor against the band. 231
5.37 A free-space link budget at 1 km. 232
5.38 The link budget of Example 5.5 against distance. 233
5.39 Two bits through a QPSK link. 234

CHAPTER 6 · AN INTRODUCTION TO INFORMATION THEORY

6.1 Self-information against probability, shown at $p = 1/8$, where $I = 3$ bits. 237
6.2 Information as yes/no questions. 238
6.3 For each symbol of $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$: the bits it carries (left bar) and its weighted share (right bar). 239
6.4 The binary entropy function (solid) and its two terms (dashed), shown at $p = 0.11$. 240
6.5 The source of Example 6.1. 241
6.6 The bits each pair of S^2 carries, for the source $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$. 242
6.7 The source encoder maps each symbol to a codeword. 243
6.8 Every sequence of n bits with $P(1) = 0.2$, placed at its value of $-\frac{1}{n}\log_2 P$ with its probability, shown at $n = 100$. 244
6.9 The typical sequences of ten bits and their index. 245
6.10 Prefix codes as trees, and one bit stream read by two codes. 246
6.11 Each codeword of length l owns 2^{-l} of the unit interval, shown for Code I. 247
6.12 Bounds on the bits a symbol for blocks of n symbols from $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$, shown at $n = 10$. 248
6.13 The least distortion of a Gaussian source at R bits a sample (line), and the Lloyd–Max quantizers of Chapter 1 (dots). 248
6.14 The Huffman merges for $0.4, 0.2, 0.2, 0.1, 0.1$. 250
6.15 Huffman codes with ties placed high and low. 251
6.16 Huffman codes for single symbols, pairs and triples of $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$. 252
6.17 Arithmetic coding of $s_1 s_1 s_2$ with $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$. 253
6.18 The 18-bit stream parsed into phrases, shown after the eighth phrase. 254
6.19 Lempel–Ziv on one random stream from a binary source with $P(1) = 0.1$: the bits sent a source bit against the stream length, and $H_b(0.1)$ (dashed). 255
6.20 The channel above as a diagram. 256
6.21 The four joint probabilities of the channel $0.8/0.2$, $0.3/0.7$, drawn to width: kept (amber) and moved (red). 257
6.22 Top: the binary symmetric channel. 258
6.23 The joint pmf as tiles, and its joint entropy as a bar, shown at the last step: $H(X)$ fills part of the bar, and $H(Y \mid X)$ fills the rest. 259
6.24 Conditional entropies of one channel. 260
6.25 A BSC with equal inputs, shown at $p = 0.1$. 261
6.26 The bars for a BSC with $p = 0.25$ and equal inputs. 261
6.27 Mutual information against the input distribution, for a BSC with $p = 0.1$ (solid) and the Z-channel (dashed), shown at $q = \frac{1}{2}$. 263
6.28 The capacity $C = 1 - H_b(p)$ of the binary symmetric channel (solid) against its crossover p, over $H_b(p)$ (dashed). 263
6.29 Top: the binary erasure channel, where a lost bit arrives as e. 264
6.30 The Z-channel and its mutual information. 265
6.31 The channel matrix of Example 6.3 as tiles. 266
6.32 A four-input channel whose outputs overlap, as tiles. 266
6.33 Long blocks of a BSC: each codeword owns a cloud of about $2^{nH_b(p)}$ likely outputs among the 2^n output words. 267
6.34 Repetition codes on a BSC with $p = 0.1$: the error after a majority vote against the rate $1/n$, for $n = 1, 3, \ldots, 15$, with $n = 3$ ringed. 268
6.35 Over a BSC: rates below $C(p) = 1 - H_b(p)$ can be made reliable, and rates above it cannot. 268
6.36 The Hamming code: a syndrome names the flipped bit. 269

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

6.37 A binary source with $P(1) = 0.1$ sent over a BSC, one use a symbol, shown at $\epsilon = 0.2$. 270
6.38 A received word lands near its codeword, inside a noise disc. 271
6.39 Capacity per hertz against the SNR in dB, shown at $\mathrm{SNR} = 15$, where $C/W = 4$ b/s/Hz. 272
6.40 Capacity of a 3.1 kHz line against its SNR in dB. 273
6.41 Capacity against bandwidth and against power. 273
6.42 The least E_b/N_0 for each spectral efficiency r (line), shown at $r = 2$. 274
6.43 The bound $(2^r - 1)/r$ as r falls: the point walks down to $\ln 2 = -1.59$ dB. 275
6.44 Six channels with noise 0.1 to 3.2 (grey). 276
6.45 A source sent over a BPSK link. 277

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

List of Tables

CHAPTER 1 · THE TRANSITION FROM ANALOG TO DIGITAL

1.1 The two families of uniform quantizer. 28
1.2 The two errors of a quantizer. 30
1.3 Natural binary and Gray code for three bits. 48
1.4 The DC component of the two families of line code. 48
1.5 The two errors of delta modulation. 53
1.6 Summary of Chapter 1: from an analog signal to bits. 61

CHAPTER 2 · BASEBAND TRANSMISSION OF DIGITAL SIGNALS

2.1 Summary of Chapter 2: baseband transmission of digital signals. 142

CHAPTER 3 · GEOMETRIC REPRESENTATION OF SIGNAL WAVEFORMS

3.1 Summary of Chapter 3: the geometric representation of signal waveforms. 167

CHAPTER 4 · THE OPTIMAL RECEIVER IN ADDITIVE WHITE GAUSSIAN NOISE

4.1 Summary of Chapter 4: the optimal receiver in additive white Gaussian noise. 200

CHAPTER 5 · DIGITAL MODULATION METHODS

5.1 The two regions of the bandwidth-efficiency plane. 228
5.2 Each family at $M = 16$ and $P_e = 10^{-5}$. 229
5.3 The E_s/N_0 each set needs for $P_b = 10^{-5}$ with Gray labels. 229
5.4 Summary of Chapter 5: the results the chapter carries forward. 235

CHAPTER 6 · AN INTRODUCTION TO INFORMATION THEORY

6.1 Probability held by the typical set, for $p = 0.2$ and $\epsilon = 0.1$. 245
6.2 Three codes for the same four symbols. 245
6.3 Huffman codes for single symbols, pairs and triples of $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$, against $H = 1.1568$. 251
6.4 Lempel–Ziv parsing of the stream 000101110010100101. 254
6.5 Summary of Chapter 6: an introduction to information theory. 278

APPENDIX A · SUMMARY OF FORMULAS

A.1 The results of Chapter 1. 280
A.2 The results of Chapter 2. 281
A.3 The results of Chapter 3. 282
A.4 The results of Chapter 4. 283
A.5 The results of Chapter 5. 284
A.6 The results of Chapter 6. 285

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CHAPTER

1

The transition from analog to digital

A telephone call turns a voice into $64\,000$ bits a second in three stages: sampling, quantization and encoding. The voice is sampled 8000 times a second, and each sample is written in 8 bits.

Two results carry through the chapter. Sampling can be undone. At $f_s \geq 2W$ the samples of a signal bandlimited to W determine it exactly. Quantization cannot be undone. Each extra bit divides the error power by four, which is about 6 dB of signal-to-quantization-noise ratio.

1.1 The sampling theorem

Fourier transform review

This chapter writes the Fourier transform in the frequency variable f, in hertz.

THE TRANSFORM IN f

$$X(f) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(t)\, e^{-j2\pi f t}\, dt$$
$$x(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} X(f)\, e^{j2\pi f t}\, df$$

Put $\omega = 2\pi f$. Then $d\omega = 2\pi\, df$, so the factor $1/2\pi$ of the inverse transform in ω disappears.

Five properties are used below. A shift in time multiplies the transform by a phase. A multiplication by a complex exponential shifts the transform. Convolution and multiplication trade places.

PROPERTIES

$$\begin{aligned} x(t - t_0) &\leftrightarrow X(f)\, e^{-j2\pi f t_0} \\ x(t)\, e^{j2\pi f_0 t} &\leftrightarrow X(f - f_0) \\ x(t) * y(t) &\leftrightarrow X(f)\, Y(f) \\ x(t)\, y(t) &\leftrightarrow X(f) * Y(f) \\ \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |x(t)|^2\, dt &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |X(f)|^2\, df \end{aligned}$$

The last line is Parseval's theorem: the energy is the same in both domains.

The pairs below are the ones the chapter uses. Here $\Pi(t/T)$ is 1 for $|t| < T/2$ and 0 elsewhere. The course uses $\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$ and $f_s = 1/T_s$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

PAIRS

$$\begin{aligned}
\delta(t) &\leftrightarrow 1 \\
1 &\leftrightarrow \delta(f) \\
e^{j2\pi f_0 t} &\leftrightarrow \delta(f - f_0) \\
\cos(2\pi f_0 t) &\leftrightarrow \tfrac{1}{2}\delta(f - f_0) + \tfrac{1}{2}\delta(f + f_0) \\
\Pi(t/T) &\leftrightarrow T\,\mathrm{sinc}(fT) \\
2W\,\mathrm{sinc}(2Wt) &\leftrightarrow \Pi\left(\frac{f}{2W}\right) \\
\sum_n \delta(t - nT_s) &\leftrightarrow \frac{1}{T_s}\sum_n \delta(f - nf_s)
\end{aligned}$$

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use $1 \leftrightarrow \delta(f)$, not $1 \leftrightarrow 2\pi\delta(f)$, when the ω pair $1 \leftrightarrow 2\pi\delta(\omega)$ moves to f. The reason is $\delta(2\pi f) = \delta(f)/2\pi$.

Impulse-train sampling

An ideal sampler takes one value of the message $g(t)$ every T_s seconds. The **sampling frequency** is $f_s = 1/T_s$. The sampler is modelled as a multiplication by a train of unit impulses.

IMPULSE TRAIN

$$p(t) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \delta(t - nT_s), \qquad f_s = \frac{1}{T_s}$$

The **sampled signal** is the product $g_\delta(t) = g(t)\,p(t)$. Move $g(t)$ inside the sum. Then use the sampling property $g(t)\delta(t - t_0) = g(t_0)\delta(t - t_0)$ on each term.

SAMPLED SIGNAL

$$\begin{aligned}
g_\delta(t) &= g(t)\,p(t) \\
&= g(t)\sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \delta(t - nT_s) \\
&= \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} g(t)\,\delta(t - nT_s) \\
&= \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} g(nT_s)\,\delta(t - nT_s)
\end{aligned}$$

Each impulse now carries the sample value at its own time.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

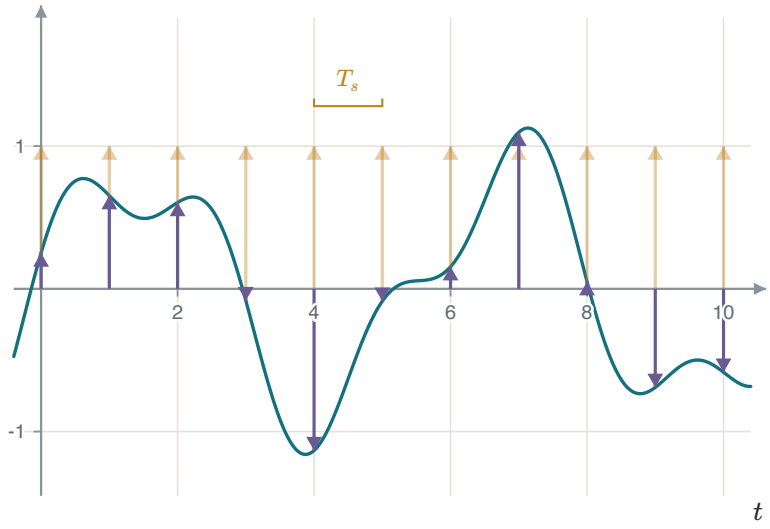


FIGURE 1.1 The message $g(t)$, the impulse train $p(t)$ behind it, and their product $g_\delta(t)$. Each impulse of g_δ has the height of the message at its sampling instant.

For example, a sampler with $T_s = 125\ \mu$s has $f_s = 1/(125 \times 10^{-6}) = 8000$ Hz, or 8 kHz.

The spectrum of a sampled signal

The sampled signal is a product in time. A product in time is a convolution in frequency, so the first step is one line.

PRODUCT IN TIME

$$G_\delta(f) = G(f) * P(f)$$

In f, no 2π appears in either pair used here: $x(t)\,y(t) \leftrightarrow X(f) * Y(f)$ and $e^{j2\pi f_0 t} \leftrightarrow \delta(f - f_0)$.

The train $p(t)$ is periodic with period T_s, so it has a Fourier series. Over one period it holds only the impulse at $t = 0$. Sifting gives $e^0 = 1$ for every coefficient c_n.

TRANSFORM OF THE TRAIN

$$c_n = \frac{1}{T_s}\int_{-T_s/2}^{T_s/2} \delta(t)\, e^{-j2\pi n f_s t}\, dt = \frac{1}{T_s}$$

$$p(t) = \frac{1}{T_s}\sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} e^{j2\pi n f_s t}$$

$$P(f) = \frac{1}{T_s}\sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \delta(f - n f_s)$$

The second pair, with $f_0 = n f_s$, transforms each term of the series.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

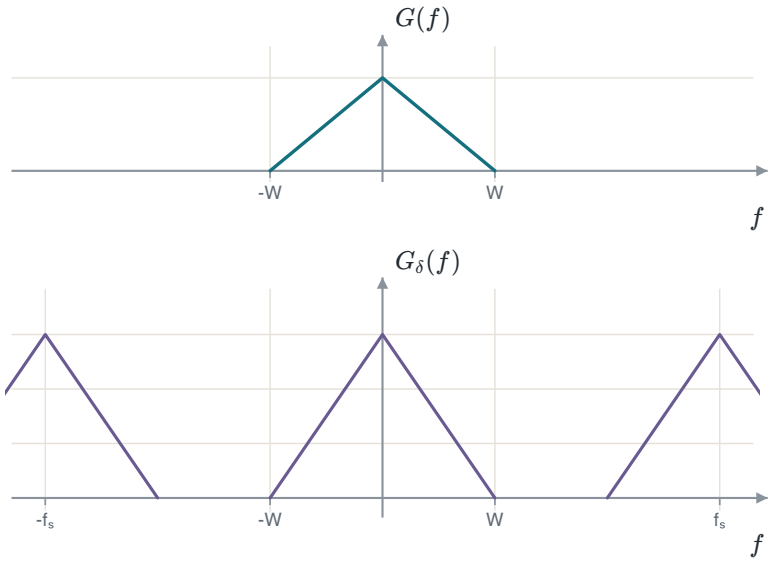


FIGURE 1.2 The message spectrum $G(f)$, and the spectrum after sampling at $f_s = 3W$. A scaled copy of $G(f)$ sits at every multiple of f_s.

For example, let $G(f) = 0$ for $|f| \geq 4$ kHz and $f_s = 10$ kHz. The copy $G(f - f_s)$ occupies $f_s - W < f < f_s + W$. So it begins at $10 - 4 = 6$ kHz.

Spectral replicas

It remains to convolve $G(f)$ with one shifted impulse. Write the convolution integral. The impulse is even, so flip the sign of its argument. Then sift at $\theta = f - nf_s$.

CONVOLUTION WITH ONE IMPULSE

$$\begin{aligned} G(f) * \delta(f - nf_s) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G(\theta)\, \delta(f - nf_s - \theta)\, d\theta \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G(\theta)\, \delta\big(\theta - (f - nf_s)\big)\, d\theta \\ &= G(f - nf_s) \end{aligned}$$

Put $P(f)$ into $G(f) * P(f)$ and convolve term by term. Each impulse of $P(f)$ places one copy of G at a multiple of f_s. The factor $1/T_s$ equals f_s.

KEY RESULT: SPECTRUM REPLICAS

$$\begin{aligned} G_\delta(f) &= \frac{1}{T_s} \sum_n G(f) * \delta(f - nf_s) \\ &= f_s \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} G(f - nf_s) \end{aligned}$$

Sampling copies the spectrum to every multiple of f_s and scales it by f_s.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

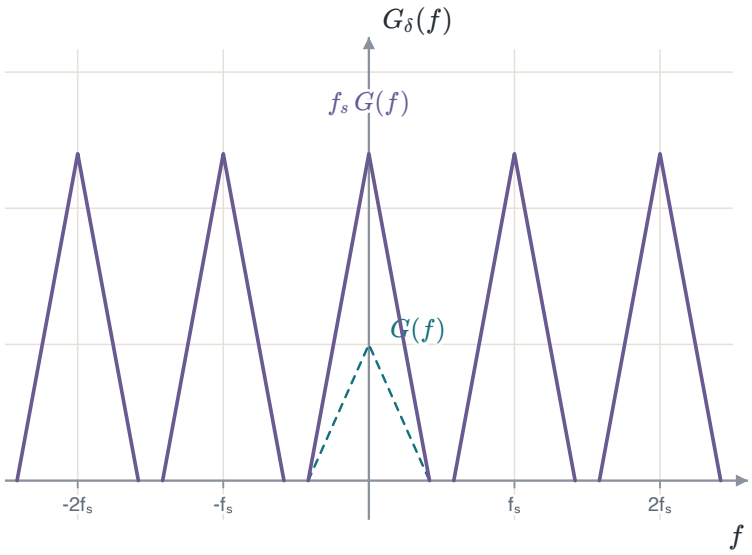


FIGURE 1.3 The message spectrum $G(f)$ (dashed) is scaled by f_s, and one copy is added for each pair of impulses at $\pm n f_s$. Copies are drawn at $\pm f_s$ and $\pm 2f_s$.

For example, let a signal be sampled at $f_s = 8$ kHz. The copy centred at f_s is $G(f - 8\ \text{kHz})$. It equals $G(1\ \text{kHz})$ where $f - 8 = 1$, that is at 9 kHz.

Three sampling rates

The copies have width $2W$ and sit f_s apart. The geometry of the copies separates three cases.

1. $f_s > 2W$: **oversampling**. A gap separates the copies.
2. $f_s = 2W$: **Nyquist sampling**. The copies touch.
3. $f_s < 2W$: **undersampling**. The copies overlap.

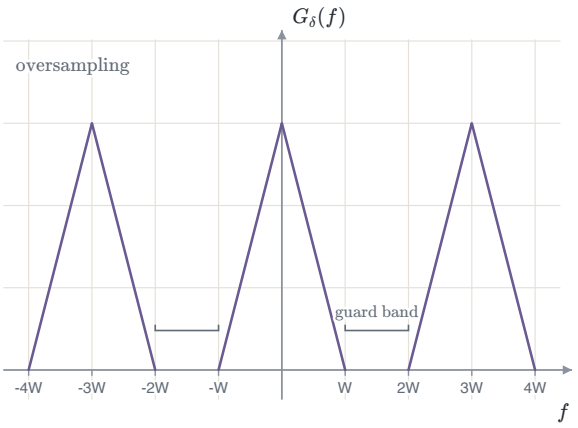


FIGURE 1.4 $f_s = 3W$: a guard band separates the copies.

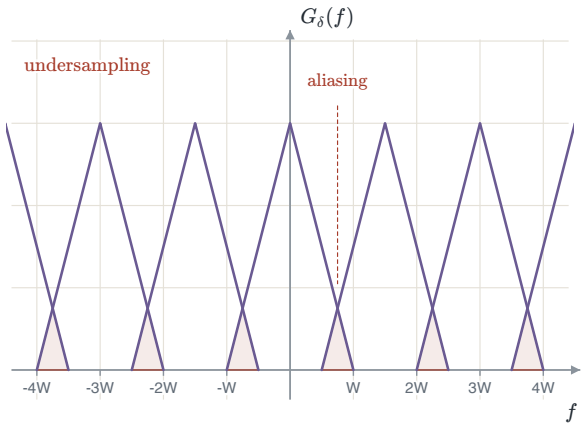


FIGURE 1.5 $f_s = 1.5W$: the copies overlap, and the overlaps (red) are aliasing.

> ⊗ ALIASING
>
> Where two copies overlap, a high message frequency lands on a low one. No filter can separate them, so the samples no longer determine the signal.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

⚠ GUARD BAND

A real signal is not strictly bandlimited. Sample at $f_s = 2W + f_g$, where f_g is a **guard band**. Filter out everything above W before the sampler.

For example, let $W = 3$ kHz and $f_s = 5$ kHz. Then $f_s < 2W = 6$ kHz. The first copy starts at $5 - 3 = 2$ kHz, inside the message band, so the copies overlap.

The sampling theorem

The three cases give the condition for exact recovery. The copies must not overlap.

ⓘ SAMPLING THEOREM

If $G(f) = 0$ for $|f| \geq W$ and $f_s \geq 2W$, the samples $g(nT_s)$ determine $g(t)$ exactly.

The copy at f_s starts at $f_s - W$. That start must not lie below the message edge W.

KEY RESULT: NYQUIST RATE

$$\begin{aligned} f_s - W &\geq W \\ f_s &\geq 2W \\ f_s^{\min} &= 2W \end{aligned}$$

The least rate $2W$ is the **Nyquist rate**.

The same condition, written for the sampling interval, gives the longest interval allowed. It is the **Nyquist interval**.

NYQUIST INTERVAL

$$\begin{aligned} T_s &= \frac{1}{f_s} \leq \frac{1}{2W} \\ T_s^{\max} &= \frac{1}{2W} \end{aligned}$$

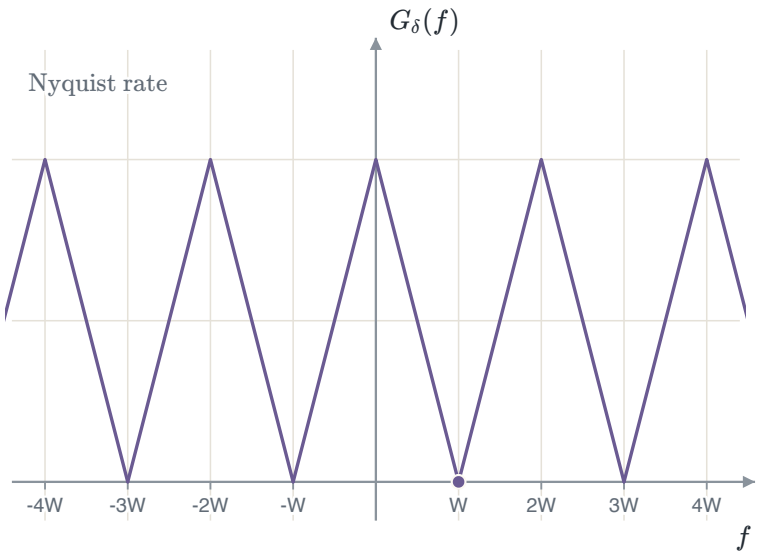


FIGURE 1.6 At $f_s = 2W$ the copies touch without overlap. A lower rate causes overlap. A higher rate leaves a gap.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

For example, telephone speech is bandlimited to $W = 3.4$ kHz. The longest sampling interval is $T_s^{\max} = 1/(2W) = 1/(6.8\ \text{kHz}) = 147\ \mu\text{s}$.

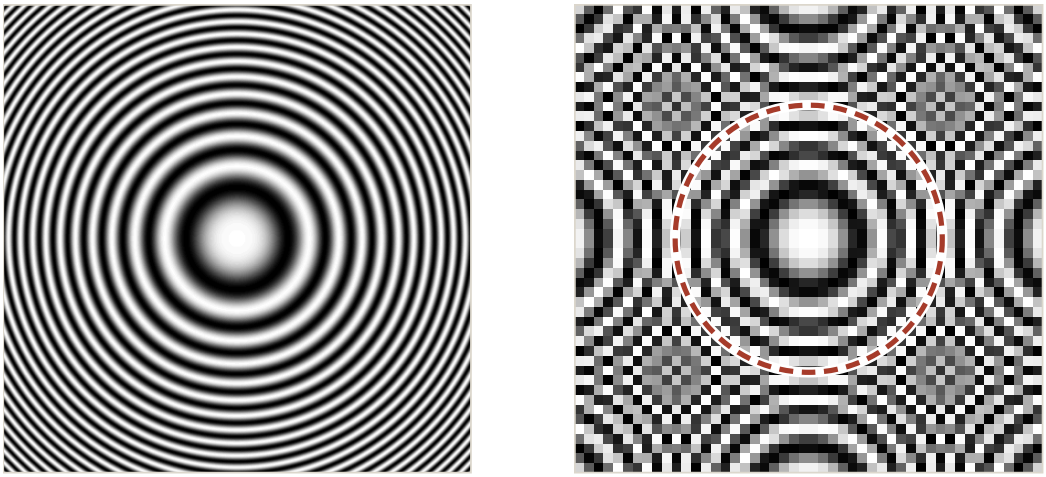
Aliasing in an image

A camera samples a scene in space with its pixels. A pattern finer than two pixels a cycle folds back into a coarser false pattern, called **moiré**.

Two pixels a cycle is the Nyquist rate in space. An image N pixels across therefore holds a pattern of spatial frequency f only up to a limit.

NO ALIASING

$$f \le \frac{N}{2} \ \text{cycles per image width}$$



the scene 48×48 samples

FIGURE 1.7 Rings that get finer toward the edge, and the same rings sampled on a 48×48 grid. Outside the red circle the rings are finer than two pixels a cycle, and false rings appear.

⚠ OPTICAL FILTER

Many cameras put a slight blur in front of the sensor. It removes detail finer than the pixels, as an anti-aliasing filter does before a sampler.

For example, an image 1000 pixels wide holds at most $N/2 = 1000/2 = 500$ cycles across its width without aliasing.

Sampling rates around us

ⓘ RATE FROM THE BAND

Each system samples above twice its highest frequency. A filter before the sampler removes anything above $f_s/2$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

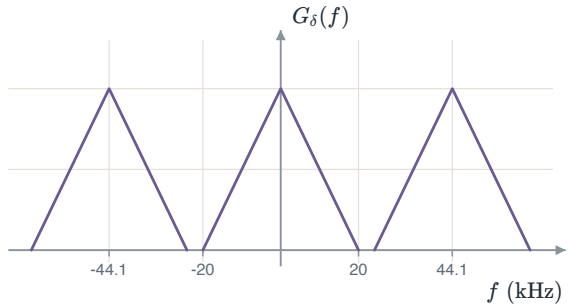


FIGURE 1.8 CD audio is sampled at 44.1 kHz. Hearing ends near 20 kHz, so a 4.1 kHz guard band remains.

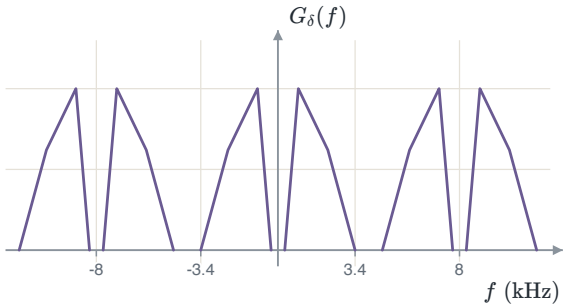


FIGURE 1.9 Telephone speech is filtered to 3.4 kHz and sampled at 8 kHz, which leaves a 1.2 kHz guard band.

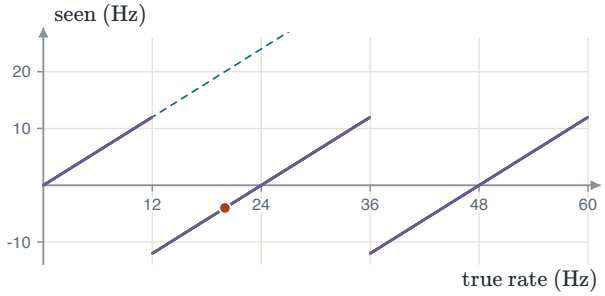


FIGURE 1.10 Film samples at 24 frames a second. A spoke pattern repeating 20 times a second appears to turn backwards at 4 a second.

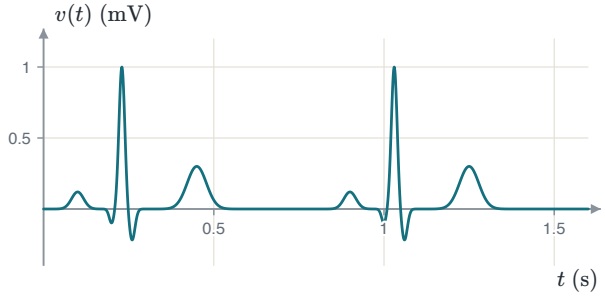


FIGURE 1.11 An electrocardiograph samples at 500 Hz. The diagnostic band ends near 150 Hz, below $f_s/2 = 250$ Hz.

> ⊗ ALIASING YOU CAN SEE
>
> A film camera has no filter before its sampler. A motion faster than half the frame rate folds back, so a wheel can appear to turn backwards.

1.2 Reconstruction

The reconstruction filter

To recover $g(t)$, keep the copy at the origin and reject all the others. An ideal lowpass filter does this.

> IDEAL LOWPASS FILTER
>
> $$H(f) = \begin{cases} T_s, & |f| \le W \\ 0, & |f| > f_s - W \end{cases}$$
>
> Between W and $f_s - W$ there is no signal energy, so the filter may do anything there.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

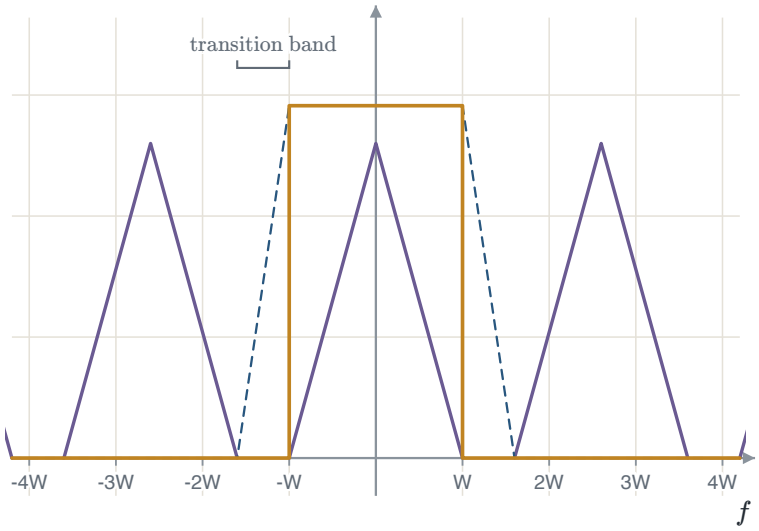


FIGURE 1.12 At $f_s = 2.6W$ the ideal filter (solid, amber) keeps the copy at the origin. A filter that can be built (dashed) falls through the gap before the next copy.

> ⚠ FILTER GAIN
>
> Sampling scales the spectrum by f_s. A gain of $T_s = 1/f_s$ removes the scale. A unit-gain filter returns f_s times the signal.

> ⓘ TRANSITION BAND
>
> Above the Nyquist rate a gap of $f_s - 2W$ opens between W and the next copy. A real filter needs this gap to roll off. The gap is the **transition band**.

For example, let $W = 4$ kHz and $f_s = 10$ kHz. The next copy starts at $f_s - W = 6$ kHz. The transition band is $6 - 4 = 2$ kHz wide.

The reconstruction filter in the time domain

At $f_s = 2W$ the gain is $T_s = 1/(2W)$. Take the inverse transform of the rectangle. Integrate, then use $e^{jx} - e^{-jx} = 2j \sin x$.

IMPULSE RESPONSE AT $f_s = 2W$

$$
\begin{aligned}
h(t) &= \int_{-W}^{W} \frac{1}{2W} e^{j2\pi f t}\, df \\
&= \frac{1}{2W} \cdot \frac{e^{j2\pi W t} - e^{-j2\pi W t}}{j2\pi t} \\
&= \frac{1}{2W} \cdot \frac{2j \sin(2\pi W t)}{j2\pi t} \\
&= \frac{\sin(2\pi W t)}{2\pi W t} \\
&= \operatorname{sinc}(2Wt)
\end{aligned}
$$

The last step uses the sinc convention of the course.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

THE SINC CONVENTION

$$\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \frac{\sin(\pi x)}{\pi x}$$

The function is one at $x = 0$ and zero at every non-zero integer.

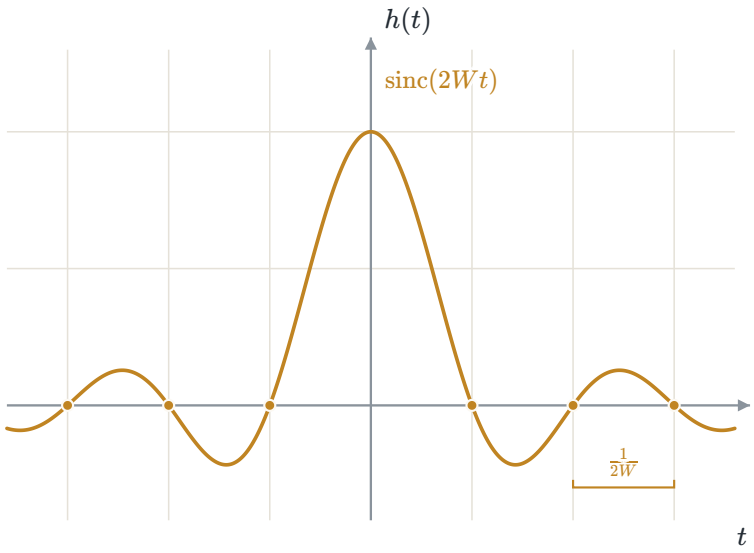


FIGURE 1.13 The pulse $\operatorname{sinc}(2Wt)$ is one at $t = 0$ and zero at every non-zero multiple of $1/(2W)$. These are the sampling instants at the Nyquist rate.

For example, let the message be bandlimited to $W = 5$ kHz. Then $\operatorname{sinc}(2Wt) = 0$ first at $2Wt = 1$. The first zero for $t > 0$ is at $t = 1/(2W) = 100$ μs.

The interpolation formula

The reconstructed signal $g_r(t)$ is the output of the filter when the input is $g_\delta(t)$. Filtering is convolution in time, with τ as the integration variable.

FILTER THE IMPULSE TRAIN

$$\begin{aligned} g_r(t) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \underbrace{\sum_n g(nT_s)\,\delta(\tau - nT_s)}_{=g_\delta(\tau)}\, h(t-\tau)\,d\tau \\ &= \sum_n g(nT_s) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} h(t-\tau)\,\delta(\tau - nT_s)\,d\tau \\ &= \sum_n g(nT_s)\, h(t - nT_s) \end{aligned}$$

The weights $g(nT_s)$ do not depend on τ, so the sum and the integral swap. Sifting then sets $\tau = nT_s$ in each term.

Substitute $h(t) = \operatorname{sinc}(2Wt)$, the filter at $f_s = 2W$, with $\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$.

KEY RESULT: INTERPOLATION FORMULA

$$g_r(t) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} g(nT_s)\,\operatorname{sinc}\big(2W(t - nT_s)\big)$$

Each sample scales one sinc pulse centred on its own sampling instant.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

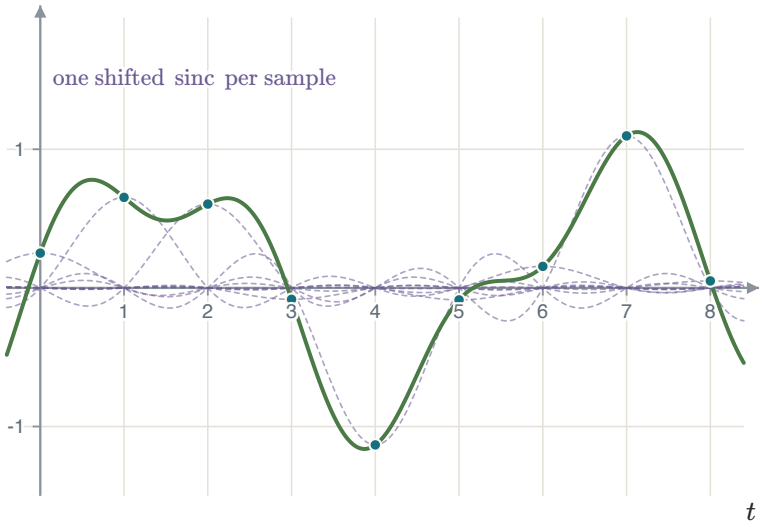


FIGURE 1.14 Each sample (cyan) scales one sinc pulse (dashed). The sum (green) passes through every sample. Here $T_s = 1$ and $2W = 1$.

For example, sample at the Nyquist rate and evaluate $g_r(t)$ at $t = 3T_s$. The term n is $g(nT_s)\,\mathrm{sinc}(3 - n)$. The sinc vanishes at every non-zero integer, so only the term $n = 3$ is non-zero.

Partial sums of the interpolation formula

At the Nyquist rate put $T_s = 1/(2W)$. Then $2WnT_s = n$, and the formula takes a shorter form.

AT THE NYQUIST RATE

$$g(t) = \sum_{n} g(nT_s)\,\mathrm{sinc}\big(2W(t - nT_s)\big)$$
$$= \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} g\Big(\frac{n}{2W}\Big)\,\mathrm{sinc}(2Wt - n)$$

VALUES AT THE SAMPLE TIMES

$h(nT_s) = \mathrm{sinc}(n) = 0$ for $n \neq 0$. So at $t = kT_s$ only the term $n = k$ survives, and $g_r(kT_s) = g(kT_s)$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

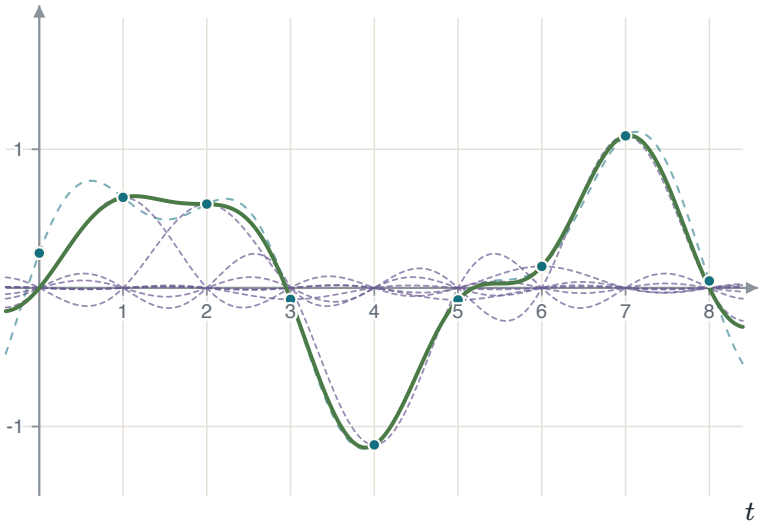


FIGURE 1.15 The partial sum of the terms $n = 1, \ldots, 7$ (green) against $g(t)$ (dashed). Each new sinc pulse corrects the sum between the samples without moving it at the samples already fitted.

> ⚠ A FINITE SUM
>
> A sum over a few samples is exact only at those samples. The error between them shrinks as more terms enter.

For example, let only one sample be non-zero: $g(0) = 1$. The sum has one term, so the formula reconstructs $1 \cdot \operatorname{sinc}(2Wt)$.

✎ EXAMPLE 1.1 — THE NYQUIST RATE, A GUARD BAND AND A MODULATED SIGNAL

GIVEN $x(t)$ is bandlimited to $W = 40$ kHz, and $y(t) = x(t)\cos(80000\pi t)$.

FIND (a) The Nyquist rate of $x(t)$. (b) The rate of $x(t)$ with a 10 kHz guard band. (c) The Nyquist rate of $y(t)$.

METHOD The Nyquist rate is $2W$, and a guard band f_g adds to it: $f_s = 2W + f_g$. For (c), find the highest frequency of y first. Modulation shifts the spectrum, so the rate follows the new band edge.

SOLUTION (a) and (b) follow from the two rules.

$$\begin{aligned} &f_s = 2W && &f_s = 2W + f_g \\ \text{(a)}\quad &= 2(40) & \text{(b)}\quad &= 80 + 10 \\ &= 80 \text{ kHz} && &= 90 \text{ kHz} \end{aligned}$$

(c) The carrier frequency comes from $2\pi f_c t = 80000\pi t$, so $f_c = 40$ kHz. Write the cosine as two exponentials. Each exponential $e^{\pm j2\pi f_c t}$ shifts the spectrum by $\pm f_c$.

$$\begin{aligned} y(t) &= x(t)\cos(2\pi f_c t) \\ &= \tfrac{1}{2}x(t)\, e^{j2\pi f_c t} + \tfrac{1}{2}x(t)\, e^{-j2\pi f_c t} \\ Y(f) &= \tfrac{1}{2}X(f - f_c) + \tfrac{1}{2}X(f + f_c) \end{aligned}$$

The highest frequency of y and its Nyquist rate follow.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

$$\begin{aligned} f_{\max} &= f_c + W & f_s &= 2f_{\max} \\ &= 40 + 40 & &= 2(80) \\ &= 80 \text{ kHz} & &= 160 \text{ kHz} \end{aligned}$$

CHECK

At 90 kHz the first copy spans $f_s - W = 50$ to $f_s + W = 130$ kHz. The gap from $W = 40$ to 50 kHz is the 10 kHz guard band. At 80 kHz the first copy starts exactly at the message edge $W = 40$ kHz.

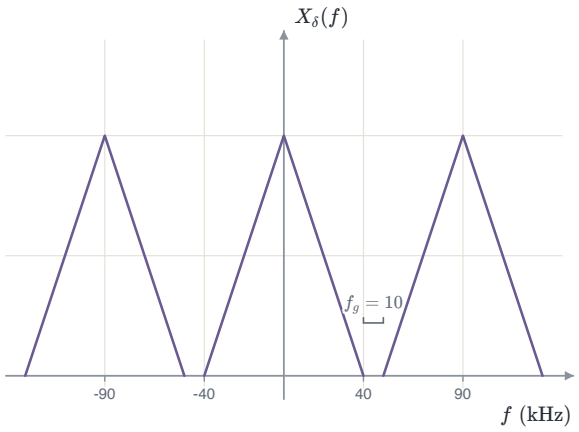


FIGURE 1.16 Parts (a) and (b): the sampled spectrum at $f_s = 90$ kHz. The first copy starts at 50 kHz and leaves a 10 kHz guard band. At $f_s = 80$ kHz it would start at 40 kHz.

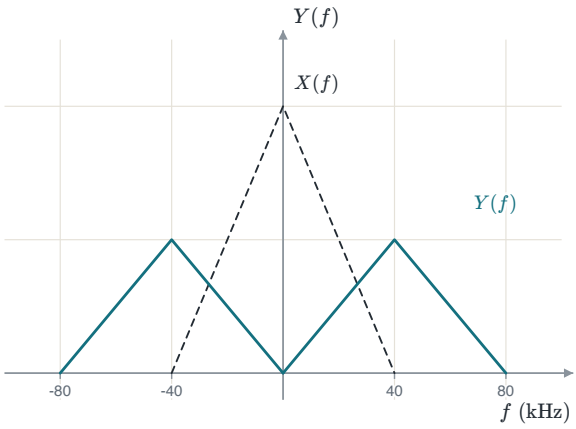


FIGURE 1.17 Part (c): $X(f)$ (dashed) and the two half-height copies that make $Y(f)$. The band edge of $Y(f)$ is 80 kHz.

COMMON ERROR

The rate 80 kHz belongs to x. Modulation moves the highest frequency to 80 kHz, so y needs 160 kHz.

Reconstruction around us

A HOLD, NOT A SINC

A converter cannot build the ideal filter. It holds each sample for T_s, then smooths the staircase with an analog filter.

A hold of length T_s has a rectangular impulse response, and a rectangle transforms to a sinc. Here $\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$.

TRANSFORM PAIR

$$h_0(t) = 1,\ 0 \le t < T_s \ \leftrightarrow\ T_s \operatorname{sinc}(fT_s)\, e^{-j\pi f T_s}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

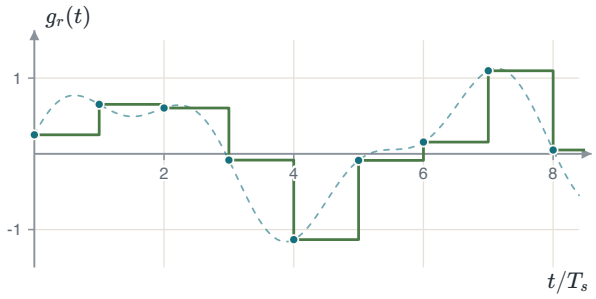


FIGURE 1.18 A zero-order hold keeps each sample until the next one. The output is a staircase.

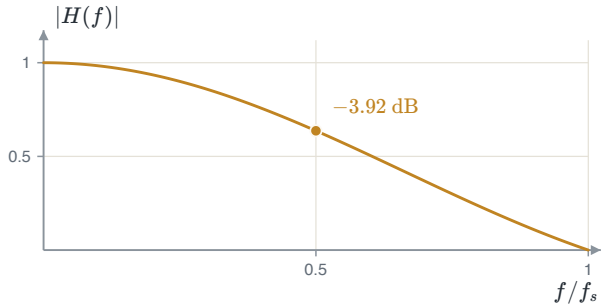


FIGURE 1.19 The hold is a filter with gain $|\operatorname{sinc}(f/f_s)|$. It falls to $2/\pi$ at $f_s/2$.

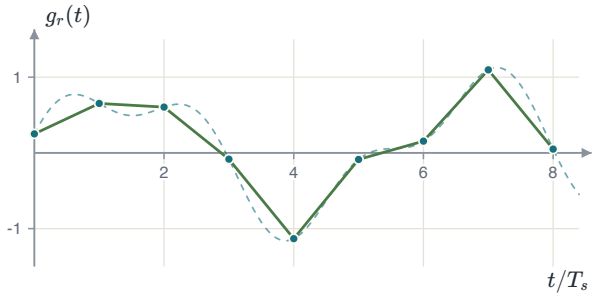


FIGURE 1.20 Joining the samples by straight lines is a filter with a triangular impulse response. It is smoother than the hold, but still not a sinc.

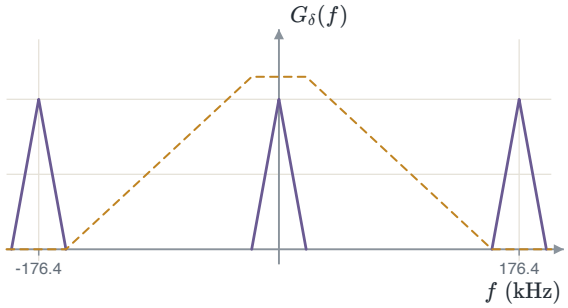


FIGURE 1.21 Oversampling CD audio by four moves the first copy to 156.4 kHz. A gentle filter (dashed) then removes it.

> ⚠ HOLD DROOP
>
> The hold weights the spectrum by $\operatorname{sinc}(f/f_s)$. At $f_s/2$ that is $2/\pi$, a loss of 3.92 dB.

1.3 Quantization

Uniform quantization

> ⓘ QUANTIZATION
>
> Quantization replaces each sample by the nearest of L **representation levels**. In a **uniform** quantizer the levels are equally spaced.

The L levels share the full range $[-m_{\max}, m_{\max}]$ equally. The spacing is the **step size** Δ.

> STEP SIZE
>
> $$\Delta = \frac{2m_{\max}}{L}$$
>
> For a range $[m_{\min}, m_{\max}]$ the step is $\Delta = (m_{\max} - m_{\min})/L$.

> ⓘ MID-RISE
>
> A decision boundary sits at zero. With L even, the levels are $\pm\Delta/2, \pm 3\Delta/2, \ldots$ and none of them is zero.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

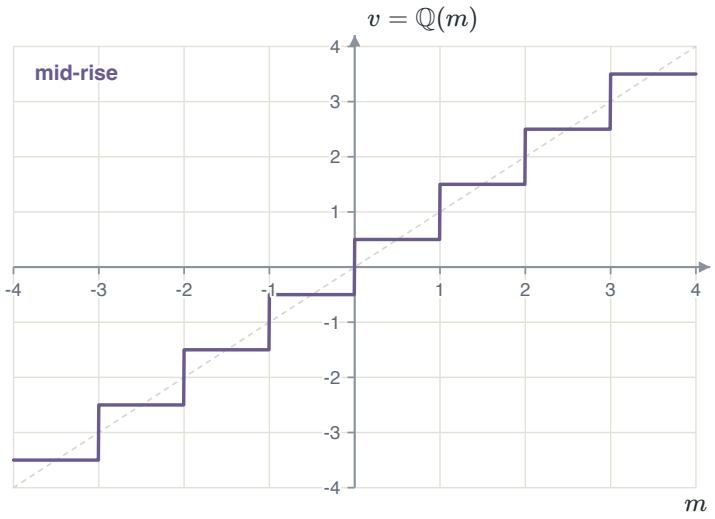


FIGURE 1.22 A mid-rise quantizer with $L = 8$ and $\Delta = 1$. A boundary sits at the origin, so the output steps through $\pm\Delta/2$.

For example, a mid-rise quantizer with $\Delta = 1$ maps $m = 0.2$ to 0.5. The input lies in the region $(0, 1]$, whose level is its midpoint 0.5.

Mid-rise and mid-tread

Uniform quantizers come in two families. They differ in what they do at zero.

TABLE 1.1 The two families of uniform quantizer.

FAMILY	AT ZERO	A SMALL INPUT
Mid-rise	a boundary	goes to $\pm\Delta/2$
Mid-tread	a level	goes to exactly 0

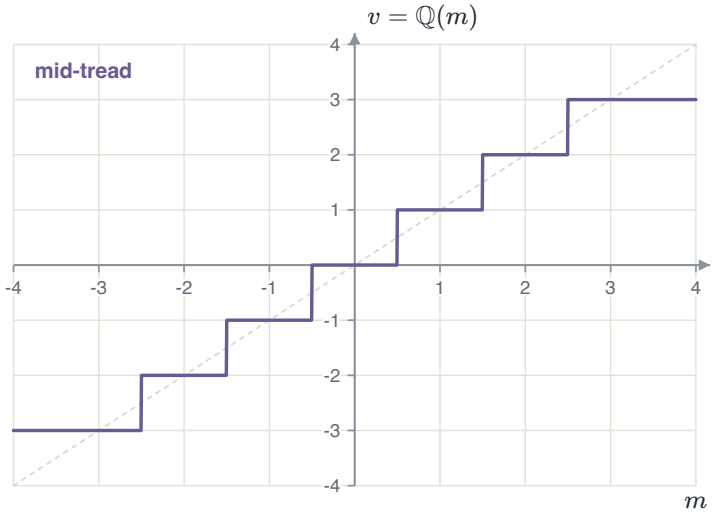


FIGURE 1.23 A mid-tread quantizer with $\Delta = 1$. A tread is a flat step of the staircase. A level sits at the origin, and the tread around zero is one step wide.

> ⚠ SILENCE
>
> A mid-rise quantizer turns a silent input with a little noise into a signal of $\pm\Delta/2$. A mid-tread quantizer keeps it silent.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

For example, a mid-tread quantizer with $\Delta = 1$ maps $m = 0.2$ to 0. The tread around zero covers $|m| < 0.5$, and its level is 0.

A sampled signal through the quantizer

A converter samples first and quantizes second. Each sample passes through three steps.

1. Sample: read $m(nT_s)$ off the signal.
2. Find the region: the sample lies between two boundaries of the staircase.
3. Output: the level of that region, $v[n] = \mathbb{Q}\big(m(nT_s)\big)$.

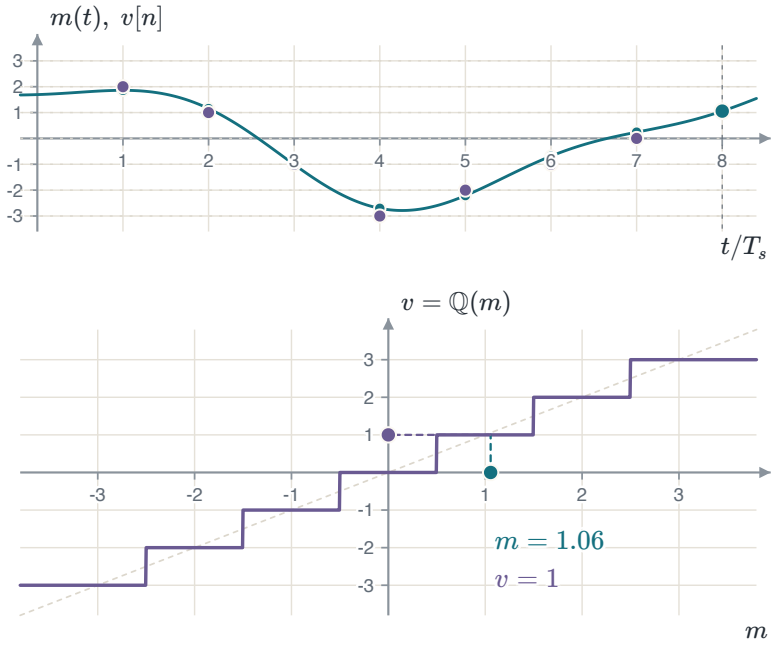


FIGURE 1.24 Eight samples $m(nT_s)$ (cyan) enter the mid-tread quantizer with $\Delta = 1$ and leave as the levels $v[n]$ (violet). The lower panel follows the eighth sample across the staircase.

> ⚠ MANY INPUTS, ONE LEVEL
>
> Every input between 1.5 and 2.5 leaves as 2. The output keeps the region and loses the exact value.

For example, the same quantizer maps the sample $m(nT_s) = 1.62$ to $v[n] = 2$. The sample lies between the boundaries 1.5 and 2.5.

The quantizer as a function

A quantizer is a function of its input. Its **boundaries** m_k cut the range into L regions. Region k is the interval $m_{k-1} < m \le m_k$, and its level is v_k.

QUANTIZER FUNCTION

$$\mathbb{Q}(m) = v_k \quad \text{for} \quad m_{k-1} < m \le m_k$$

An optimal quantizer meets two conditions.

1. Each boundary is the midpoint of its two levels: $m_k = \frac{1}{2}(v_k + v_{k+1})$. Every input then goes to the nearer level.
2. Each level is the centroid of its region: $v_k = E[M \mid M \in \text{region } k]$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

A quantizer that meets both conditions is the **Lloyd–Max quantizer**.

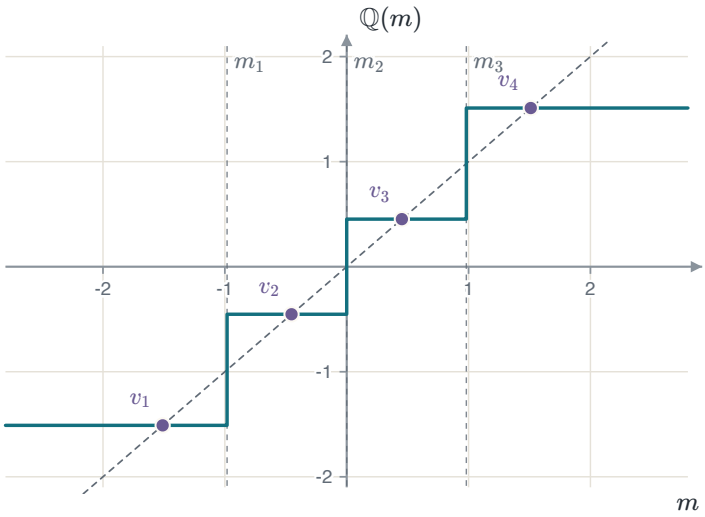


FIGURE 1.25 The best four-level quantizer for a Gaussian input. The steps widen in the tails, where the input is rare. Each boundary m_k lies midway between two levels.

> UNIFORM INPUT
>
> A uniform quantizer always meets the midpoint condition. For a uniform input it meets the centroid condition too, so it is optimal.

For example, let two neighbouring levels be $v_1 = 1$ and $v_2 = 3$. The midpoint condition puts the boundary between them at $\frac{1}{2}(1 + 3) = 2$.

Overload and granular noise

A quantizer spanning $[-m_{\max}, m_{\max}]$ makes two kinds of error. The choice of $m_{\max}$ trades one against the other.

TABLE 1.2 The two errors of a quantizer.

ERROR	WHERE	SIZE
Overload	an input beyond $\pm m_{\max}$, clipped to the outer level	no bound
Granular noise	an input inside the range	$\lvert q \rvert \le \Delta/2$, larger for a wider range

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

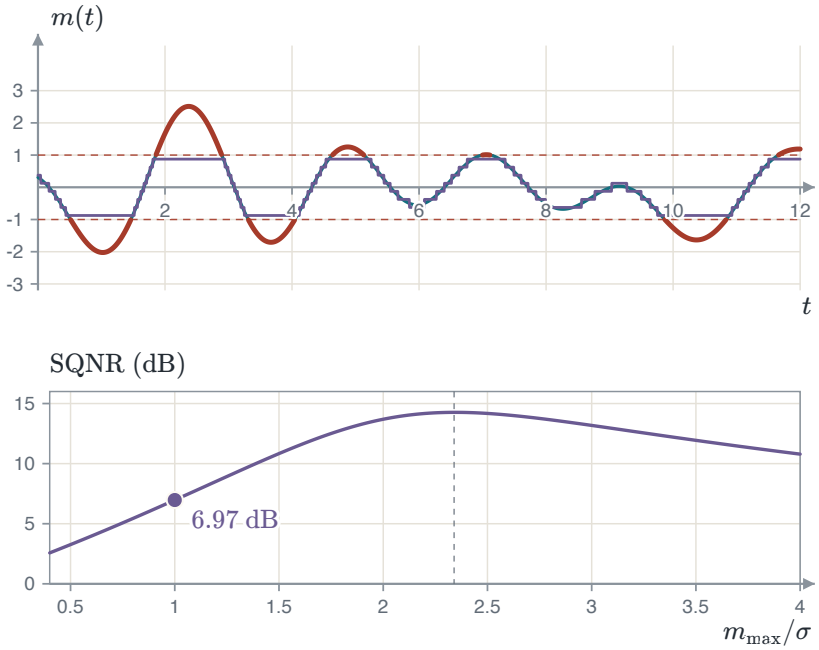


FIGURE 1.26 A signal with rare large peaks through a 3-bit quantizer spanning $[-m_{\max}, m_{\max}]$ with $m_{\max} = \sigma$. Red marks the clipped peaks. The lower curve is the SQNR of a Gaussian input against the range, and the dot sits at $m_{\max} = \sigma$.

THE BEST RANGE

For a Gaussian input and 3 bits the SQNR peaks at $m_{\max} = 2.34\sigma$, with 14.27 dB. A few clipped peaks cost less than a coarser step.

COMMON ERROR

Set $m_{\max}$ from the rare peaks of the signal, not from its typical size. At $m_{\max} = \sigma$ the SQNR falls to 6.97 dB.

For example, set a 3-bit quantizer to $m_{\max} = \sigma$ for a Gaussian input. About 32% of the samples lie outside $\pm\sigma$, and each of them is clipped. Overload then dominates.

Quantizers around us

EVERY READING IS A LEVEL

A digital display shows one of a finite set of values. A change smaller than one step leaves the reading unchanged.

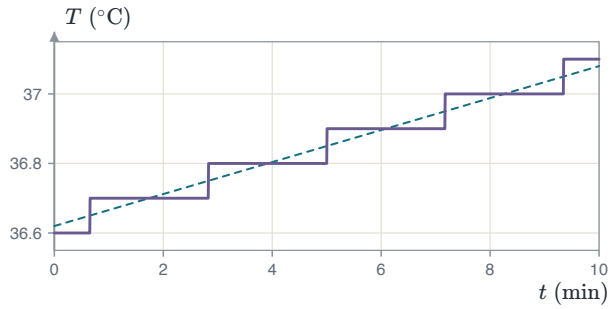


FIGURE 1.27 A clinical thermometer shows 0.1 °C steps. The reading jumps only when the temperature crosses a boundary.

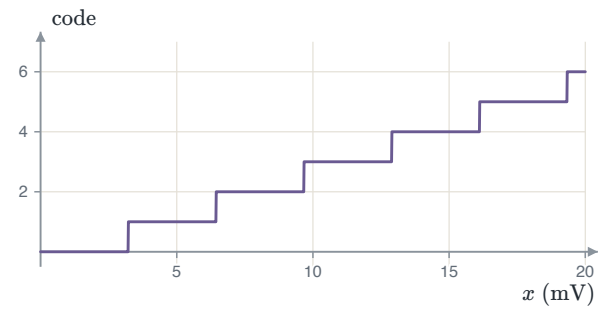


FIGURE 1.28 A 10-bit converter over 3.3 V has $\Delta = 3.3/1024 = 3.22$ mV. Inputs inside one step share one code.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

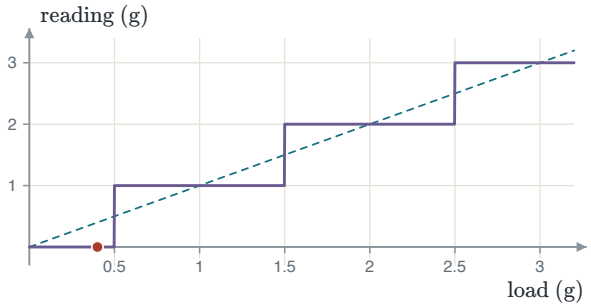


FIGURE 1.29 A kitchen scale reads in 1 g steps and rounds. A 0.4 g feather reads 0: the scale is a mid-tread quantizer.

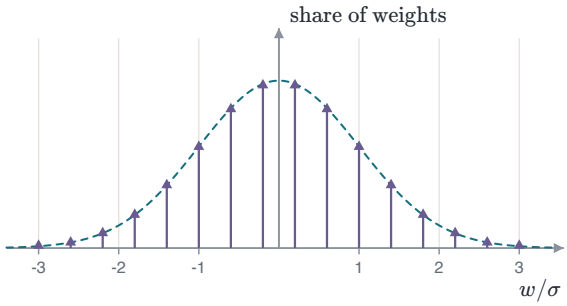


FIGURE 1.30 A language model with 70×10^9 weights needs 140 GB at 16 bits. At 4 bits each weight is rounded to one of $2^4 = 16$ levels, and the model needs about 35 GB.

> A LEVEL AT ZERO
>
> A display that rounds is mid-tread, so an empty scale reads exactly zero. A converter that truncates puts a boundary at each code edge.

1.4 Quantization noise and SQNR

Probability review

This section treats the quantization error as a random variable. A **random variable** X is described by its **density** $f_X(x)$. A density is never negative and has total area 1. The probability of an interval is the area under the density over that interval.

The **expectation** weights each value by its density. The same rule gives the expectation of any function $g(X)$, with no new density.

DENSITY AND EXPECTATION

$$P(a < X \le b) = \int_a^b f_X(x)\,dx$$
$$E[X] = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x\, f_X(x)\,dx$$
$$E[g(X)] = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} g(x)\, f_X(x)\,dx$$

The **power** of X is its mean-square value. The **variance** is the power of X about its mean $\mu_X = E[X]$. Expand the square and take the expectation term by term: $E[X^2] - 2\mu_X E[X] + \mu_X^2 = E[X^2] - \mu_X^2$.

POWER AND VARIANCE

$$P_X = E[X^2]$$
$$\sigma_X^2 = E\left[(X - \mu_X)^2\right]$$
$$= E[X^2] - \mu_X^2$$

Two densities appear below. The uniform density $U(a, b)$ is flat on (a, b). The Gaussian density $\mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$ is the bell curve with mean μ and variance σ^2.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TWO DENSITIES

$$U(a,b):\ f_X(x)=\frac{1}{b-a},\quad a<x<b$$
$$\mu_X=\frac{a+b}{2},\quad \sigma_X^2=\frac{(b-a)^2}{12}$$
$$\mathcal{N}(\mu,\sigma^2):\ f_X(x)=\frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma^2}}\,e^{-(x-\mu)^2/2\sigma^2}$$
$$P\big(|X-\mu|>\sigma\big)=2Q(1)=0.317$$

$Q(x)$ is the Gaussian tail. So about 32% of Gaussian samples lie outside $\pm\sigma$.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use $P_X=E[X^2]$, not σ_X^2, for the power of a signal with a non-zero mean. The two are equal only when $\mu_X=0$.

Quantization noise

The **quantization error** is the difference between the input and its level.

QUANTIZATION ERROR

$$q=m-\mathbb{Q}(m)$$

Inside the range, v_k is the midpoint of a region Δ wide. The input cannot lie farther from the midpoint than half the region.

BOUND

$$\begin{aligned}|q|&=|m-v_k|\\&\le\tfrac{1}{2}(m_k-m_{k-1})\\&=\frac{\Delta}{2}\end{aligned}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

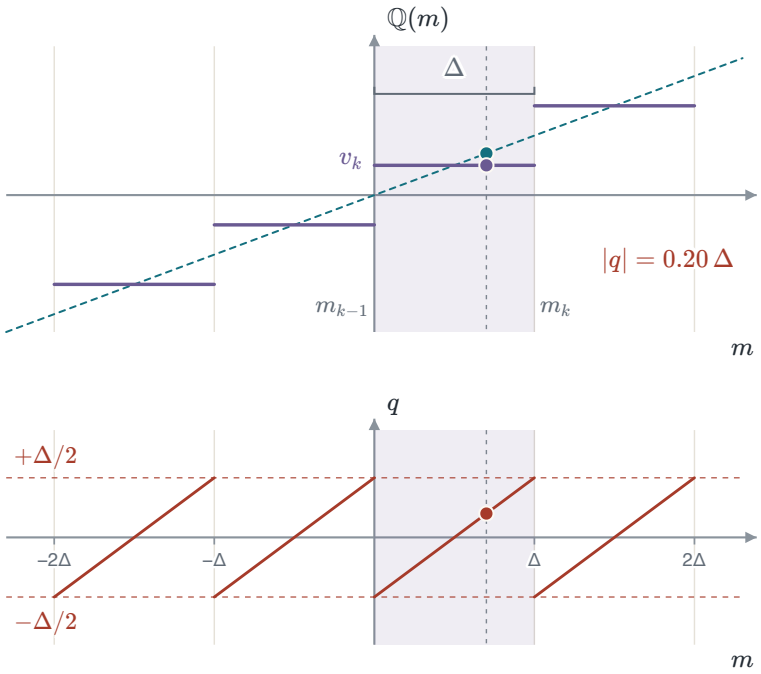


FIGURE 1.31 The error is the gap between the line $v = m$ and the staircase, shown at $m = 0.7\Delta$. It is largest at a boundary, where it equals $\Delta/2$.

> UNIFORM MODEL
>
> For a small Δ the input density is nearly flat across one region. The error is then modelled as $Q \sim U(-\Delta/2, \Delta/2)$.

For example, a quantizer with $\Delta = 1.25$ whose input stays inside its range has $|q| \le \Delta/2 = 0.625$.

The power of quantization noise

The power of the error is its mean-square value $E[Q^2]$. Under the uniform model the error density is $f_Q(q) = 1/\Delta$ on $[-\Delta/2, \Delta/2]$. Write the expectation as an integral and evaluate the antiderivative at its limits.

MEAN-SQUARE ERROR

$$\begin{aligned} E[Q^2] &= \int_{-\Delta/2}^{\Delta/2} q^2 \, \frac{1}{\Delta} \, dq \\ &= \frac{1}{\Delta}\left[\frac{q^3}{3}\right]_{-\Delta/2}^{\Delta/2} \\ &= \frac{1}{3\Delta}\left(\frac{\Delta^3}{8} + \frac{\Delta^3}{8}\right) \\ &= \frac{\Delta^2}{12} \end{aligned}$$

The lower limit gives $(-\Delta/2)^3 = -\Delta^3/8$, which is subtracted.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

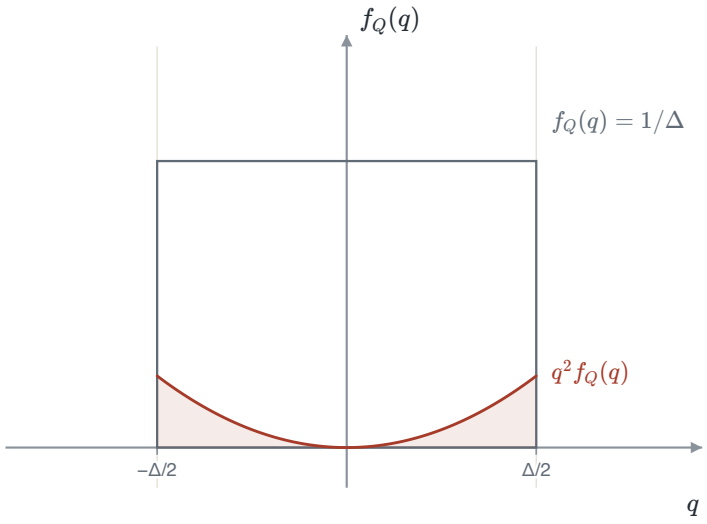


FIGURE 1.32 The uniform error density, and $q^2 f_Q(q)$ shaded. The shaded area is the noise power $E[Q^2]$.

For example, a fine uniform quantizer with $\Delta = 0.5$ has $E[Q^2] = \Delta^2/12 = 0.25/12 = 0.0208$.

Quantization noise in bits

An R-bit quantizer has $L = 2^R$ levels. Substitute $\Delta = 2m_{\max}/L$ and $L = 2^R$ into $E[Q^2] = \Delta^2/12$.

IN BITS

$$\begin{aligned} E[Q^2] &= \frac{\Delta^2}{12} \\ &= \frac{1}{12}\left(\frac{2m_{\max}}{2^R}\right)^2 \\ &= \frac{1}{12} \cdot \frac{4m_{\max}^2}{2^{2R}} \\ &= \frac{m_{\max}^2}{3 \cdot 2^{2R}} \end{aligned}$$

ONE BIT, A QUARTER

Each extra bit halves Δ and divides the noise power by four.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

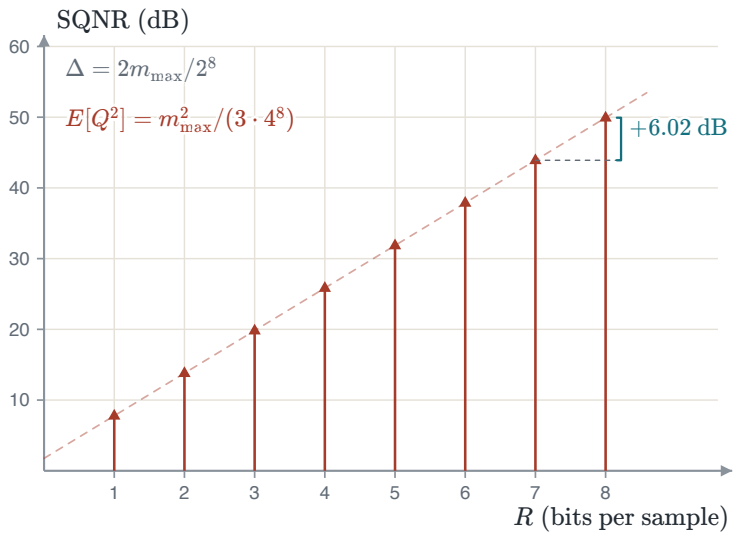


FIGURE 1.33 The SQNR of a full-scale sinusoid for $R = 1, \ldots, 8$. Each added bit halves Δ, divides $E[Q^2]$ by four, and lifts the SQNR by $10 \log_{10} 4 = 6.02$ dB.

For example, a fine quantizer that goes from $R = 6$ to $R = 7$ bits divides $E[Q^2]$ by 4. The noise power is proportional to 2^{-2R}, and $2^2 = 4$.

Signal-to-quantization-noise ratio

The **signal-to-quantization-noise ratio** (SQNR) compares the power P_M of the message with the power of the error. Substitute $E[Q^2] = m_{\max}^2/(3 \cdot 2^{2R})$.

UNIFORM QUANTIZER

$$\begin{aligned} \text{SQNR} &= \frac{P_M}{E[Q^2]} \\ &= \frac{3P_M}{m_{\max}^2}\, 2^{2R} \end{aligned}$$

In decibels the product becomes a sum, because the log of a product is a sum of logs. The factor 2^{2R} gives $20R \log_{10} 2$, and $20 \log_{10} 2 = 6.02$.

KEY RESULT: SIX DECIBELS A BIT

$$\begin{aligned} \text{SQNR [dB]} &= \underbrace{10 \log_{10} \frac{3P_M}{m_{\max}^2}}_{=\alpha} + 10 \log_{10} 2^{2R} \\ &= \alpha + 20R \log_{10} 2 \\ &= \alpha + 6.02R \end{aligned}$$

Every extra bit adds 6.02 dB.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

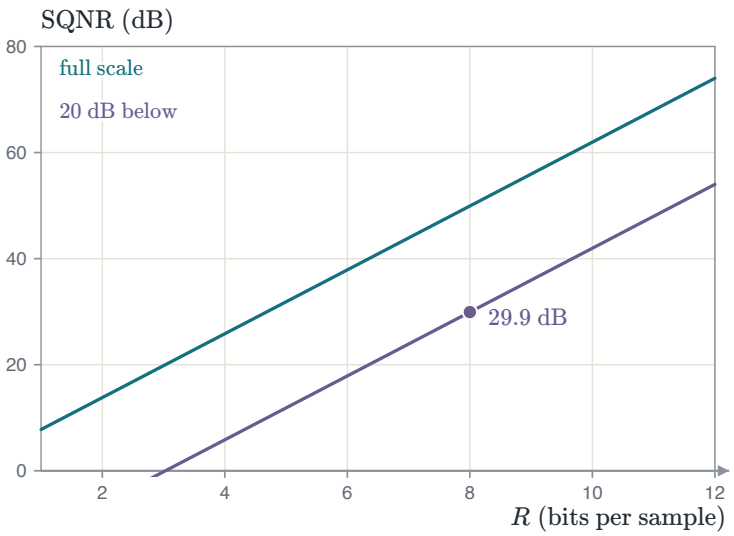


FIGURE 1.34 The SQNR of a full-scale sinusoid (cyan) and of the same sinusoid 20 dB below full scale (violet). The line keeps its slope of 6.02 dB a bit and drops by the level.

For example, a quantizer that gives 40 dB at $R = 6$ gives 52.04 dB at $R = 8$. Two more bits add $2(6.02) = 12.04$ dB.

SQNR of a random variable and of a signal

The SQNR is a ratio of two powers. For a random variable M quantized to $\mathbb{Q}(M)$, both powers are expected values.

RANDOM VARIABLE

$$\mathrm{SQNR} = \frac{E[M^2]}{E\big[(M - \mathbb{Q}(M))^2\big]}$$

For a signal $m(t)$ quantized to $\mathbb{Q}(m(t))$, both powers are time averages over the whole time axis.

SIGNAL

$$\mathrm{SQNR} = \frac{\lim\limits_{T\to\infty} \dfrac{1}{T} \displaystyle\int_{-T/2}^{T/2} m^2(t)\, dt}{\lim\limits_{T\to\infty} \dfrac{1}{T} \displaystyle\int_{-T/2}^{T/2} \big(m(t) - \mathbb{Q}(m(t))\big)^2\, dt}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

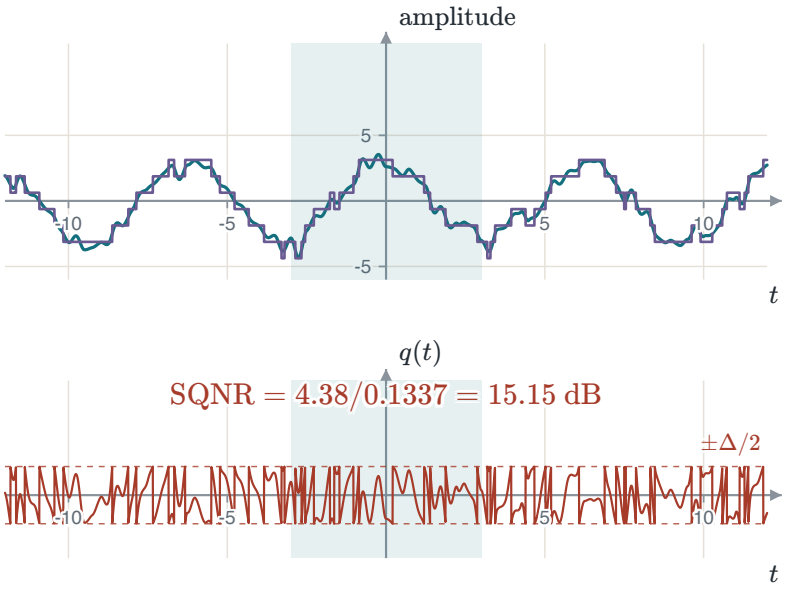


FIGURE 1.35 A sinusoid with Gaussian noise on it, through a 3-bit quantizer spanning $[-5, 5]$, averaged over the window $T = 6$ s (shaded). The ratio of the two time averages settles as T grows.

> **THE NOISY SINUSOID**
>
> Here $m(t) = 3\cos t + n(t)$, with $n(t)$ Gaussian of variance 0.36. As $T \to \infty$ the numerator tends to $P_M = 4.5 + 0.36 = 4.86$. The uniform error model puts the denominator at $\Delta^2/12$.

EXAMPLE 1.2 — SQNR OF A SINUSOID

GIVEN $m(t) = 5\cos t$, and a uniform quantizer over its full range with $R = 3$.

FIND The step size and the SQNR.

METHOD Find the signal power and the step size. The noise power is $\Delta^2/12$, and the SQNR is the ratio of the two powers. A sinusoid of peak A has power $A^2/2$.

SOLUTION The range $[-5, 5]$ is 10 wide, and $R = 3$ gives $L = 2^3 = 8$ levels.

$$P_M = \tfrac{1}{2}(5)^2 = 12.5$$

$$\Delta = \frac{2(5)}{2^3} = 1.25$$

Divide the signal power by the noise power.

$$E[Q^2] = \frac{1.25^2}{12} = 0.1302$$

$$\mathrm{SQNR} = 10\log_{10}\frac{12.5}{0.1302} = 19.82 \text{ dB}$$

CHECK The rule gives the same value: $\alpha = 10\log_{10} 1.5 = 1.76$ dB and $1.76 + 6.02(3) = 19.82$ dB. Measured on the waveform the SQNR is 19.09 dB, since three bits is a coarse quantizer.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

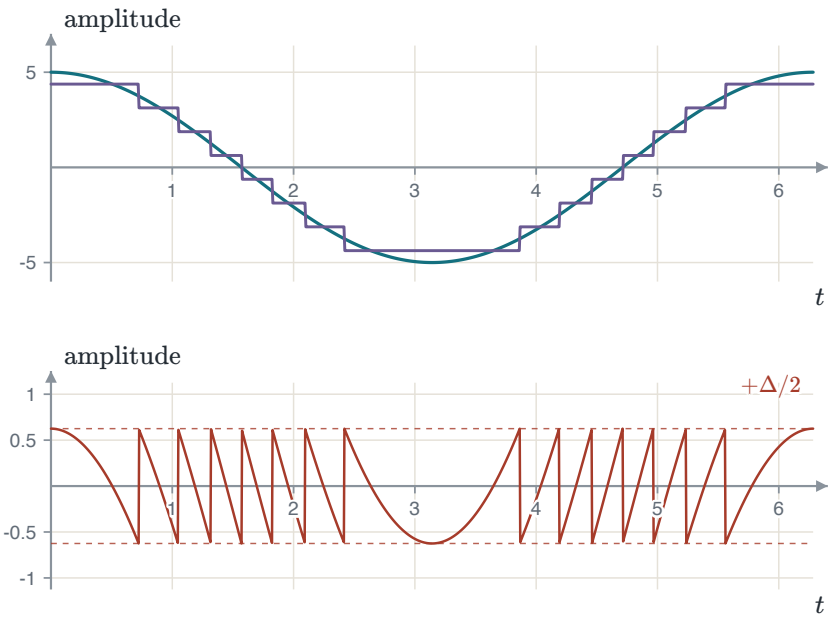


FIGURE 1.36 $m(t) = 5\cos t$ through a 3-bit quantizer spanning $[-5, 5]$, and the error below it. The error stays between $-\Delta/2$ and $\Delta/2$.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $\Delta = 2m_{\max}/L$, not $m_{\max}/L$. The full range is $2m_{\max} = 10$ V.

EXAMPLE 1.3 — SQNR OF A UNIFORM SOURCE

GIVEN $M \sim U(-1, 1)$, and a uniform quantizer with $L = 256$.

FIND The SQNR.

METHOD Compute the two powers. The signal power comes from the density $f_M(m) = \frac{1}{2}$ on $[-1, 1]$. The noise power is $\Delta^2/12$ with $\Delta = 2/256 = 1/128$.

SOLUTION Integrate $m^2 f_M(m)$ and evaluate the antiderivative at its limits.

$$P_M = \int_{-1}^{1} \tfrac{1}{2} m^2 \, dm = \tfrac{1}{2}\left[\frac{m^3}{3}\right]_{-1}^{1} = \tfrac{1}{2} \cdot \tfrac{2}{3} = \tfrac{1}{3}$$

Then the noise power and the ratio follow.

$$E[Q^2] = \frac{(1/128)^2}{12} = \frac{1}{196\,608}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{SQNR} &= \tfrac{1}{3}(196\,608) \\ &= 65\,536 = 2^{16} \\ &= 48.16 \text{ dB} \end{aligned}$$

CHECK Each region holds a flat piece of the input density, so the error is exactly $U(-\Delta/2, \Delta/2)$. The result is $6.02(8)$ dB, so $\alpha = 0$ for this source.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

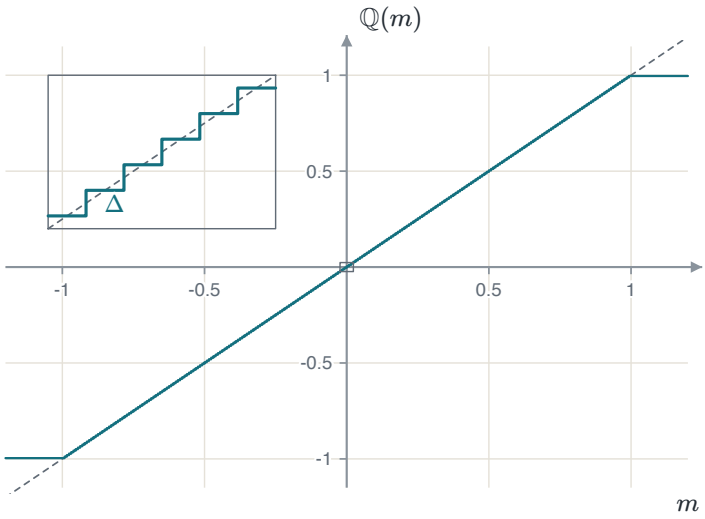


FIGURE 1.37 The 256-level quantizer on $[-1, 1]$. At full scale the steps are too fine to see. The inset enlarges the six around the origin.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $\Delta = 2/256$, not $1/256$. The range $[-1, 1]$ is 2 wide.

EXAMPLE 1.4 — SQNR OF A GAUSSIAN SOURCE

GIVEN A zero-mean stationary Gaussian source has $S_X(f) = 2$ for $|f| < 100$ Hz. Its samples enter a quantizer with five levels $0, \pm 10, \pm 30$ and boundaries $\pm 20, \pm 40$.

FIND The SQNR.

METHOD The signal power is the area under the power spectral density. The quantizer is coarse and its outer regions are unbounded, so the noise power is integrated region by region.

SOLUTION The signal power is the area under S_X, not its height.

$$P_X = \int_{-100}^{100} 2\, df = 2(200) = 400$$

The mean is zero, so 400 is also the variance, and $f_X(x)$ is Gaussian with $\sigma = 20$. The density $f_X(x)$ is even, so each side region has a twin. The integrals are evaluated numerically.

$$\begin{aligned} P_Q &= \int_{-20}^{20} x^2 f_X(x)\, dx + 2\int_{20}^{40} (x-10)^2 f_X(x)\, dx + 2\int_{40}^{\infty} (x-30)^2 f_X(x)\, dx \\ &= 79.50 + 2(46.36) + 2(7.98) = 188.17 \end{aligned}$$

$$\mathrm{SQNR} = 10 \log_{10} \frac{400}{188.17} = 3.28 \text{ dB}$$

CHECK The five areas of the error integrand add to $79.50 + 92.72 + 15.96 = 188.18$, which is 188.17 before rounding. The ratio $400/188.17 = 2.126$, and $10 \log_{10} 2.126 = 3.28$ dB.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

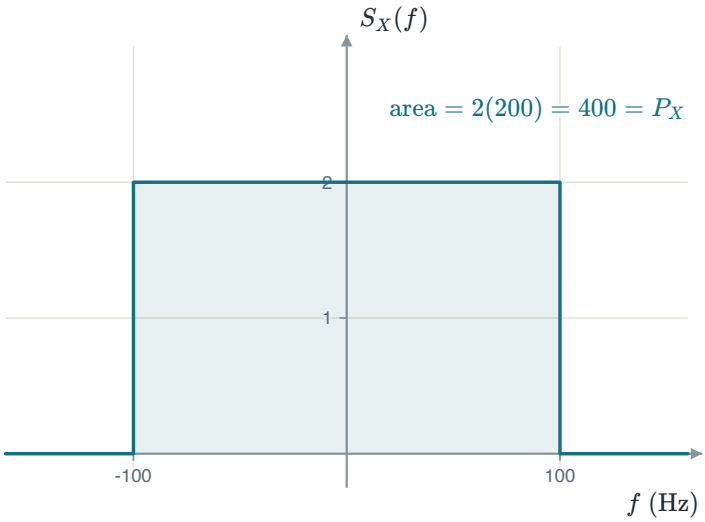


FIGURE 1.38 The power spectral density $S_X(f) = 2$ for $|f| < 100$ Hz. Its area, $2(200) = 400$, is the signal power P_X.

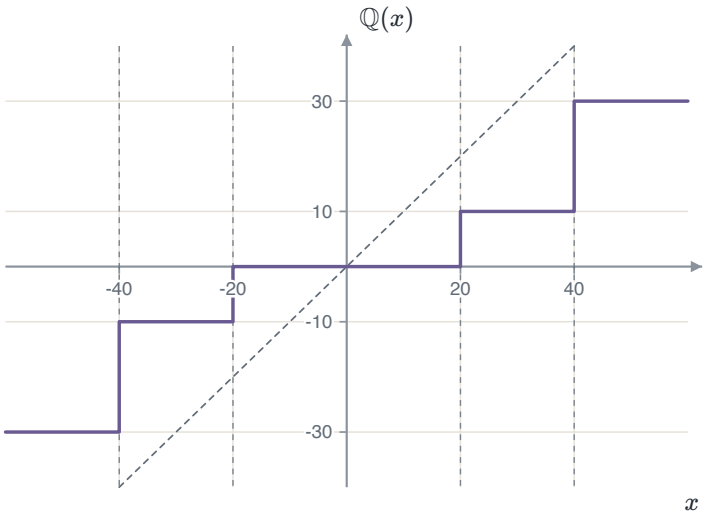


FIGURE 1.39 The five-level quantizer: outputs $0, \pm 10, \pm 30$ and boundaries $\pm 20, \pm 40$. The dashed line is $y = x$.

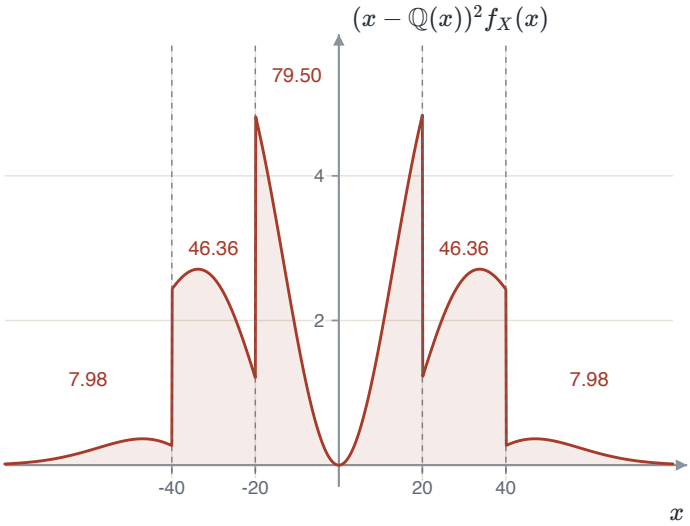


FIGURE 1.40 The error integrand $(x - \mathbb{Q}(x))^2 f_X(x)$, region by region. The five areas add to the noise power $P_Q = 188.17$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Using $\Delta^2/12 = 33.3$ gives 10.8 dB, 7.5 dB too high. That model holds only for a small Δ and an input inside the range.

One rule, three sources

Every source gains 6.02 dB a bit. The source sets only the intercept, $\alpha = 10\log_{10}(3P_M/m_{\max}^2)$. Three sources at full range give three intercepts.

THREE INTERCEPTS

$$\begin{aligned} \text{sinusoid:} \quad & 10\log_{10}\frac{3(A^2/2)}{A^2} = 1.76 \text{ dB} \\ \text{uniform:} \quad & 10\log_{10}\frac{3(1/3)}{1} = 0 \text{ dB} \\ \text{Gaussian, } m_{\max} = 4\sigma\text{:} \quad & 10\log_{10}\frac{3\sigma^2}{16\sigma^2} = -7.27 \text{ dB} \end{aligned}$$

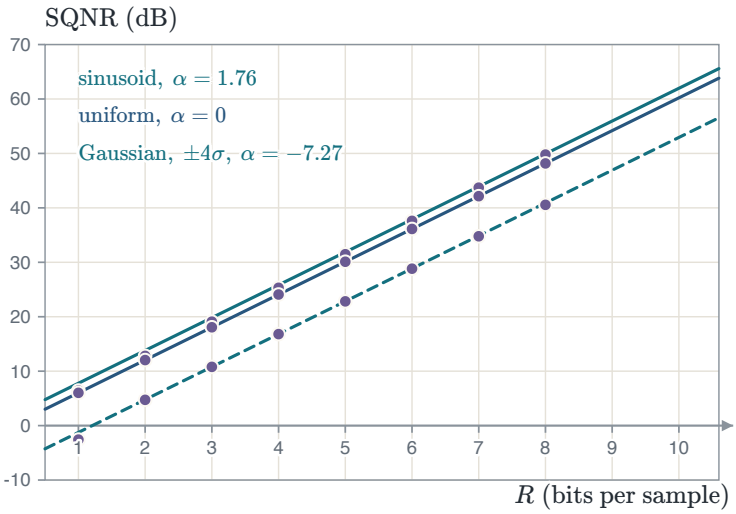


FIGURE 1.41 The lines are $\alpha + 6.02R$ for the three sources. The dots are measured on each quantized source, up to $R = 8$. The Gaussian dots leave their line at many bits, where the clipped peaks set the error.

⚠ PEAKS COST RANGE

A Gaussian source has rare large peaks. A range wide enough for them leaves most levels unused on typical samples.

For example, at $R = 8$ the rule puts the Gaussian source at $\pm 4\sigma$ below the sinusoid by $1.76 - (-7.27) = 9.03$ dB. The slopes are equal, so the gap is the gap in α.

Hearing quantization noise

Speech quantized with 8 bits has an error that sounds like a faint hiss. At 2 bits the error follows the words.

⚠ NOISE THAT FOLLOWS THE SIGNAL

At a few bits the error moves with the speech. It sounds like distortion, not like hiss, and the uniform error model no longer holds.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

For example, speech that sounds clean at 8 bits loses $4(6.02) = 24.08$ dB of SQNR at 4 bits, by the rule of six decibels a bit.

SQNR around us

HEADROOM COSTS SQNR

The formula assumes a full-scale input. Each decibel below full scale takes one decibel from the SQNR.

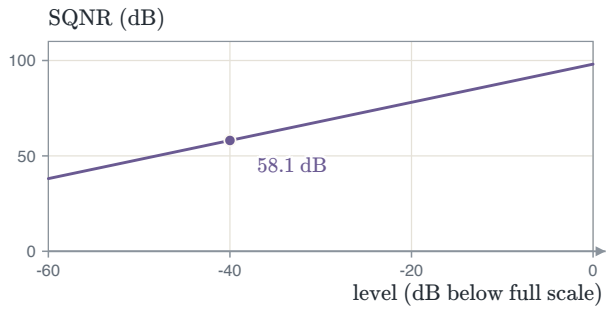


FIGURE 1.42 CD audio uses 16 bits: 98.1 dB at full scale, and 58.1 dB for a passage 40 dB quieter.

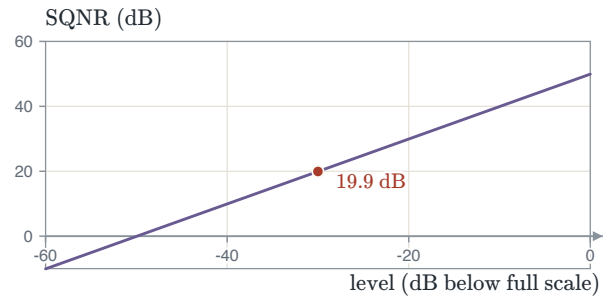


FIGURE 1.43 By $\alpha + 6.02R$, uniform 8-bit PCM gives 49.9 dB at full scale but only 19.9 dB for a signal 30 dB below it.

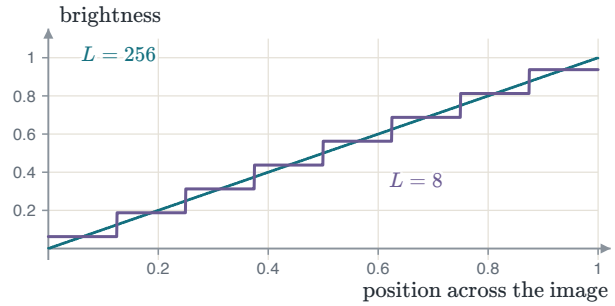


FIGURE 1.44 A row of an image at 8 levels shows bands where the 256-level row is smooth.

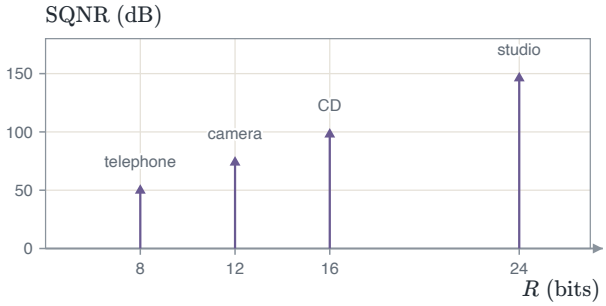


FIGURE 1.45 A full-scale sinusoid at common word lengths: 49.9, 74.0, 98.1 and 146.3 dB.

QUIET TALKERS AT 8 BITS

A telephone call spans a wide range of levels. At 8 uniform bits a quiet talker keeps little SQNR. Companding, next, fixes this.

1.5 Non-uniform quantization

Non-uniform quantization

Speech is mostly quiet and only sometimes reaches its peak. A uniform step is the same for a whisper and a shout. So the whisper is quantized coarsely in proportion to itself.

Divide the bound $|q| \le \Delta/2$ by $|m|$ to get the **relative error**. Small amplitudes suffer the most.

RELATIVE ERROR

$$\frac{|q|}{|m|} \le \frac{\Delta/2}{|m|} = \frac{\Delta}{2|m|}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

COMPANDING

Compress the signal with a memoryless curve, quantize uniformly, and expand at the receiver. The name **companding** joins **com**pressing and ex**panding**.

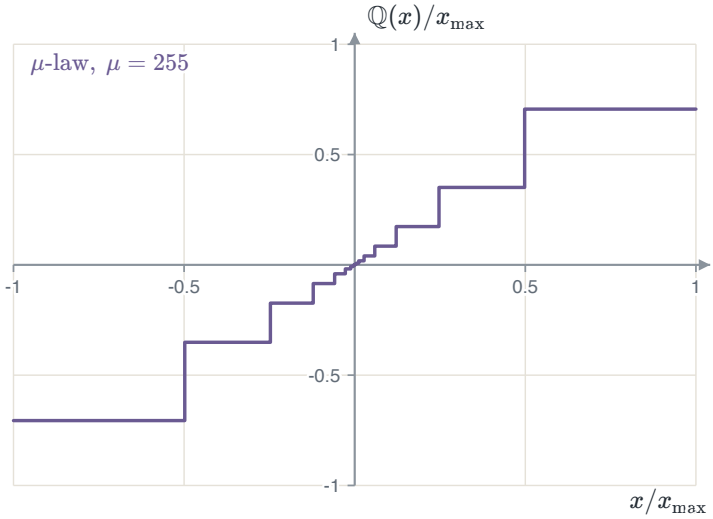


FIGURE 1.46 A sixteen-level μ-law quantizer. Its steps are fine near zero, where speech amplitudes crowd, and coarse near the peak.

For example, let a uniform quantizer have $\Delta = 0.1$ V and a quiet signal peak at 0.2 V. The error can reach $(\Delta/2)/0.2 = 0.05/0.2 = 25\%$ of that peak.

The compander

A **compander** builds a non-uniform quantizer from three parts: a compressor, a uniform quantizer and an expander.

COMPRESSOR

A memoryless curve $y = c(m)$. It gives a weak signal a high gain and a strong signal a low gain, so small amplitudes are spread over more quantizer levels.

EXPANDER

The receiver applies the inverse curve c^{-1}. It takes away the boost that the compressor gave the weak signal and returns every level to its original size.

The whole chain maps m to $\hat{m}$. Here Q is the uniform quantizer.

COMPANDER

$$\hat{m} = c^{-1}\big(Q(c(m))\big)$$

Near an input m, a step Δ in y is a step of about $\Delta/c'(m)$ in m.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

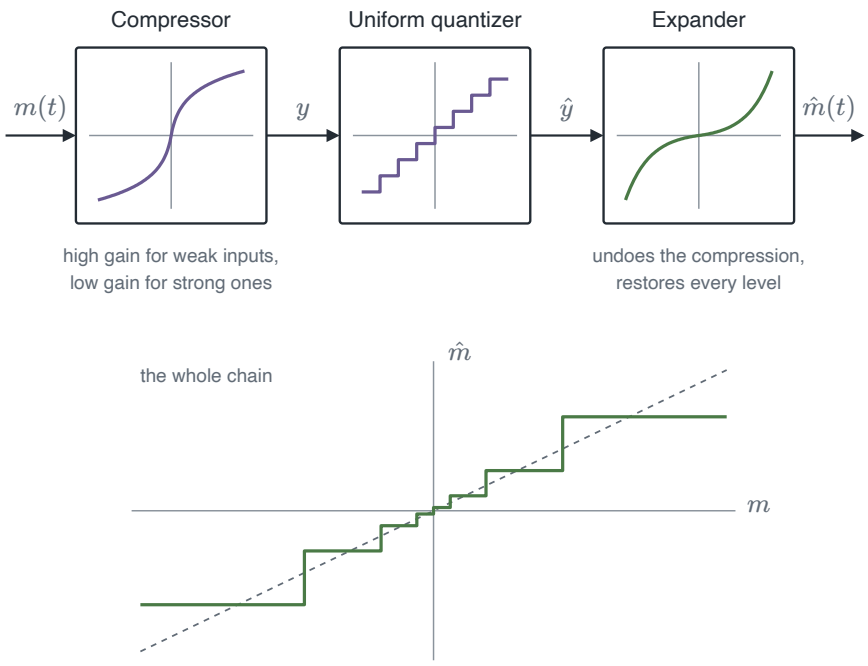


FIGURE 1.47 The quantizer in the middle is uniform. Seen from m to $\hat{m}$, its steps are fine near zero and coarse near the peak.

For example, let the compressor have slope $c'(0) = 4$ near zero and the uniform step be $\Delta = 0.1$. A quiet signal sees the step $\Delta / c'(0) = 0.1/4 = 0.025$. That step is four times finer than the uniform one.

A-law and μ-law companding

Two compressor curves are standard. Both act on an input normalized to $|x| \le 1$. The first is the μ-law.

μ-LAW

$$y = \frac{\ln(1 + \mu |x|)}{\ln(1 + \mu)} \operatorname{sgn}(x), \qquad |x| \le 1$$

The second is the A-law.

A-LAW

$$y = \begin{cases} \dfrac{A|x|}{1 + \ln A} \operatorname{sgn}(x), & |x| \le \dfrac{1}{A} \\[2ex] \dfrac{1 + \ln(A|x|)}{1 + \ln A} \operatorname{sgn}(x), & \dfrac{1}{A} < |x| \le 1 \end{cases}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

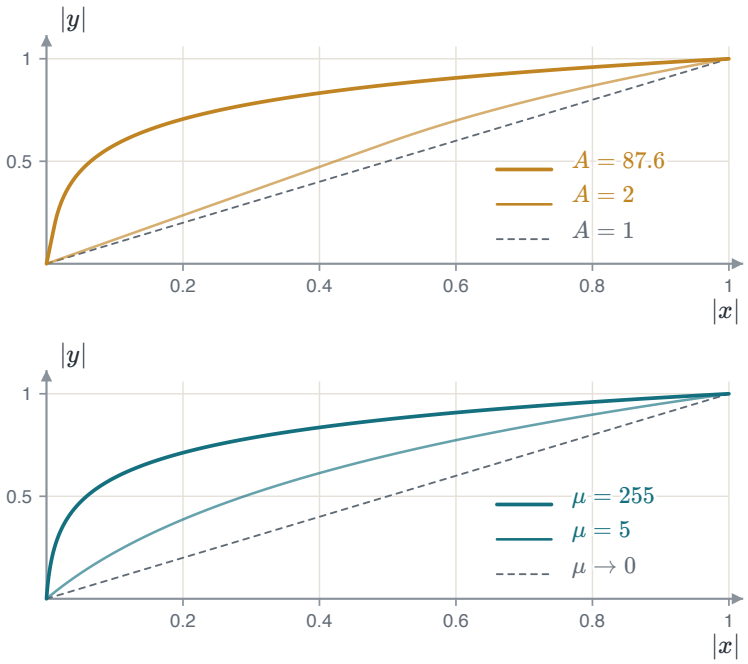


FIGURE 1.48 A-law (top) and μ-law (bottom) for three parameter values. The dashed line is no companding. The larger the parameter, the more output range goes to small inputs.

> IN USE
>
> μ-law with $\mu = 255$ is used in the United States, Canada and Japan. A-law with $A = 87.6$ is used in Europe, Türkiye and most other countries.

For example, with $\mu = 255$ the input $x = 0.01$ gives $y = \ln(3.55)/\ln(256) = 1.267/5.545 = 0.23$. One per cent of the range is lifted to almost a quarter.

Hearing companding

Compare a uniform quantizer and a μ-law quantizer, both with 6 bits over the same range. The uniform one spends its levels evenly, so a quiet voice meets only a few of them.

> QUIET VOICES STAY CLEAR
>
> The μ-law steps shrink with the voice. Its SQNR hardly changes as the level falls, while the uniform SQNR falls a decibel per decibel.

For example, let a talker drop 20 dB below full scale. The uniform noise power $\Delta^2/12$ stays the same and the signal power falls by 20 dB. So the uniform SQNR falls by 20 dB.

Companding around us

> TELEPHONE PCM
>
> North America and Japan use μ-law with $\mu = 255$. Most other countries use A-law with $A = 87.6$. Both use 8 bits at 8 kHz.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

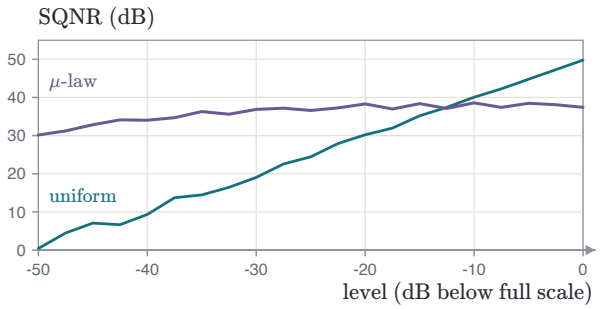


FIGURE 1.49 Two 8-bit quantizers on a sinusoid. The μ-law SQNR stays nearly flat as the level falls. The uniform one falls a decibel per decibel.

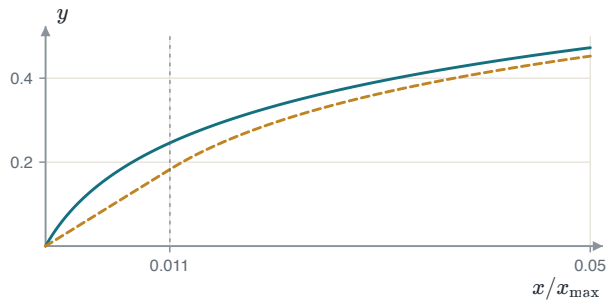


FIGURE 1.50 Near zero the laws differ: A-law is a straight line up to $1/A = 0.0114$, and μ-law is curved all the way.

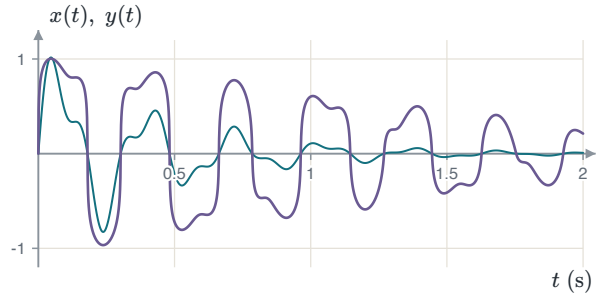


FIGURE 1.51 A decaying burst (cyan) and its μ-law compressed form (violet). The quiet tail is lifted toward full scale.

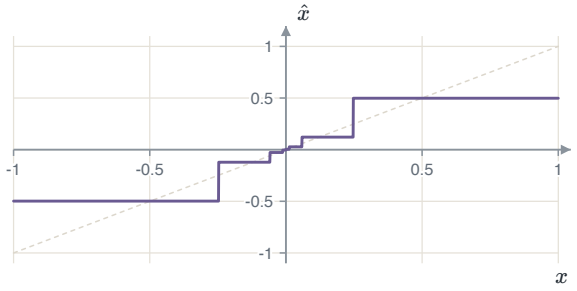


FIGURE 1.52 A 3-bit μ-law quantizer drawn against its input: narrow steps near zero, wide steps near the peak.

STEADY QUALITY

Companding gives up a little SQNR at full scale. In return the SQNR stays nearly constant over a wide range of input levels.

1.6 PCM, DPCM and delta modulation

Encoding and the bit rate

Pulse code modulation (PCM) writes each quantized sample as R bits. The bit rate is the bits a sample times the samples a second.

KEY RESULT: BIT RATE

$$R_b = R\, f_s \qquad \left(\frac{\text{bits}}{\text{sample}}\right)\left(\frac{\text{samples}}{\text{s}}\right)$$

TWO CODES

Natural binary numbers the levels 0 to $L-1$ in order. **Gray coding** orders the words so that adjacent levels differ in exactly one bit.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TABLE 1.3 The eight levels of a 3-bit quantizer in natural binary and in Gray code. The natural words 011 and 100 either side of the middle differ in all three bits.

LEVEL	NATURAL	GRAY
0	000	000
1	001	001
2	010	011
3	011	010
4	100	110
5	101	111
6	110	101
7	111	100

> GRAY-CODE ADVANTAGE
>
> A small decision error usually picks a neighbouring level. With a Gray code that costs one bit error, not several.

For example, telephone speech uses $L = 256$ levels at $f_s = 8$ kHz. Then $R = \log_2 256 = 8$ bits, and $R_b = 8(8000) = 64$ kb/s.

Line codes

> LINE CODE
>
> A **line code** is the rule that turns the bits of a PCM stream into a waveform on the wire.

Line codes differ in their levels. The levels decide whether the waveform has a DC component.

TABLE 1.4 The DC component of the two families of line code.

FAMILY	LEVELS	DC COMPONENT
Unipolar	0 and $+A$	present, and an AC-coupled stage cannot pass it
Polar	$\pm A$	none for balanced data

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

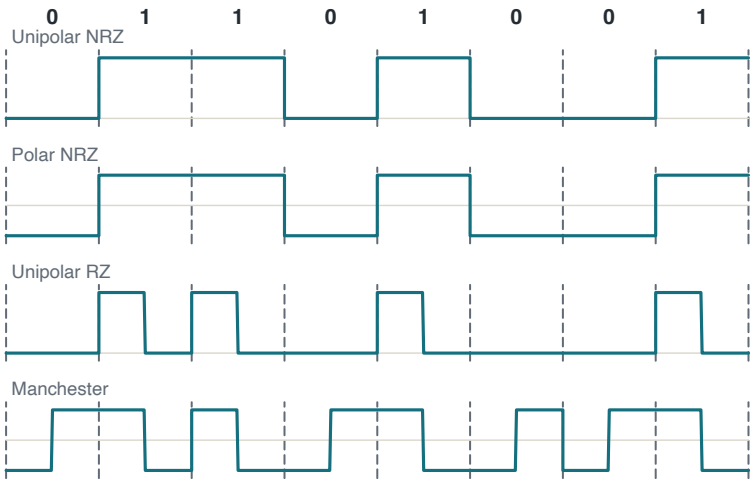


FIGURE 1.53 Four line codes of the bits $0\,1\,1\,0\,1\,0\,0\,1$. Each faint line is the zero of its trace.

> ⚠ CLOCK RECOVERY
>
> A long run of equal NRZ bits has no transitions. Manchester coding puts a transition in every bit, at the cost of twice the bandwidth.

For example, a polar NRZ stream that sends a long run of ones stays at $+A$. It has no transitions to lock onto, so the receiver cannot recover its clock from that stretch.

EXAMPLE 1.5 — PCM ENCODING OF A SINC PULSE

GIVEN $m(t) = 8\,|\operatorname{sinc}(t-2)|$, with $\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$. It is sampled every $T_s = 0.6$ s and quantized by an eight-level uniform quantizer over $[0, 8]$.

FIND The step size, the code words for $t = 0, 0.6, \ldots, 3.6$, and the bit rate.

METHOD Take Δ from the range and L. Evaluate each sample. Find the region of each sample, then its level and code word. The bit rate is $R_b = R\,f_s$.

SOLUTION The step and the levels come from the range $[0, 8]$ and $L = 8$.

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta &= \frac{8-0}{8} = 1\ \text{V} \\ v_k &= \left(k + \tfrac{1}{2}\right)\Delta, \quad k = 0, \ldots, 7 \\ &= 0.5,\ 1.5,\ \ldots,\ 7.5\ \text{V} \end{aligned}$$

Evaluate the samples. For instance, $m(0.6) = 8\,|\sin(1.4\pi)|/(1.4\pi) = 8(0.951)/4.398 = 1.73$.

t	0	0.6	1.2	1.8	2.4	3.0	3.6
$t-2$	-2	-1.4	-0.8	-0.2	0.4	1	1.6
$m(t)$	0	1.73	1.87	7.48	6.05	0	1.51

Each sample takes the level of its tread. The index is $k = v/\Delta - \tfrac{1}{2}$, written in three bits.

v	0.5	1.5	1.5	7.5	6.5	0.5	1.5
k	0	1	1	7	6	0	1
code	000	001	001	111	110	000	001

Three bits a sample give the bit rate and the bit duration.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

$$f_s = \frac{1}{T_s} = \frac{1}{0.6} = 1.667 \text{ samples/s}$$
$$R_b = R\, f_s = \frac{3}{0.6} = 5 \text{ b/s}$$
$$T_b = \frac{1}{R_b} = 0.2 \text{ s}$$

CHECK At $t = 3$ the sample is $8\left|\operatorname{sinc}(1)\right| = 0$ exactly, because sinc vanishes at every non-zero integer.

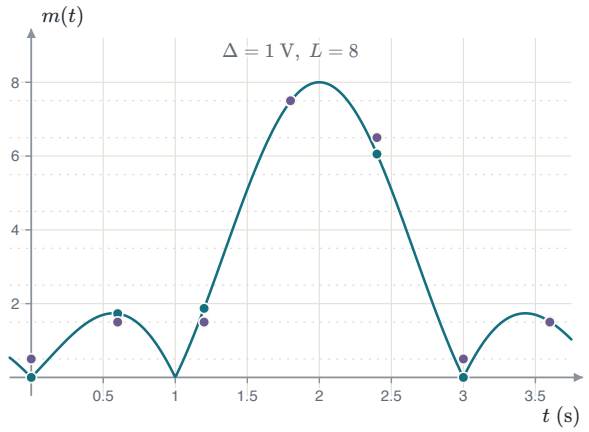


FIGURE 1.54 The message (cyan), its samples every 0.6 s, and the selected levels (violet). Each error is under half a step.

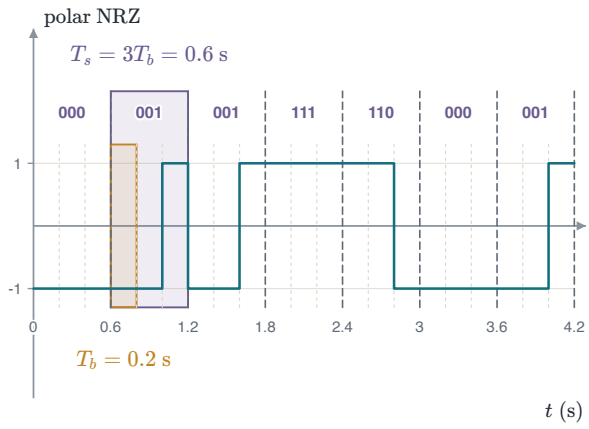


FIGURE 1.55 The seven code words as one polar NRZ stream. The amber box marks one bit, $T_b = 0.2$ s. The violet box marks one code word, $T_s = 3T_b$.

The bandwidth of PCM

A binary stream of R_b bits a second needs a bandwidth of at least $R_b/2$ hertz. Chapter 2 shows why. At the Nyquist rate $f_s = 2W$ this becomes RW.

KEY RESULT: BANDWIDTH OF PCM

$$B_T \geq \frac{R_b}{2} = \frac{R\, f_s}{2}$$
$$B_T \geq RW \quad \text{at } f_s = 2W$$

BITS FOR BANDWIDTH

Each extra bit adds 6.02 dB of SQNR and W hertz of bandwidth. PCM buys quality with bandwidth.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

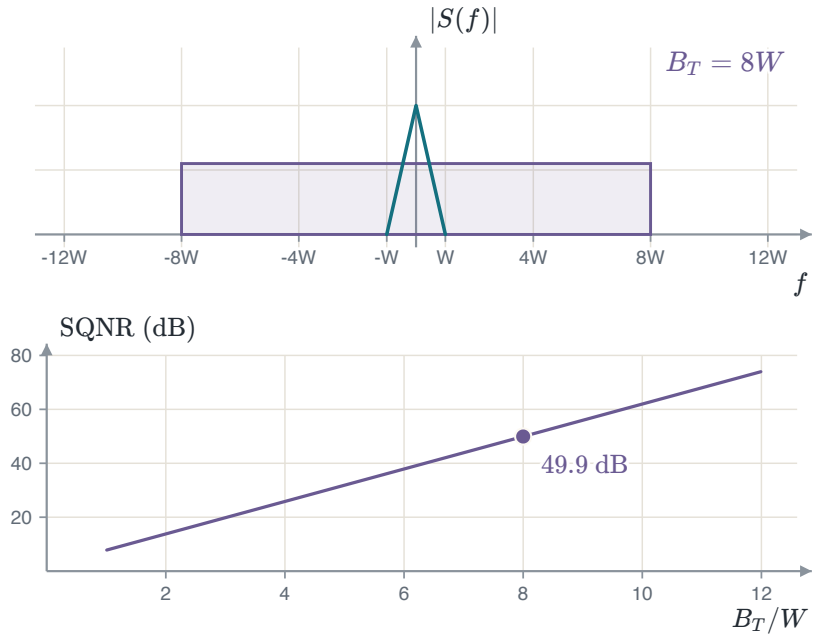


FIGURE 1.56 Top: the message band W (cyan) and the least band of 8-bit PCM sampled at $2W$ (violet). Bottom: the SQNR of a full-scale sinusoid against that bandwidth.

For example, telephone PCM with $f_s = 8$ kHz and $R = 8$ bits has $R_b = 8(8000) = 64$ kb/s. Its least bandwidth is $B_T \geq R_b/2 = 32$ kHz, eight times the 4 kHz of the voice.

Bit errors in PCM

A channel error flips one bit of a code word. With natural binary coding the damage depends on the position of the bit. Bit b counts from 0 at the right and carries the weight 2^b.

SIZE OF THE ERROR

$$\hat{m} - m_q = \pm 2^b \Delta$$

Here m_q is the level sent and $\hat{m}$ the level decoded. The first bit, $b = R - 1$, moves the sample by $2^{R-1}\Delta = m_{\max}$, half the range.

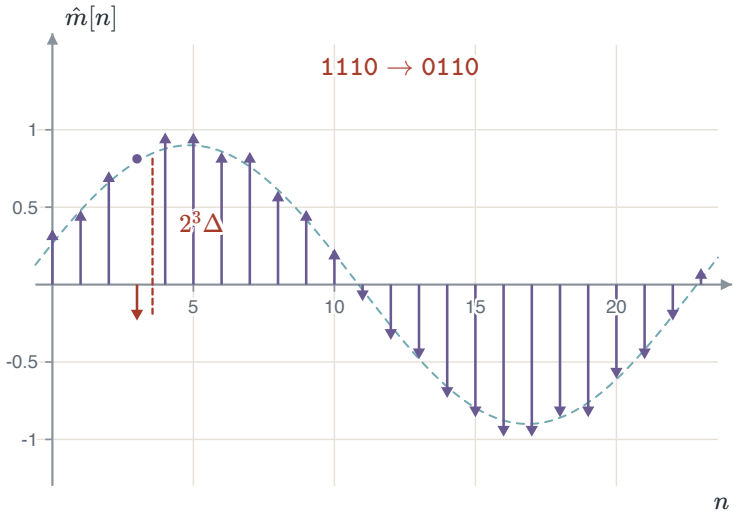


FIGURE 1.57 A 4-bit PCM stream with $\Delta = 0.125$. Bit $b = 3$ of the code word 1110 is received wrong, and the sample moves by $2^3\Delta$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

⚠ CLICKS

A wrong first bit throws a sample across half the range. The ear hears a click, far louder than the quantization noise.

For example, an 8-bit quantizer with $\Delta = 1/128$ V moves a sample by $2^7\Delta = 128/128 = 1$ V when the first bit is wrong. That is $m_{\max}$.

Differential PCM

ⓘ PREDICT, THEN SEND THE DIFFERENCE

Neighbouring samples are close. **Differential PCM** (DPCM) quantizes the difference between a sample and its prediction, which has a much smaller range.

The prediction is the last decoded value $\hat{x}[n-1]$. The encoder forms the difference, and the decoder adds the quantized difference to its last value.

ENCODER AND DECODER

$$e[n] = x[n] - \hat{x}[n-1]$$
$$\hat{x}[n] = \hat{x}[n-1] + \mathbb{Q}\big(e[n]\big)$$

The encoder predicts from $\hat{x}[n-1]$, the value the decoder also has. So $x[n] - \hat{x}[n] = e[n] - \mathbb{Q}(e[n])$, and errors do not pile up.

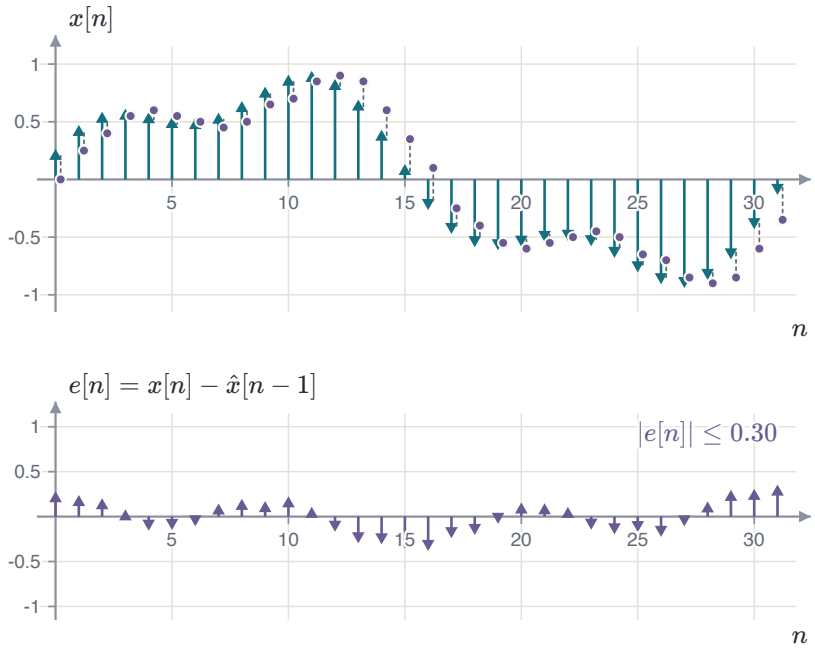


FIGURE 1.58 Each sample is predicted by the last decoded value (violet dots). The difference, on the same scale below, is far smaller than the sample.

✓ FEWER BITS

For speech at 8 kHz, DPCM with 4 bits a sample matches PCM with 8. That is 32 kb/s in place of 64 kb/s.

For example, DPCM with 4 bits a sample at $f_s = 8$ kHz has $R_b = R\, f_s = 4(8000) = 32$ kb/s.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Delta modulation

ONE BIT A SAMPLE

Delta modulation is DPCM with a two-level quantizer. Each bit moves the staircase up or down by Δ.

The step size trades two errors against each other.

TABLE 1.5 The two errors of delta modulation.

ERROR	CAUSE
Slope overload	The signal rises faster than Δ a sample. The staircase falls behind.
Granular noise	The signal is flat. The staircase hunts by $\pm\Delta$ around it.

The staircase climbs at most Δ every T_s. It follows the signal only while the slope stays below that climb.

NO OVERLOAD

$$\left|\frac{dx}{dt}\right| \leq \frac{\Delta}{T_s} = \Delta f_s$$

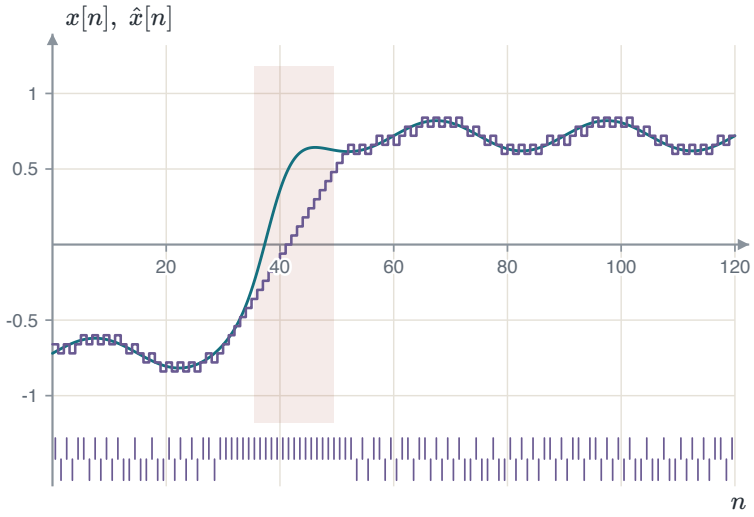


FIGURE 1.59 A signal with one steep rise, and the staircase with $\Delta = 0.06$ that follows it one step a sample. Red shades slope overload. The ticks under the plot are the bits.

For example, $x(t) = \sin(2\pi\, 1000\, t)$ has largest slope $2\pi(1000)$, and the rate is $f_s = 64$ kHz. No overload needs $\Delta \geq 2\pi(1000)/64\,000 = 0.098$.

PCM around us

RATE FROM THREE NUMBERS

The bit rate is the bits a sample, times the sampling rate, times the number of channels.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

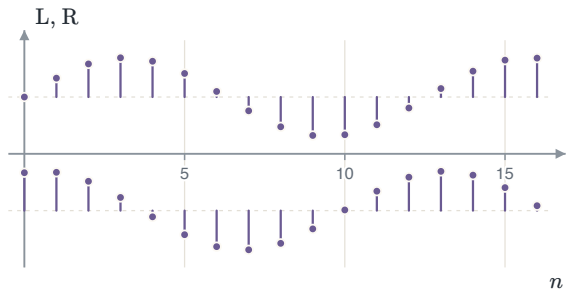


FIGURE 1.60 CD audio: two channels of 16 bits at 44.1 kHz give $2(16)(44\,100) = 1.4112$ Mb/s.

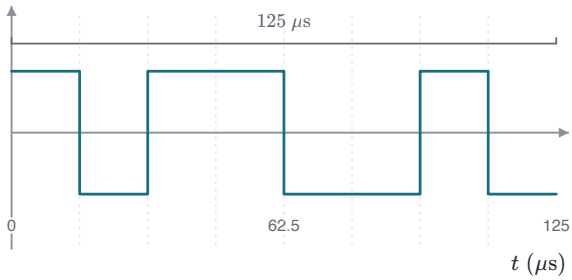


FIGURE 1.61 A telephone call sends one 8-bit word every $125\ \mu$s, which is 64 kb/s.

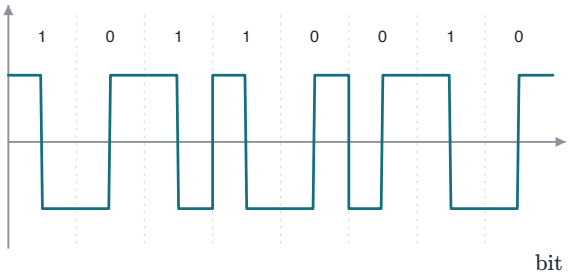


FIGURE 1.62 Ten-megabit Ethernet over twisted pair uses Manchester coding: a transition in the middle of every bit.

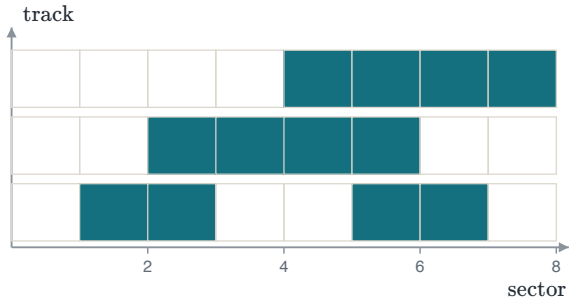


FIGURE 1.63 A shaft encoder prints a Gray code on three tracks. At each sector edge only one track changes.

ONE BIT AT A BOUNDARY

A reading taken exactly on a sector edge can see either neighbour. With a Gray code it is off by at most one sector.

1.7 Coding in practice

PCM sends every sample on its own. The methods below spend fewer bits: they quantize samples together, predict them, or transform them first.

Vector quantization

VECTOR QUANTIZATION

Vector quantization treats n samples as one point in n dimensions and sends the nearest point of a **codebook**. Scalar quantization is the case $n = 1$.

Take pairs of samples from a 16-level quantizer. Quantized one at a time, every pair of levels must be nameable.

EVERY PAIR

$$L^2 = 16^2 = 256 \text{ pairs}$$
$$\log_2 256 = 8 \text{ bits a pair}$$

Now let neighbouring samples differ by at most one step. Only pairs of levels with $|i - j| \le 1$ occur. The diagonal holds L such pairs and each side line $L - 1$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

PAIRS THAT OCCUR

$$\begin{aligned} L + 2(L-1) &= 3L - 2 \\ &= 3(16) - 2 = 46 \text{ pairs} \\ \lceil \log_2 46 \rceil &= \lceil 5.52 \rceil = 6 \text{ bits a pair} \end{aligned}$$

Six bits a pair is three bits a sample, not four.

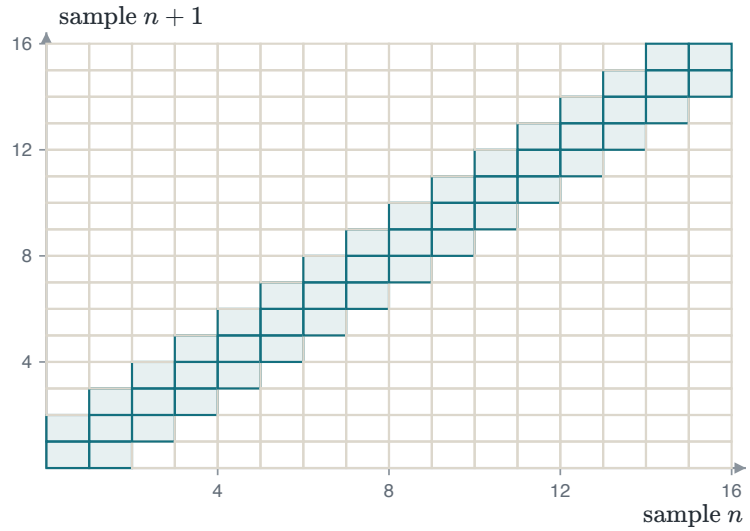


FIGURE 1.64 All 256 pairs of a 16-level quantizer. If neighbours differ by at most one step, only the 46 shaded pairs occur.

For example, an 8-level quantizer whose neighbours differ by at most one step has $3L - 2 = 3(8) - 2 = 22$ pairs that can occur.

Image quantization

A greyscale image is quantized pixel by pixel. The size of the file is the pixel count times the bits a pixel. One KiB is $8(1024)$ bits, and 32 levels need $\log_2 32 = 5$ bits.

BITS IN A 512×512 IMAGE

$$\begin{aligned} 512^2(8) &= 2\,097\,152 \text{ bits} \\ &= 256 \text{ KiB} \end{aligned} \qquad \begin{aligned} 512^2(5) &= 1\,310\,720 \text{ bits} \\ &= 160 \text{ KiB} \end{aligned}$$

The file shrinks by $(256 - 160)/256 = 37.5\%$.

Three bits fewer cost three times six decibels of SQNR.

WHAT IT COSTS

$$6.02(8 - 5) = 6.02(3) = 18.06 \text{ dB}$$



FIGURE 1.65 A grey ramp from 0 to 1 through a uniform quantizer with $L = 8$ levels. Below it is the size of a 512×512 image at 3 bits a pixel.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

⚠ BANDING

Coarse levels turn a smooth gradient into flat steps. The eye reads the step edges as contours that the scene never had.

For example, a 256×256 image with $L = 64$ levels needs $R = \log_2 64 = 6$ bits a pixel. Its size is $256^2(6)/8 = 49\,152$ bytes, or 48 KiB.

Linear predictive coding

ⓘ A MODEL, NOT A WAVEFORM

Linear predictive coding (LPC) measures a model of the voice every 20 ms and sends its settings. The receiver runs the model to make the speech again.

The model is an all-pole filter driven by an excitation w_n. Each output sample is a weighted sum of the last p outputs plus the scaled excitation.

ALL-POLE MODEL

$$x_n = \sum_{i=1}^{p} a_i \, x_{n-i} + G \, w_n$$

w_n is a pulse train for a voiced sound and white noise for an unvoiced one. The a_i describe the shape of the vocal tract.

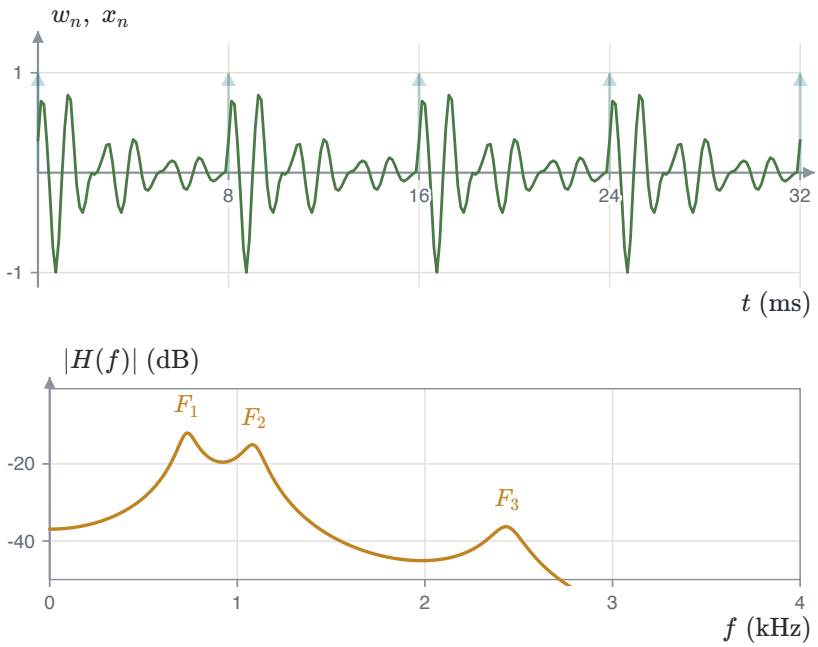


FIGURE 1.66 A pulse train at $f_0 = 125$ Hz (faint) drives an all-pole filter with three peaks, the formants F_1, F_2, F_3. The output is a vowel (green). Noise through the same filter is a whisper.

✓ BIT RATE

Each frame sends the a_i, the gain G, the pitch and one voiced bit. That brings speech down to about 2.4 kb/s, against 64 kb/s for PCM.

For example, a coder that sends 48 bits for each 20 ms frame sends 50 frames a second. Its bit rate is $48(50) = 2400$ b/s.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Time-division multiplexing and T1

TIME-DIVISION MULTIPLEXING

Many PCM calls share one line by taking turns. Each call gets one slot in every frame, and a frame lasts one sampling interval.

The T1 line carries 24 calls of 8 bits each, plus one framing bit. The extra bit marks the start of each frame, so the receiver knows which slot is which. A frame is sent every $125\ \mu$s, that is 8000 times a second.

T1 LINE RATE

$$24(8) + 1 = 193 \text{ bits a frame}$$
$$193(8000) = 1.544 \text{ Mb/s}$$

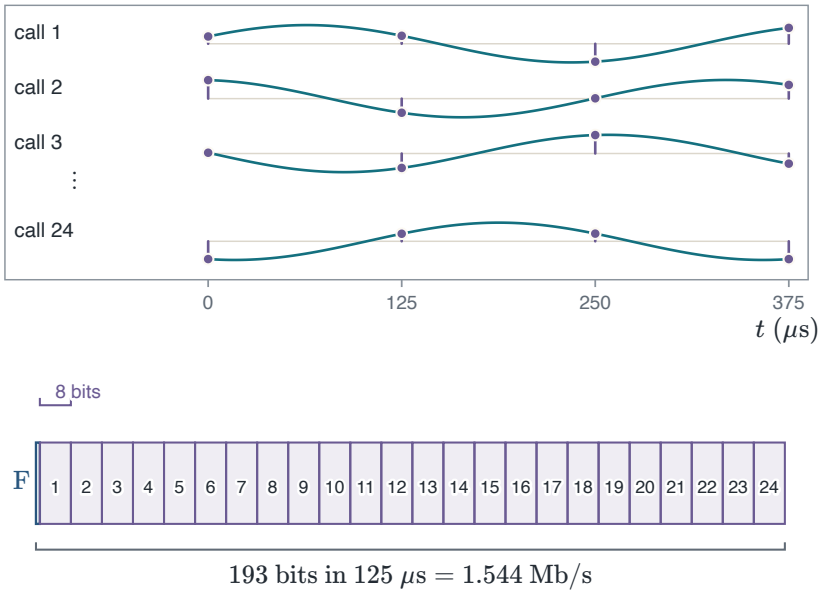


FIGURE 1.67 Every call is sampled every $125\ \mu$s. Its 8-bit word takes one slot of the frame, after a framing bit F.

A HIERARCHY

Four T1 lines make a 6.312 Mb/s line, and seven of those a 44.736 Mb/s line. Europe and Türkiye use E1: 32 slots, 2.048 Mb/s.

For example, leave out the framing bit. The 24 calls alone need $24(64) = 1536$ kb/s. The framing bit adds 8 kb/s to make 1.544 Mb/s.

Oversampling and sigma-delta conversion

OVERSAMPLE, THEN USE ONE BIT

At a rate far above $2W$, neighbouring samples are nearly equal. One bit a sample can then carry the change.

A **sigma-delta** converter integrates the error between the input and its one-bit output. The output bit is the sign of the integrator.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

SIGMA–DELTA LOOP

$$v[n] = v[n-1] + x[n] - y[n-1]$$
$$y[n] = \operatorname{sgn}\big(v[n]\big)$$

The integrator v adds up the error, so the running average of the bits y stays on the input.

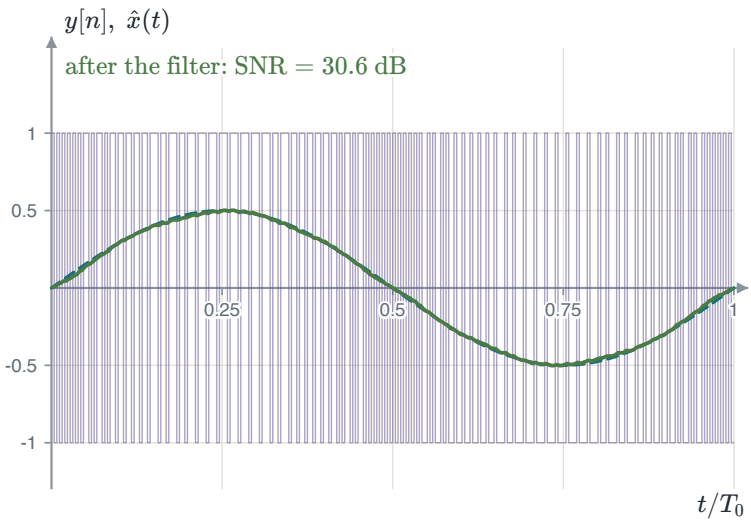


FIGURE 1.68 One period of a sinusoid (dashed) oversampled $U = 16$ times. The one-bit output (violet) swings between ± 1, and a lowpass filter averages it back to the signal (green).

THE DECODER IS A FILTER

A lowpass filter turns the bits back into the signal. The fast swings of the bits lie far above 20 kHz and are removed.

For example, a CD player that oversamples 44.1 kHz audio by $U = 256$ runs its one-bit converter at $256(44.1\ \text{kHz}) = 11.2896$ MHz.

Transform coding and JPEG

TRANSFORM CODING

JPEG cuts the picture into 8×8 blocks and takes the discrete cosine transform of each. Most of the energy of a block lands in a few low-frequency coefficients.

QUANTIZE THE COEFFICIENTS

Each coefficient has its own uniform step, larger at high frequencies. Most high-frequency coefficients round to zero and cost almost nothing to send.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

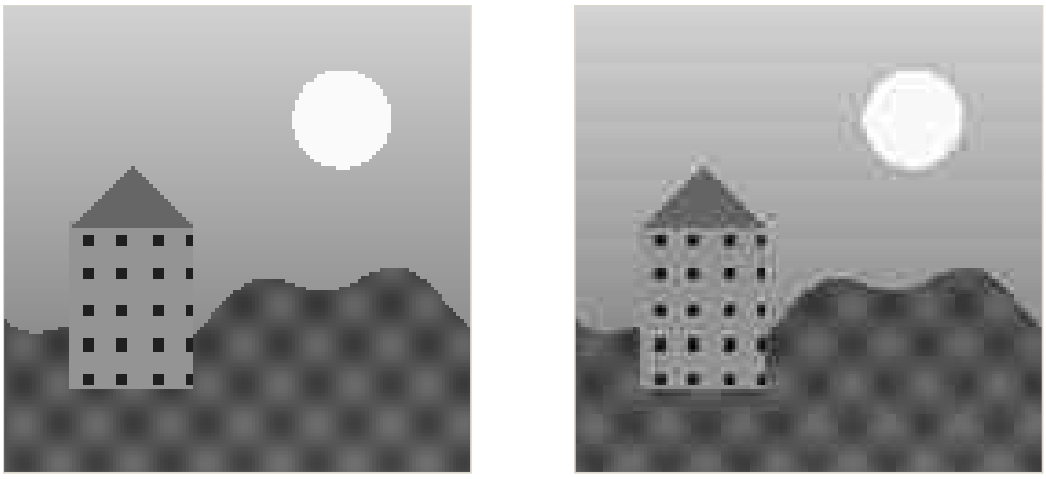


FIGURE 1.69 A drawn picture of 128×128 pixels and its JPEG version at quality 25. At lower quality more coefficients become zero, and the 8×8 blocks begin to show.

> ⚠ BLOCKING
>
> At a coarse step each block keeps little more than its average. The picture breaks into visible 8×8 squares.

For example, a 512×512 picture coded at 0.5 bit a pixel takes $512^2(0.5)/8 = 16\,384$ bytes, or 16 KiB. That is sixteen times less than at 8 bits a pixel.

1.8 Summary

From sound to bits

One signal passes through the whole chain in four stages.

1. Filter the signal to the band W.
2. Sample at $f_s \geq 2W$.
3. Quantize to $L = 2^R$ levels.
4. Write R bits a sample.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

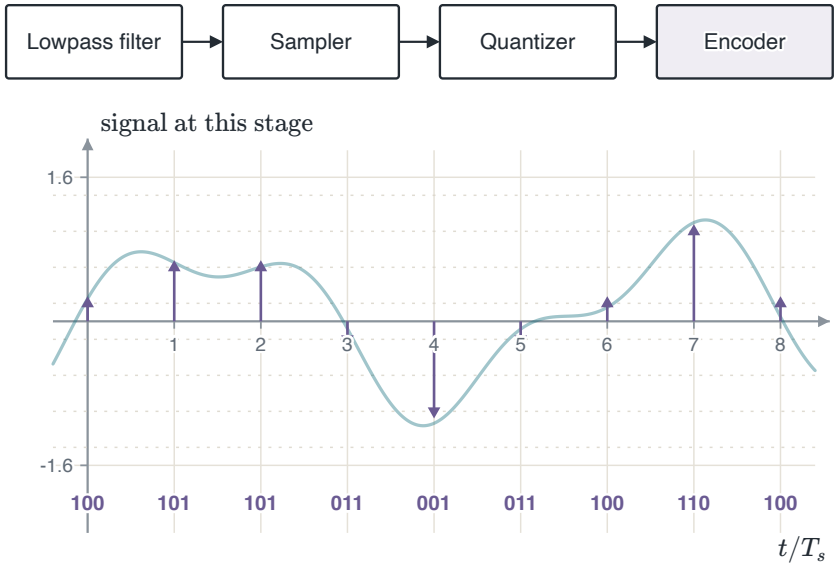


FIGURE 1.70 One message through the four stages. The filter has removed a fast ripple, and the sampler has kept one value every T_s. The quantizer has moved each value to one of eight levels, and the encoder has written three bits for it.

> QUANTIZATION ERROR
>
> Filtering and sampling at $f_s \geq 2W$ keep everything inside the band. Only the quantizer adds an error that no receiver can remove.

For example, a recording sampled at 16 kHz with 12 bits a sample has $R_b = R\, f_s = 12(16\,000) = 192$ kb/s.

Quick check

Each question needs no calculation on paper. The answer and its reason follow the question.

1 Aliasing. A 7 kHz tone sampled at 10 kHz appears at what frequency?
Answer: 3 kHz. Since $7 > f_s/2 = 5$, it folds to $|7 - 10| = 3$ kHz.

2 Nyquist rate. What is the Nyquist rate of audio bandlimited to 20 kHz?
Answer: $2W = 40$ kHz. CD audio samples a little above it.

3 The sinc convention. What is $\operatorname{sinc}(2)$?
Answer: 0. Since $\sin(2\pi)/(2\pi) = 0$, sinc vanishes at every non-zero integer.

4 Bits and SQNR. By about how much do two more bits a sample raise the SQNR?
Answer: 12 dB. At 6.02 dB a bit, two bits give 12.04 dB.

5 Step size. Doubling Δ multiplies $E[Q^2]$ by what factor?
Answer: 4. $E[Q^2] = \Delta^2/12$ grows with the square of the step.

6 Companding. Does μ-law companding give finer steps to small or to large amplitudes?
Answer: Small amplitudes. The compressor is steep near zero, so small inputs spread over many levels.

7 Gray code. In how many bits do two adjacent Gray code words differ?
Answer: One bit. That is the rule that defines the code.

8 Levels. How many levels does a 16-bit quantizer have?
Answer: $L = 2^{16} = 65\,536$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Summary of results

TABLE 1.6 Summary of Chapter 1: from an analog signal to bits.

QUESTION	RESULT	ANCHOR
What does sampling do to the spectrum?	$G_\delta(f) = f_s \sum_n G(f - nf_s)$: a copy at every multiple of f_s, scaled by f_s.	PS CH7.1.1
What is the lowest safe sampling rate?	The Nyquist rate $2W$. Below it the copies overlap and alias.	PS CH7.1.1
What filter turns the samples back into the signal?	An ideal lowpass filter with gain T_s. At $f_s = 2W$ its impulse response is $\operatorname{sinc}(2Wt)$.	PS CH7.1.1
How is $g(t)$ written in terms of its samples?	$g(t) = \sum_n g(nT_s)\operatorname{sinc}\big(2W(t - nT_s)\big)$, exact at every t.	PS CH7.1.1
Mid-rise or mid-tread: which has a level at zero?	Mid-tread. Mid-rise has a boundary at zero and outputs $\pm\Delta/2$ there.	PS CH7.2.1
What is the power of the quantization noise?	$E[Q^2] = \Delta^2/12$, with $\Delta = 2m_{\max}/L$, for a fine quantizer.	PS CH7.2.1
What does one more bit buy?	6.02 dB: $\mathrm{SQNR} = \alpha + 6.02R$, and $\alpha = 1.76$ dB for a full-scale sinusoid.	PS CH7.2.1
Why compand?	Small amplitudes are common. Finer steps near zero keep the SQNR steady as the level falls.	PS CH7.2.1
What bit rate does PCM need?	$R_b = R\,f_s$. Telephone speech: $8(8000) = 64$ kb/s.	PS CH7.3
Why use a Gray code?	Adjacent levels differ in one bit, so a small decision error costs one bit error.	PS CH7.3
What bandwidth does PCM need?	$B_T \geq R_b/2$, which is RW at $f_s = 2W$. Each extra bit adds 6.02 dB and W hertz.	PS CH7.4.1
What do DPCM and delta modulation send?	The difference from a prediction. Delta modulation sends one bit a sample and needs Δf_s above the largest slope.	PS CH7.4.2–7.4.3

> METHOD
>
> Check a rate against $2W$ before sampling. Take Δ from the full range $2m_{\max}$. Compute the SQNR from the two powers and compare it with $\alpha + 6.02R$. Chapter 2 sends the resulting bits over a channel.

Projects to try

Four optional projects use the chapter on real and computed signals. Each gives an aim, what it practises, a few steps and what to look for.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

HEAR ALIASING IN A RECORDING

Lower the sampling rate of a recording and hear what aliasing does to it.

Practises: The Nyquist rate $2W$ of a real signal. Aliasing: a tone above $f_s/2$ returns at a lower frequency. Why a lowpass filter comes before the sampler.

1. Record a few seconds of music or speech at $f_s = 44.1$ kHz.
2. Keep every 4th sample and play the result at $f_s/4$. Then keep every 8th sample.
3. Repeat, but first remove everything above the new $f_s/2$ with a lowpass filter.
4. Do the same with a tone that sweeps from 0 to 10 kHz, and plot the spectrum of each version.

Look for: Without the filter, high notes come back as new low notes that were never played. With the filter, the sound is only duller. The swept tone climbs, turns and falls, again and again.

REBUILD A TONE FROM ITS SAMPLES

Rebuild a signal from its samples in two ways and measure how close each one gets.

Practises: The interpolation formula $g(t) = \sum_n g(nT_s)\,\mathrm{sinc}\big(2W(t - nT_s)\big)$, with $\mathrm{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$. The zero-order hold, which keeps each sample until the next one. The error of a finite sum of sinc terms.

1. Sample $g(t) = \cos(2\pi\, 3t)$ at $f_s = 8$ Hz on $0 \le t \le 4$ s.
2. Rebuild $g(t)$ on a fine grid with the sinc sum. Rebuild it again with a zero-order hold.
3. Plot both against the true $g(t)$, and plot the error of each.
4. Repeat with $f_s = 6.5$ Hz and with $f_s = 5$ Hz.

Look for: The sinc sum is close in the middle and worse near the two ends, where terms are missing. The hold lags by half a sample. At $f_s = 5$ Hz both rebuild a different tone.

TAKE BITS AWAY FROM A SONG

Quantize a recording with fewer and fewer bits and compare the measured SQNR with the rule.

Practises: A uniform quantizer with $L = 2^R$ levels and $\Delta = 2m_{\max}/L$. The SQNR measured from the signal power and the error power. When the model of the error as uniform noise fails.

1. Scale a recording so that $|x| \le m_{\max}$. Quantize it with $R = 12, 8, 6, 4, 2$ bits.
2. For each R, compute the error $q = x_q - x$ and the SQNR $= 10\log_{10}\big(\overline{x^2}/\overline{q^2}\big)$.
3. Plot SQNR against R and draw the line $\alpha + 6.02R$ over it.
4. Listen to x_q and to q alone for each R.

Look for: The points follow a straight line for large R and leave it for small R. There the error sounds like the music, not like a hiss. α is lower than for a full-scale sinusoid.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

KEEP A QUIET VOICE CLEAR

Compare a uniform quantizer with a μ-law quantizer as the input level falls.

Practises: The μ-law compressor and its inverse, the expander. SQNR against input level for both quantizers. Why speech and telephony use companding.

1. Record a sentence and scale its peak to $m_{\max}$. Make copies scaled down by 10, 20, 30 and 40 dB.
2. Quantize each copy with 8 bits: once uniformly, once through the compressor with $\mu = 255$, then the expander.
3. Compute the SQNR of every version and plot it against the input level.
4. Listen to the quietest copy in both versions.

Look for: The uniform curve falls by about the same number of dB as the input. The μ-law curve stays nearly flat, so the quiet copy keeps most of its SQNR.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CHAPTER

2

Baseband transmission of digital signals

Each bit is sent as one waveform. The channel adds noise, and the receiver filters, samples and decides. Noise is a random signal, so the chapter first describes random signals.

The matched filter gives the largest peak SNR, $2E/N_0$. Only the pulse energy counts, not its shape. With polar signalling and equal priors, $P_b = Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$. A channel narrower than $R_b/2$ cannot avoid intersymbol interference.

2.1 Random signals

A random signal

On each trial, send the same pulse and record the receiver noise. The pulse is fixed, but the noise waveform changes.

A **random process** $X(t)$ assigns one waveform to each outcome. A waveform is a **sample function**. Their collection is the **ensemble**.

Fix a time t_0 and compare trials. Each trial supplies one value of the random variable $X(t_0)$.

> AT A FIXED TIME
>
> $$X(t_0) \text{ has density } f_{X(t_0)}(x)$$
>
> Reading a thousand trials at $t_0 = 5$ ms gives draws of this random variable. Reading one trial over time gives one waveform.

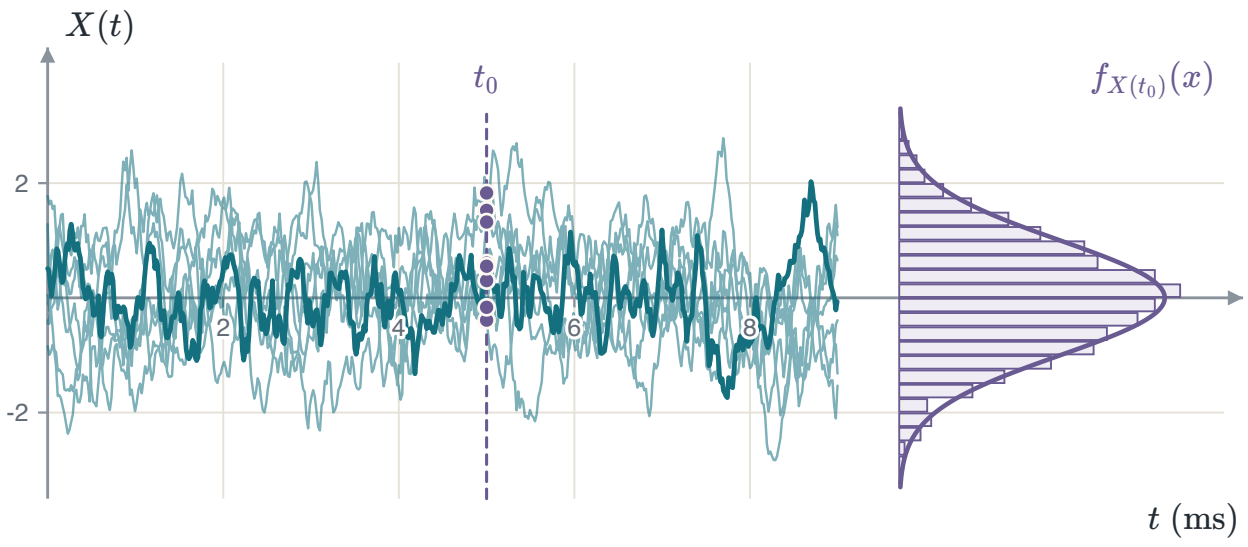


FIGURE 2.1 One recording is a sample function. Values at the same time across recordings describe the random variable $X(t_0)$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The ensemble mean

At a fixed time, average the readings across trials. This defines the **ensemble mean**.

MEAN

$$\mu_X(t) = E[X(t)]$$

A zero ensemble mean allows positive and negative individual readings. Replacing this expectation with a time average requires additional assumptions, such as mean ergodicity.

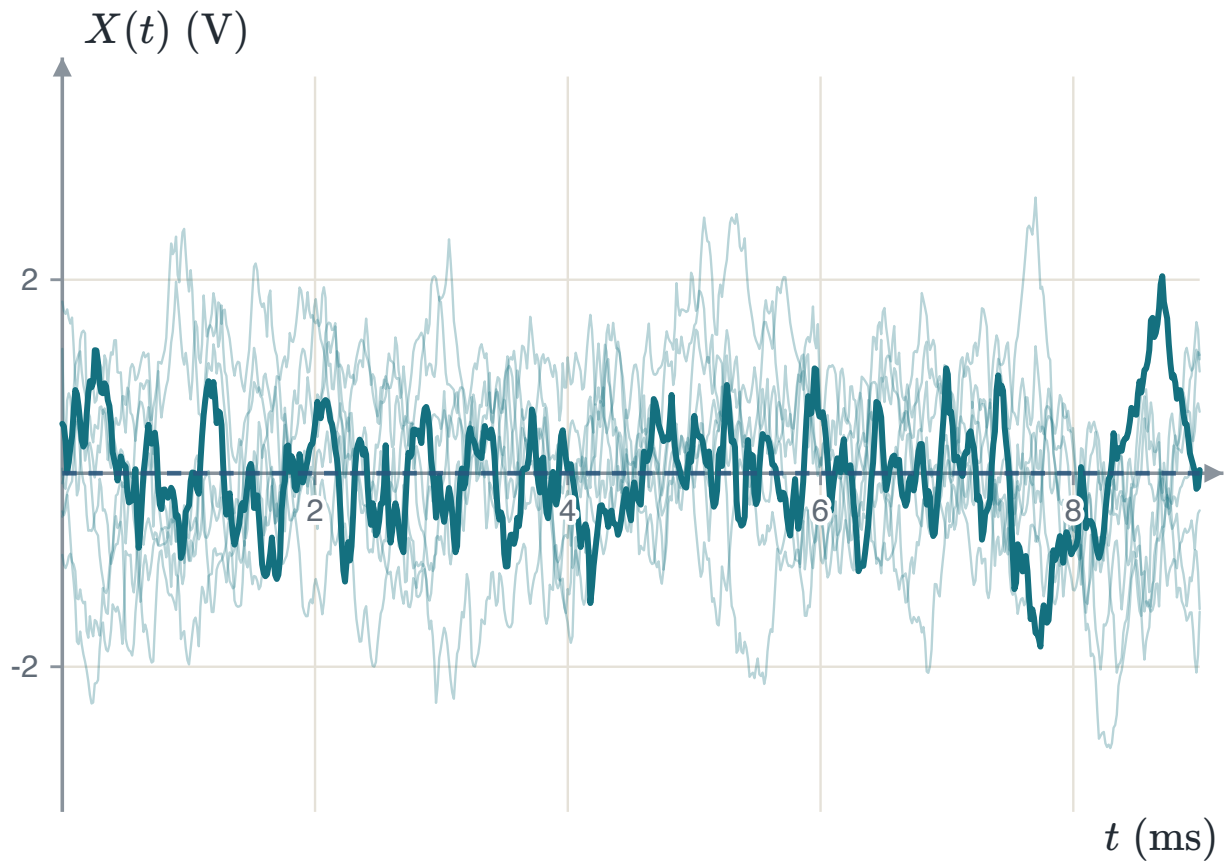


FIGURE 2.2 The recordings fluctuate while their ensemble mean is zero. The dashed line represents the population mean, not an estimate from these eight traces.

Autocorrelation

Take two readings from each trial, separated by τ. Average their products across trials to obtain the **autocorrelation**.

DEFINITION

$$R_X(t, t+\tau) = E[X(t)X(t+\tau)]$$

For a zero-mean process, positive autocorrelation indicates a tendency toward the same sign. Negative autocorrelation indicates the opposite tendency. Magnitudes also affect the product.

Autocorrelation is not generally a normalized correlation coefficient. For nonzero means, covariance subtracts the product of the means.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

COVARIANCE

$$C_X(t,u) = R_X(t,u) - \mu_X(t)\mu_X(u)$$

For zero-mean noise, covariance and autocorrelation are equal. Zero covariance alone does not imply independence unless additional conditions hold.

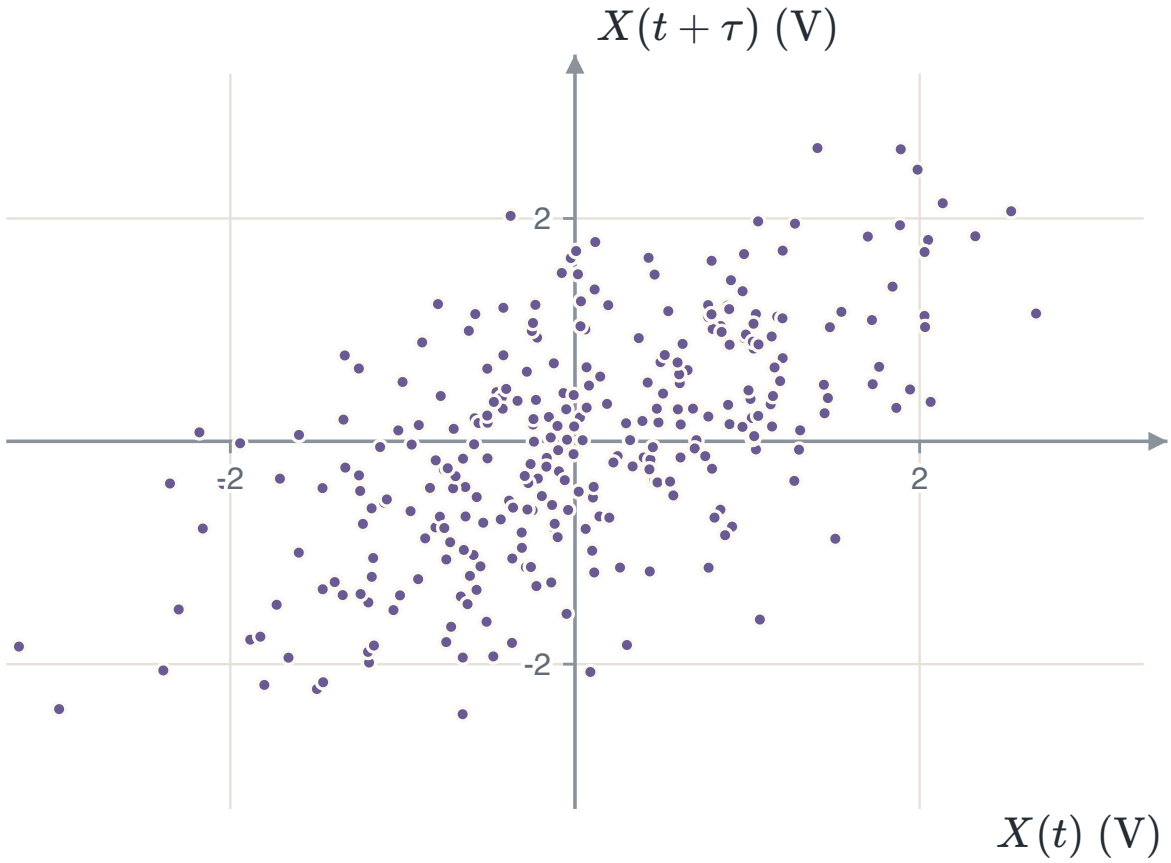


FIGURE 2.3 Each dot contains two readings from one trial, separated by 0.5 ms. The correlated cloud is elongated along the diagonal.

Reading the autocorrelation

In this example, autocorrelation depends only on the time gap. Its characteristic time is $\tau_c = 1$ ms.

EXAMPLE

$$\begin{aligned} R_X(\tau) &= e^{-|\tau|/\tau_c}\ \mathrm{V}^2 \\ R_X(1\ \mathrm{ms}) &= e^{-1}\ \mathrm{V}^2 \\ &\approx 0.37\ \mathrm{V}^2 \end{aligned}$$

At zero gap, $R_X(0) = 1\ \mathrm{V}^2$. Increasing the gap reduces the relationship between the readings in this example.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

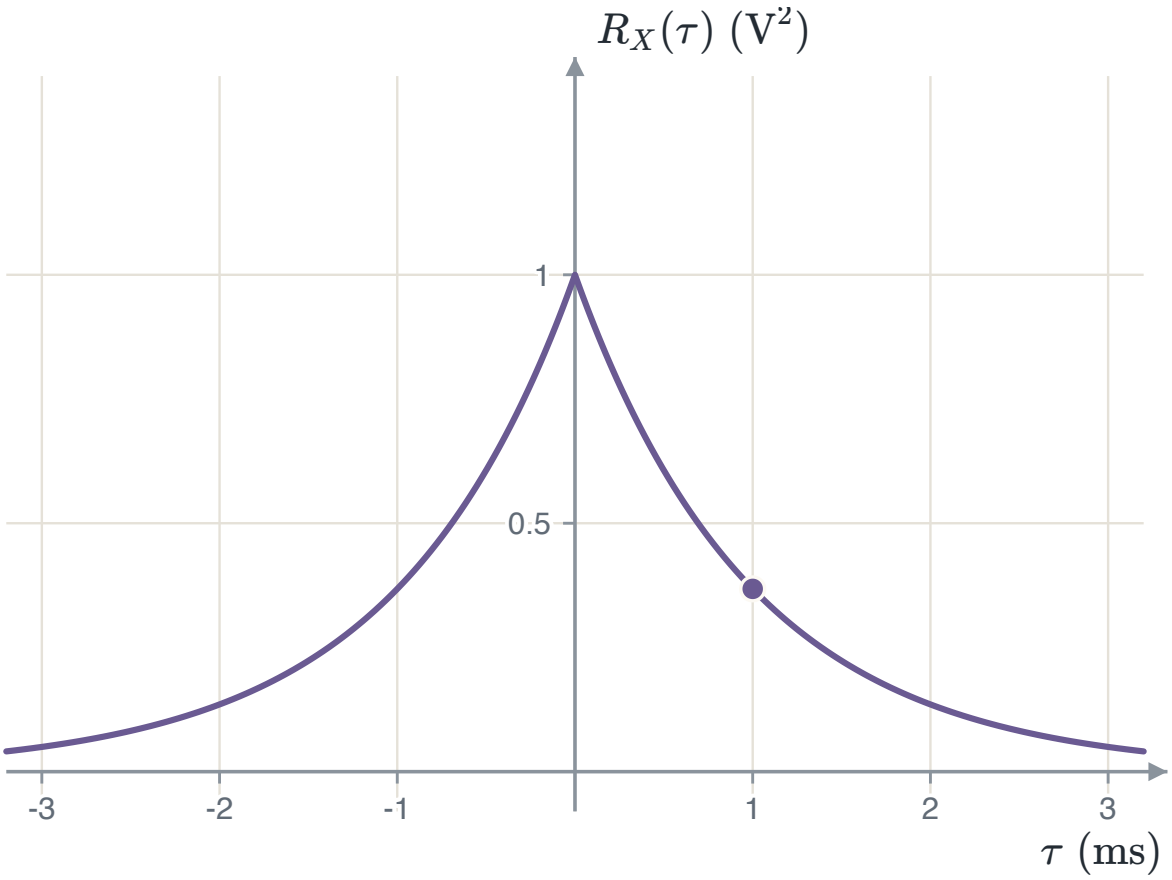


FIGURE 2.4 The autocorrelation at a gap of 1 ms is 0.37 V^2. A nonzero gap can retain a nonzero correlation.

Wide-sense stationarity

For **wide-sense stationarity** (WSS), the finite mean is constant and the finite autocorrelation depends only on the gap.

> WSS CONDITIONS
>
> $$\mu_X(t) = \mu_X, \qquad R_X(t, t+\tau) = R_X(\tau)$$
>
> Moving the observation window preserves these ensemble statistics. It does not preserve the readings of an individual waveform.

A **strict-sense stationary** process preserves every joint distribution under a common shift of all observation times. With finite second moments, this implies WSS.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

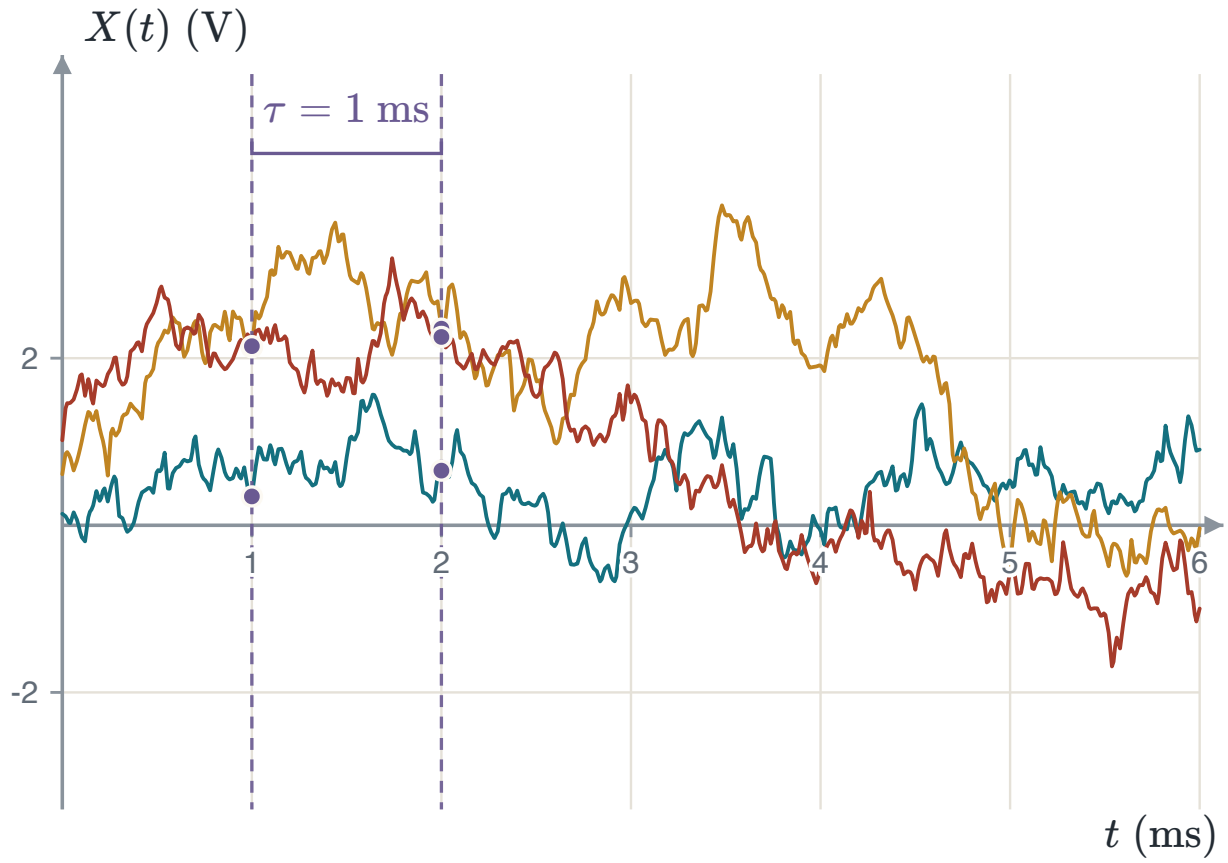


FIGURE 2.5 Three recordings read at $t = 1$ ms and $t + \tau = 2$ ms. Moving both readings by the same shift changes the values, but for a WSS process their average product stays $R_X(1\text{ ms}) = 0.37\text{ V}^2$.

Strict-sense stationarity

A **strict-sense stationary** (SSS) process keeps every joint distribution when all observation times move by the same shift Δ.

SHIFT INVARIANCE

$$f_{X(t_1),\ldots,X(t_n)}(x_1,\ldots,x_n) = f_{X(t_1+\Delta),\ldots,X(t_n+\Delta)}(x_1,\ldots,x_n)$$

Here x_i is a value of $X(t_i)$. This holds for every n, every choice of times and every shift Δ. With finite second moments, SSS implies WSS.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

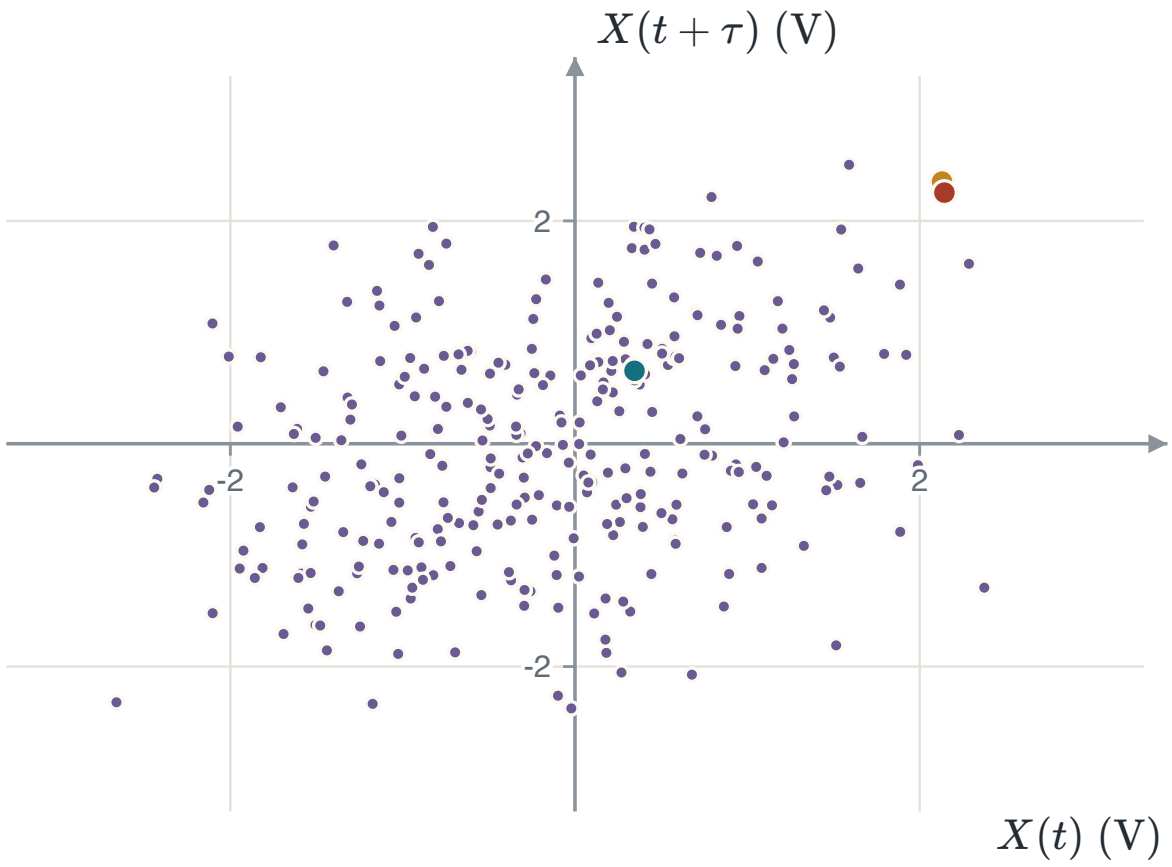


FIGURE 2.6 Each dot holds two readings, at $t = 1$ ms and $t + \tau = 2$ ms, from one of 300 recordings. Moving t leaves the shape of the cloud unchanged. Two readings show only the first two orders of the joint distribution.

Autocorrelation and power

At zero gap, each reading is multiplied by itself. Its expectation is the mean-square power P_X.

POWER

$$R_X(0) = E[X^2(t)] = P_X$$

For a real WSS process, exchanging the two readings leaves their product unchanged. Set $s = t - \tau$ to obtain symmetry.

EVEN AUTOCORRELATION

$$R_X(-\tau) = E[X(s+\tau)X(s)] = R_X(\tau)$$

The mean square of a sum or difference is nonnegative. Expand the square using both signs.

BOUND

$$E[(X(t) \pm X(t+\tau))^2] = 2R_X(0) \pm 2R_X(\tau) \geq 0$$
$$-R_X(0) \leq R_X(\tau) \leq R_X(0)$$
$$|R_X(\tau)| \leq R_X(0)$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

For $R_X(\tau) = 4e^{-|\tau|/2}\cos(2\pi\tau)\ \mathrm{V}^2$, with τ in ms, $P_X = 4\ \mathrm{V}^2$. Across $1\ \Omega$, that corresponds to 4 W.

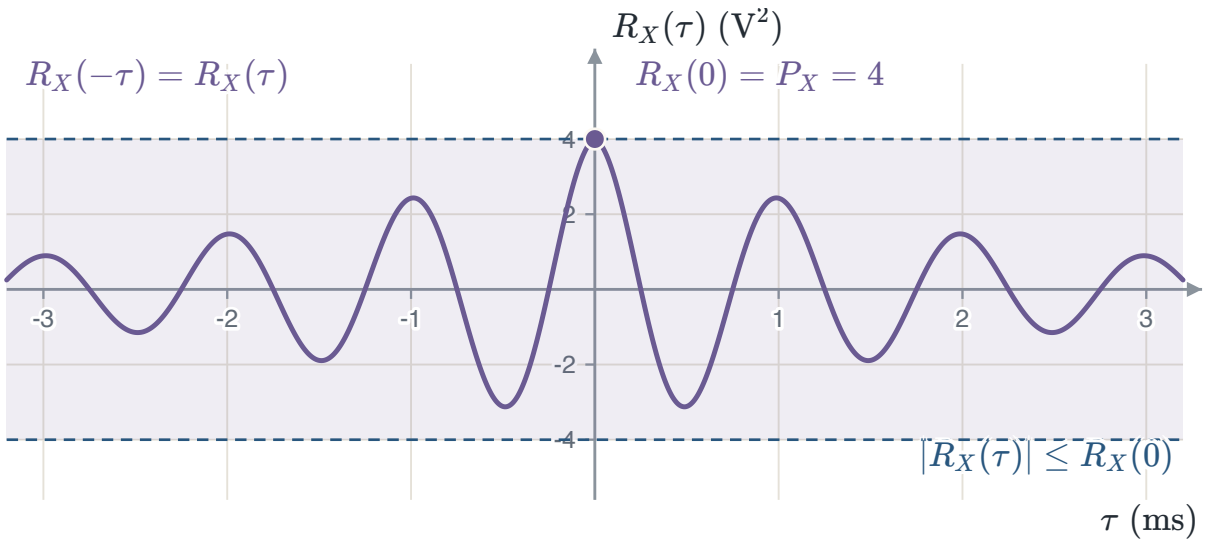


FIGURE 2.7 The real WSS autocorrelation is even, has value $4\ \mathrm{V}^2$ at zero, and remains bounded by that magnitude.

Worked example: a sinusoid with a random phase

EXAMPLE 2.1 — A SINUSOID WITH A RANDOM PHASE

GIVEN — $X(t) = A\cos(2\pi f_0 t + \Theta)$ with $A = 3$ V, $f_0 = 1$ kHz and Θ uniform on $[0, 2\pi)$, so its density there is $1/(2\pi)$.

FIND — The mean μ_X, the autocorrelation $R_X(\tau)$ and the power P_X.

METHOD — Average over the phase with its density. Turn the product of two cosines into a sum with $\cos a \cos b = \tfrac{1}{2}\cos(a-b) + \tfrac{1}{2}\cos(a+b)$.

SOLUTION — The mean is $\mu_X = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int_0^{2\pi} A\cos(2\pi f_0 t + \theta)\,d\theta = 0$, since a cosine integrates to zero over a full period of θ. With $\phi = 2\pi f_0(2t+\tau)$, $R_X = \frac{A^2}{2}E\big[\cos(2\pi f_0\tau)\big] + \frac{A^2}{2}E\big[\cos(\phi + 2\Theta)\big]$. The second average is zero for the same reason. So $R_X(\tau) = \frac{A^2}{2}\cos(2\pi f_0\tau) = 4.5\cos(2\pi f_0\tau)\ \mathrm{V}^2$ and $P_X = R_X(0) = 4.5\ \mathrm{V}^2$.

CHECK — The mean is constant and R_X depends on τ only, so the process is wide-sense stationary. The time average of one sample function, $A^2\cos^2$ over a period, is also $A^2/2 = 4.5\ \mathrm{V}^2$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

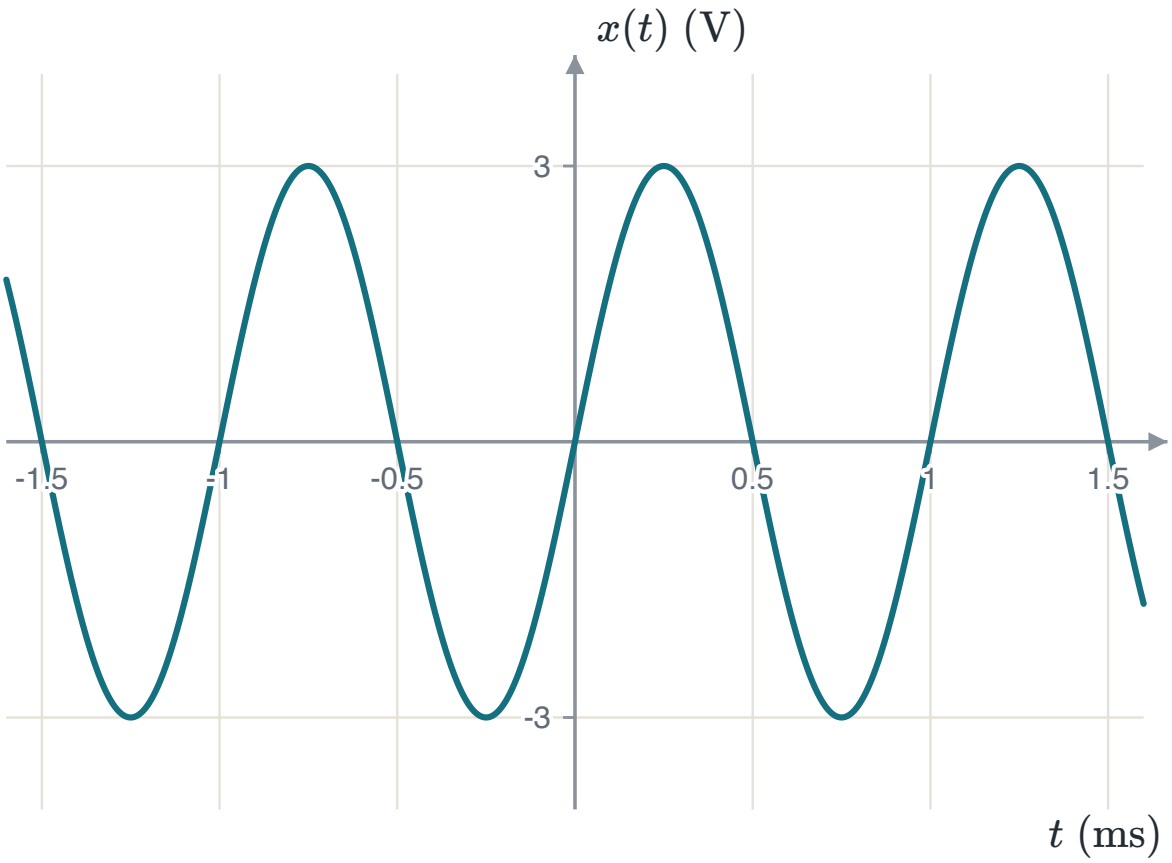


FIGURE 2.8 Example 2.1: one recording with $\theta = 3\pi/2$. Its voltage varies with time, while the ensemble mean over the uniform phase is zero.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $A^2/2$, not A^2, for the power of the sinusoid. Dropping the $\frac{1}{2}$ gives $9\ \mathrm{V}^2$.

Power spectral density

The **power spectral density** (PSD) describes power per unit frequency. For a WSS process, it is the Fourier transform of the autocorrelation.

> WIENER–KHINCHIN
>
> $$S_X(f) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R_X(\tau) e^{-j2\pi f\tau}\, d\tau$$
>
> For a real process, the PSD is real, even and nonnegative. Generalized Fourier transforms include spectral lines.

For the exponential autocorrelation, symmetry cancels the odd sine term. Integrate the remaining cosine term.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CORRELATION TIME AND BANDWIDTH

$$\begin{aligned} S_X(f) &= 2\int_0^\infty e^{-\tau/\tau_c}\cos(2\pi f\tau)\,d\tau \\ &= \frac{2(1/\tau_c)}{(1/\tau_c)^2+(2\pi f)^2} \\ &= \frac{2\tau_c}{1+(2\pi f\tau_c)^2} \end{aligned}$$

Use $\int_0^\infty e^{-a\tau}\cos(b\tau)d\tau = a/(a^2+b^2)$ with $a = 1/\tau_c > 0$. The half-power frequency is $1/(2\pi\tau_c)$.

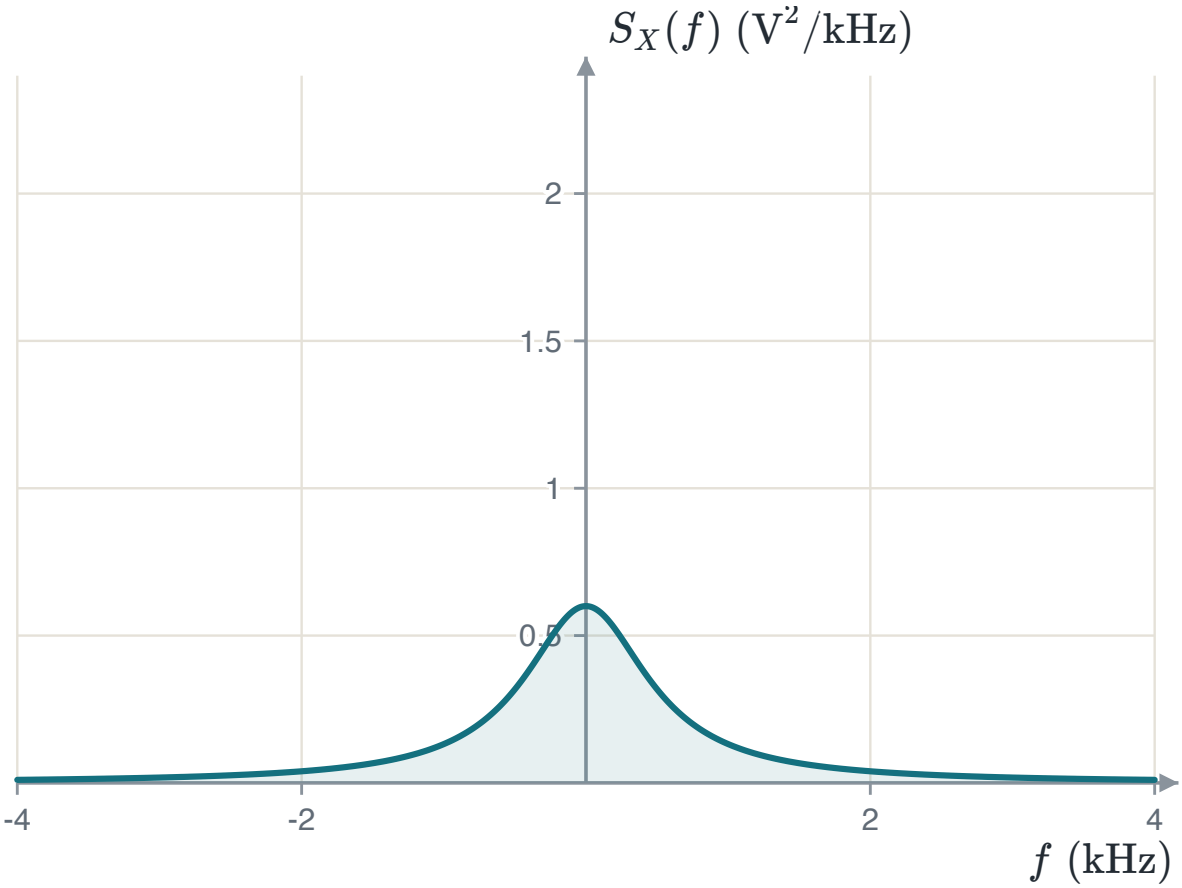


FIGURE 2.9 With $\tau_c = 0.3$ ms, the PSD spreads around zero frequency. Increasing the correlation time narrows the spectrum while preserving total power.

Power from the spectrum

Set the time gap to zero in the inverse transform. The exponential becomes one, so the integral is the total power.

SPECTRAL AREA

$$\begin{aligned} R_X(\tau) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} S_X(f)e^{j2\pi f\tau}\,df \\ P_X = R_X(0) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} S_X(f)\,df \end{aligned}$$

For $S_X(f) = 10^{-3}$ W/Hz on $|f| < 5$ kHz, integrate over both halves of the band.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

RECTANGLE AREA

$$\begin{aligned} P_X &= \int_{-5000}^{5000} 10^{-3}\, df \\ &= [10^{-3} f]_{-5000}^{5000} \\ &= 10^{-3}(5000 - (-5000)) = 10\ \mathrm{W} \end{aligned}$$

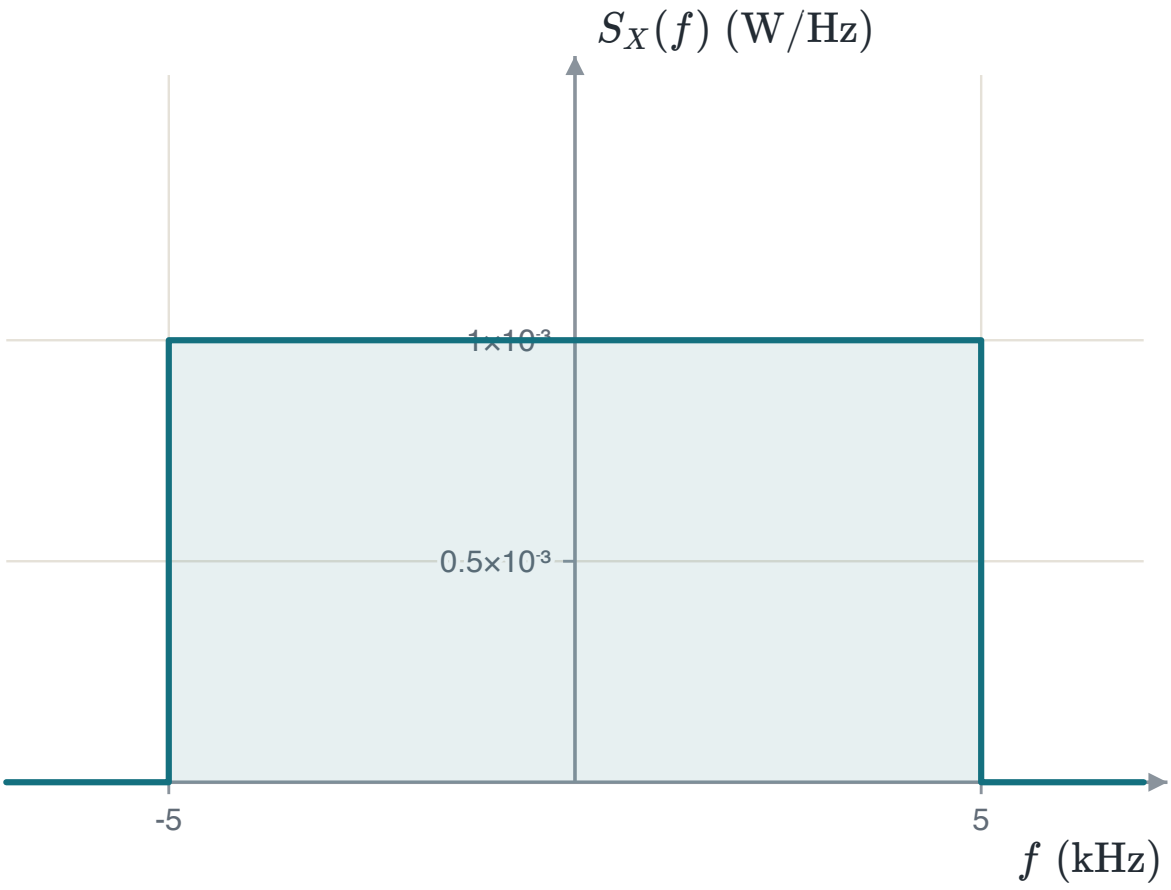


FIGURE 2.10 The two-sided spectrum has height 10^{-3} W/Hz and total width 10 kHz. Its area is 10 W.

Noise in a finite band

Begin with zero-mean noise having a flat two-sided density $N_0/2$ on $|f| < B$. The density is zero outside the band.

NOISE POWER

$$\begin{aligned} P_w &= \int_{-B}^{B} \frac{N_0}{2}\, df \\ &= \frac{N_0}{2}(B - (-B)) = N_0 B \end{aligned}$$

The band has total width $2B$. Doubling B doubles the power when the density stays fixed.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

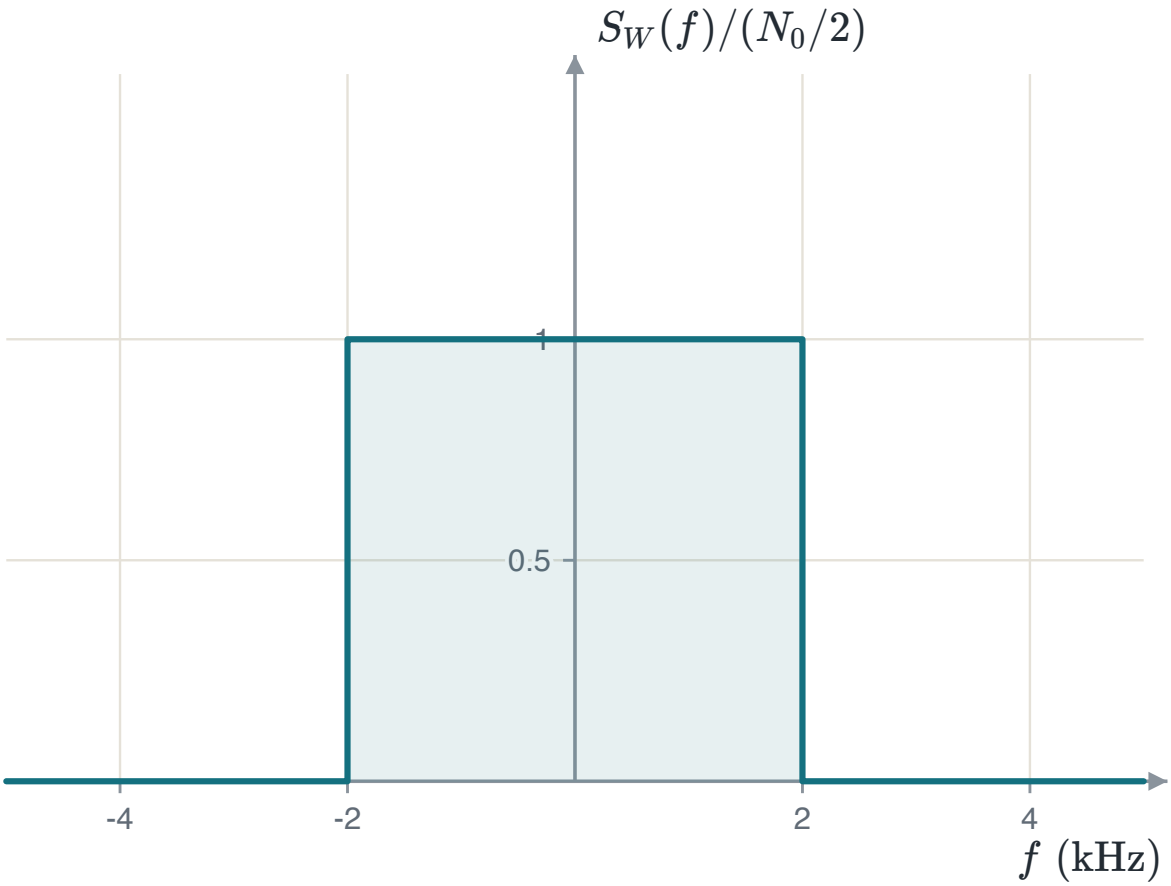


FIGURE 2.11 The flat spectrum occupies $|f| < 2$ kHz. Both frequency halves contribute to the noise power.

Bandlimited noise samples

Take the inverse transform of the finite-band spectrum. The result describes relationships between noise readings at different times.

AUTOCORRELATION

$$\begin{aligned} R_w(\tau) &= \int_{-B}^{B} \frac{N_0}{2} e^{j2\pi f\tau}\, df \\ &= \frac{N_0}{2}\,\frac{\sin(2\pi B\tau)}{\pi\tau} \\ &= N_0 B\,\operatorname{sinc}(2B\tau) \end{aligned}$$

Here $\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$ and $\operatorname{sinc}(0) = 1$. The value at zero follows by continuity.

The zeros occur at $\tau = k/(2B)$ for nonzero integer k. For $B = 1$ MHz and $\tau = 0.5\ \mu$s, $2B\tau = 1$, so the samples are uncorrelated.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

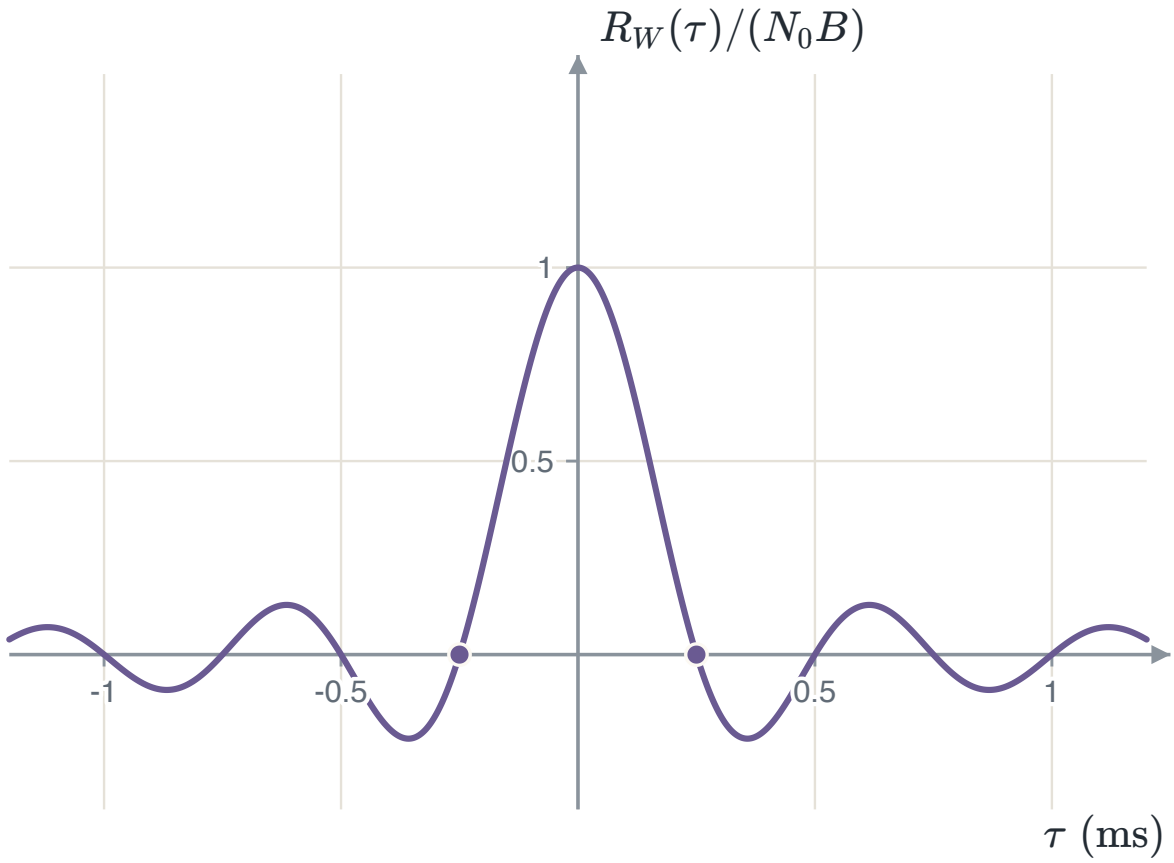


FIGURE 2.12 At $B = 2$ kHz, the first zeros are at $\tau = \pm 0.25$ ms. Other nonzero gaps can retain correlation.

The white-noise model

Ideal **white noise** extends the constant PSD over all frequencies. Its total power is infinite, so it is a generalized model.

IDEAL WHITE NOISE

$$S_w(f) = \frac{N_0}{2}, \qquad R_w(\tau) = \frac{N_0}{2}\delta(\tau)$$

A constant spectrum transforms to an impulse in the generalized sense. Ideal white noise is defined through weighted integrals rather than finite-variance point samples.

⚠ FINITE RECEIVER BAND

At 300 K, thermal noise stays within 10% of flat up to 10^{12} Hz. Practical receiver filtering admits finite noise power.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

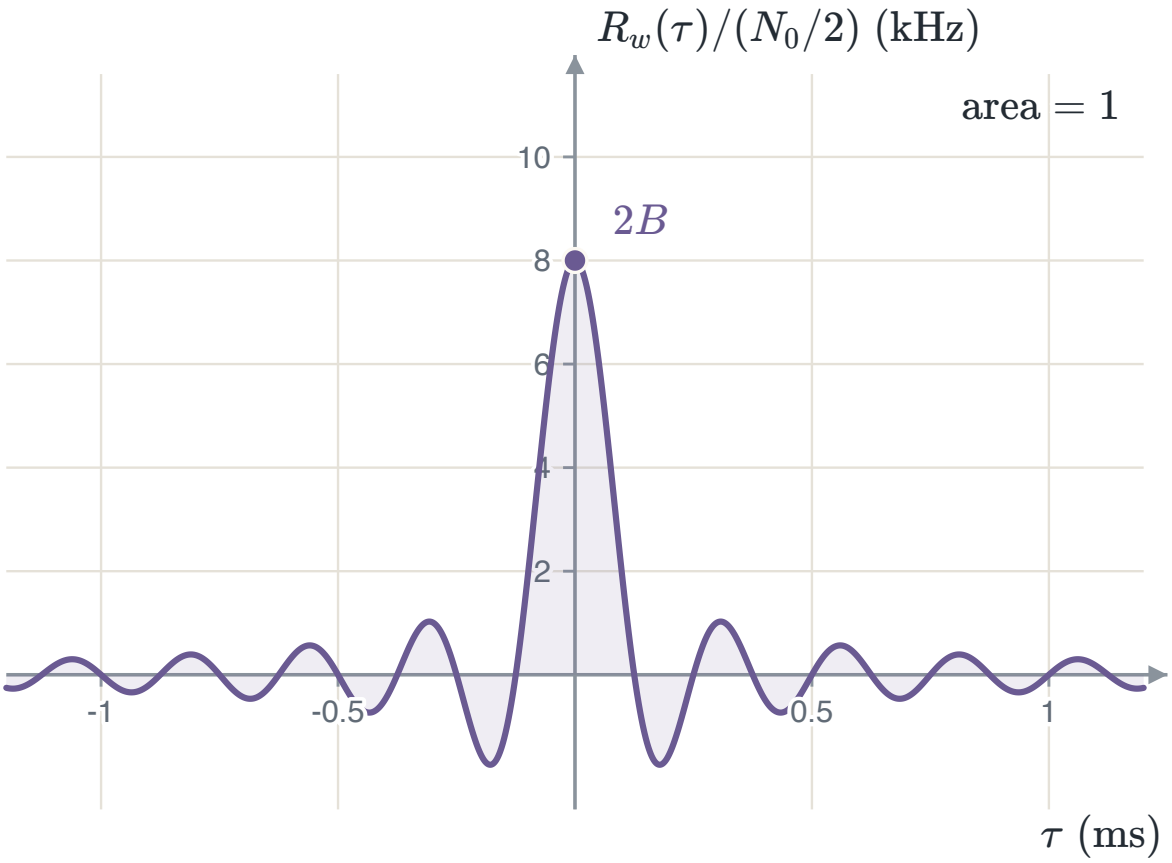


FIGURE 2.13 At $B = 4$ kHz the peak is $2B = 8$ kHz and the lobe is narrow, while the area stays 1. As B grows without limit, $R_w(\tau)/(N_0/2)$ tends to the impulse $\delta(\tau)$.

The mean through a filter

An LTI filter weights delayed input values. For a WSS input, take the expectation inside the convolution integral.

MEAN

$$\begin{aligned}\mu_Y &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} h(u) E[X(t-u)]\, du \\ &= \mu_X \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} h(u)\, du \\ &= \mu_X H(0)\end{aligned}$$

Line 1: $E[\cdot]$ is linear, and $h(u)$ is not random, so E acts only on X. Line 2: for a WSS input $E[X(t-u)] = \mu_X$ is constant, so it leaves the integral. Line 3: since $H(f) = \int h(u) e^{-j2\pi f u} du$, setting $f = 0$ makes the exponential 1, so $\int h(u)\, du = H(0)$, the DC gain. Assume these integrals and output statistics exist. An ideal differentiator removes a constant mean when its output is defined for the input process.

For $\mu_X = 3$ V and $H(f) = j2\pi f$, $\mu_Y = 3H(0) = 0$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

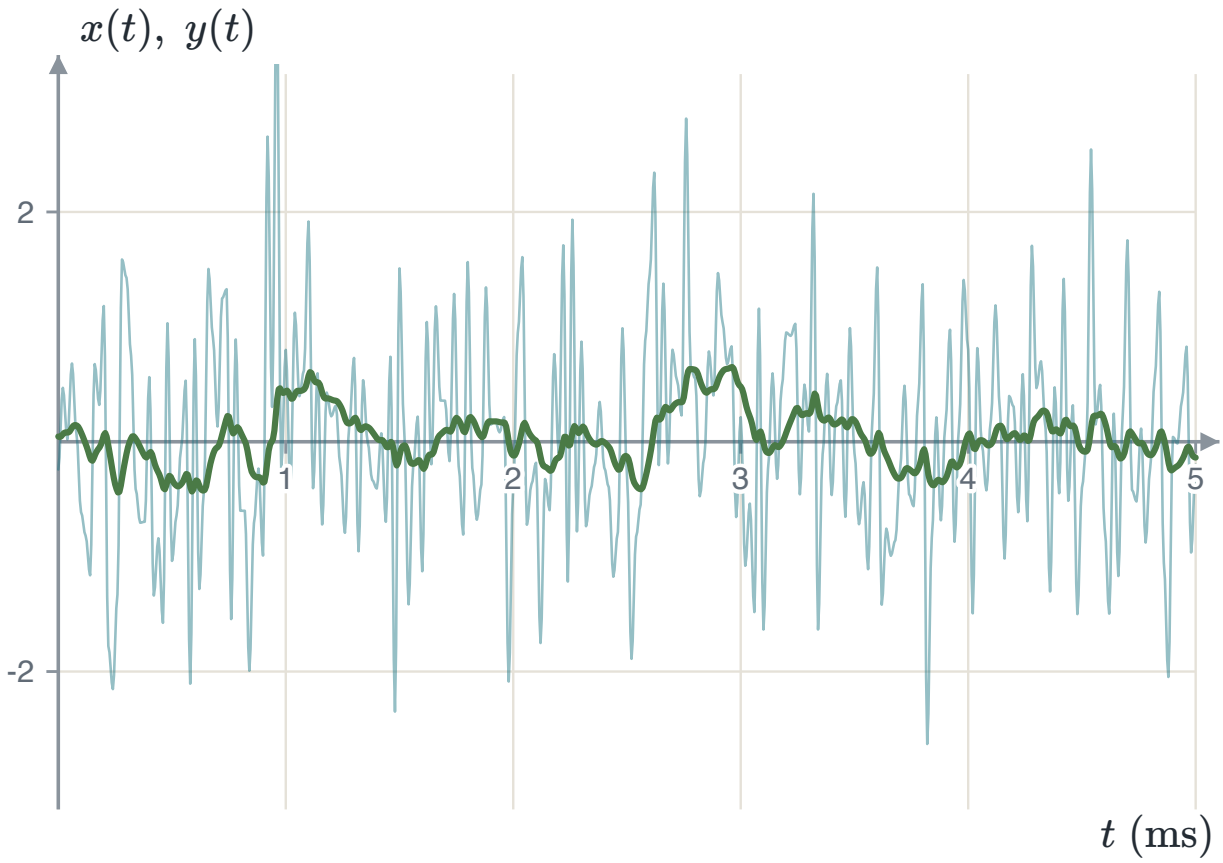


FIGURE 2.14 An illustrative input recording and its RC-filtered output. The filter smooths variations. Its DC gain determines the ensemble mean.

The spectrum through a filter

For a real LTI filter and a WSS input, the output PSD follows from the input PSD and the filter.

For receiver noise, use $X(t) = w(t)$ and $Y(t) = n(t)$. Thus $S_n(f) = |H(f)|^2 S_w(f)$.

OUTPUT SPECTRUM

$$\begin{aligned} S_Y(f) &= H(f)H^*(f)S_X(f) \\ &= |H(f)|^2 S_X(f) \end{aligned}$$

Assume the output statistics exist. A magnitude gain of $1/2$ gives a power gain of $1/4$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

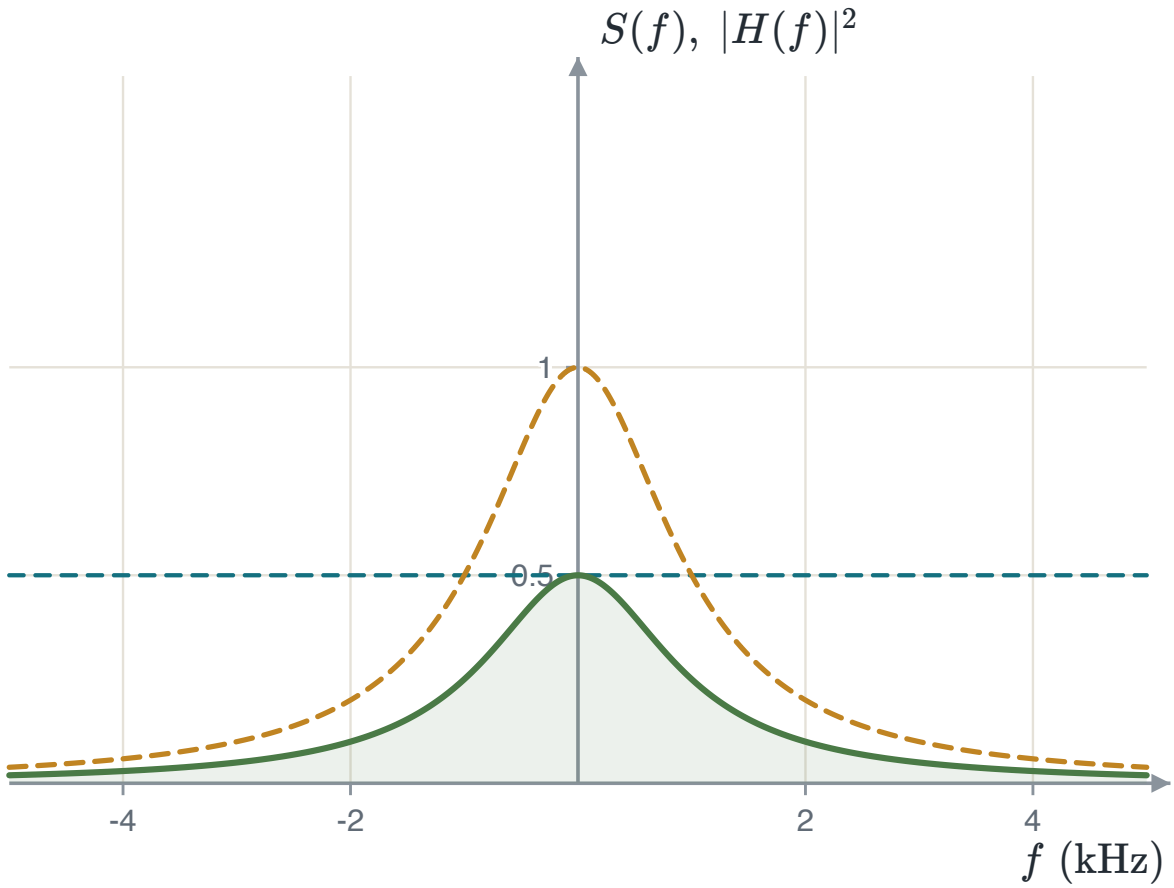


FIGURE 2.15 The output PSD equals the input PSD multiplied by $|H(f)|^2. The RC filter passes low frequencies more strongly than high frequencies.

Filtered white noise

For white input, the output PSD is $(N_0/2)|H(f)|^2$. Its area is the output noise power.

OUTPUT NOISE POWER

$$P_n = \frac{N_0}{2}\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |H(f)|^2 df$$

A finite-energy filter admits finite noise power. Equal areas under the power gain give equal output noise powers.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

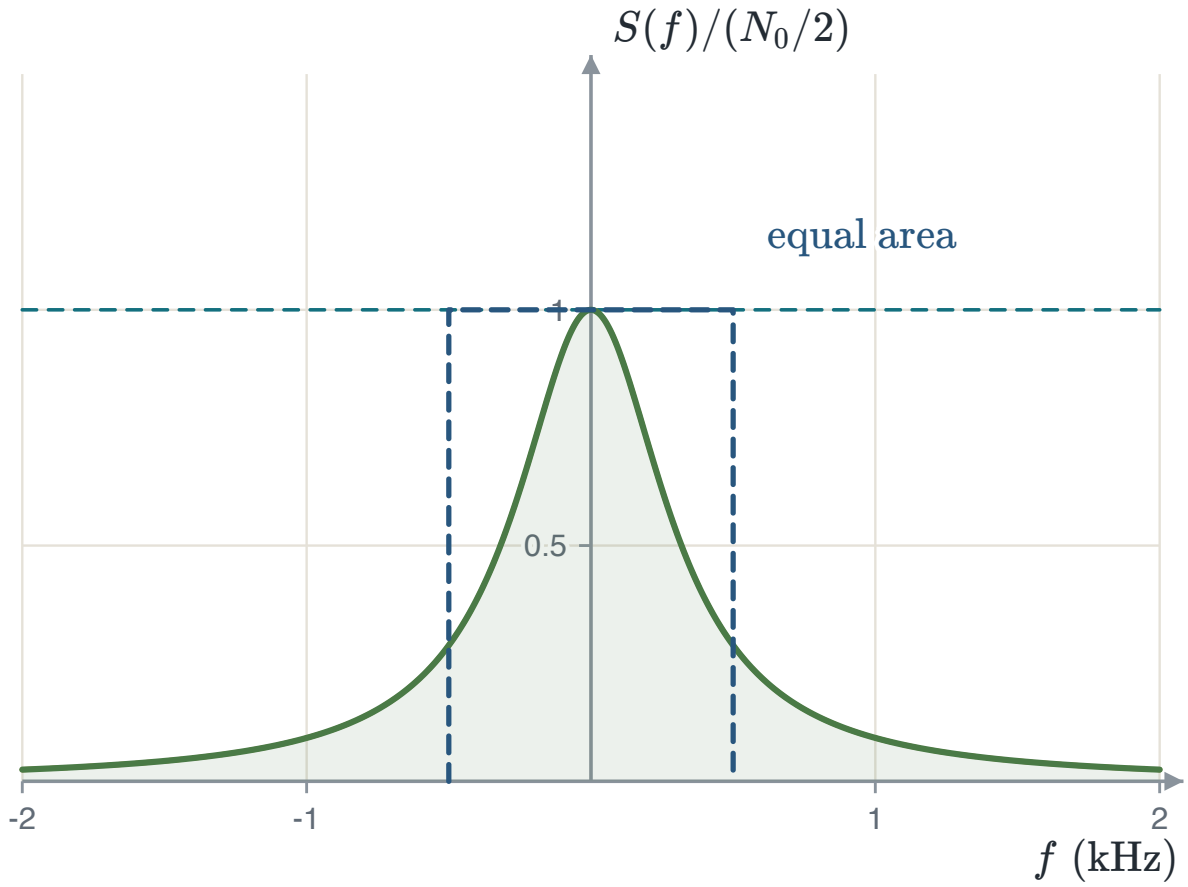


FIGURE 2.16 The filter gain $|H(f)|^2$ shapes the flat input PSD. The area under the output PSD is the output noise power, and a rectangle of equal area gives the same power.

Noise-equivalent bandwidth

Replace the power gain by a rectangle of equal peak and area. Both filters pass equal white-noise power.

DEFINITION

$$B_{\text{neq}} = \frac{\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |H(f)|^2 df}{2H_{\max}^2}$$
$$P_n = N_0 B_{\text{neq}} H_{\max}^2$$

$H_{\max} = \max_f |H(f)|$. The noise-equivalent bandwidth is the half-width of this ideal filter, whose total width is $2B_{\text{neq}}$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

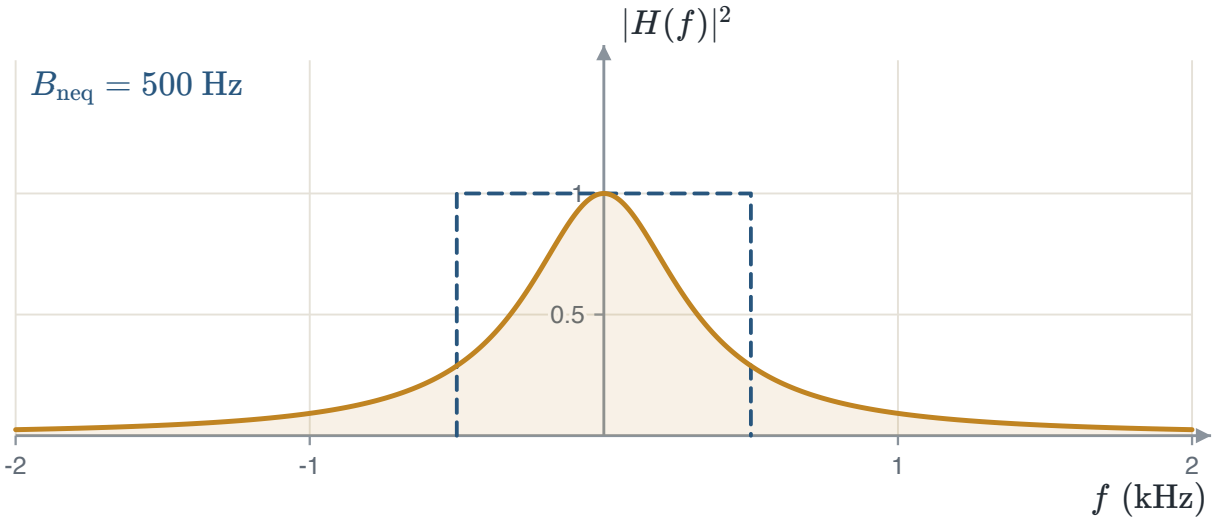


FIGURE 2.17 A lowpass filter and the dashed ideal filter have equal peak gain and equal total spectral area, including tails beyond the plotted range.

Noise bandwidth of an RC filter

The RC filter has $|H(f)|^2 = 1/[1 + (2\pi f RC)^2]$ and $H_{\max} = 1$. Substitute $u = 2\pi f RC$. The infinite limits remain infinite.

RC LOWPASS

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |H(f)|^2 df &= \frac{1}{2\pi RC}\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{du}{1+u^2} \\ &= \frac{1}{2\pi RC}[\arctan u]_{-\infty}^{\infty} \\ &= \frac{1}{2\pi RC}(\pi/2 - (-\pi/2)) \\ &= \frac{1}{2RC} \\ B_{\text{neq}} &= \frac{1}{4RC}\end{aligned}$$

The 3 dB frequency is $1/(2\pi RC)$. The equivalent bandwidth is $\pi/2$ times this frequency.

EXAMPLE 2.2 — WHITE NOISE THROUGH AN RC FILTER

GIVEN White noise with $N_0/2 = 10^{-8}$ W/Hz enters an RC lowpass filter with $RC = 1$ ms.

FIND The noise-equivalent bandwidth B_{neq} and the output noise power P_n.

METHOD Use $B_{\text{neq}} = 1/(4RC)$ with $H_{\max} = 1$, then $P_n = N_0 B_{\text{neq}}$. The formula needs only the area of $|H(f)|^2$.

SOLUTION $B_{\text{neq}} = 1/(4 \times 10^{-3}) = 250$ Hz. With $N_0 = 2 \times 10^{-8}$ W/Hz, $P_n = (2 \times 10^{-8})(250) = 5 \times 10^{-6}$ W.

CHECK Work in time instead. The impulse response is $h(t) = \frac{1}{RC}e^{-t/RC}$ for $t \geq 0$, so $\int_0^{\infty} h^2(t)\,dt = \frac{1}{R^2C^2} \cdot \frac{RC}{2} = \frac{1}{2RC} = 500\ \text{s}^{-1}$. By Parseval, $P_n = \frac{N_0}{2}\int h^2\,dt = (10^{-8})(500) = 5 \times 10^{-6}$ W.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use $B_{\text{neq}} = 1/(4RC)$, not the 3 dB frequency $1/(2\pi RC)$, for the noise power. The 3 dB width gives 3.18×10^{-6} W, which is $\pi/2$ too small.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Gaussian noise

Draw n independent random numbers, each flat on $[-1, 1]$, and add them. Scale the sum by $\sqrt{n/3}$ so its variance is 1. Repeat many times and plot how often each value of Z occurs.

One source gives a flat box. Two give a triangle. Five already look like a bell. Thermal noise is a sum of a huge number of tiny independent motions, so it is Gaussian.

White describes the PSD. Gaussian describes joint distributions. These properties are distinct. A linear filter preserves Gaussianity when the output variance is finite.

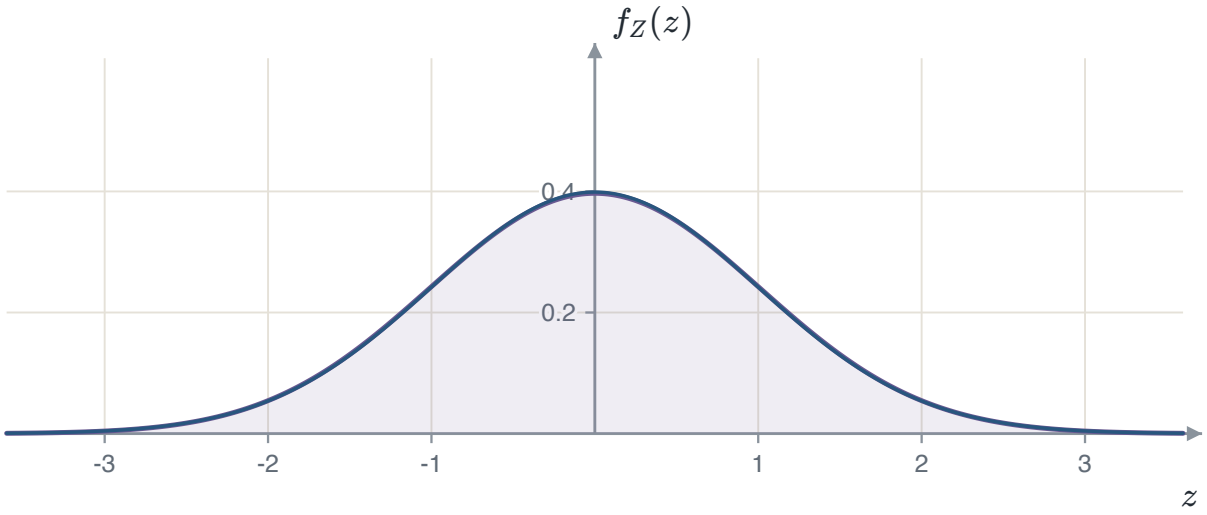


FIGURE 2.18 The sum of thirty independent uniform sources, scaled to unit variance, closely follows a Gaussian density.

From a noise waveform to one sample

The filtered noise $n(t)$ is a random process. At the end of a bit of duration T_b, the receiver reads $n = n(T_b)$.

FILTERED WHITE GAUSSIAN NOISE

$$n = n(T_b) \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma_n^2)$$
$$\sigma_n^2 = E[n^2] = \frac{N_0}{2} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |H(f)|^2 df$$

For zero-mean noise, variance equals mean-square power. The filter sets the spread of the sample distribution.

A sample above a threshold occupies a tail of the Gaussian density. Normalize the threshold by the standard deviation.

GAUSSIAN TAIL

$$P(n > a) = Q(a/\sigma_n)$$
$$P(n > 4\,\text{mV}) = Q(4/2) = Q(2) \approx 0.0228$$

Here $\sigma_n = 2$ mV. For a Gaussian X with mean μ and standard deviation σ, $P(X > z) = Q\big((z - \mu)/\sigma\big)$. This noise sample will later enter the receiver decision statistic.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

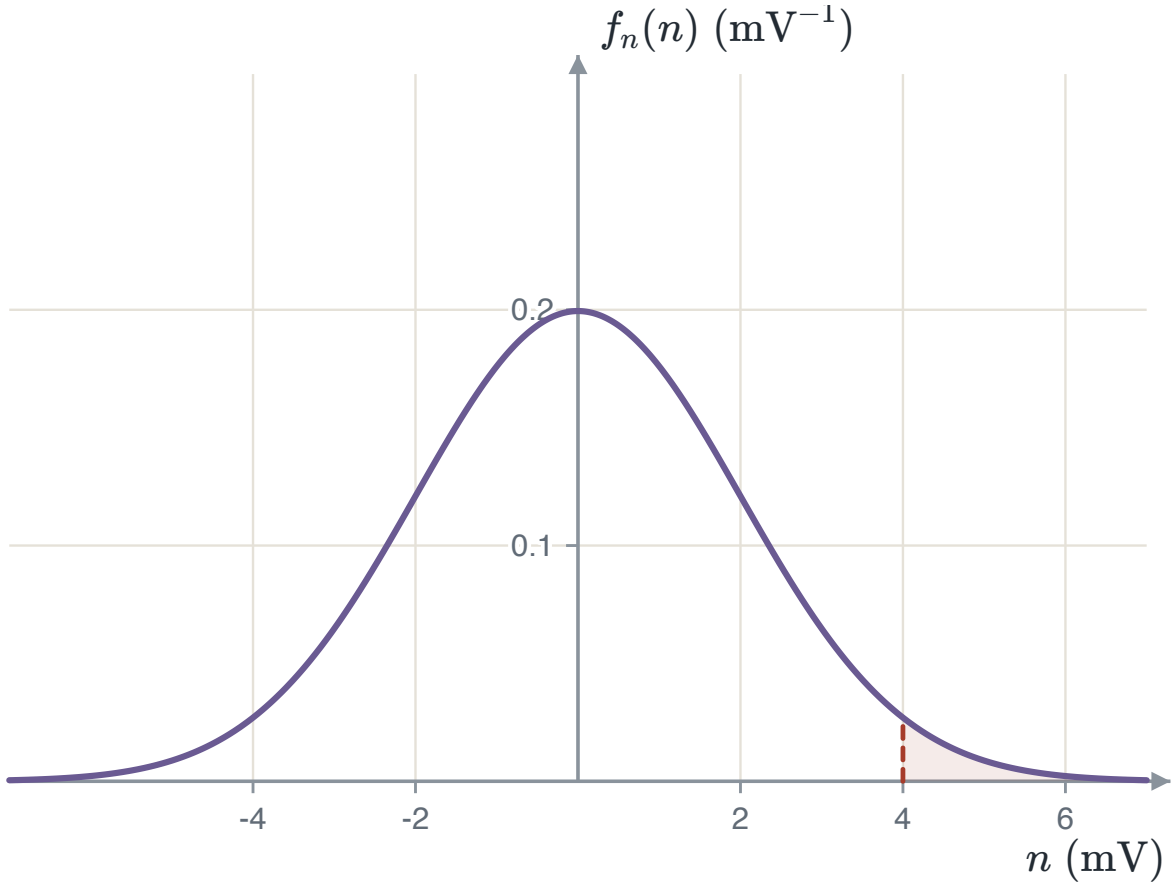


FIGURE 2.19 A zero-mean Gaussian sample with standard deviation 2 mV. The shaded tail above 4 mV has probability approximately 0.0228.

Random signals around us

Random signals appear in every resistor, in speech coders, in receiver noise floors and in scrambled data.

- **Thermal noise.** A $1\ \mathrm{k}\Omega$ resistor at $T = 290$ K in a band $B = 1$ MHz has $v_{\mathrm{rms}} = \sqrt{4kTRB} = 4.0\ \mu$V.
- **Pitch.** A vowel is a sum of harmonics of its pitch f_0. A speech coder finds $f_0 = 125$ Hz where $R(\tau)$ peaks again, at $T_0 = 8$ ms.
- **Noise floor.** At $T = 290$ K, $N_0 = kT = -174$ dBm/Hz. A 20 MHz Wi-Fi channel collects $kTB = -101$ dBm.
- **Scrambled data.** The 15-chip shift-register sequence $c[n]$ has $R[k] = \frac{1}{15}\sum_{n} c[n]\,c[n+k]$ equal to 1 at $k = 0$ and $-1/15$ elsewhere, so it looks white.

> ⚠ BANDWIDTH COSTS NOISE
>
> Noise power grows by 10 dB for every factor of 10 in bandwidth. So a receiver filters to the band of its signal.

2.2 The matched filter

Additive Gaussian noise

Each bit is sent as a pulse, $g(t) = +1$ or -1 for one bit time T. The channel adds noise $w(t)$ to it. The receiver sees the sum.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

ADDITIVE NOISE

$$x(t) = g(t) + w(t), \qquad w(t) \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$$

At each instant the noise is a Gaussian value with mean 0 and standard deviation σ. Its size against the pulse decides how hard the bit is to read.

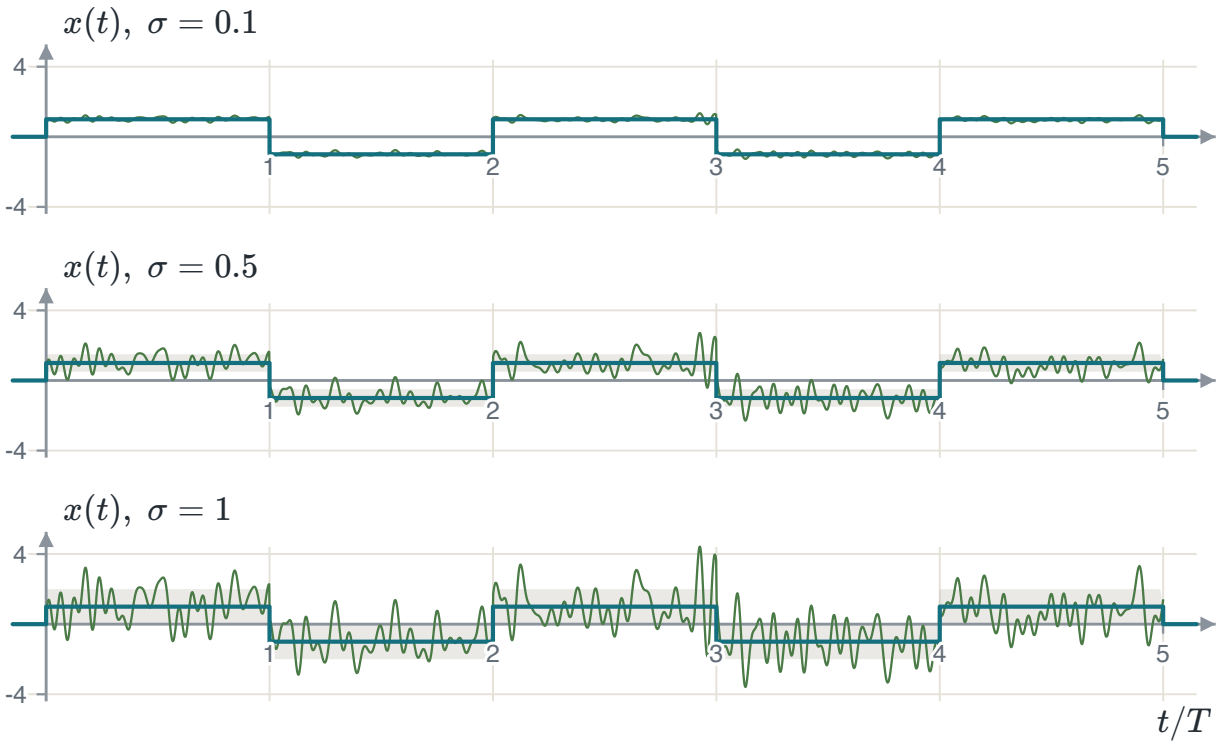


FIGURE 2.20 Five polar bits $g(t) = \pm 1$ (cyan) and the received $x(t)$ (green) at three noise levels, $\sigma = 0.1$, 0.5 and 1. The shaded band is $g(t) \pm \sigma$. The noise is one bandlimited Gaussian realisation, scaled by σ.

Read $x(t)$ at one instant t_0 inside a $+1$ bit. The sample is Gaussian with mean 1 and standard deviation σ. It has the wrong sign when the noise is below -1.

ONE SAMPLE OF A $+1$ BIT

$$P\big(x(t_0) < 0\big) = P\big(w(t_0) < -1\big) = Q\Big(\frac{1}{\sigma}\Big)$$

$Q(x)$ is the chance that a standard Gaussian value exceeds x: $Q(x) = \int_x^\infty \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-u^2/2}\, du$. For a Gaussian X with mean μ and standard deviation σ, $P(X > z) = Q\big((z-\mu)/\sigma\big)$. At $\sigma = 0.1$ the chance is $Q(10)$, about 10^{-23}. At $\sigma = 0.5$ it is $Q(2) = 0.023$, and at $\sigma = 1$ it is $Q(1) = 0.16$. At $\sigma = 0.25$ it is $Q(4) = 3.2 \times 10^{-5}$.

One sample is a poor guide when σ is near the pulse height. The receiver should use the whole bit. A filter does that, and the rest of this section finds the best one.

Choosing the receive filter

The receiver reads one number, $y(T)$, and decides the bit from it. The pulse puts a value there and the noise moves it. The receive filter $h(t)$ decides how far the noise moves it.

The task of this section is to choose $h(t)$ so that the pulse part of $y(T)$ is as large as possible against the noise part.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

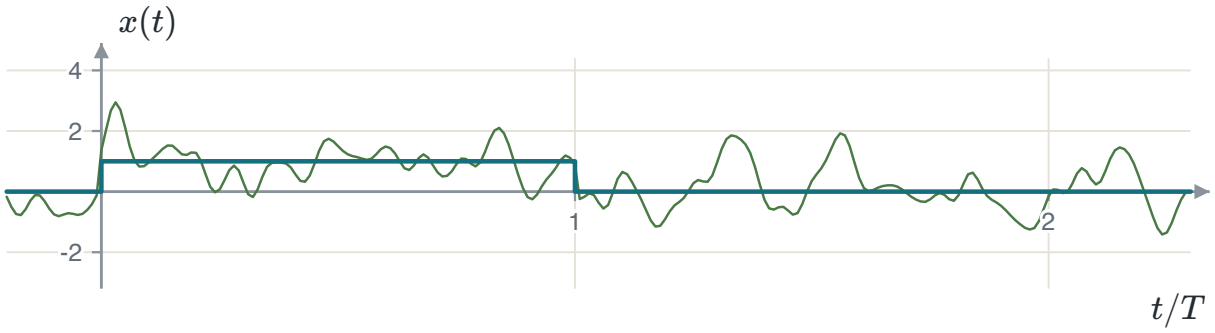


FIGURE 2.21 One rectangular pulse $g(t)$ (cyan) on $[0, T]$, buried in white noise. The green line is the input $x(t)$.

A first try is an RC lowpass filter. Its impulse response decays with the time constant τ. The output noise power is $\frac{N_0}{2}\int h^2(t)\,dt$, the filtered white noise result of Section 2.1.

AN RC FILTER

$$h(t) = \frac{1}{\tau}\,e^{-t/\tau}, \qquad t \geq 0$$

$$E[n^2] = \frac{N_0}{2}\int_0^\infty \frac{e^{-2t/\tau}}{\tau^2}\,dt = \frac{N_0}{2}\cdot\frac{1}{2\tau} = \frac{N_0}{4\tau}$$

A small τ passes a wide band of noise. For example, making τ ten times smaller makes $E[n^2]$ ten times larger. A large τ passes little noise, but it also smooths the pulse away.

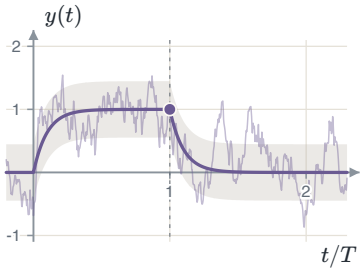


FIGURE 2.22 RC, $\tau = T/10$: the pulse passes, and so does much noise.

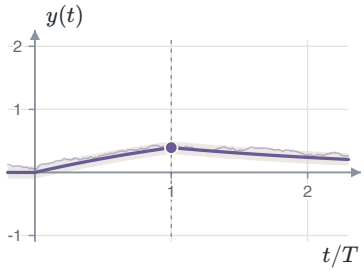


FIGURE 2.23 RC, $\tau = 2T$: little noise passes, and the pulse is smoothed away.

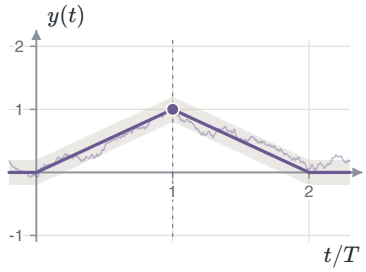


FIGURE 2.24 The matched filter: a clear peak at $t = T$, with η at its bound.

Each panel shows the signal part of the output (heavy line), a band one noise standard deviation wide around it, and one noisy output. The rest of this section finds the best filter and the best value η can take.

The receiver model

One bit is sent as a pulse $g(t)$ on $0 \leq t \leq T$. The channel adds noise $w(t)$. The receiver passes the sum through a linear filter $h(t)$ and samples the output once, at $t = T$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

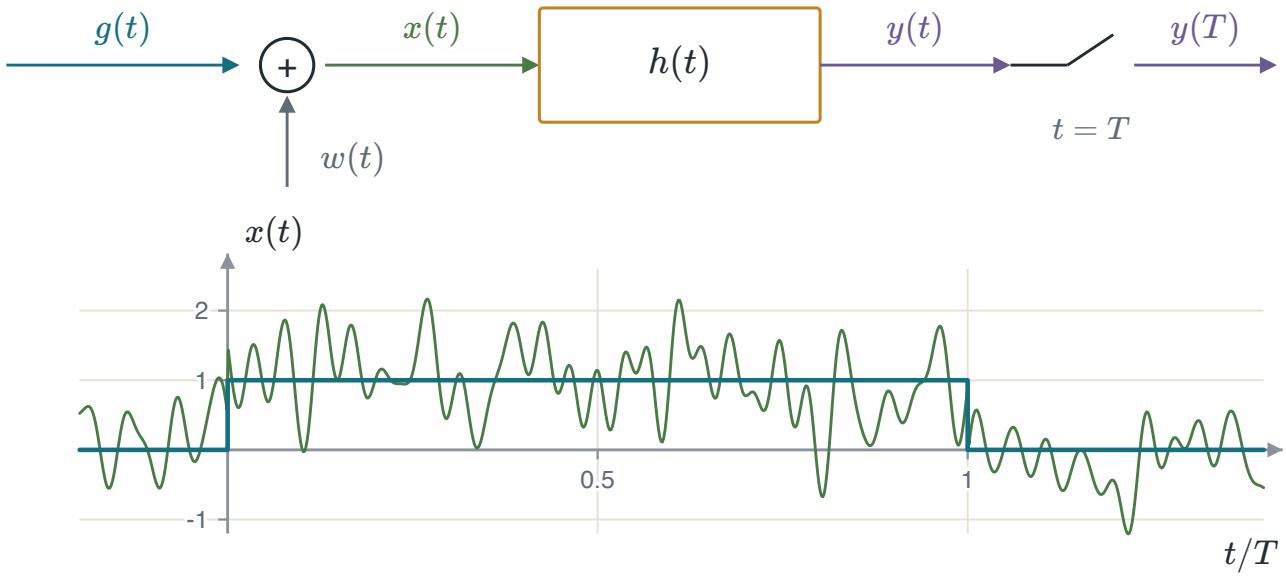


FIGURE 2.25 The receiver model. One pulse $g(t)$ on $[0, T]$ plus white noise $w(t)$ enters a linear filter, and the output is sampled once, at $t = T$. The lower panel shows one pulse (cyan) and the same pulse with noise on it (green).

RECEIVED SIGNAL

$$x(t) = g(t) + w(t), \qquad 0 \le t \le T$$

$g(t)$ is the pulse of one bit. $w(t)$ is the noise the channel adds.

The noise is white and Gaussian. White means that its power spectral density is flat. Its autocorrelation is then an impulse, so noise values at two different times are uncorrelated.

WHITE NOISE

$$S_W(f) = \frac{N_0}{2} \quad \text{for all } f$$
$$R_W(\tau) = \frac{N_0}{2}\,\delta(\tau), \qquad N_0 = k_B T_e$$

The density is two-sided: it is $N_0/2$ at every positive and every negative frequency. $k_B = 1.38 \times 10^{-23}$ J/K is Boltzmann's constant and T_e is the noise temperature of the receiver in kelvin. The subscript B keeps k_B apart from the filter gain k used below.

For example, $T_e = 290$ K gives $N_0 = k_B T_e = (1.38 \times 10^{-23})(290) = 4.0 \times 10^{-21}$ W/Hz. The two-sided density is then $N_0/2 = 2.0 \times 10^{-21}$ W/Hz.

Signal part and noise part

The filter is linear. So each part of the input passes through it on its own, and the output is the sum of two outputs.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TWO PARTS

$$y(t) = x(t) * h(t) = \underbrace{g(t) * h(t)}_{=g_0(t)} + \underbrace{w(t) * h(t)}_{=n(t)}$$

The **signal part** $g_0(t)$ is the output for the pulse alone. It is the same every time the bit is sent. The **noise part** $n(t)$ is the output for the noise alone, and it is random.

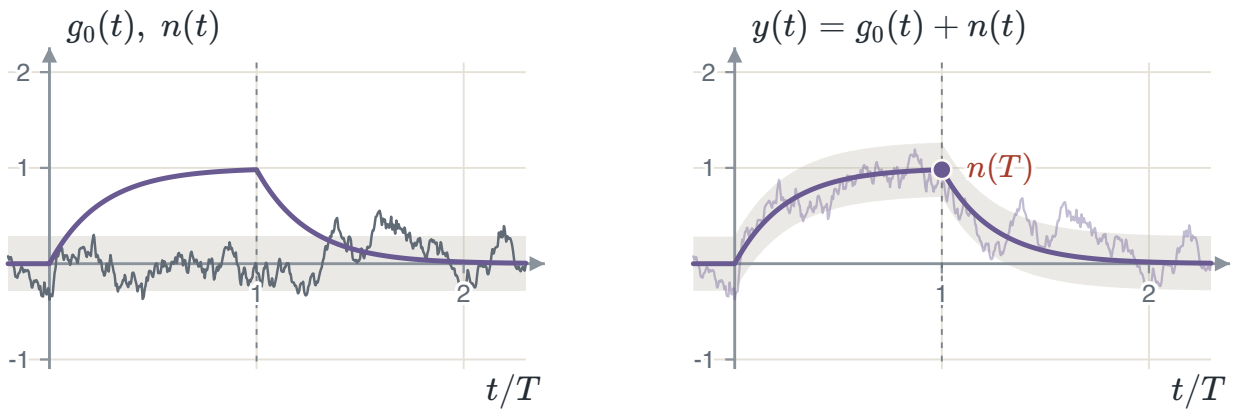


FIGURE 2.26 The noisy pulse through an RC filter with $\tau = T/4$. Left: the signal part $g_0(t)$ (violet) and the noise part $n(t)$ alone (grey), with a band one standard deviation wide. Right: their sum $y(t)$. At $t = T$ the noise moves the sample away from $g_0(T)$ by $n(T)$.

The noise part never vanishes. The filter cannot tell noise from pulse in the band the pulse uses. A filter with $g_0(T) \neq 0$ must have $H(f) \neq 0$ where $G(f) \neq 0$, and white noise has power at those frequencies. So the filter can only make $n(T)$ small against $g_0(T)$, never zero.

The peak pulse signal-to-noise ratio

The receiver reads one value, at $t = T$. The quality of that value is the signal power there against the noise power there.

PEAK PULSE SNR

$$\eta = \frac{|g_0(T)|^2}{E[n^2(T)]}$$

The ratio η is the **peak pulse signal-to-noise ratio**. For example, $g_0(T) = 2$ mV and $E[n^2(T)] = 10^{-6}\ \mathrm{V}^2$ give $\eta = (2 \times 10^{-3})^2/10^{-6} = 4$.

The instant T is chosen where the signal part is largest. The signal part rises while the pulse enters the filter and falls after the pulse has passed. So it peaks at $t = T$, the end of the pulse.

Convolution in time is a product in frequency. Take the inverse transform of that product and read it at $t = T$.

SIGNAL PART IN f

$$G_0(f) = G(f)\,H(f)$$
$$g_0(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G(f)\,H(f)\,e^{j2\pi ft}\,df$$
$$g_0(T) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G(f)\,H(f)\,e^{j2\pi fT}\,df$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

For the RC filter and the rectangular pulse, $g_0(T) = 1 - e^{-T/\tau}$ and $E[n^2] = N_0/(4\tau)$, with $E = T$. Divide one by the other and write $x = T/\tau$.

$$\frac{\eta}{2E/N_0} = \frac{(1 - e^{-x})^2}{N_0/(4\tau)} \cdot \frac{N_0}{2T} = \frac{2\,(1 - e^{-x})^2}{x}$$

This ratio is largest at $x = T/\tau \approx 1.26$, where it is 0.81. So the best RC filter stays 0.9 dB below the bound $2E/N_0$ derived below.

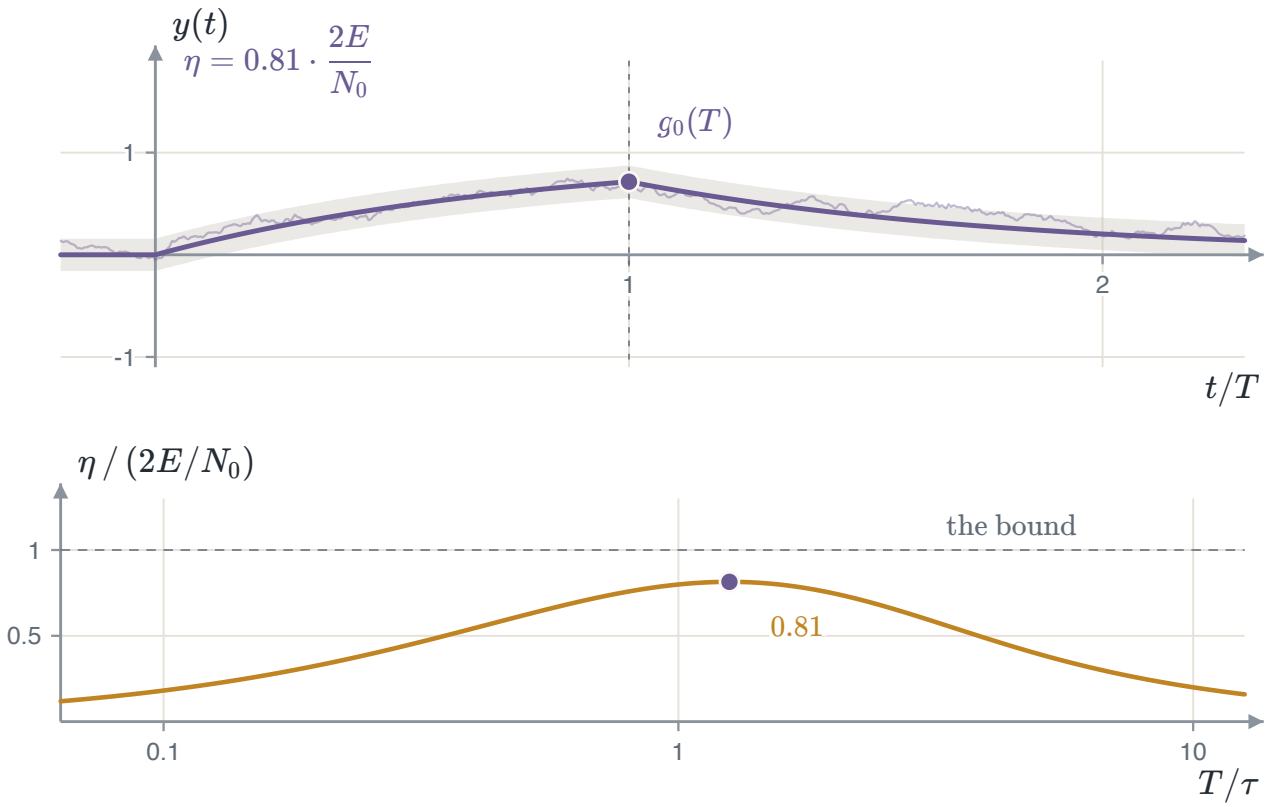


FIGURE 2.27 The RC filter at its best, $T/\tau = 1.26$. Above: the signal part $g_0(t)$, a band one noise standard deviation wide, and one noisy output. Below: η as a fraction of $2E/N_0$ against T/τ. No RC filter passes 0.81.

The output noise power

A filter multiplies a power spectral density by $|H(f)|^2$. White noise has the same density $N_0/2$ at every frequency.

STEP 1 · FILTERED DENSITY

$$S_N(f) = S_W(f)\,|H(f)|^2 = \frac{N_0}{2}\,|H(f)|^2$$

The power of a random signal is the area under its density. The noise part is stationary, so its power is the same at every t, and it is also $E[n^2(T)]$.

STEP 2 · NOISE POWER

$$E[n^2(t)] = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} S_N(f)\,df = \frac{N_0}{2}\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |H(f)|^2\,df$$

For the RC filter the area is $N_0/(4\tau)$, which is N_0/T at $\tau = T/4$. For an ideal lowpass filter with $|H(f)| = 1$ for $|f| < B$ the area is $\frac{N_0}{2} \cdot 2B = N_0 B$. For example, $B = 1$ kHz and $N_0 = 2 \times 10^{-9}$ W/Hz give 2×10^{-6} W.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

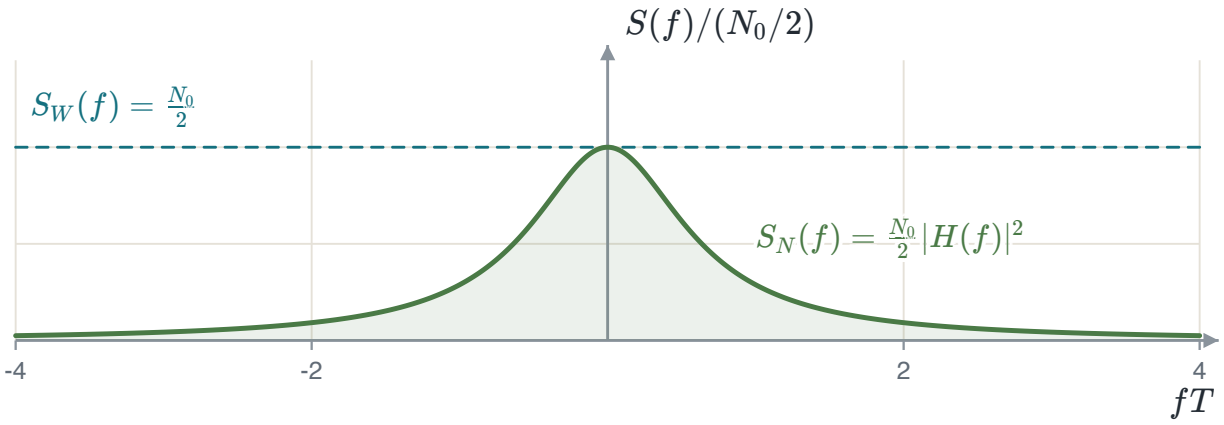


FIGURE 2.28 White noise of density $N_0/2$ (cyan, dashed) through an RC filter with $\tau = T/4$. The output density $S_N(f)$ (green) is the input density times $|H(f)|^2$. The shaded area is the output noise power. The tails beyond $|f| = 4/T$ hold the last tenth of it.

Both parts of η are now in the frequency domain. Put them into one fraction.

THE PROBLEM

$$\eta = \frac{\left|\int G(f)\, H(f)\, e^{j2\pi fT}\, df\right|^2}{\frac{N_0}{2}\int |H(f)|^2\, df}$$

For a given pulse spectrum $G(f)$, find the $H(f)$ that makes η largest. The top wants H large where G is large. The bottom charges for every hertz H passes.

Schwarz's inequality

Schwarz's inequality bounds η. It holds for any pair of functions.

SCHWARZ'S INEQUALITY

$$\left|\int \phi_1(f)\, \phi_2(f)\, df\right|^2 \le \int |\phi_1(f)|^2\, df \int |\phi_2(f)|^2\, df$$

Both functions must have finite energy. The square is on the magnitude of the whole integral, not inside it. Equality holds only when $\phi_1(f) = k\, \phi_2^*(f)$ for a constant k.

Take $\phi_1 = H(f)$ and $\phi_2 = G(f)\, e^{j2\pi fT}$. The left side is then $|g_0(T)|^2$. Since $|e^{j2\pi fT}| = 1$, the right side is $\int |H(f)|^2 df \int |G(f)|^2 df$.

APPLY IT TO $g_0(T)$

$$\begin{aligned} |g_0(T)|^2 &= \left|\int H(f)\, G(f)\, e^{j2\pi fT}\, df\right|^2 \\ &\le \int |H(f)|^2 df \int |G(f)|^2 df \end{aligned}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

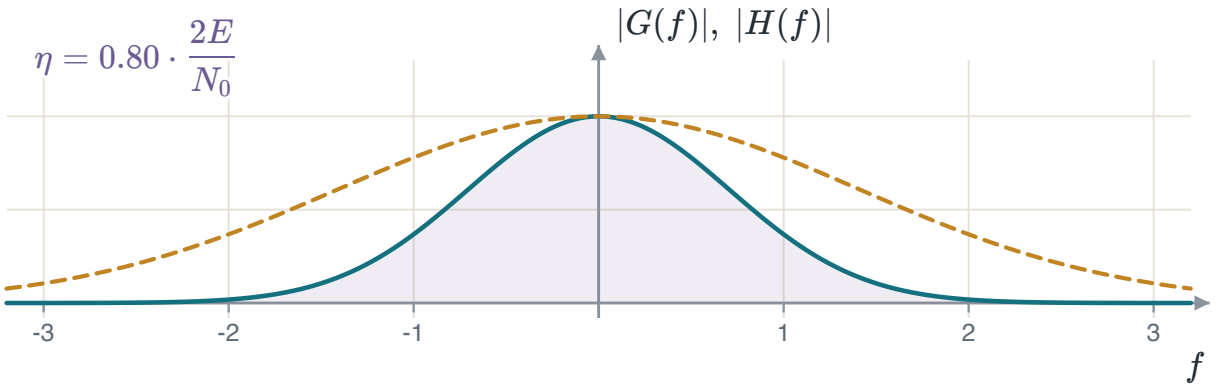


FIGURE 2.29 The signal spectrum $|G(f)|$ (cyan) and a filter $|H(f)|$ (amber, dashed) of twice its width, $b = 2$. The shaded overlap sets the SNR, here 0.80 of the bound. A wider $|H|$ passes noise where the pulse has no energy, and a narrower one cuts the pulse.

A gain on the filter changes nothing. If $H(f)$ becomes $3H(f)$, then $|g_0(T)|^2$ and $E[n^2(T)]$ both grow 9 times, so η stays the same. Only the shape of H matters.

The bound on the output SNR

Write η with the noise power in the frequency domain. Put Schwarz's bound on the top.

THE BOUND

$$\begin{aligned}\eta &= \frac{|g_0(T)|^2}{\frac{N_0}{2}\int |H(f)|^2 df} \\ &\le \frac{\int |H(f)|^2 df \int |G(f)|^2 df}{\frac{N_0}{2}\int |H(f)|^2 df} \\ &= \frac{2}{N_0}\int |G(f)|^2\, df = \frac{2E}{N_0}\end{aligned}$$

The factor $\int |H(f)|^2 df$ is above and below the line, so it cancels. Parseval's theorem gives $\int |G(f)|^2 df = E$, the pulse energy, so the bound contains no H. It depends on the energy of the pulse, not on its shape. For example, $E = 5 \times 10^{-7}$ J and $N_0 = 10^{-7}$ W/Hz give $\eta_{\max} = 2(5 \times 10^{-7})/10^{-7} = 10$.

The bound is reached when Schwarz's inequality holds with equality. Put $\phi_1 = H(f)$ and $\phi_2 = G(f)e^{j2\pi fT}$ into $\phi_1 = k\phi_2^*$.

THE EQUALITY CONDITION

$$H_{\text{opt}}(f) = k\,\phi_2^*(f) = k\,G^*(f)\,e^{-j2\pi fT}$$

The conjugate of $e^{j2\pi fT}$ is $e^{-j2\pi fT}$, and k is the constant of the equality condition. The best filter passes most where the pulse spectrum is largest.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

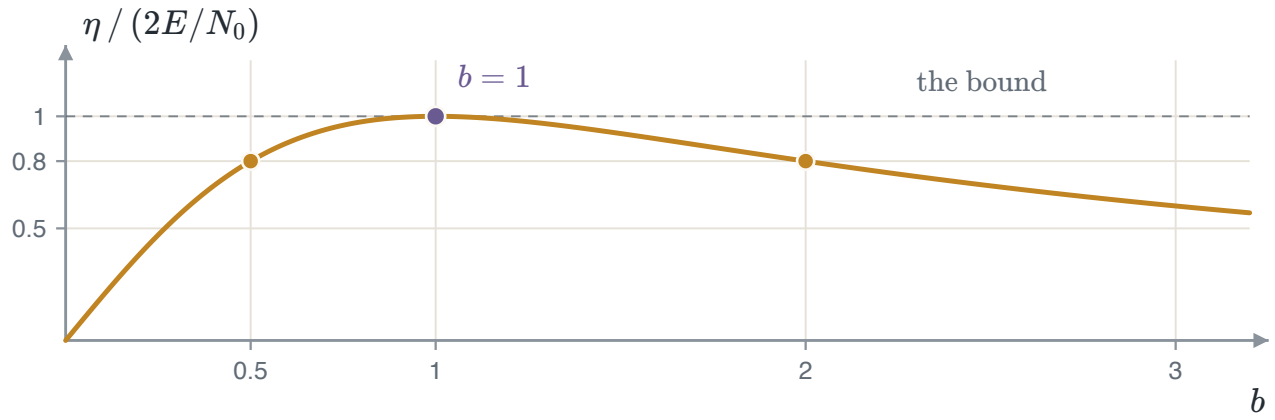


FIGURE 2.30 The SNR of the filter of width b as a fraction of the bound, $2b/(1+b^2)$. It is 0.80 at $b = 1/2$ and at $b = 2$, and it reaches 1 only at $b = 1$.

The matched filter

The impulse response is the inverse transform of $H_{\text{opt}}(f)$. It takes three steps. First substitute H_{opt} and join the two exponentials.

STEP 1 · INVERSE TRANSFORM

$$\begin{aligned} h_{\text{opt}}(t) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} H_{\text{opt}}(f)\, e^{j2\pi f t}\, df \\ &= k \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G^*(f)\, e^{j2\pi f (t-T)}\, df \end{aligned}$$

Second, use that the pulse is real. Conjugation in time gives $g^*(t) \leftrightarrow G^*(-f)$. A real pulse has $g = g^*$, so $G(f) = G^*(-f)$. Take the conjugate of both sides.

STEP 2 · A REAL PULSE

$$\begin{aligned} g(t) = g^*(t) \;&\Rightarrow\; G(f) = G^*(-f) \\ &\Rightarrow\; G^*(f) = G(-f) \end{aligned}$$

Third, use time reversal, $g(-s) \leftrightarrow G(-f)$. Its inverse transform reads $g(-s) = \int G(-f)\, e^{j2\pi f s}\, df$. Here the exponent is $j2\pi f(t-T)$, so $s = t - T$.

STEP 3 · REVERSE AND SHIFT

$$\begin{aligned} h_{\text{opt}}(t) &= k \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G(-f)\, e^{j2\pi f (t-T)}\, df \\ &= k\, g\big(-(t-T)\big) = k\, g(T-t) \end{aligned}$$

The filter is the pulse reversed in time and shifted right by T. It is called the **matched filter**. For example, the ramp $g(t) = t/T$ on $0 \le t \le T$ with $k = 1$ has $h_{\text{opt}}(0) = g(T-0) = g(T) = 1$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

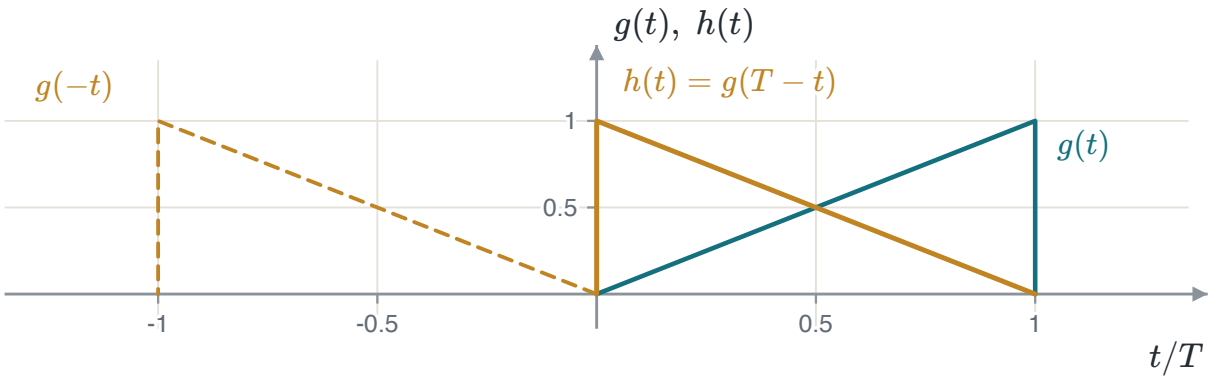


FIGURE 2.31 The matched filter of the ramp $g(t) = t/T$, built in two moves. The ramp (cyan) is reversed in time to $g(-t)$ (amber, dashed), then shifted right by T to $h(t) = g(T - t)$ (amber).

The matched filter in frequency

The same filter can be read in frequency. Take the magnitude and the phase of $H_{\text{opt}}(f)$ one at a time.

MAGNITUDE AND PHASE

$$H(f) = k\, G^*(f)\, e^{-j2\pi fT}$$
$$|H(f)| = k\, |G(f)|$$
$$\angle H(f) = -\angle G(f) - 2\pi fT$$

The magnitude response has the shape of the pulse spectrum. The filter passes the band where the pulse has energy and weights each frequency by $|G(f)|$. Where $G(f_1) = 0$, also $|H(f_1)| = 0$: the pulse has nothing there, so the filter lets no noise through.

Now pass the pulse through the filter. Multiply the two spectra.

THE OUTPUT SPECTRUM

$$Y(f) = G(f)\, H(f) = k\, |G(f)|^2\, e^{-j2\pi fT}$$

The phase $-\angle G$ of the filter cancels the phase of the pulse. Only the linear phase $-2\pi fT$, a delay of T, is left. Every frequency component of $y(t)$ is a cosine of non-negative amplitude that peaks at $t = T$, so they all add there.

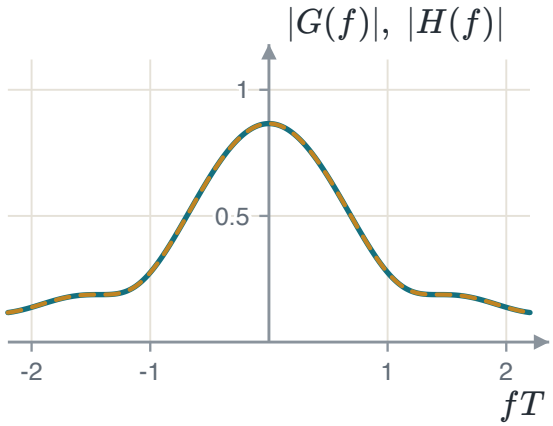


FIGURE 2.32 The magnitudes for the ramp $g(t) = \sqrt{3}\, t/T$ with $E = 1$ and $k = 1$. $|G(f)|$ (cyan) and $|H(f)|$ (amber, dashed) lie on each other.

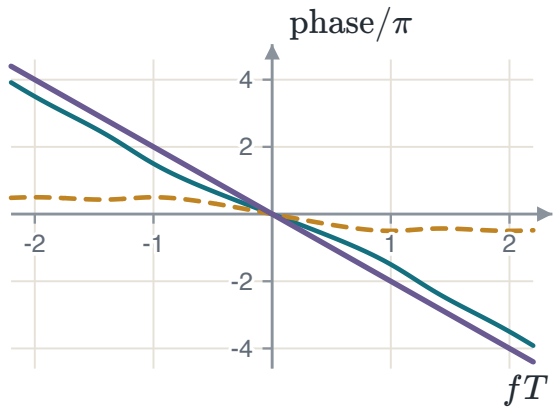


FIGURE 2.33 The phases over π: $\angle G$ (cyan), $\angle H$ (amber, dashed) and their sum $-2\pi fT$ (violet), a straight line.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The output of the matched filter

The matched-filter output is a sliding product. Write it as a convolution and substitute $h(t) = g(T - t)$, so that $h(t - \tau) = g(T - t + \tau)$. That is the pulse itself, moved to start at $t - T$. For each t, multiply the two curves and take the area of the product.

CONVOLUTION

$$\begin{aligned} y(t) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} g(\tau)\, h(t - \tau)\, d\tau \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} g(\tau)\, g(T - t + \tau)\, d\tau \end{aligned}$$

Convolution reverses h once more. Because h was already the reversed pulse, at $t = T$ the copy lies exactly on g. Every product is then $g^2 \geq 0$, nothing cancels, and the area is the energy.

THE PEAK

$$y(T) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} g^2(\tau)\, d\tau = E$$

For the ramp $g(t) = t/T$, take $T = 1$, so $E = 1/3$. For $0 \leq t \leq 1$ the copies overlap on $0 \leq \tau \leq t$.

$$\begin{aligned} y(t) &= \int_{0}^{t} \tau\,(1 - t + \tau)\, d\tau \\ &= \frac{(1 - t)\, t^2}{2} + \frac{t^3}{3} \end{aligned}$$

At $t = 1/2$ this is $1/16 + 1/24 = 5/48$, so $y(T/2) = (5/48)/(1/3)\, E = 0.31E$. The output is even about $t = T$: $y(T + u) = \int g(\tau) g(\tau - u)\, d\tau$, and the shift $\tau \to \tau + u$ turns it into $y(T - u)$. So $y(3T/2) = 0.31E$ as well.

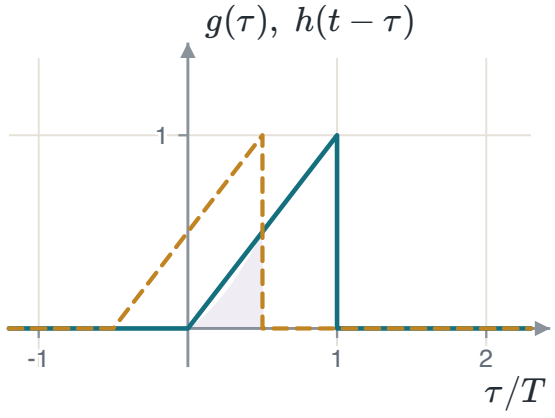


FIGURE 2.34 The overlap at $t = T/2$. The ramp $g(\tau)$ (cyan) and the copy $h(t - \tau)$ (amber, dashed). The shaded area is their product.

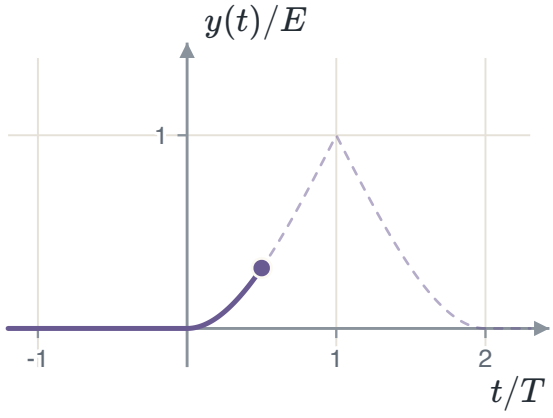


FIGURE 2.35 The output $y(t)/E$, the area of that product, drawn up to $t = T/2$. The dashed rest is even about $t = T$ and peaks at $y(T) = E$.

Leave out the reversal and use $h = g$. At $t = T$ the copy is $g(T - \tau) = 1 - \tau$, which runs the wrong way. The product is $\tau(1 - \tau)$ and its area is $1/6 = 0.50E$. The output of $h = g$ peaks at $2(\sqrt{2} - 1)E = 0.83E$, at $t = \sqrt{2}\,T$, and never reaches E.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

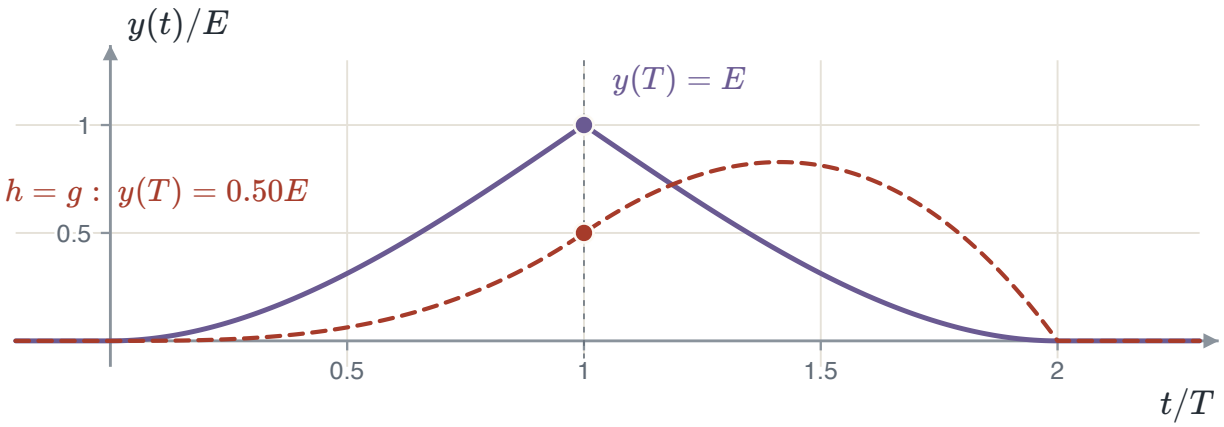


FIGURE 2.36 The ramp through its matched filter (violet) and through $h = g$, the filter without the reversal (red, dashed). Only the matched filter reaches E, and it does so at $t = T$.

The sampling instant follows. The output is largest at $t = T$, where the copies line up. The noise power is the same at every t. So η is largest at $t = T$, the first instant the whole pulse is inside the filter.

The correlator

Only the sample at $t = T$ is used. Write that sample with $h(t) = g(T - t)$. The argument of h is $T - \tau$, so $h(T - \tau) = g\big(T - (T - \tau)\big) = g(\tau)$.

THE SAMPLE AT $t = T$

$$y(T) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(\tau)\, h(T - \tau)\, d\tau$$
$$= \int_{0}^{T} x(\tau)\, g(\tau)\, d\tau$$

At $t = T$ the reversal is undone. The sample is the input multiplied by the pulse and integrated over the bit. A receiver that does this is a **correlator**.

The correlator starts at the start of each bit, is read at $t = T$ and is then reset to zero. This is called integrate and dump. It needs the bit timing, as the matched filter does for its sampling instant.

The two outputs are equal only at $t = T$. For the ramp $g(t) = t/T$ with no noise, the correlator gives $z(t) = \int_0^t g^2\, d\tau = (t/T)^3 E$. So $z(T/2) = E/8 = 0.13E$, while the matched filter gives $y(T/2) = 0.31E$.

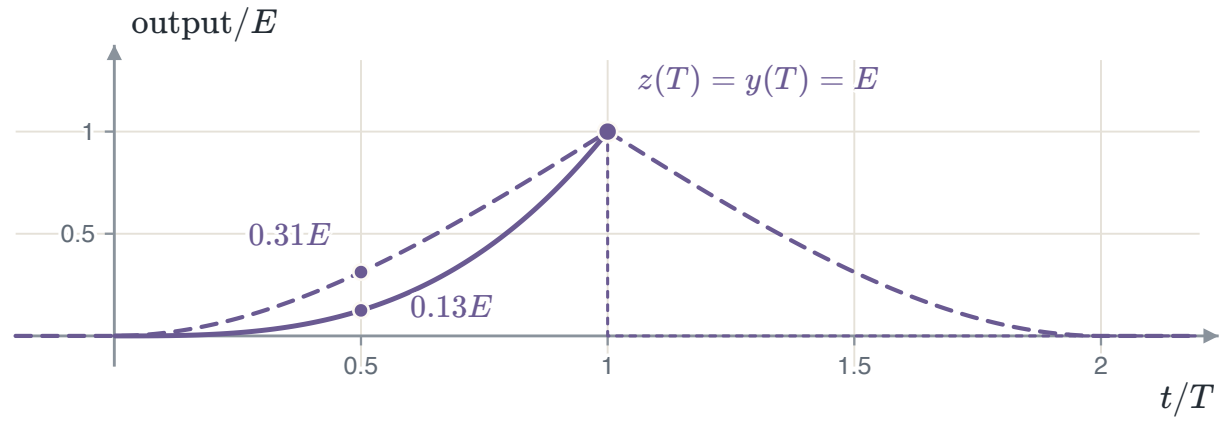


FIGURE 2.37 The noiseless ramp through a correlator, $z(t)$ (solid, reset at $t = T$), and through its matched filter, $y(t)$ (dashed). The two differ before T and agree at $t = T$, where both are E.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Properties of the matched filter

Keep the gain k and compute both parts of η for the matched filter. First the signal part at $t = T$.

STEP 1 · SIGNAL AT $t = T$

$$\begin{aligned} g_0(T) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G(f)\, H(f)\, e^{j2\pi fT}\, df \\ &= k \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G(f)\, G^*(f)\, e^{-j2\pi fT} e^{j2\pi fT}\, df \\ &= k \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |G(f)|^2\, df = kE \end{aligned}$$

The two exponentials cancel and $GG^* = |G|^2$. Parseval's theorem turns the last integral into the energy E.

Then the noise power. Use $|e^{-j2\pi fT}| = 1$.

STEP 2 · NOISE POWER

$$\begin{aligned} E[n^2(t)] &= \frac{N_0}{2} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left| k\, G^*(f)\, e^{-j2\pi fT} \right|^2 df \\ &= \frac{k^2 N_0}{2} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |G(f)|^2\, df = \frac{k^2 N_0 E}{2} \end{aligned}$$

The noise power is not zero. The matched filter keeps the noise that shares the band of the pulse.

The signal part grows as k and the noise power as k^2, so the noise standard deviation grows as k. Doubling k doubles both $g_0(T)$ and the noise standard deviation. In η the factor k^2 cancels, so every gain gives the same SNR.

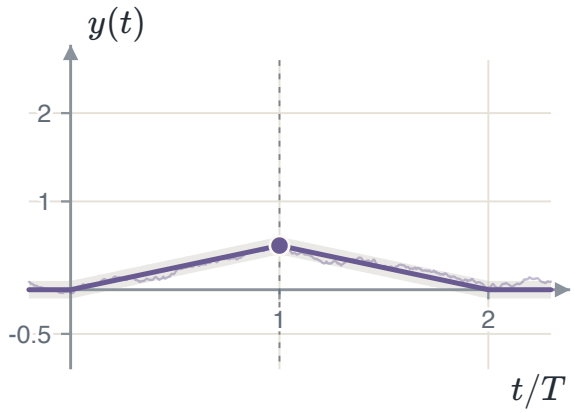


FIGURE 2.38 The matched filter of the noisy rectangular pulse with $k = 0.5$. The signal part peaks at kE, and the band is one noise standard deviation wide.

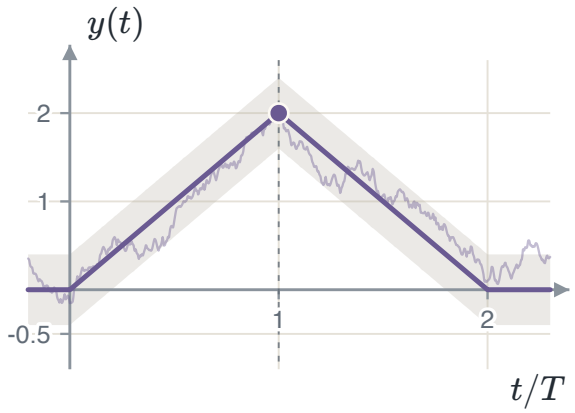


FIGURE 2.39 The same filter with $k = 2$. Every part is four times larger than at $k = 0.5$, so η is the same, 25 for $E = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.08$.

The output SNR of the matched filter

Divide the square of the signal part by the noise power.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

KEY RESULT · PEAK SNR

$$\eta = \frac{|g_0(T)|^2}{E[n^2(T)]} = \frac{(kE)^2}{k^2 N_0 E/2} = \frac{2E}{N_0}$$

The gain k cancels. The matched filter reaches the bound, and the SNR depends on the pulse energy and on N_0, not on the shape of $g(t)$.

The ratio E/N_0 compares the energy of the pulse with the spectral density of the noise. It has no unit.

UNITS

$$\frac{E}{N_0}: \quad \frac{\mathrm{J}}{\mathrm{W/Hz}} = \frac{\mathrm{J}}{(\mathrm{J/s})\cdot \mathrm{s}} = 1$$

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Common error: call $N_0/2$ the noise density at the filter output. It is the density of the white noise at the filter input. At the output the density is $\frac{N_0}{2}|H(f)|^2$, which is not flat.

For example, a rectangular pulse and a half-sine pulse with $E = 10^{-6}$ J and $N_0 = 10^{-7}$ W/Hz both give $\eta_{\max} = 2(10^{-6})/10^{-7} = 20$. The output of each is its autocorrelation $R_g(t - T)$, with $R_g(u) = \int g(\tau) g(\tau - u)\, d\tau$, and both peak at $R_g(0) = E$.

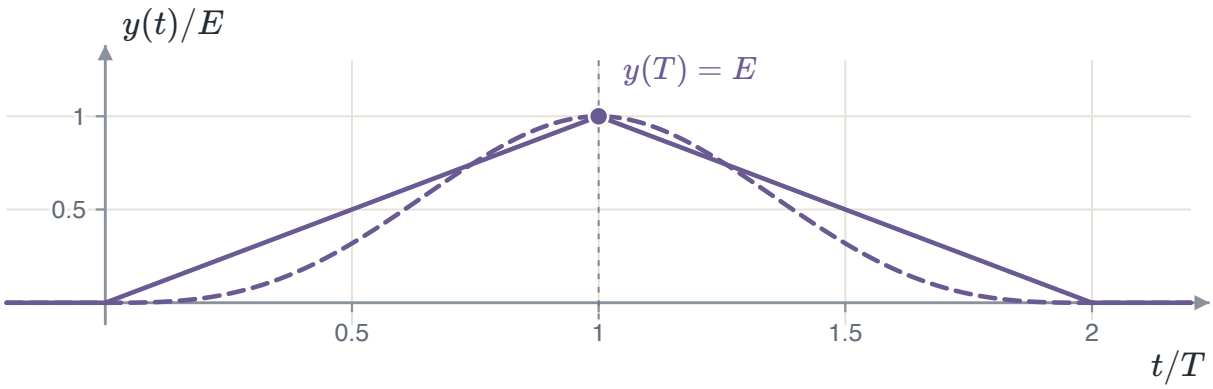


FIGURE 2.40 A rectangular pulse and a half-sine pulse of the same energy E, each through its own matched filter. The rectangular output is solid and the half-sine output dashed. Both peak at $t = T$ with the value E.

Sampling early or late

A receiver may sample at a time t_0 that is not exactly T. The noise power $k^2 N_0 E/2$ is the same at every t_0. Only the signal part changes.

SNR AT t_0

$$\eta(t_0) = \frac{g_0^2(t_0)}{k^2 N_0 E/2} = \left(\frac{g_0(t_0)}{kE}\right)^2 \frac{2E}{N_0}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

For the rectangular pulse the output is the triangle, so $g_0(t_0)/(kE) = 1 - |t_0 - T|/T$. Sampling $0.1T$ late leaves $(1 - 0.1)^2 = 0.81$ of $2E/N_0$. That is a loss of $10 \log_{10} 0.81 = -0.92$ dB.

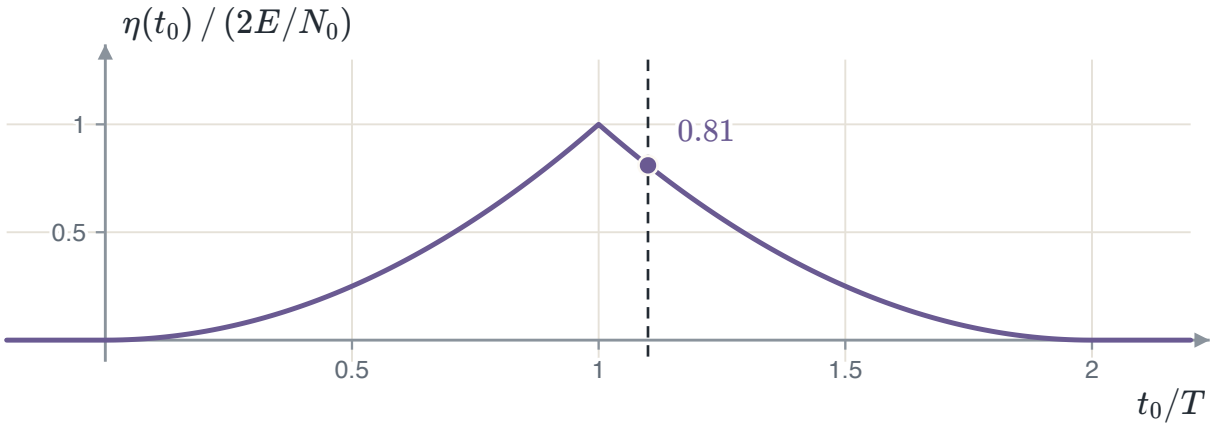


FIGURE 2.41 The SNR at the sampling instant t_0 for the rectangular pulse, as a fraction of $2E/N_0$. Sampling at $t_0 = 1.1T$ leaves 0.81.

An earlier peak would need another filter. A filter that peaks at $t_0 < T$ is $h(t) = g(t_0 - t)$. It is non-zero for some $t < 0$, so it would need the input before the input arrives. Such a filter is not causal. A causal matched filter needs $t_0 \geq T$, and a later t_0 only adds delay.

The output sample

Send polar bits, $+g(t)$ for a 1 and $-g(t)$ for a 0, and sample the matched filter at $t = T$. The signal part is $\pm kE$. The noise part is filtered Gaussian noise.

> THE SAMPLE AT $t = T$
>
> $$y(T) = \pm kE + n(T)$$
> $$n(T) \sim \mathcal{N}\left(0,\ k^2 N_0 E/2\right)$$
>
> A linear filter turns Gaussian noise into Gaussian noise. So $y(T)$ is a Gaussian random variable centred on $+kE$ or $-kE$, with $\sigma = k\sqrt{N_0 E/2}$.

Take $E = 1$, $N_0 = 0.5$ and $k = 1$. Then $\sigma = \sqrt{0.5/2} = 0.5$. For the bit $+1$ the fraction of samples below 0 is $Q(1/0.5) = Q(2) = 0.023$. Section 2.4 chooses the threshold and computes this error probability.

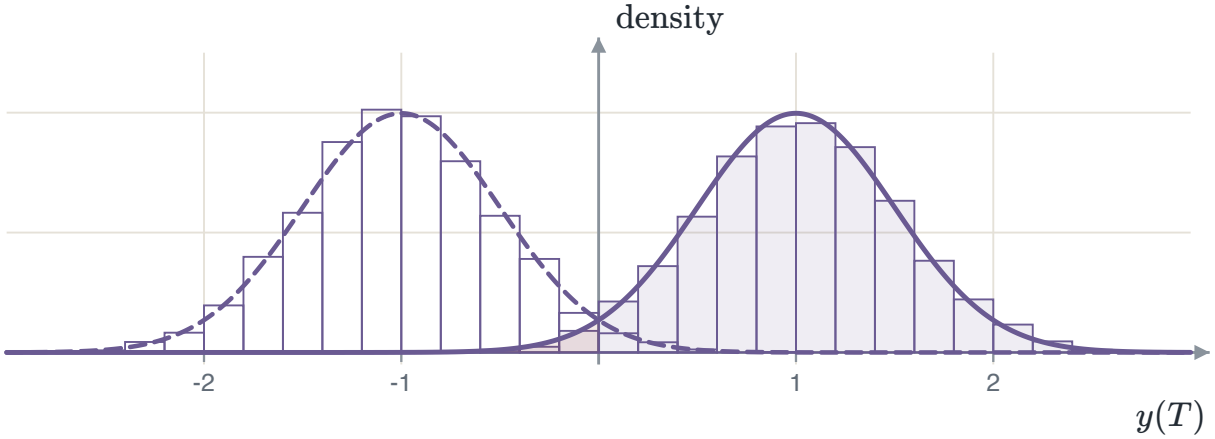


FIGURE 2.42 Histograms of 5000 samples $y(T)$ for each bit, with $k = 1$, $E = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$: the bit $+1$ filled, the bit -1 dashed. The curves are the two Gaussian densities. The red area is $Q(2)$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

EXAMPLE 2.3 – THE MATCHED FILTER OF A RECTANGULAR PULSE

GIVEN $g(t) = A$ on $[0, T]$, with $A = 2$ V, $T = 0.5$ ms and $N_0/2 = 10^{-4}$ W/Hz.

FIND The matched filter $h(t)$, its output $y(t)$ and the largest peak SNR $\eta_{\max}$.

METHOD Reverse and shift the pulse to get $h(t)$. The output is the sliding overlap of g and h. The largest SNR is $2E/N_0$, which needs only the energy.

SOLUTION $h(t) = g(T - t) = A$ for $0 \le t \le T$. Up to $t = T$ the pulse and the reversed copy overlap on $[0, t]$, so $y(t) = \int_0^t A^2\, d\tau = A^2 t$. After it they overlap on $[t - T, T]$, so $y(t) = \int_{t-T}^{T} A^2\, d\tau = A^2(2T - t)$ for $T \le t \le 2T$. The limits $\int_0^t$ hold only for $t \le T$. The energy is $E = A^2 T = (2)^2(0.5 \times 10^{-3}) = 2 \times 10^{-3}$ J. Then $\eta_{\max} = 2E/N_0 = 2(2 \times 10^{-3})/(2 \times 10^{-4}) = 20$.

CHECK $10 \log_{10} 20 = 13.0$ dB. The peak is $y(T) = A^2 T = E$, as the general result requires.

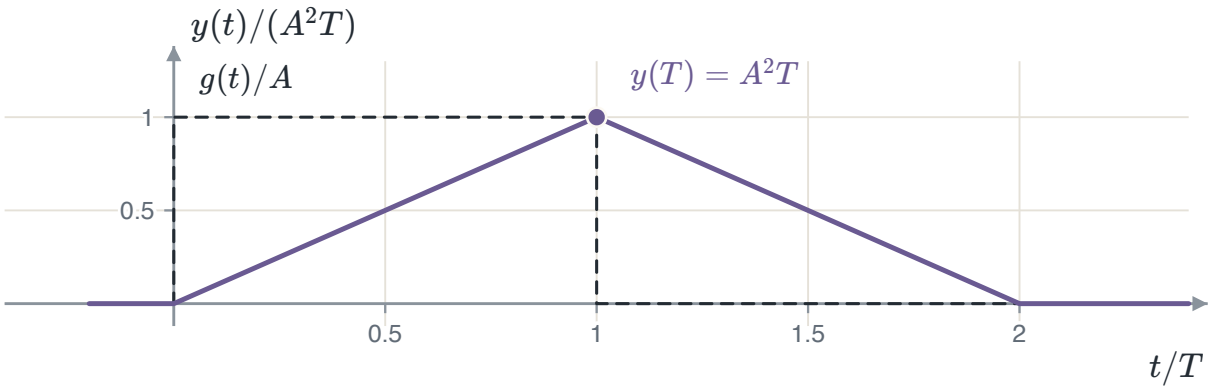


FIGURE 2.43 Example 2.3: the pulse $g(t)/A$ (dashed) and the output of its matched filter, $y(t)/(A^2T)$. The output is a triangle that peaks at $y(T) = A^2T$.

COMMON ERROR

Use $N_0 = 2 \times 10^{-4}$, not $N_0/2$, in $2E/N_0$. The wrong value gives 40.

Matched filters around us

The matched filter appears in radar, Wi-Fi, range finders and serial ports.

- **Radar.** A radar chirp lasts $T = 10$ μs and sweeps $B = 5$ MHz. Its matched output is $(1 - |t|/T)\,|\operatorname{sinc}(Bt(1 - |t|/T))|$, a peak about $1/B = 0.2$ μs wide.
- **Wi-Fi.** Wi-Fi at 1 and 2 Mb/s spreads each bit over the 11-chip Barker code $c[n]$. Its matched output $R[k] = \sum_n c[n]\, c[n + k]$ is 11 at $k = 0$ and 0 or -1 elsewhere.
- **Range finder.** An ultrasonic range finder correlates the echo with the pulse it sent. The peak at $t_0 = 5.83$ ms gives $d = ct_0/2 = 1.00$ m for $c = 343$ m/s.
- **Serial port.** A serial port at 9600 baud integrates each bit over $T_b = 1/9600 = 104.2$ μs, then dumps. The integrator is the matched filter of a rectangular bit.

CORRELATION WITH A TEMPLATE

Each receiver correlates what it hears with a copy of what was sent. That is the matched filter $h(t) = g(T - t)$ read at its peak.

PEAK TIME

The peak falls where the copy lines up with the echo. Its time is the delay, and the delay gives the range.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

⚠ PULSE COMPRESSION

A long chirp carries much energy, and its matched output is still a peak about $1/B$ wide. The resolution comes from the bandwidth B, not from the length T.

2.3 The demodulator

The unit-energy pulse

The demodulator works with one fixed pulse shape $\psi(t)$, a rectangle one bit long. T_b is the bit duration in seconds. From here on $\psi(t)$ is called the **basis function**. Module 3 builds one for any signal set (Gram–Schmidt).

THE PULSE

$$\psi(t) = \begin{cases} 1/\sqrt{T_b}, & 0 \le t \le T_b \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Its height is chosen so that its energy is 1. Square the height, then integrate over the bit.

STEP 1 · ITS ENERGY

$$\begin{aligned} E_\psi &= \int_0^{T_b} \psi^2(t)\, dt \\ &= \int_0^{T_b} \frac{1}{T_b}\, dt \\ &= \frac{1}{T_b} \cdot T_b = 1 \end{aligned}$$

For example, $T_b = 4$ ms gives the height $1/\sqrt{4 \times 10^{-3}} = 15.8\ \mathrm{s}^{-1/2}$. Then $\psi^2 = 250\ \mathrm{s}^{-1}$, and $250 \times 4 \times 10^{-3} = 1$.

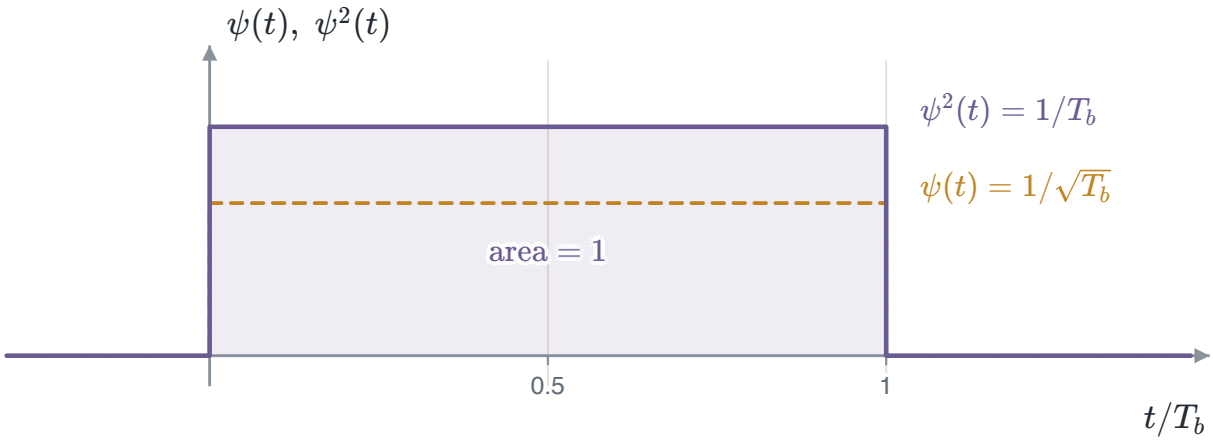


FIGURE 2.44 The pulse $\psi(t)$ (amber, dashed) and its square $\psi^2(t)$ (violet). The area under $\psi^2(t)$ over one bit is 1.

Antipodal signalling

Each bit is sent as the same shape times a number. The number s_m carries the bit.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

ONE SHAPE, TWO NUMBERS

$$s_m(t) = s_m\,\psi(t), \qquad m \in \{0, 1\}$$

Polar NRZ takes $s_1 = +A\sqrt{T_b}$ and $s_0 = -A\sqrt{T_b}$. Multiply each number by the height of $\psi(t)$.

POLAR NRZ

$$s_1(t) = +A\sqrt{T_b} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{T_b}} = +A$$
$$s_0(t) = -A\sqrt{T_b} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{T_b}} = -A$$

The $\sqrt{T_b}$ cancels, so the waveforms are $\pm A$ on $0 \le t \le T_b$. One is the negative of the other, so the signalling is called **antipodal**.

The energy per bit E_b is the energy of one waveform.

ENERGY PER BIT

$$E_b = \int_0^{T_b} s_1^2(t)\,dt = \int_0^{T_b} A^2\,dt$$
$$= A^2 T_b$$

So $A\sqrt{T_b} = \sqrt{E_b}$, and the two numbers are $s_1 = +\sqrt{E_b}$ and $s_0 = -\sqrt{E_b}$. With $A = 2$ V and $T_b = 1$ ms in a $1\ \Omega$ load, $E_b = (2)^2(10^{-3}) = 4$ mJ.

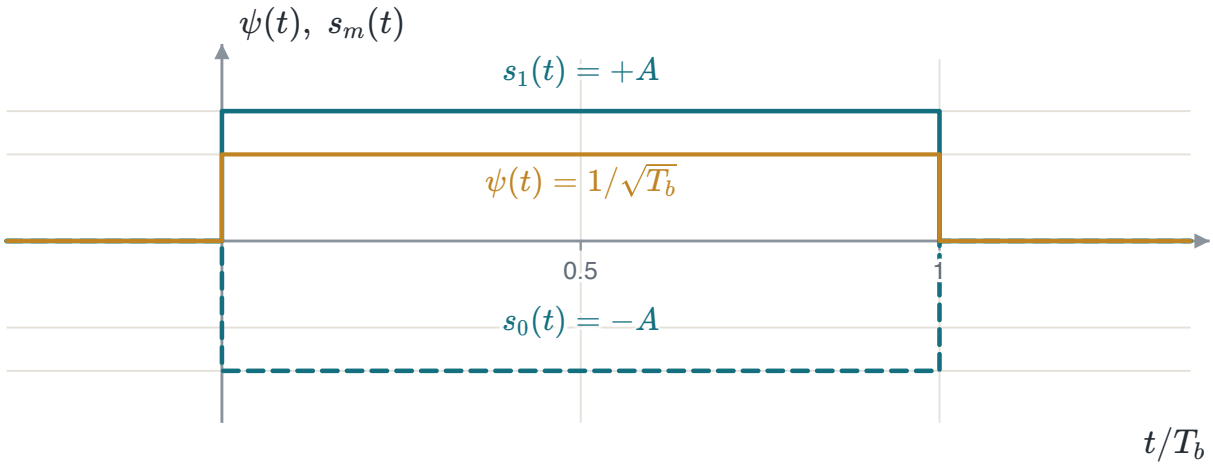


FIGURE 2.45 The basis $\psi(t)$ (amber) and the two waveforms of polar signalling, $s_1(t)$ (cyan) and $s_0(t)$ (cyan, dashed), drawn with $T_b = 1$ and $A = 1.5$. Each waveform is $\psi(t)$ times a number.

Two waveforms as two points

The number that multiplies $\psi(t)$ is found by projection. Multiply the waveform by $\psi(t)$ and integrate over the bit.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

COEFFICIENT ON ψ

$$s_m = \int_0^{T_b} s_m(t)\,\psi(t)\,dt$$

$$s_1 = \int_0^{T_b} A \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{T_b}}\,dt = \frac{A}{\sqrt{T_b}} \cdot T_b = A\sqrt{T_b} = +\sqrt{E_b}$$

For $s_0(t) = -A$ the same steps give $s_0 = -\sqrt{E_b}$. The two waveforms have become two points on one axis, the axis of $\psi(t)$. Module 3 draws any signal set this way.

The distance between the two points measures how far noise must push the received number to cause an error.

DISTANCE

$$d = s_1 - s_0 = \sqrt{E_b} - \left(-\sqrt{E_b}\right) = 2\sqrt{E_b}$$

A larger distance means noise must move the received number further before it lands nearer the wrong point. For $E_b = 4$ mJ, $d = 2\sqrt{4 \times 10^{-3}} = 2(0.0632) = 0.126\ \sqrt{\text{J}}$.

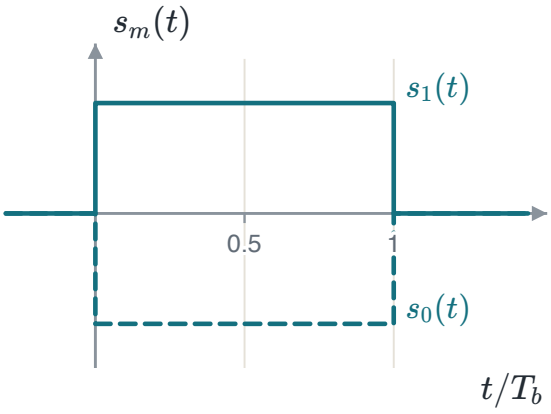


FIGURE 2.46 The two waveforms of polar signalling, $s_1(t)$ (solid) and $s_0(t)$ (dashed).

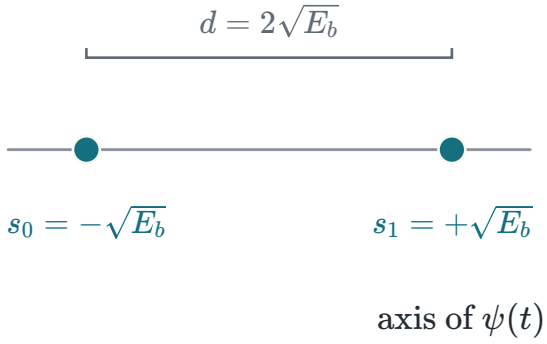


FIGURE 2.47 The same two waveforms as points on the axis of $\psi(t)$. The points are $2\sqrt{E_b}$ apart.

The matched-filter demodulator

The first demodulator is a filter matched to $\psi(t)$. Its impulse response is ψ reversed in time and delayed by one bit. Its input is one bit plus the white Gaussian noise $w(t)$ of the channel.

FILTER AND INPUT

$$h(t) = \psi(T_b - t)$$

$$x(t) = s_m\psi(t) + w(t), \qquad 0 \le t \le T_b$$

The filter is linear, so each part of $x(t)$ passes through it on its own. The output splits into a signal part and a noise part.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

STEP 1 · SPLIT THE OUTPUT

$$\begin{aligned} y(t) &= x(t) * h(t) \\ &= \underbrace{s_m\psi(t) * h(t)}_{\text{signal part}} + \underbrace{w(t) * h(t)}_{=n(t)} \end{aligned}$$

The noise part $n(t)$ is a random process: it changes from one transmission to the next.

Send the same bit twice and only the signal part repeats. It depends on s_m and ψ alone, while $n(t)$ is a new sample function every time.

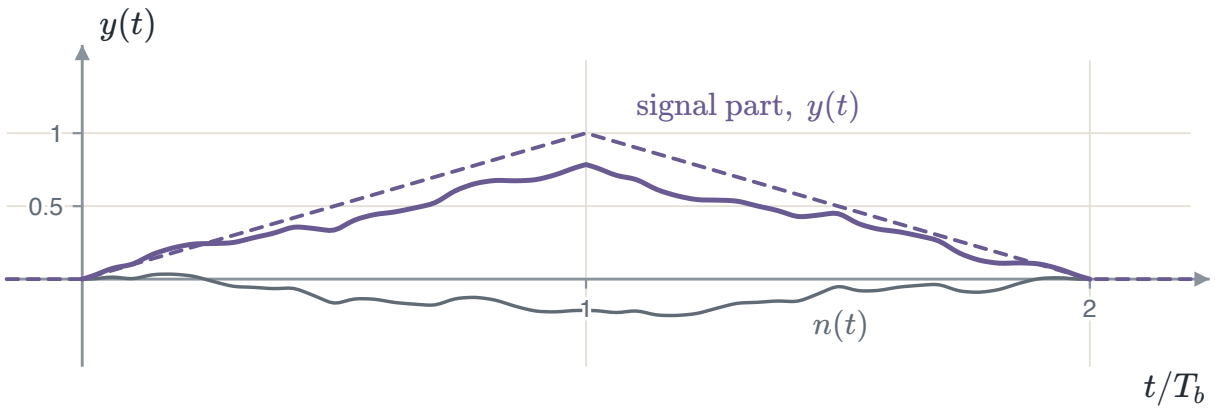


FIGURE 2.48 One noisy bit with $s_m = +1$ through the filter matched to the rectangular ψ. Shown: the signal part (dashed), the noise part $n(t)$ (grey) and their sum $y(t)$.

The signal part as a convolution

Write the signal part as a convolution integral. The limits are 0 and T_b, because $\psi(\tau) = 0$ outside the bit. Then replace $h(t-\tau)$ by ψ at $T_b - (t-\tau)$.

STEP 2 · THE SIGNAL PART

$$\begin{aligned} s_m\psi(t) * h(t) &= \int_0^{T_b} s_m\psi(\tau)\, h(t-\tau)\, d\tau \\ &= \int_0^{T_b} s_m\psi(\tau)\, \psi\big(T_b - (t-\tau)\big)\, d\tau \end{aligned}$$

The output is defined for every t. Only its value at $t = T_b$ is used.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Common error: take the output to end with the bit at T_b. The bit and $h(t)$ each last T_b, so for the rectangular ψ the output is non-zero on $0 < t < 2T_b$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

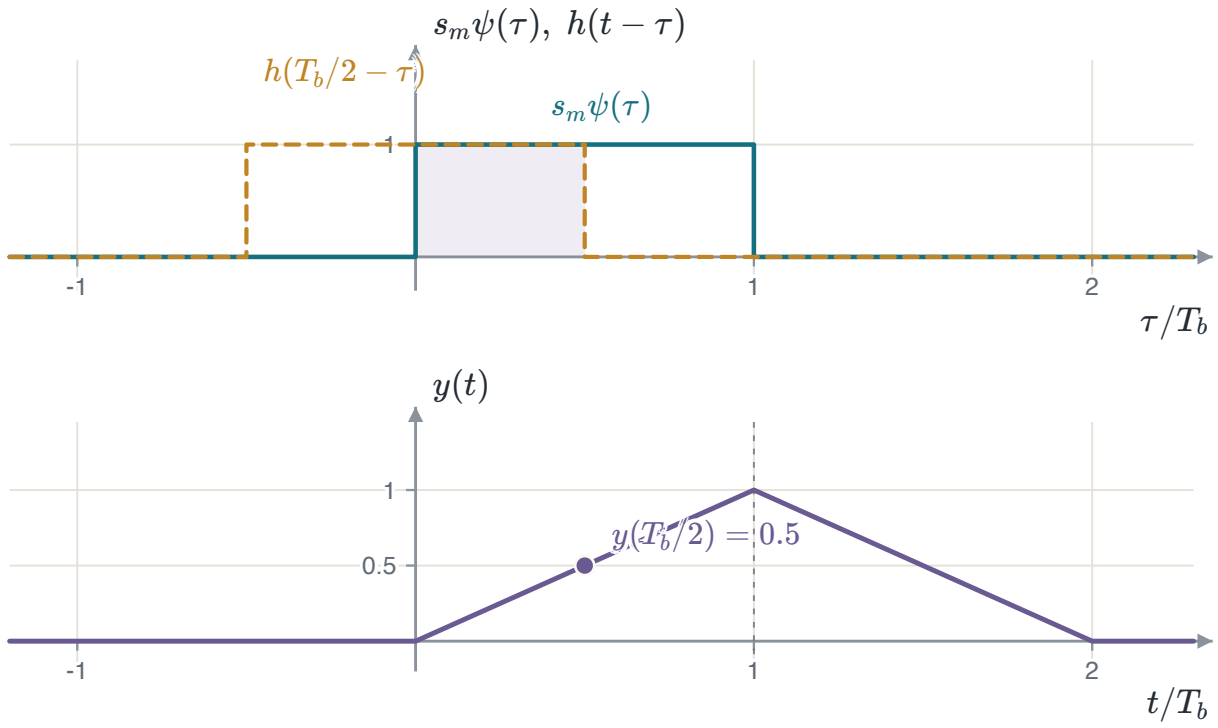


FIGURE 2.49 The convolution at $t = T_b/2$, for one noiseless bit with $s_m = 1$ and the rectangular ψ. The shaded overlap of $s_m\psi(\tau)$ and $h(t-\tau)$ is the output $y(t)$, here 0.5.

The demodulator output

Sample the output at the end of the bit. Put $t = T_b$ in the signal part: the reversal and the delay of the filter cancel.

STEP 1 · SAMPLE AT $t = T_b$

$$y(T_b) = \int_0^{T_b} s_m\psi(\tau)\,\psi(\tau)\,d\tau + n(T_b)$$

Here $\psi\big(T_b - (T_b - \tau)\big) = \psi(\tau)$.

s_m is a constant, so it leaves the integral. What is left is the energy of ψ, which is 1.

STEP 2 · USE UNIT ENERGY

$$\begin{aligned} y(T_b) &= s_m \underbrace{\int_0^{T_b} \psi^2(\tau)\,d\tau}_{=1} + n(T_b) \\ &= s_m \cdot 1 + n(T_b) \end{aligned}$$

KEY RESULT · THE DEMODULATOR OUTPUT

$$y = s_m + n, \qquad n = \int_0^{T_b} w(\tau)\,\psi(\tau)\,d\tau$$

The waveform has become one number. s_m is set by the bit. $n = n(T_b)$ is a random variable with a new value on every bit. For example, with $E_b = 4$ mJ, the bit 0 and $n = 0.01$, $y = -0.0632 + 0.01 = -0.053$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

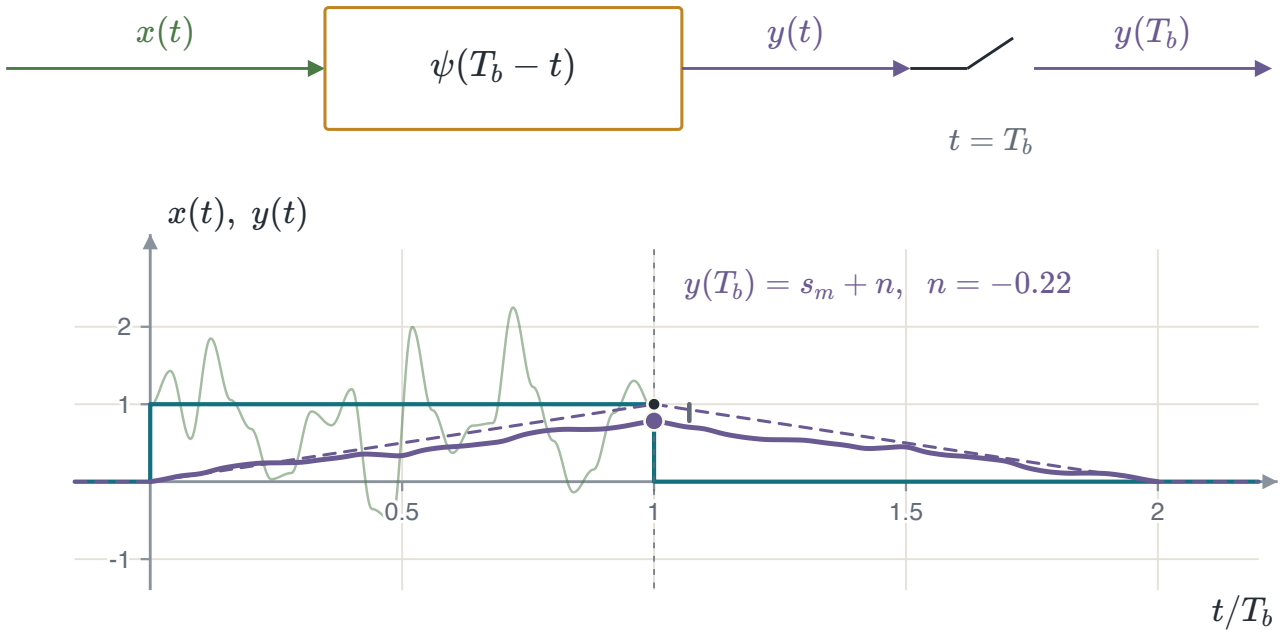


FIGURE 2.50 The filter matched to $\psi(t)$, and what it does to one noisy bit with $s_m = +1$. The received bit is green, the output violet, and its signal part dashed. At $t = T_b$ the output is s_m plus a noise value n.

The demodulator for other pulse shapes

Step 2 above used only the unit energy of ψ, never its shape. So the same result holds for any unit-energy pulse. The Manchester pulse is one: $+1$ on the first half of the bit, -1 on the second. A pulse of three steps is another.

ANY UNIT-ENERGY ψ

$$y(T_b) = s_m \underbrace{\int_0^{T_b} \psi^2(\tau)\, d\tau}_{=1} = s_m = \pm 1$$

The filter is matched to ψ, so one filter serves both bits of a code: the bit 0 is the pulse $-\psi(t)$.

The output between samples does depend on the shape. For the Manchester bit 1 at $t = T_b/2$, the filter overlaps the first half of the bit, where $\psi = +1$ meets $h = -1$. So $y(T_b/2) = -0.5$, and y rises to $+1$ at T_b.

⚠ SIGNAL PART ONLY

The curves in the figure carry no noise. With noise the sample is $s_m + n$, and the curve between samples moves too.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

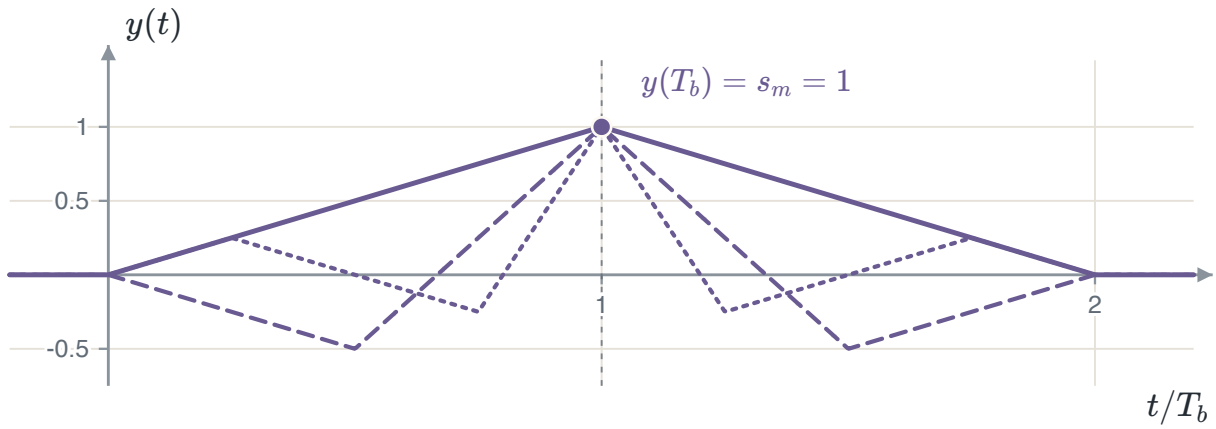


FIGURE 2.51 Noiseless matched-filter outputs for $s_m = 1$: the rectangle (solid), the Manchester pulse (dashed) and the pulse of three steps (dotted). The shapes differ, but each reads 1 at $t = T_b$.

A stream of bits

Bit k lasts from $(k-1)T_b$ to kT_b. Its output peaks at kT_b, and the outputs of the bits before and after it are zero there. So each sample holds its own bit and its own noise value.

BIT k

$$y(kT_b) = s_{m,k} + n_k, \qquad k = 1, 2, \ldots$$

Two equal bits in a row give a flat output between their samples. Take two polar 1 bits. The falling side of the first triangle and the rising side of the second add to 1 between them.

READING THE SAMPLES

A sample above 0 is read as bit 1, and a sample below 0 as bit 0. Section 2.4 places this threshold and finds how often noise moves a sample across it.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

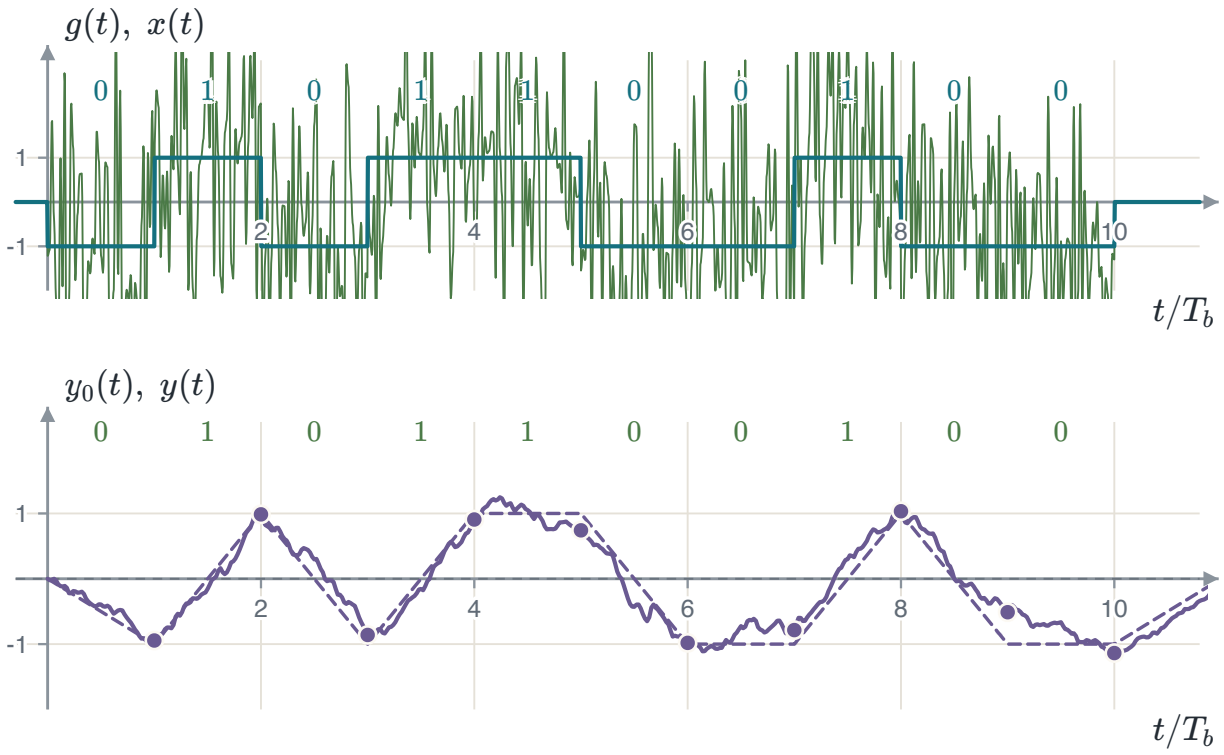


FIGURE 2.52 Ten polar bits through the matched filter. Above: the bits and the received $x(t)$. Below: the noiseless output $y_0(t)$ (dashed), the noisy output $y(t)$ and its samples at $t = kT_b$, with the bit read from each sign.

The correlator demodulator

The second demodulator multiplies the input by $\psi(t)$ and integrates from the start of the bit. It is called the **correlator**.

THE CORRELATOR

$$y(t) = \int_0^t x(\tau)\,\psi(\tau)\,d\tau, \qquad 0 \le t \le T_b$$

Substitute $x(\tau) = s_m\psi(\tau) + w(\tau)$, multiply out and split the integral.

STEP 1 · SUBSTITUTE $x(\tau)$

$$\begin{aligned} y(t) &= \int_0^t \underbrace{\left[s_m\psi(\tau) + w(\tau)\right]}_{=x(\tau)}\psi(\tau)\,d\tau \\ &= s_m \int_0^t \psi^2(\tau)\,d\tau + \int_0^t w(\tau)\,\psi(\tau)\,d\tau \end{aligned}$$

The first term grows through the bit. The second is the noise of the correlator.

Inside the bit the correlator and the matched filter give different curves. For the Manchester bit 1 with no noise, the correlator gives $y(T_b/2) = \int_0^{T_b/2} \psi^2\,d\tau = 0.5$, while the matched filter gives -0.5.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

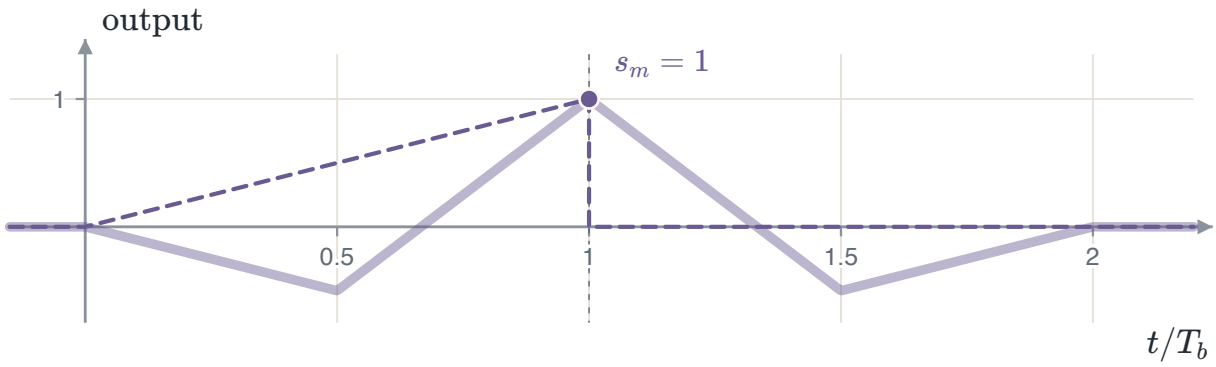


FIGURE 2.53 One noiseless Manchester bit with $s_m = 1$. The matched-filter output is the wide line and the correlator output is dashed. The correlator integrates from 0 and is reset at T_b. At $t = T_b$ both read s_m.

Correlator and matched-filter demodulators

The number y can be formed in two ways. The correlator is read at the end of the bit and then reset to 0.

Read the output at $t = T_b$ and use the unit energy of ψ.

CORRELATOR AT T_b

$$y(T_b) = s_m \underbrace{\int_0^{T_b} \psi^2(\tau)\, d\tau}_{=1} + \int_0^{T_b} w(\tau)\, \psi(\tau)\, d\tau$$
$$= s_m + n$$

At $t = T_b$ the noise integral is the same n as at the matched filter. At earlier times the correlator noise $\int_0^t w\psi\, d\tau$ and the filter noise $n(t)$ are different processes.

The matched filter has the impulse response $\psi(T_b - t)$. Write its output as a convolution and put $t = T_b$.

MATCHED FILTER AT T_b

$$h(t) = \psi(T_b - t)$$
$$y(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(\tau)\, \underbrace{\psi(T_b - t + \tau)}_{=h(t-\tau)}\, d\tau$$
$$y(T_b) = \int_0^{T_b} x(\tau)\, \psi(\tau)\, d\tau$$

The last line is the correlator output, for any shape of ψ. Both demodulators turn the waveform into the one number $y = s_m + n$.

Away from T_b the two outputs differ. Take one noiseless bit with $s_m = 1$ and the rectangular ψ. On $[0, T_b]$ both outputs rise along the same line.

After T_b the correlator has been reset, while the matched-filter output falls as $2 - t/T_b$. So $y(1.5T_b) = 0.5$ at the filter. Only the value at T_b is used.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

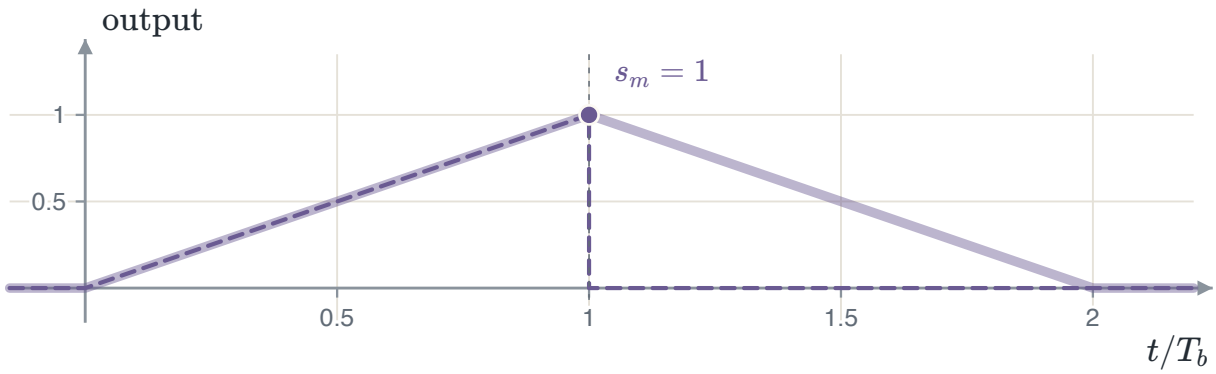


FIGURE 2.54 One noiseless bit with $s_m = 1$ and the rectangular ψ. The matched-filter output is the wide line and the correlator output is dashed. The correlator integrates from 0 and is reset at T_b. At $t = T_b$ both read s_m.

The noise sample

The noise value n decides how often the bit is read wrongly, so its mean and variance are needed. Start with the mean. The expectation moves inside the integral, and white noise has zero mean.

STEP 1 · THE MEAN

$$\begin{aligned} E[n] &= \int_0^{T_b} E[w(\tau)]\,\psi(\tau)\,d\tau \\ &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

So the variance of n is $E[n^2]$.

Write n^2 as the product of two integrals with different variables, t and u. Then take the expectation inside.

STEP 2 · SQUARE AND AVERAGE

$$\begin{aligned} E[n^2] &= E\Big[\int_0^{T_b} w(t)\psi(t)\,dt \int_0^{T_b} w(u)\psi(u)\,du\Big] \\ &= \int_0^{T_b}\int_0^{T_b} E[w(t)w(u)]\,\psi(t)\,\psi(u)\,dt\,du \end{aligned}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

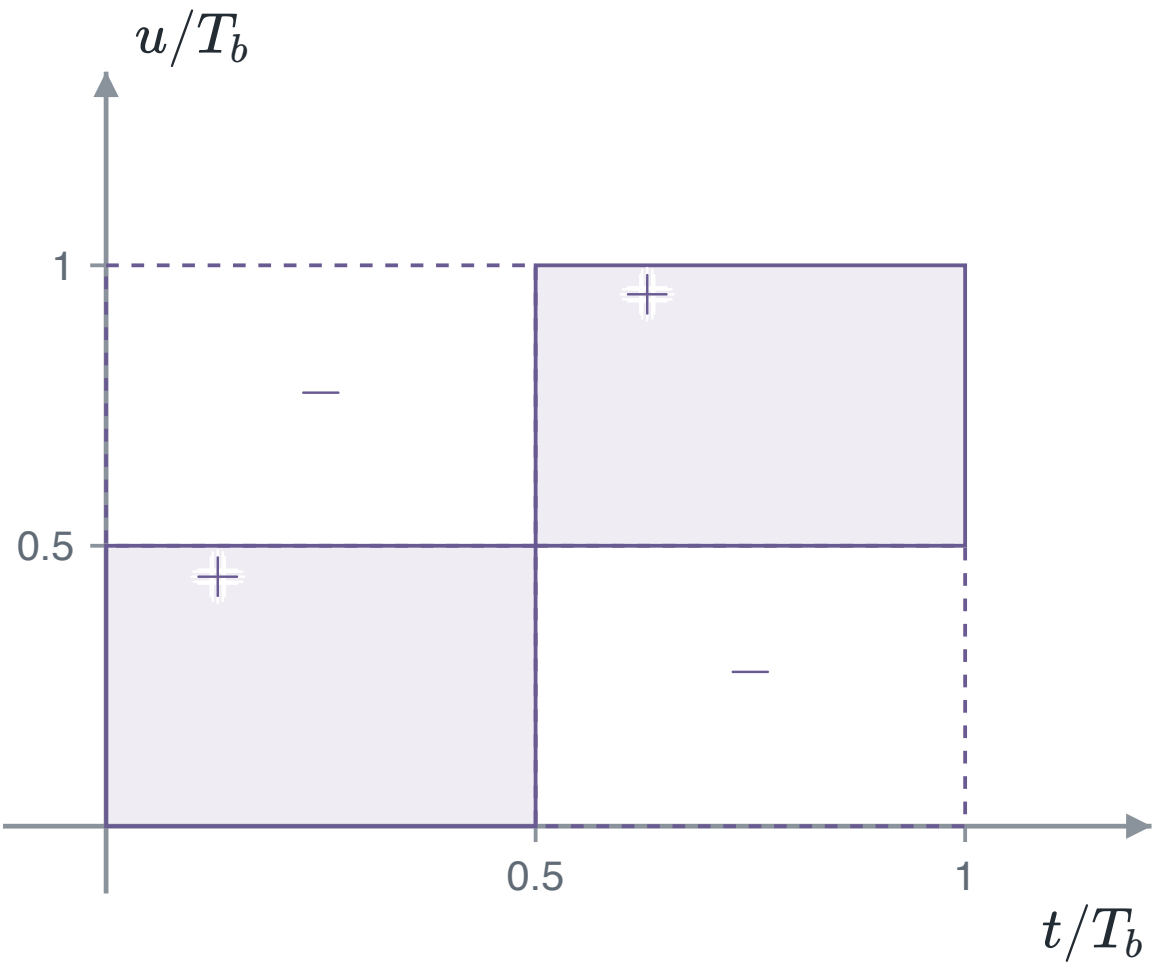


FIGURE 2.55 The square of (t, u) pairs in the double integral, for the Manchester $\psi(t)$. The product $\psi(t)\psi(u)$ is $+1/T_b$ on the shaded squares and $-1/T_b$ on the others.

The noise variance

The mean of $w(t)w(u)$ is the autocorrelation $R_w(t-u)$ of the noise. For white noise it is an impulse at $t = u$.

STEP 3 · WHITE NOISE

$$\begin{aligned} E[w(t)w(u)] &= R_w(t-u) \\ &= \frac{N_0}{2}\,\delta(t-u) \end{aligned}$$

Put the impulse into the double integral. The impulse is even, so $\delta(t-u) = \delta(u-t)$, and the inner integral sifts out $\psi(t)$. The unit energy of ψ gives the last line.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

STEP 4 · SIFT AND USE UNIT ENERGY

$$\begin{aligned} E[n^2] &= \int_0^{T_b} \psi(t) \int_0^{T_b} \frac{N_0}{2}\,\delta(t-u)\,\psi(u)\,du\,dt \\ &= \frac{N_0}{2}\int_0^{T_b} \psi(t) \underbrace{\int_0^{T_b} \psi(u)\,\delta(u-t)\,du}_{=\psi(t)}\,dt \\ &= \frac{N_0}{2}\underbrace{\int_0^{T_b} \psi^2(t)\,dt}_{=1} \\ &= \frac{N_0}{2} \end{aligned}$$

The impulse leaves only the line $t = u$, where $\psi(t)\psi(u) = \psi^2(t)$.

A linear operation on Gaussian noise gives a Gaussian random variable. Adding the constant s_m moves the mean only.

KEY RESULT · THE NOISE VALUE

$$n \sim \mathcal{N}\Big(0,\ \frac{N_0}{2}\Big), \qquad y \sim \mathcal{N}\Big(s_m,\ \frac{N_0}{2}\Big)$$

For example, $N_0 = 2 \times 10^{-4}$ W/Hz gives $\sigma^2 = 10^{-4}$, so $\sigma = 0.01$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

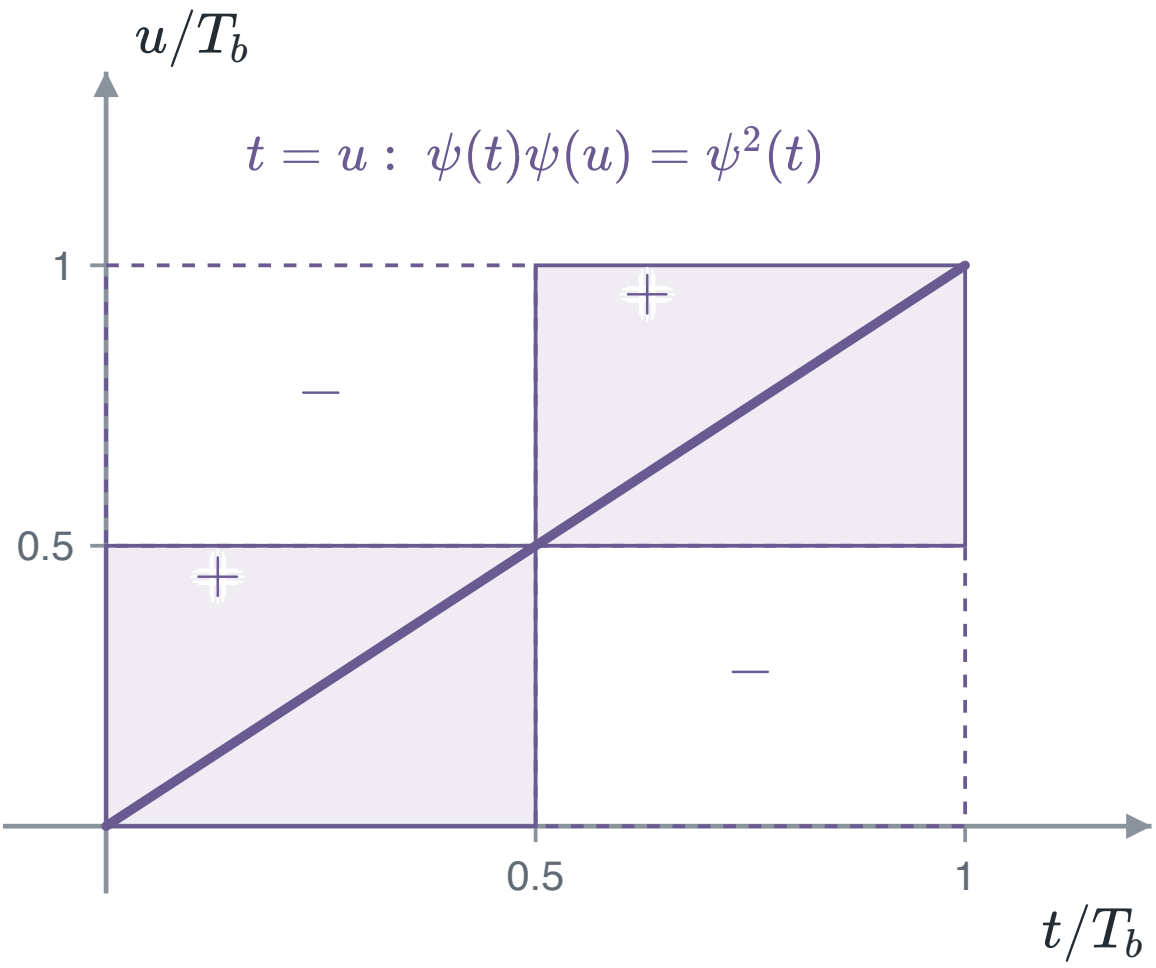


FIGURE 2.56 White noise keeps only the line $t = u$ of the square. On that line the product is $\psi^2(t) = 1/T_b$, whatever the sign pattern of ψ.

Measuring the noise value

The result $\sigma = \sqrt{N_0/2}$ can be measured. Make many noise values n, each the weighted sum of its own white noise samples, and look at their spread.

THE PREDICTION

$$\sigma = \sqrt{\frac{N_0}{2}}$$

With $N_0 = 0.5$, 3000 values give a measured spread of 0.505 against the predicted 0.5. Making N_0 four times larger doubles σ.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Common error: take $\sigma = N_0/2$. That is the variance. At $N_0 = 0.5$ the spread is $\sqrt{0.25} = 0.5$, not 0.25.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0



FIGURE 2.57 Histogram of 3000 noise values at $N_0 = 0.5$, with the Manchester ψ, and the Gaussian density with $\sigma = \sqrt{N_0/2} = 0.5$.

Two orthogonal signals

In pulse position signalling, s_1 fills the first half of the bit and s_2 the second. The two waveforms are orthogonal, so each needs its own unit-energy basis, ψ_1 and ψ_2, and its own correlator.

TWO CORRELATORS

$$y_m = \int_0^{T_b} r(\tau)\,\psi_m(\tau)\,d\tau, \qquad m = 1, 2$$

$$s_1 \text{ sent:} \quad y_1 = \sqrt{E_b} + n_1, \qquad y_2 = n_2$$

ψ_2 is zero where s_1 is not, so the second output holds noise only. The received point is (y_1, y_2) on a plane.

The sifting step of the variance, with ψ_2 in place of the second ψ, gives the correlation of the two noise terms.

THE TWO NOISE TERMS

$$\begin{aligned} E[n_1 n_2] &= \frac{N_0}{2} \int_0^{T_b} \psi_1(t)\,\psi_2(t)\,dt \\ &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

The two Gaussian noise terms are uncorrelated, and so independent. The points $(\sqrt{E_b}, 0)$ and $(0, \sqrt{E_b})$ are $\sqrt{2E_b}$ apart. For $E_b = 4$ mJ that is 0.089, against 0.126 for antipodal points.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

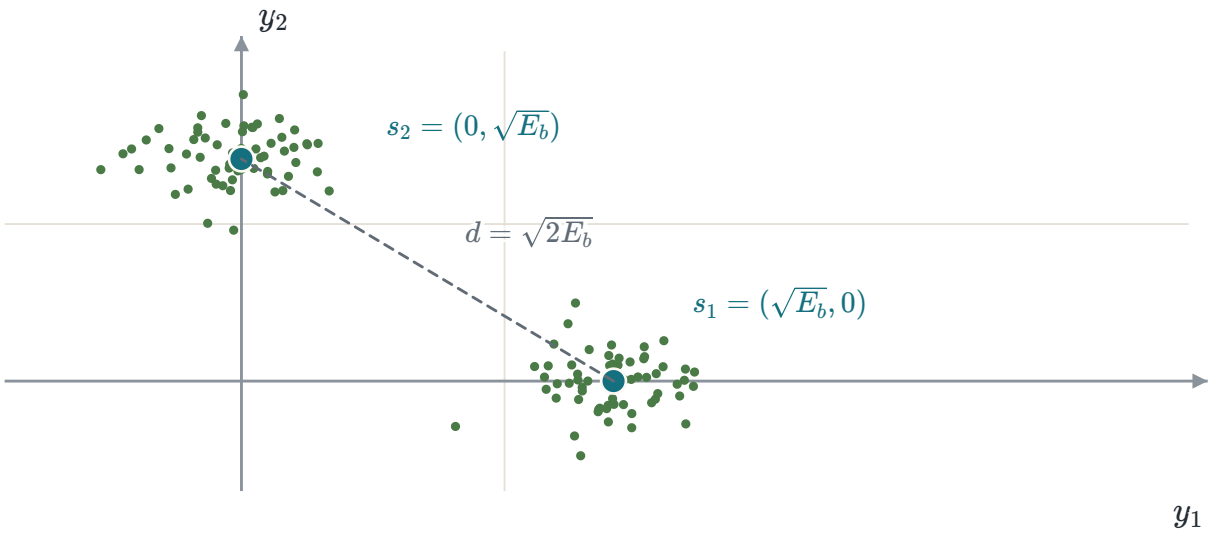


FIGURE 2.58 The two signal points of orthogonal signalling on the plane of the correlator outputs, with 60 noisy outputs around each.

Demodulators around us

Antipodal signalling and the correlator appear in serial links and digital receivers.

- **RS-485.** An RS-485 pair at 1 Mb/s sends $s(t) = \pm A$ on the difference of two wires, with $A = 2$ V. That is polar signalling with $s_m = \pm A\sqrt{T_b}$.
- **UART.** A UART takes 16 samples a bit. The sum $y = \sum_{n=0}^{15} x[n]$ is a correlator with a rectangular ψ, run on samples.
- **Decision statistic.** The values of y for 4000 bits at $E_b/N_0 = 6$ dB form two bumps. They sit at $\pm\sqrt{E_b}$, each with spread $\sigma = \sqrt{N_0/2}$.
- **Sampling instant.** Sampled $0.1T_b$ early, the output keeps $0.9\sqrt{E_b}$. The signal energy seen drops to $0.81E_b$, a loss of 0.92 dB.

> ⓘ TWO POINTS ON A LINE
>
> Every antipodal link sends $\pm A$ for one bit. After the demodulator only the number $y = \pm\sqrt{E_b} + n$ is left.

> ⓘ A CORRELATOR ON SAMPLES
>
> A digital receiver adds samples instead of integrating. The sum of N samples a bit is the correlator with ψ sampled N times.

> ⚠ TIMING
>
> The correlator is read at the end of the bit. An offset of ϵ scales the signal term by $1 - \epsilon/T_b$.

2.4 The decision and its error

The decision statistic

The demodulator output y at $t = T_b$ is the **decision statistic**. It is all the receiver keeps of the bit.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

THE STATISTIC

$$y = s_m + n, \qquad s_m = \pm\sqrt{E_b}, \qquad n \sim \mathcal{N}\left(0, \tfrac{N_0}{2}\right)$$

The symbol sets the mean of y. The noise sets its spread.

Given the symbol, y is a constant plus a Gaussian, so it is Gaussian too. Find its mean and variance.

MEAN AND VARIANCE

$$\begin{aligned} E[y] &= E[s_m + n] = E[s_m] + E[n] \\ &= s_m \\ \sigma_Y^2 &= \mathrm{Var}(y) = \mathrm{Var}(s_m + n) \\ &= \mathrm{Var}(n) = \frac{N_0}{2} \end{aligned}$$

s_m is a constant and $E[n] = 0$, so the mean is the symbol. Adding a constant moves y but does not change its spread, since $\mathrm{Var}(aX + b) = a^2\,\mathrm{Var}(X)$ with $a = 1$.

So y is Gaussian with mean s_m and variance $\sigma^2 = N_0/2$. Put these into the Gaussian density.

CONDITIONAL DENSITY

$$\begin{aligned} f_Y(y \mid s_1) &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma^2}} \exp\left(-\frac{(y - \sqrt{E_b})^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{\pi N_0}} \exp\left(-\frac{(y - \sqrt{E_b})^2}{N_0}\right) \end{aligned}$$

The second line uses $2\sigma^2 = N_0$. For s_0, replace $-\sqrt{E_b}$ by $+\sqrt{E_b}$ in the exponent. With $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$, $\sigma = \sqrt{0.25} = 0.5$ for either symbol.

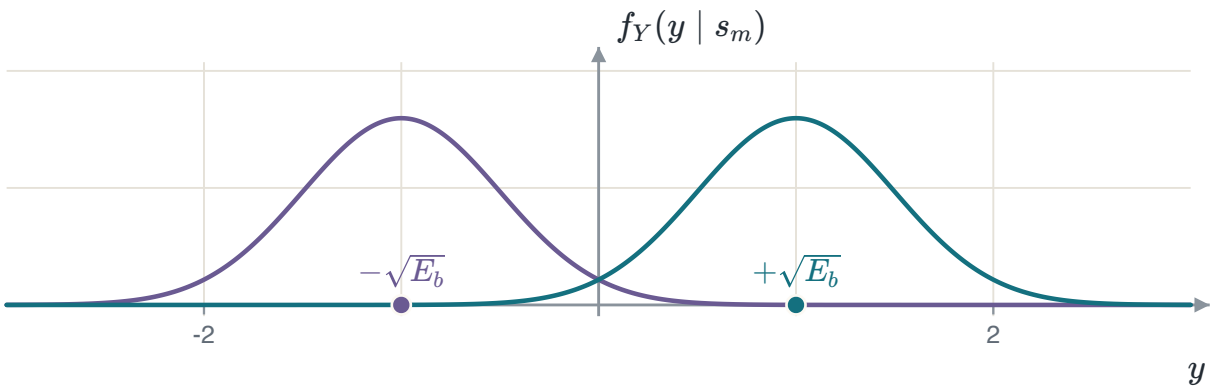


FIGURE 2.59 The density of y for each symbol, drawn with $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$. The density given s_0 is violet and the density given s_1 cyan. Each is a Gaussian centred on its symbol, and the two overlap.

The two conditional errors

The receiver decides s_1 when $y > \lambda$ and s_0 otherwise. Each symbol then has its own error probability: the area of its density on the wrong side of λ.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

GAUSSIAN TAIL: $X \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$

$$P(X > \lambda) = Q\left(\frac{\lambda - \mu}{\sigma}\right)$$

$$P(X < \lambda) = 1 - P(X > \lambda) = 1 - Q\left(\frac{\lambda - \mu}{\sigma}\right)$$

$$Q(x) = 1 - Q(-x)$$

CASE I: s_0 SENT, $y > \lambda$

$$\begin{aligned} P(\text{err} \mid s_0) = P(y > \lambda \mid s_0) &= \int_{\lambda}^{\infty} f_Y(y \mid s_0)\, dy \\ &= \int_{\lambda}^{\infty} \frac{1}{\sqrt{\pi N_0}}\, e^{-(y+\sqrt{E_b})^2/N_0}\, dy \\ &= Q\left(\frac{\lambda - \mu_0}{\sigma}\right) = Q\left(\frac{\lambda + \sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right) \end{aligned}$$

Given s_0, y is Gaussian with mean $\mu_0 = -\sqrt{E_b}$ and deviation $\sigma = \sqrt{N_0/2}$. The Gaussian tail rule above gives $Q\big((\lambda - \mu_0)/\sigma\big)$.

CASE II: s_1 SENT, $y < \lambda$

$$\begin{aligned} P(\text{err} \mid s_1) = P(y < \lambda \mid s_1) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\lambda} f_Y(y \mid s_1)\, dy \\ &= 1 - Q\left(\frac{\lambda - \mu_1}{\sigma}\right) = 1 - Q\left(\frac{\lambda - \sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right) \end{aligned}$$

Given s_1 the mean is $\mu_1 = +\sqrt{E_b}$, and the tail below λ is $1 - Q\big((\lambda - \mu_1)/\sigma\big)$. Here $Q(x)$ is the Gaussian tail. For example, $E_b = 1$, $\sigma = 0.5$ and $\lambda = 0$ give $P(\text{err} \mid s_0) = Q\big((0+1)/0.5\big) = Q(2) = 0.0228$.

Moving λ trades one error against the other. One area grows as the other shrinks.

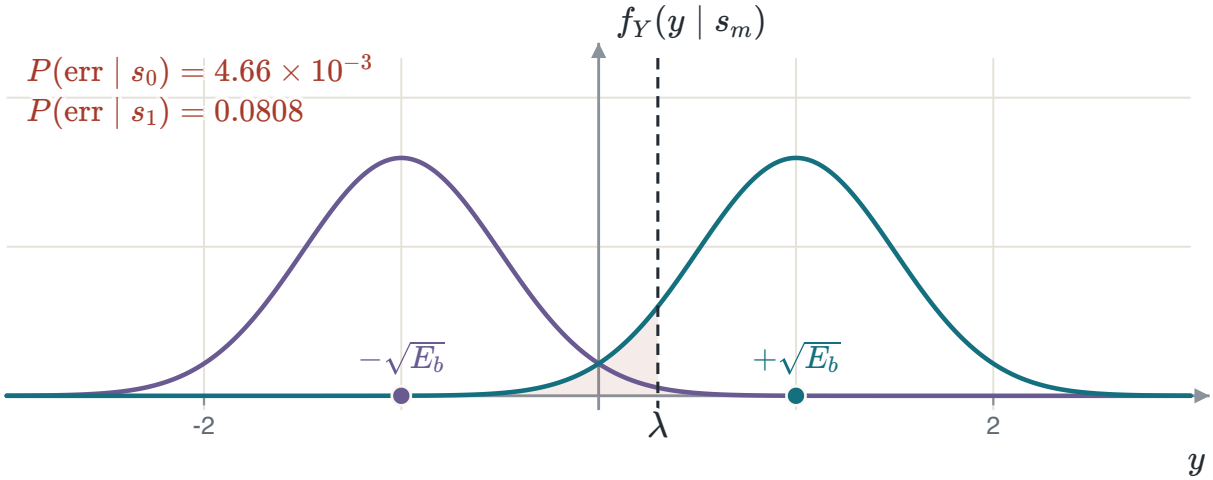


FIGURE 2.60 The two conditional densities with $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$, and the threshold at $\lambda = 0.3$. Each red area is one conditional error. Moving λ to the right shrinks the error given s_0 and grows the error given s_1.

The optimal threshold

The best threshold minimises the average error probability. The priors $p_0 = P(s_0)$ and $p_1 = P(s_1)$ weight the two conditional errors.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

MINIMISE THE AVERAGE ERROR

$$P_e(\lambda) = p_0 \int_{\lambda}^{\infty} f_Y(y \mid s_0)\, dy + p_1 \int_{-\infty}^{\lambda} f_Y(y \mid s_1)\, dy$$

The first integral is $P(\text{err} \mid s_0)$, the second $P(\text{err} \mid s_1)$. Both depend on λ only through a limit of integration.

The Leibniz rule gives the derivative of an integral with respect to one of its limits.

LEIBNIZ RULE

$$\frac{d}{db}\int_a^b f(x)\,dx = f(b), \qquad \frac{d}{da}\int_a^b f(x)\,dx = -f(a)$$

SET THE DERIVATIVE TO ZERO

$$\frac{dP_e}{d\lambda} = -p_0\, f_Y(\lambda \mid s_0) + p_1\, f_Y(\lambda \mid s_1) = 0$$

λ is the lower limit of the first integral, so its derivative carries a minus sign. It is the upper limit of the second.

At the minimum the two weighted densities are equal. Cancel the common factor $1/\sqrt{\pi N_0}$, take logarithms, then expand the two squares.

$$\begin{aligned} p_0\, e^{-(\lambda+\sqrt{E_b})^2/N_0} &= p_1\, e^{-(\lambda-\sqrt{E_b})^2/N_0} \\ \ln p_0 - \frac{(\lambda+\sqrt{E_b})^2}{N_0} &= \ln p_1 - \frac{(\lambda-\sqrt{E_b})^2}{N_0} \\ (\lambda+\sqrt{E_b})^2 - (\lambda-\sqrt{E_b})^2 &= N_0 \ln\frac{p_0}{p_1} \\ 4\lambda\sqrt{E_b} &= N_0 \ln\frac{p_0}{p_1} \end{aligned}$$

The λ^2 and E_b terms cancel in the difference of the two squares. Divide by $4\sqrt{E_b}$.

THE OPTIMAL THRESHOLD

$$\lambda_{\text{opt}} = \frac{N_0}{4\sqrt{E_b}} \ln\frac{p_0}{p_1}$$

For example, $p_0 = 0.7$, $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$ give $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = \frac{0.5}{4}\ln\frac{0.7}{0.3} = 0.125(0.847) = 0.106$. It moves toward the less likely symbol.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

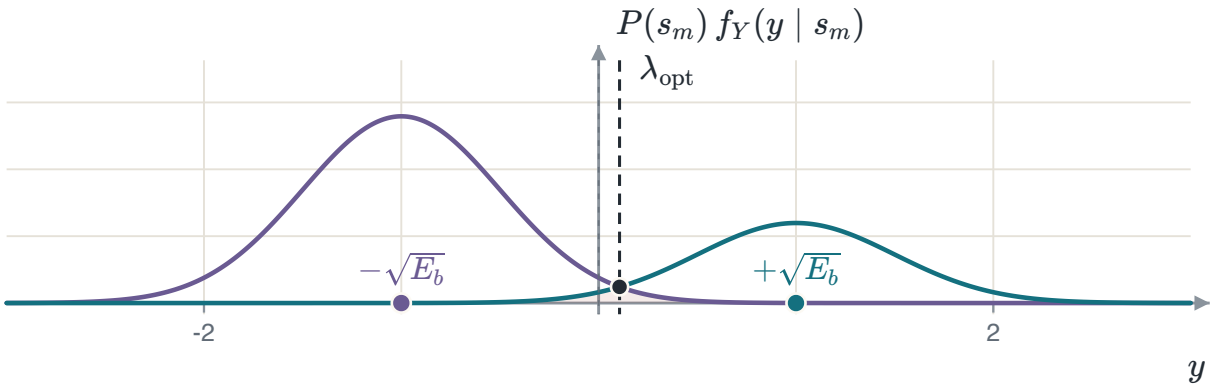


FIGURE 2.61 The two densities weighted by their priors, for $p_0 = 0.7$, $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$. The weighted density of s_0 is violet. They cross at λ_{opt}, right of zero. The shaded area is P_e.

Threshold, priors and noise

The formula for λ_{opt} shows two effects.

1. The threshold moves away from the more likely symbol, so that symbol gets the larger region.
2. The move grows with N_0. With little noise, y decides and the prior hardly matters.

With equal priors, $p_0 = p_1 = 0.5$, the logarithm is $\ln(0.5/0.5) = \ln 1 = 0$. Then $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = 0$ for every N_0.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $\ln(p_0/p_1)$, not $\ln(p_1/p_0)$. With $p_0 > p_1$ the threshold is positive, so the more likely s_0 keeps more of the axis.

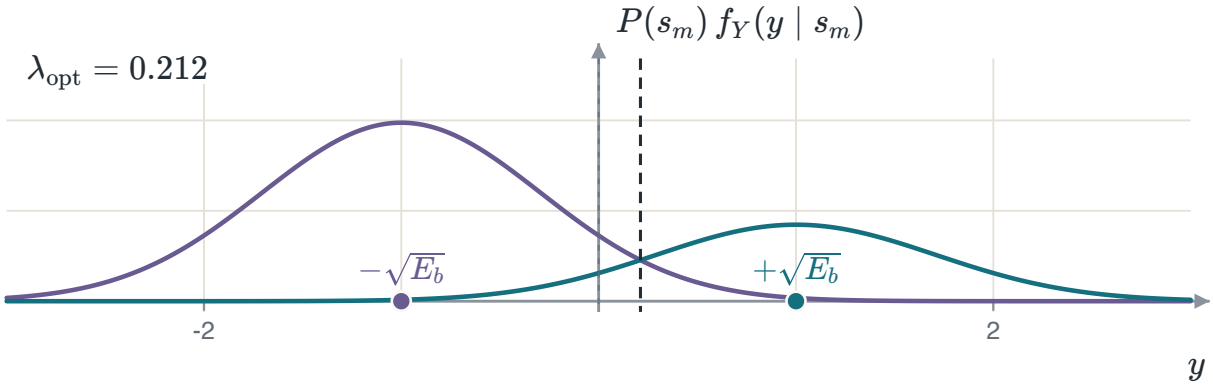


FIGURE 2.62 The weighted densities for $p_0 = 0.7$ at $E_b/N_0 = 0$ dB, with $E_b = 1$. The noise density is twice that of the last figure, and the threshold has moved twice as far, to $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = 0.212$.

The Q function

The Gaussian tail has no closed form. It is written as a function of its own, $Q(x)$.

> DEFINITION
>
> $$Q(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int_x^{\infty} e^{-z^2/2}\, dz$$
>
> $Q(x)$ is the probability that a Gaussian of mean 0 and variance 1 exceeds x.

A few values recur throughout the course.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

VALUES

$$Q(0) = 0.5, \quad Q(1) = 0.159, \quad Q(2) = 0.0228, \quad Q(3) = 1.35 \times 10^{-3}$$

For large x, $Q(x) \le \frac{1}{2} e^{-x^2/2}$, so the tail falls faster than any power of x.

A Gaussian value of mean 0 and standard deviation σ is divided by σ before Q is used. The probability that it exceeds 3σ is $Q(3) = 1.35 \times 10^{-3}$.

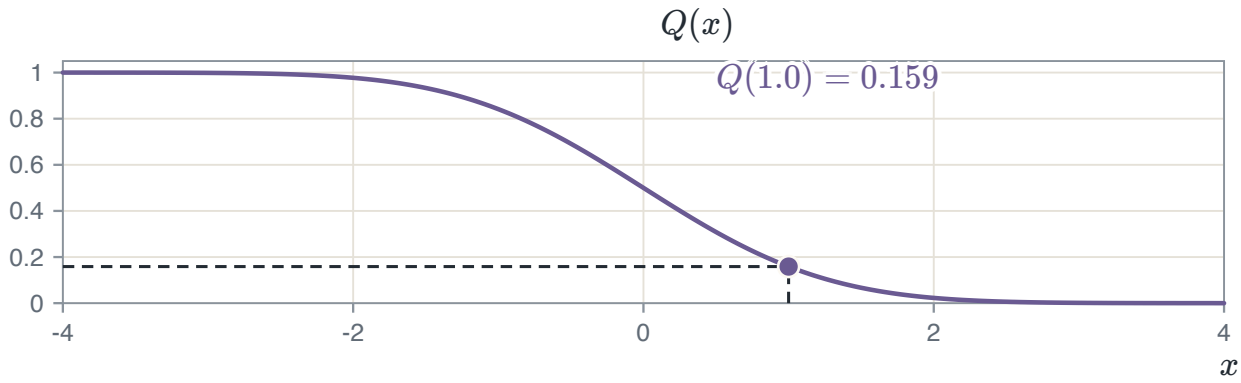


FIGURE 2.63 $Q(x)$ falls from 1 to 0 and passes 0.5 at $x = 0$. The point marks $Q(1) = 0.159$.

The bit error probability

With equal priors the threshold is $\lambda = 0$. Put $\lambda = 0$ in both conditional errors. The last step uses $Q(-x) = 1 - Q(x)$.

CONDITIONAL ERRORS AT $\lambda = 0$

$$\begin{aligned} P(\text{err} \mid s_0) &= Q\left(\frac{0 + \sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right) = Q\left(\frac{\sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right) \\ P(\text{err} \mid s_1) &= 1 - Q\left(\frac{0 - \sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right) = 1 - Q\left(-\frac{\sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right) \\ &= 1 - \left[1 - Q\left(\frac{\sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right)\right] = Q\left(\frac{\sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right) \end{aligned}$$

The two conditional errors are equal, so each prior multiplies the same value.

EQUAL PRIORS

$$P_e = \underbrace{p_0}_{=1/2} \underbrace{\int_0^{\infty} f_Y(y \mid s_0)\, dy}_{=Q(\sqrt{E_b}/\sigma)} + \underbrace{p_1}_{=1/2} \underbrace{\int_{-\infty}^{0} f_Y(y \mid s_1)\, dy}_{=Q(\sqrt{E_b}/\sigma)} = Q\left(\frac{\sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma}\right)$$

$$\frac{\sqrt{E_b}}{\sigma} = \frac{\sqrt{E_b}}{\sqrt{N_0/2}} = \sqrt{\frac{2E_b}{N_0}}$$

The result is the bit error probability of polar signalling.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

POLAR SIGNALLING

$$P_e = Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{2E_b}{N_0}}\right)$$

$2E_b/N_0$ is the peak SNR of the matched filter, so $P_e = Q\left(\sqrt{\eta_{\max}}\right)$.

The error probability falls slowly at low E_b/N_0 and steeply at high E_b/N_0.

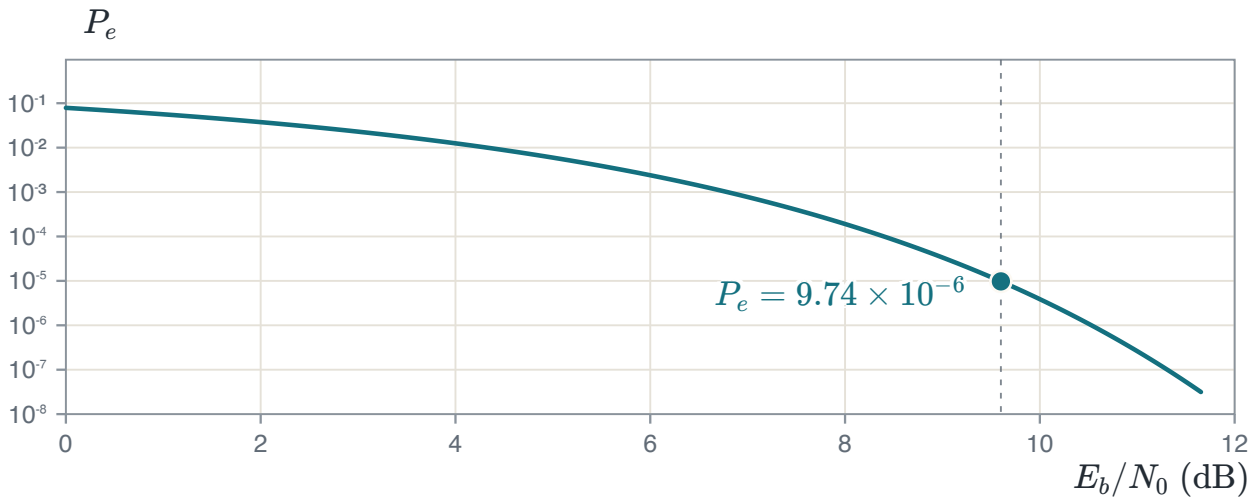


FIGURE 2.64 Bit error probability of polar signalling against E_b/N_0. The marked point is $E_b/N_0 = 9.6$ dB, where $P_e = 9.74 \times 10^{-6}$.

EXAMPLE 2.4 — UNEQUAL PRIORS: THE THRESHOLD

GIVEN Polar signalling with $E_b = 1$, $N_0 = 0.1$ and $P(s_1) = 0.3$.

FIND (a) The optimal threshold λ_{opt}.

METHOD The priors are unequal, so the threshold is not zero. Use $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = \frac{N_0}{4\sqrt{E_b}} \ln \frac{p_0}{p_1}$ with $p_0 = 1 - P(s_1) = 0.7$ and $p_1 = 0.3$.

SOLUTION $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = \frac{0.1}{4(1)} \ln \frac{0.7}{0.3} = 0.025(0.8473) = 0.0212$.

CHECK Both weighted densities are equal there. $p_0 f_Y(\lambda \mid s_0) = \frac{0.7}{\sqrt{0.1\pi}} e^{-(1.0212)^2/0.1} = 1.249\, e^{-10.428} = 3.70 \times 10^{-5}$. $p_1 f_Y(\lambda \mid s_1) = \frac{0.3}{\sqrt{0.1\pi}} e^{-(0.9788)^2/0.1} = 0.535\, e^{-9.581} = 3.70 \times 10^{-5}$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

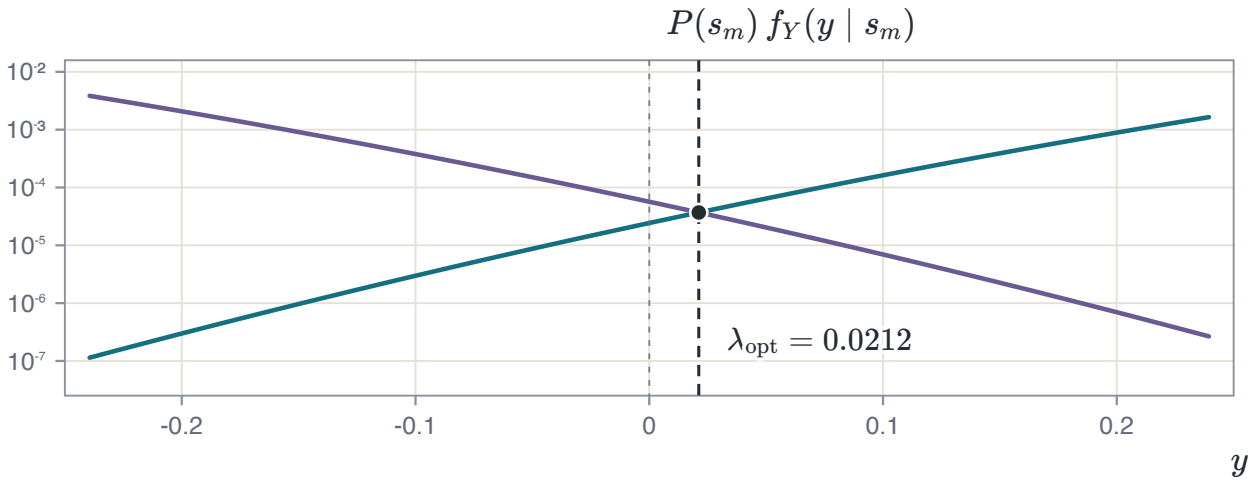


FIGURE 2.65 Example 2.4: the two weighted densities on a logarithmic scale, where each is a parabola. The weighted density of s_0 is violet. They cross at $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = 0.0212$, just right of zero.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $p_0 = 0.7$, not the given 0.3, for s_0. Swapping them gives -0.0212.

✎ EXAMPLE 2.5 – UNEQUAL PRIORS: THE ERROR PROBABILITY

GIVEN $E_b = 1$, $N_0 = 0.1$, $p_0 = 0.7$ and $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = 0.0212$, from Example 2.4.

FIND (b) P_e at λ_{opt}, against P_e at $\lambda = 0$.

METHOD Weight the two conditional errors by their priors: $P_e = p_0\, Q\big((\lambda + \sqrt{E_b})/\sigma\big) + p_1\, Q\big((\sqrt{E_b} - \lambda)/\sigma\big)$, with $\sigma = \sqrt{N_0/2} = 0.2236$.

SOLUTION $P(\text{err} \mid s_0) = Q(1.0212/0.2236) = Q(4.567) = 2.48 \times 10^{-6}$. $P(\text{err} \mid s_1) = Q(0.9788/0.2236) = Q(4.377) = 6.01 \times 10^{-6}$. In units of 10^{-6}, $P_e = 0.7(2.48) + 0.3(6.01) = 3.53$, so $P_e = 3.53 \times 10^{-6}$.

CHECK At $\lambda = 0$ both conditional errors are $Q(1/0.2236) = Q(4.472)$, so $P_e = Q(4.472) = 3.87 \times 10^{-6}$. The ratio $3.87/3.53 = 1.10$, so the zero threshold is about 10 per cent worse.

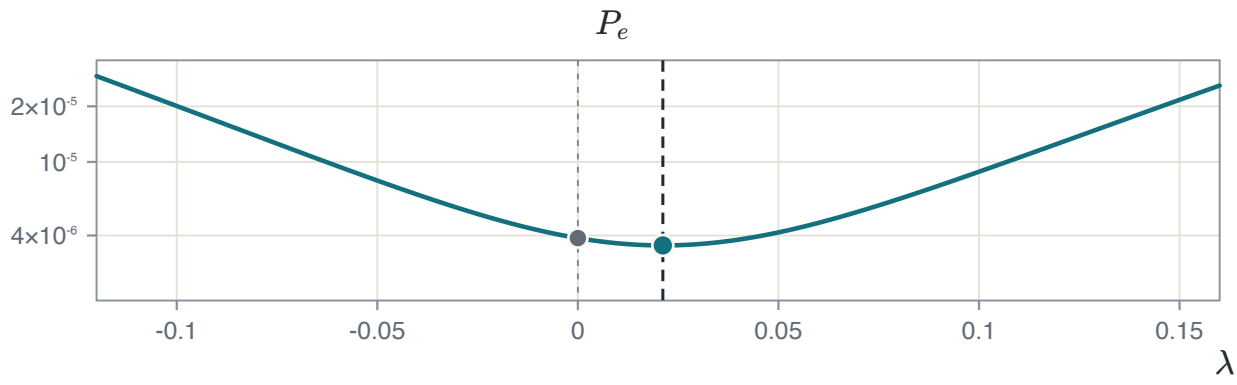


FIGURE 2.66 Example 2.5: P_e against the threshold for the same link. The minimum sits at $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = 0.0212$. At $\lambda = 0$ (grey dot) it is about 10 per cent higher.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $\sigma = \sqrt{N_0/2}$, not $\sqrt{N_0}$. The wrong σ raises P_e over a hundred times.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Error rates around us

The error probability sets link targets, moves the threshold for rare events, and is measured by counting errors.

- **Ethernet.** Wired Ethernet asks for $P_b < 10^{-10}$. Polar signalling reaches it at $E_b/N_0 = 13.1$ dB, where $\sqrt{2E_b/N_0} = 6.36$.
- **Rare events.** A sensor reports a rare event with prior $p_1 = 0.1$. With $E_b = 1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$, $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = 0.125 \ln 9 = 0.275$, moved toward the rare symbol.
- **The tail on decades.** On a logarithmic scale, the Gaussian tail $Q(x)$ keeps steepening. Above $x = 3$ each unit step in x divides $Q(x)$ by more than 40.
- **Error counts.** A tester counts errors in blocks of 10^5 bits at $P_b = 10^{-4}$. It expects 10 a block, and the counts scatter around that.

> ⓘ TARGET ERROR RATE
>
> A standard fixes the largest P_b a link may have. The curve $Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$ turns that target into the E_b/N_0 the link needs.

> ⓘ COUNTING ERRORS
>
> A measured P_b is errors divided by bits. About 10 errors are needed for a steady estimate, so $P_b = 10^{-4}$ needs about 10^5 bits.

> ⚠ RARE SYMBOLS
>
> When one symbol is rare, λ_{opt} moves toward it. The receiver then needs stronger evidence before it decides the rare symbol.

2.5 Intersymbol interference

The baseband link

A baseband link carries bits as pulses over a wire or a cable. It has six blocks, and the signal changes its form at each one.

- The **pulse-amplitude modulator** (PAM) turns each bit b_k into an amplitude a_k.
- The **transmit filter** $g(t)$ sends one pulse per amplitude. Their sum is $s(t)$.
- The **channel** $h(t)$ changes the shape of the pulses, giving $x(t)$. White Gaussian noise $w(t)$ adds to it.
- The **receive filter** $c(t)$ gives $y(t)$, which is sampled once a bit, at $t_i = iT_b$.
- The **decision device** compares each sample $y(t_i)$ with a threshold and decides the bit.

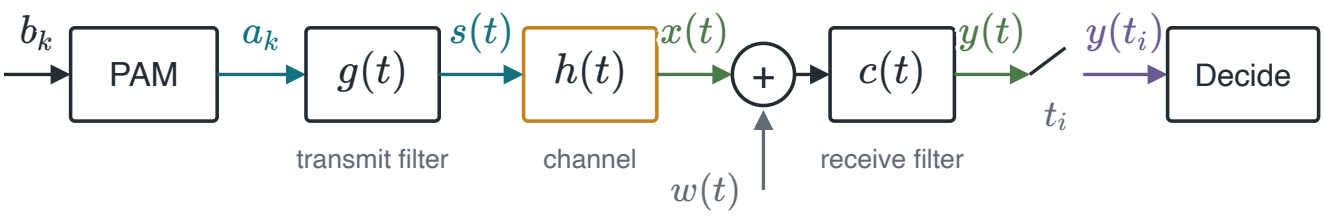


FIGURE 2.67 The baseband link. Each arrow carries the name of the signal on it. The channel $h(t)$ is the block this section studies.

The three filters act on a pulse one after another. Their convolution is one overall filter. Its impulse response is written $\mu\, p(t)$, with $p(t)$ scaled so that $p(0) = 1$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

OVERALL PULSE

$$\mu\, p(t) = g(t) * h(t) * c(t) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \mu\, P(f) = G(f)\, H(f)\, C(f)$$

Convolution in time is multiplication in frequency, so the overall frequency response is the product of the three. μ carries the gain of the link.

RECEIVE-FILTER OUTPUT

$$y(t) = \mu \sum_k a_k\, p(t - kT_b) + n(t)$$

One copy of $p(t)$ for each bit, shifted to its slot and signed by a_k. $n(t)$ is the noise after the receive filter.

The channel acts on $s(t)$ by convolution, $x(t) = s(t) * h(t)$. An ideal channel has $h(t) = \delta(t)$, and convolution with $\delta(t)$ returns the signal itself, so $x(t) = s(t)$.

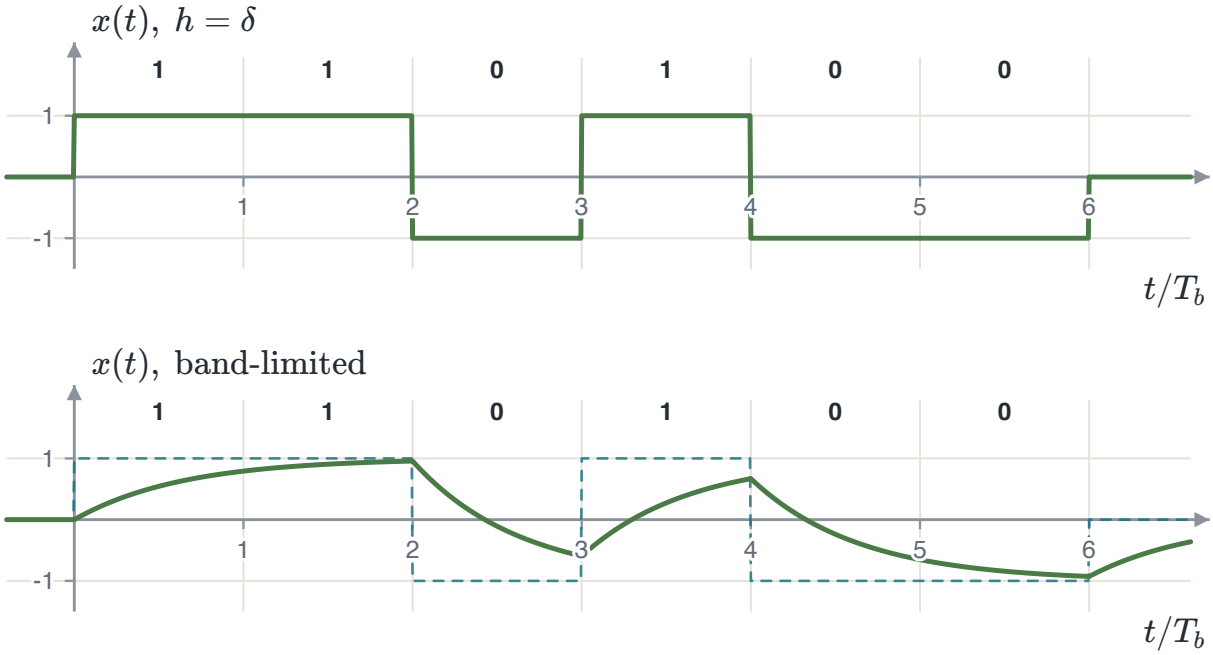


FIGURE 2.68 The bits $1\,1\,0\,1\,0\,0$ through two channels, with $s(t)$ dashed. Top: an ideal channel, $h(t) = \delta(t)$, gives $x(t) = s(t)$. Bottom: a band-limited RC channel with $BT_b = 0.25$ rounds the edges and spreads each pulse.

PULSE SPREADING

With rectangular transmit pulses, it is the channel. A bandlimited channel cannot follow the sharp edges of $s(t)$, so it smooths each pulse and gives it a tail.

From bits to pulses

In polar NRZ signalling each bit sets the sign of one pulse. NRZ, non-return-to-zero, means the level holds for the whole bit.

POLAR NRZ

$$a_k = \begin{cases} +1, & b_k = 1 \\ -1, & b_k = 0 \end{cases}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TRANSMITTED SIGNAL

$$s(t) = \sum_k a_k \, g(t - kT_b)$$

Here $g(t)$ is a rectangle of height 1 on $[0, T_b]$. The copies sit side by side and never overlap, so at any time only the pulse of the current bit is on.

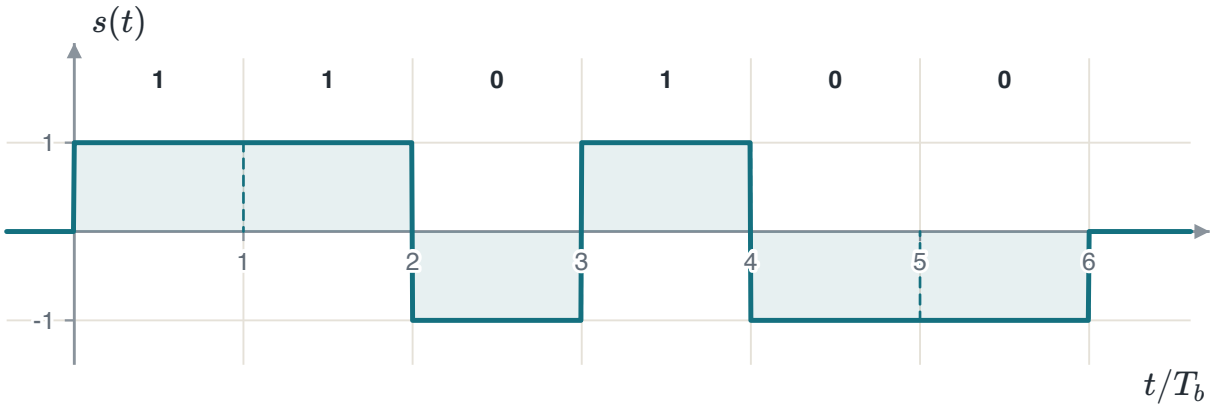


FIGURE 2.69 The bits $1\,1\,0\,1\,0\,0$ in polar NRZ. Each bit stamps one copy of $g(t)$ (shaded, dashed) into its slot, and the copies add up to $s(t)$.

An ideal and a bandlimited channel

A linear channel puts out the convolution of its input with its impulse response. To compute one value $x(t)$, flip h, slide it to t, multiply it by s, and take the area of the product.

CHANNEL OUTPUT

$$x(t) = s(t) * h(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} s(u)\, h(t-u)\, du$$

An **ideal channel** has a flat response. Its impulse response is a single impulse, which picks out one value of s.

IDEAL CHANNEL

$$H(f) = c \quad \Longrightarrow \quad h(t) = c\,\delta(t), \qquad x(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} s(u)\, c\,\delta(t-u)\, du = c\, s(t)$$

Every frequency of $s(t)$ passes with the same gain, so the pulses keep their shape. For example, $H(f) = 0.5$ gives $x(t) = 0.5\, s(t)$.

A first-order RC lowpass is the simplest bandlimited channel. It has one parameter, the 3 dB bandwidth B.

THE RC CHANNEL

$$H(f) = \frac{1}{1 + jf/B}, \qquad h(t) = \frac{1}{\tau} e^{-t/\tau}\ (t \geq 0), \qquad \tau = \frac{1}{2\pi B}$$

The impulse response is spread over a few time constants τ. The convolution then averages s over the recent past, and the sharp edges of $s(t)$ become slow rises and falls.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

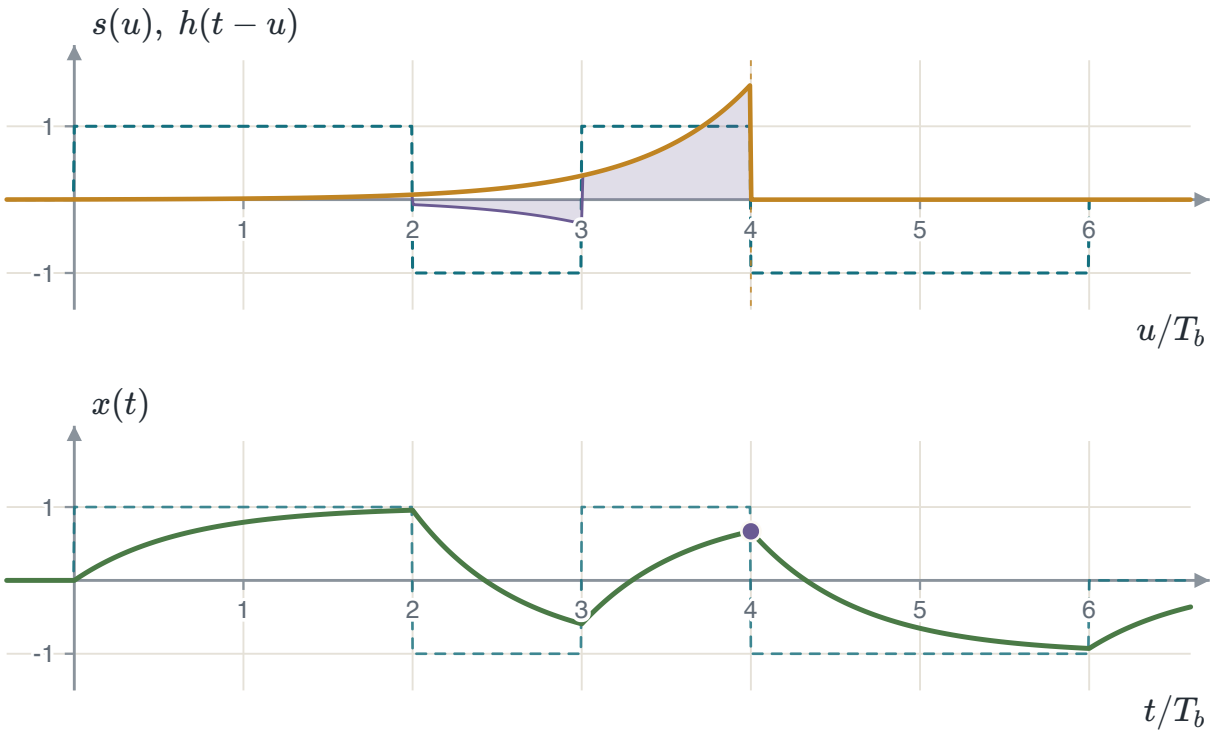


FIGURE 2.70 The convolution for the RC channel with $BT_b = 0.25$, at $t = 4T_b$. Above, $s(u)$ (dashed), the flipped response $h(t-u)$ (amber) and their product (violet). The shaded area is $x(4T_b)$. Below, the whole output $x(t)$ (green) with that value marked.

Intersymbol interference

Send one unit bit on $[0, T_b]$ through the RC channel. Inside the bit the output is the integral of h. It never reaches 1 inside the bit, and it decays after the bit ends.

ONE BIT

$$r(t) = \int_0^t \frac{1}{\tau} e^{-u/\tau}\, du = 1 - e^{-t/\tau}, \quad 0 \le t \le T_b$$
$$r(T_b) = 1 - q, \qquad q = e^{-T_b/\tau} = e^{-2\pi B T_b}$$

The share q is the part of the bit's level still missing at the end of the bit. For $BT_b = 0.25$, $q = e^{-2\pi(0.25)} = e^{-\pi/2} = 0.208$ and $r(T_b) = 1 - q = 0.792$.

A pulse spread beyond its own bit overlaps its neighbours at their sampling instants. That overlap is **intersymbol interference** (ISI): one symbol interferes with the symbols after it.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

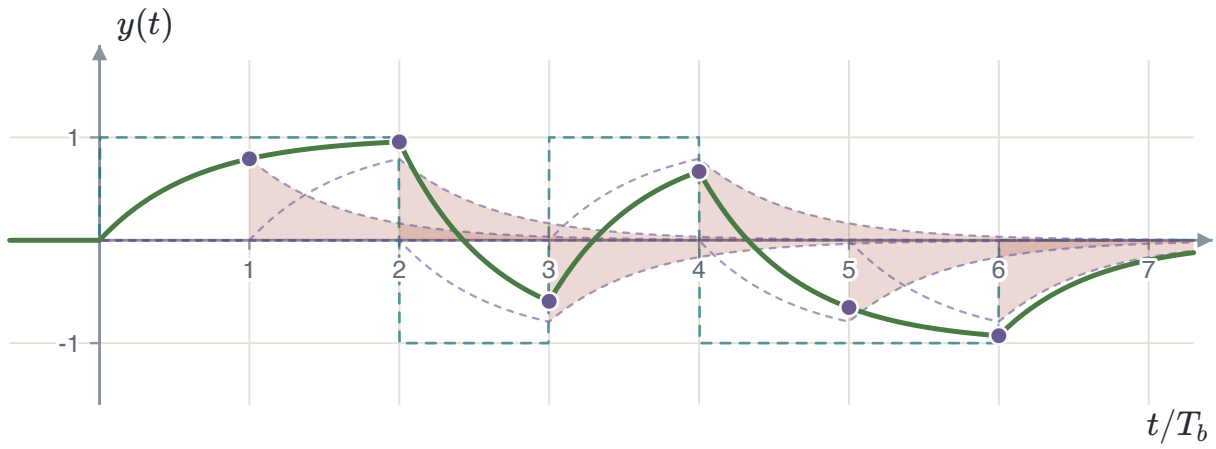


FIGURE 2.71 Six bits $1, 1, 0, 1, 0, 0$ through an RC channel with $BT_b = 0.25$. The sent bits are cyan and each bit's own response is dashed violet. The red areas are the tails that spill into later bits. Their sum is the received waveform (green), and the dots are its samples at the end of each bit.

The three parts of a sample

Sample the receive-filter output at $t_i = iT_b$. The sum over all bits splits into the bit being decided, all the other bits, and the noise.

SAMPLED OUTPUT

$$\begin{aligned} y(t_i) &= \mu \sum_k a_k \, p\big((i-k)T_b\big) + n(t_i) \\ &= \underbrace{\mu\, a_i}_{\text{own bit}} + \underbrace{\mu \sum_{k \neq i} a_k \, p\big((i-k)T_b\big)}_{\text{intersymbol interference}} \\ &\quad + \underbrace{n(t_i)}_{\text{noise}} \end{aligned}$$

The term $k = i$ is taken out of the sum. Since $p(0) = 1$, it is μa_i. Every other bit adds the value of its pulse at t_i.

For the RC channel with the sample at the end of each bit, $\mu p(0) = r(T_b) = 1 - q$ and $\mu p(mT_b) = r\big((m+1)T_b\big) = (1-q)q^m$. Dividing by μ gives p.

RC CHANNEL

$$\mu = 1 - q, \qquad p(mT_b) = \begin{cases} q^m, & m \geq 0 \\ 0, & m < 0 \end{cases}$$

The channel is causal, so only earlier bits interfere. At $BT_b = 0.25$ the previous bit, if it is a $+1$, adds $\mu\, p(T_b) = (1-q)q = 0.792 \times 0.208 = 0.165$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

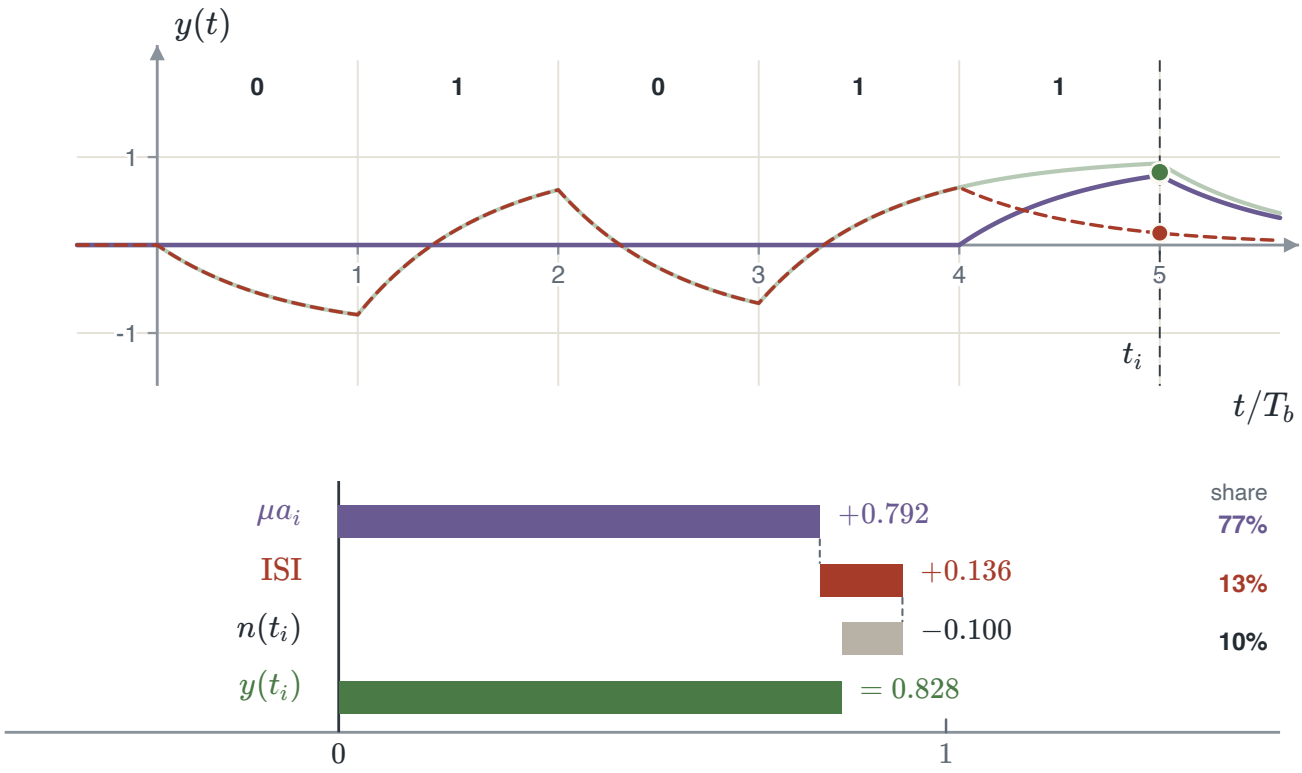


FIGURE 2.72 The bits $0\,1\,0\,1\,1$ through the RC channel with $BT_b = 0.25$, sampled at $t_i = 5T_b$. Top, the own pulse (violet) and the other pulses added together (red, dashed). Bottom, the sample built tip to tail: the own bit 0.792, the interference $+0.136$, a noise value -0.1, and the total 0.828. The percentages are each part's share of their total size. A narrower channel shrinks the own bit and grows the interference.

The eye diagram

An **eye diagram** shows the interference of every bit pattern at once. Cut the received waveform into pieces $2T_b$ long, centred on the sampling instants t_k, and draw them all on one axis. An oscilloscope triggered by the bit clock does this.

The RC channel turns each bit edge into a sharp corner and a slow tail, so its eye leans to one side. For the eye diagrams of this section the channel is a **Gaussian lowpass filter** of 3 dB bandwidth B. It rounds every edge into a smooth S-curve, the same on the rise and the fall, so the eye comes out symmetric.

Its impulse response is a Gaussian bell of width σ. A bit of amplitude 1 on $[-T_b/2,\ T_b/2]$ comes out as the bell summed over the bit.

GAUSSIAN CHANNEL

$$\sigma = \frac{\sqrt{\ln 2}}{2\pi B}$$

$$p(t) = Q\left(\frac{t - T_b/2}{\sigma}\right) - Q\left(\frac{t + T_b/2}{\sigma}\right)$$

$Q(x)$ is the Gaussian tail probability. The bit is sampled at its centre, $t = 0$.

At the centre the pulse is $p(0) = Q(-a) - Q(a) = 1 - 2Q(a)$, with $a = T_b/(2\sigma)$. Name the share that leaks past one edge q.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

LEAK PAST ONE EDGE

$$q = Q\left(\frac{T_b}{2\sigma}\right) = Q\left(\frac{\pi B T_b}{\sqrt{\ln 2}}\right)$$
$$p(0) = 1 - 2q$$

The bit keeps $1 - 2q$ of its own sample. The rest, q on each side, lands on its neighbours.

Each piece of the eye holds the sampled bit and half of each neighbour. Three bits give eight patterns. The line before and after a pattern holds its outer bits, so the eight pieces already show the best and the worst case.

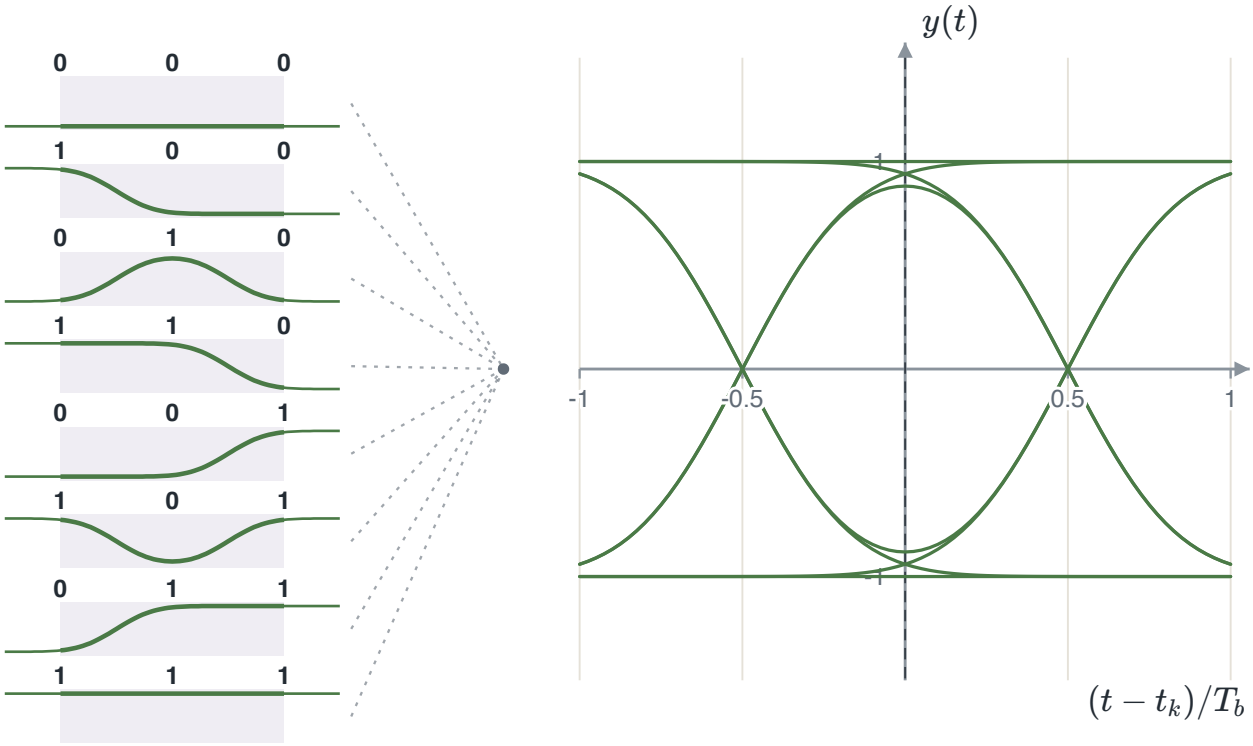


FIGURE 2.73 How the eye is built, for the Gaussian channel with $BT_b = 0.5$. Left, the eight patterns of three bits, each with the window $2T_b$ wide around t_k shaded. Right, the eight pieces laid on one axis make the eye.

A wider channel rounds the edges less. Less of each bit leaks into its neighbours, so the band of traces at the sampling instant gets thinner.

Reading the eye

An eye diagram is read at a few places. The bit is sampled at its centre $t = t_k$, where the eye is widest.

- **Best sampling time.** The instant where the eye is most open.
- **Margin over noise.** The vertical gap at that instant. Noise smaller than half of it cannot cause an error.
- **Distortion at $t = 0$.** The thickness of the band of traces at that instant. Interference from the other bits causes it.
- **Zero-crossing spread.** The range of times at which the traces cross zero.
- **Sampling window.** The time between the inner crossings, where a sample still decides correctly.
- **Timing sensitivity.** The slope of the sides of the eye.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

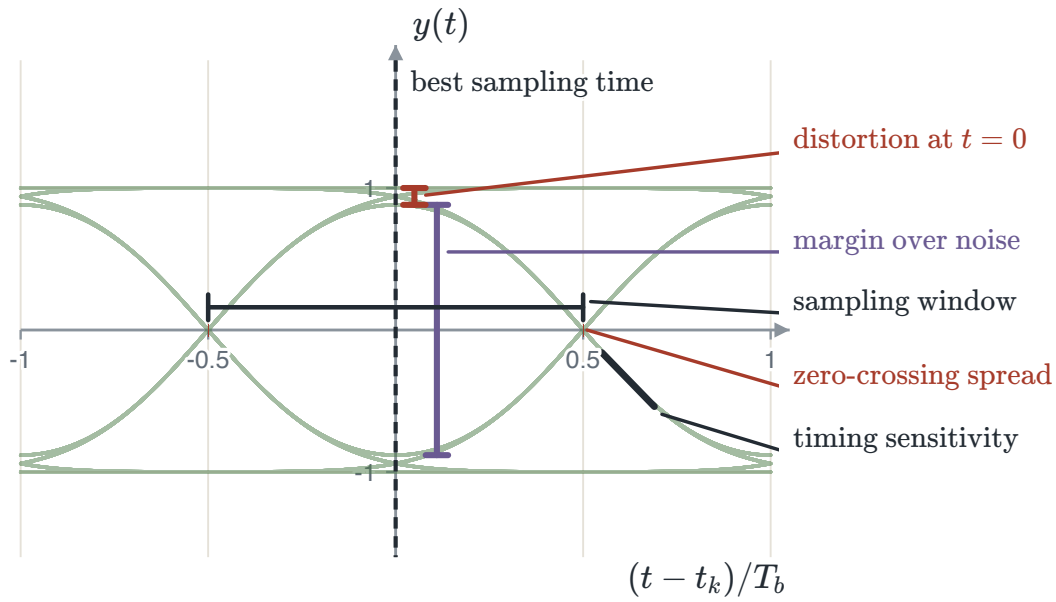


FIGURE 2.74 The eye of the Gaussian channel with $BT_b = 0.5$, from 128 bit patterns. Its readings are the best sampling time, the margin over noise, the distortion at $t = 0$, the zero-crossing spread, the sampling window and the timing sensitivity.

The size of the opening follows from the worst pattern, in which every other bit is opposite to the sampled one. A share q of each bit leaks past each of its two edges, so the sampled bit keeps $1 - 2q$. The leaks of the other bits add up to $2q$ against it.

OPENING

$$\min_{\text{patterns}} |y_k| = (1 - 2q) - 2q = 1 - 4q$$
$$\text{opening} = 2(1 - 4q)$$

For $BT_b = 0.5$, $q = Q(0.5\pi/\sqrt{\ln 2}) = Q(1.887) = 0.030$, so the eye opening at the sampling instant is $2(1 - 4q) = 2(0.882) = 1.76$.

Eye closure

A narrower channel closes the eye. It is fully closed when the opening reaches zero. Set $1 - 4q = 0$ and read the argument of Q from a table.

CLOSURE

$$1 - 4q = 0$$
$$Q\left(\frac{\pi BT_b}{\sqrt{\ln 2}}\right) = \tfrac{1}{4}$$
$$\frac{\pi BT_b}{\sqrt{\ln 2}} = 0.674$$
$$BT_b = \frac{0.674\sqrt{\ln 2}}{\pi} = 0.179$$

Below $BT_b = 0.179$ some patterns cross zero at the sampling instant, and decisions fail with no noise at all. At $BT_b = 0.15$, $q = Q(0.566) = 0.286 > 0.25$, so $1 - 4q = -0.14 < 0$ and the eye is closed.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

NOISE MARGIN

Noise must move a sample by more than $1 - 4q$ to cause an error. A half-closed eye halves the margin, which costs 6 dB of SNR.

COMMON ERROR

Use the worst pattern, not a typical one. A random stream may run for a long time before it shows the pattern that closes the eye.

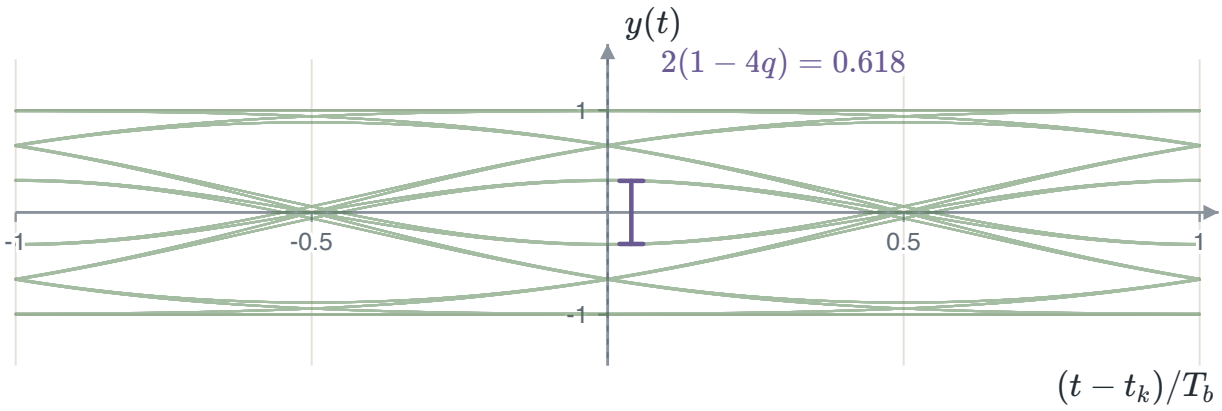


FIGURE 2.75 The eye of the Gaussian channel at $BT_b = 0.25$, where $q = 0.173$ and the opening has shrunk to 0.618. Below $BT_b = 0.179$ the eye is closed.

Noise on the eye

A real sample carries noise as well as interference. Each sample then has three parts.

ONE SAMPLE

$$y_k = \underbrace{a_k(1-2q)}_{\text{own bit}} + \underbrace{\text{ISI}_k}_{\text{other bits}} + \underbrace{n_k}_{\text{noise}}$$

Interference moves each sample to one of a few levels. Noise then spreads every level into a bell.

WORST PATTERN

The levels nearest zero fail first. Their margin is $1 - 4q$, not $1 - 2q$, so a half-closed eye needs much less noise to fail.

As the noise grows from zero, the worst-pattern samples cross zero first. At $BT_b = 0.5$ they sit at $\pm(1 - 4q) = \pm 0.88$, the levels closest to the threshold.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

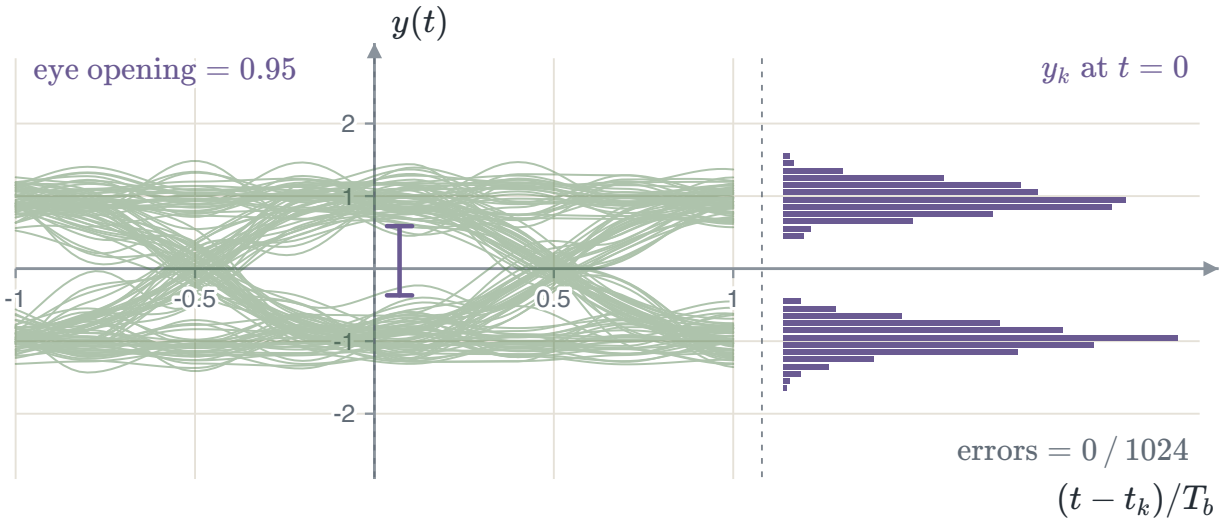


FIGURE 2.76 The eye of the Gaussian channel at $BT_b = 0.5$ with noise of standard deviation $\sigma = 0.2$. The violet bracket is the opening the traces leave at $t = 0$. The bars at the right count 1024 samples taken at $t = 0$, red ones on the wrong side of zero.

Intersymbol interference around us

Intersymbol interference appears in cables, radio echoes and optical fibre.

- **Cable.** A long twisted pair acts like the RC channel with $BT_b = 0.15$. One bit leaves $(1 - q)q^m$ in the sample m bits later, with $q = e^{-2\pi BT_b} = 0.39$.
- **Radio echo.** An echo three symbols late with gain 0.6 gives $h[n] = \delta[n] + 0.6\,\delta[n - 3]$. Each sample then carries $0.6\,a_{k-3}$ from an older symbol.
- **Optical fibre.** A 10 Gb/s light pulse with $\sigma_0 = 20$ ps spreads to $\sigma = \sqrt{20^2 + 34^2} = 39.4$ ps after 20 km of fibre. It then reaches into the next bit, 100 ps away.
- **Eye opening.** The eye opening $2(1 - 2q)$ of the RC channel shrinks as BT_b falls. It reaches zero at $BT_b = \ln 2/(2\pi) = 0.110$.

> ⓘ CHANNEL MEMORY
>
> Every bandlimited channel spreads a pulse beyond its own bit. The sample of one bit then carries part of its neighbours.

> ⓘ ECHOES
>
> A radio echo is intersymbol interference with a delay. An echo d symbols late with gain g adds $g\,a_{k-d}$ to y_k.

> ⚠ ERRORS WITHOUT NOISE
>
> When the eye is closed, some bit patterns are decided wrongly with no noise at all. More transmit power does not remove them.

2.6 Nyquist and the raised cosine

Zero interference at the sampling instants

Section 2.5 split each sample into the own bit, the other bits and the noise. Intersymbol interference disappears when every other pulse is zero at the sampling instant.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

SAMPLED OUTPUT

$$y(t_i) = \mu a_i + \mu \sum_{k \neq i} a_k \, p\big((i-k)T_b\big) + n(t_i)$$

The middle term vanishes only if $p\big((i-k)T_b\big) = 0$ for every $k \neq i$.

This gives the condition on the pulse. It is **Nyquist's criterion** for distortionless transmission, written in the time domain.

NYQUIST'S CRITERION, TIME DOMAIN

$$p\big((i-k)T_b\big) = \begin{cases} 1, & i = k \\ 0, & i \neq k \end{cases}$$

A pulse with this property adds nothing to the samples of its neighbours, however long it lasts.

For $i = k$ the pulse gives $p(0) = 1$, so only the own bit and the noise are left. At high SNR the noise is small, $|\mu a_i| \gg |n(t_i)|$.

ZERO INTERFERENCE

$$y(t_i) = \mu a_i + n(t_i) \;\cong\; \mu a_i$$

For example, with $\mu = 1$, $a_i = -1$ and $n(t_i) = 0.1$, the sample is $y(t_i) = -1 + 0.1 = -0.9$, whatever the other bits are.

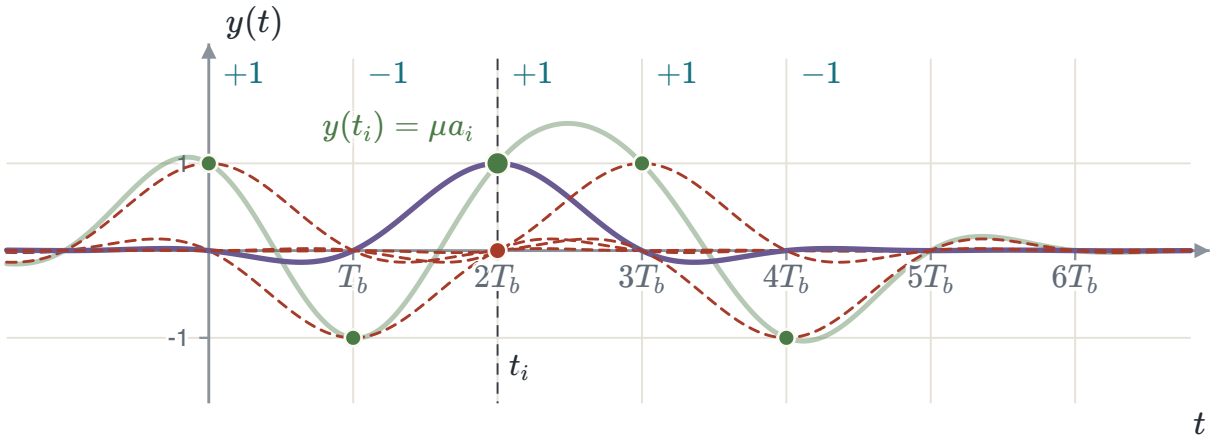


FIGURE 2.77 Five bits sent with a pulse that meets the criterion, sampled at $t_i = 2T_b$. The own pulse (violet) gives μa_i. Every other pulse (red, dashed) passes through zero at t_i, so the sample of $y(t)$ is μa_i.

The sampled pulse

The criterion is easier to test in frequency. Multiply $p(t)$ by an impulse train of period T_b. Each impulse then carries one sample $p(mT_b)$.

SAMPLED PULSE

$$p_\delta(t) = \sum_m p(mT_b)\,\delta(t - mT_b)$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Its transform follows from the replication result of Chapter 1, with the sampling rate $f_s = 1/T_b = R_b$. It is a copy of $P(f)$ every R_b, scaled by $1/T_b$.

ITS SPECTRUM

$$p_\delta(t) \xrightarrow{\mathcal{F}} P_\delta(f) = \frac{1}{T_b}\sum_n P\Big(f - n\frac{1}{T_b}\Big) = R_b \sum_n P(f - nR_b)$$

For example, $p(t) = \operatorname{sinc}(0.7t/T_b)$ has a spectrum that ends at $0.35R_b$. Each copy is $0.7R_b$ wide, so a gap of $R_b - 0.7R_b = 0.3R_b$ is left between neighbours. There $P_\delta(f) = 0$, so $P_\delta(f)$ cannot be constant.

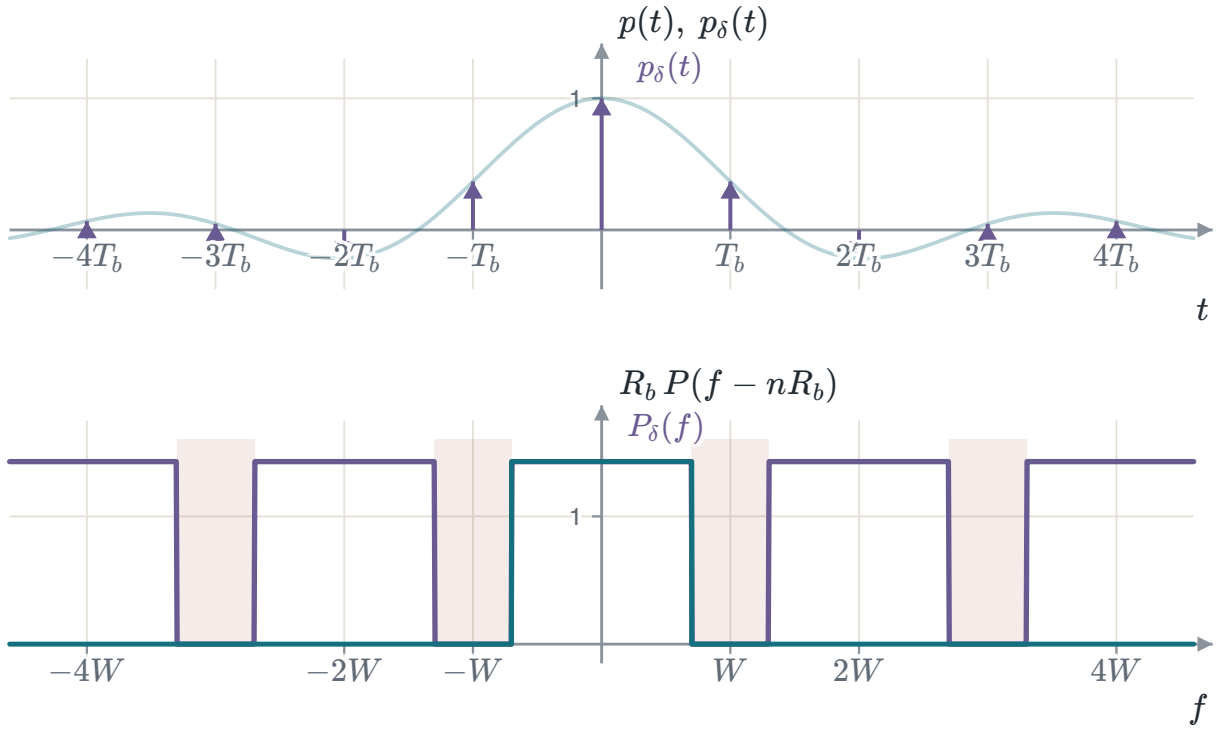


FIGURE 2.78 The pulse $p(t) = \operatorname{sinc}(0.7t/T_b)$ (faint) and its samples, the impulses of $p_\delta(t)$ (above). Below, $P(f)$ (cyan) and the sum of its copies $P_\delta(f)$ (violet), which drops to zero in the gaps (red).

Nyquist's criterion in frequency

Start from the definition of the Fourier transform and substitute the sampled pulse.

FOURIER TRANSFORM OF $p_\delta(t)$

$$P_\delta(f) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p_\delta(t)\, e^{-j2\pi ft}\, dt = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \overbrace{\Big\{\sum_m p(mT_b)\,\delta(t - mT_b)\Big\}}^{=p_\delta(t)} e^{-j2\pi ft}\, dt$$

Let $m = i - k$. If $i = k$, then $m = 0$. If $i \neq k$, zero interference makes $p(mT_b) = 0$. Only the term $m = 0$ is left.

ZERO INTERFERENCE

$$P_\delta(f) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p(0)\,\delta(t)\, e^{-j2\pi ft}\, dt = p(0)\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \delta(t-0)\, e^{-j2\pi ft}\, dt$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The sifting property picks the value of $e^{-j2\pi ft}$ at $t = 0$, which is 1. Since $p(0) = 1$ as well, the transform is 1 at every frequency.

SIFTING

$$P_\delta(f) = \overbrace{p(0)}^{=1} \cdot \overbrace{e^{-j2\pi f \cdot 0}}^{=1} = 1$$

Set the replication sum of the last section equal to this result. This is Nyquist's criterion in the frequency domain.

NYQUIST'S CRITERION, FREQUENCY DOMAIN

$$R_b \sum_n P(f - nR_b) = 1, \qquad R_b = \frac{1}{T_b}$$

The copies of $P(f)$ spaced R_b apart must add to the constant T_b.

For example, the triangle $P(f) = T_b(1 - |f|/R_b)$ for $|f| < R_b$ meets the criterion. Neighbouring triangles overlap, one rising as the other falls, so $R_b \sum_n P(f - nR_b) = 1$. Its pulse is $\mathrm{sinc}^2(t/T_b)$, which is zero at $t = kT_b$, $k \neq 0$.

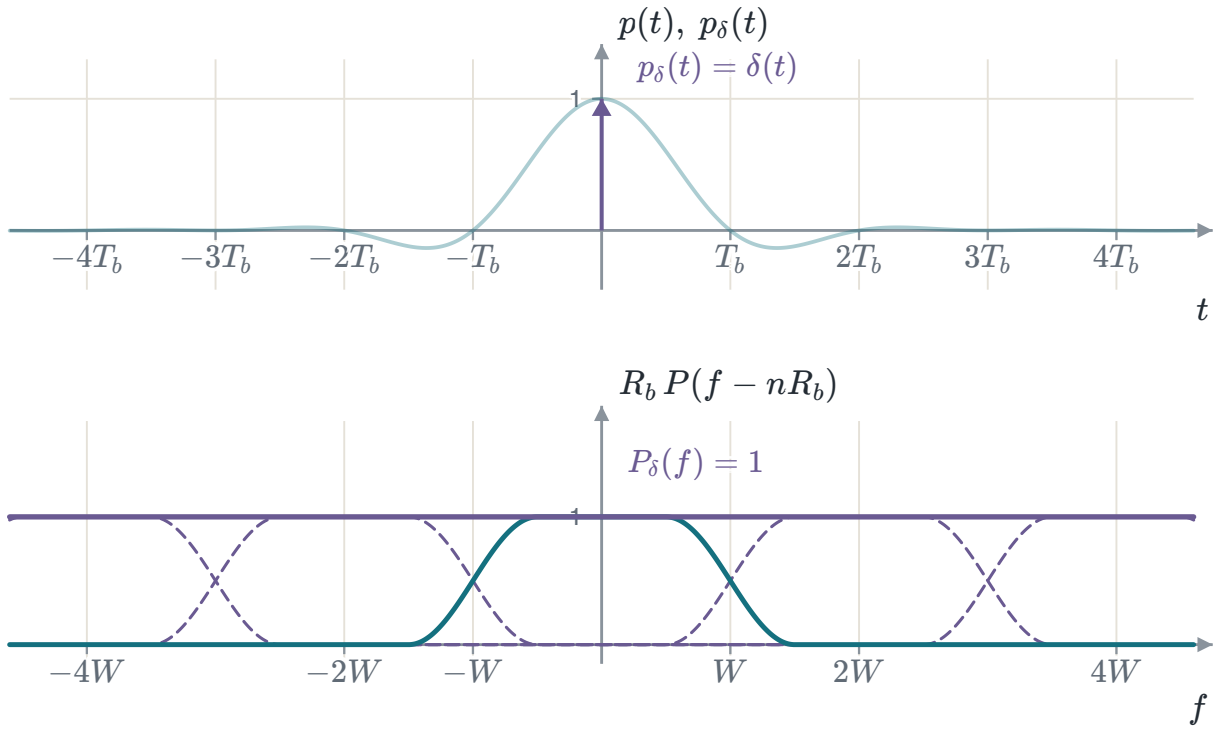


FIGURE 2.79 The pulse of the last figure made to meet the criterion. Above, only the impulse at $t = 0$ is left, so $p_\delta(t) = \delta(t)$. Below, $P(f)$ (cyan), its copies (dashed) and their sum $P_\delta(f) = 1$ (violet).

The ideal Nyquist channel

The simplest spectrum that meets the criterion is a rectangle. Its width is $2W = R_b$, so neighbouring copies meet edge to edge.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

IDEAL NYQUIST CHANNEL

$$P(f) = \begin{cases} \dfrac{1}{2W}, & -W \le f \le W \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \qquad W = \frac{R_b}{2} = \frac{1}{2T_b}$$

W is the **Nyquist bandwidth**. The height $1/(2W)$ equals T_b, so the copies add to T_b.

The pulse is the inverse transform of the rectangle. Integrate the exponential over $[-W, W]$ and use $e^{jx} - e^{-jx} = 2j \sin x$.

ITS PULSE

$$\begin{aligned} p(t) &= \int_{-W}^{W} \frac{1}{2W} e^{j2\pi ft}\, df = \frac{1}{2W} \cdot \frac{e^{j2\pi Wt} - e^{-j2\pi Wt}}{j2\pi t} \\ &= \frac{1}{2W} \cdot \frac{2j \sin(2\pi Wt)}{j2\pi t} = \frac{\sin(2\pi Wt)}{2\pi Wt} = \operatorname{sinc}(2Wt) \end{aligned}$$

Here $\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$. Since $2W = 1/T_b$, $p(kT_b) = \operatorname{sinc}(k) = 0$ for $k \neq 0$.

No narrower spectrum works. If $P(f) = 0$ for $|f| > W$ with $W < R_b/2$, the copies leave gaps and their sum cannot be constant.

HIGHEST BIT RATE

$$R_b \le 2W \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad W \ge \frac{R_b}{2}$$

A channel of bandwidth W carries at most $2W$ bits per second without interference. For example, $R_b = 64$ kb/s needs at least $W = 64/2 = 32$ kHz.

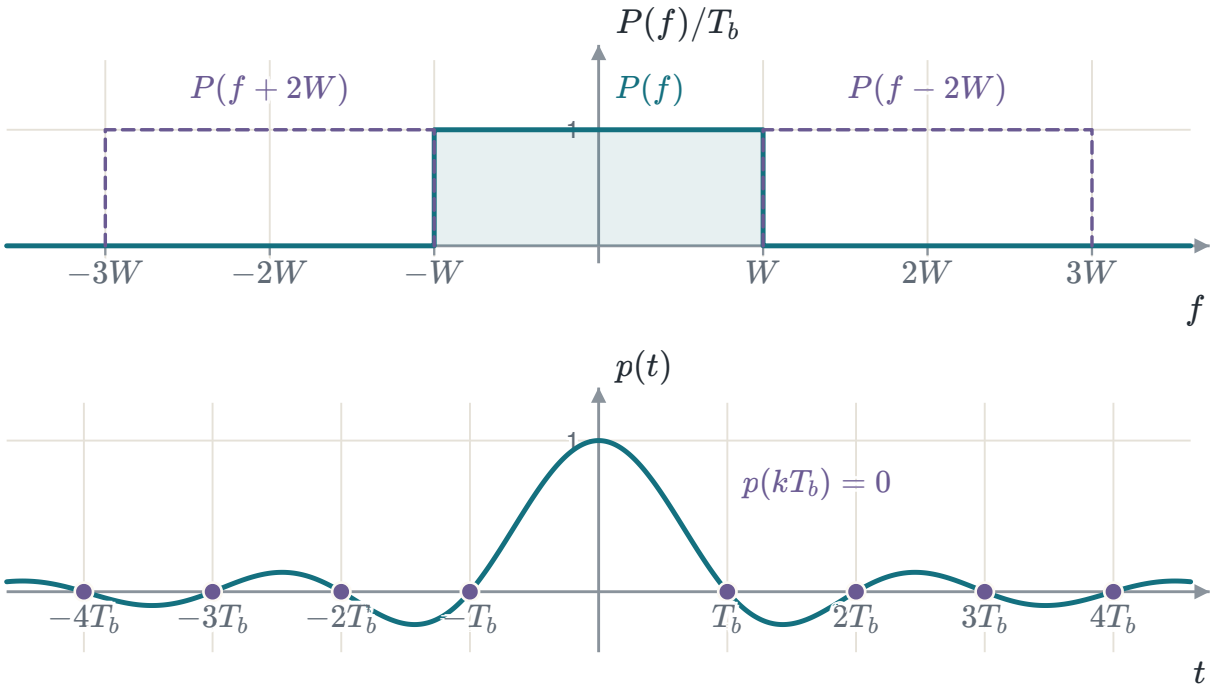


FIGURE 2.80 The ideal Nyquist channel. Above, the rectangle $P(f)$ of height T_b and its copies at $\pm 2W$, which meet it edge to edge. Below, its pulse $p(t) = \operatorname{sinc}(2Wt)$, zero at $t = kT_b$, $k \neq 0$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The ideal channel in practice

The ideal Nyquist channel has two problems in practice.

The ideal pulse needs a perfectly sharp filter edge, and no real filter has one. Its tails also die away slowly.

At the exact reading time, every neighbouring pulse is at zero. A real clock reads slightly late, so each neighbour leaks a little into the bit.

SOLUTION

The **raised cosine** keeps the same zeros, but its tails die away quickly. A late reading picks up only a small leak. The price is more bandwidth.

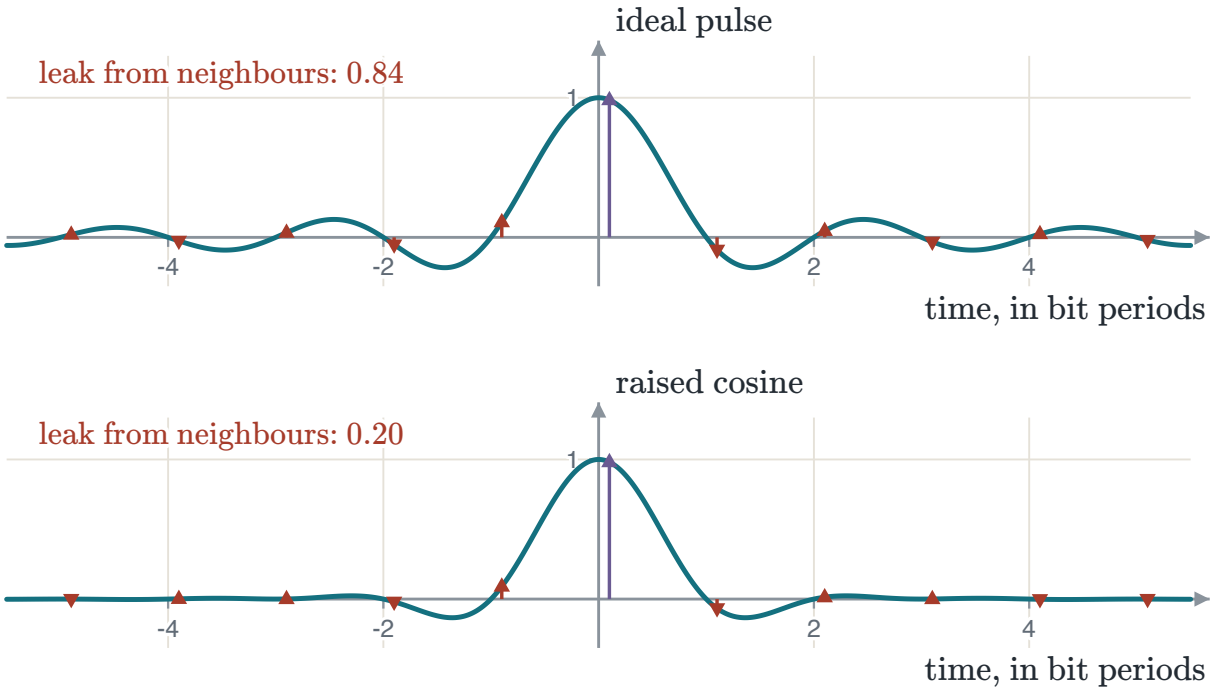


FIGURE 2.81 A bit read 0.1 of a bit period late. Each red stem is one neighbour leaking into the bit. The number adds up 40 neighbours on each side.

For example, a receiver reads every bit slightly late. The ideal pulse suffers more, because its slow tails reach many bits.

The raised-cosine spectrum

The raised cosine overcomes the practical difficulties of the ideal channel. Its band grows from W to between W and $2W$, and its edges are rounded.

RAISED-COSINE SPECTRUM

$$P(f) = \begin{cases} \dfrac{1}{2W}, & 0 \le |f| \le f_1 \\ \dfrac{1}{4W}\left\{1 - \sin\left(\dfrac{\pi(|f| - W)}{2W - 2f_1}\right)\right\}, & f_1 \le |f| \le 2W - f_1 \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

The spectrum is flat up to f_1. It then falls along half a period of a sine to zero at $2W - f_1$.

f_1 and W are related by the **roll-off factor** α, which runs from 0 to 1.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

ROLL-OFF FACTOR

$$\alpha = 1 - \frac{f_1}{W}, \qquad f_1 = W(1-\alpha), \qquad 2W - f_1 = W(1+\alpha)$$

$\alpha = 0$ gives $f_1 = W$, the ideal rectangle. For example, $R_b = 10$ kb/s and $\alpha = 0.25$ give $W = 5$ kHz and $f_1 = 5(0.75) = 3.75$ kHz.

At $|f| = W$ the argument of the sine is zero, so the spectrum is at half height.

HALF HEIGHT AT W

$$P(W) = \frac{1}{4W}\{1 - \sin 0\} = \frac{1}{4W} = \frac{T_b}{2}$$

The roll-off is odd about the point $(W, T_b/2)$. What it takes away below W it adds above W.

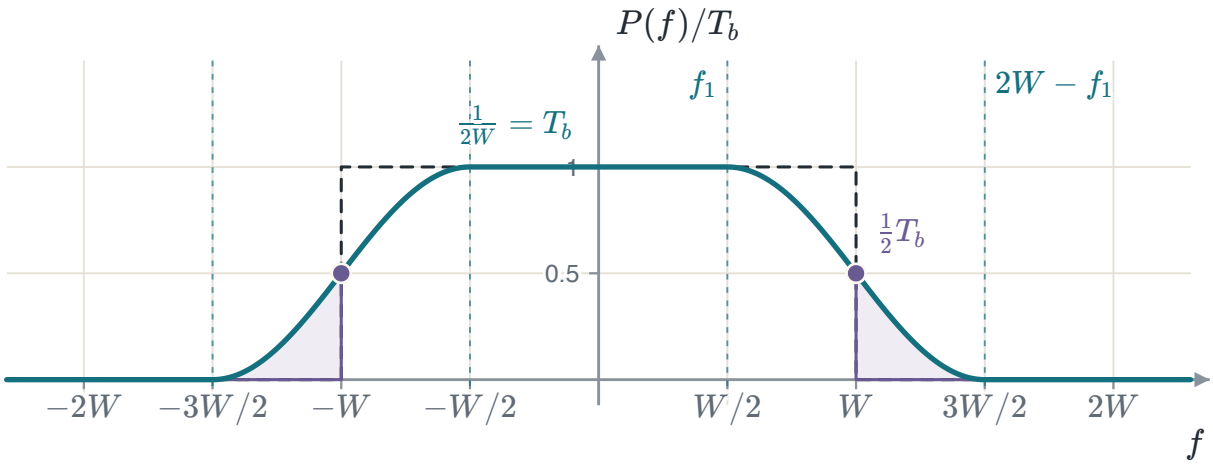


FIGURE 2.82 The raised-cosine spectrum with $\alpha = 0.5$ (cyan) on the ideal rectangle (dashed). The piece the roll-off cuts below W, turned half a turn about $(W, T_b/2)$, fills the piece it adds above W (violet).

The copies add to a constant

The raised cosine still meets Nyquist's criterion. With $R_b = 2W$ the copies sit every $2W$, and only two of them overlap at any frequency.

NYQUIST'S CRITERION

$$R_b \sum_n P(f - nR_b) = 1 \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \sum_n P(f - 2nW) = T_b$$

Take $f_1 \le f \le 2W - f_1$, where $P(f)$ and $P(f - 2W)$ overlap, and write $\theta = \pi(f - W)/(2W - 2f_1)$. For the copy, $|f - 2W| = 2W - f$, so $|f - 2W| - W = -(f - W)$ and its sine changes sign.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

IN THE OVERLAP

$$\begin{aligned} P(f) + P(f - 2W) &= \frac{1}{4W}\{1 - \sin\theta\} + \frac{1}{4W}\{1 - \sin(-\theta)\} \\ &= \frac{1}{4W}\{1 - \sin\theta\} + \frac{1}{4W}\{1 + \sin\theta\} \\ &= \frac{1}{2W} = T_b \end{aligned}$$

Outside the overlaps only one copy is non-zero, and it is flat at T_b. So the sum is T_b everywhere.

For example, with $\alpha = 0.5$, $P(0.8W) = 0.794\,T_b$. Then $P(1.2W) = P(-1.2W) = P(0.8W - 2W) = T_b - 0.794\,T_b = 0.206\,T_b$.

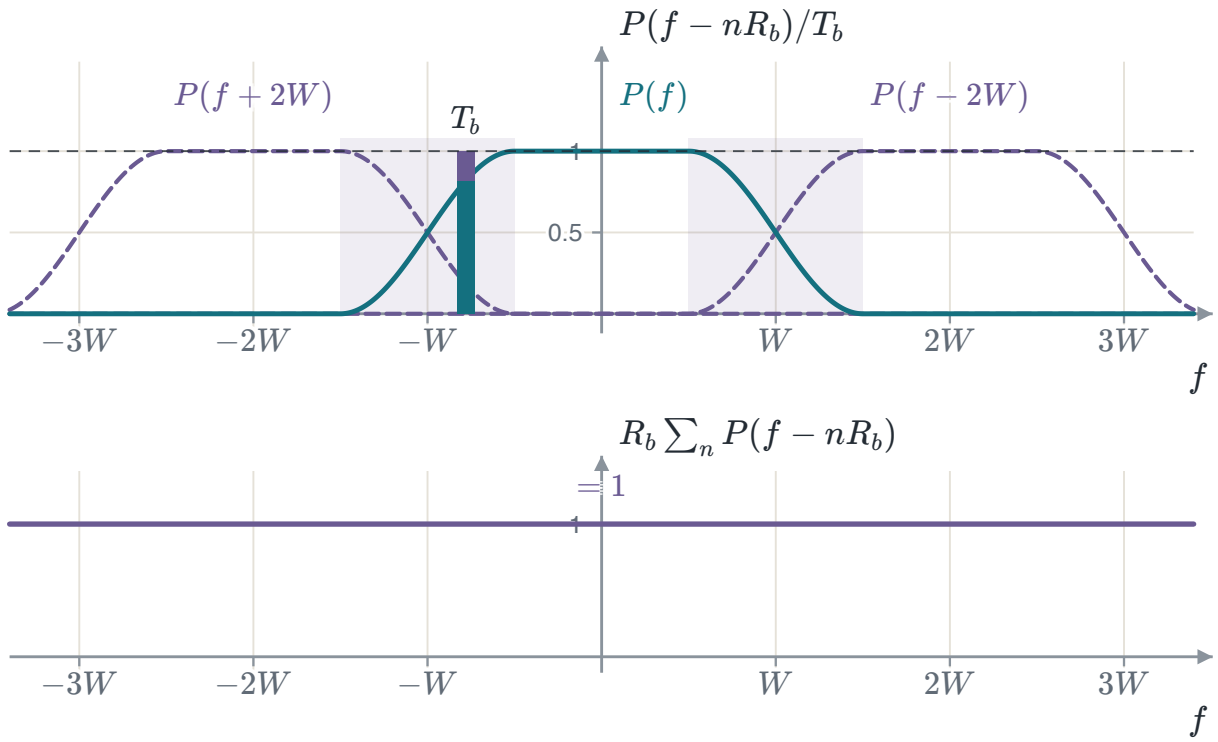


FIGURE 2.83 The raised cosine with $\alpha = 0.5$ and its copies at $\pm 2W$ (dashed). In each shaded overlap the two values at one frequency stack to T_b (bar). Below, the sum, which is flat.

The raised-cosine pulse

The inverse transform of the raised-cosine spectrum is a product of two factors.

RAISED-COSINE PULSE

$$p(t) = \mathcal{F}^{-1}\{P(f)\} = \underbrace{\operatorname{sinc}(2Wt)}_{\text{zeros at } t_i = iT_b} \underbrace{\frac{\cos(2\pi\alpha W t)}{1 - 16\alpha^2 W^2 t^2}}_{\text{faster decay}}$$

Here $\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$. Since $2W = 1/T_b$, the sinc factor is zero at $t = kT_b$, $k \neq 0$, and the product keeps those zeros.

FASTER DECAY

For $\alpha > 0$ the second factor falls as $1/t^2$, so the tails fall as $1/|t|^3$, against $1/|t|$ for the sinc pulse. A timing error then collects little interference.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Write $\cos(2\pi\alpha W t)$, not $\cos(2\pi\alpha W)$. Without t the factor is a constant and does nothing to the tails.

The second factor can add zeros of its own. With $\alpha = 1$ and $t = 1.5T_b$, $2\pi\alpha W t = 1.5\pi$ and the cosine is 0. The denominator is $1 - 16(1)(0.25)(2.25) = 1 - 9 = -8 \neq 0$, so $p(1.5T_b) = 0$.

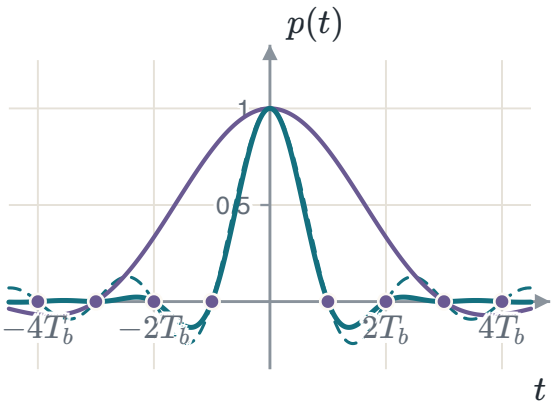


FIGURE 2.84 The sinc factor (dashed), the second factor for $\alpha = 0.5$ (violet) and their product $p(t)$ (cyan).

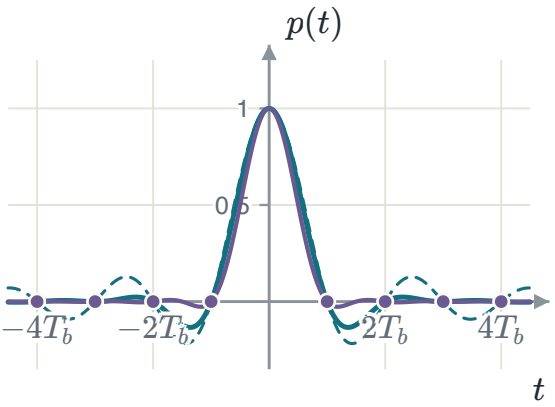


FIGURE 2.85 The pulses of $\alpha = 0$ (dashed), $\alpha = 0.5$ (cyan) and $\alpha = 1$ (violet). All are zero at $t = kT_b$, $k \neq 0$.

Choosing the roll-off

The raised-cosine spectrum has three bands. The **passband** ends at f_1. The **transition band** runs from f_1 to B_T. The **stop band** starts at B_T.

TRANSMISSION BANDWIDTH

$$B_T = 2W - f_1 = 2W - W(1-\alpha) = W(1+\alpha) = \frac{R_b}{2}(1+\alpha)$$

The bandwidth beyond W is αW. For example, $W = 5$ kHz and $\alpha = 0.25$ give $B_T = 5(1.25) = 6.25$ kHz.

α controls the sharpness of the filter. As α increases:

- The tails of $p(t)$ decay faster.
- The bandwidth B_T grows.
- The filter is easier to design, since its edges are gentler.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

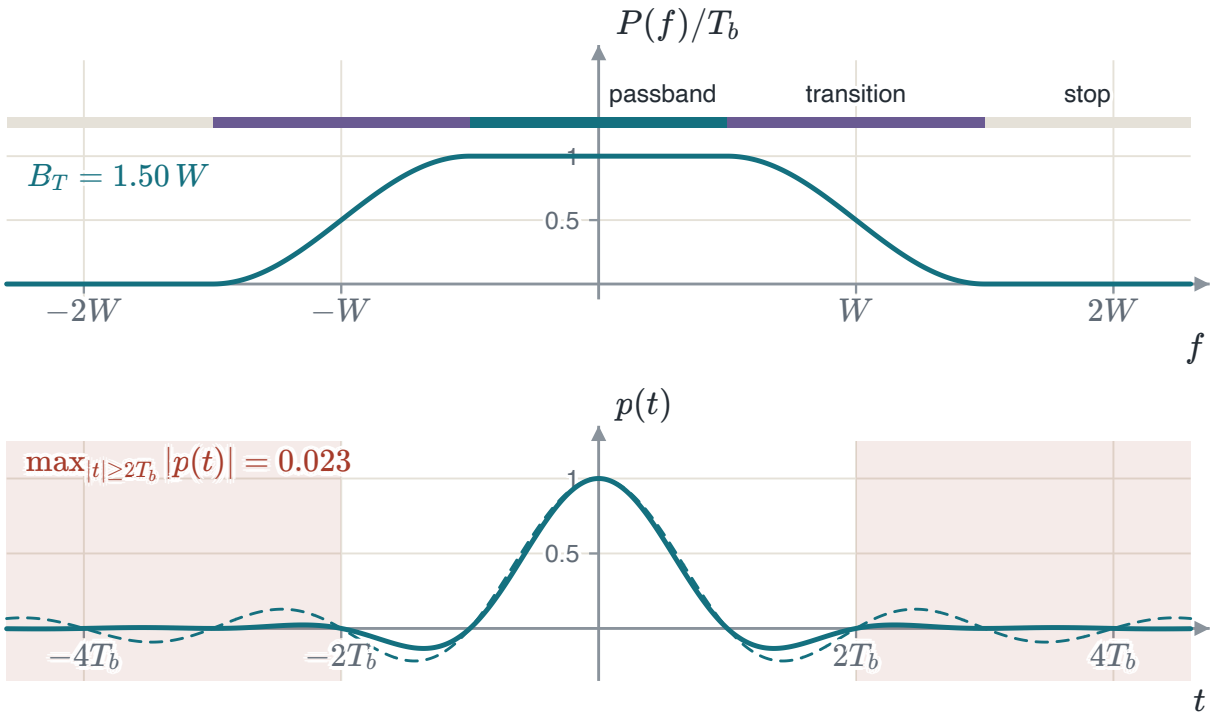


FIGURE 2.86 The raised cosine with $\alpha = 0.5$. Above, the spectrum, with a strip that marks the passband (cyan), the transition band (violet) and the stop band. Below, the pulse against the sinc pulse (dashed). The largest tail beyond $|t| = 2T_b$ is 0.023.

EXAMPLE 2.6 – A RAISED-COSINE LINK

GIVEN A link sends $R_b = 20$ kb/s with raised-cosine pulses and $\alpha = 0.5$.

FIND W, f_1 and B_T.

METHOD Each of the three follows from R_b and α: $W = R_b/2$, $f_1 = W(1-\alpha)$ and $B_T = 2W - f_1 = W(1+\alpha)$. The spectrum is flat up to f_1 and falls to zero at B_T, with its half-height point at W.

SOLUTION $W = 20/2 = 10$ kHz. $f_1 = 10(1-0.5) = 5$ kHz. $B_T = 10(1+0.5) = 15$ kHz.

CHECK $B_T - W = W - f_1 = 5$ kHz, so the roll-off is symmetric about W.

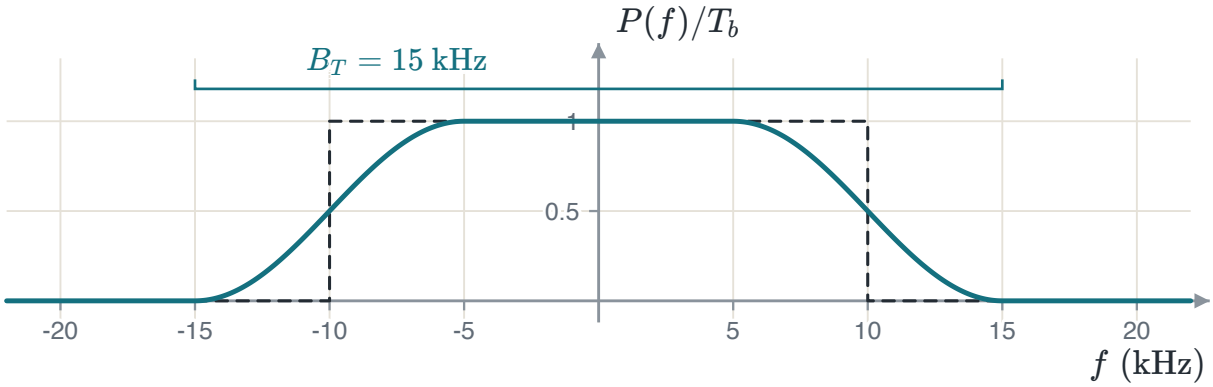


FIGURE 2.87 Example 2.6: the ideal rectangle of width $2W$ (dashed) and the raised-cosine spectrum with $\alpha = 0.5$, which reaches $B_T = 15$ kHz.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $W = R_b/2 = 10$ kHz, not $R_b = 20$ kHz. The wrong W gives $B_T = 30$ kHz, twice the true value.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Splitting the raised cosine

The raised cosine can be shared between the two ends of the link. H_T shapes the pulse at the transmitter and H_R filters at the receiver. Over a flat channel their product must be $P(f)$.

SPLIT

$$H_T(f)\,H_R(f) = P(f), \qquad H_T(f) = H_R(f) = \sqrt{P(f)}$$

Each end is a **square-root raised-cosine** (SRRC) filter.

MATCHED AND FREE OF INTERFERENCE

$H_R = H_T^*$ for a real, even $\sqrt{P(f)}$, so the receive filter is matched to the pulse. The link then has both the smallest P_b and zero interference.

IMPLEMENTATION

A raised-cosine or SRRC filter is usually a finite impulse response (FIR) filter, also called a tapped-delay-line (TDL) filter. Its taps are samples of the pulse, cut off after a few T_b.

With $\alpha = 0.5$, $P(W) = T_b/2$ and $P(0) = T_b$. So $H_T(W)/H_T(0) = \sqrt{1/2} = 0.707$.

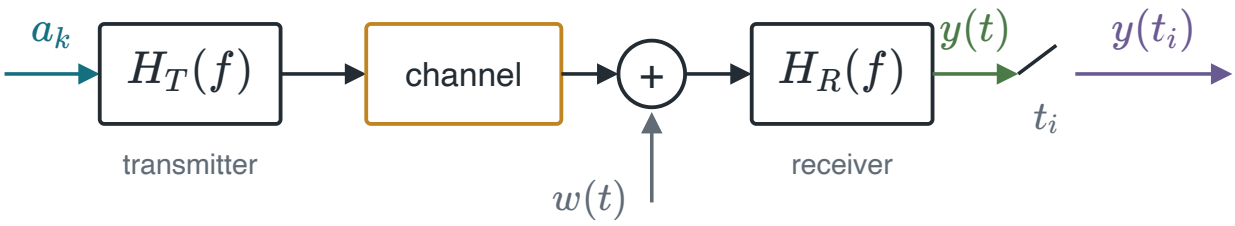


FIGURE 2.88 The link with a square-root raised-cosine filter at each end of a flat channel.

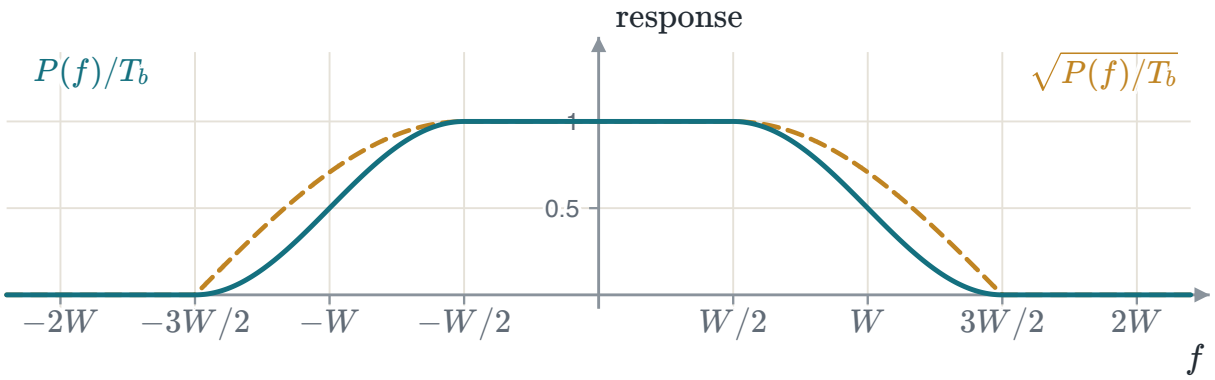


FIGURE 2.89 The raised cosine with $\alpha = 0.5$ (cyan) and its square root (amber, dashed). Two square-root filters in a row give the raised cosine.

Pulse shaping around us

Broadcast and mobile standards fix the roll-off factor and the bandwidth.

- **Satellite television.** Satellite television at $R_s = 27.5$ Mbaud with $\alpha = 0.35$ uses $B_T = 13.75(1.35) = 18.6$ MHz at baseband.
- **3G mobile.** 3G mobile sends 3.84 Mchip/s with $\alpha = 0.22$. $B_T = 1.92(1.22) = 2.34$ MHz fits inside the ± 2.5 MHz of its 5 MHz channel.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

- **The pulse.** The raised-cosine pulse of $\alpha = 0.35$ is zero at every other sampling instant, so the samples carry no interference.
- **Timing.** A sample taken ϵ late collects interference, summed here over $1 \leq |k| \leq 30$. The raised cosine with $\alpha = 0.5$ collects far less than the sinc pulse.

ROLL-OFF IN STANDARDS

Satellite television uses $\alpha = 0.35$, 0.25 or 0.20. 3G mobile uses $\alpha = 0.22$. A small α saves bandwidth.

BANDWIDTH

$B_T = \frac{R_s}{2}(1 + \alpha)$ at baseband. On a carrier the occupied band is twice that, $R_s(1 + \alpha)$.

TIMING

A small α gives long tails. A sample taken late then collects interference from many neighbours.

2.7 Summary

From bits to decisions

The whole link has four stages.

1. Send each bit as $\pm\sqrt{E_b}\,\psi(t)$.
2. The channel adds white noise of density $N_0/2$.
3. Correlate with $\psi(t)$ and read y_k at the end of the bit.
4. Decide by comparing y_k with λ_{opt}.

TWO LIMITS

Noise sets $P_b = Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$. Bandwidth sets $R_b \leq 2B_T/(1 + \alpha)$ for zero interference.

For example, a polar link at $E_b/N_0 = 9.6$ dB with equal priors has $E_b/N_0 = 10^{0.96} = 9.12$. Then $P_b = Q(\sqrt{18.2}) = Q(4.27) = 9.7 \times 10^{-6}$, about 10^{-5}.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

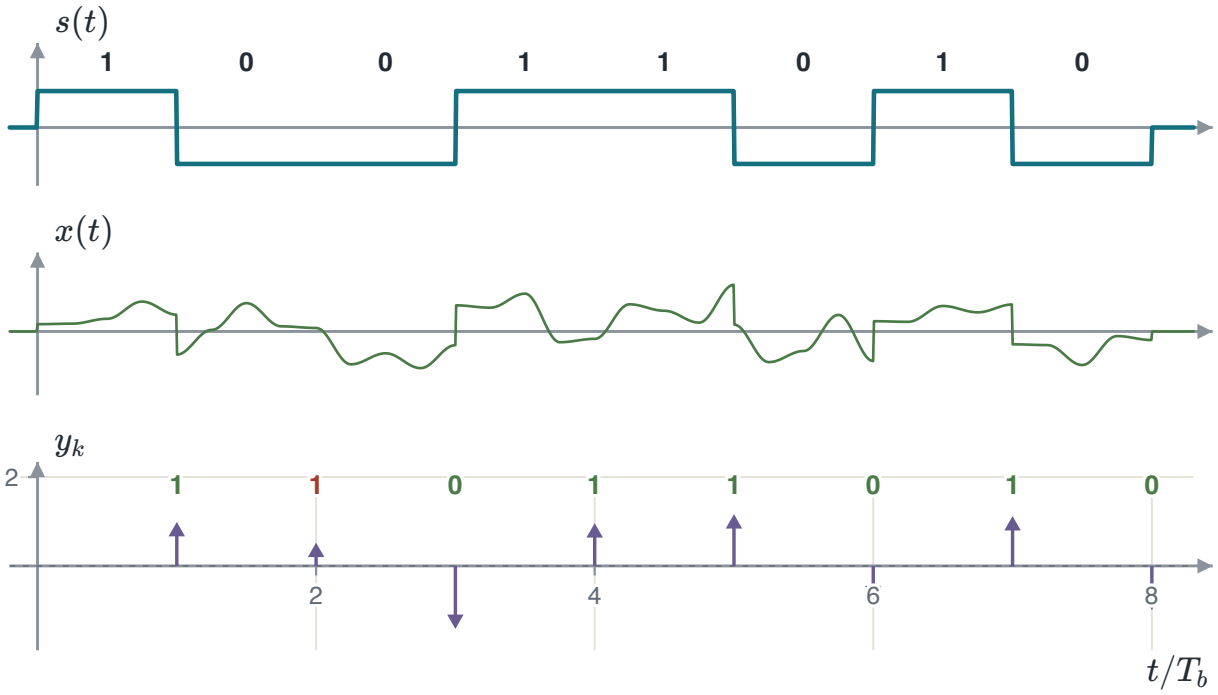


FIGURE 2.90 Eight bits through the link. Each bit becomes $\pm A$ in $s(t)$, noise is added in $x(t)$, and the correlator gives one number y_k a bit. The sign of y_k is the decision, and the second decision is wrong (red).

Quick check

Six short predictions, each with its reason.

1 **Matched filter.** The filter matched to $s(t)$ on $[0, T]$ has the impulse response $s(t)$, $s(T-t)$ or $s(t-T)$?
Answer: $s(T-t)$. Reverse the pulse in time, then shift it right by T.

2 **Peak SNR.** With $E = 2\ \mu$J and $N_0 = 10^{-7}$ W/Hz, the largest peak SNR is 20, 40 or 80?
Answer: 40, since $2E/N_0 = 2(2 \times 10^{-6})/10^{-7} = 40$.

3 **Threshold.** With equal priors, the optimal threshold is 0, $N_0/4$ or $\sqrt{E_b}$?
Answer: 0, since $\ln(p_0/p_1) = \ln 1 = 0$.

4 **Error probability.** E_b/N_0 rises from 4 to 8. P_b falls from 2.3×10^{-3} to 1.2×10^{-3}, 3.2×10^{-5} or 10^{-9}?
Answer: 3.2×10^{-5}, since $Q(\sqrt{16}) = Q(4) = 3.2 \times 10^{-5}$.

5 **Interference.** An RC channel has $BT_b = 0.25$. The worst-case total interference q is 0.208, 0.5 or 0.792?
Answer: 0.208, since $q = e^{-2\pi(0.25)} = e^{-\pi/2} = 0.208$.

6 **Bandwidth.** $R_b = 1$ Mb/s with a raised cosine of $\alpha = 0.5$ needs $B_T = 0.5$, 0.75 or 1 MHz?
Answer: 0.75 MHz, since $B_T = \frac{R_b}{2}(1+\alpha) = 0.5(1.5) = 0.75$ MHz.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Results of the chapter

Twelve questions recall the results this chapter carries forward.

TABLE 2.1 Summary of Chapter 2: baseband transmission of digital signals.

QUESTION	RESULT	ANCHOR
Which filter gives the largest peak SNR?	The matched filter $h(t) = k\,g(T-t)$, or $H(f) = k\,G^*(f)\,e^{-j2\pi fT}$, sampled at $t = T$.	PS CH8.3.2
What is that largest peak SNR?	$\eta_{\max} = 2E/N_0$. It depends on the pulse energy E, not on its shape.	PS CH8.3.2
Where do the two symbols of polar signalling sit?	At $\pm\sqrt{E_b}$ on the axis of the unit-energy $\psi(t)$, a distance $2\sqrt{E_b}$ apart.	PS CH8.2.1
When do the correlator and the matched filter agree?	At $t = T_b$, where both give $\int_0^{T_b} x(t)\,\psi(t)\,dt$, for any shape of ψ.	PS CH8.3.1
What noise is left in the demodulator output?	$y = s_m + n$, with n Gaussian of mean 0 and variance $N_0/2$.	PS CH8.3.1
Where does the optimal threshold go?	$\lambda_{\text{opt}} = \frac{N_0}{4\sqrt{E_b}} \ln \frac{p_0}{p_1}$, at 0 for equal priors and toward the less likely symbol otherwise.	PS CH8.3.3
What is $Q(x)$?	The Gaussian tail $Q(x)$, the chance that a unit Gaussian exceeds x.	PS CH8.3.3
What is P_b for polar signalling?	$P_b = Q\big(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\big)$ with equal priors and a matched filter.	PS CH8.3.3
How much interference does an RC channel add?	A bit m bits back adds $(1-q)q^m$, with $q = e^{-2\pi BT_b}$. The worst case totals q.	PS CH10.1.1
When does the eye close?	For the Gaussian channel the opening is $2(1-4q)$, with $q = Q(\pi BT_b/\sqrt{\ln 2})$. It closes at $BT_b = 0.179$, and errors then occur without noise.	—
What is Nyquist's criterion?	$p(kT_b) = \delta[k]$ exactly when $\sum_n P(f - nR_b) = T_b$. It needs $B_T \geq R_b/2$.	PS CH10.3.1
What bandwidth does a raised cosine need?	$B_T = \frac{R_b}{2}(1+\alpha)$. The tails fall as $1/\lvert t\rvert^3$ for $\alpha > 0$.	PS CH10.3.1

Match the filter to the pulse and read it at the end of the bit. Place the threshold from the priors. Check B_T against $R_b/2$ before choosing a pulse. Chapter 3 extends these steps to more than two waveforms.

Projects to try

Four optional projects use the chapter on simulated links. Each gives an aim, what it practises, a few steps and what to look for.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

ⓘ MEASURE A BIT ERROR RATE

Simulate a polar link and compare the measured error rate with $Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$.
Practises: the correlator receiver and its decision statistic. Setting the noise variance from E_b/N_0. How many bits a reliable estimate of P_b needs.

1. Draw 10^6 random bits and map them to ± 1.
2. Add Gaussian noise of variance $N_0/2$ for E_b/N_0 from 0 to 10 dB.
3. Decide by the sign of each value and count the errors.
4. Plot the measured P_b on a logarithmic axis with the Q curve over it.

Look for: the points lie on the curve until the error count gets small. There they scatter, because too few errors were seen.

ⓘ FIND AN ECHO IN NOISE

Hide a known pulse in strong noise and find its delay with a matched filter.
Practises: correlation with a template. Why a long pulse with a wide bandwidth gives a sharp peak. Reading a delay from the peak position.

1. Make a chirp of 1000 samples that sweeps a wide band.
2. Place it at an unknown delay inside $10\,000$ samples of noise that hides it.
3. Correlate the record with the chirp and find the largest peak.
4. Repeat with a plain rectangular pulse of the same energy.

Look for: the chirp gives one narrow peak at the true delay. The rectangle gives a broad triangle whose top is hard to place in noise.

ⓘ DRAW THE EYE OF A CABLE

Send random bits through a lowpass channel and watch the eye close as the bandwidth falls.
Practises: intersymbol interference from a bandlimited channel. The eye diagram as an overlay of short pieces. The link between eye opening and error rate.

1. Build an RC lowpass with time constant $\tau = 1/(2\pi B)$.
2. Pass 2000 random polar bits through it at $BT_b = 0.5$, 0.25 and 0.12.
3. Cut the output into pieces $2T_b$ long around each sample and plot them together.
4. Add a little noise and count the errors at each bandwidth.

Look for: the eye narrows as BT_b falls and is nearly shut near 0.11. The error count jumps once the eye closes.

ⓘ SHAPE PULSES WITH A RAISED COSINE

Compare the sinc pulse with raised-cosine pulses in bandwidth and in sensitivity to timing.
Practises: the raised-cosine pulse and its roll-off α. The spectrum of a pulse train. Why a small α needs a precise clock.

1. Build raised-cosine pulses with $\alpha = 0$, 0.25 and 0.5, truncated to $\pm 8T_b$.
2. Send random polar bits with each and plot the spectrum of the result.
3. Sample the received train slightly late, by $0.05T_b$ to $0.3T_b$.
4. Plot the eye for each α at each timing error.

Look for: a larger α widens the spectrum. It also keeps the eye open for a larger timing error.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CHAPTER

3

Geometric representation of signal waveforms

Each waveform of a signal set becomes a point. Energies, distances and the receiver are then read off a picture.

The chapter has two results. First, an orthonormal basis turns each waveform into N numbers. Energy is squared length, and the energy of a difference is squared distance.

Second, Gram–Schmidt finds a basis for any set, with $N \leq M$. Sets with the same constellation need the same receiver.

3.1 Signals as vectors

Vectors and space

A vector written against the unit axes $\mathbf{e}_1$ and $\mathbf{e}_2$ is the list (a_1, a_2). Its length and its angle to another vector come from that list.

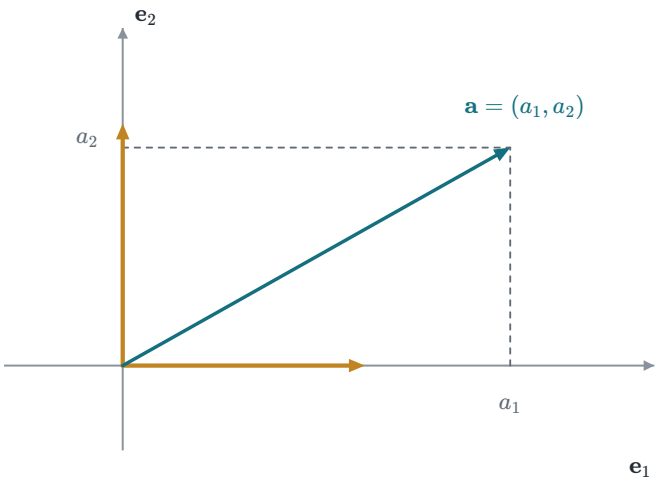


FIGURE 3.1 A vector written against the unit axes $\mathbf{e}_1$ and $\mathbf{e}_2$ is the list (a_1, a_2). Its length and its angle to another vector come from that list.

In N dimensions the unit vectors $\mathbf{e}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{e}_N$ are the axes. N is the smallest number of vectors that builds every vector of the space.

A VECTOR IN N DIMENSIONS

$$\mathbf{a} = \sum_{i=1}^{N} a_i \, \mathbf{e}_i = (a_1, a_2, \ldots, a_N)$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The inner product multiplies matching entries and adds them.

INNER PRODUCT

$$\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b} = \langle \mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b} \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^{N} a_i b_i$$

The norm is the length of the vector. It is the root of the inner product of the vector with itself.

NORM

$$\|\mathbf{a}\| = \sqrt{\langle \mathbf{a}, \mathbf{a} \rangle} = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^{N} a_i^2}$$

$\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ are **orthogonal** when $\langle \mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b} \rangle = 0$. In the plane they meet at 90°.

An orthonormal basis

A set of vectors is **orthonormal** when each pair is orthogonal and each vector has unit norm: $\mathbf{e}_i \cdot \mathbf{e}_j = 0$ for $i \neq j$, and $\|\mathbf{e}_i\| = 1$.

For signals the sum becomes an integral.

SIGNALS

$$\langle x, y \rangle = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(t)\, y(t)\, dt, \qquad \|x\|^2 = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x^2(t)\, dt = E_x$$

The squared length of a signal is its energy.

A set of functions is **orthogonal** when two different functions of the set have inner product 0. The angle between them is 90°.

ORTHOGONAL SET

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \psi_j(t)\, \psi_k(t)\, dt = \begin{cases} c_j, & j = k \\ 0, & j \neq k \end{cases}$$

If every $c_j = 1$, the set $\{\psi_1, \ldots, \psi_N\}$ is **orthonormal**. Each function then has unit energy, $\int \psi_k^2(t)\, dt = 1$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

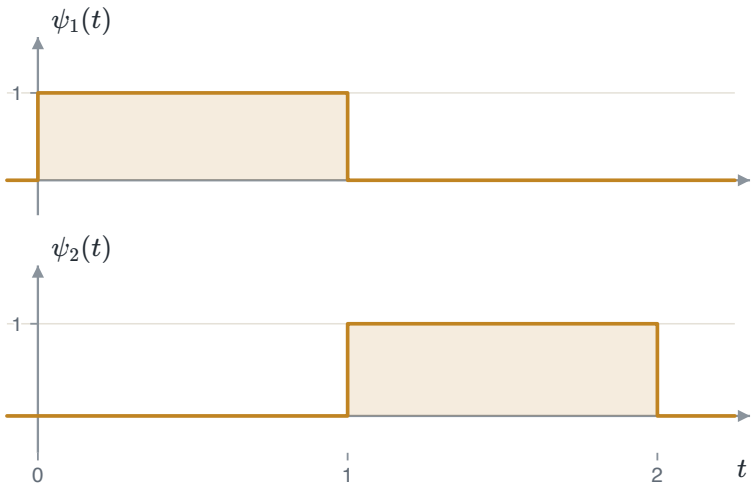


FIGURE 3.2 The unit pulses ψ_1 on $[0, 1)$ and ψ_2 on $[1, 2)$. Each has energy 1. They never overlap, so $\int \psi_1(t)\psi_2(t)\,dt = 0$.

The coordinates of a waveform

One integral for each axis takes the waveform apart into N numbers. x_k is the **projection** of $x(t)$ on $\psi_k(t)$.

PROJECTION

$$x_k = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(t)\,\psi_k(t)\,dt, \qquad k = 1, \ldots, N$$

The N numbers build the waveform back. This step is called **synthesis**.

SYNTHESIS

$$x(t) = \sum_{k=1}^{N} x_k\,\psi_k(t), \qquad \mathbf{x} = (x_1, x_2, \ldots, x_N)$$

The list $\mathbf{x}$ is the vector of $x(t)$.

The figure shows synthesis on two unit pulses. The waveform $x_1\psi_1(t) + x_2\psi_2(t)$ and the point (x_1, x_2) change together.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

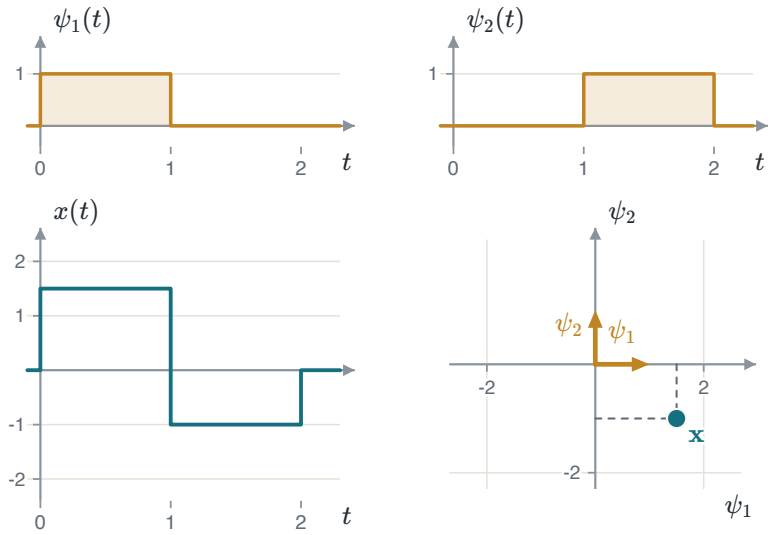


FIGURE 3.3 The waveform $x_1\psi_1(t) + x_2\psi_2(t)$ and the point (x_1, x_2), drawn for $x_1 = 1.5$ and $x_2 = -1$. The basis pulses ψ_1 and ψ_2 are drawn above, and in the plane as the two unit arrows.

For example, take $\psi_1 = 1$ on $[0, 1)$ and $\psi_2 = 1$ on $[1, 2)$. Let $x(t) = 3$ on $[0, 1)$ and -1 on $[1, 2)$. Each coordinate is one projection integral.

THE COORDINATES OF ONE WAVEFORM

$$x_1 = \int_0^1 3 \cdot 1 \, dt = 3$$
$$x_2 = \int_1^2 (-1) \cdot 1 \, dt = -1$$

So $\mathbf{x} = (3, -1)$.

Inner products are preserved

An integral over two waveforms equals a sum over N pairs of coordinates.

KEY RESULT: INNER PRODUCTS

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(t)\, y(t)\, dt = \sum_{k=1}^{N} x_k y_k = \langle \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y} \rangle$$

The proof writes both waveforms on the basis, moves the integral inside both sums and then uses orthonormality.

PROOF

$$\begin{aligned}\int x(t)\, y(t)\, dt &= \int \Big(\sum_{k=1}^{N} x_k \psi_k(t)\Big)\Big(\sum_{j=1}^{N} y_j \psi_j(t)\Big) dt \\ &= \sum_{k=1}^{N}\sum_{j=1}^{N} x_k y_j \int \psi_k(t)\, \psi_j(t)\, dt \\ &= \sum_{k=1}^{N} x_k y_k\end{aligned}$$

The last integral is 1 for $j = k$ and 0 otherwise. Only the terms with $j = k$ are left.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

For example, take $x = 2\psi_1 + \psi_2$ and $y = \psi_1 - \psi_2$ on the two unit pulses. So $\mathbf{x} = (2, 1)$ and $\mathbf{y} = (1, -1)$. The product $x(t)\,y(t)$ is 2 on $[0, 1)$ and -1 on $[1, 2)$.

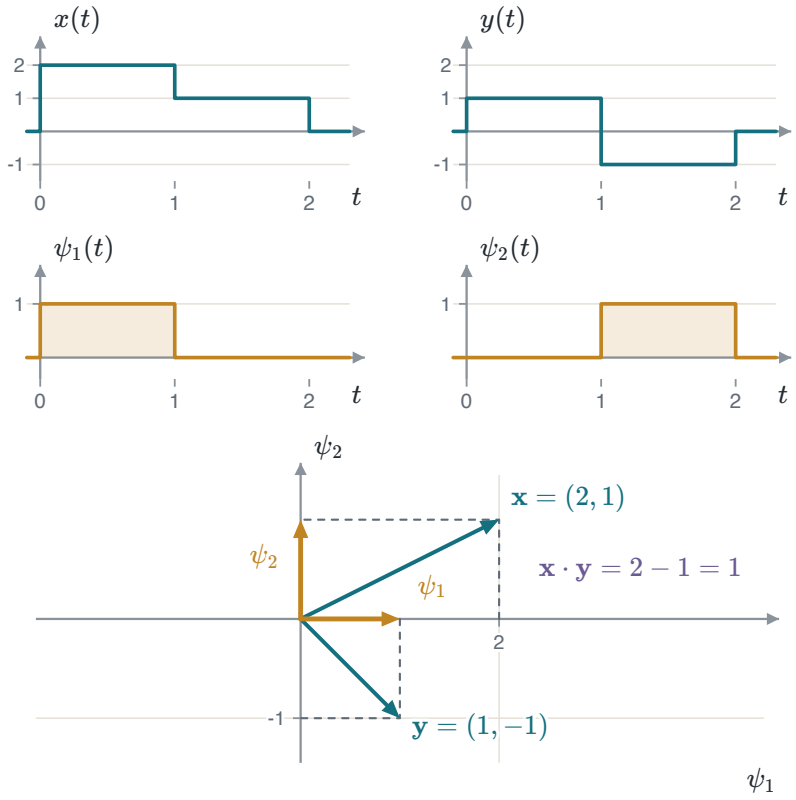


FIGURE 3.4 $x = 2\psi_1 + \psi_2$ and $y = \psi_1 - \psi_2$, the unit pulses ψ_1 and ψ_2 they are built from, and the same signals as vectors. In the plane the pulses are the unit arrows.

THE SIGNED AREA AND THE COORDINATES AGREE

$$\int_0^2 x(t)\,y(t)\,dt = 2 - 1 = 1, \qquad x_1y_1 + x_2y_2 = 2(1) + 1(-1) = 1$$

Basis functions for a signal set

Take a set of M waveforms $s_i(t)$ of finite energy. All of them can be written on one set of N orthonormal basis functions, with $N \le M$.

SIGNAL SET

$$s_i(t) = \sum_{j=1}^{N} s_{ij}\,\psi_j(t), \qquad i = 1, \dots, M, \quad 0 \le t \le T$$

Each coefficient is a projection, so each waveform becomes a point.

COORDINATES

$$s_{ij} = \int_0^T s_i(t)\,\psi_j(t)\,dt, \qquad \mathbf{s}_i = (s_{i1}, \dots, s_{iN})$$

The list $\mathbf{s}_i$ is the **signal vector**.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The **synthesizer** builds the waveform from its coordinates. It scales each $\psi_j(t)$ by s_{ij} and adds the N products.

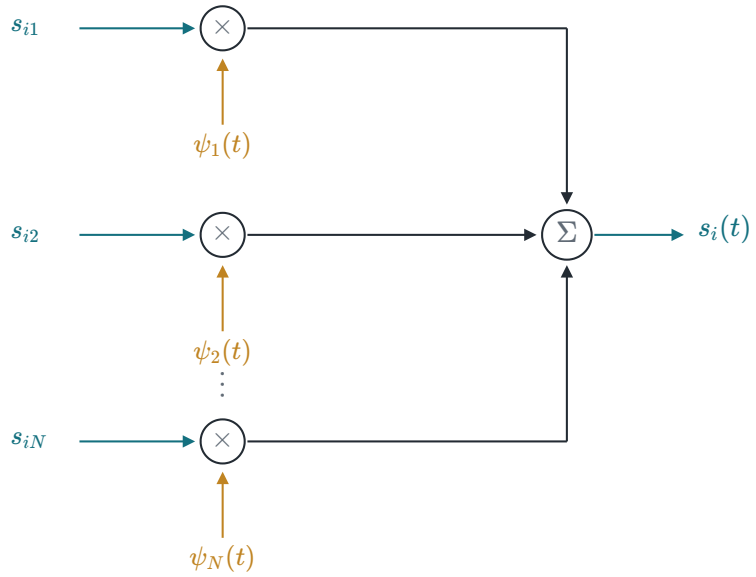


FIGURE 3.5 The synthesizer: each coordinate s_{ij} scales its basis function, and the products are added to give $s_i(t)$.

The **analyzer** runs the other way. It multiplies the waveform by each $\psi_j(t)$ and integrates over $[0, T]$, so it is a bank of correlators, one for each basis function.

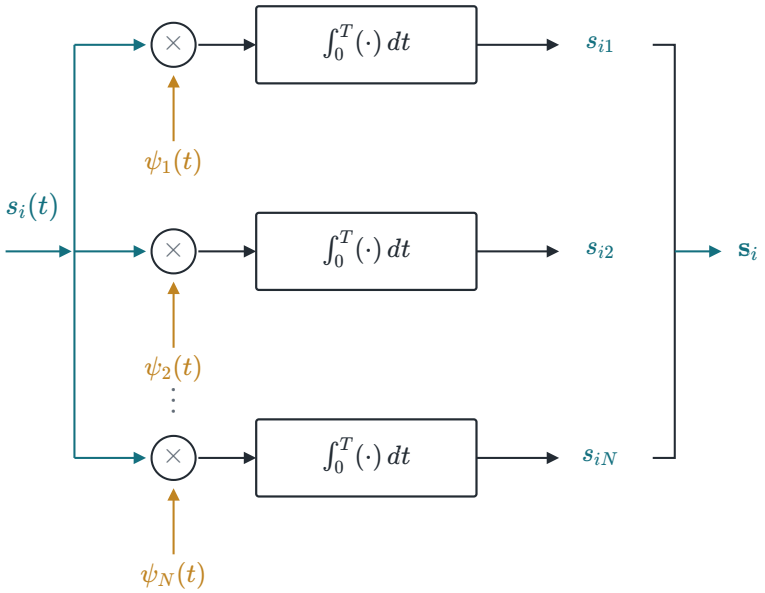


FIGURE 3.6 The analyzer: one correlator for each basis function. Its N outputs are the coordinates, and together they form the signal vector $\mathbf{s}_i$.

The receiver of Chapter 4 is this bank of correlators.

Energy and distance

Put $y = x$ in the key result. Energy is the squared distance from the point to the origin.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

ENERGY

$$E_i = \int_0^T s_i^2(t)\,dt = \sum_{j=1}^{N} s_{ij}^2 = \|\mathbf{s}_i\|^2$$

Apply the key result to the difference $s_i - s_k$, whose vector is $\mathbf{s}_i - \mathbf{s}_k$.

DISTANCE

$$d_{ik}^2 = \|\mathbf{s}_i - \mathbf{s}_k\|^2 = \int_0^T \big(s_i(t) - s_k(t)\big)^2 dt$$

In the figure, $\mathbf{s}_1$ and $\mathbf{s}_2$ stay on the circle of radius $\sqrt{2}$. So both energies stay 2, and only their distance d changes with the angle between them.

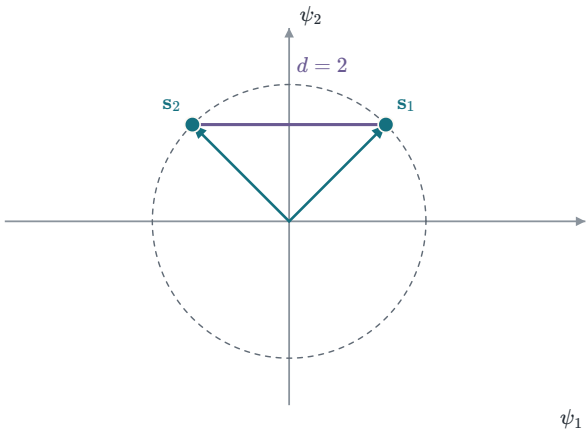


FIGURE 3.7 $\mathbf{s}_1$ and $\mathbf{s}_2$ on the circle of radius $\sqrt{2}$, drawn with the angle between them at $90°$. Both energies are 2. Only their distance d changes with the angle.

⚠ DISTANCE, NOT ENERGY

Noise moves the received point. Two points far apart are hard to confuse, so d decides the error rate. Chapter 4 derives the rule.

For example, $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$ and $\mathbf{s}_2 = (1, -1)$ give $\mathbf{s}_1 - \mathbf{s}_2 = (0, 2)$. So $d_{12} = \sqrt{0^2 + 2^2} = 2$. Its square, 4, is the energy of $s_1 - s_2$.

Example 3.1 finds a basis for four signals by reading their pieces. The figure shows the four signals and their points.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

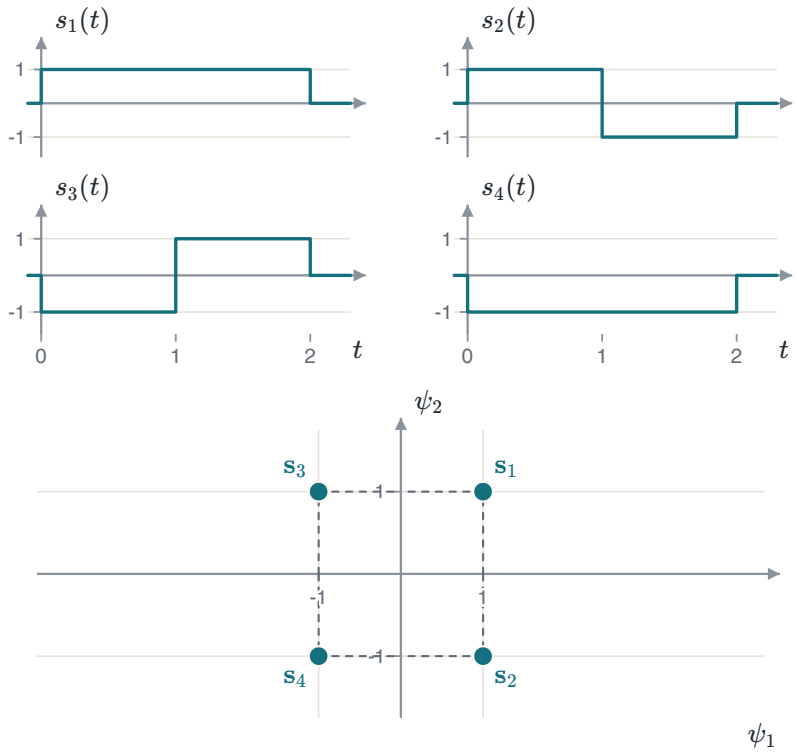


FIGURE 3.8 The four signals of Example 3.1, each constant on $[0, 1)$ and on $[1, 2)$, and their four points.

EXAMPLE 3.1 — A BASIS BY INSPECTION

GIVEN Four signals, each ± 1 on $[0, 1)$ and on $[1, 2)$, giving all four sign pairs.

FIND A basis and the four vectors. How many basis functions?

METHOD Every signal is built from a pulse on $[0, 1)$ and a pulse on $[1, 2)$, so two basis functions are enough. Read off the pieces, then check unit energy and orthogonality.

SOLUTION Take $\psi_1(t) = 1$ for $0 \le t < 1$ and $\psi_2(t) = 1$ for $1 \le t < 2$. Then $\int \psi_1^2(t)\,dt = \int \psi_2^2(t)\,dt = 1$. Also $\int \psi_1(t)\psi_2(t)\,dt = 0$, because the pulses never overlap. Each coordinate is the height on that half times its width 1. So $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$, $\mathbf{s}_2 = (1, -1)$, $\mathbf{s}_3 = (-1, 1)$ and $\mathbf{s}_4 = (-1, -1)$, with $N = 2$.

CHECK The four points form a square. Each energy is $1^2 + 1^2 = 2$ from the vectors, and $\int_0^2 (\pm 1)^2\,dt = 2$ from the waveforms.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $\psi_1 = s_1/\sqrt{E_1}$ as an axis, not s_1 itself. Here $E_1 = 2$, so an unscaled axis puts every coordinate a factor $\sqrt{2}$ off.

Orthogonal signals around us

Four everyday systems use orthogonal signal sets.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

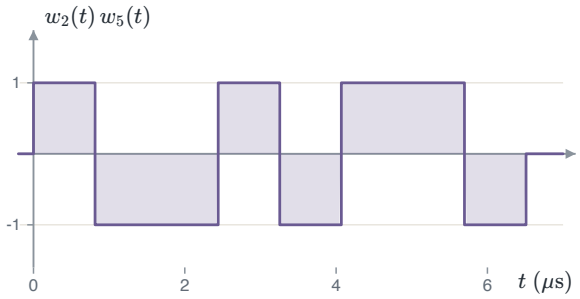


FIGURE 3.9 IS-95 phones share one band, each call with its own Walsh code at 1.2288 Mchip/s. Two codes multiply to $+1$ on four chips and -1 on four, so $\sum_n w_2[n]\,w_5[n] = 0$.

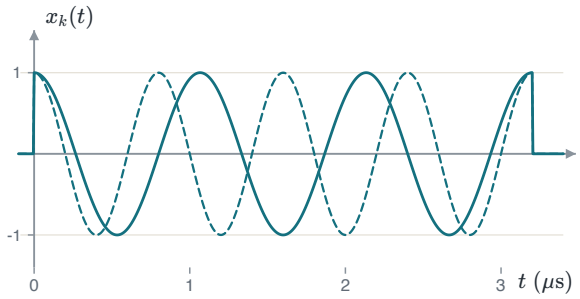


FIGURE 3.10 Wi-Fi spaces its subcarriers $\Delta f = 312.5$ kHz apart. Over one symbol of $T = 1/\Delta f = 3.2$ μs, $\cos(2\pi k \Delta f t)$ for $k = 3$ and $k = 4$ are orthogonal.

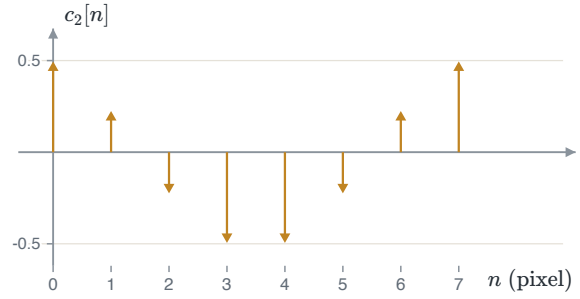


FIGURE 3.11 JPEG writes each row of 8 pixels against the DCT basis $c_k[n] = \frac{1}{2}\cos\big(\pi(2n+1)k/16\big)$, $k \geq 1$. Here $k = 2$. The basis is orthonormal, so a row's energy is the sum of its squared coefficients.

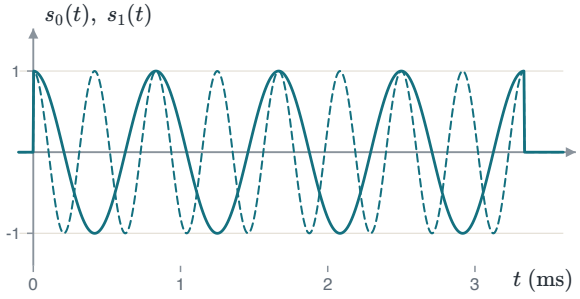


FIGURE 3.12 The Kansas City standard stored bits on cassette tape at 300 baud: 4 cycles of 1200 Hz for a 0, 8 cycles of 2400 Hz for a 1. Whole cycles in $T = 3.33$ ms make the tones orthogonal.

Each system picks signals whose inner product is zero. A correlator matched to one of them gives zero for all the others.

Two sinusoids are orthogonal over T when each fits a whole number of cycles in T and the numbers differ.

> ⚠ THE INTERVAL
>
> Orthogonality holds over the exact interval. A receiver that integrates over a shifted window lets the signals leak into each other.

3.2 Constellations

The constellation diagram

The **constellation diagram** is the signal vectors drawn in the space of their basis. It has one point for each waveform and one axis for each basis function.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

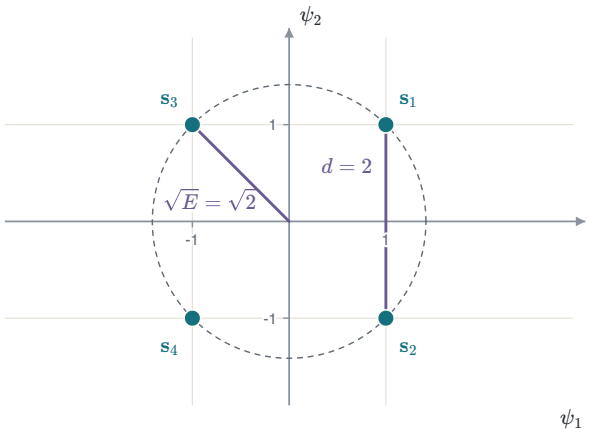


FIGURE 3.13 The four signals of Example 3.1 as a constellation, with an energy read as a radius and a distance between two points.

Three things are read off the constellation.

1. Distance to the origin: $\sqrt{E_i}$.
2. Distance between two points: the root of the energy of their difference.
3. Number of axes: the correlators the receiver needs.

For example, take the four points at $(\pm 1, \pm 1)$. Neighbours such as $(1, 1)$ and $(1, -1)$ differ by 2 in one coordinate, so $d_{\min} = 2$. The diagonal pairs are $2\sqrt{2} = 2.83$ apart.

Three binary signal sets as points

Two classic binary sets are compared by the distance between their two points. Each has average energy per bit E_b.

Antipodal signals satisfy $s_2 = -s_1$. They need one axis, and $d = 2\sqrt{E_b}$. Polar NRZ and BPSK are antipodal.

Orthogonal signals satisfy $\langle s_1, s_2 \rangle = 0$. They need two axes, and $d = \sqrt{2E_b}$. PPM and FSK are orthogonal.

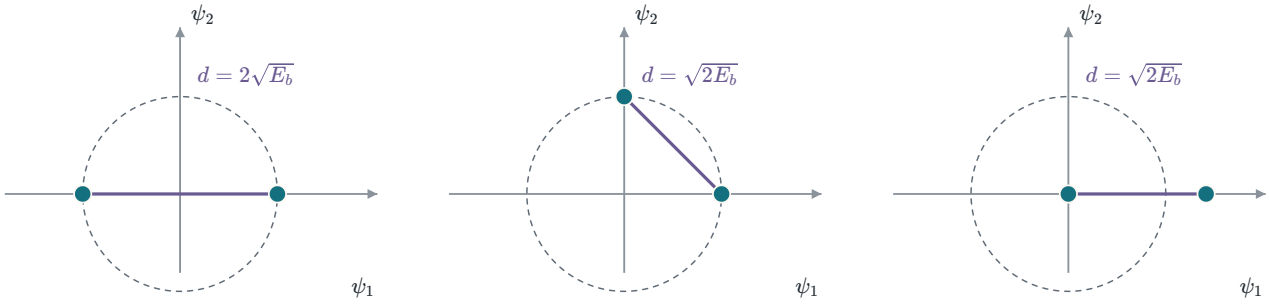


FIGURE 3.14 Three binary sets, each with average energy E_b, in units of $\sqrt{E_b}$: antipodal on the left, orthogonal in the middle and on-off on the right.

Find the energy each set needs for the same distance d. Square the two distance formulas and set them equal.

ENERGY FOR EQUAL DISTANCE

$$4E_b^{\text{anti}} = d^2 = 2E_b^{\text{orth}}$$

$$\frac{E_b^{\text{orth}}}{E_b^{\text{anti}}} = 2 = 3.01 \text{ dB}$$

Orthogonal signalling needs twice the energy for the same distance.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

On-off keying sends 0 or $s(t)$ with equal priors and average energy E_b. The average is E_b, so $s(t)$ has energy $2E_b$. The points are 0 and $\sqrt{2E_b}$, so $d = \sqrt{2E_b}$.

A cosine and a sine as axes

A cosine and a sine of the same carrier form an orthonormal pair.

THE TWO AXES

$$\psi_1(t) = \sqrt{\tfrac{2}{T}}\cos(2\pi f_c t), \qquad \psi_2(t) = \sqrt{\tfrac{2}{T}}\sin(2\pi f_c t), \qquad 0 \le t \le T$$

$f_c T$ is a whole number, so each function holds whole cycles in $[0, T]$.

The factor $\sqrt{2/T}$ gives each axis unit energy. Use $2\cos^2 a = 1 + \cos 2a$, then integrate term by term.

UNIT ENERGY

$$\begin{aligned}\int_0^T \psi_1^2(t)\,dt &= \frac{2}{T}\int_0^T \cos^2(2\pi f_c t)\,dt \\ &= \frac{1}{T}\int_0^T \left[1 + \cos(4\pi f_c t)\right] dt \\ &= 1 + \frac{\sin(4\pi f_c T)}{4\pi f_c T} = 1\end{aligned}$$

The sine is zero because $4\pi f_c T$ is a whole multiple of 2π. The same steps with $2\sin^2 a = 1 - \cos 2a$ give unit energy for ψ_2.

The two axes are orthogonal. Use $2\cos a \sin a = \sin 2a$.

ORTHOGONAL

$$\begin{aligned}\int_0^T \psi_1(t)\psi_2(t)\,dt &= \frac{2}{T}\int_0^T \cos(2\pi f_c t)\sin(2\pi f_c t)\,dt \\ &= \frac{1}{T}\int_0^T \sin(4\pi f_c t)\,dt \\ &= \frac{1 - \cos(4\pi f_c T)}{4\pi f_c T} = 0\end{aligned}$$

The product holds $2f_c T$ whole cycles, and $\cos(4\pi f_c T) = 1$.

The waveform $\sqrt{2E/T}\cos(2\pi f_c t - \theta)$ sits at $(\sqrt{E}\cos\theta, \sqrt{E}\sin\theta)$. Expand the cosine of a difference to see it.

A CARRIER WITH PHASE θ

$$\begin{aligned}s(t) &= \sqrt{\tfrac{2E}{T}}\cos(2\pi f_c t - \theta) \\ &= \sqrt{\tfrac{2E}{T}}\left[\cos\theta\cos(2\pi f_c t) + \sin\theta\sin(2\pi f_c t)\right] \\ &= \sqrt{E}\cos\theta\,\psi_1(t) + \sqrt{E}\sin\theta\,\psi_2(t)\end{aligned}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

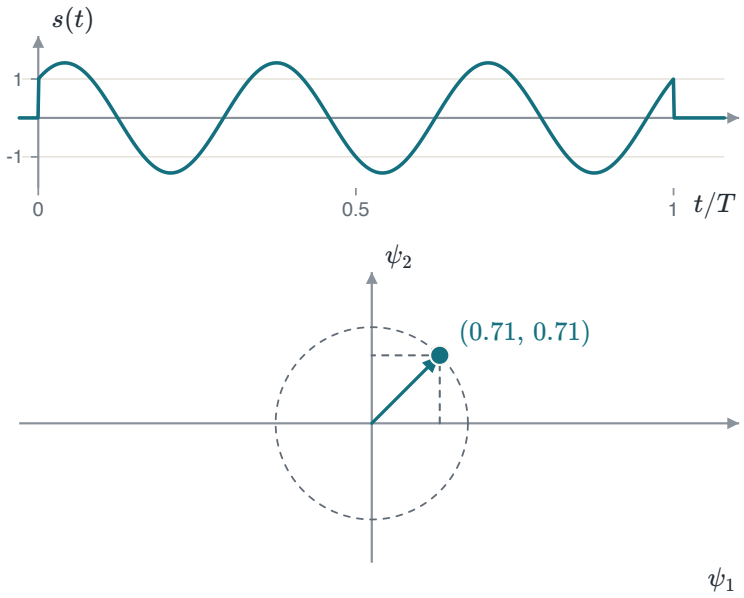


FIGURE 3.15 The waveform $\sqrt{2E/T}\cos(2\pi f_c t-\theta)$ and its point $(\sqrt{E}\cos\theta,\sqrt{E}\sin\theta)$, drawn for $\theta=45^\circ$, $E=1$ and $f_cT=3$.

For example, take $\theta=90^\circ$. Since $\cos(x-90^\circ)=\sin x$, $s(t)=\sqrt{E}\,\psi_2(t)$. Its point is $(0,\sqrt{E})$.

Example 3.2 finds the basis and the constellation of four carrier waveforms, and compares it with the pulse set of Example 3.1.

EXAMPLE 3.2 – FOUR CARRIER WAVEFORMS

GIVEN For $0\le t\le T$ and whole f_cT: $s_{1,2}(t)=\mp\sqrt{2/T}\cos(2\pi f_c t)+\sqrt{2/T}\sin(2\pi f_c t)$ and $s_{3,4}(t)=\mp\sqrt{2/T}\cos(2\pi f_c t)-\sqrt{2/T}\sin(2\pi f_c t)$.

FIND The basis, the four points and the energy of each.

METHOD By inspection, every waveform is a sum of two functions.

$$\psi_1(t)=\sqrt{\tfrac{2}{T}}\cos(2\pi f_c t),\qquad \psi_2(t)=\sqrt{\tfrac{2}{T}}\sin(2\pi f_c t),\qquad 0\le t\le T$$

Show that they are orthonormal. The coefficients are then the coordinates.

SOLUTION First the two functions are orthogonal. Use $\sin A\cos B=\tfrac12[\sin(A+B)+\sin(A-B)]$ with $A=B$, then integrate.

$$\begin{aligned}\int_0^T \psi_1(t)\psi_2(t)\,dt &= \frac{2}{T}\int_0^T \cos(2\pi f_c t)\sin(2\pi f_c t)\,dt\\ &= \frac{1}{T}\int_0^T \big[\sin(4\pi f_c t)+\sin 0\big]\,dt\\ &= \frac{1}{T}\Big[-\frac{\cos(4\pi f_c t)}{4\pi f_c}\Big]_0^T\\ &= -\frac{\cos(4\pi f_c T)-\cos 0}{4\pi f_c T}=-\frac{1-1}{4\pi f_c T}=0\end{aligned}$$

Since $2f_cT$ is whole, $\cos(4\pi f_cT)=1$. Next each has unit energy. Use $\cos^2 x=\tfrac12+\tfrac12\cos 2x$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

$$\begin{aligned}\int_0^T \psi_1^2(t)\,dt &= \frac{2}{T}\int_0^T \cos^2(2\pi f_c t)\,dt \\ &= \frac{2}{T}\int_0^T \left[\frac{1}{2}+\frac{1}{2}\cos(4\pi f_c t)\right]dt \\ &= \frac{1}{T}\,T + \frac{1}{T}\left[\frac{\sin(4\pi f_c t)}{4\pi f_c}\right]_0^T \\ &= 1+\frac{\sin(4\pi f_c T)-\sin 0}{4\pi f_c T} = 1+0=1\end{aligned}$$

For ψ_2 use $\sin^2 x = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2}\cos 2x$. The same steps give $1 - 0 = 1$, so the basis is orthonormal. The coordinates are the coefficients: $\mathbf{s}_1 = (-1, 1)$, $\mathbf{s}_2 = (1, 1)$, $\mathbf{s}_3 = (-1, -1)$ and $\mathbf{s}_4 = (1, -1)$. The points form a square. Each energy is $1 + 1 = 2$, and $d_{\min} = 2$.

CHECK

This is the square of the four pulse signals of Example 3.1. The waveforms differ, and the picture is the same. Common error: drop the factor $\sqrt{2/T}$. Then $\int_0^T \cos^2(2\pi f_c t)\,dt = T/2$, not 1.

Geometric equivalence of signal sets

Different waveform sets can have the same constellation. They are called **geometrically equivalent**. They then need the same receiver and have the same error probability in white Gaussian noise.

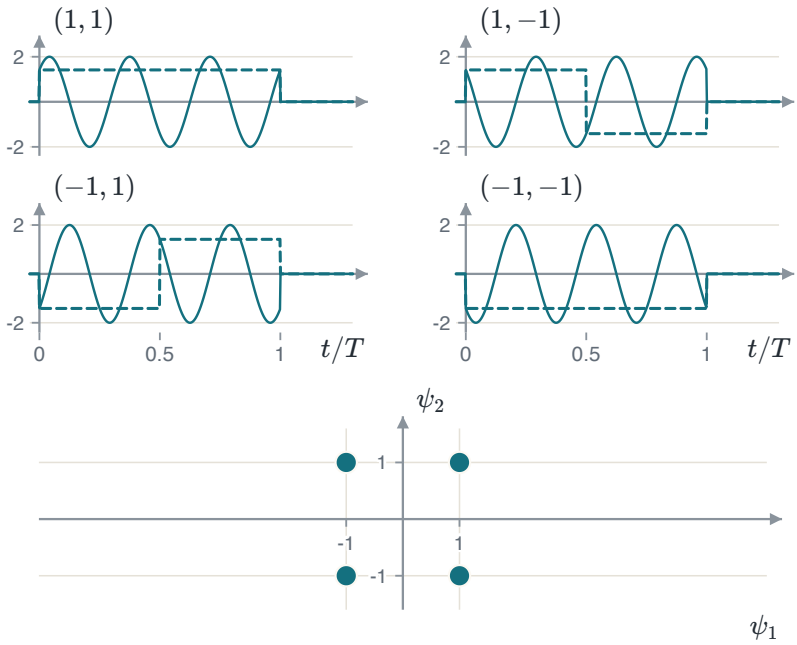


FIGURE 3.16 The pulse set and the carrier set. Each panel keeps its vector: its pair of pulses is dashed and its carrier waveform is solid. The constellation below is the same for both.

> ⚠ BANDWIDTH
>
> The constellation does not fix the bandwidth. The pulse set occupies frequencies near $f = 0$, and the carrier set occupies frequencies near f_c.

So two sets with the same constellation can differ in bandwidth. Error probability and receiver follow from the points. Bandwidth follows from the waveform shapes.

Points on a circle

M equal-energy carrier waveforms at equally spaced phases form the signal set below.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

THE SIGNAL SET

$$s_i(t) = A\cos\!\left(2\pi f_c t - \tfrac{2\pi i}{M}\right), \quad i = 0, \dots, M-1$$
$$\mathbf{s}_i = \sqrt{E}\left(\cos\tfrac{2\pi i}{M},\ \sin\tfrac{2\pi i}{M}\right), \quad E = \tfrac{A^2 T}{2}$$

Every waveform has the same energy, so every point lies on one circle. The second line is the carrier result above with $\theta = 2\pi i/M$ and $A = \sqrt{2E/T}$.

Two neighbours are $2\pi/M$ apart in angle. The chord of that angle on a circle of radius $\sqrt{E}$ is $d_{\min}$. To find it, square the length of $\mathbf{s}_0 - \mathbf{s}_1$ and use $1 - \cos 2a = 2\sin^2 a$.

NEAREST NEIGHBOURS

$$\begin{aligned} d_{\min}^2 &= E\left[\left(1 - \cos\tfrac{2\pi}{M}\right)^2 + \sin^2\tfrac{2\pi}{M}\right] \\ &= E\left[2 - 2\cos\tfrac{2\pi}{M}\right] \\ &= 4E\sin^2\tfrac{\pi}{M} \end{aligned}$$

$$d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E}\,\sin\frac{\pi}{M}$$

The middle step uses $\cos^2 a + \sin^2 a = 1$.

All M points share the circle of radius $\sqrt{E}$. Each doubling of M brings neighbours closer.

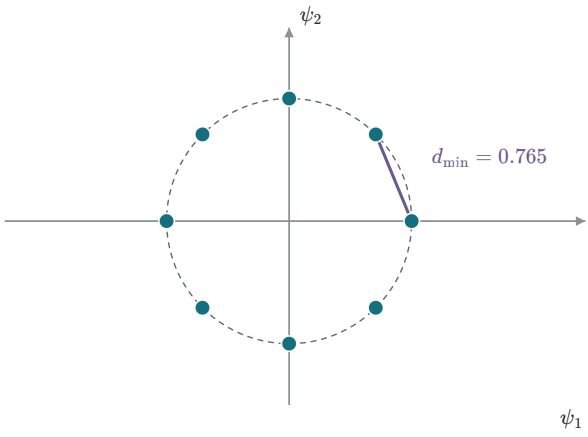


FIGURE 3.17 $M = 8$ points on the circle of radius $\sqrt{E}$, here $E = 1$, and the nearest pair.

For example, 8-PSK with $E = 1$ gives $d_{\min} = 2\sin(\pi/8) = 2(0.383) = 0.765$.

Constellations around us

Four real systems, each drawn at average energy 1.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

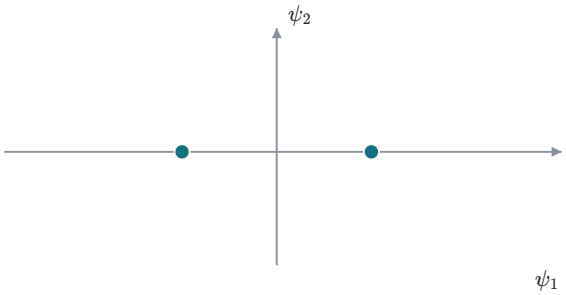


FIGURE 3.18 GPS satellites send their C/A code with BPSK on 1575.42 MHz. Two points, 1 bit a symbol, $d = 2\sqrt{E}$.

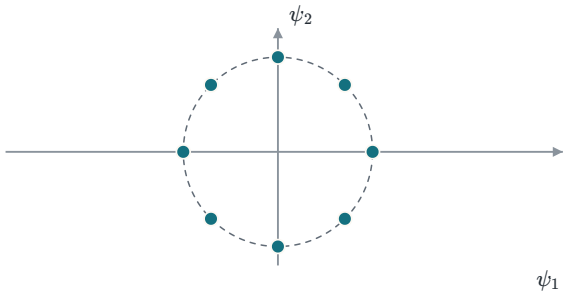


FIGURE 3.19 Satellite television (DVB-S2) can use 8PSK: 3 bits a symbol on one circle, with $d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E}\sin(\pi/8) = 0.765\sqrt{E}$.

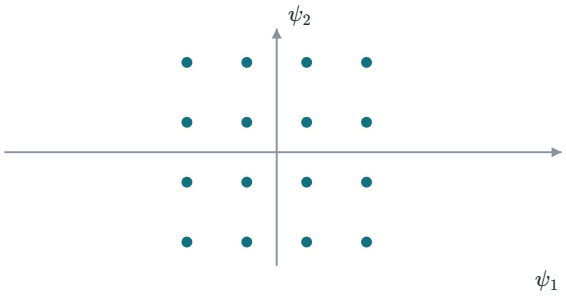


FIGURE 3.20 Wi-Fi at 36 Mb/s uses 16-QAM, 4 bits a symbol. Scaled to $E_{\text{avg}} = 1$, the grid step is $d_{\min} = 2/\sqrt{10} = 0.632$.

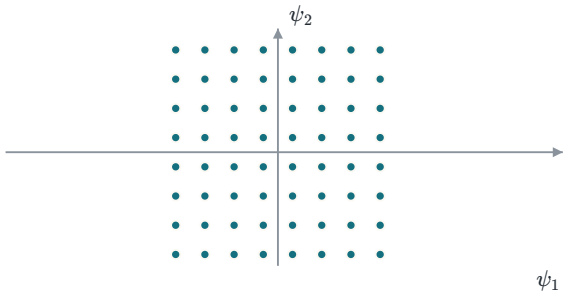


FIGURE 3.21 At 54 Mb/s Wi-Fi uses 64-QAM, 6 bits a symbol. With $E_{\text{avg}} = 1$, $d_{\min} = 2/\sqrt{42} = 0.309$.

M points carry $\log_2 M$ bits a symbol. Each doubling of M adds one bit.

All four are drawn with $E_{\text{avg}} = 1$. More points in the same energy must sit closer together.

> ⚠ SMALLER DISTANCE
>
> $d_{\min}$ falls from 2 for BPSK to 0.309 for 64-QAM. Closer points need a cleaner channel.

3.3 The Gram–Schmidt procedure

The Gram–Schmidt steps

The **Gram–Schmidt procedure** finds an orthonormal basis for any set of signals. The first axis is the first signal scaled to unit energy.

STEP 1

$$E_1 = \int s_1^2(t)\,dt, \qquad \psi_1(t) = \frac{s_1(t)}{\sqrt{E_1}}$$

For each later signal, remove what the earlier axes already hold. Then scale the remainder to unit energy.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

STEP k

$$s_{ki} = \int s_k(t)\,\psi_i(t)\,dt, \qquad g_k(t) = s_k(t) - \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} s_{ki}\,\psi_i(t)$$

$$\psi_k(t) = \frac{g_k(t)}{\sqrt{E_{g_k}}}, \qquad E_{g_k} = \int g_k^2(t)\,dt$$

The figure runs the procedure on two signals.

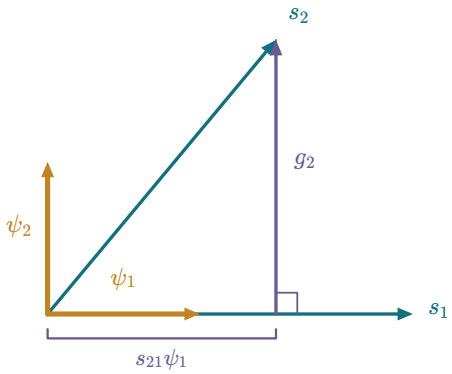


FIGURE 3.22 The procedure on two signals. The part of s_2 along ψ_1 is removed. The remainder g_2, scaled to unit length, is ψ_2.

⚠ STOP RULE

If $g_k(t) = 0$, then s_k is a combination of earlier signals and adds no axis. So $N \le M$, with $N = M$ only when no signal is a combination of the others.

For example, let s_2 have energy 25 and $s_{21} = 3$. The remainder g_2 is perpendicular to ψ_1, so the squared lengths add: $E_2 = s_{21}^2 + E_{g_2}$.

THE ENERGY OF THE REMAINDER

$$E_{g_2} = E_2 - s_{21}^2 = 25 - 3^2 = 16$$

Example 3.3 runs the procedure on three pulses. It finds that two axes are enough.

EXAMPLE 3.3 — GRAM–SCHMIDT FOR THREE PULSES

GIVEN — $s_1 = 1$ on $[0, 2)$, $s_2 = 1$ on $[2, 3)$ and $s_3 = 1$ on $[0, 3)$, each zero elsewhere.

FIND — The basis and the vectors. How many axes?

METHOD — Run Gram–Schmidt in the order s_1, s_2, s_3.

STEP 1 — THE FIRST AXIS — The first signal sets the first axis. Its energy is

$$\int_0^2 s_1^2(t)\,dt = \int_0^2 1^2\,dt = 2 = E_1.$$

Dividing by $\sqrt{E_1}$ gives a function of unit energy,

$$\psi_1(t) = \frac{s_1(t)}{\sqrt{E_1}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \text{ on } [0,2), \qquad \int_0^2 \psi_1^2(t)\,dt = \int_0^2 \tfrac{1}{2}\,dt = 1.$$

STEP 2 — THE SECOND AXIS

ψ_1 is zero on $[2,3)$ and s_2 is zero on $[0,2)$, so their product is zero at every t:

$$s_{21} = \int s_2(t)\psi_1(t)\,dt = 0.$$

Nothing is taken off s_2, so the remainder is the signal itself, and scaling it to unit energy leaves it unchanged:

$$g_2(t) = s_2(t) - s_{21}\psi_1(t) = s_2(t), \qquad E_{g_2} = \int_2^3 1^2\,dt = 1, \qquad \psi_2(t) = \frac{g_2(t)}{\sqrt{E_{g_2}}} = s_2(t).$$

STEP 3 — THE THIRD SIGNAL

Each integral runs over the interval where its basis function is non-zero:

$$s_{31} = \int s_3(t)\psi_1(t)\,dt = \int_0^2 1 \cdot \tfrac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\,dt = \sqrt{2}, \qquad s_{32} = \int s_3(t)\psi_2(t)\,dt = \int_2^3 1 \cdot 1\,dt = 1.$$

The two projections put back a pulse of height 1 on $[0,2)$ and on $[2,3)$, which is s_3 itself:

$$g_3(t) = s_3(t) - s_{31}\psi_1(t) - s_{32}\psi_2(t) = s_3(t) - \sqrt{2} \cdot \tfrac{1}{\sqrt{2}} - 1 \cdot 1 = 0.$$

A zero remainder adds no axis, so the basis stops at two.

SOLUTION

Each signal is now written in the basis, and its coefficients are its coordinates:

$$\begin{aligned} s_1(t) &= \sqrt{2}\,\psi_1(t) + 0\,\psi_2(t), & \mathbf{s}_1 &= (\sqrt{2}, 0) \\ s_2(t) &= 0\,\psi_1(t) + 1\,\psi_2(t), & \mathbf{s}_2 &= (0, 1) \\ s_3(t) &= \sqrt{2}\,\psi_1(t) + 1\,\psi_2(t), & \mathbf{s}_3 &= (\sqrt{2}, 1) \end{aligned}$$

CHECK

The squared lengths are 2, 1 and 3. They are the same as $\int s_i^2(t)\,dt$: height 1 over lengths 2, 1 and 3.

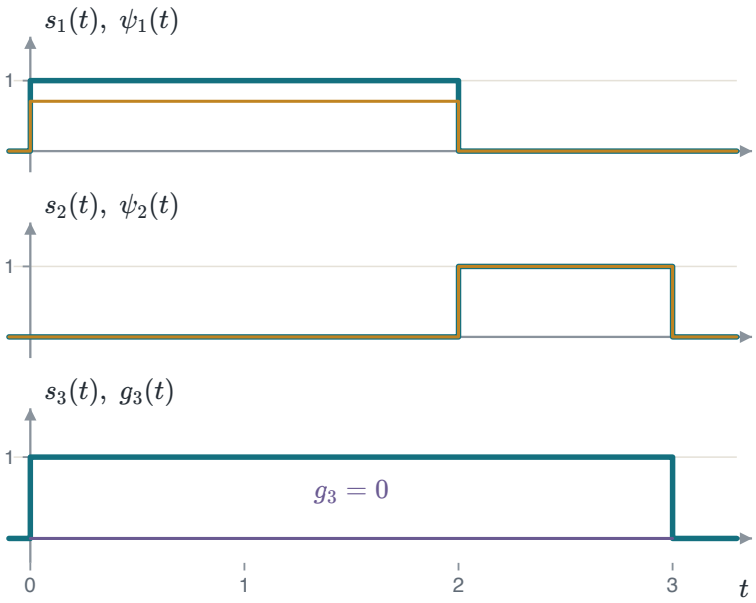


FIGURE 3.23 Each row holds one signal of Example 3.3 in cyan, with the basis function it produces drawn over it. The third leaves nothing: $g_3 = 0$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

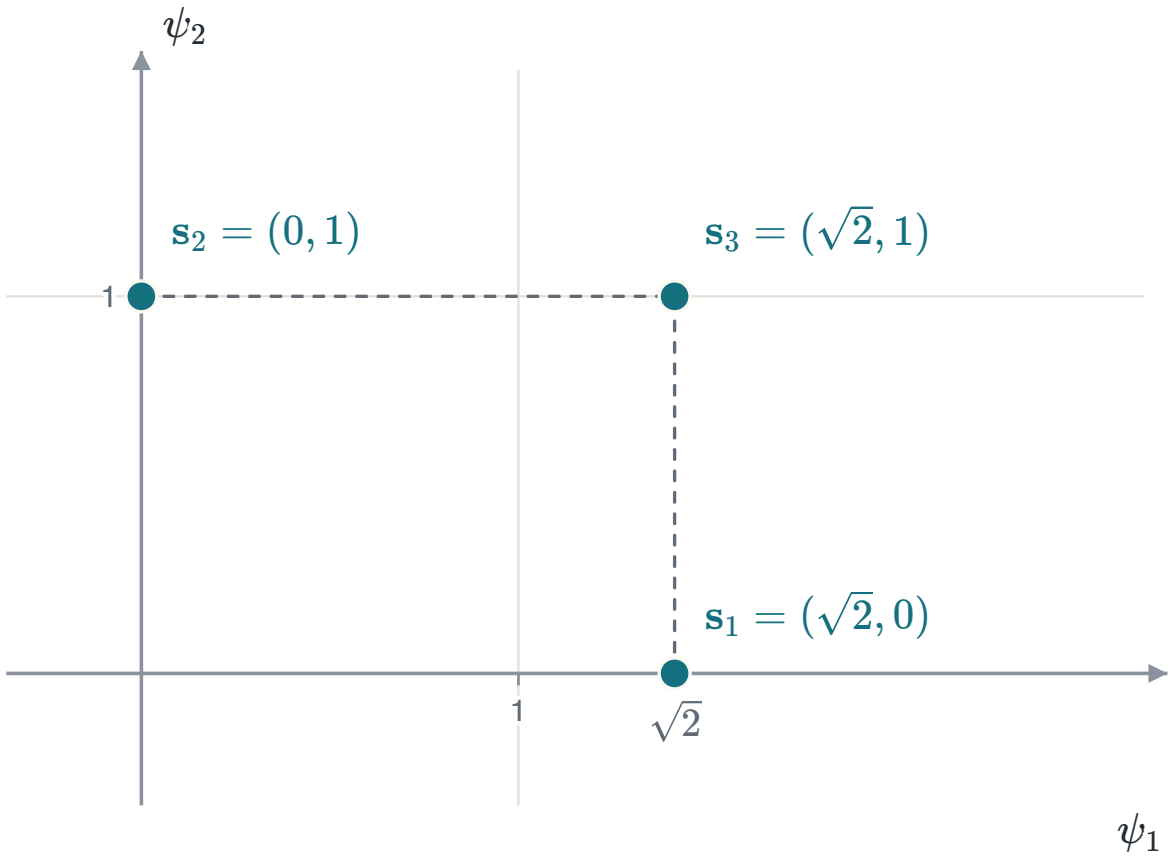


FIGURE 3.24 The three signals of Example 3.3 as points in the plane the basis spans. The dashed guides read each coordinate off its axis.

Example 3.4 runs the procedure on four signals that span three dimensions.

EXAMPLE 3.4 — FOUR SIGNALS, THREE AXES

GIVEN $s_1(t) = 1$ on $[0, 2)$. $s_2(t) = 1$ on $[0, 1)$ and -1 on $[1, 2)$. $s_3(t) = -1$ on $[0, 1)$ and 1 on $[1, 3)$. $s_4(t) = 1$ on $[0, 3)$. Each is zero elsewhere.

FIND How many dimensions does the set span?

METHOD Run Gram–Schmidt in the order s_1, s_2, s_3, s_4. Each coordinate is a sum of piece heights times piece widths.

STEPS 1 AND 2 $E_1 = \int_0^2 1^2\, dt = 2$, so $\psi_1(t) = s_1(t)/\sqrt{2}$. Then $s_{21} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(1 - 1) = 0$, so $g_2(t) = s_2(t)$, with energy 2, and $\psi_2(t) = s_2(t)/\sqrt{2}$.

STEP 3 $s_{31} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(-1 + 1) = 0$ and $s_{32} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(-1 - 1) = -\sqrt{2}$. Then $g_3(t) = s_3(t) + \sqrt{2}\,\psi_2(t) = s_3(t) + s_2(t)$. It is 1 on $[2, 3)$ and zero elsewhere, with energy 1, so $\psi_3(t) = g_3(t)$.

STEP 4 $s_4(t) = s_1(t) + s_2(t) + s_3(t)$, so $g_4(t) = 0$ and $s_4(t)$ adds no axis. Its coordinates are $s_{41} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(1 + 1) = \sqrt{2}$, $s_{42} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(1 - 1) = 0$ and $s_{43} = \int_2^3 1\, dt = 1$.

SOLUTION $\mathbf{s}_1 = (\sqrt{2}, 0, 0)$, $\mathbf{s}_2 = (0, \sqrt{2}, 0)$, $\mathbf{s}_3 = (0, -\sqrt{2}, 1)$ and $\mathbf{s}_4 = (\sqrt{2}, 0, 1)$. The set spans $N = 3$ dimensions.

CHECK Energies from the vectors are 2, 2, 3 and 3, equal to $\int s_i^2(t)\, dt$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use one axis for each independent signal, not one for each signal, so $N \le M$. Here $g_4(t) = 0$, so $N = 3$, not $M = 4$.

The figure draws the four vectors in three dimensions.

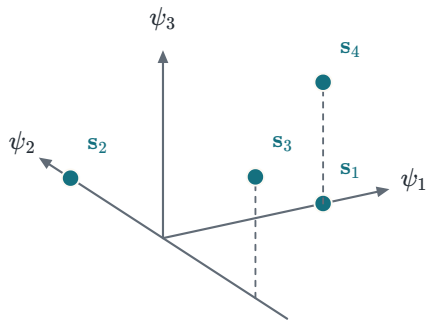


FIGURE 3.25 Four signals need three axes, seen here from an angle of 30°. $\mathbf{s}_4$ sits one unit above $\mathbf{s}_1$, along ψ_3.

Example 3.5 runs the procedure on eight carriers that differ only in phase. It finds that one cosine and one sine carry all eight.

EXAMPLE 3.5 — EIGHT PHASES, TWO AXES

GIVEN — $s_i(t) = A\cos\!\left(2\pi f_c t - \frac{\pi}{4} i\right)$ for $i = 0, \dots, 7$ and $0 \le t \le T$, where $f_c T$ is an integer.

FIND — An orthonormal basis, and the constellation of the eight signals.

METHOD — Open each phase with the cosine of a difference, then run Gram–Schmidt in the order $s_0, s_1, \dots$

STEP 0 — OPEN THE PHASE

The identity $\cos(a - b) = \cos a \cos b + \sin a \sin b$ writes every signal with the same two waveforms:

$$s_i(t) = A\cos\tfrac{\pi i}{4}\,\cos(2\pi f_c t) + A\sin\tfrac{\pi i}{4}\,\sin(2\pi f_c t).$$

Only the two weights change with i, so the set spans at most two dimensions.

STEP 1 — THE FIRST AXIS

The first signal is the carrier itself. Its energy follows from $\cos^2 x = \frac{1}{2}(1 + \cos 2x)$:

$$E_0 = \int_0^T A^2\cos^2(2\pi f_c t)\,dt = \frac{A^2}{2}\int_0^T \big[1 + \cos(4\pi f_c t)\big]\,dt = \frac{A^2 T}{2}.$$

The second term runs over a whole number of cycles, because $f_c T$ is an integer, so it integrates to zero. Scaling the carrier to unit energy gives the first basis function:

$$\psi_1(t) = \frac{s_0(t)}{\sqrt{E_0}} = \sqrt{\frac{2}{T}}\,\cos(2\pi f_c t).$$

STEP 2 — THE SECOND AXIS

Of the two terms of $s_1(t)$, only the cosine survives the integral against $\psi_1(t)$:

$$s_{11} = \int_0^T s_1(t)\psi_1(t)\,dt = A\cos\tfrac{\pi}{4}\sqrt{\tfrac{2}{T}}\int_0^T \cos^2(2\pi f_c t)\,dt = A\sqrt{\tfrac{T}{2}}\,\cos\tfrac{\pi}{4}.$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

What is left of $s_1(t)$ is its sine term, and scaling it to unit energy gives the second basis function:

$$g_2(t) = s_1(t) - s_{11}\psi_1(t) = A\sin\tfrac{\pi}{4}\,\sin(2\pi f_c t), \qquad E_{g_2} = A^2\sin^2\tfrac{\pi}{4}\cdot\tfrac{T}{2} = \tfrac{A^2T}{4},$$

$$\psi_2(t) = \frac{g_2(t)}{\sqrt{E_{g_2}}} = \sqrt{\frac{2}{T}}\,\sin(2\pi f_c t).$$

Every later signal is already a sum of $\psi_1(t)$ and $\psi_2(t)$, so $g_i(t) = 0$ for $i \geq 2$ and the basis stops at two.

STEP 3 — THE COORDINATES

Each integral keeps one term of Step 0 and drops the other, because the two basis functions are orthogonal:

$$s_{i1} = \int_0^T s_i(t)\psi_1(t)\,dt = A\sqrt{\tfrac{T}{2}}\,\cos\tfrac{\pi i}{4}, \qquad s_{i2} = \int_0^T s_i(t)\psi_2(t)\,dt = A\sqrt{\tfrac{T}{2}}\,\sin\tfrac{\pi i}{4}.$$

SOLUTION

With $E = A^2T/2$ the eight vectors are

$$\mathbf{s}_i = \sqrt{E}\left(\cos\tfrac{\pi i}{4},\ \sin\tfrac{\pi i}{4}\right), \qquad i = 0,\dots,7.$$

They are eight points on one circle of radius $\sqrt{E}$, one every $\pi/4$. Two neighbours are $d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E}\sin(\pi/8) = 0.765\sqrt{E}$ apart.

CHECK

Every point has $|\mathbf{s}_i|^2 = E\cos^2\tfrac{\pi i}{4} + E\sin^2\tfrac{\pi i}{4} = E$, which is the energy $\int_0^T s_i^2(t)\,dt$ of each signal. A phase shift moves no energy.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

$\int_0^T \cos^2(2\pi f_c t)\,dt = T/2$ holds only when f_cT is an integer. Without it the term $\frac{1}{8\pi f_c}\sin(4\pi f_c T)$ stays, and the basis is no longer orthonormal.

The first figure draws the first two signals with the remainder and the two basis functions. The second draws the eight points.

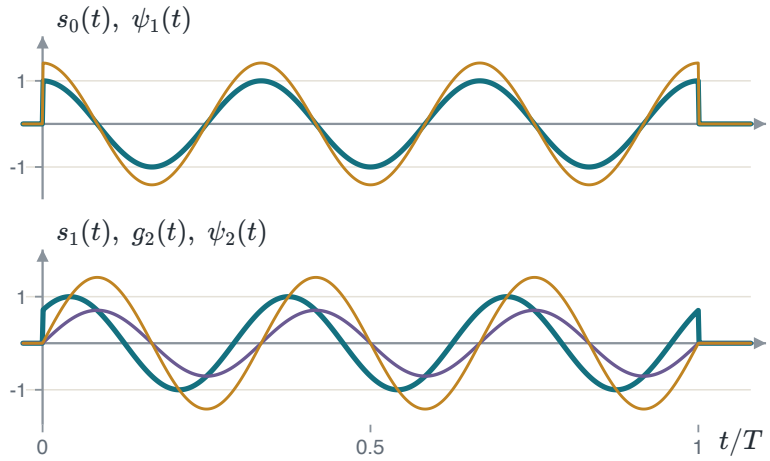


FIGURE 3.26 The first two signals of Example 3.5 in cyan, with $A = 1$, $T = 1$ and three whole cycles. Over them are the remainder $g_2(t)$ and the two basis functions.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

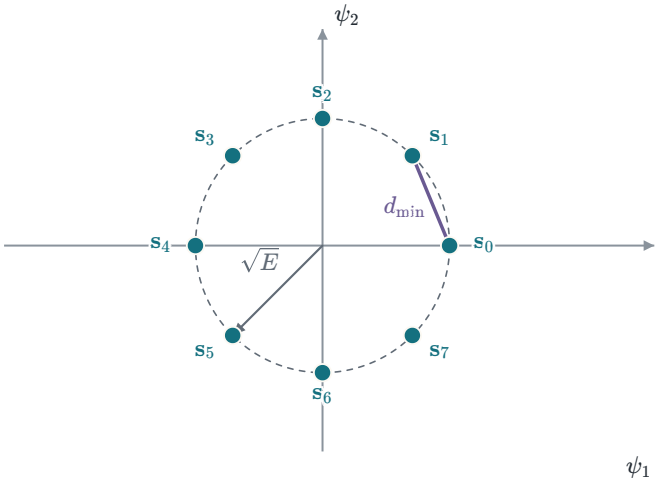


FIGURE 3.27 The eight signals of Example 3.5 on one circle of radius $\sqrt{E} = A\sqrt{T/2}$, one every $\pi/4$. The chord between two neighbours is $d_{\min}$.

The basis is not unique

Another orthonormal basis of the same space turns or reflects the axes. Taking the signals in another order in Gram–Schmidt gives such a basis.

The coordinates change. The quantities below do not.

> UNCHANGED
>
> $$N, \qquad \|\mathbf{s}_i\|^2 = E_i, \qquad \langle \mathbf{s}_i, \mathbf{s}_k \rangle, \qquad \|\mathbf{s}_i - \mathbf{s}_k\|$$
>
> Each is an integral of the waveforms, and the waveforms did not change.

The figure turns the axes by 30°. The coordinates of $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$ become $(1.37, 0.37)$. The four points and their distances stay.

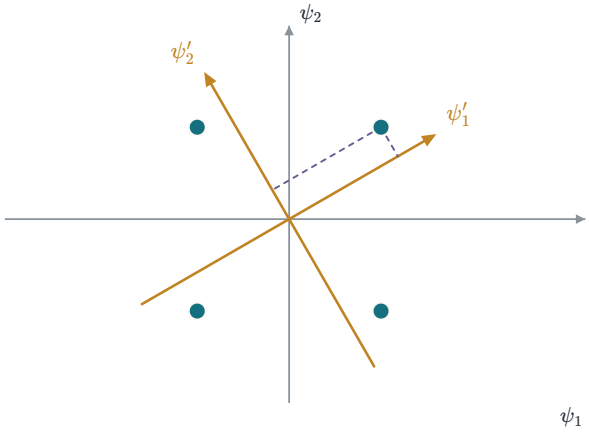


FIGURE 3.28 The axes ψ_1' and ψ_2' turned by 30°, where $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1.37, 0.37)$. The coordinates of $\mathbf{s}_1$ change. The four points and their distances do not.

For example, turn the axes by 45°. Then $\psi_1' = (\psi_1 + \psi_2)/\sqrt{2}$ and $\psi_2' = (\psi_2 - \psi_1)/\sqrt{2}$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

THE NEW COORDINATES OF $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$

$$\langle \mathbf{s}_1, \psi_1' \rangle = \frac{1+1}{\sqrt{2}} = \sqrt{2}$$

$$\langle \mathbf{s}_1, \psi_2' \rangle = \frac{-1+1}{\sqrt{2}} = 0$$

ψ_1' points along $(1, 1)$, so all the length $\sqrt{2}$ of $\mathbf{s}_1$ lies on it. The new coordinates are $(\sqrt{2}, 0)$.

Gram–Schmidt around us

Four real systems use the Gram–Schmidt step.

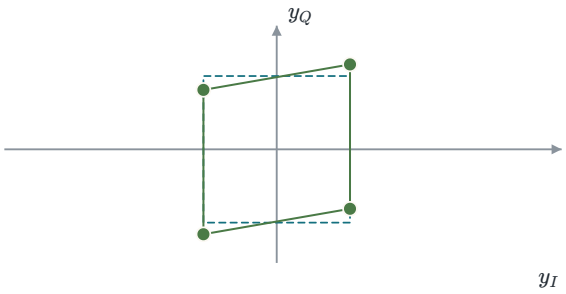


FIGURE 3.29 A receiver whose sine branch is 10° off reads QPSK as a sheared square, $y_Q = y\cos 10^\circ + x \sin 10^\circ$. Gram–Schmidt removes the $\sin 10^\circ = 0.174$ leak and restores the dashed square.

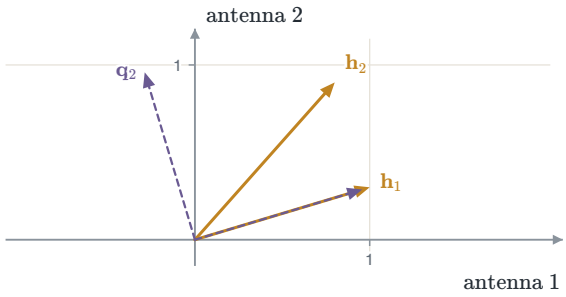


FIGURE 3.30 A two-antenna Wi-Fi receiver orthogonalizes the channel columns $\mathbf{h}_1 = (1, 0.3)$ and $\mathbf{h}_2 = (0.8, 0.9)$ before detection. The result $\mathbf{q}_1, \mathbf{q}_2$ is the QR factorization.

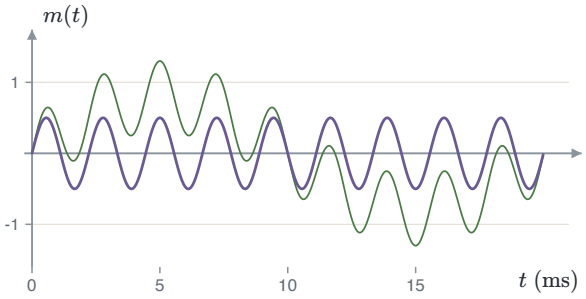


FIGURE 3.31 A hum filter projects the microphone signal $m(t)$ on a 50 Hz reference $r(t)$ over 20 ms. The coefficient $\langle m, r \rangle / \|r\|^2 = 0.8$, and $m - 0.8\, r$ leaves the 450 Hz tone.

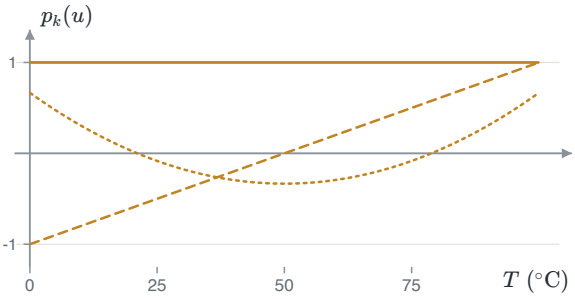


FIGURE 3.32 A sensor fit over 0 to 100 °C uses $u = (T - 50)/50$. Gram–Schmidt on 1, u, u^2 over $[-1, 1]$ gives the orthogonal set 1, u, $u^2 - \frac{1}{3}$.

Each case subtracts the projection on a known signal. That is step k of Gram–Schmidt, $g_k = s_k - \sum_i s_{ki}\psi_i$.

What is left is orthogonal to everything removed. It holds only what is new in the signal.

⚠ THE ORDER

Starting from $\mathbf{h}_2$ instead of $\mathbf{h}_1$ gives other axes. They span the same plane.

3.4 Summary

From waveforms to points

One waveform goes through the whole translation: basis, correlators and point. The figure uses $s(t) = 1.5\psi_1(t) - 0.8\psi_2(t)$ on the two unit pulses.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

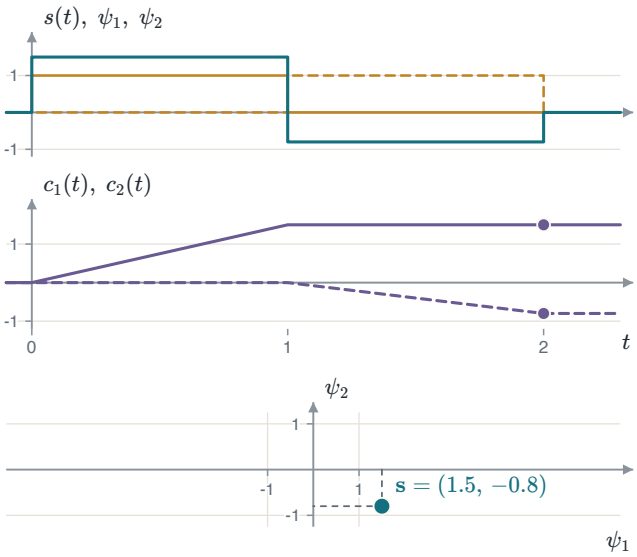


FIGURE 3.33 The waveform $s(t)$ over the basis ψ_1 and ψ_2 (dashed), the correlator outputs $c_1(t)$ and $c_2(t)$ (dashed), and the point. Each correlator integrates $s(t)\,\psi_j(t)$. Its value at $t = 2$ is one coordinate of the point.

The translation takes four moves.

1. Find a basis, by inspection or by Gram–Schmidt.
2. Correlate each waveform with each ψ_j.
3. Draw the vectors as points.
4. Read energies and distances off the picture.

The receiver of Chapter 4 correlates, as the analyzer does, and then picks a point. Its error probability depends only on the distances between the points.

For example, a set of $M = 16$ waveforms spans $N = 2$ dimensions. The receiver needs one correlator for each basis function, so $N = 2$ correlators.

Quick check

Six short predictions. Each answer follows with its reason.

1. Two pulses never overlap in time. What is their inner product?
Answer: 0. Where one is nonzero the other is zero, so the product is zero everywhere.

2. $\psi(t) = c$ on $[0, 4]$ has unit energy when c is what?
Answer: $1/2$. $4c^2 = 1$, so $c = 1/2$.

3. $s(t) = 2\psi_1(t) - 3\psi_2(t)$ on an orthonormal basis. What is its energy?
Answer: 13. $\|\mathbf{s}\|^2 = 2^2 + (-3)^2 = 13$.

4. $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 2)$ and $\mathbf{s}_2 = (4, 6)$. What is their distance?
Answer: 5. $\sqrt{3^2 + 4^2} = \sqrt{25} = 5$.

5. Five waveforms are all multiples of one pulse. What N does Gram–Schmidt give?
Answer: $N = 1$. After the first axis every remainder is zero.

6. QPSK has $E = 2$. What is its $d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E}\sin(\pi/4)$?
Answer: 2. $2\sqrt{2}\,(0.707) = 2$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Summary of results

TABLE 3.1 Summary of Chapter 3: the geometric representation of signal waveforms.

RESULT	STATEMENT	ANCHOR
Orthonormal set	functions with $\int \psi_j \psi_k \, dt = 1$ for $j = k$ and 0 for $j \neq k$: unit energy, and every pair orthogonal	PS CH8.1
Coordinate	$s_{ij} = \int_0^T s_i(t)\, \psi_j(t)\, dt$, one correlator for each basis function	PS CH8.1
Synthesis	$s_i(t) = \sum_{j=1}^{N} s_{ij}\, \psi_j(t)$. The vector $\mathbf{s}_i$ holds the whole waveform	PS CH8.1
Inner products	preserved: $\int x(t)\, y(t)\, dt = \sum_k x_k y_k$	PS CH8.1
Energy	$E_i = \lVert \mathbf{s}_i \rVert^2$, the squared distance from its point to the origin	PS CH8.1
Distance	$d_{ik} = \lVert \mathbf{s}_i - \mathbf{s}_k \rVert$, the root of $\int (s_i - s_k)^2\, dt$	PS CH8.1
Binary sets	antipodal is further apart, $d = 2\sqrt{E_b}$ against $\sqrt{2E_b}$. Orthogonal needs twice the energy, 3 dB, for the same distance	PS CH8.2
Carrier axes	a cosine and a sine are orthogonal over $[0, T]$ when $f_c T$ is a whole number. Scaled by $\sqrt{2/T}$ they are an orthonormal pair	PS CH8.6.1
M-PSK	$d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E}\sin(\pi/M)$. All M points lie on the circle of radius $\sqrt{E}$	PS CH8.6.1
Gram–Schmidt step	$g_k = s_k - \sum_{i<k} s_{ki}\psi_i$, then $\psi_k = g_k / \sqrt{E_{g_k}}$. A zero g_k adds no axis	PS CH8.1
Dimension	$N \leq M$, with $N = M$ only when no signal is a combination of the others	PS CH8.1
Change of basis	only the coordinates change. N, the energies and the distances stay, and so do the receiver and its error probability	PS CH8.1

The method: find a basis, correlate to get the coordinates, and draw the constellation. Chapter 4 detects a received point by its distances to these points.

Projects to try

Four optional projects use the chapter on simulated signals. Each gives an aim, what it practises, steps and what to look for.

GRAM–SCHMIDT ON NOISY WAVEFORMS

Run Gram–Schmidt on sampled waveforms and see how noise changes the count of dimensions. It practises Gram–Schmidt on samples instead of formulas. It shows why a tolerance is needed to call a remainder zero, and how to count the dimensions of a signal set.

Steps: Sample the three pulses of Example 3.3 at 1000 points. Run Gram–Schmidt and print the energy of each remainder. Add a little Gaussian noise to each signal and run it again. Raise the tolerance until the count returns to 2.

Look for: without noise the third remainder is zero. With noise it is small but not zero, so a strict test finds three axes.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

ⓘ SHARE A CHANNEL WITH WALSH CODES

Send two users' bits at the same time and separate them with orthogonal codes. It practises Walsh codes as an orthogonal set, correlation as the analyzer, and what breaks when the codes lose their alignment.
Steps: Build the 8×8 Hadamard matrix and take two of its rows as codes. Map each user's bits to ± 1 and multiply by that user's code. Add the two signals and correlate the sum with each code. Delay one user by one chip and repeat.
Look for: aligned, each correlator returns only its own user's bit. With a one-chip delay the other user leaks in.

ⓘ ORTHOGONAL CARRIERS WITH THE FFT

Place symbols on orthogonal subcarriers and recover them, as OFDM does. It practises sinusoids with whole cycles as an orthogonal basis, with the inverse FFT as the synthesizer and the FFT as the analyzer. It shows why a frequency offset breaks orthogonality.
Steps: Choose 16 QPSK symbols, one for each subcarrier. Build the time signal with an inverse FFT of length 64. Recover the symbols with an FFT and plot them. Shift the frequency by a tenth of the spacing and plot again.
Look for: the points come back exactly. With the offset each point spreads into a small cloud, because the carriers leak into each other.

ⓘ A CONSTELLATION ZOO

Compare the smallest distance of many signal sets at the same average energy. It practises normalizing a constellation to average energy 1, computing $d_{\min}$ from all pairs of points, and the trade between bits a symbol and distance.
Steps: Build BPSK, QPSK, 8-PSK, 16-PSK, 16-QAM and 64-QAM. Scale each to average energy 1. Compute $d_{\min}$ for each and plot it against $\log_2 M$. Compare 16-PSK with 16-QAM.
Look for: $d_{\min}$ falls as bits are added. At 16 points, QAM keeps its points further apart than PSK.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CHAPTER

4

The optimal receiver in additive white Gaussian noise

One of M signals is sent and the channel adds noise. The receiver turns what arrives into a point and picks the nearest signal point.

A bank of correlators turns $r(t)$ into a point $\mathbf{r}$. The best rule picks the nearest signal point, with a handicap for each prior. How often the receiver is wrong depends only on the distances between the points. The union bound turns those distances into a number.

The figure below sends one point many times and marks the received points that land in the wrong region.

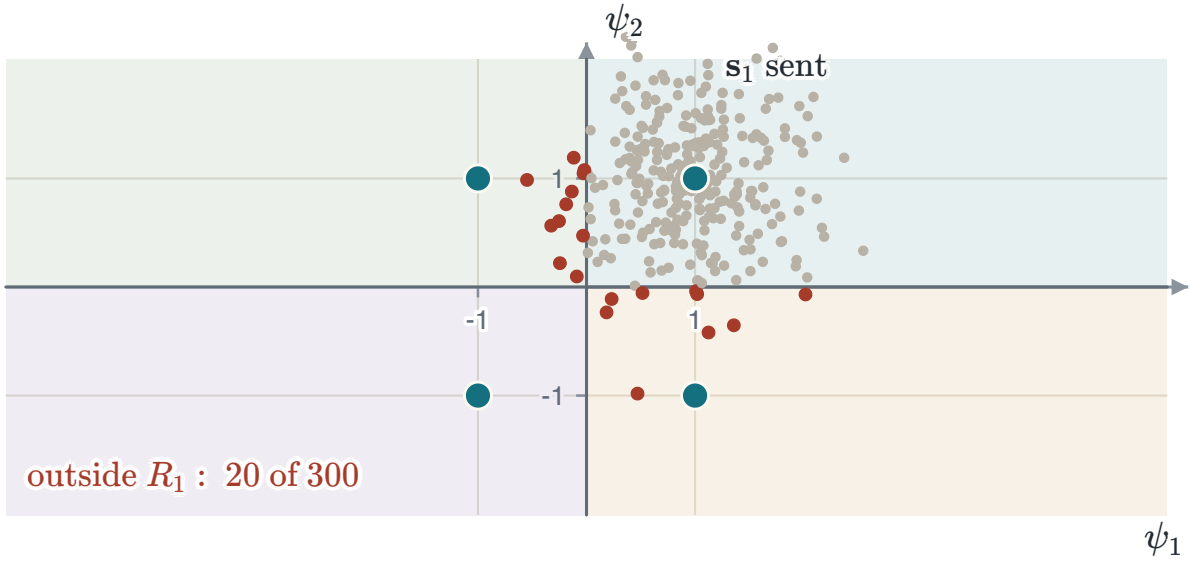


FIGURE 4.1 Four signal points and their decision regions. The grey dots are received points when $\mathbf{s}_1$ is sent, and the red ones fall outside its region R_1.

4.1 The observation

Bits into symbols

With M waveforms, each symbol carries $k = \log_2 M$ bits. The bit stream is read in blocks of k bits, and each block picks one waveform.

BITS AND SYMBOLS

$$k = \log_2 M, \qquad R_s = \frac{1}{T}, \qquad R_b = kR_s, \qquad T_b = \frac{T}{k}$$

Each symbol carries k bits and lasts T. The symbol rate R_s counts waveforms a second. The bit rate R_b counts bits.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Each T seconds the transmitter sends one of the M waveforms $s_1(t), \dots, s_M(t)$. The receiver must name it from a noisy $r(t)$.

The figure below reads twelve bits in blocks of two. Each block picks one of four levels and holds it for $T = 2T_b$.

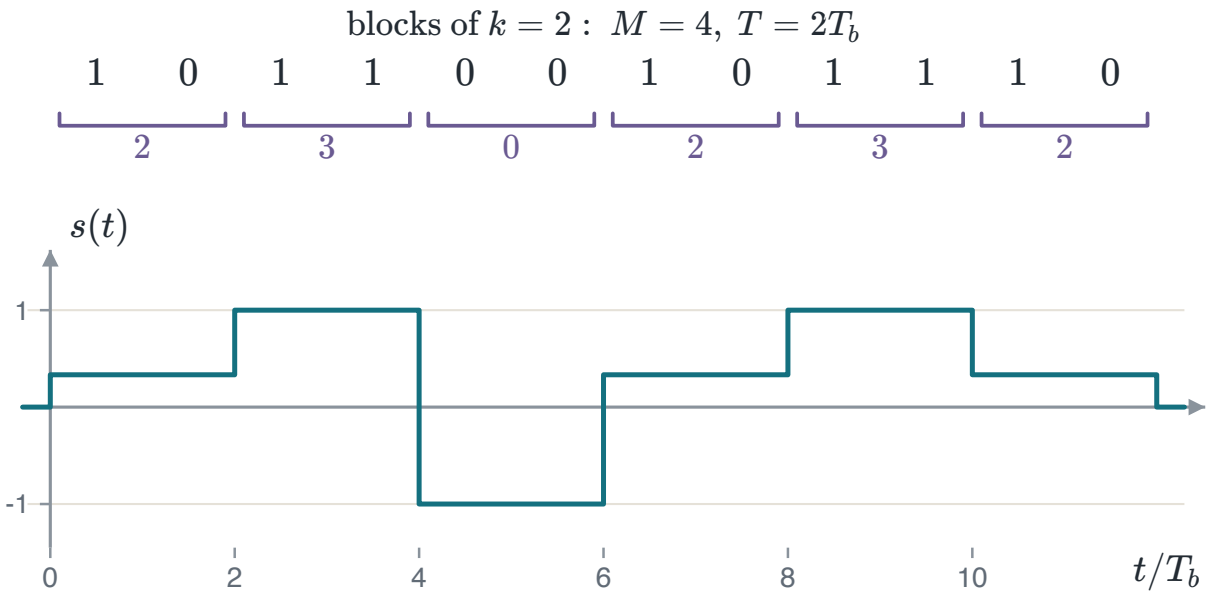


FIGURE 4.2 Twelve bits read in blocks of $k = 2$, so $M = 2^k = 4$ and $T = kT_b = 2T_b$. The number under each block is the level it picks, from 0 to 3.

For example, a modem sends 2400 symbols a second with $M = 16$. Then $k = \log_2 16 = 4$ bits a symbol, and $R_b = 4 \times 2400 = 9600$ b/s.

The observation vector

Over one symbol the receiver sees $r(t) = s_i(t) + n(t)$. Here $n(t)$ is white Gaussian noise of two-sided power spectral density $N_0/2$.

The receiver correlates $r(t)$ with each of the N orthonormal basis functions $\psi_1(t), \dots, \psi_N(t)$ of the signal set. Each correlator multiplies by one basis function and integrates over one symbol.

CORRELATOR OUTPUTS

$$\begin{aligned} r_j &= \int_0^T r(t)\,\psi_j(t)\,dt \\ &= \int_0^T s_i(t)\,\psi_j(t)\,dt + \int_0^T n(t)\,\psi_j(t)\,dt \\ &= s_{ij} + n_j, \qquad j = 1, \dots, N \end{aligned}$$

The integral is linear, so it splits over the sum. The first integral is the coordinate s_{ij} of the sent signal. The second is a noise coordinate n_j.

Stack the N outputs into one vector. The result is the observation the receiver decides from.

THE OBSERVATION VECTOR

$$\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{s}_i + \mathbf{n}$$

The receiver now works with one point $\mathbf{r}$. The noise moves it away from the sent point $\mathbf{s}_i$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The figure below follows one received waveform, with $T = 1$, through two correlators.

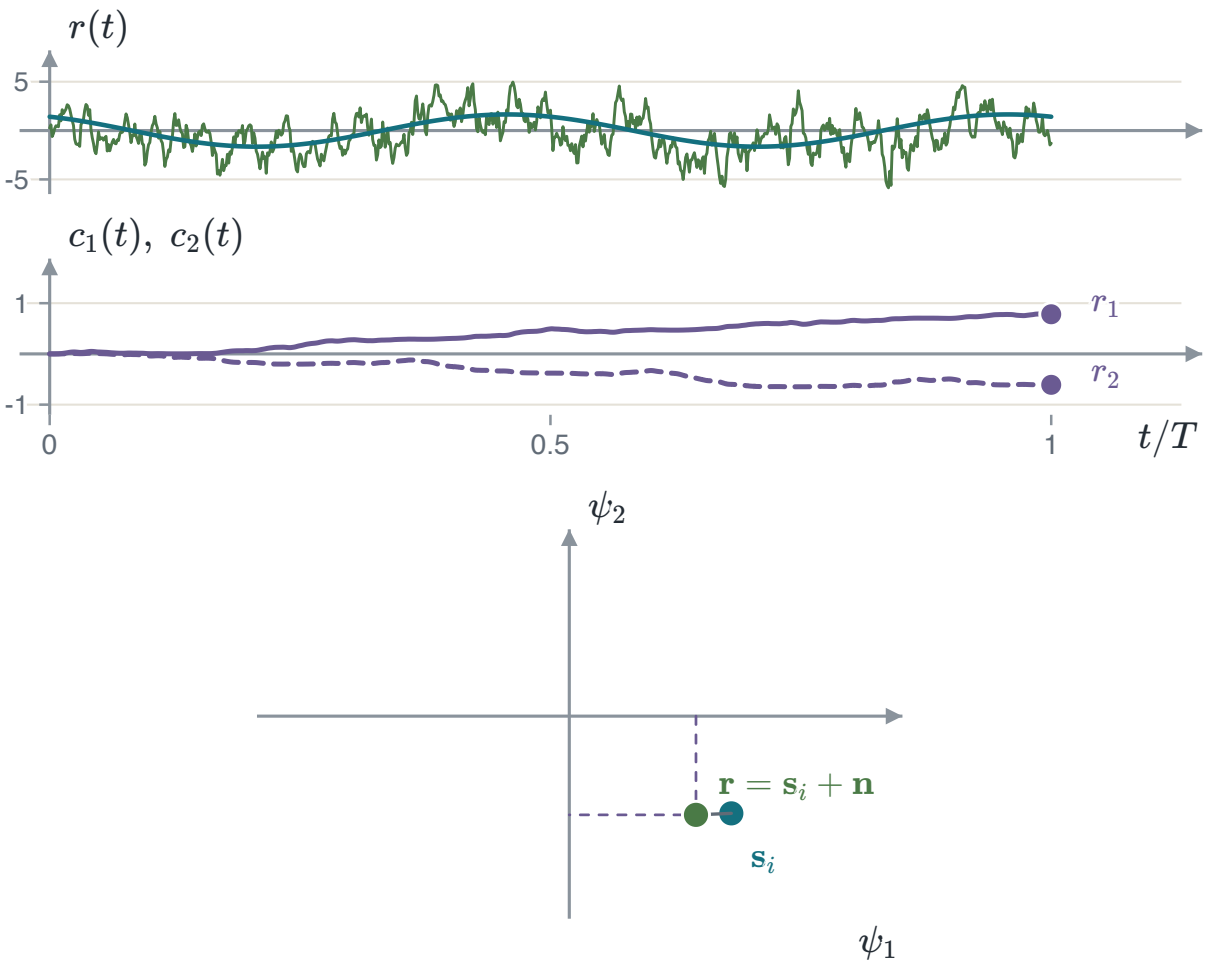


FIGURE 4.3 Top: $r(t)$, green, is $s_i(t)$, cyan, plus noise. Middle: the running integrals $c_1(t)$, solid, and $c_2(t)$, dashed, of $r(t)\,\psi_j(t)$. Bottom: their end values r_1 and r_2 are the coordinates of $\mathbf{r}$.

For example, let $\mathbf{s}_i = (2, -1)$ be sent with noise coordinates $n_1 = 0.3$ and $n_2 = -0.4$. Then $\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{s}_i + \mathbf{n} = (2 + 0.3,\ -1 - 0.4) = (2.3, -1.4)$.

The matched-filter bank

A bank of matched filters gives the same numbers as the correlators. The filter for axis j is its basis function turned around in time.

MATCHED FILTER

$$h_j(t) = \psi_j(T - t)$$

The filter output is the convolution of $r(t)$ with $h_j(t)$. Write the convolution, then put in $h_j(t - \tau) = \psi_j(T - t + \tau)$.

$$\begin{aligned} y_j(t) &= \int_0^T r(\tau)\, h_j(t - \tau)\, d\tau \\ &= \int_0^T r(\tau)\, \psi_j(T - t + \tau)\, d\tau \end{aligned}$$

Now sample the output at $t = T$. The shift $T - t$ becomes zero, and the integral is the correlator.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

SAMPLE AT T

$$y_j(T) = \int_0^T r(\tau)\,\psi_j(\tau)\,d\tau = r_j$$

At any other time the two outputs differ.

The figure below uses $\psi(t) = \sqrt{3}\,t$ on $[0, 1]$ and $r(t) = 1.5\,\psi(t)$, with no noise. The two curves meet only at $t = T = 1$.

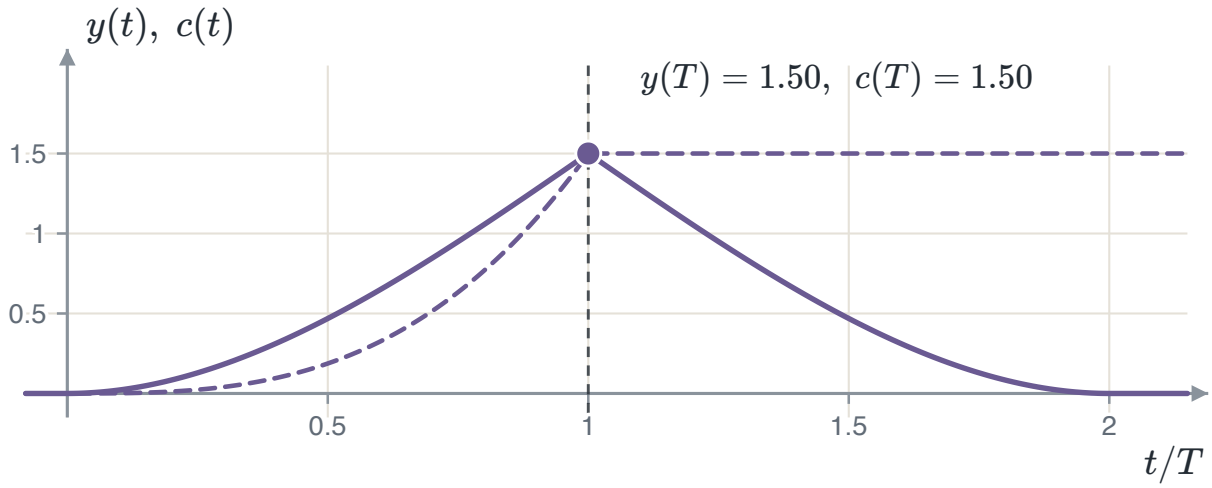


FIGURE 4.4 Solid: the matched filter output $y(t)$. Dashed: the correlator output $c(t)$. At the sampling time $t_0 = T$ both equal 1.5.

The value at T follows from the energy of ψ. The correlator gives $y(1) = 1.5\int_0^1 \psi^2(t)\,dt = 1.5\int_0^1 3t^2\,dt = 1.5$.

The noise the receiver ignores

Noise has parts in every direction, not only in the signal space. The part outside the span of $\psi_1, \ldots, \psi_N$ is written $n'(t)$. It does not depend on the signal sent.

Let $\tilde{\mathbf{r}}$ be the received waveform with nothing dropped. It is $\mathbf{r}$ plus n', and n' is at right angles to the signal space. So Pythagoras splits each squared distance into two parts.

$$\tilde{\mathbf{r}} - \mathbf{s}_j = (\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_j) + n'$$

THE NOISE OUTSIDE THE SIGNAL SPACE

$$\|\tilde{\mathbf{r}} - \mathbf{s}_j\|^2 = \|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_j\|^2 + \|n'\|^2$$

The second part is the same for every j. It cannot change which signal is nearest, so the receiver can drop it.

SUFFICIENT STATISTICS

The N correlator outputs $r_1, \ldots, r_N$ hold everything the decision needs. Nothing is lost by dropping $n'(t)$. Outputs with this property are called **sufficient statistics**.

The figure below draws the signal space as a sheet in three dimensions.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

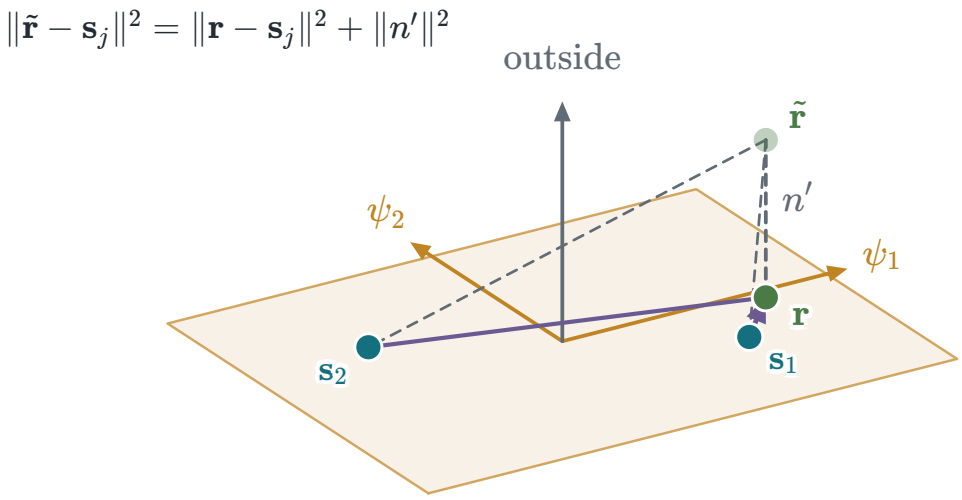


FIGURE 4.5 The amber sheet is the signal space, spanned by ψ_1 and ψ_2. The noise splits into a part in the sheet and n' outside it. Only the part in the sheet moves $\mathbf{r}$.

For example, let the squared distances in the sheet be $\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_1\|^2 = 0.5$ and $\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_2\|^2 = 2.0$, with $\|n'\|^2 = 0.8$. The full squared distances are $0.5 + 0.8 = 1.3$ and $2.0 + 0.8 = 2.8$. The gap stays 1.5, so $\mathbf{s}_1$ still wins.

The noise components

Each noise coordinate is the noise correlated with one basis function. It is a weighted integral of a Gaussian process, so it is Gaussian.

ONE COMPONENT

$$n_j = \int_0^T n(t)\,\psi_j(t)\,dt, \qquad E[n_j] = 0$$

The noise has mean zero, and the integral keeps the mean at zero.

The variance of one component, and the correlation of two, follow from the autocorrelation of white noise, $E[n(t)n(u)] = \frac{N_0}{2}\delta(t-u)$.

$$\begin{aligned} E[n_j n_k] &= \int_0^T\!\!\int_0^T E[n(t)n(u)]\,\psi_j(t)\,\psi_k(u)\,dt\,du \\ &= \int_0^T\!\!\int_0^T \frac{N_0}{2}\,\delta(t-u)\,\psi_j(t)\,\psi_k(u)\,dt\,du \\ &= \frac{N_0}{2}\int_0^T \psi_j(t)\,\psi_k(t)\,dt \end{aligned}$$

The delta function collapses the integral over u. Orthonormality then gives 1 for the last integral when $j = k$, and 0 otherwise.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TWO COMPONENTS

$$E[n_j^2] = \frac{N_0}{2}, \qquad E[n_j n_k] = 0, \quad j \neq k$$

Gaussian variables that are uncorrelated are independent. So the N components are independent, each with variance $N_0/2$.

Every axis has the same variance, and the axes are independent. So the cloud of received points around a signal point is round.

⚠ AN ELLIPSE

Coloured noise gives correlated components, with correlation coefficient $\rho \neq 0$. The cloud tilts into an ellipse, and the nearest point is no longer the best guess.

For example, noise with $\rho = 0.8$ reaches the two correlators. A positive ρ makes n_2 follow n_1, so the cloud stretches along the line $n_1 = n_2$.

The figure below draws two components of variance 1 for two values of ρ.

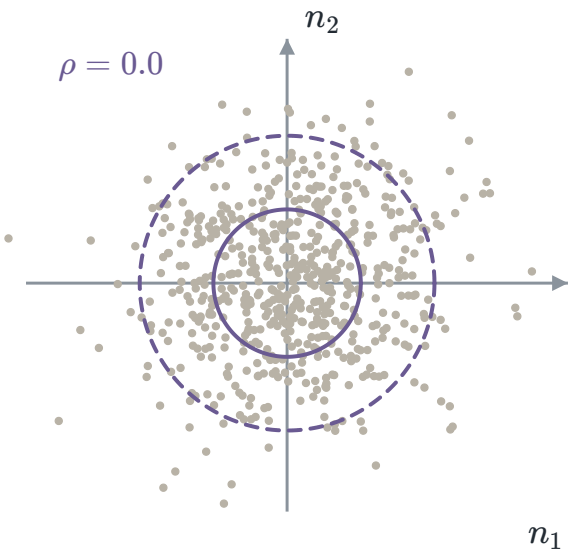


FIGURE 4.6 $\rho = 0$: independent components and a round cloud. The solid and dashed curves hold about 39% and 86% of the points.

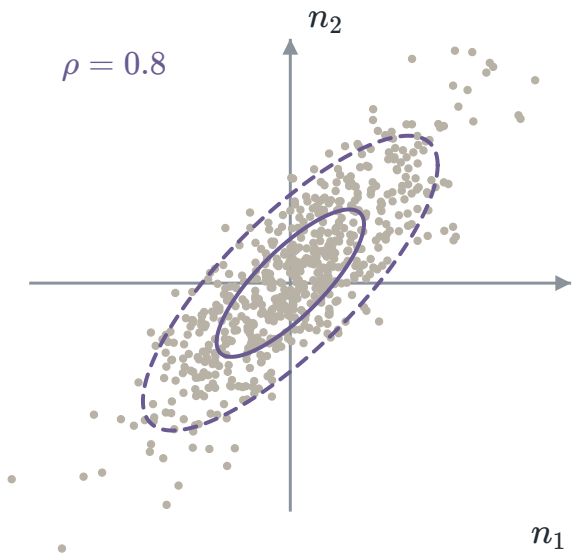


FIGURE 4.7 $\rho = 0.8$: n_2 follows n_1, and the cloud stretches along the line $n_1 = n_2$.

EXAMPLE 4.1 — FOUR-LEVEL PAM

GIVEN — Four-level PAM, $s_m \in \{-1.5, -0.5, 0.5, 1.5\}$ on a unit-energy pulse, with $N_0 = 0.1$.

FIND — The conditional density $f(r \mid s_m)$ of the correlator output for each level, and the height of each bell.

METHOD — One basis function means one correlator and one number, $r = s_m + n$. The noise n is Gaussian with mean 0 and variance $\sigma^2 = N_0/2$. So r is Gaussian and centred on s_m.

SOLUTION — Put $\sigma^2 = N_0/2$ into the Gaussian density.

$$f(r \mid s_m) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma^2}}\, e^{-(r-s_m)^2/2\sigma^2} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{\pi N_0}}\, e^{-(r-s_m)^2/N_0}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Here $\sigma^2 = 0.05$. The peak is $1/\sqrt{\pi N_0} = 1/\sqrt{0.1\pi} = 1.78$. The four bells have one shape, each centred on its level.

CHECK — Each bell has $\sigma = \sqrt{0.05} = 0.22$, well inside half the spacing between levels, 0.5. At $N_0 = 0.6$, $\sigma = 0.55$ and neighbouring bells overlap.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use $N_0/2$, not N_0, as the variance. N_0 makes each bell $\sqrt{2}$ times too wide.

The figure below draws the four densities of Example 4.1.

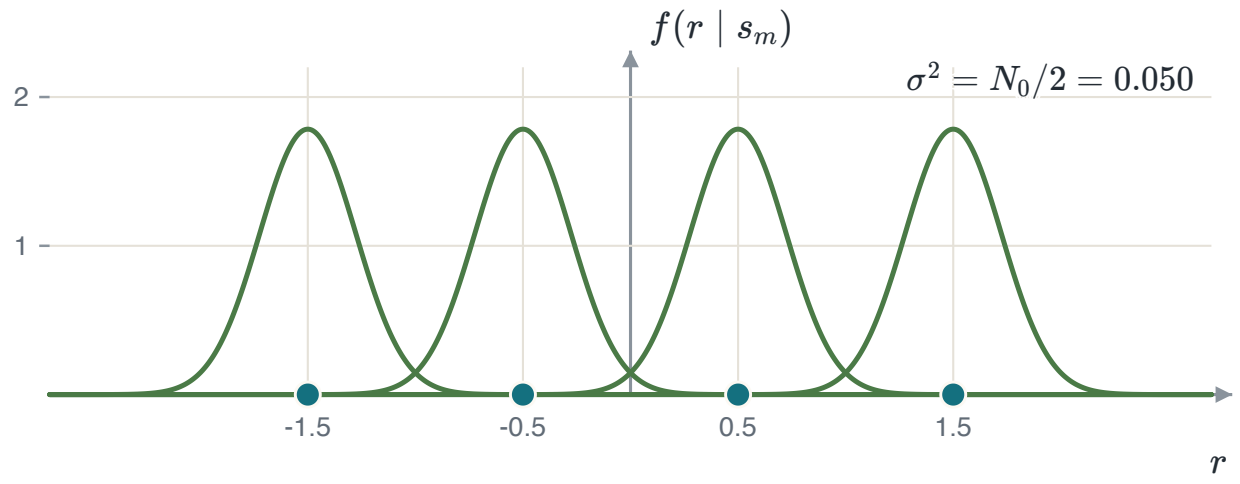


FIGURE 4.8 The four conditional densities of Example 4.1, drawn for $N_0 = 0.1$. Each bell sits on one level, and its width grows with $\sqrt{N_0}$.

EXAMPLE 4.2 — FOUR ORTHOGONAL SIGNALS

GIVEN — Four orthogonal signals of energy $E = 4$, with $N_0 = 1$. $\mathbf{s}_1 = (2, 0, 0, 0)$ is sent.

FIND — The density of each correlator output r_k, and the mean of r_1.

METHOD — Each signal lies along its own axis, at distance $\sqrt{E}$ from the origin. So only the first correlator sees the signal.

$$r_1 = \sqrt{E} + n_1, \qquad r_k = n_k, \quad k = 2, 3, 4$$

SOLUTION — Each n_k is Gaussian with variance $N_0/2 = 0.5$, so $2\sigma^2 = 1$.

$$f(r_1 \mid \mathbf{s}_1) = \frac{e^{-(r_1 - 2)^2}}{\sqrt{\pi}}, \qquad f(r_k \mid \mathbf{s}_1) = \frac{e^{-r_k^2}}{\sqrt{\pi}}$$

The mean of r_1 is $\sqrt{E} = 2$. Each density has peak $1/\sqrt{\pi} = 0.56$, and the four outputs are independent.

CHECK — The means $(2, 0, 0, 0)$ have squared length $2^2 = 4 = E$, as they must.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use $\sqrt{E} = 2$, not $E = 4$, as the mean of r_1. The coordinate of $\mathbf{s}_1$ is its length, and E is its squared length.

The figure below draws the four densities of Example 4.2.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

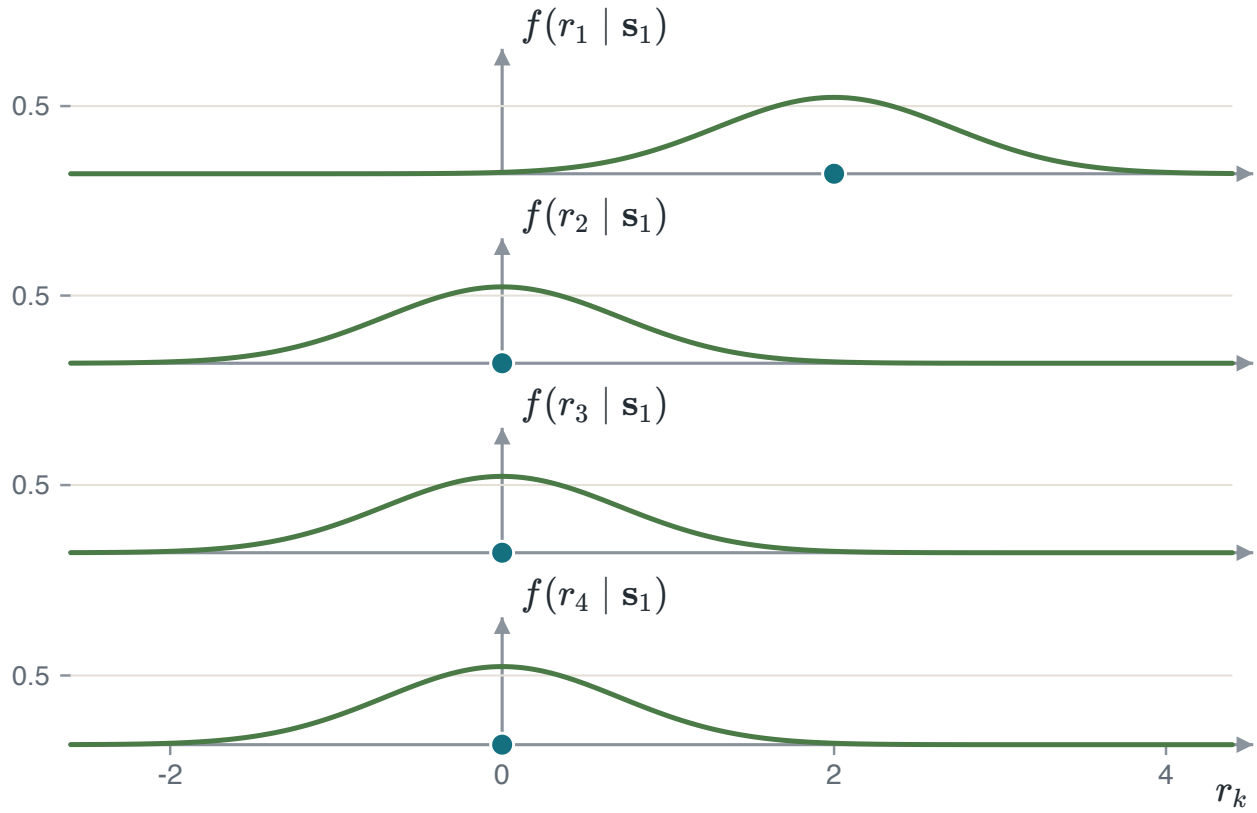


FIGURE 4.9 The four correlator outputs of Example 4.2 when $\mathbf{s}_1$ is sent. Only r_1 is centred away from zero.

Correlators around us

Four everyday receivers correlate what arrives with a known waveform.

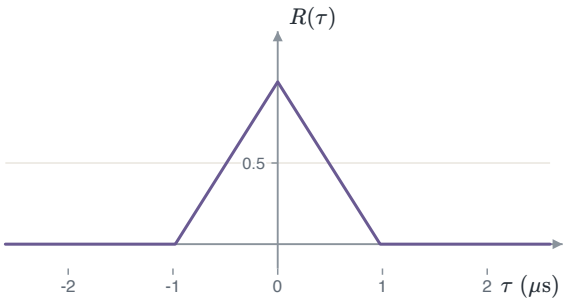


FIGURE 4.10 A GPS receiver correlates the C/A code with a local copy. $R(\tau) = 1 - |\tau|/T_c$, with $T_c = 0.978$ μs, peaks when the two align.

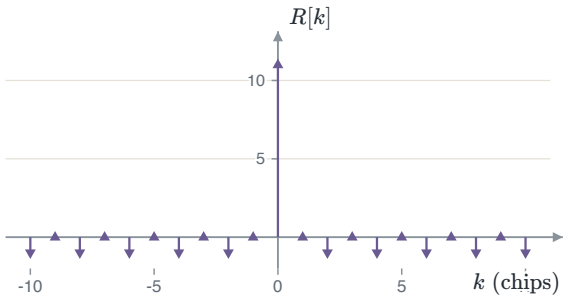


FIGURE 4.11 802.11b Wi-Fi spreads each bit with the 11-chip Barker code. Its correlation $R[k]$ is 11 at $k = 0$ and 0 or -1 elsewhere.

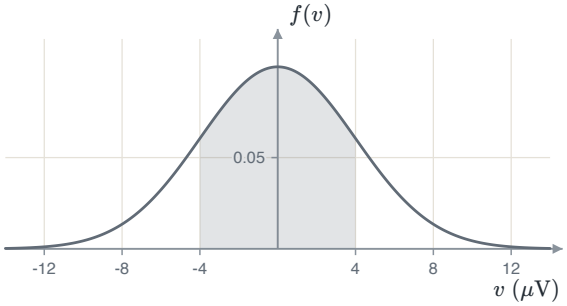


FIGURE 4.12 A $50\ \Omega$ resistor at 290 K, over 20 MHz, gives noise with $\sigma = \sqrt{4kTRB} = 4.0$ μV. Every correlator output carries some.

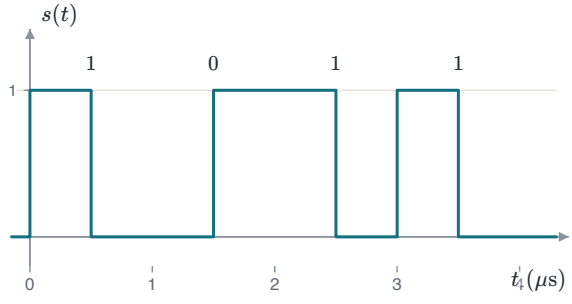


FIGURE 4.13 Aircraft ADS-B sends a 1 as a 0.5 μs pulse in the first half of the bit, a 0 in the second. Two correlators give (r_1, r_2) .

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CORRELATE, THEN DECIDE

Each receiver multiplies what arrives by a known waveform and integrates. The number it gets is one coordinate of $\mathbf{r}$.

NOISE IN EVERY OUTPUT

Thermal noise reaches every correlator. Each output is the signal coordinate plus a Gaussian sample.

⚠ THE WINDOW

The integral runs over one symbol. A GPS copy that is late by T_c gives $R = 0$ and loses the whole signal.

4.2 The decision rule

MAP and ML

The receiver should name the signal that is most probable once $\mathbf{r}$ has been seen. This is the maximum a posteriori, or **MAP**, rule.

Bayes' rule writes that probability with the prior $P(\mathbf{s}_i)$ and the likelihood $f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)$.

$$P(\mathbf{s}_i \mid \mathbf{r}) = \frac{P(\mathbf{s}_i)\, f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)}{f(\mathbf{r})}$$

The denominator $f(\mathbf{r})$ is the same for every i, so it cannot change which i wins.

MAP

$$\hat{s} = \arg\max_i P(\mathbf{s}_i \mid \mathbf{r}) = \arg\max_i P(\mathbf{s}_i)\, f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)$$

With equal priors the factor $P(\mathbf{s}_i)$ is common to every i and drops too. MAP then becomes the maximum-likelihood, or **ML**, rule.

ML

$$\hat{s} = \arg\max_i f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)$$

For example, let $P(s_1) = 0.8$ and $P(s_2) = 0.2$. At some r the likelihoods are $f(r \mid s_1) = 0.2$ and $f(r \mid s_2) = 0.5$. MAP compares $0.8(0.2) = 0.16$ with $0.2(0.5) = 0.10$ and picks s_1. ML picks s_2, because $0.5 > 0.2$.

In one dimension the MAP rule picks the taller of the two weighted densities $P(s_i)\, f(r \mid s_i)$. The figure below shows that their crossing τ is the threshold.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

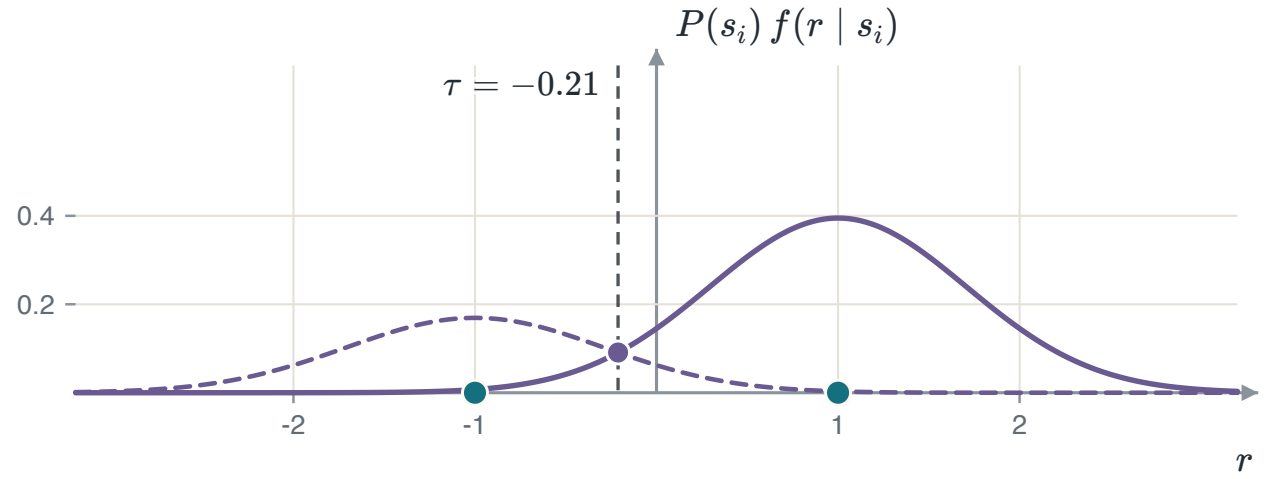


FIGURE 4.14 $s_1 = +1$ and $s_2 = -1$, with $N_0 = 1$, drawn for $P(s_1) = 0.7$. Solid: $P(s_1)\,f(r \mid s_1)$. Dashed: $P(s_2)\,f(r \mid s_2)$. The crossing τ sits on the side of the less likely s_2.

Minimum distance

In Gaussian noise the likelihood has a simple form. The N noise components are independent, so the density of $\mathbf{r}$ is a product of N bells.

$$\begin{aligned} f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i) &= \prod_{j=1}^{N} \frac{1}{\sqrt{\pi N_0}}\, e^{-(r_j - s_{ij})^2 / N_0} \\ &= \frac{1}{(\pi N_0)^{N/2}}\, e^{-\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_i\|^2 / N_0} \end{aligned}$$

The sum of the squares in the exponent is the squared distance $\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_i\|^2$. Now take the logarithm of the MAP product. The logarithm is increasing, so the best signal does not change.

$$\ln\big(P(\mathbf{s}_i)\, f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)\big) = \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i) - \frac{N}{2}\ln(\pi N_0) - \frac{\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_i\|^2}{N_0}$$

The middle term is the same for every i and drops. Multiply what is left by $-N_0$, which turns the largest into the smallest.

> MINIMUM DISTANCE
>
> $$\hat{s} = \arg\min_i \Big(\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_i\|^2 - N_0 \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i) \Big)$$
>
> With equal priors the MAP receiver picks the signal point nearest to $\mathbf{r}$. Unequal priors subtract $N_0 \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i)$ from each squared distance, a handicap in favour of the likely signals.

The figure below takes $\mathbf{r} = (0.5, 0.3)$ and four equally likely points $(\pm 1, \pm 1)$. It marks the squared distance D_i^2 to each point.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

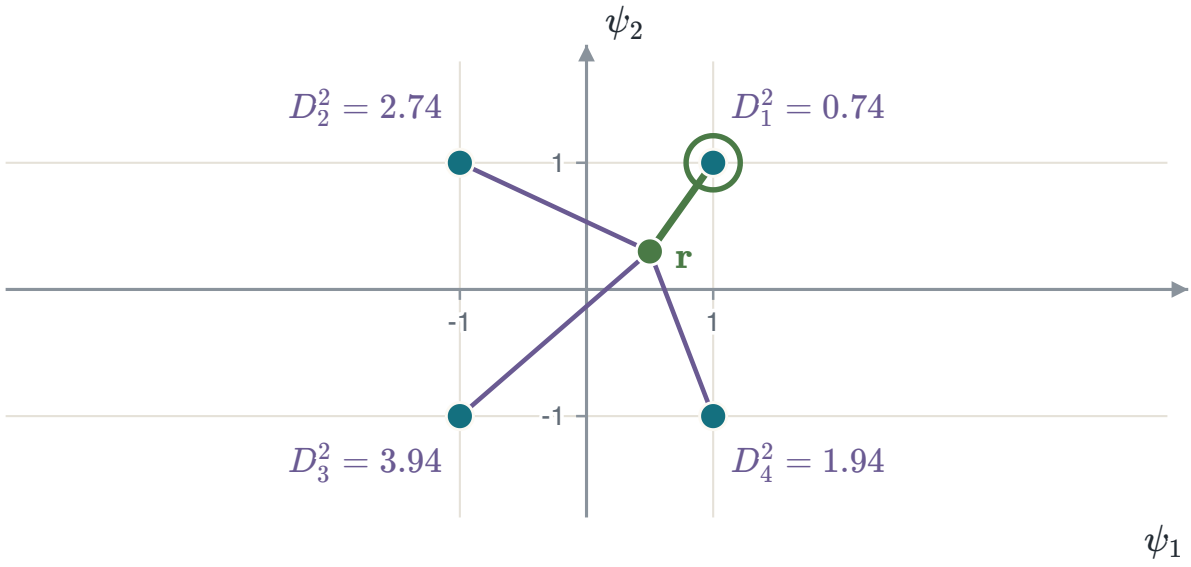


FIGURE 4.15 The received point $\mathbf{r} = (0.5, 0.3)$ and the points $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1,1)$, $\mathbf{s}_2 = (-1,1)$, $\mathbf{s}_3 = (-1,-1)$ and $\mathbf{s}_4 = (1,-1)$. The ring marks the nearest one, $\mathbf{s}_1$.

For $\mathbf{s}_1$ the squared distance is $D_1^2 = (0.5-1)^2 + (0.3-1)^2 = 0.25 + 0.49 = 0.74$. The others are 2.74, 3.94 and 1.94. With equal priors the receiver picks $\mathbf{s}_1$.

Now let $N_0 = 1$, with $P(\mathbf{s}_4) = 0.7$ and 0.1 for each of the others. Each score adds $-\ln P(\mathbf{s}_i)$ to the squared distance.

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{s}_1 &: \quad 0.74 - \ln 0.1 = 0.74 + 2.30 = 3.04 \\
\mathbf{s}_2 &: \quad 2.74 + 2.30 = 5.04 \\
\mathbf{s}_3 &: \quad 3.94 + 2.30 = 6.24 \\
\mathbf{s}_4 &: \quad 1.94 - \ln 0.7 = 1.94 + 0.36 = 2.30
\end{aligned}
$$

The smallest score is 2.30, so MAP picks $\mathbf{s}_4$.

The correlation metric

Expanding the squared distance gives the form in which a receiver is built.

$$
\begin{aligned}
\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_i\|^2 &= \sum_{j=1}^{N} (r_j - s_{ij})^2 \\
&= \sum_{j=1}^{N} r_j^2 - 2\sum_{j=1}^{N} r_j s_{ij} + \sum_{j=1}^{N} s_{ij}^2 \\
&= \|\mathbf{r}\|^2 - 2\,\mathbf{r}\cdot\mathbf{s}_i + E_i
\end{aligned}
$$

Here $E_i = \|\mathbf{s}_i\|^2$ is the energy of $s_i(t)$. The term $\|\mathbf{r}\|^2$ is the same for every i and drops. Halve the rest and change its sign, so the smallest becomes the largest.

CORRELATION METRIC

$$
\hat{s} = \arg\max_i \left(\mathbf{r}\cdot\mathbf{s}_i - \frac{E_i}{2} + \frac{N_0}{2} \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i) \right)
$$

This is the same rule as minimum distance. With equal energies and equal priors only $\mathbf{r}\cdot\mathbf{s}_i$ is left: pick the largest correlation.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

With unequal energies the term $-E_i/2$ must stay. Take 4-PAM at $s_i = -3, -1, 1, 3$ with $r = 1.6$ and equal priors. Each metric is $rs_i - s_i^2/2$.

$$\begin{aligned} s = -3: &\quad -4.8 - 4.5 = -9.3 \\ s = -1: &\quad -1.6 - 0.5 = -2.1 \\ s = 1: &\quad 1.6 - 0.5 = 1.1 \\ s = 3: &\quad 4.8 - 4.5 = 0.3 \end{aligned}$$

The largest is 1.1, so the receiver picks $s = 1$, the nearest level. The correlation alone is largest for $s = 3$, at 4.8. The figure below draws both sets of bars.

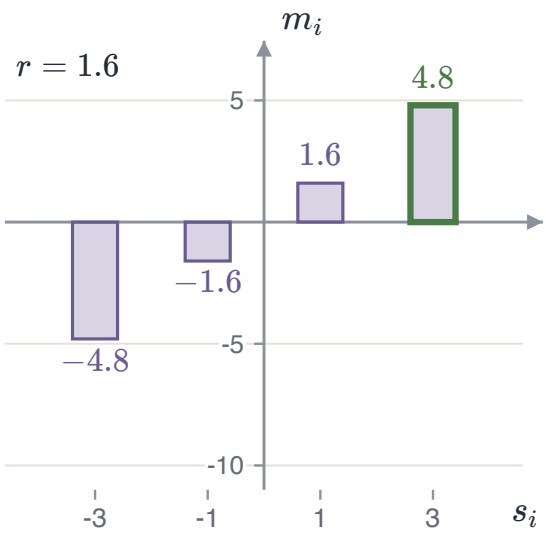


FIGURE 4.16 The correlation rs_i alone. The largest bar, outlined in green, is $s = 3$.

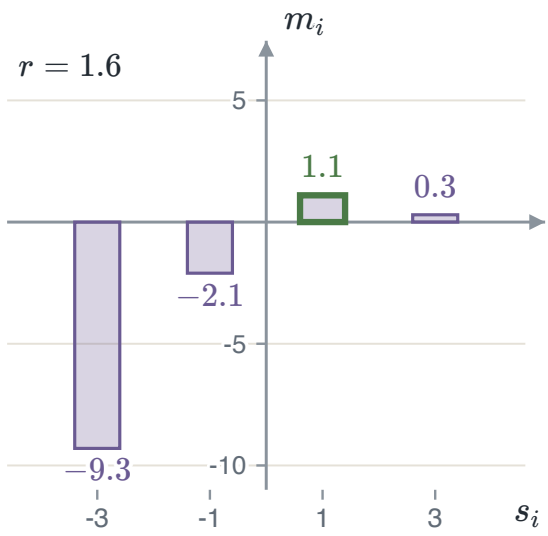


FIGURE 4.17 The metric $rs_i - s_i^2/2$. The energy term gives the win to $s = 1$.

Two receiver structures

There are two ways to build the receiver. Both compute the correlation metric for every signal and keep the largest.

Method I computes $\mathbf{r} = (r_1, \ldots, r_N)$ with N correlators. Then it forms $\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_i + a_i$ for each i and keeps the largest.

> THE BIAS
>
> $$a_i = \frac{N_0}{2} \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i) - \frac{E_i}{2}$$
>
> There is one constant for each signal. The priors and the energies fix it before any signal arrives.

Method II correlates $r(t)$ with each waveform $s_i(t)$ directly. Inner products are preserved, so each of these correlators gives $\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_i$ at once.

$$\int_0^T r(t)\, s_i(t)\, dt = \mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_i$$

Method I needs N correlators and Method II needs M. So Method I is cheaper whenever $N < M$. For example, $M = 16$ signals in $N = 2$ dimensions need 16 correlators in Method II and 2 in Method I.

The figure below draws both structures as block diagrams.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

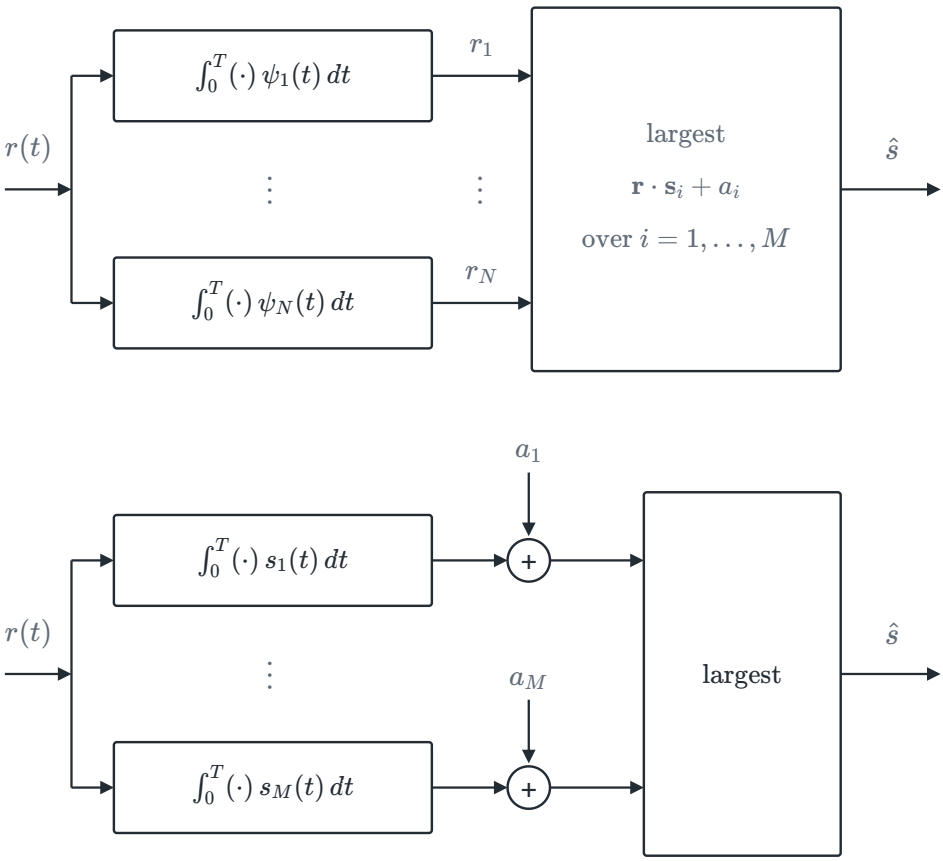


FIGURE 4.18 Top: Method I correlates with the N basis functions, then forms M metrics. Bottom: Method II correlates with the M waveforms and adds each bias a_i. Both give the same $\hat{s}$.

Optimality of the MAP rule

No other rule has a smaller error probability than MAP. In one dimension the reason is a picture, because the error probability is an area.

Take two signals and a threshold τ, with s_1 decided above τ. Each way to be wrong is a weighted density on the wrong side of τ.

ERROR AS AN AREA

$$P_e(\tau) = P(s_1)\int_{-\infty}^{\tau} f(r \mid s_1)\,dr + P(s_2)\int_{\tau}^{\infty} f(r \mid s_2)\,dr$$

Move τ right by a small Δ. The first area gains $P(s_1)f(\tau \mid s_1)\Delta$, and the second loses $P(s_2)f(\tau \mid s_2)\Delta$. So the slope of P_e is the difference.

$$\frac{dP_e}{d\tau} = P(s_1)\,f(\tau \mid s_1) - P(s_2)\,f(\tau \mid s_2)$$

The slope is zero where the two weighted densities are equal. That point is the MAP threshold, and no move of τ helps there.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

IN ANY DIMENSION

Give each $\mathbf{r}$ to the signal whose weighted density $P(\mathbf{s}_i) f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)$ is largest there. Any other choice adds area, so MAP has the smallest P_e.

The figure below uses ± 1 with $P(s_1) = 0.25$ at $+1$ and $N_0 = 0.5$. Its lower panel is $P_e(\tau)$ as the threshold moves.

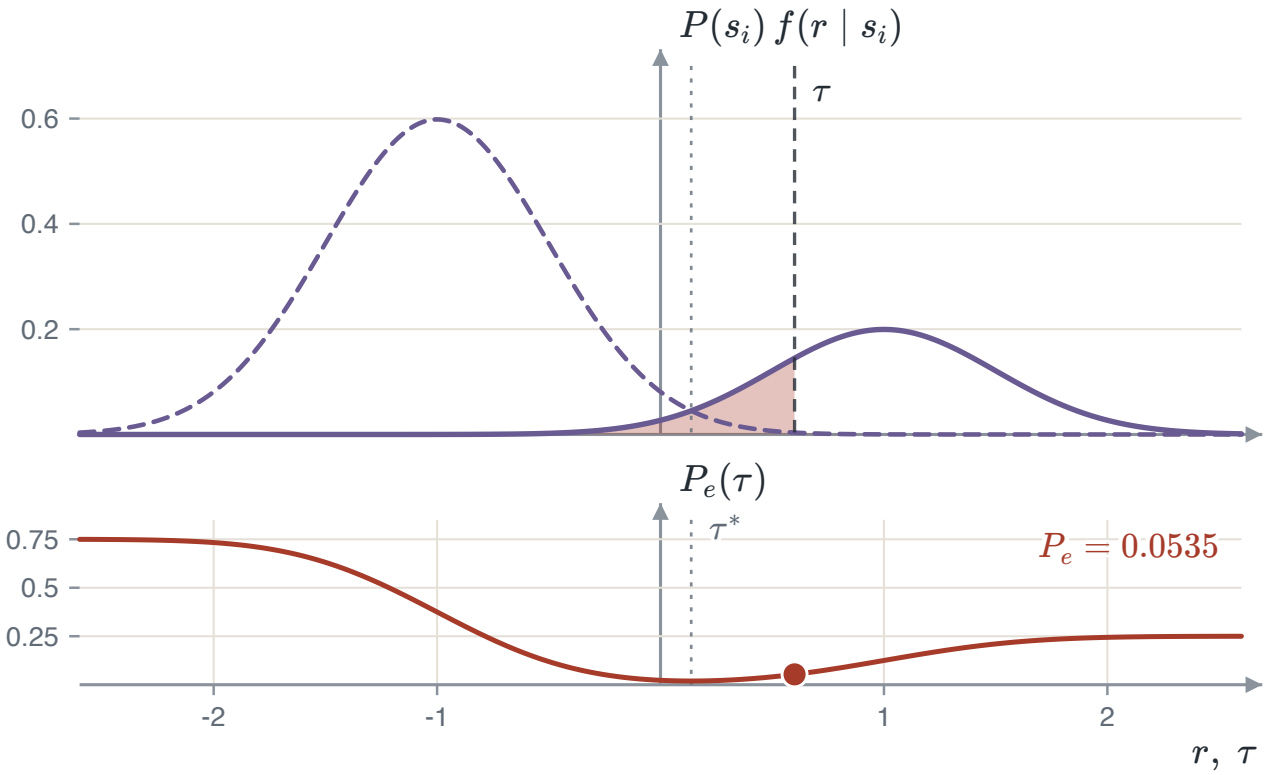


FIGURE 4.19 Drawn for $\tau = 0.6$. Top: the red areas are the weighted densities on the wrong side of τ. Bottom: their sum $P_e(\tau)$, smallest at $\tau^* = 0.137$, where the weighted densities cross.

The minimum sits at $\tau^* = 0.137$, with $P_e = 0.0192$. At $\tau = 0$ it is 0.0228.

EXAMPLE 4.3 — A MAP THRESHOLD

GIVEN Antipodal signals ± 1, so $E_b = 1$, with $P(s_1) = 0.25$ at $+1$, $P(s_2) = 0.75$ at -1, and $N_0 = 0.5$.

FIND The MAP threshold τ, the direction it moves, and the error probability.

METHOD The MAP threshold is where the two weighted densities are equal. Set them equal at $r = \tau$ and take logarithms. The common factor $1/\sqrt{\pi N_0}$ cancels.

$$\ln P(s_1) - \frac{(\tau - \sqrt{E_b})^2}{N_0} = \ln P(s_2) - \frac{(\tau + \sqrt{E_b})^2}{N_0}$$

$$\frac{(\tau + \sqrt{E_b})^2 - (\tau - \sqrt{E_b})^2}{N_0} = \ln \frac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)}$$

$$\frac{4\sqrt{E_b}\,\tau}{N_0} = \ln \frac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)}$$

The squares τ^2 and E_b cancel in the second line. So $\tau = \dfrac{N_0}{4\sqrt{E_b}} \ln \dfrac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)}$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

SOLUTION $\tau = \frac{0.5}{4}\ln\frac{0.75}{0.25} = 0.125\ln 3 = 0.137$. It is positive, so it moves toward $+1$, the less likely signal. Each Q argument is the distance from a point to τ, over $\sigma = \sqrt{N_0/2} = 0.5$.

$$\begin{aligned} P_e &= 0.25\,Q\left(\frac{1-0.137}{0.5}\right) + 0.75\,Q\left(\frac{1+0.137}{0.5}\right) \\ &= 0.25\,Q(1.73) + 0.75\,Q(2.27) \\ &= 0.25(0.0422) + 0.75(0.0115) = 0.0192 \end{aligned}$$

CHECK ML keeps $\tau = 0$ and gets $Q(1/0.5) = Q(2) = 0.0228$. MAP is about 16% better.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use $\ln\big(P(s_2)/P(s_1)\big)$, not its inverse. The inverse gives $\tau = -0.137$.

The figure below marks the threshold and the two error areas of Example 4.3.

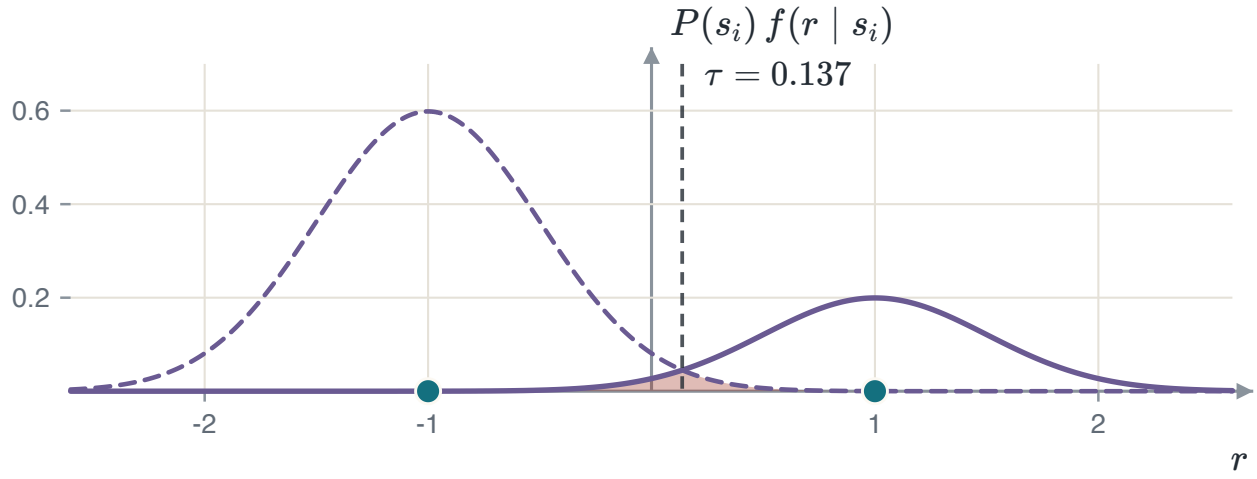


FIGURE 4.20 Example 4.3. Solid: $0.25\,f(r \mid s_1)$ at $+1$. Dashed: $0.75\,f(r \mid s_2)$ at -1. The two red areas are the two ways to be wrong, and their sum is $P_e = 0.0192$.

✎ EXAMPLE 4.4 — A RECEIVER FOR FOUR WAVEFORMS

GIVEN Four equally likely waveforms on $[0, 2)$. $s_1(t) = 2$ on $[0, 1)$ and $s_2(t) = 1$ on $[0, 2)$. $s_3(t)$ is -1 on $[0, 1)$ and 1 on $[1, 2)$, and $s_4(t) = -1$ on $[0, 2)$. $\mathbf{r} = (1.2, 0.3)$ arrives.

FIND The receiver and its decision for $\mathbf{r}$.

METHOD Every waveform is constant on each half, so two unit pulses form an orthonormal basis: $\psi_1 = 1$ on $[0, 1)$ and $\psi_2 = 1$ on $[1, 2)$. Read each point from the heights on the two halves.

$$\mathbf{s}_1 = (2, 0), \quad \mathbf{s}_2 = (1, 1), \quad \mathbf{s}_3 = (-1, 1), \quad \mathbf{s}_4 = (-1, -1)$$

The energies $E_i = \|\mathbf{s}_i\|^2$ are $4, 2, 2, 2$. They differ, so the metric keeps $-E_i/2$.

SOLUTION With equal priors the metric is $\mathbf{r}\cdot\mathbf{s}_i - E_i/2$.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{s}_1: &\quad 1.2(2) + 0.3(0) - 2 = 0.4 \\ \mathbf{s}_2: &\quad 1.2(1) + 0.3(1) - 1 = 0.5 \\ \mathbf{s}_3: &\quad 1.2(-1) + 0.3(1) - 1 = -1.9 \\ \mathbf{s}_4: &\quad 1.2(-1) + 0.3(-1) - 1 = -2.5 \end{aligned}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The largest is 0.5, so $\hat{s} = s_2$.

CHECK

$\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_1\|^2 = 0.8^2 + 0.3^2 = 0.73$ and $\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_2\|^2 = 0.2^2 + 0.7^2 = 0.53$. So $\mathbf{s}_2$ is also the nearest point, and $\mathbf{r}$ lies in its region.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use $\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_i - E_i/2$, not $\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_i$, if the energies differ. Correlation alone picks s_1.

The figure below draws the waveforms, the basis and the regions of Example 4.4.

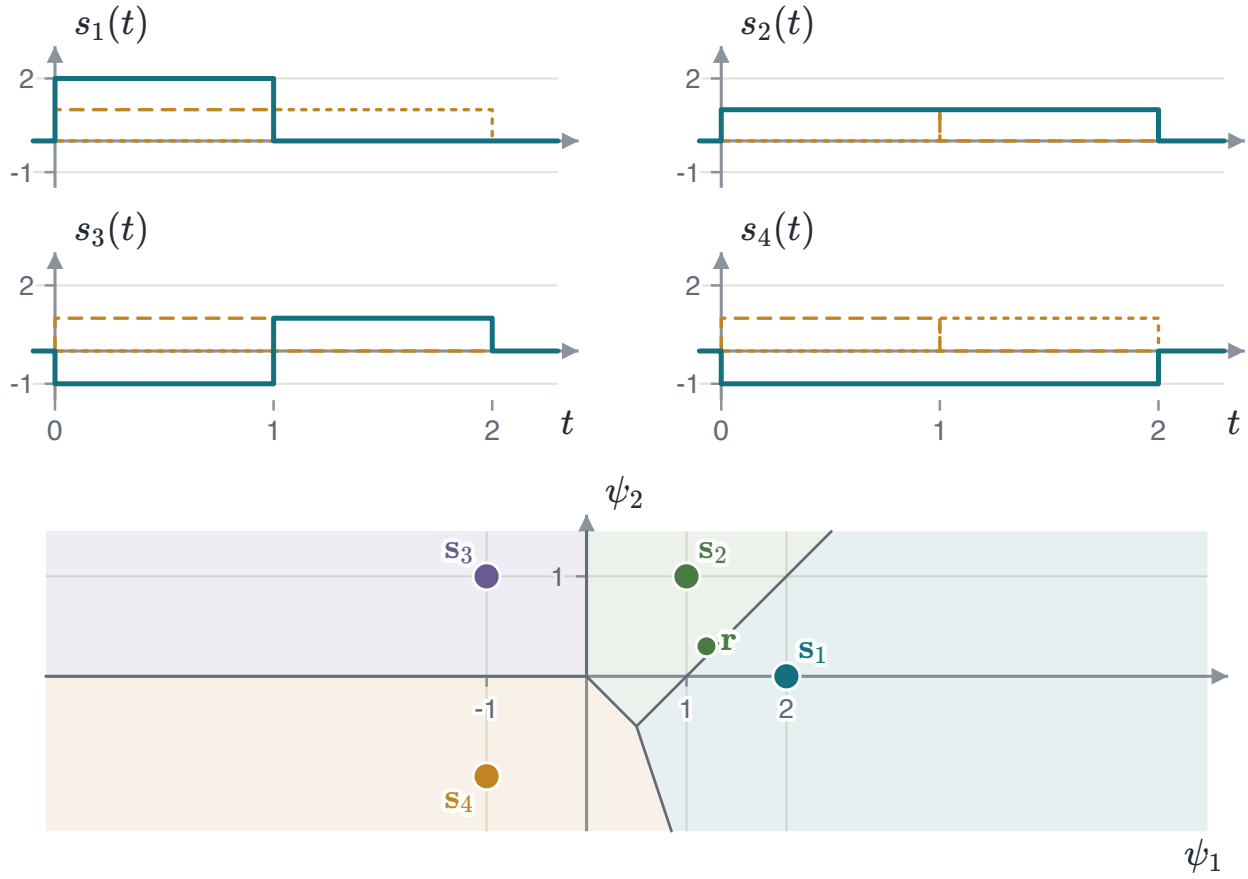


FIGURE 4.21 Example 4.4. Top: the four waveforms, with the two unit pulses dashed in amber. Bottom: the four points, the regions of the minimum-distance receiver, and $\mathbf{r} = (1.2, 0.3)$ in the region of $\mathbf{s}_2$.

Decision rules around us

Four everyday receivers use the MAP threshold, the energy term or the correlation receiver.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

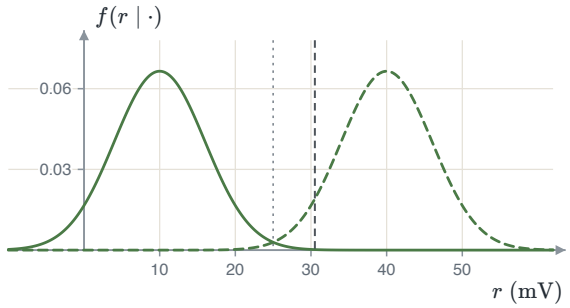


FIGURE 4.22 A smoke alarm reads 10 mV in clean air and 40 mV in smoke, with $\sigma = 6$ mV. Smoke is rare, $P = 0.01$, so the threshold moves from 25 to 30.5 mV.

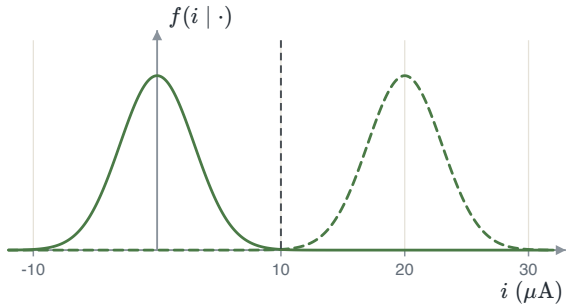


FIGURE 4.23 An optical receiver sees 0 or 20 μA. The energy term puts the threshold at 10 μA. With $\sigma = 3$ μA, $P_e = Q(10/3) = 4.3 \times 10^{-4}$.

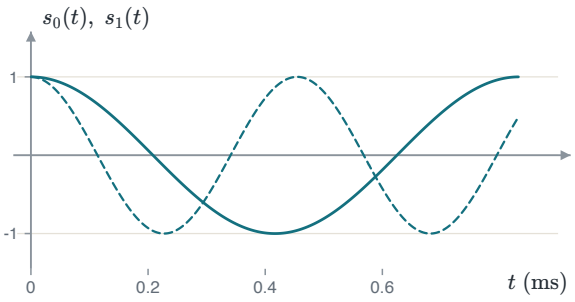


FIGURE 4.24 Caller ID sends 1200 Hz for a 1 and 2200 Hz for a 0. The receiver correlates with both tones over $T = 0.833$ ms: Method II.

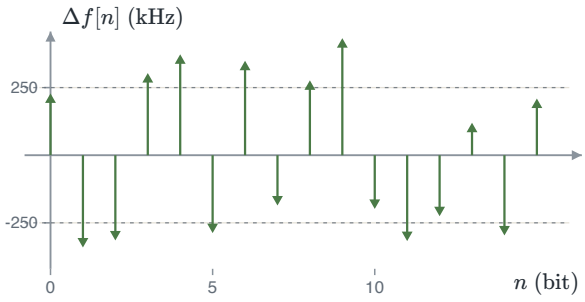


FIGURE 4.25 Bluetooth Low Energy shifts the carrier by about ± 250 kHz. With equal priors the receiver decides by the sign of each sample.

> ⓘ PRIORS MOVE THE THRESHOLD
>
> A rare event gets a smaller region. The threshold moves toward the less likely signal.

> ⓘ THE ENERGY TERM
>
> With unequal energies the metric keeps $-E_i/2$. For on-off keying that puts the threshold at half the on level.

> ⚠ UNKNOWN PRIORS
>
> When the priors are not known, the receiver uses ML. It is optimal only when the priors are equal.

4.3 Decision regions

Regions with equal priors

Group the observations that give the same decision. The space splits into M **decision regions**, one for each signal.

Start with two points. The points $\mathbf{r}$ equally far from $\mathbf{s}_i$ and $\mathbf{s}_j$ form a line, the **perpendicular bisector** of the segment between them. Expanding both squared distances shows why.

$$\begin{aligned} \|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_i\|^2 &= \|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_j\|^2 \\ -2\,\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_i + E_i &= -2\,\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_j + E_j \\ 2\,\mathbf{r} \cdot (\mathbf{s}_j - \mathbf{s}_i) &= E_j - E_i \end{aligned}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The $\|\mathbf{r}\|^2$ terms cancel, and the last line is linear in $\mathbf{r}$. So the boundary is a straight line, at right angles to $\mathbf{s}_j - \mathbf{s}_i$.

A REGION

$$R_i = \{\mathbf{r} : \ \|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_i\| < \|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_j\| \text{ for all } j \neq i\}$$

Each region is cut out by bisectors, so it is a convex polygon.

⚠ UNBOUNDED REGIONS

Outer points have regions that run off to infinity. Noise that pushes an outer point outward causes no error.

The figure below takes five equally likely points: the corners $(\pm 1.2, \pm 1.2)$ and the centre.

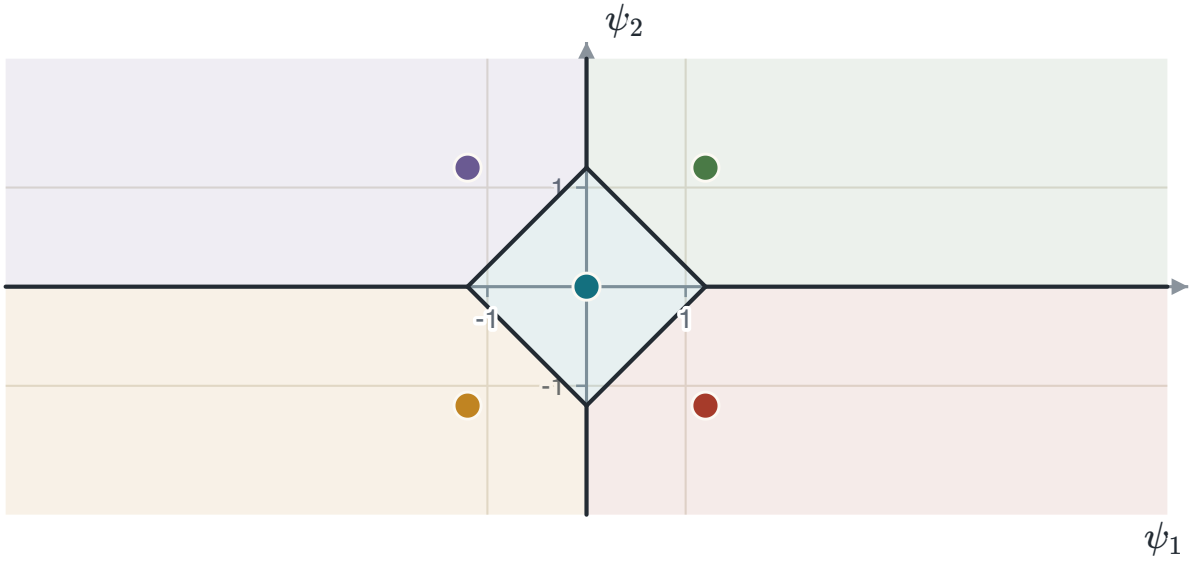


FIGURE 4.26 Five equally likely points and their regions. The centre region is the square $|r_1| + |r_2| < 1.2$, turned by $45°$. The four corner regions are unbounded.

The centre region has four straight faces. The bisector between $(0, 0)$ and $(1.2, 1.2)$ is $r_1 + r_2 = 1.2$. The other three corners give the other three faces.

Regions with unequal priors

With unequal priors the boundary between $\mathbf{s}_i$ and $\mathbf{s}_j$ is where the two MAP scores are equal.

A BOUNDARY

$$\|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_i\|^2 - N_0 \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i) = \|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{s}_j\|^2 - N_0 \ln P(\mathbf{s}_j)$$

The $\|\mathbf{r}\|^2$ terms still cancel. The boundary is still a straight line, parallel to the bisector.

To find where the line sits, measure along the segment from $\mathbf{s}_i$ to $\mathbf{s}_j$, which is d long. Put the boundary a distance x from $\mathbf{s}_i$.

$$x^2 - N_0 \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i) = (d - x)^2 - N_0 \ln P(\mathbf{s}_j)$$

$$2dx - d^2 = N_0 \ln \frac{P(\mathbf{s}_i)}{P(\mathbf{s}_j)}$$

Solve for x and call the result μ_i.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

THE SHIFT

$$\mu_i = \frac{d}{2} + \frac{N_0}{2d} \ln \frac{P(\mathbf{s}_i)}{P(\mathbf{s}_j)}$$

μ_i is the distance from $\mathbf{s}_i$ to its boundary with $\mathbf{s}_j$. A likely point pushes the line away from itself, toward the less likely point.

For example, take $d = 2$, $N_0 = 1$, $P(\mathbf{s}_i) = 0.8$ and $P(\mathbf{s}_j) = 0.2$. Then $\mu_i = 1 + \frac{1}{4} \ln 4 = 1 + 0.35 = 1.35$. The likely point keeps the larger share.

The figure below gives each of three points a prior, with $N_0 = 1$.

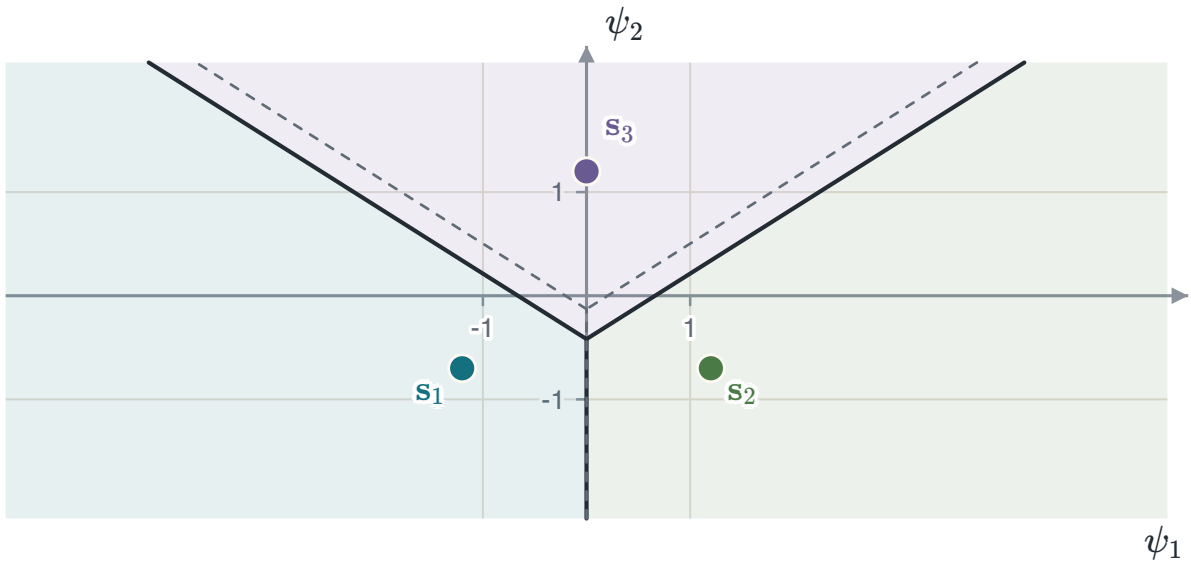


FIGURE 4.27 Three points with $N_0 = 1$, drawn for $P(\mathbf{s}_3) = 0.6$ and $P(\mathbf{s}_1) = P(\mathbf{s}_2) = 0.2$. Solid lines are the MAP boundaries, dashed lines the equal-prior ones. The likely $\mathbf{s}_3$ takes more of the plane.

Binary error probability

Two equally likely points a distance d apart give the simplest error probability. The boundary is the midpoint, $d/2$ from each point.

Only the noise along the line through the two points can cause an error. That component has variance $N_0/2$, and an error needs more than $d/2$ of it.

ALONG THE LINE

$$P_e = P\left(n > \frac{d}{2}\right) = Q\left(\frac{d/2}{\sqrt{N_0/2}}\right)$$
$$= Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{d^2}{2N_0}}\right)$$

Here $Q(x)$ is the Gaussian tail. The last step squares the argument: $(d/2)^2/(N_0/2) = d^2/2N_0$.

Put the distance of each special case into $d^2/2N_0$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TWO SPECIAL CASES

$$\text{antipodal, } d = 2\sqrt{E_b}: \qquad \frac{d^2}{2N_0} = \frac{2E_b}{N_0}, \qquad P_e = Q\big(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\big)$$

$$\text{orthogonal or on-off, } d = \sqrt{2E_b}: \qquad \frac{d^2}{2N_0} = \frac{E_b}{N_0}, \qquad P_e = Q\big(\sqrt{E_b/N_0}\big)$$

For example, $d = 2$ and $N_0 = 0.5$ give $d^2/2N_0 = 4/1 = 4$, so $P_e = Q(2) = 0.0228$.

The figure below draws the two densities along the line for $d = 2$ and $N_0 = 1$.

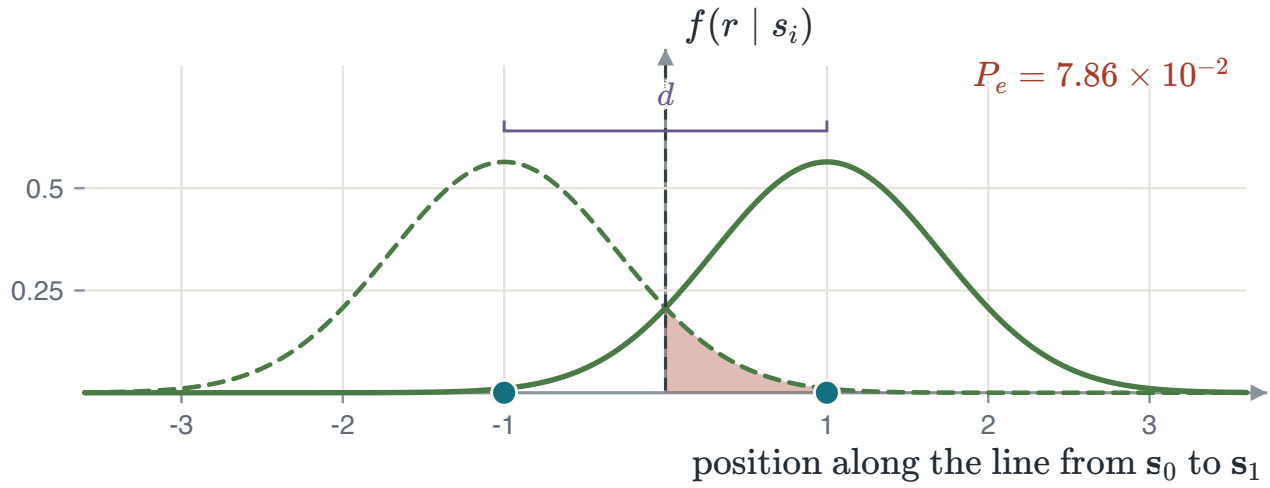


FIGURE 4.28 Two equally likely points $d = 2$ apart, with $N_0 = 1$. The red tail of the left density past the midpoint is $P_e = Q(\sqrt{2}) = 7.86 \times 10^{-2}$.

Binary error with unequal priors

With unequal priors the MAP boundary moves off the midpoint. Put s_0 and s_1 a distance d apart, with the boundary a distance μ from s_1.

THE BOUNDARY

$$\mu = \frac{d}{2} + \frac{N_0}{2d} \ln \frac{P(s_1)}{P(s_0)}$$

This is the shift μ_i above, with s_1 in the place of $\mathbf{s}_i$.

If s_0 is sent, an error needs noise past $d - \mu$. If s_1 is sent, it needs noise past μ. Weight each tail by its prior.

TWO TAILS

$$P_e = P(s_0)\, Q\left(\frac{d-\mu}{\sqrt{N_0/2}}\right) + P(s_1)\, Q\left(\frac{\mu}{\sqrt{N_0/2}}\right)$$

Equal priors give $\mu = d/2$ and the formula for two equally likely points.

For example, take $d = 2$, $N_0 = 0.5$ and $P(s_1) = 0.9$. The boundary and the error follow in two steps.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

$$\mu = 1 + \frac{0.5}{4}\ln\frac{0.9}{0.1} = 1 + 0.125(2.197) = 1.27$$
$$P_e = 0.1\,Q\!\left(\frac{2-1.27}{0.5}\right) + 0.9\,Q\!\left(\frac{1.27}{0.5}\right)$$
$$= 0.1\,Q(1.45) + 0.9\,Q(2.55) = 0.0122$$

The ML receiver keeps the midpoint and gets $Q(2) = 0.0228$. So the MAP receiver has the smaller P_e.

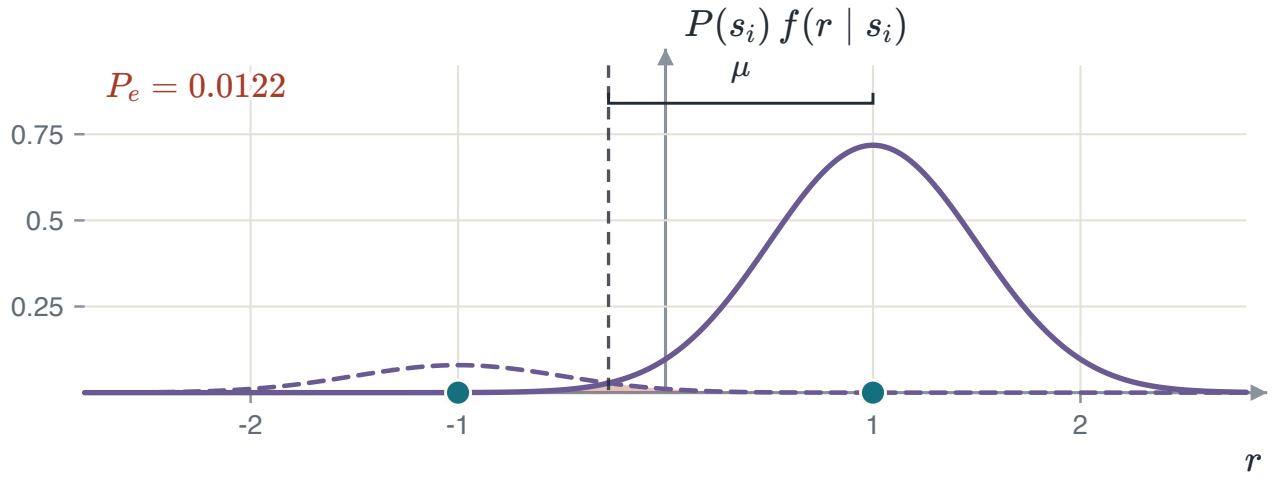


FIGURE 4.29 $s_0 = -1$ and $s_1 = +1$, so $d = 2$, with $N_0 = 0.5$, drawn for $P(s_1) = 0.9$. The boundary sits $\mu = 1.27$ from s_1, and the two red tails add up to $P_e = 0.0122$.

Decision regions around us

Four everyday systems decide in regions cut by bisectors.

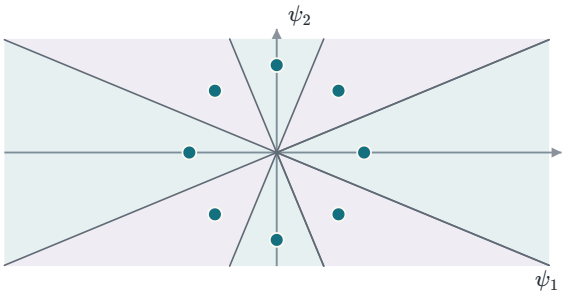


FIGURE 4.30 Satellite television can use 8PSK. Its regions are eight 45° sectors, so the receiver decides by the phase of $\mathbf{r}$ alone.

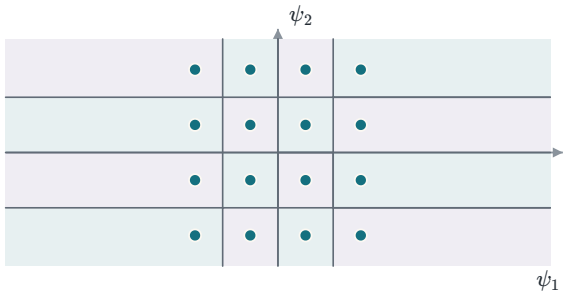


FIGURE 4.31 Wi-Fi 16-QAM at unit average energy has square regions of side $d_{\min} = 2/\sqrt{10} = 0.632$. The 12 outer ones are unbounded.

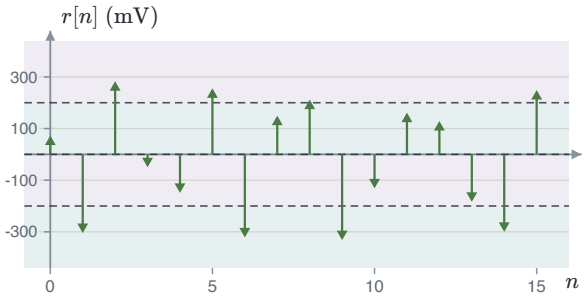


FIGURE 4.32 PAM4 in data-centre links sends ± 100 and ± 300 mV. The thresholds 0 and ± 200 mV cut the axis into four intervals.

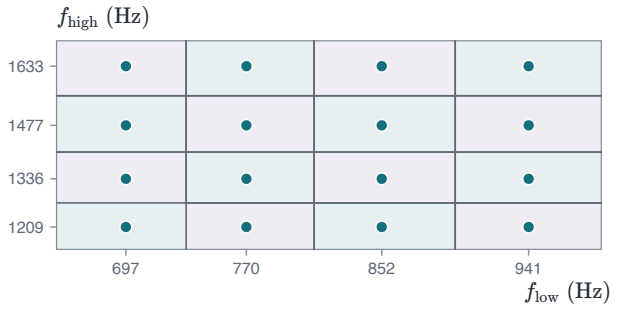


FIGURE 4.33 A phone key sends one low and one high tone. The receiver decides in rectangles with edges halfway between neighbouring tones.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

NEAREST POINT

In each system the receiver picks the signal point nearest to $\mathbf{r}$. The regions are cut by perpendicular bisectors.

OUTER REGIONS

Points on the edge of a constellation have unbounded regions. Noise can push them outward without an error.

SCALE

The regions hold only if the receiver knows the scale of the points. A gain error moves every point and every boundary.

4.4 Error probability and the union bound

The exact error probability

The exact error probability adds, over the signals, the part of each Gaussian bell that falls outside its region.

EXACT ERROR

$$P_e = \sum_{i=1}^{M} P(\mathbf{s}_i) \int_{\mathbf{r} \notin R_i} f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)\, d\mathbf{r}$$

Each term is the part of a Gaussian bell that falls outside a polygon.

NO CLOSED FORM

For most polygons this integral has no formula. It needs numerical integration or a simulation.

A **simulation** sends many symbols, adds noise and counts the wrong decisions. About 100 errors give a usable estimate. At $P_e = 10^{-4}$ that takes about $100/10^{-4} = 10^{6}$ symbols.

Sometimes the integral is easy. In the five-point set of Section 4.3, send the centre with $\sigma = 0.4$. Its region is the square $|r_1| + |r_2| < 1.2$, turned by 45°.

Turn the axes with the square. Each new noise component still has variance σ^2. The region becomes $|u_1| < a$ and $|u_2| < a$, with half-width $a = 1.2/\sqrt{2} = 0.849$.

$$\begin{aligned} P(\text{error} \mid \text{centre}) &= 1 - \big(1 - 2Q(a/\sigma)\big)^2 \\ &= 1 - \big(1 - 2Q(2.12)\big)^2 = 0.067 \end{aligned}$$

The figure below counts the draws that land outside the centre region.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

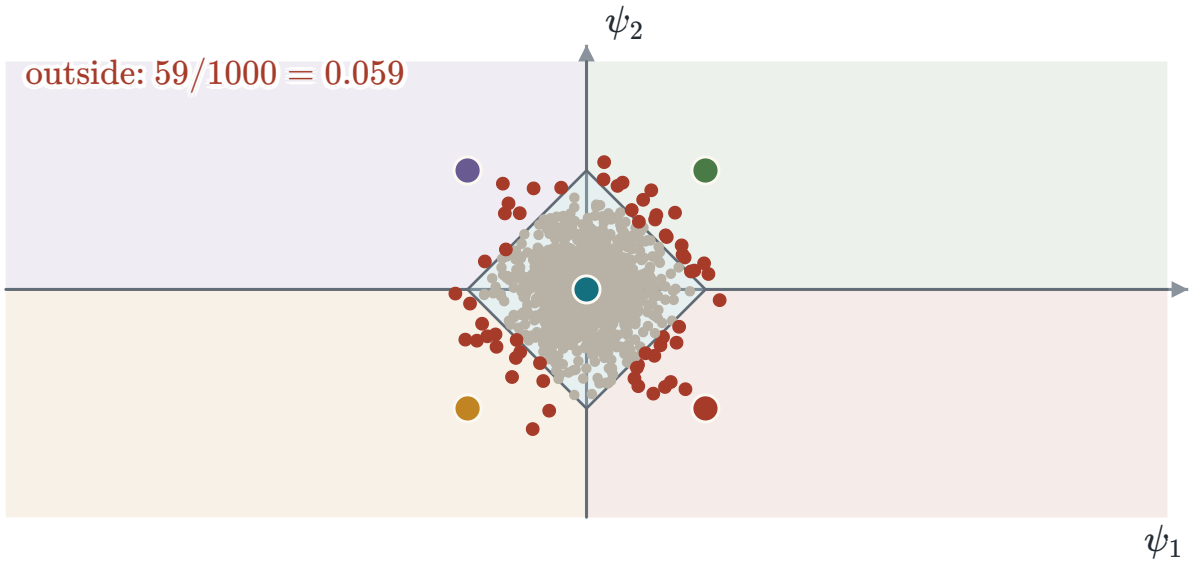


FIGURE 4.34 The centre point of the five-point set is sent with $\sigma = 0.4$, drawn for 1000 draws. The red draws fall outside its region, and their fraction settles near the exact 0.067.

The union bound

The union bound avoids the integral. Suppose $\mathbf{s}_i$ was sent, and let A_{ij} be the event that $\mathbf{r}$ is nearer $\mathbf{s}_j$ than $\mathbf{s}_i$.

An error happens when at least one A_{ij} happens, so the error is the union of these events. The probability of a union is at most the sum of the probabilities.

PAIRWISE EVENTS

$$P(\text{error} \mid \mathbf{s}_i) \le \sum_{j \neq i} P(A_{ij})$$

$$P(A_{ij}) = Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{d_{ij}^2}{2N_0}}\right)$$

Each A_{ij} is a binary error between two points at distance d_{ij}. So its probability is the binary result of Section 4.3.

OVERLAPS COUNTED TWICE

The events overlap. The sum counts each overlap more than once, so it can only be larger than the true probability.

Average over the signals with equal priors $1/M$. This gives the union bound, which needs only the distances between the points.

UNION BOUND

$$P_e \le \frac{1}{M} \sum_{i=1}^{M} \sum_{j \neq i} Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{d_{ij}^2}{2N_0}}\right)$$

The figure below draws the three half-planes for $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$ of the square.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

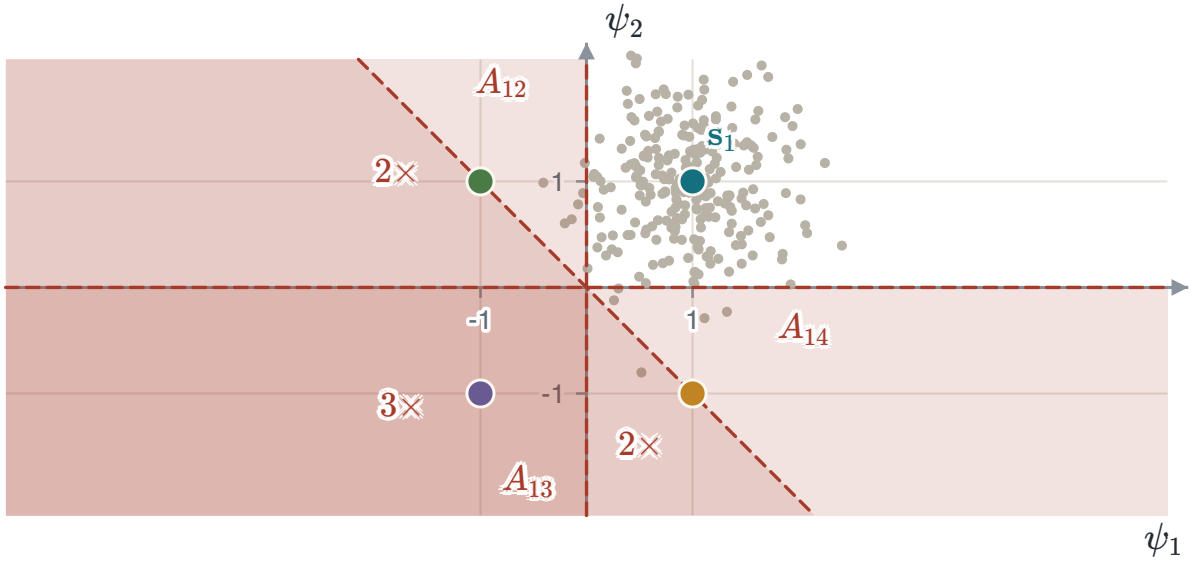


FIGURE 4.35 $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$ is sent, and the grey dots are received points. Each red half-plane A_{1j} is where $\mathbf{r}$ is nearer $\mathbf{s}_j$. The labels mark the parts the sum counts two or three times.

For $\mathbf{s}_1$ the bound has $M - 1 = 3$ terms. Two are for the points at $d = 2$, and one is for the diagonal point at $2\sqrt{2}$.

The minimum-distance bound

Every d_{ij} is at least the smallest distance $d_{\min}$, and Q falls as its argument grows. So each term is at most the term at $d_{\min}$.

MINIMUM-DISTANCE BOUND

$$P_e \le (M - 1)\, Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{d_{\min}^2}{2N_0}}\right)$$

Each of the M signals has $M - 1$ terms, each at most $Q\left(\sqrt{d_{\min}^2/2N_0}\right)$. The average over the M signals leaves $M - 1$ of them.

ONE NUMBER

The bound needs only M and the smallest distance. It is quick, and loose when few pairs sit at $d_{\min}$.

8-PSK puts $M = 8$ points on a circle of radius $\sqrt{E_s}$. The point j steps away sits at $d_j = 2\sqrt{E_s}\sin(\pi j/8)$. With $E_s = 1$, $d_{\min} = 2\sin(\pi/8) = 2(0.383) = 0.77$.

Only two of the seven other points sit at $d_{\min}$. So the bound, which puts all seven there, is loose.

The figure below compares it with the union bound for 8-PSK. Each term uses $d_j^2/2N_0 = (2E_s/N_0)\sin^2(\pi j/8)$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

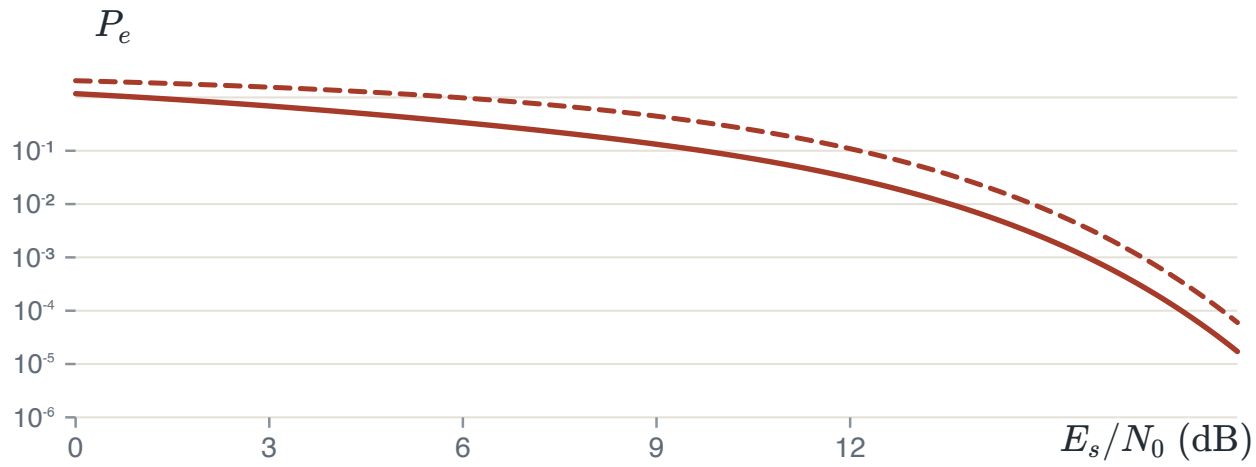


FIGURE 4.36 8-PSK. Solid: the union bound, the sum of all seven pairwise terms. Dashed: the minimum-distance bound, with every distance replaced by $d_{\min}$. The dashed curve stays above.

An exponential bound

The function $Q(x)$ has no closed form. A plain exponential sits above it for every $x \geq 0$.

EXPONENTIAL BOUND

$$Q(x) \leq \tfrac{1}{2} e^{-x^2/2}, \qquad x \geq 0$$

Put $x^2 = d_{\min}^2 / 2N_0$ into the minimum-distance bound. Then $x^2/2 = d_{\min}^2 / 4N_0$.

APPLIED TO THE BOUND

$$P_e \leq \frac{M-1}{2}\, e^{-d_{\min}^2/4N_0}$$

The error falls exponentially in $d_{\min}^2/N_0$.

For example, at $x = 3$ the bound is $\frac{1}{2}e^{-4.5} = 5.6 \times 10^{-3}$ against $Q(3) = 1.35 \times 10^{-3}$. It is about 4.1 times larger. The figure below draws both on a logarithmic axis.

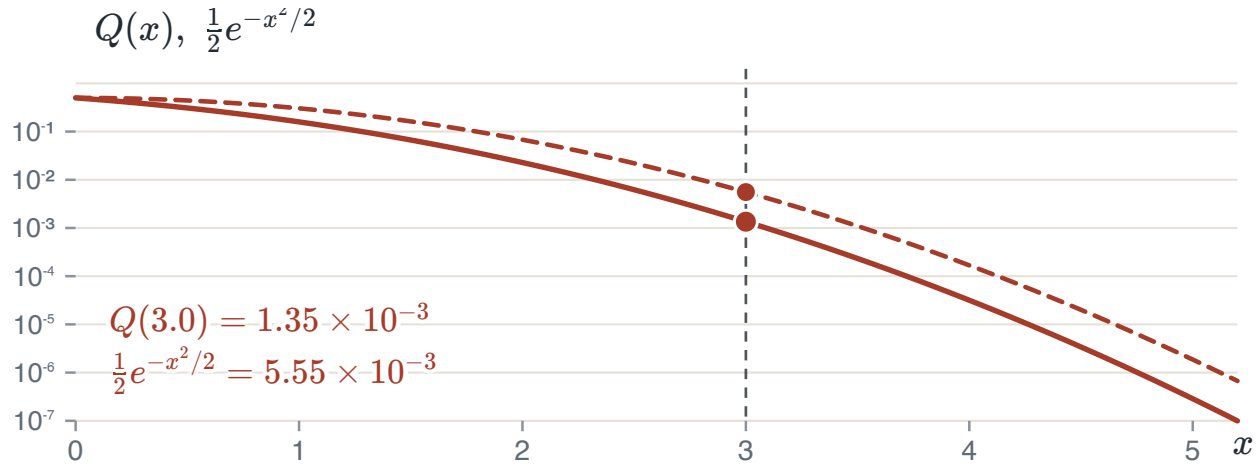


FIGURE 4.37 Solid: $Q(x)$. Dashed: $\frac{1}{2}e^{-x^2/2}$, marked at $x = 3$. The bound stays above $Q(x)$, and both fall with the same exponent.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The intelligent union bound

To leave R_i, the point $\mathbf{r}$ must cross one of the faces of R_i. So keep the terms for the points that share a face with R_i, a set written F_i. Drop the others.

INTELLIGENT UNION BOUND

$$P(\text{error} \mid \mathbf{s}_i) \leq \sum_{j \in F_i} Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{d_{ij}^2}{2N_0}}\right)$$

The bound is tighter than the general union bound, and still a bound.

In the square, the region of $\mathbf{s}_1$ is the first quadrant. The figure below marks its two faces, shared with $\mathbf{s}_2$ and $\mathbf{s}_4$. So the bound keeps two terms and drops the term for $\mathbf{s}_3$.

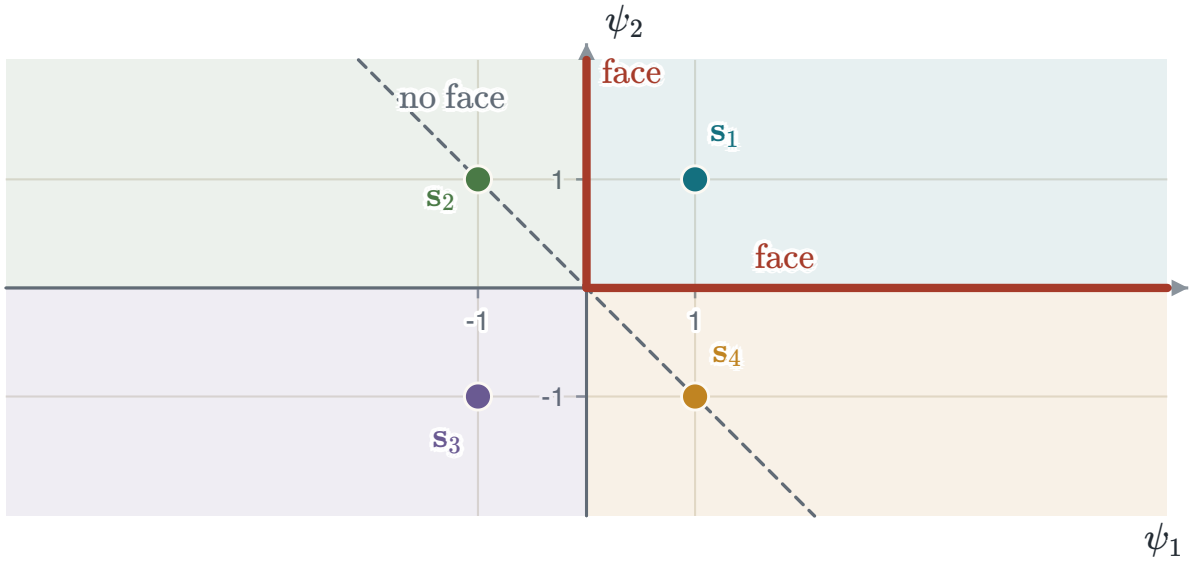


FIGURE 4.38 The region of $\mathbf{s}_1$ is the first quadrant. Its two faces, in red, are shared with $\mathbf{s}_2$ and $\mathbf{s}_4$. The bisector with $\mathbf{s}_3$, dashed, only touches the corner.

Nearest neighbours

At high SNR the terms at $d_{\min}$ are far larger than the others. Keeping only those terms gives the nearest-neighbour form.

NEAREST NEIGHBOURS

$$P_e \approx \bar{N}_{\min}\, Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{d_{\min}^2}{2N_0}}\right)$$

$\bar{N}_{\min}$ is the average number of neighbours at $d_{\min}$, taken over the M points.

⚠ AN APPROXIMATION

It keeps only part of the union bound, so it is not a bound. It can sit below the exact P_e.

In QPSK on the square $(\pm 1, \pm 1)$, each point has two neighbours at $d_{\min} = 2$. The diagonal point is at $2\sqrt{2}$, so $\bar{N}_{\min} = 2$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

In 16-QAM on the grid $\pm 1, \pm 3$, $d_{\min} = 2$. The four corners have two neighbours at $d_{\min}$, the eight edge points three, and the four inner points four.

$$\bar{N}_{\min} = \frac{4(2) + 8(3) + 4(4)}{16} = \frac{48}{16} = 3$$

The figure below joins every pair of neighbours in 16-QAM.

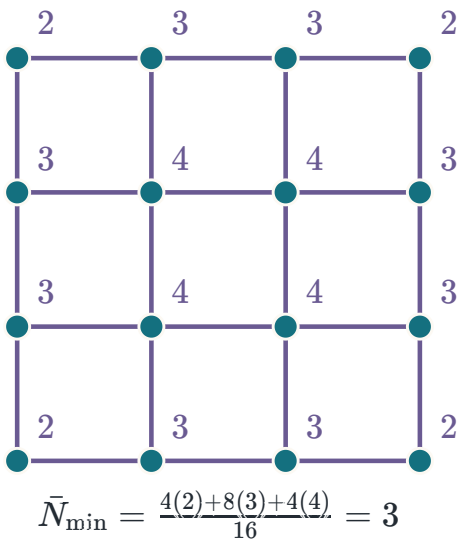


FIGURE 4.39 16-QAM on the grid $\pm 1, \pm 3$. Each line joins two neighbours at $d_{\min} = 2$, and each number counts the neighbours of its point.

EXAMPLE 4.5 — FOUR FORMS ON QPSK

GIVEN — QPSK at $(\pm 1, \pm 1)$, equally likely, with $N_0 = 2/9$. So $d_{\min}^2 / 2N_0 = 4/(4/9) = 9$.

FIND — The general union bound, the intelligent bound, the nearest-neighbour form and the minimum-distance bound. Which is largest?

METHOD — From $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1, 1)$, two points are at $d = 2$, which gives $x = \sqrt{9} = 3$. One is at $2\sqrt{2}$, which gives $x = \sqrt{8/(4/9)} = \sqrt{18} = 4.24$. The region of $\mathbf{s}_1$ is a quadrant with two faces, and all four points are alike.

$$Q(3) = 1.35 \times 10^{-3}, \qquad Q(4.24) = 1.1 \times 10^{-5}$$

SOLUTION

$$\begin{aligned} \text{general} &= 2Q(3) + Q(4.24) = 2.71 \times 10^{-3} \\ \text{intelligent} = \text{nearest} &= 2Q(3) = 2.70 \times 10^{-3} \\ d_{\min}\ \text{bound} &= 3Q(3) = 4.05 \times 10^{-3} \end{aligned}$$

The minimum-distance bound is the largest. It counts three terms at $Q(3)$, and the others count two plus a tiny diagonal term.

CHECK — The regions are quadrants, so each noise component acts on its own. The exact value is $1 - \big(1 - Q(3)\big)^2 = 2.70 \times 10^{-3}$. The diagonal term adds only 0.4%.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $\bar{N}_{\min} = 2$, not 3. The diagonal point is at $2\sqrt{2}$, not at $d_{\min} = 2$.

The figure below shows the nearest neighbours of $\mathbf{s}_1$ in Example 4.5.

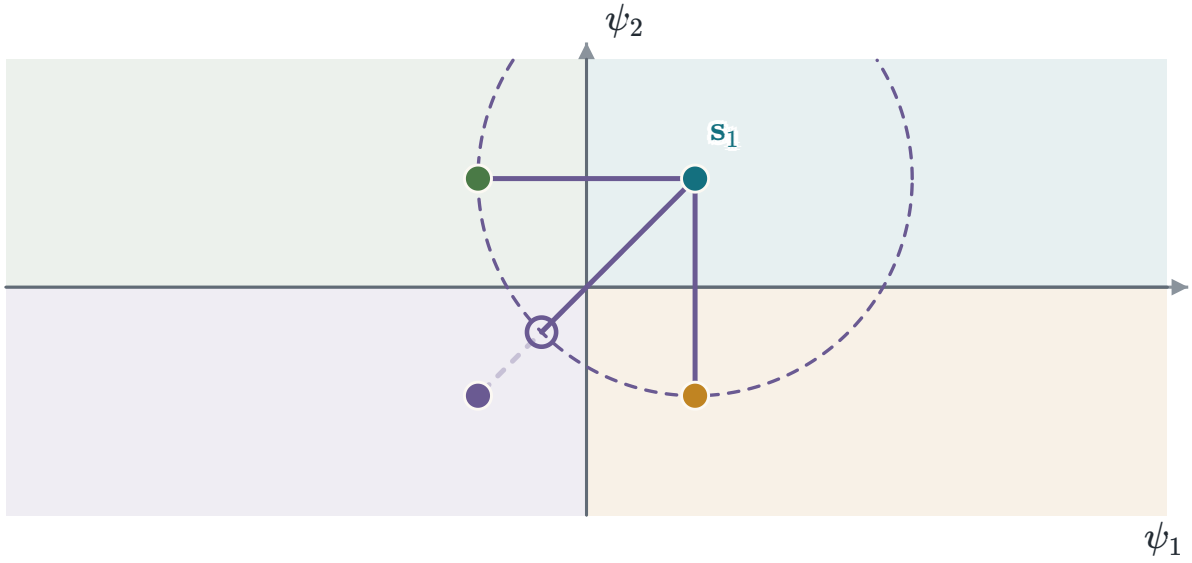


FIGURE 4.40 Example 4.5 from $\mathbf{s}_1$. The dashed circle of radius $d_{\min}$ passes through the two nearest neighbours. The minimum-distance bound moves the diagonal point in to $d_{\min}$, ringed.

✎ EXAMPLE 4.6 — A RECTANGLE

GIVEN Four equally likely points $(\pm 1.5, \pm 1)$ with $N_0 = 0.4$.

FIND The intelligent bound and the nearest-neighbour form. Which point shares a face with $\mathbf{s}_1 = (1.5, 1)$ but is not a nearest neighbour?

METHOD From $\mathbf{s}_1$ the others are at 3, 2 and $\sqrt{13}$. The region of $\mathbf{s}_1$ is the first quadrant, and its faces are shared with the points at 3 and 2. Each Q argument is $d/\sqrt{2N_0} = d/\sqrt{0.8}$.

$$d = 2: \; Q(2.24) = 1.27 \times 10^{-2}, \qquad d = 3: \; Q(3.35) = 4.0 \times 10^{-4}$$

SOLUTION

$$\text{intelligent} = Q(2.24) + Q(3.35) = 1.31 \times 10^{-2}$$
$$\text{nearest} = \bar{N}_{\min}\, Q(2.24) = 1.27 \times 10^{-2}$$

Each point has one neighbour at $d_{\min} = 2$, so $\bar{N}_{\min} = 1$. The point $(-1.5, 1)$ shares the face $r_1 = 0$ but sits at 3, more than $d_{\min}$.

CHECK The regions are quadrants, so the exact value is $1 - \big(1 - Q(3.35)\big)\big(1 - Q(2.24)\big) = 1.31 \times 10^{-2}$. The nearest-neighbour form is 3% below it, so it is not a bound.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
>
> Use $Q(2.24) + Q(3.35)$ for both faces, not only $Q(2.24)$ for the nearest neighbour.

The figure below marks the faces and the nearest neighbour of $\mathbf{s}_1$ in Example 4.6.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

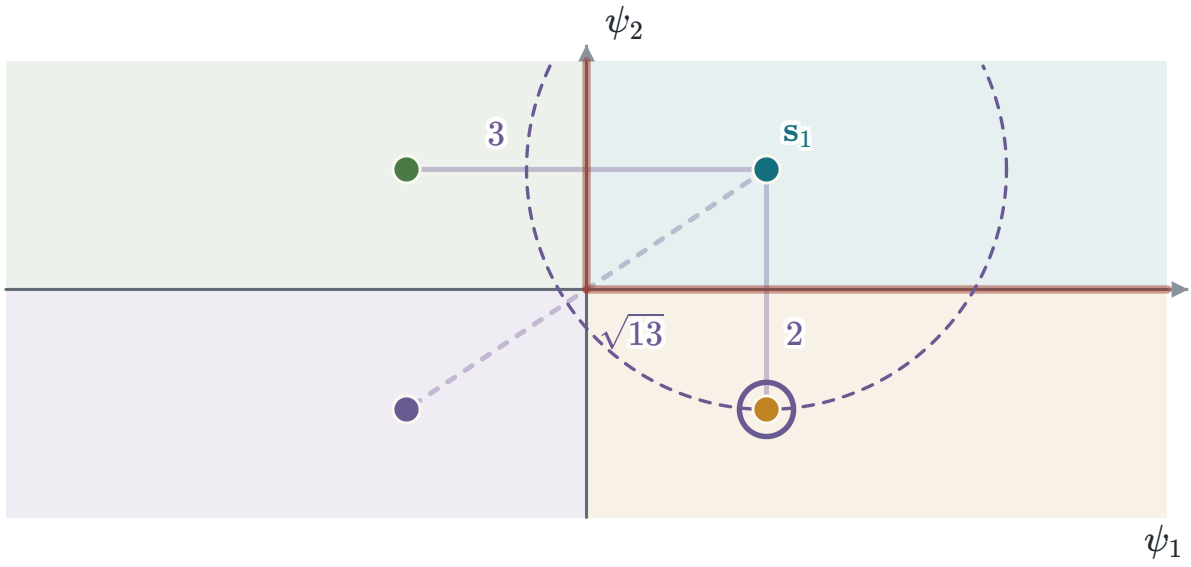


FIGURE 4.41 Example 4.6. The two red faces of R_1 are shared with the points at 3 and 2. The dashed circle of radius $d_{\min} = 2$ passes through one nearest neighbour, ringed.

Tightness of the bounds

The bounds differ most at low SNR. Many terms are then large, and they overlap.

> LOW SNR
>
> The union bound can pass 1 and then tells nothing. For 16-QAM with $E_s = 10$ at $E_s/N_0 = 0$ dB, it adds 15 heavily overlapping terms and gives 2.79.

> HIGH SNR
>
> The terms at $d_{\min}$ dominate. The union bound, the nearest-neighbour form and the simulation meet.

> THE MINIMUM-DISTANCE BOUND
>
> It counts all 15 other points at $d_{\min}$, five times the $\bar{N}_{\min} = 3$ of 16-QAM. So it stays five times too high.

The figure below compares the three forms with a simulation for 16-QAM.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

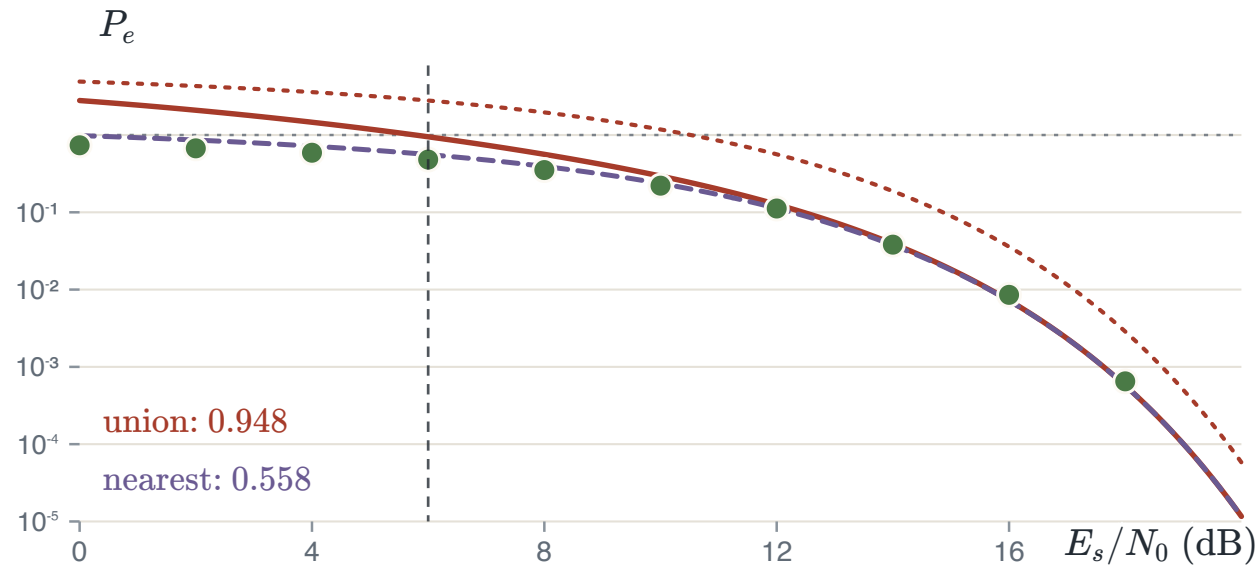


FIGURE 4.42 16-QAM with $E_s = 10$, marked at $E_s/N_0 = 6$ dB. Solid red: the union bound. Dotted red: the minimum-distance bound. Dashed violet: the nearest-neighbour form. Green dots: a simulation of $20\,000$ symbols. The dashed line at the top is $P_e = 1$.

Error probability around us

Wi-Fi, LTE and 5G use the nearest-neighbour form and the union bound, and a tester measures the error rate.

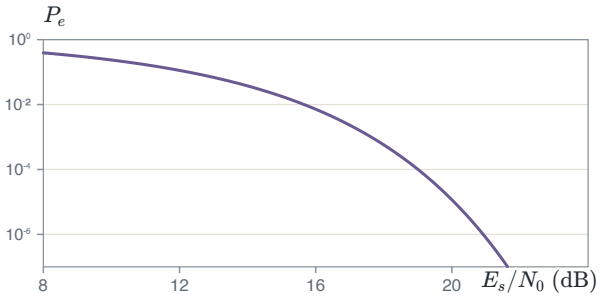


FIGURE 4.43 Wi-Fi 16-QAM has $d^2_{\min} = 0.4E_s$ and $\bar{N}_{\min} = 3$. The nearest-neighbour form is $P_e \approx 3Q\left(\sqrt{E_s/5N_0}\right)$.

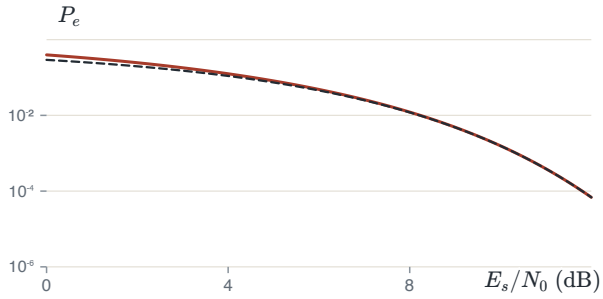


FIGURE 4.44 LTE control channels use QPSK. Solid: the union bound. Dashed: the exact P_e. They differ by less than 1% above 10 dB.

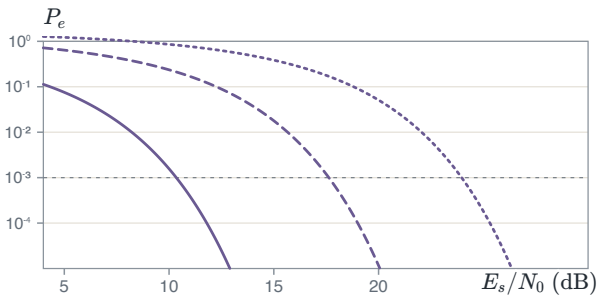


FIGURE 4.45 A 5G phone picks its modulation from the channel. For $P_e = 10^{-3}$, QPSK, 16-QAM and 64-QAM need about 10.3, 17.6 and 24.0 dB.

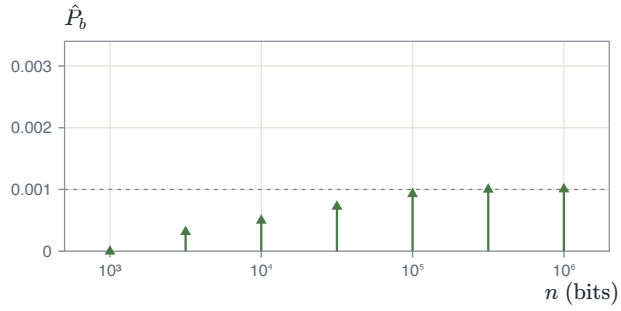


FIGURE 4.46 A bit-error-rate tester divides the errors by the bits sent. At $P_b = 10^{-3}$ the estimate settles once about 100 errors are in.

> **NEAREST NEIGHBOURS FIRST**
>
> At useful error rates the terms at $d_{\min}$ dominate. Designers quote $\bar{N}_{\min} Q\left(\sqrt{d^2_{\min}/2N_0}\right)$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

ⓘ A TARGET ERROR RATE

A link fixes a target such as 10^{-3}. Each constellation then needs its own E_s/N_0.

⚠ FEW ERRORS

An error rate measured from a few errors is noisy. A tester waits for about 100 errors.

4.5 Summary

From waveform to error rate

The figure below follows one symbol through the receiver and then repeats it.

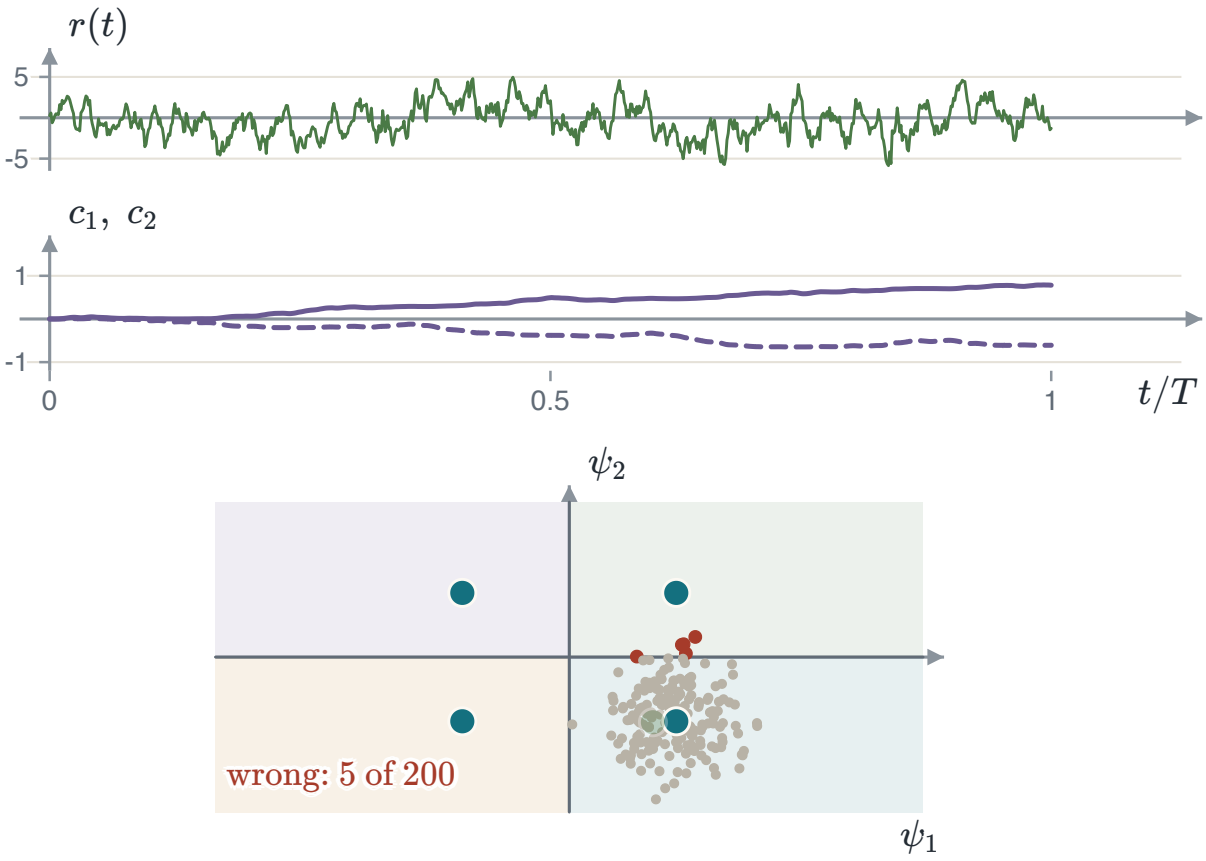


FIGURE 4.47 One symbol through the receiver: $r(t)$, the correlator outputs c_1 and c_2, and the regions of four points $(\pm 1, \pm 0.6)$. The 200 repeats with $\sigma = 0.3$ estimate P_e, and the wrong ones are red.

The receiver of this chapter makes four moves.

1. Correlate $r(t)$ with the basis to get $\mathbf{r}$.
2. Pick the best metric: the nearest point for equal priors.
3. Read the regions from the bisectors.
4. Bound P_e from the distances.

Each modulation of Chapter 5 is a constellation. Its error rate follows from its distances and this receiver.

For example, take QPSK with $d_{\min}^2/2N_0 = 16$. Here $\bar{N}_{\min} = 2$ and $Q(4) = 3.17 \times 10^{-5}$, so the nearest-neighbour form gives $P_e \approx 6.3 \times 10^{-5}$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Quick check

1 A set of $M = 32$ signals. How many bits does each symbol carry?
Answer: 5 bits, since $\log_2 32 = 5$.

2 $N_0 = 0.4$. What is the noise variance of each correlator output?
Answer: $N_0/2 = 0.2$.

3 $\mathbf{r} = (0.2, 0.9)$, with $(0, 1)$ and $(1, 0)$ equally likely. Which point does the receiver pick?
Answer: $(0, 1)$. The squared distances are 0.05 and 1.45, and the smaller wins.

4 $P(\mathbf{s}_1)$ rises. Which way does the boundary between $\mathbf{s}_1$ and $\mathbf{s}_2$ move?
Answer: Away from $\mathbf{s}_1$. A likely point gets a larger region, so the line moves toward $\mathbf{s}_2$.

5 Two equally likely points, $d = 2$ and $N_0 = 2$. What is P_e?
Answer: $Q(1)$, since $d^2/2N_0 = 4/4 = 1$.

6 A set of $M = 8$ points. For one sent point, how many terms does the general union bound have?
Answer: 7 terms, one for each other point, $M - 1 = 7$.

Summary of results

TABLE 4.1 Summary of Chapter 4: the optimal receiver in additive white Gaussian noise.

RESULT	STATEMENT	ANCHOR
Bits and symbols	$k = \log_2 M$, so $R_b = kR_s$ and $T_b = T/k$	PS CH8.4
Correlator bank	$\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{s}_i + \mathbf{n}$, with $r_j = \int_0^T r(t)\,\psi_j(t)\,dt$	PS CH8.4.1
Matched filter	the same number at the sampling time $t = T$, with impulse response $\psi_j(T - t)$	PS CH8.4.1
Noise outside the signal space	does not depend on the signal and adds the same $\|n'\|^2$ to every distance	PS CH8.4.1
Noise components	independent Gaussians with mean 0 and variance $N_0/2$. The cloud is round	PS CH8.4.1
MAP and ML	MAP maximises $P(\mathbf{s}_i)\,f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)$. With equal priors it is ML	PS CH8.4.1
Minimum distance	ML in Gaussian noise. MAP subtracts $N_0 \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i)$ from each squared distance	PS CH8.4.1
Correlation metric	$\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_i - E_i/2 + \frac{N_0}{2} \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i)$. Keep the largest	PS CH8.4.1
Decision regions	convex polygons cut by bisectors. Unequal priors shift each line toward the less likely point	PS CH8.4.1
Binary error	$Q\left(\sqrt{d^2/2N_0}\right)$ for equal priors	PS CH8.3.3, 8.4.2
Union bound	$P_e \le \frac{1}{M} \sum_i \sum_{j \ne i} Q\left(\sqrt{d_{ij}^2/2N_0}\right)$. The intelligent bound keeps only faces	PS CH8.4.2
Nearest neighbours	$\bar{N}_{\min} Q\left(\sqrt{d_{\min}^2/2N_0}\right)$. Close at high SNR, but not a bound	

Correlate to get $\mathbf{r}$, pick the best metric, and bound P_e from the distances. Chapter 5 uses this receiver for every modulation.

Projects to try

Four optional projects use the chapter on simulated signals. Each gives an aim, what it practises, a few steps and what to look for.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

A CORRELATION RECEIVER FROM SAMPLES

Build the whole receiver for QPSK from sampled waveforms and measure how often it is wrong.

Practises: correlators computed as sums over samples. Scaling noise to a chosen N_0. Counting errors to estimate P_e.

1. Build two carrier basis functions over one symbol at 100 samples.
2. Send random QPSK symbols and add Gaussian noise of variance $N_0/2$ to each sample, scaled for the sample spacing.
3. Correlate, pick the nearest point and count the errors.
4. Repeat at several N_0 and plot P_e on a log axis.

Look for: the measured points follow $2Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$ once enough errors are counted.

MAP AGAINST ML

See how much a receiver gains by knowing the priors.

Practises: the MAP threshold for a binary link. Why the gain grows as the priors become uneven. What happens when the assumed priors are wrong.

1. Send antipodal bits with $P(s_1) = p$ for several p from 0.5 to 0.95.
2. Decide each with the midpoint and with the MAP threshold.
3. Plot both error rates against p.
4. Decide with a threshold built for the wrong p.

Look for: the two receivers agree at $p = 0.5$. The MAP receiver pulls ahead as p grows, and a wrong prior can do worse than ML.

DECISION REGIONS ON A GRID

Draw the regions of any constellation by deciding every point of a fine grid.

Practises: minimum distance as a rule you can run anywhere. How priors move the boundaries. Why the regions are convex polygons.

1. Pick a constellation of five to eight points.
2. Decide every point of a 400×400 grid and colour it by the answer.
3. Give one point a larger prior and redraw.
4. Compare the boundaries with the perpendicular bisectors.

Look for: every boundary is a straight line. A larger prior pushes its point's boundaries outward, parallel to themselves.

TIGHTNESS OF THE UNION BOUND

Compare the union bound and its variants with a simulation across SNR.

Practises: the general and intelligent union bounds. The nearest-neighbour form. Where each is close to the truth.

1. Take 8-PSK and 16-QAM at unit average energy.
2. Compute every bound from the pairwise distances.
3. Simulate at SNR from 0 to 20 dB.
4. Plot all on one log axis and read the gap at each SNR.

Look for: at low SNR the general bound can pass 1. At high SNR all the curves close in on the simulation.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CHAPTER

5

Digital modulation methods

A carrier has an amplitude, a phase and a frequency. Keying one of them, or two at once, puts bits on the carrier. Every scheme of this chapter is a set of points. Its error rate follows from their distances, through the receiver of Chapter 4. More points carry more bits. PSK and QAM pay for them in energy, and orthogonal signals pay in band.

5.1 Putting bits on a carrier

Bits on a carrier

A baseband signal $s(t)$ has its spectrum near $f = 0$. Multiplying it by a carrier $\cos(2\pi f_c t)$ moves that spectrum to $\pm f_c$. To see this, write the cosine as two complex exponentials.

$$u(t) = s(t)\cos(2\pi f_c t) = \tfrac{1}{2}s(t)\,e^{j2\pi f_c t} + \tfrac{1}{2}s(t)\,e^{-j2\pi f_c t}$$

Multiplying a signal by $e^{j2\pi f_c t}$ shifts its spectrum up by f_c. Apply this to each term.

> MODULATION SHIFTS THE SPECTRUM
>
> $$u(t) = s(t)\cos(2\pi f_c t) \implies U(f) = \tfrac{1}{2}S(f - f_c) + \tfrac{1}{2}S(f + f_c)$$
>
> Each copy keeps the shape of $S(f)$ at half the height.

The carrier also halves the energy. Use $\cos^2 x = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2}\cos 2x$ under the integral.

$$\begin{aligned}\int s^2(t)\cos^2(2\pi f_c t)\,dt &= \tfrac{1}{2}\int s^2(t)\,dt + \tfrac{1}{2}\int s^2(t)\cos(4\pi f_c t)\,dt \\ &\approx \tfrac{1}{2}E_s\end{aligned}$$

The second integral nearly vanishes when $f_c \gg W$. There $s^2(t)$ changes slowly while the cosine swings through many cycles, so its positive and negative parts cancel.

Each copy runs from $f_c - W$ to $f_c + W$. The passband signal needs a band of $2W$, twice the baseband width. For example, $W = 5$ kHz on a 40 kHz carrier occupies 35 to 45 kHz, a band of $2W = 10$ kHz.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

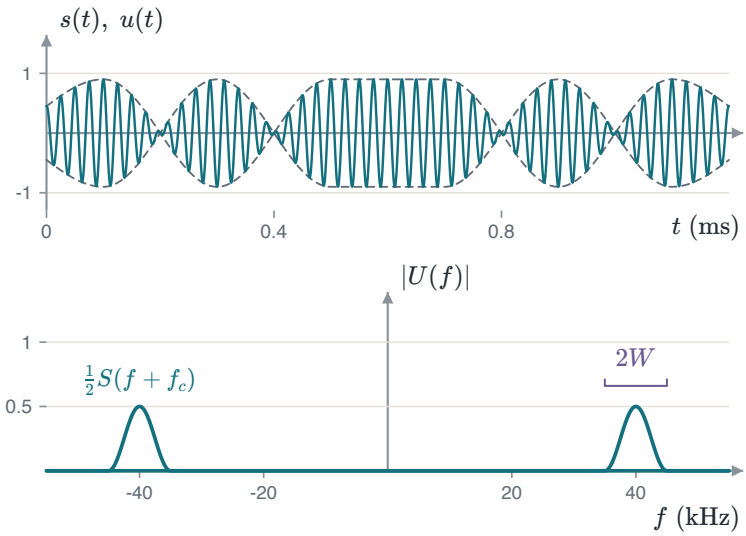


FIGURE 5.1 A baseband pulse stream $s(t)$ with band $W = 5$ kHz, and its product $u(t)$ with a 40 kHz carrier (top). The spectrum of $u(t)$ holds two half-height copies at $\pm f_c$, each $2W$ wide (bottom).

The IQ modulator

Two baseband numbers can share one carrier frequency. The IQ modulator puts I on the cosine and Q on the sine.

THE IQ MODULATOR

$$s(t) = I\cos(2\pi f_c t) - Q\sin(2\pi f_c t)$$

Two baseband numbers ride two carriers 90° apart. One point (I, Q) of the plane is one symbol.

The same point can be written in polar form. Put $I = A\cos\theta$ and $Q = A\sin\theta$, then use $\cos(a+b) = \cos a\cos b - \sin a\sin b$.

$$\begin{aligned} A\cos(2\pi f_c t + \theta) &= A\cos\theta\cos(2\pi f_c t) - A\sin\theta\sin(2\pi f_c t) \\ &= I\cos(2\pi f_c t) - Q\sin(2\pi f_c t) \end{aligned}$$

AMPLITUDE AND PHASE

$$s(t) = A\cos(2\pi f_c t + \theta), \qquad A = \sqrt{I^2 + Q^2}, \quad \theta = \operatorname{atan2}(Q, I)$$

PSK moves only θ and ASK moves only A.

The cosine and the sine carriers are orthogonal. Their product is $\cos x \sin x = \frac{1}{2}\sin 2x$, which averages to zero over many carrier cycles.

$$\int \cos(2\pi f_c t)\sin(2\pi f_c t)\,dt = \tfrac{1}{2}\int \sin(4\pi f_c t)\,dt \approx 0$$

So a correlator on the cosine sees I alone, and one on the sine sees Q alone. For example, the symbol $(I, Q) = (-1, +1)$ lies in the second quadrant, so its carrier phase is $\theta = \operatorname{atan2}(1, -1) = 135^\circ$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

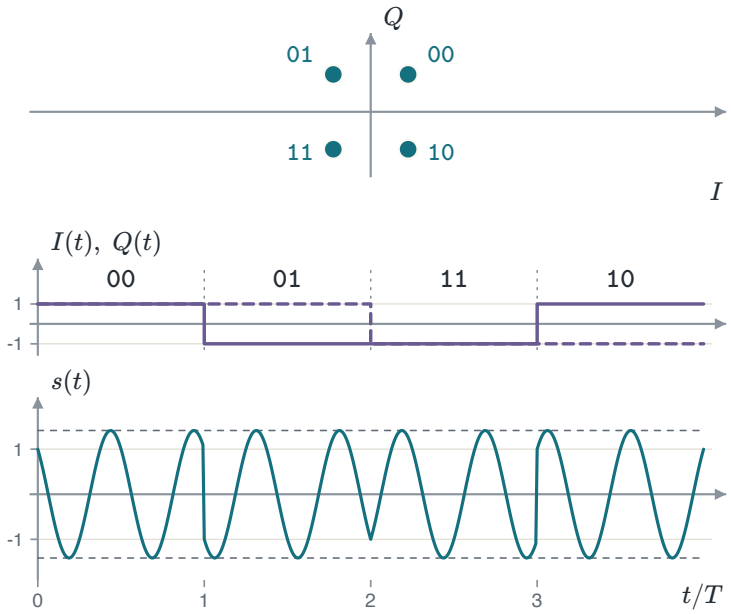


FIGURE 5.2 Four QPSK symbols at $(\pm 1, \pm 1)$, sent in the order 00, 01, 11, 10. Each point sets I (solid) and Q (dashed) for one symbol, and the carrier burst below follows them.

Binary phase-shift keying

Binary phase-shift keying (BPSK) sends a one as the carrier and a zero as the carrier inverted. The phase is 0 or π.

BPSK

$$s_1(t) = \sqrt{\frac{2E_b}{T_b}}\cos(2\pi f_c t), \qquad s_0(t) = -s_1(t)$$

Take the basis function $\psi(t) = \sqrt{2/T_b}\cos(2\pi f_c t)$. Then $s_1(t) = \sqrt{E_b}\,\psi(t)$ and $s_0(t) = -\sqrt{E_b}\,\psi(t)$. The two points sit on one axis at $\pm\sqrt{E_b}$, so they are antipodal.

$$d_{\min} = \sqrt{E_b} - \left(-\sqrt{E_b}\right) = 2\sqrt{E_b}$$

The binary result of Chapter 4 is $P_b = Q\left(\sqrt{d^2/2N_0}\right)$. Here $Q(x)$ is the Gaussian tail. Substitute $d^2 = 4E_b$.

$$\frac{d^2}{2N_0} = \frac{4E_b}{2N_0} = \frac{2E_b}{N_0}$$

KEY RESULT · BPSK

$$d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E_b}, \qquad P_b = Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{2E_b}{N_0}}\right)$$

BPSK is baseband antipodal signalling times $\cos(2\pi f_c t)$. The carrier changes the band, not the error rate. With $E_b = 4$ the two points are $2\sqrt{4} = 4$ apart.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

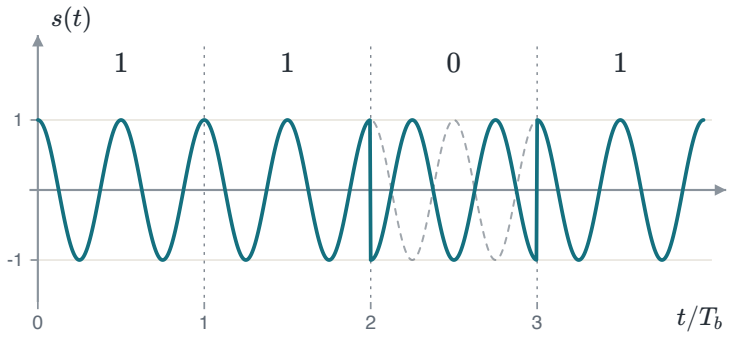


FIGURE 5.3 BPSK for the bits $1\,1\,0\,1$, two carrier cycles a bit, over the faint unmodulated carrier. A one sends the carrier and a zero sends it inverted.

Binary frequency-shift keying

Binary frequency-shift keying (BFSK) sends a one and a zero as two tones of energy E_b each.

BFSK

$$s_i(t) = \sqrt{\frac{2E_b}{T_b}}\cos(2\pi f_i t), \qquad f_1 = f_0 + \Delta f$$

The two tones are orthogonal only for certain spacings Δf. Their correlation over one bit measures how far they are from orthogonal. Expand the product with $\cos a \cos b = \tfrac{1}{2}\cos(a-b) + \tfrac{1}{2}\cos(a+b)$.

$$\rho = \frac{1}{E_b}\int_0^{T_b} s_0(t)\, s_1(t)\, dt = \frac{1}{T_b}\int_0^{T_b}\Big[\cos(2\pi\Delta f\, t) + \cos\big(2\pi(f_0+f_1)t\big)\Big]dt$$

The sum-frequency term averages out when $f_0 \gg 1/T_b$. The difference term integrates to a sine.

$$\rho \approx \frac{1}{T_b}\left[\frac{\sin(2\pi\Delta f\, t)}{2\pi\Delta f}\right]_0^{T_b} = \frac{\sin(2\pi\Delta f T_b)}{2\pi\Delta f T_b}$$

CORRELATION

$$\rho = \frac{1}{E_b}\int_0^{T_b} s_0(t)\, s_1(t)\, dt \approx \frac{\sin(2\pi\Delta f T_b)}{2\pi\Delta f T_b}$$

$\rho = 0$ at $\Delta f = n/(2T_b)$. The first zero comes at $2\pi\Delta f T_b = \pi$, so $\Delta f = 1/(2T_b)$ is the least spacing that keeps the tones orthogonal. The lowest value, $\rho = -0.217$, falls at $\Delta f = 0.715/T_b$.

At an orthogonal spacing the two points lie on two axes at right angles, each $\sqrt{E_b}$ from the origin. By Pythagoras, $d^2 = E_b + E_b = 2E_b$.

KEY RESULT · BFSK

$$d_{\min} = \sqrt{2E_b}, \qquad P_b = Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{E_b}{N_0}}\right)$$

Two orthogonal points have $d^2 = 2E_b$, against $4E_b$ for BPSK. BFSK needs 3 dB more energy.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

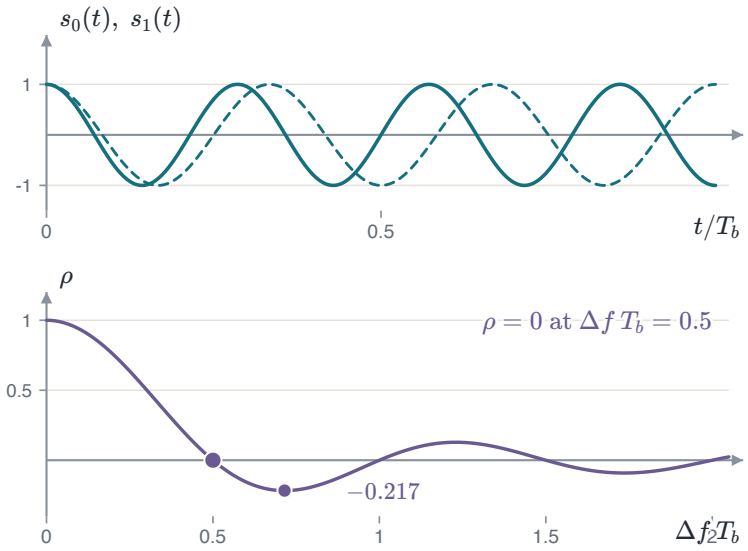


FIGURE 5.4 Two tones over one bit, $f_0 T_b = 3$ (dashed) and $f_0 + \Delta f$ (solid), at $\Delta f\, T_b = 0.5$ (top). Their correlation against the spacing: $\rho = 0$ first at $\Delta f = 1/(2T_b)$, and $\rho = -0.217$ is the lowest value (bottom).

Binary amplitude-shift keying

Binary amplitude-shift keying (BASK), also called on-off keying, sends the carrier for a one and nothing for a zero.

BASK

$$s_1(t) = \sqrt{\frac{2E}{T_b}} \cos(2\pi f_c t), \qquad s_0(t) = 0$$

Ones and zeros are equally likely, and only the ones cost energy. The average energy a bit is therefore half the peak energy E.

$$E_b = \tfrac{1}{2}E + \tfrac{1}{2}(0) = \frac{E}{2}$$

The two points sit at 0 and $\sqrt{E}$ on one axis. Write their distance in terms of E_b.

$$d = \sqrt{E} - 0 = \sqrt{E} = \sqrt{2E_b}$$

KEY RESULT · BASK

$$d = \sqrt{E} = \sqrt{2E_b}, \qquad P_b = Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{E_b}{N_0}}\right)$$

This is the distance of BFSK at the same average energy. For example, a peak energy $E = 2$ gives $E_b = E/2 = 1$.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use the average $E_b = E/2$, not the peak E, in P_b. Only the ones carry energy.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

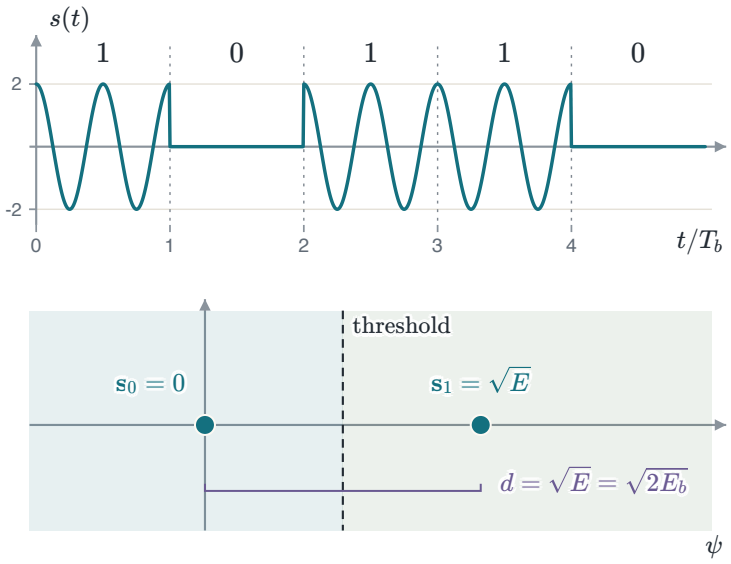


FIGURE 5.5 On-off keying of $1\,0\,1\,1\,0$ with peak energy $E = 2$ a bit (top). Its two points on one axis, with the threshold halfway (bottom).

Three binary schemes compared

The three schemes differ only in the squared distance between their two points.

> SQUARED DISTANCE
>
> $$\text{BPSK: } d^2 = 4E_b, \qquad \text{BFSK, BASK: } d^2 = 2E_b$$
>
> Half the squared distance costs a factor 2 in energy, $10\log_{10} 2 = 3$ dB.

To give the same argument of Q, BFSK needs E_b/N_0 twice as large as BPSK does. So BPSK reaches $P_b = 10^{-5}$ at 9.6 dB, and BFSK reaches it at $9.6 + 3.0 = 12.6$ dB.

BFSK and BASK need the same average E_b/N_0. BASK spends it only on the ones.

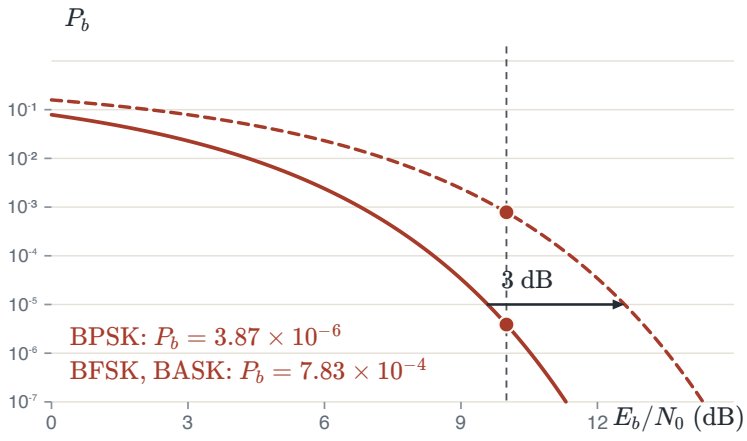


FIGURE 5.6 Bit error of BPSK (solid) and of BFSK and BASK (dashed). At 10^{-5} the dashed curve sits 3 dB to the right. The dots read both curves at $E_b/N_0 = 10$ dB, the case of Example 5.1.

EXAMPLE 5.1 — A BINARY LINK

GIVEN A link receives $P = 4 \times 10^{-15}$ W at $R_b = 100$ kb/s, with $N_0 = 4 \times 10^{-21}$ W/Hz.

FIND P_b for BPSK and for BFSK.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

METHOD Both error formulas depend only on E_b/N_0. The energy a bit is power times bit time, $E_b = P/R_b$. Divide it by N_0.

SOLUTION $E_b = P/R_b = 4 \times 10^{-15}/10^5 = 4 \times 10^{-20}$ J, so $E_b/N_0 = 10$, or 10 dB. BPSK: $P_b = Q(\sqrt{20}) = 3.87 \times 10^{-6}$. BFSK: $P_b = Q(\sqrt{10}) = 7.83 \times 10^{-4}$.

CHECK BFSK needs twice the energy for the same distance. It would match BPSK at 8×10^{-15} W.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Use $E_b = P/R_b$, not P, over N_0. The ratio $P/N_0 = 10^6$ Hz is not a signal-to-noise ratio.

Binary keying around us

- An NFC reader sends 106 kb/s by switching the amplitude of a 13.56 MHz carrier, $s(t) = A(t)\cos(2\pi f_c t)$. One bit lasts 9.43 μs.
- FM radio sends RDS data at 1187.5 b/s by phase keying a 57 kHz subcarrier, $s(t) = \pm\cos(2\pi f_c t)$. One bit holds 48 carrier cycles.
- A car key fob switches a 433.92 MHz carrier on and off. Bit n sends $A[n]\cos(2\pi f_c t)$ with $A[n] \in \{0, 1\}$.
- GPS phase-keys a 1575.42 MHz carrier at 1.023 Mchip/s. Its spectrum $T_c\,\mathrm{sinc}^2((f - f_c)T_c)$, with $\mathrm{sinc}\,x = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$, has nulls at ± 1.023 MHz.

- **One switch a bit.** Each system changes one thing about its carrier for each bit: the amplitude or the sign.
- **Energy on the ones.** On-off keying spends energy only on the ones. With equal ones and zeros, E_b is half the peak energy.
- **Bit rate and band.** A faster bit rate widens the spectrum. The GPS main lobe is $2 \times 1.023 = 2.046$ MHz wide.

5.2 Phase-shift keying

M-ary phase-shift keying

M-ary PSK puts M points on a circle of radius $\sqrt{E_s}$. All points have equal energy and differ only in phase. Each symbol carries $k = \log_2 M$ bits, so $E_s = kE_b$.

M-PSK

$$s_m(t) = \sqrt{\frac{2E_s}{T}}\cos\left(2\pi f_c t + \frac{2\pi m}{M}\right), \quad m = 0, \ldots, M-1$$

Two neighbours are each $\sqrt{E_s}$ from the origin, and the angle between them is $2\pi/M$. The cosine rule gives their squared distance.

$$\begin{aligned} d_{\min}^2 &= E_s + E_s - 2E_s\cos\frac{2\pi}{M} \\ &= 2E_s\left(1 - \cos\frac{2\pi}{M}\right) \\ &= 4E_s\sin^2\frac{\pi}{M} \end{aligned}$$

The last line uses $1 - \cos 2x = 2\sin^2 x$ with $x = \pi/M$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

NEIGHBOUR DISTANCE

$$d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E_s}\,\sin\frac{\pi}{M}$$

At $M = 2$, $d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E_s}$: this is BPSK. Each doubling of M nearly halves $d_{\min}$. QPSK with $E_s = 2$ has $d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{2}\,\sin(\pi/4) = 2\sqrt{2}/\sqrt{2} = 2$.

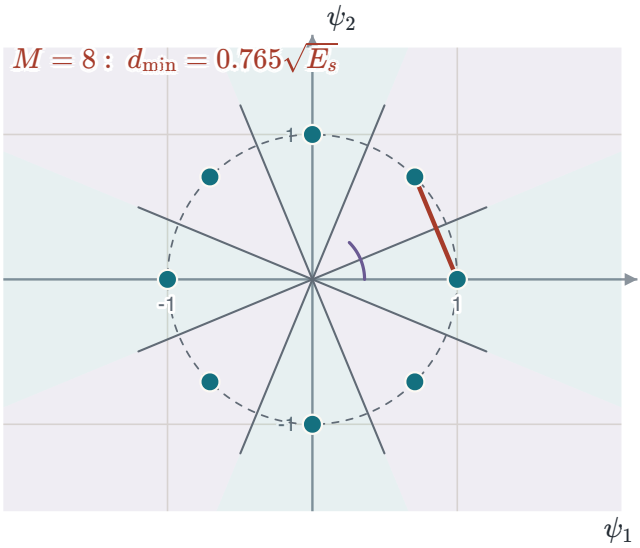


FIGURE 5.7 8-PSK with $E_s = 1$ and its wedges. The red chord is $d_{\min} = 2\sin(\pi/8)\sqrt{E_s} = 0.765\sqrt{E_s}$.

QPSK as two BPSK links

QPSK is M-PSK with $M = 4$. Written through the IQ modulator, it splits into a cosine half and a sine half. Each half is a BPSK signal.

$$s(t) = \underbrace{I\cos(2\pi f_c t)}_{\text{BPSK on cos}} - \underbrace{Q\sin(2\pi f_c t)}_{\text{BPSK on sin}}$$

The carriers are orthogonal, so the noise on one half does not reach the other. The symbol energy $E_s = 2E_b$ splits equally, and each bit sees its own BPSK link with energy E_b.

KEY RESULT · QPSK

$$P_b = Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{2E_b}{N_0}}\right), \qquad P_e = 1 - (1 - P_b)^2 \approx 2P_b$$

A symbol is right only when both halves are right. QPSK carries twice the bits of BPSK in the same band, at the same bit error.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

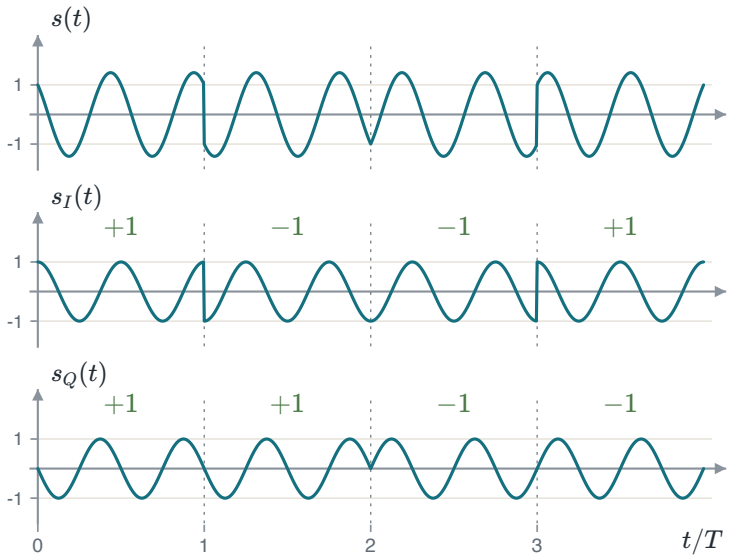


FIGURE 5.8 The QPSK burst of the IQ modulator (top) and its two halves. Each half is a BPSK signal, and the receiver decides each sign on its own (green).

Detecting PSK by phase

The receiver uses two correlators on the basis of the IQ modulator.

TWO CORRELATORS

$$y_1 = \int_0^T r(t)\,\psi_1(t)\,dt, \qquad y_2 = \int_0^T r(t)\,\psi_2(t)\,dt$$

$$\psi_1(t) = \sqrt{2/T}\cos(2\pi f_c t), \qquad \psi_2(t) = -\sqrt{2/T}\sin(2\pi f_c t)$$

Write the received vector $\mathbf{y}$ in polar form, with length $\|\mathbf{y}\|$ and angle θ. Its squared distance to the point $\mathbf{s}_m$ follows from the cosine rule.

$$\|\mathbf{y} - \mathbf{s}_m\|^2 = \|\mathbf{y}\|^2 + E_s - 2\|\mathbf{y}\|\sqrt{E_s}\,\cos\!\left(\theta - \frac{2\pi m}{M}\right)$$

Only the cosine depends on m. The distance is least where that cosine is largest, which is where $2\pi m/M$ is nearest θ.

PHASE DECISION

$$\theta = \operatorname{atan2}(y_2, y_1), \qquad \hat{m} = \text{the } m \text{ with } \tfrac{2\pi m}{M} \text{ nearest } \theta$$

All points have equal energy, so the nearest point has the nearest phase. The length of $\mathbf{y}$ plays no part.

For example, an 8-PSK receiver measures $\theta = 50^\circ$. The phases are 45° apart, and 50° is 5° from 45° and 40° from 90°. The receiver picks 45°.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

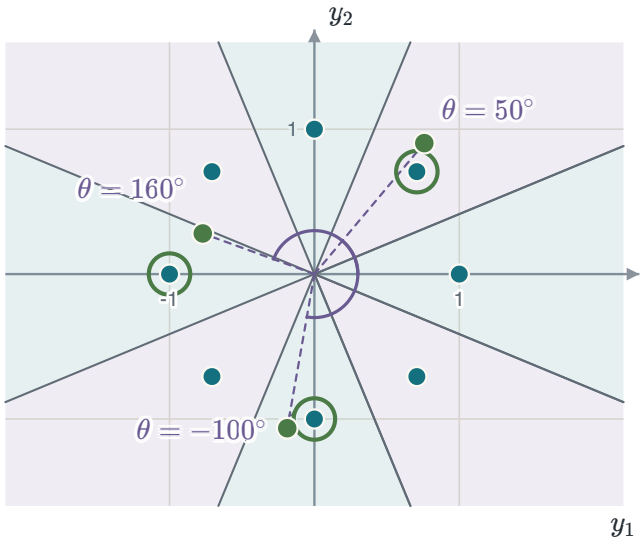


FIGURE 5.9 8-PSK and its wedges, with received points at $\theta = 50°$, $160°$ and $-100°$. For each one the receiver picks the point of nearest phase (green ring).

M-PSK error probability

Each point has two neighbours at $d_{\min}$. The nearest-neighbour form of Chapter 4 is $P_e \approx \bar{N}_{\min}\, Q\!\left(\sqrt{d_{\min}^2/2N_0}\right)$, with $\bar{N}_{\min} = 2$. Substitute the neighbour distance.

$$\frac{d_{\min}^2}{2N_0} = \frac{4E_s \sin^2(\pi/M)}{2N_0} = \frac{2E_s}{N_0}\sin^2\frac{\pi}{M}$$

SYMBOL ERROR

$$P_e \approx 2Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{2E_s}{N_0}}\,\sin\frac{\pi}{M}\right), \qquad E_s = kE_b$$

Doubling M brings the points closer. To keep the same $d_{\min}$, the symbol energy must grow by the ratio of the two $\sin^2$ terms. From QPSK to 8-PSK:

$$\frac{E_{s,8}}{E_{s,4}} = \frac{\sin^2(\pi/4)}{\sin^2(\pi/8)} = \frac{0.5}{0.1464} = 3.41\ (5.33\ \text{dB})$$

Each 8-PSK symbol now carries 3 bits, not 2. Per bit the cost is $5.33 - 10\log_{10}1.5 = 5.33 - 1.76 = 3.57$ dB. For large M, $\sin(\pi/M) \approx \pi/M$, so each doubling divides $\sin^2$ by 4. The cost then tends to 6 dB a doubling.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

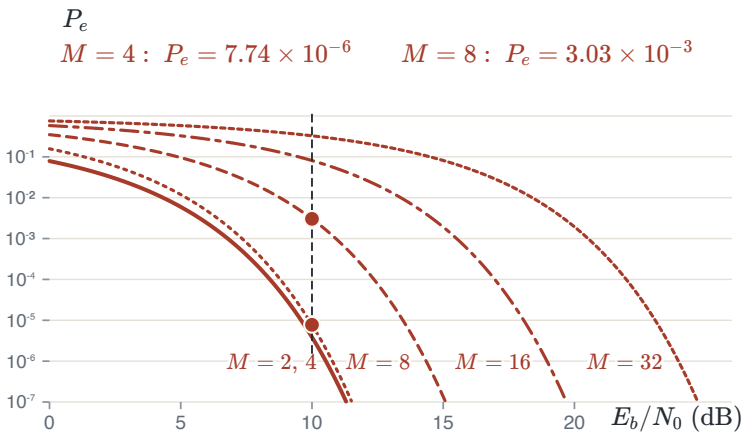


FIGURE 5.10 Symbol error of M-PSK for $M = 2$ to 32, from the nearest-neighbour form, exact for $M = 2$. $M = 2$ and 4 nearly share one curve. The dots read QPSK and 8-PSK at $E_b/N_0 = 10$ dB.

Gray labels

A symbol error nearly always lands on a neighbour. Gray labels make neighbours differ in one bit.

GRAY CODE

$$g = i \oplus \lfloor i/2 \rfloor$$

For $i = 0, \ldots, 7$ this gives 000, 001, 011, 010, 110, 111, 101, 100. Neighbours differ in one bit.

For example, $i = 5$ is 101 and $\lfloor 5/2 \rfloor = 2$ is 010. Their bitwise sum is $101 \oplus 010 = 111$, the sixth label of the list.

With Gray labels a neighbour costs one bit of the k bits of a symbol. The bit error is then the symbol error divided by k.

BITS FROM SYMBOLS

$$P_b \approx \frac{P_e}{\log_2 M}$$

For example, 8-PSK with Gray labels at $P_e = 3 \times 10^{-3}$ has $P_b \approx P_e/3 = 10^{-3}$.

⚠ NATURAL LABELS

Natural labels put 011 beside 100. That one symbol error costs three bits.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

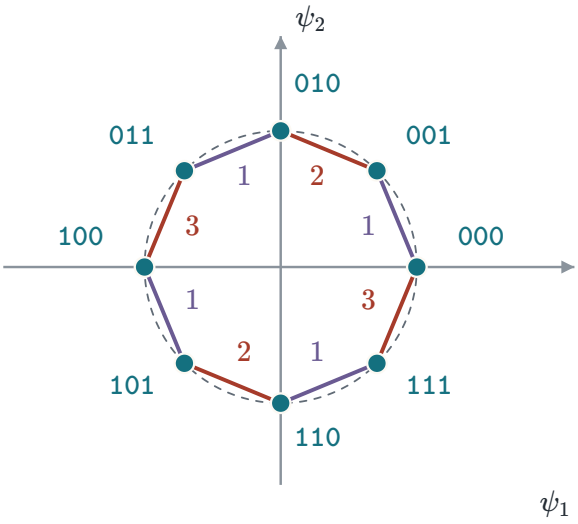


FIGURE 5.11 8-PSK with natural labels. Each chord shows how many bits its two labels differ in. The chords between 011 and 100 and between 111 and 000 cost three.

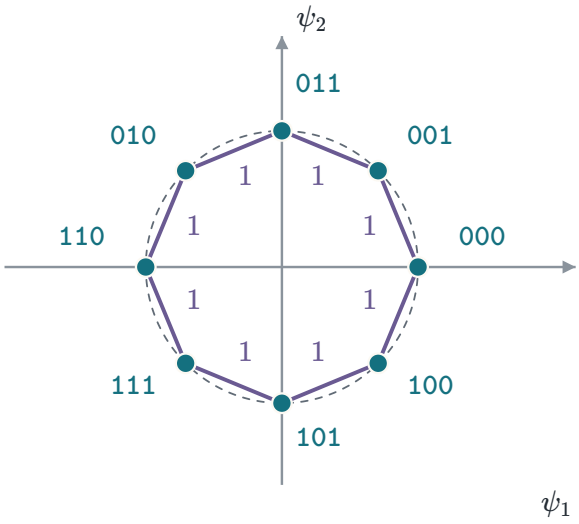


FIGURE 5.12 8-PSK with Gray labels. Every chord costs one bit.

EXAMPLE 5.2 — 8-PSK

GIVEN 8-PSK with Gray labels at $E_b/N_0 = 10$ dB.

FIND The symbol error P_e and the bit error P_b.

METHOD Use the nearest-neighbour form, since each point has two neighbours at $d_{\min}$. First turn E_b/N_0 into E_s/N_0. Then divide P_e by 3 for Gray labels.

SOLUTION 10 dB is a ratio of 10, and each symbol carries 3 bits, so $E_s/N_0 = 3(10) = 30$. The argument of Q is $x = \sqrt{2(30)}\,\sin(\pi/8) = 2.96$. So $P_e \approx 2Q(2.96) = 2(1.52 \times 10^{-3}) = 3.0 \times 10^{-3}$ and $P_b \approx P_e/3 = 1.0 \times 10^{-3}$.

CHECK The sent point sits inside a wedge of $\pm 22.5^\circ$. Each of its two neighbours, $d_{\min}$ away, contributes one Q term.

COMMON ERROR

Use $E_s = 3E_b$, not E_b, inside Q. With E_b the argument is 1.71 and P_e comes out as 0.087.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

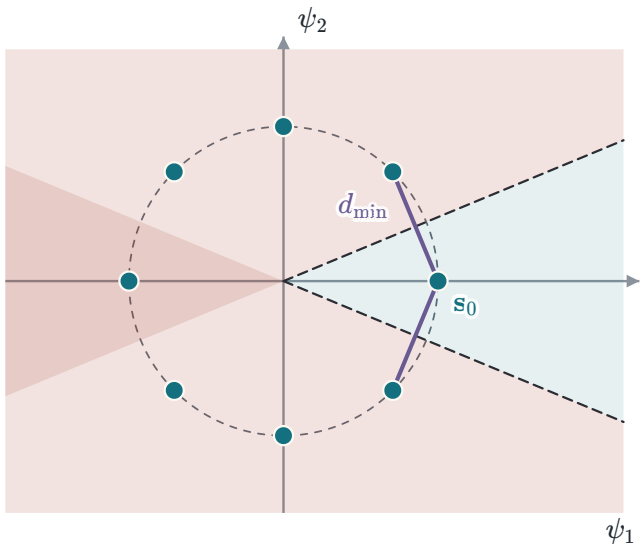


FIGURE 5.13 Example 5.2: the sent point $\mathbf{s}_0$ and its wedge of $\pm 22.5^\circ$. The red half-planes lie nearer a neighbour, each $d_{\min}$ away.

A carrier phase error

A receiver whose carrier is off by φ receives

A PHASE ERROR

$$r(t) = \sqrt{\tfrac{2E_s}{T}}\cos(2\pi f_c t + \theta_m + \varphi) + n(t)$$

It sees every point turned by φ.

⚠ AMBIGUITY

M-PSK looks the same after a turn of $2\pi/M$. A receiver can lock its carrier to any of these M phases.

For example, take QPSK with $\varphi = 90^\circ$ and no noise. Each point lands exactly on a neighbour, so every symbol is decided as that neighbour. No decision is right.

Differential encoding avoids the problem. It sends the bits in the change of phase from one symbol to the next. A constant φ then cancels.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0



FIGURE 5.14 QPSK with 200 noisy symbols at a carrier phase error $\varphi = 20°$, decided in the fixed quadrants. The green rings are the points turned by φ. Red dots are wrong decisions.

Differential PSK

Differential PSK (DPSK) puts each bit in the change of phase, not in the phase itself.

DIFFERENTIAL ENCODING

$$\theta_n = \theta_{n-1} + \pi b_n \pmod{2\pi}$$

For example, send the bits $1\,0\,1\,1$ from $\theta_0 = 0$. A one adds π and a zero adds nothing.

$$\theta_1 = \pi, \quad \theta_2 = \pi, \quad \theta_3 = 2\pi \equiv 0, \quad \theta_4 = \pi$$

Three ones add 3π, which is π modulo 2π. So the final phase is $\theta_4 = \pi$.

The receiver compares each received point with the one before. Their dot product is $\|\mathbf{y}_n\|\|\mathbf{y}_{n-1}\|\cos(\theta_n - \theta_{n-1})$, which is negative when the phase has changed by π.

DIFFERENTIAL DETECTION

$$\hat{b}_n = 1 \quad \text{when} \quad \mathbf{y}_n \cdot \mathbf{y}_{n-1} < 0$$

A constant phase error turns both points by the same angle. A turn does not change the dot product, so the error cancels.

⚠ ERRORS IN PAIRS

One badly received symbol spoils two comparisons, with the symbol before and the one after. DPSK errors tend to come in pairs.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

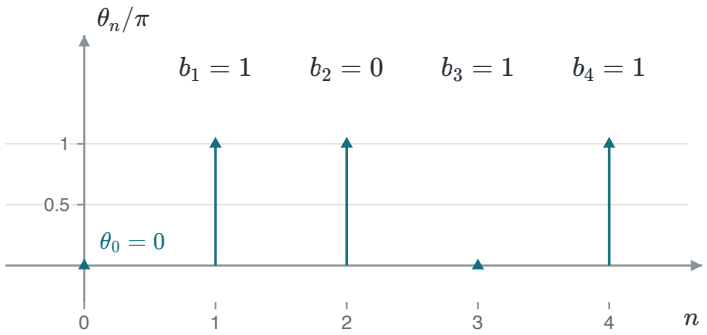


FIGURE 5.15 Differential encoding of the bits $1\,0\,1\,1$ from $\theta_0 = 0$. A one adds π to the phase and a zero adds nothing, so θ_n/π runs $0, 1, 1, 0, 1$.

DPSK error probability

Binary DPSK needs no carrier phase. The previous symbol is the reference.

KEY RESULT · BINARY DPSK

$$P_b = \frac{1}{2} e^{-E_b/N_0}$$

The price is small. Solve $\frac{1}{2}e^{-x} = 10^{-5}$ for the ratio $x = E_b/N_0$.

$$x = \ln\left(5 \times 10^4\right) = 10.82, \qquad 10 \log_{10} 10.82 = 10.34 \text{ dB}$$

At $P_b = 10^{-5}$ binary DPSK needs 10.34 dB against 9.59 dB for BPSK. It costs 0.75 dB, less than 1 dB. At $E_b/N_0 = 10$ dB, $P_b = \frac{1}{2}e^{-10} = 2.27 \times 10^{-5}$, where BPSK gives 3.87×10^{-6}.

⚠ FOUR PHASES AND MORE

For $M \geq 4$, differential detection costs about 3 dB over coherent PSK. The reference symbol is as noisy as the one decided.

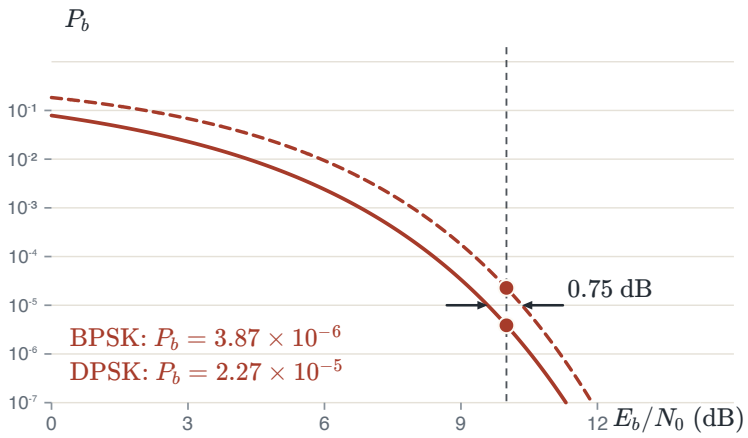


FIGURE 5.16 Bit error of coherent BPSK (solid) and binary DPSK (dashed). At 10^{-5} they are 0.75 dB apart. The dots read both at $E_b/N_0 = 10$ dB.

Phase keying around us

- 802.11b Wi-Fi at 1 Mb/s sends one bit a microsecond as a phase change of 0 or π: $\theta_n = \theta_{n-1} + \pi b_n$. At 2 Mb/s it uses four phase changes.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

- Satellite television (DVB-S) sends QPSK with Gray labels. Each bit sees its own BPSK link, $P_b = Q\big(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\big)$.
- Bluetooth EDR at 2 Mb/s uses $\pi/4$-DQPSK. Each symbol turns the phase by $\Delta\theta \in \{\pm\pi/4, \pm 3\pi/4\}$, so no step passes through the origin.
- Satellite DVB-S2 adds 8PSK to QPSK. Neighbouring points are $d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E_s}\sin(\pi/8) = 0.765\sqrt{E_s}$ apart.
- **Phase alone.** PSK keeps the amplitude constant. The power amplifier sees one level.
- **Differential phase.** 802.11b and Bluetooth EDR carry the bits in phase changes. The receiver needs no absolute carrier phase.
- **Crowding.** Beyond eight points the circle crowds. Satellite links then add a second ring, and other links move to QAM.

5.3 Amplitude and quadrature

M-ary amplitude-shift keying

M-ary amplitude-shift keying (M-ASK), also called PAM, puts M equally spaced amplitudes on one carrier. Neighbours are d apart.

M-ASK

$$s_m = (2m - 1 - M)\,\frac{d}{2}, \qquad m = 1, \dots, M$$

The amplitudes are $\pm d/2$, $\pm 3d/2$, and so on.

The average energy is the mean of the squared amplitudes, with each level equally likely.

$$E_s = \frac{1}{M}\sum_{m=1}^{M} s_m^2 = \frac{d^2}{4M}\sum_{m=1}^{M}(2m - 1 - M)^2$$

The numbers $2m - 1 - M$ run over the odd values $\pm 1, \pm 3, \dots, \pm(M-1)$. Their squares sum to $M(M^2 - 1)/3$. For $M = 4$ that is $1 + 9 + 1 + 9 = 20 = 4(15)/3$.

AVERAGE ENERGY

$$E_s = \frac{d^2}{4M}\cdot\frac{M(M^2-1)}{3} = \frac{(M^2-1)\,d^2}{12}$$

4-ASK with levels ± 1, ± 3 has $d = 2$ and $E_s = (1 + 9 + 9 + 1)/4 = 5$, or $(16 - 1)(4)/12 = 5$.

Count the neighbours. The average count is $\bar{N}_{\min} = \big(2(M-2) + 2\big)/M = 2(M-1)/M$. Then write d in terms of E_s.

$$d^2 = \frac{12E_s}{M^2 - 1} \quad\Longrightarrow\quad \frac{d^2}{2N_0} = \frac{6E_s}{(M^2-1)N_0}$$

KEY RESULT · M-ASK

$$P_e = \frac{2(M-1)}{M}\,Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{6E_s}{(M^2-1)N_0}}\right)$$

Inner points have two neighbours and the end points one. Each doubling of M costs about 6 dB.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

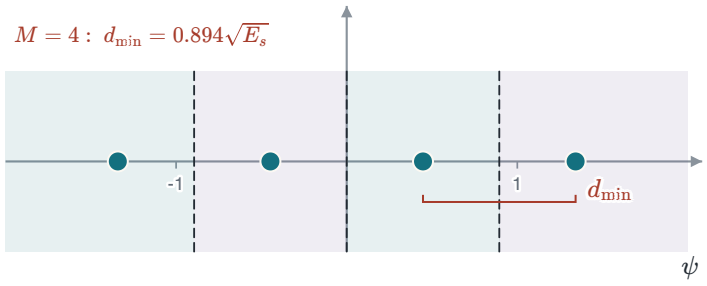


FIGURE 5.17 4-ASK on one axis at unit average energy, with its thresholds halfway between levels. The spacing shrinks as $\sqrt{12/(M^2-1)}$.

EXAMPLE 5.3 – FOUR-LEVEL ASK

GIVEN 4-ASK with levels $\pm A$, $\pm 3A$ at $E_s/N_0 = 25$.

FIND The symbol error P_e, and the average neighbour count $\bar{N}_{\min}$.

METHOD Use the nearest-neighbour form. Write $d_{\min} = 2A$ in terms of E_s, and count the neighbours of each point.

SOLUTION $E_s = A^2(9+1+1+9)/4 = 5A^2$ and $d_{\min} = 2A$, so $d_{\min}^2/2N_0 = 4A^2/2N_0 = 2E_s/5N_0 = 2(25)/5 = 10$. The end points have 1 neighbour and the inner two have 2, so $\bar{N}_{\min} = (1+2+2+1)/4 = 1.5$. Then $P_e \approx 1.5\,Q(\sqrt{10}) = 1.5(7.83\times10^{-4}) = 1.17\times10^{-3}$.

CHECK The M-ASK formula with $M = 4$ gives the same: $2(3)/4 = 1.5$ and $6(25)/15 = 10$.

COMMON ERROR

Use $\bar{N}_{\min} = 1.5$, not 2. The two end points have one neighbour each.

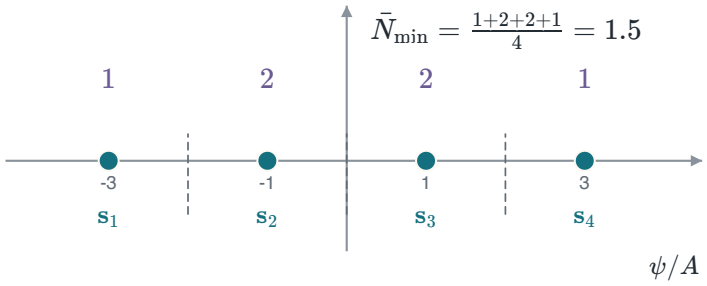


FIGURE 5.18 Example 5.3: four levels at $\pm A$, $\pm 3A$ with the neighbour count of each point, $1, 2, 2, 1$, and their average 1.5.

Quadrature amplitude modulation

Quadrature amplitude modulation (QAM) runs one ASK signal on the cosine and another on the sine. Square M-QAM is two $\sqrt{M}$-level ASK axes at right angles.

SQUARE QAM

$$s(t) = I\cos(2\pi f_c t) - Q\sin(2\pi f_c t), \qquad I,\, Q \in \left\{\pm\tfrac{d}{2}, \pm\tfrac{3d}{2}, \ldots\right\}$$

Each axis carries $\sqrt{M}$ levels, d apart. Gray labels on each axis give neighbours that differ in one bit.

The energy of a point is the sum of the energies on the two axes. Each axis is a $\sqrt{M}$-level ASK, so put $\sqrt{M}$ in place of M in the ASK energy.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

AVERAGE ENERGY

$$E_s = 2 \cdot \frac{\left((\sqrt{M})^2 - 1\right) d^2}{12} = \frac{(M-1)\, d^2}{6}$$

16-QAM with $d = 2$ gives $E_s = 15(4)/6 = 10$.

Count the neighbours of 16-QAM. Its 4 corners have 2 neighbours, its 8 edge points 3 and its 4 inner points 4.

$$\bar{N}_{\min} = \frac{4(2) + 8(3) + 4(4)}{16} = \frac{48}{16} = 3 = 4\left(1 - \frac{1}{\sqrt{16}}\right)$$

In general $\bar{N}_{\min} = 4(1 - 1/\sqrt{M})$. The distance in terms of E_s is $d^2 = 6E_s/(M-1)$, so $d^2/2N_0 = 3E_s/((M-1)N_0)$.

KEY RESULT · SQUARE QAM

$$P_e \approx 4\left(1 - \frac{1}{\sqrt{M}}\right) Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{3E_s}{(M-1)N_0}}\right)$$

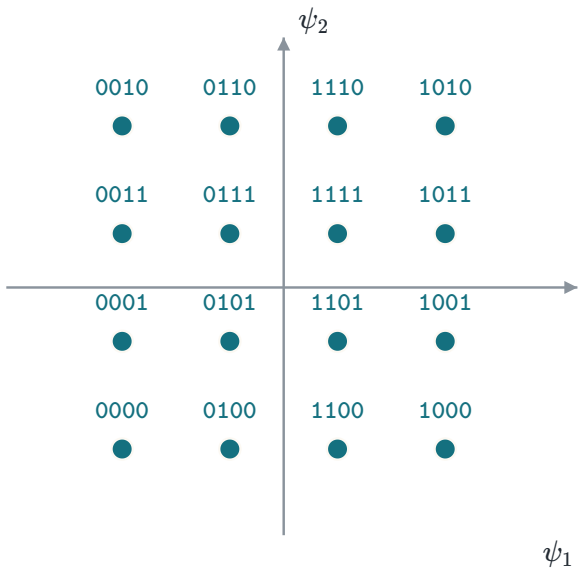


FIGURE 5.19 16-QAM as 4-ASK on the cosine and 4-ASK on the sine, with Gray labels on each axis.

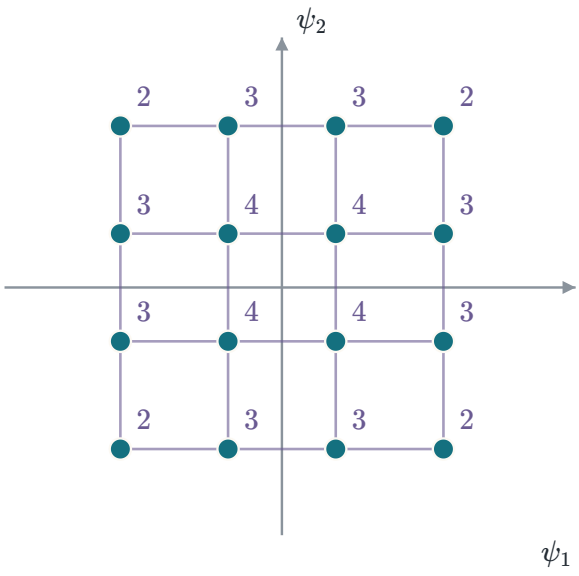


FIGURE 5.20 The neighbours of each 16-QAM point: 2 at a corner, 3 on an edge, 4 inside. Their average is $\bar{N}_{\min} = 48/16 = 3$.

QAM error probability

A symbol is right only when both axes are right. Each axis is a $\sqrt{M}$-level ASK with its own error $P_{\sqrt{M}}$.

EXACT SQUARE QAM

$$P_e = 1 - \left(1 - P_{\sqrt{M}}\right)^2, \qquad P_{\sqrt{M}} = 2\left(1 - \tfrac{1}{\sqrt{M}}\right) Q\left(\sqrt{\tfrac{3E_s}{(M-1)N_0}}\right)$$

Expand the square to compare this with the nearest-neighbour form.

$$1 - \left(1 - P_{\sqrt{M}}\right)^2 = 2P_{\sqrt{M}} - P_{\sqrt{M}}^2$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The nearest-neighbour form keeps only $2P_{\sqrt{M}}$. At high SNR the square is tiny, so the two forms are close. For example, $P_{\sqrt{M}} = 10^{-3}$ gives $P_e = 1 - (1 - 10^{-3})^2 = 1.999 \times 10^{-3}$, about 2×10^{-3}.

> ⚠ THREE DB A BIT
>
> At a fixed $d_{\min}$, E_s grows as $M - 1$. Doubling M nearly doubles $M - 1$, so each extra bit a symbol costs about 3 dB of E_s/N_0.

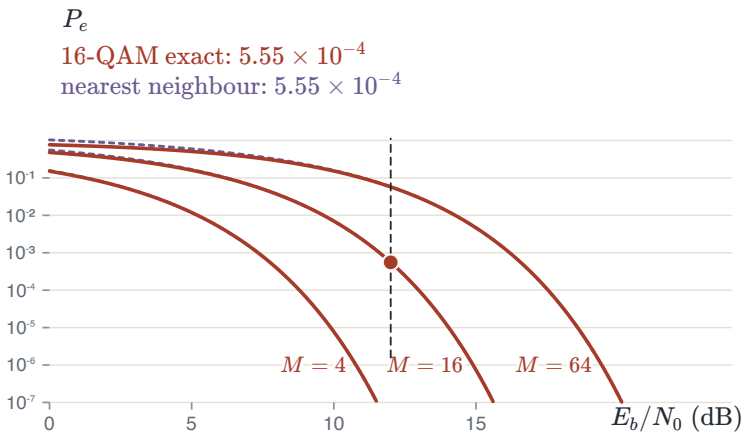


FIGURE 5.21 Symbol error of square QAM for $M = 4, 16$ and 64. Solid: exact. Dashed: nearest-neighbour form. The dot reads 16-QAM at $E_b/N_0 = 12$ dB.

Eight-point constellations

Take four sets of eight points, all with neighbours $d_{\min} = 2$ apart. At high SNR they err at about the same rate. The best set needs the least energy.

The average energy of each set is the mean of $x^2 + y^2$ over its points. Each set has four points at one radius and four at another.

$$\begin{aligned}
&\text{(a)} \quad E = \tfrac{1}{8}\big(4 \cdot 2 + 4 \cdot 10\big) = 6 \\
&\text{(b)} \quad E = \tfrac{1}{8}\big(4 \cdot 2 + 4 \cdot 2(1+\sqrt{2})^2\big) = 6.83 \\
&\text{(c)} \quad E = \tfrac{1}{8}\big(4 \cdot 4 + 4 \cdot 8\big) = 6 \\
&\text{(d)} \quad E = \tfrac{1}{8}\big(4 \cdot 2 + 4(1+\sqrt{3})^2\big) = 4.73
\end{aligned}$$

Set (d) puts four points on an inner square at $(\pm 1, \pm 1)$ and four on the axes at $1 + \sqrt{3}$. The point $(1 + \sqrt{3}, 0)$ is $\sqrt{3 + 1} = 2$ from $(1, 1)$, so $d_{\min}$ stays 2.

> GAIN
>
> $$10 \log_{10} \frac{6}{4.73} = 1.03 \text{ dB}$$
>
> Set (d) saves about 1 dB over the rectangle (a). The packing matters, not the grid.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

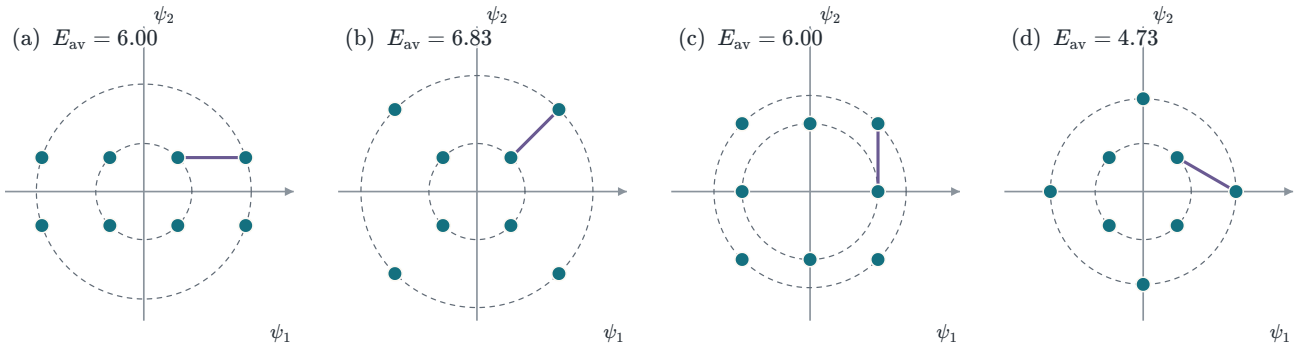


FIGURE 5.22 Four sets of eight points, each with $d_{\min} = 2$ (violet chord), and the average energy of each. Set (d) needs the least.

EXAMPLE 5.4 – 16-QAM

GIVEN 16-QAM with $d_{\min} = 2$ and $E_s/N_0 = 80$, about 19 dB.

FIND The energy E_s, the symbol error P_e and the bit error P_b with Gray labels.

METHOD Use the nearest-neighbour form of square QAM. Find E_s from d, write $d_{\min}^2/2N_0$ in terms of E_s/N_0, and divide P_e by 4 bits.

SOLUTION $E_s = (M-1)d^2/6 = 15(4)/6 = 10$. Then $d_{\min}^2/2N_0 = 3E_s/15N_0 = E_s/5N_0 = 16$, and $\bar{N}_{\min} = 3$. So $P_e \approx 3\,Q(\sqrt{16}) = 3\,Q(4) = 9.5 \times 10^{-5}$ and $P_b \approx P_e/4 = 2.4 \times 10^{-5}$.

CHECK The grid $\pm 1, \pm 3$ on both axes gives $E_s = 5 + 5 = 10$ directly. The boundaries sit halfway between levels, at 0 and ± 2 on each axis.

> ⊗ COMMON ERROR
> Use $\bar{N}_{\min} = 3$, not 4. Only the four inner points have four neighbours.

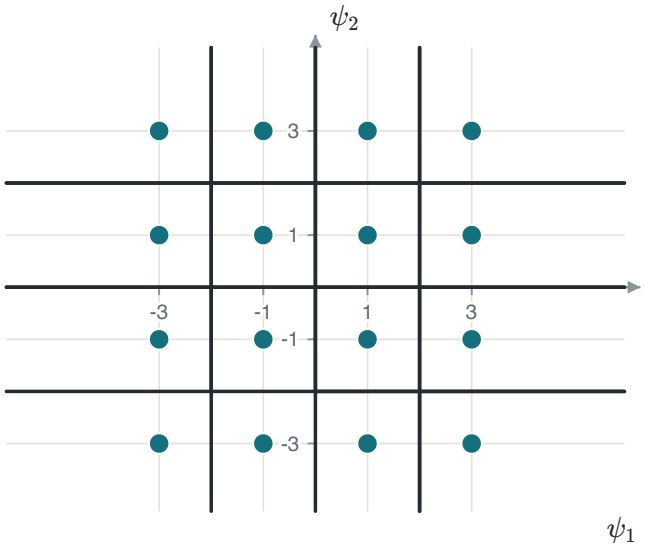


FIGURE 5.23 Example 5.4: 16-QAM on the grid $\pm 1, \pm 3$ with its decision boundaries at 0 and ± 2 on each axis.

QAM against PSK

At the same average energy, QAM spreads its points over the plane and PSK keeps them on a circle. Both distances come from the results above.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

DISTANCE AT EQUAL ENERGY

$$d^2_{\text{QAM}} = \frac{6E_s}{M-1}, \qquad d^2_{\text{PSK}} = 4E_s \sin^2 \frac{\pi}{M}$$

Their ratio measures the advantage of QAM. The energy E_s cancels.

ADVANTAGE

$$R_M = \frac{d^2_{\text{QAM}}}{d^2_{\text{PSK}}} = \frac{6E_s/(M-1)}{4E_s \sin^2(\pi/M)} = \frac{3}{2(M-1)\sin^2(\pi/M)}$$

Above 1, QAM needs less energy for the same $d_{\min}$.

For $M = 16$, $\sin^2(\pi/16) = 0.0381$. So $R_{16} = 3/\big(30 \sin^2(\pi/16)\big) = 2.63$, or $10 \log_{10} 2.63 = 4.20$ dB.

The gap grows with M. QAM saves 1.65, 4.20, 7.02 and 9.95 dB over PSK at $M = 8$, 16, 32 and 64. PSK uses only a circle, and QAM uses the whole plane.

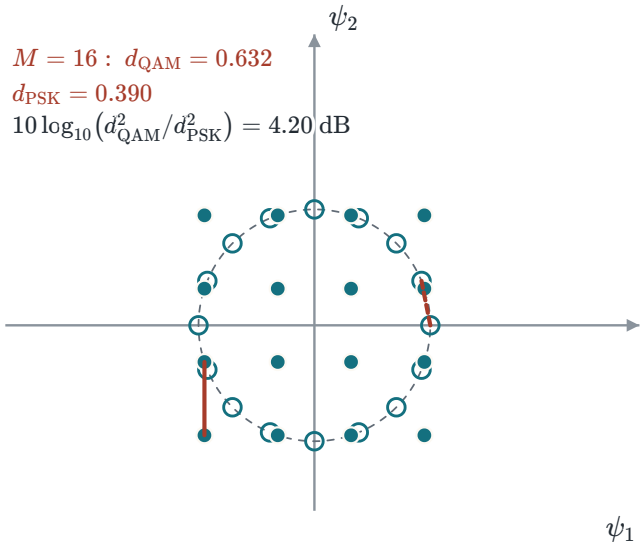


FIGURE 5.24 16-PSK (rings) and 16-QAM (dots) at the same $E_s = 1$. The dashed chord is the PSK $d_{\min}$ and the solid one the QAM $d_{\min}$.

QAM around us

- Wi-Fi 6 uses QAM with up to 1024 points, 10 bits a symbol. At $E_s = 1$ the points are $d_{\min} = \sqrt{6/1023} = 0.077$ apart.
- LTE and 5G NR use QAM with up to 256 points. Each axis then carries one of 16 levels, $I[n] \in \{\pm 1, \pm 3, \ldots, \pm 15\}$.
- ADSL splits a phone line into tones 4.3125 kHz apart. Tone k carries b_k bits as a QAM set of 2^{b_k} points. Higher tones arrive weaker and carry fewer bits.
- Digital cable television uses 64-QAM and 256-QAM. Each $\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{s} + \mathbf{n}$ lands in a small cloud, here 64-QAM at $E_s/N_0 = 30$ dB.
- **Two PAM sets.** Square QAM puts one PAM set on each axis. The receiver decides each axis on its own.
- **Bits a symbol.** 256 points carry 8 bits a symbol and 1024 points carry 10.
- **Spacing.** At fixed energy $d^2_{\min} = 6E_s/(M-1)$. Going from 256 to 1024 points costs 6.0 dB.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

5.4 Frequency-shift keying and orthogonal signals

M-ary frequency-shift keying

M-ary FSK sends one of M tones, each orthogonal to the others. The spacing $1/(2T)$ keeps every pair orthogonal, as for BFSK.

M-FSK

$$s_m(t) = \sqrt{\frac{2E_s}{T}}\cos\bigl(2\pi(f_c + m\,\Delta f)\,t\bigr), \qquad \Delta f = \frac{1}{2T}$$

Each tone is one axis of an M-dimensional space, with its point at $\sqrt{E_s}$ on that axis.

Two points on different axes are at right angles. By Pythagoras their squared distance is $E_s + E_s$.

DISTANCES

$$\|\mathbf{s}_i - \mathbf{s}_j\|^2 = 2E_s, \qquad i \neq j$$

Every point is a neighbour of every other, so each has $M - 1$ neighbours at one distance. 8-FSK has 7.

The union bound of Chapter 4 adds one Q term for each of the $M - 1$ neighbours. Each term has $d^2/2N_0 = 2E_s/2N_0 = E_s/N_0$.

KEY RESULT · ORTHOGONAL SIGNALS

$$P_e \le (M-1)\,Q\left(\sqrt{\frac{E_s}{N_0}}\right), \qquad E_s = E_b \log_2 M$$

More tones add bits without bringing the points closer. The receiver picks the largest correlator output.

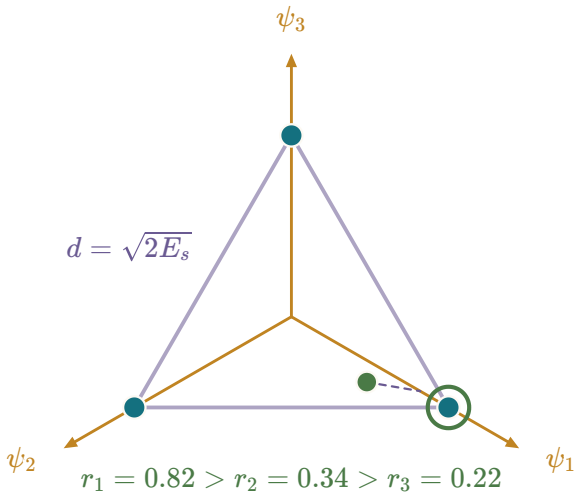


FIGURE 5.25 Three orthogonal signals, one on each axis at $\sqrt{E_s}$ from the origin. Every pair is $\sqrt{2E_s}$ apart. A received point with $r_1 > r_2 > r_3$ is decided as $\mathbf{s}_1$ (green ring).

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

More signals, less energy

A wrong symbol is any of the other $M-1$ with equal chance. Take one bit position of the k-bit label. It differs from the sent bit in 2^{k-1} of the 2^k labels, and the sent label is not one of them.

BITS FROM SYMBOLS

$$P_b = \frac{2^{k-1}}{2^k - 1} P_e$$

At $P_b = 10^{-5}$, $M = 2$ needs 12.6 dB and $M = 64$ about 6.1 dB. Each doubling of M lowers the E_b/N_0 needed.

⚠ A FLOOR

The gain has a limit. As M grows, $P_b \to 0$ only above $E_b/N_0 = \ln 2$, or -1.6 dB. More signals move the curves toward this limit, not past it. Chapter 6 shows why.

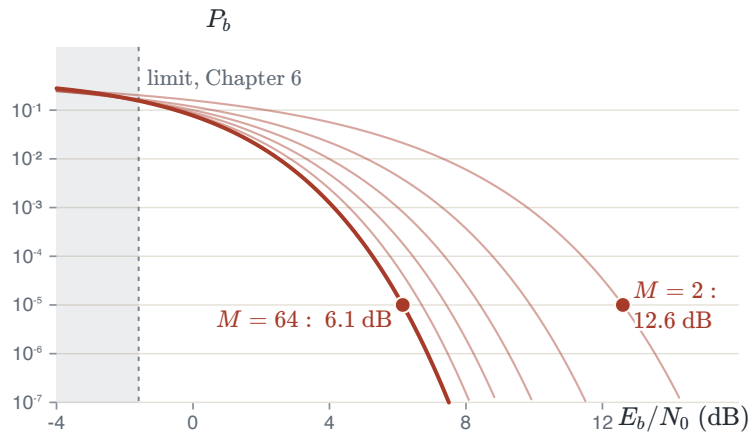


FIGURE 5.26 Exact bit error of M orthogonal signals for $M = 2$ to 64, with $M = 64$ drawn heavy. The curves move left as M grows. The shaded wall at -1.6 dB is the limit Chapter 6 derives.

Noncoherent FSK

A noncoherent receiver does not know the carrier phase. For each tone it uses a cosine and a sine correlator.

A tone of unit amplitude and unknown phase φ gives $y_c = \cos\varphi$ and $y_s = \sin\varphi$. The length of (y_c, y_s) is $\sqrt{\cos^2\varphi + \sin^2\varphi} = 1$, whatever φ is.

ENVELOPE DETECTOR

$$\ell_i = \sqrt{y_{c,i}^2 + y_{s,i}^2}$$

The envelope ℓ_i does not depend on φ. The receiver picks the larger ℓ_i.

Without the phase, the tones must stay orthogonal for every φ. Both the cosine and the sine correlations must then vanish.

$$\frac{1}{T}\int_0^T \cos(2\pi\Delta f\, t)\, dt = \frac{\sin(2\pi\Delta f T)}{2\pi\Delta f T}, \qquad \frac{1}{T}\int_0^T \sin(2\pi\Delta f\, t)\, dt = \frac{1-\cos(2\pi\Delta f T)}{2\pi\Delta f T}$$

Both are zero first at $2\pi\Delta f T = 2\pi$. This is twice the coherent spacing.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

SPACING

$$\Delta f = \frac{1}{T}$$

KEY RESULT · NONCOHERENT BFSK

$$P_b = \frac{1}{2} e^{-E_b/2N_0}$$

At 10^{-5} it needs 13.4 dB against 12.6 dB coherent. The exponent holds $E_b/2N_0$ in place of E_b/N_0, so it needs twice the energy of binary DPSK.

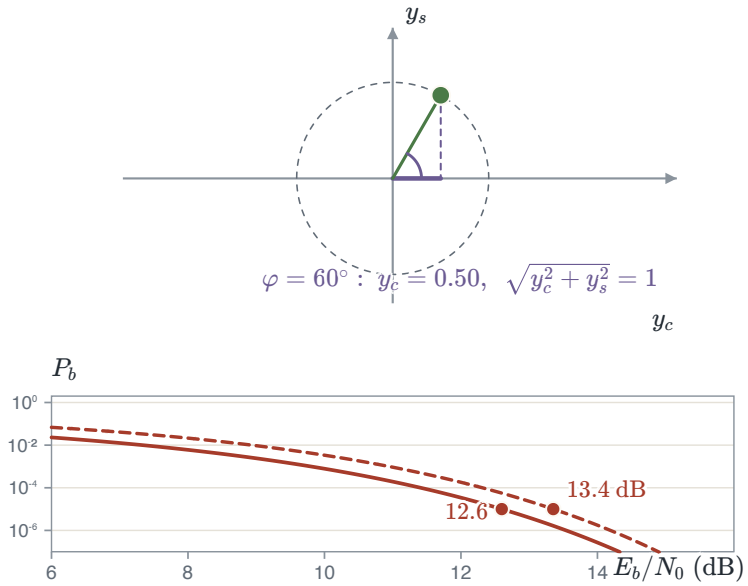


FIGURE 5.27 A tone with unknown phase $\varphi = 60^\circ$ gives $y_c = \cos\varphi$ and $y_s = \sin\varphi$, and its envelope stays 1 (top). Coherent (solid) and noncoherent (dashed) BFSK, 12.6 against 13.4 dB at 10^{-5} (bottom).

Frequency keying around us

- Caller ID and radio packet modems (Bell 202) send 1200 b/s as 1200 Hz for a one and 2200 Hz for a zero. The phase runs on across each switch.
- Bluetooth Low Energy sends 1 Mb/s with Gaussian FSK (GFSK). A Gaussian filter rounds each switch of frequency, so the spectrum falls off faster.
- GSM sends GMSK: MSK whose frequency pulse passes a Gaussian filter with $BT_b = 0.3$. The Gaussian pulse spreads over about three bits, where plain MSK holds one.
- Digital mobile radio (DMR) uses four-level FSK. Each symbol shifts the carrier by one of four offsets $\{\pm d, \pm 3d\}$ and carries 2 bits.
- **Frequency carries the bits.** FSK keeps a constant envelope. A cheap receiver can detect it without the carrier phase.
- **Smooth switching.** GFSK and GMSK smooth each change of frequency. The side lobes of the spectrum then fall off faster.
- **Band grows with M.** Orthogonal tones need a band that grows with M. Radio links therefore keep M at 2 or 4.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

5.5 Bandwidth and the choice of scheme

Spectrum and bandwidth

Take PSK or QAM with a rectangular pulse of length T. The pulse has the Fourier transform $T\,\mathrm{sinc}(fT)$, so the spectrum of the signal is a sinc^2.

SPECTRUM

$$S(f) \propto T\,\mathrm{sinc}^2(fT), \qquad T = kT_b$$

Here $\mathrm{sinc}\,x = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$. Longer symbols give a narrower spectrum, and the passband copy sits at $\pm f_c$.

The sinc^2 is first zero at $f = \pm 1/T$, so the main lobe is $2/T = 2R_b/k$ wide. At the same bit rate, QPSK symbols last $2T_b$. Its main lobe is R_b wide, half the $2R_b$ of BPSK.

A band W carries $2W$ dimensions a second. A scheme that uses N dimensions a symbol at $R_s = R_b/\log_2 M$ symbols a second needs $W = NR_s/2$. PAM on one sideband uses one dimension, PSK and QAM two, and orthogonal signals M.

BAND OF EACH FAMILY

$$\text{PAM (SSB):}\ \frac{R_b}{2\log_2 M}, \qquad \text{PSK, QAM:}\ \frac{R_b}{\log_2 M}, \qquad \text{orthogonal:}\ \frac{MR_b}{2\log_2 M}$$

Orthogonal signals need M dimensions a symbol, so their band grows with M.

For example, 16-QAM at 10 Mb/s carries 4 bits a symbol, so $W = 10/4 = 2.5$ MHz.

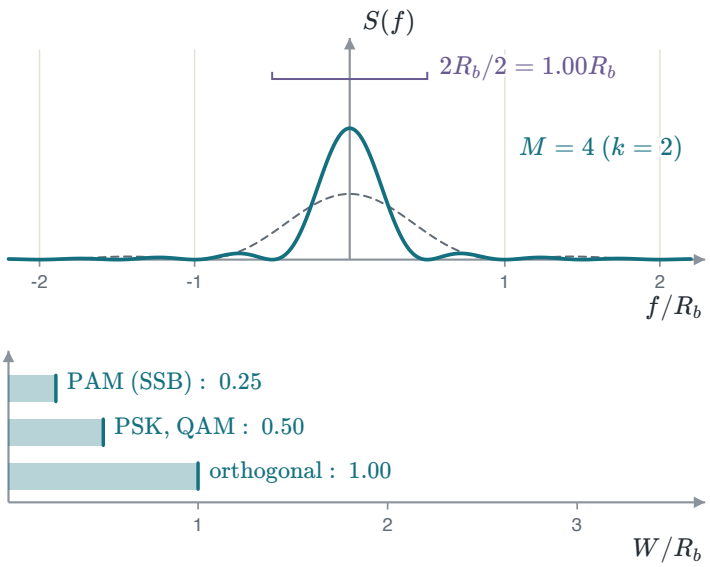


FIGURE 5.28 PSK or QAM with a rectangular pulse at a fixed bit rate, for $k = 2$ (solid) and $k = 1$ (dashed). The main lobe narrows to $2R_b/k$ (top). The band each family needs at $k = 2$ (bottom).

Offset QPSK and MSK

QPSK can swing through the origin when I and Q change sign at the same time. Its envelope then falls to zero.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

OFFSET QPSK

Delay Q by T_b. Only one axis changes at a time, so the path never crosses the origin and the envelope stays above $1/\sqrt{2}$.

Minimum-shift keying (MSK) goes further. Each bit shifts the frequency by $\pm\Delta f/2 = \pm 1/(4T_b)$, which turns the phase by $2\pi \cdot \frac{1}{4T_b} \cdot T_b = \pi/2$ over one bit.

MSK

$$\Delta\theta = \pm\frac{\pi}{2} \text{ a bit}, \qquad \Delta f = \frac{1}{2T_b}$$

Each bit turns the phase by $\pm\pi/2$ at a steady rate. MSK is BFSK at the least orthogonal spacing, with a continuous phase.

Of the three, only MSK keeps a constant envelope. Its phase moves along the circle, so $|s(t)|$ never changes.

SPECTRUM

The MSK main lobe reaches $0.75/T_b$ against $0.5/T_b$, so it is 50% wider. Its side lobes fall much faster.

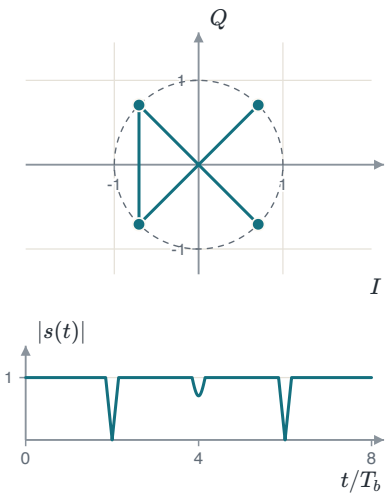


FIGURE 5.29 QPSK: the path of (I, Q) crosses the origin, and the envelope drops to zero.

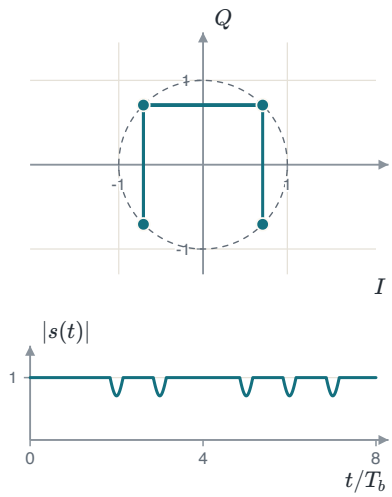


FIGURE 5.30 Offset QPSK: one axis moves at a time, and the envelope stays above $1/\sqrt{2}$.

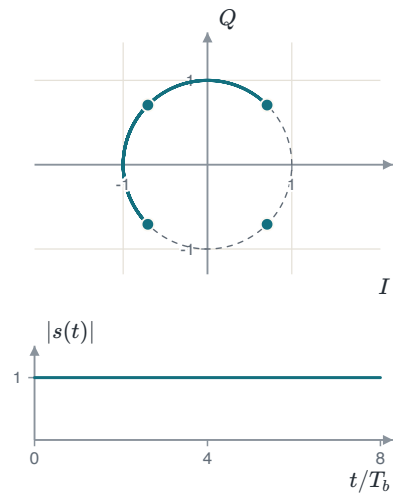


FIGURE 5.31 MSK: the path stays on the circle, and the envelope is constant.

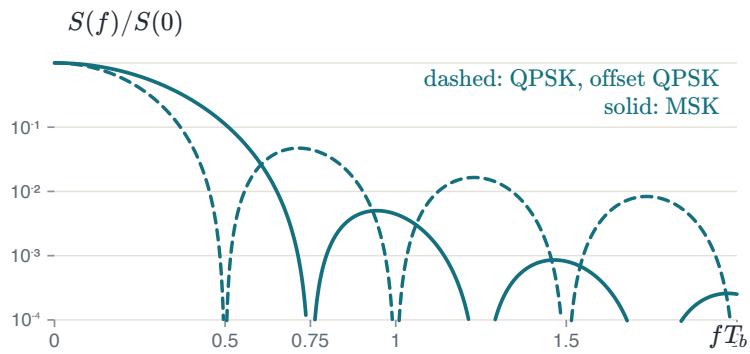


FIGURE 5.32 Spectra of QPSK and offset QPSK (dashed) and of MSK (solid). The MSK main lobe reaches $0.75/T_b$ against $0.5/T_b$, and its side lobes fall faster.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The bandwidth-efficiency plane

The bandwidth efficiency counts the bits a second that each hertz of band carries.

BANDWIDTH EFFICIENCY

$$r = \frac{R_b}{W} \text{ b/s/Hz}$$

From the bands above, PSK and QAM have $r = \log_2 M$, PAM on one sideband $r = 2\log_2 M$, and orthogonal signals $r = 2\log_2 M/M$.

PAM, PSK and QAM raise r with M. Orthogonal signals lower it. Each family then sits on a plane of r against the E_b/N_0 it needs.

TABLE 5.1 The two regions of the bandwidth-efficiency plane.

REGION	FAMILIES	TRADE
$r > 1$: bandwidth-limited	PAM, PSK, QAM	More bits a symbol, more energy a bit.
$r < 1$: power-limited	Orthogonal signals	More band, less energy a bit.

⚠ A LIMIT

No scheme sits left of the curve $E_b/N_0 = (2^r - 1)/r$. Chapter 6 derives it.

For example, 64-QAM carries 6 bits a symbol, so $r = 6 > 1$. It is bandwidth-limited: it saves band and pays in energy.

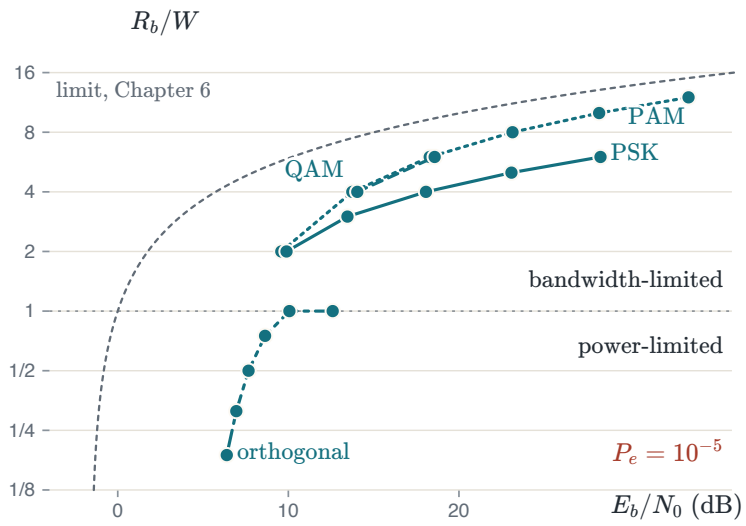


FIGURE 5.33 R_b/W against the E_b/N_0 each set needs for $P_e = 10^{-5}$, for M up to 64. The faint curve is the limit Chapter 6 derives.

Comparing the families

PAM, PSK and QAM are bandwidth-limited. They pay energy for each extra bit, and QAM pays the least of the three. Orthogonal signals are power-limited. They need less E_b/N_0 as M grows, at the price of band.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TABLE 5.2 Each family at $M = 16$ and $P_e = 10^{-5}$.

FAMILY	E_b/N_0	$r = R_b/W$	REGION
PAM (SSB)	23.1 dB	8	bandwidth-limited
PSK	18.1 dB	4	bandwidth-limited
QAM	14.0 dB	4	bandwidth-limited
Orthogonal (FSK)	7.7 dB	0.5	power-limited

The same 4 bits a symbol cost four very different amounts of energy. Sixteen orthogonal tones need about 7.7 dB, and 16-QAM about 14.0 dB.

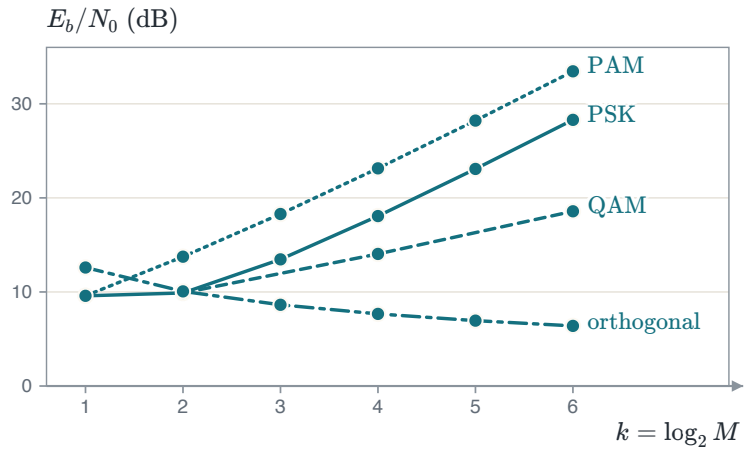


FIGURE 5.34 The E_b/N_0 each family needs for $P_e = 10^{-5}$, against the bits a symbol. PAM and PSK climb fastest, QAM more slowly, and orthogonal signals fall.

Adaptive modulation

Adaptive modulation uses this trade as the channel changes. The receiver measures E_s/N_0 and reports it. The transmitter picks the largest M that still meets the target bit error.

TABLE 5.3 The E_s/N_0 each set needs for $P_b = 10^{-5}$ with Gray labels.

SET	BITS A SYMBOL	E_s/N_0 FOR $P_b = 10^{-5}$
BPSK	1	9.6 dB
QPSK	2	12.6 dB
16-QAM	4	19.5 dB
64-QAM	6	25.6 dB
256-QAM	8	31.5 dB

Each step of two bits costs about 6 dB. The symbol rate stays fixed, so every step adds bits in the same band. A fading channel moves the link up and down the steps.

For example, a channel that gives $E_s/N_0 = 22$ dB clears the 16-QAM step at 19.5 dB but not 64-QAM at 25.6 dB. The link chooses 16-QAM.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

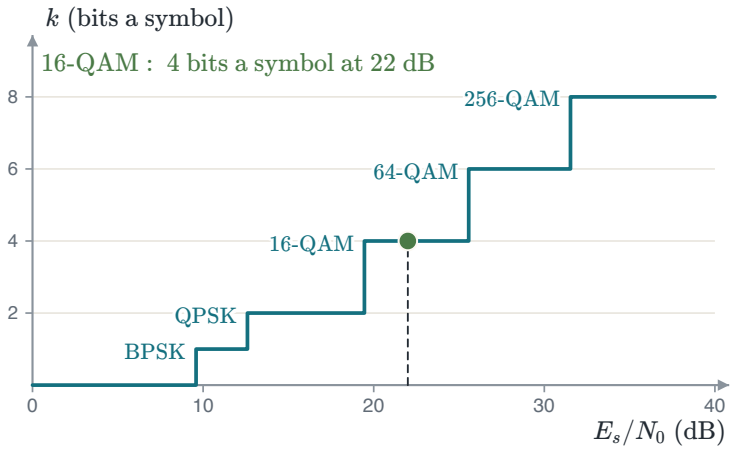


FIGURE 5.35 The largest set whose bit error stays at 10^{-5}, with Gray labels, against E_s/N_0. At 22 dB the link sends 16-QAM.

The receiver noise floor

A power in dBm is in decibels above 1 mW, $P_{\text{dBm}} = 10\log_{10}(P/1\ \text{mW})$. A ratio in dB adds to a power in dBm.

Every receiver hears thermal noise. At the reference temperature $T_0 = 290$ K its density is kT_0, with Boltzmann's constant $k = 1.38 \times 10^{-23}$ J/K. The receiver adds noise of its own, counted by the noise figure $F \geq 1$.

THERMAL NOISE

$$N_0 = kT_0F, \qquad kT_0 = (1.38 \times 10^{-23})(290) = 4.00 \times 10^{-21}\ \text{W/Hz}$$

$$10\log_{10}\frac{4.00 \times 10^{-21}\ \text{W/Hz}}{10^{-3}\ \text{W}} = -174\ \text{dBm/Hz}, \qquad \text{NF} = 10\log_{10} F$$

The noise figure in dB is NF. A receiver that adds no noise has $F = 1$, or $\text{NF} = 0$ dB.

⚠ ONE-SIDED DENSITY

kT_0F is N_0, not $N_0/2$. The two-sided density $N_0/2$ is 3 dB lower, -177 dBm/Hz with $F = 1$. It covers both signs of f, so both give $N = N_0B$.

A band of width B collects the noise power $N = N_0B$. In decibels the product becomes a sum.

NOISE POWER IN A BAND

$$N = N_0B, \qquad N_{\text{dBm}} = -174 + \text{NF} + 10\log_{10} B$$

For $B = 10$ MHz, $10\log_{10} 10^7 = 70$. With $\text{NF} = 5$ dB the noise floor is $N = -174 + 5 + 70 = -99$ dBm.

The noise floor grows as $10\log_{10} B$. A receiver that widens its band from 1 MHz to 10 MHz raises it by $10\log_{10} 10 = 10$ dB.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

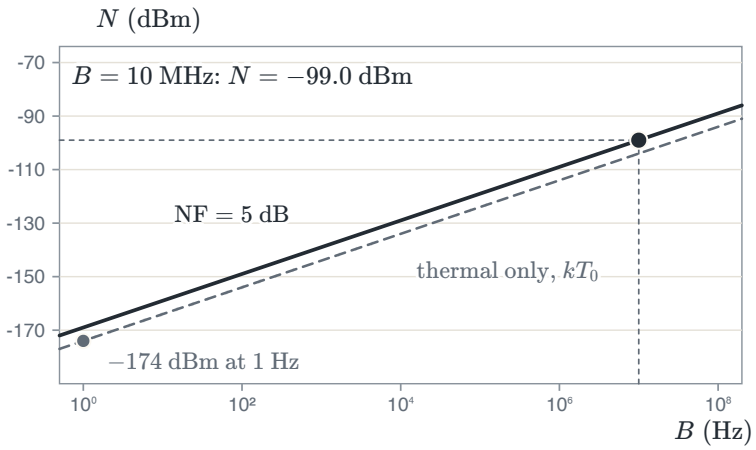


FIGURE 5.36 Noise power against the band. Dashed: thermal noise alone. Solid: a receiver with noise figure $\mathrm{NF} = 5$ dB, which lies 5 dB higher. The guides read the floor at $B = 10$ MHz.

Sensitivity and the link budget

The sensitivity $P_{\min}$ is the least received power that meets the target error. The energy a bit is the received power times the bit time, $E_b = P_r / R_b$. So $E_b/N_0 = P_r/(R_b N_0)$. Solve for P_r at the required ratio.

$$P_{\min} = \left(\frac{E_b}{N_0}\right)_{\text{req}} R_b N_0 = \left(\frac{E_b}{N_0}\right)_{\text{req}} R_b \, kT_0 F$$

SENSITIVITY

$$P_{\min} = -174 + \mathrm{NF} + 10\log_{10} R_b + \left(\frac{E_b}{N_0}\right)_{\text{req,dB}} \text{dBm}$$

The band cancels. QPSK at 10 Mb/s needs $E_b/N_0 = 9.6$ dB for $P_b = 10^{-5}$. With $\mathrm{NF} = 5$ dB it needs $-174 + 5 + 70 + 9.6 = -89.4$ dBm.

The received power comes from the transmit power, the two antennas and the path. In free space the Friis formula gives it. The antenna gains G_t and G_r are measured against an antenna that radiates equally in every direction, and $\lambda = c/f_c$ is the wavelength.

$$P_r = P_t G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi d}\right)^2$$

Take $10\log_{10}$ of both sides. The products become sums, and the last factor becomes the path loss L_p.

FREE-SPACE BUDGET

$$P_r = P_t + G_t + G_r - L_p, \qquad L_p = 20\log_{10}\frac{4\pi d}{\lambda}$$

Powers are in dBm and antenna gains in dBi. At 2.4 GHz, $\lambda = 12.5$ cm and $L_p = 20\log_{10}(4\pi \cdot 1000/0.125) = 100.0$ dB at 1 km.

The loss L_p grows with d^2. Each doubling of the range raises it by $20\log_{10} 2 = 6$ dB, so P_r falls by 6 dB.

The margin $P_r - P_{\min}$ covers fading and losses the free-space model leaves out. The range of a link is the largest d at which the margin is still met.

Take $P_t = 20$ dBm and two 10 dBi antennas at 2.4 GHz. At 1 km, $P_r = 20 + 10 + 10 - 100.0 = -60.0$ dBm, which is 29.4 dB above the QPSK sensitivity of -89.4 dBm. Keeping a 10 dB margin allows $L_p = 119.4$ dB, a range of 9.3 km.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

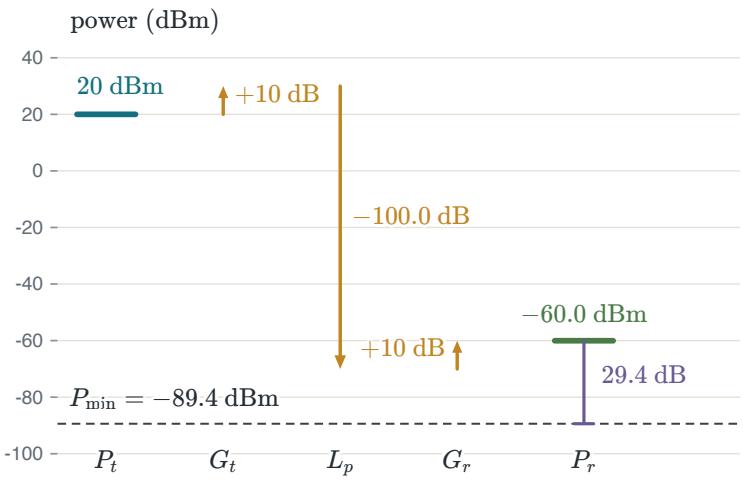


FIGURE 5.37 The budget at $d = 1$ km: $P_t = 20$ dBm, two 10 dBi antennas and the path loss at 2.4 GHz, against the sensitivity of QPSK at 10 Mb/s. The violet bracket is the margin.

EXAMPLE 5.5 — A LINK BUDGET

GIVEN A 5.8 GHz link has a band $B = 25$ MHz with roll-off $\alpha = 0.25$. It has $P_t = 20$ dBm, $G_t = G_r = 12$ dBi and $\mathrm{NF} = 7$ dB, and it keeps a 15 dB margin. For $P_b = 10^{-5}$, QPSK needs $E_b/N_0 = 9.6$ dB and 16-QAM 13.4 dB.

FIND The bit rate, the sensitivity and the range of each scheme. Which reaches farther?

METHOD The band fixes the symbol rate $R_s = B/(1+\alpha)$. The sensitivity follows from R_b and NF. The allowed loss is $L_p = P_t + G_t + G_r - P_{\min} - \text{margin}$, and inverting $L_p = 20\log_{10}(4\pi d/\lambda)$ gives $d = (\lambda/4\pi)\,10^{L_p/20}$.

SOLUTION $R_s = 25/1.25 = 20$ Msym/s, so QPSK carries 40 Mb/s and 16-QAM 80 Mb/s. Then $10\log_{10}(40\times10^6) = 76.0$ and $10\log_{10}(80\times10^6) = 79.0$, and $-174 + \mathrm{NF} = -167$ dBm/Hz. QPSK: $P_{\min} = -167 + 76.0 + 9.6 = -81.4$ dBm and $L_p = 20 + 24 + 81.4 - 15 = 110.4$ dB. 16-QAM: $P_{\min} = -167 + 79.0 + 13.4 = -74.6$ dBm and $L_p = 20 + 24 + 74.6 - 15 = 103.6$ dB. With $\lambda = 3\times10^8/5.8\times10^9 = 5.17$ cm, $\lambda/4\pi = 4.12\times10^{-3}$ m. So QPSK reaches $d = 4.12\times10^{-3}\cdot10^{110.4/20} = 1.36$ km and 16-QAM $d = 4.12\times10^{-3}\cdot10^{103.6/20} = 0.62$ km. QPSK reaches farther.

CHECK The two sensitivities differ by $-74.6 - (-81.4) = 6.8$ dB: 3.8 dB of E_b/N_0 and 3.0 dB of bit rate. A loss 6.8 dB smaller is a range $10^{6.8/20} = 2.19$ times shorter, and $1.36/0.62 = 2.19$.

COMMON ERROR

Use $20\log_{10}$, not $10\log_{10}$, to turn a loss into range. A loss of 6.8 dB is a factor 2.2 in range, not 4.8. The loss L_p grows with d^2.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

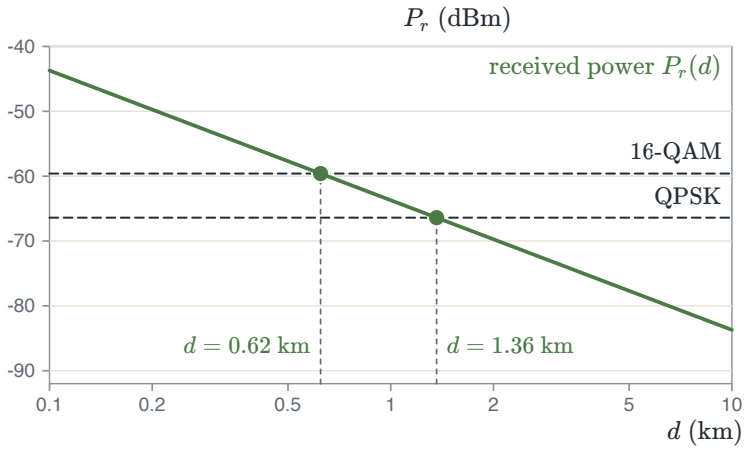


FIGURE 5.38 Example 5.5: received power against distance, with each sensitivity plus the 15 dB margin. Where they cross is the range.

Choosing a scheme around us

- Satellite DVB-S2 also sends 16APSK: 4 points on an inner ring and 12 on an outer ring. Two amplitudes suit a satellite amplifier better than the three of 16-QAM.
- Bluetooth Classic sends 1 million symbols a second. GFSK carries 1 bit a symbol, $\pi/4$-DQPSK carries 2 and 8DPSK 3, for 1, 2 and 3 Mb/s.
- GSM sends GMSK, whose envelope stays constant. A 16-QAM envelope jumps between three levels, so its amplifier must stay linear.
- LTE and 5G NR change the modulation as the channel changes, from QPSK with $k = 2$ up to 256-QAM with $k = 8$ bits a symbol.

- **Energy or band.** A link short of band packs more bits into each symbol. A link short of energy spreads them over orthogonal signals.
- **Amplifier cost.** A constant envelope lets the amplifier run near saturation. That matters in a handset and on a satellite.
- **Adapt.** Most modern links measure the channel and change M as it changes.

5.6 Summary

From bits to decisions

A link carries bits to decisions in four moves.

1. Map k bits to a point of the set.
2. The IQ modulator puts the point on the carrier.
3. Two correlators turn $r(t)$ into $\mathbf{r}$.
4. The receiver picks the nearest point.

Here the error rate follows from E_b/N_0 and the set. Chapter 6 asks how many bits a second a band and a power can carry at all.

The number of bits a second is the symbol rate times $k = \log_2 M$. For example, 16-QAM at 10^6 symbols a second carries $k = \log_2 16 = 4$ bits a symbol, so 4×10^6 b/s.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

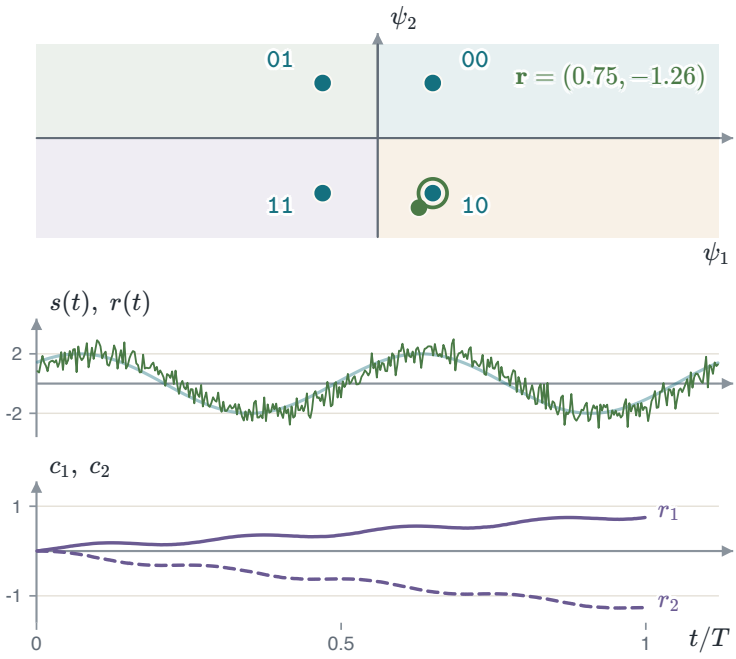


FIGURE 5.39 The bits 10 through a QPSK link. Top: the point $(1, -1)$ and the received point. Middle: the carrier $s(t)$ (faint) and the noisy $r(t)$. Bottom: the two correlator outputs, which end at r_1 and r_2.

Quick check

1 BPSK reaches $P_b = 10^{-5}$ at 9.6 dB. Where does BFSK reach it?

Answer: 12.6 dB. Half the squared distance costs 3 dB.

2 How many bits does each 8-PSK symbol carry?

Answer: 3 bits, since $\log_2 8 = 3$.

3 4-ASK moves to 8-ASK at the same $d_{\min}$. By about how much does E_s grow?

Answer: About 6 dB. $E_s \propto M^2 - 1$, so $10 \log_{10}(63/15) = 6.2$ dB.

4 Against what does a DPSK receiver decide each symbol?

Answer: The previous symbol. The bit is in the change of phase from the symbol before.

5 Orthogonal signals at a fixed bit rate go from $M = 8$ to $M = 16$. What does the band do?

Answer: It widens. $W = MR_b/(2 \log_2 M)$ goes from $1.33R_b$ to $2R_b$.

6 At a fixed bit rate, how wide is the QPSK main lobe next to that of BPSK?

Answer: Half as wide. Its symbols last twice as long.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Results of the chapter

TABLE 5.4 Summary of Chapter 5: the results the chapter carries forward.

QUESTION	RESULT	ANCHOR
What does a carrier do to the spectrum?	$U(f) = \frac{1}{2}S(f - f_c) + \frac{1}{2}S(f + f_c)$. The band doubles to $2W$ and the energy halves.	PS CH8.5.1
What does the IQ modulator send?	$s(t) = I\cos(2\pi f_c t) - Q\sin(2\pi f_c t)$: one point of the plane a symbol.	PS CH8.6, 8.7
How do the binary schemes compare?	BPSK: $Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$. BFSK and BASK: $Q\left(\sqrt{E_b/N_0}\right)$, 3 dB worse.	PS CH8.3.3, 8.6.1, 9.5
What is the M-PSK neighbour distance?	$d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E_s}\sin(\pi/M)$, and $P_e \approx 2Q\left(\sqrt{2E_s/N_0}\sin(\pi/M)\right)$.	PS CH8.6.1, 8.6.3
What do Gray labels buy?	Neighbours differ in one bit, so $P_b \approx P_e/\log_2 M$.	PS CH8.6.1, 8.6.3
What does DPSK save, and what does it cost?	No carrier phase. $P_b = \frac{1}{2}e^{-E_b/N_0}$, under 1 dB behind BPSK.	PS CH8.6.4, 8.6.5
What is the M-ASK error?	$\frac{2(M-1)}{M}Q\left(\sqrt{6E_s/((M^2-1)N_0)}\right)$, about 6 dB a doubling.	PS CH8.5.3
What is the square-QAM error?	$4(1 - 1/\sqrt{M})\,Q\left(\sqrt{3E_s/((M-1)N_0)}\right)$, with $E_s = (M-1)d^2/6$.	PS CH8.7.3
How much does QAM save over PSK?	4.20 dB at $M = 16$ and 9.95 dB at $M = 64$.	PS CH8.7.3
What do M orthogonal signals give?	$M - 1$ neighbours at $\sqrt{2E_s}$. The E_b/N_0 needed falls as M grows, toward -1.6 dB.	PS CH9.1.1, 9.1.2
What does noncoherent BFSK need?	Tones $1/T$ apart and an envelope detector. $P_b = \frac{1}{2}e^{-E_b/2N_0}$.	PS CH9.5.2, 9.5.3
What is MSK?	BFSK at $\Delta f = 1/(2T_b)$ with a continuous phase. Its envelope is constant.	PS CH9.6.1, 9.6.2
How wide is each family?	PSK and QAM: $R_b/\log_2 M$. Orthogonal: $MR_b/(2\log_2 M)$.	PS CH10.2, 9.7
Where does each family sit on the plane?	PAM, PSK and QAM: bandwidth-limited, $r > 1$. Orthogonal: power-limited, $r < 1$.	PS CH9.7

Pick the point set, read $d_{\min}$ and $\bar{N}_{\min}$, and apply the receiver of Chapter 4. Chapter 6 asks how far any scheme can go.

Projects to try

Four optional projects use the chapter on simulated signals. Each gives an aim, what it practises, a few steps and what to look for.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

AN IQ MODEM FROM SAMPLES

Build a QPSK and 16-QAM modem from sampled carriers and measure how often it is wrong.

Practises: The IQ modulator as two products and a sum. Two correlators as sums over samples. Counting errors to estimate P_e.

1. Build a cosine and a sine carrier over one symbol at 64 samples.
2. Map random bits to QPSK points and form $s(t) = I\cos - Q\sin$.
3. Add Gaussian noise, correlate, and pick the nearest point.
4. Repeat for 16-QAM and plot both error rates against E_b/N_0.

Look for: the measured points follow the formulas of this chapter once enough errors are counted.

GRAY AGAINST NATURAL LABELS

Measure how much Gray labels lower the bit error of 8-PSK.

Practises: Gray code as $i \oplus \lfloor i/2 \rfloor$. Why a symbol error usually lands on a neighbour. Bit error against symbol error.

1. Send random 8-PSK symbols over noise.
2. Label the points once with natural binary and once with Gray code.
3. Count the bit errors of each on the same noisy symbols.
4. Plot both bit errors and $P_e/3$ against E_b/N_0.

Look for: the Gray curve sits on $P_e/3$. The natural curve sits above it.

DPSK WITH A DRIFTING PHASE

See why differential detection survives a slowly drifting carrier phase.

Practises: Differential encoding of bits into phase changes. Coherent against differential detection. What a phase drift does to each.

1. Encode random bits as binary DPSK.
2. Turn each received symbol by a phase that grows slowly with time.
3. Detect coherently with a fixed reference and differentially.
4. Count the errors of each as the drift rate grows.

Look for: the coherent receiver fails once the drift passes 90°. The differential one barely notices.

AN ADAPTIVE LINK

Build a link that changes its constellation as the SNR changes.

Practises: Thresholds for a target bit error. Throughput against a fixed scheme. Why a margin above each threshold helps.

1. Draw an SNR that wanders slowly between 0 and 35 dB.
2. At each block pick the largest set that meets the target.
3. Simulate the block and count its errors.
4. Compare the bits delivered with a fixed QPSK link.

Look for: the adaptive link carries several times the bits at about the same error rate.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CHAPTER

6

An introduction to information theory

Two numbers set what any code can do. A source has an entropy: the fewest bits a symbol that any lossless code can reach. A channel has a capacity: the most bits a use that any code can carry reliably.

6.1 Information and entropy

A source emits one symbol at a time from an alphabet $s_1, \ldots, s_K$. Symbol s_k appears with probability p_k.

Self-information

The **self-information** of a symbol measures the information it carries as minus the logarithm of its probability.

SELF-INFORMATION

$$I(s_k) = \log_2 \frac{1}{p_k} = -\log_2 p_k \quad \text{bits}$$

A symbol of probability p_k carries $I(s_k)$ bits when it arrives. Base 2 gives bits, and base e gives nats.

A symbol of probability $1/8$ carries $-\log_2 \frac{1}{8} = \log_2 8 = 3$ bits: three halvings from certainty. The figure plots $I(p)$ against p.

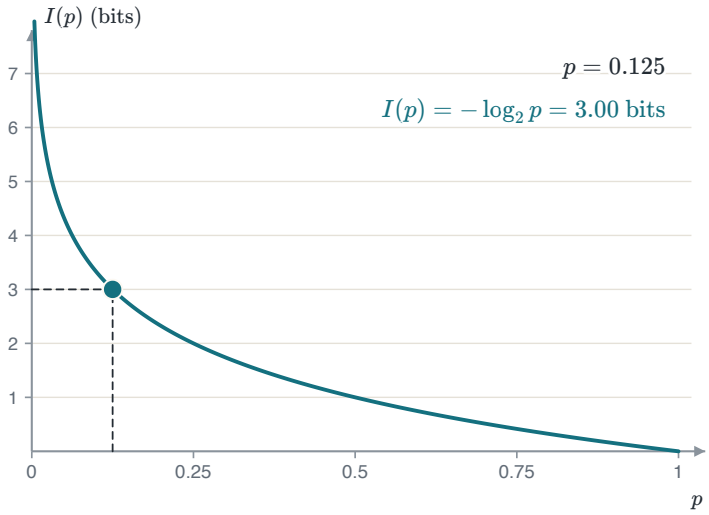


FIGURE 6.1 Self-information against probability, shown at $p = 1/8$, where $I = 3$ bits. A rare symbol carries many bits, and a certain one carries none.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

THREE PROPERTIES

$I(s_k) \geq 0$, and $I(s_k) = 0$ when $p_k = 1$. A certain symbol tells nothing.
Rarer symbols carry more: $I(s_k) > I(s_j)$ when $p_k < p_j$.
Independent symbols add. Their probabilities multiply, and the logarithm turns the product into a sum: $I(s_j s_k) = I(s_j) + I(s_k)$.

COMMON ERROR

Write $-\log_2 p_k$, not $\log_2 p_k$. The logarithm of a probability is negative, and information is not.

Information as yes/no questions

A bit has a plain reading as one yes/no question. A question whose two answers are equally likely halves the candidates. One such answer gives one bit.

EQUALLY LIKELY CASES

$$K = 2^m \text{ cases} \implies m = \log_2 K \text{ questions}$$

Eight equally likely cards take $\log_2 8 = 3$ questions: the answers cut 8 to 4, 4 to 2 and 2 to 1. Sixteen outcomes take $\log_2 16 = 4$ questions, which halve 16 to 8, 4, 2 and 1.

A skewed source is searched faster on average by asking about the likely symbol first. Take four symbols with probabilities $\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{8}, \frac{1}{8}$. The first question asks for s_1. The second asks for s_2, and the third separates s_3 from s_4.

AVERAGE NUMBER OF QUESTIONS

$$\begin{aligned} \bar{L} &= \tfrac{1}{2}(1) + \tfrac{1}{4}(2) + \tfrac{1}{8}(3) + \tfrac{1}{8}(3) \\ &= 0.5 + 0.5 + 0.375 + 0.375 \\ &= 1.75 = H \end{aligned}$$

Symbol s_k is found after $-\log_2 p_k$ questions: 1, 2, 3 and 3 here. So the average number of questions is the average self-information of the source. That average is the entropy H, defined next.

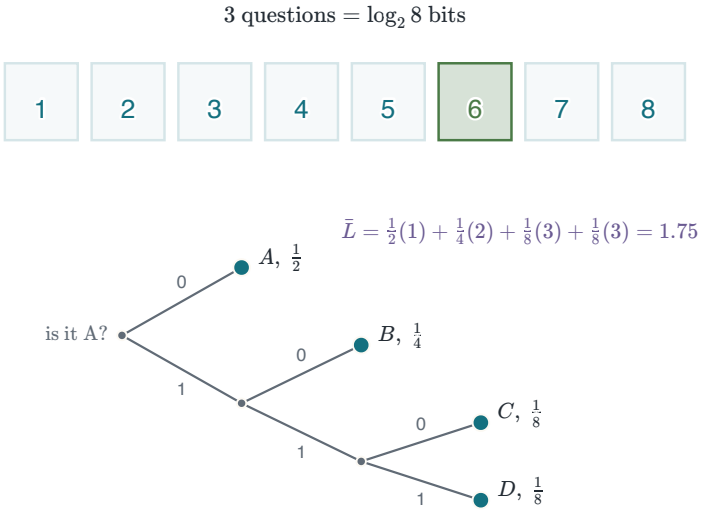


FIGURE 6.2 Top: one of eight equally likely cards found with three yes/no questions. Bottom: the skewed source $\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{8}, \frac{1}{8}$ asked with a tree, likely symbol first. Shown at the last step, where the average is $\bar{L} = 1.75$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Entropy

The **entropy** of a source is the average self-information of its symbols. Each symbol's information is weighted by how often the symbol occurs.

ENTROPY

$$H(S) = \sum_{k=1}^{K} p_k I(s_k) = -\sum_{k=1}^{K} p_k \log_2 p_k$$

The average information of a symbol, in bits a symbol.

For the source $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$, write out the three terms and add them.

ENTROPY OF A THREE-SYMBOL SOURCE

$$\begin{aligned} H(S) &= -0.7 \log_2 0.7 - 0.2 \log_2 0.2 - 0.1 \log_2 0.1 \\ &= 0.360 + 0.464 + 0.332 \\ &= 1.157 \text{ bits} \end{aligned}$$

The figure draws both quantities for each symbol: the bits it carries, and that number weighted by its probability.

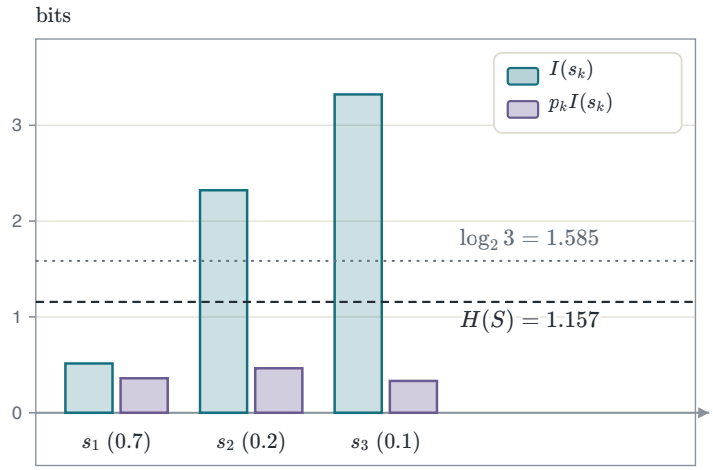


FIGURE 6.3 For each symbol of $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$: the bits it carries (left bar) and its weighted share (right bar). The weighted bars add to $H(S) = 1.157$, below $\log_2 3 = 1.585$.

The entropy lies between two bounds.

ENTROPY BOUNDS

$$0 \le H(S) \le \log_2 K$$

The lower bound holds when one symbol has probability 1 and nothing is in doubt. The upper bound holds when all K symbols are equally likely. With $p_k = 1/K$ the sum is $\sum_k \frac{1}{K} \log_2 K = \log_2 K$. Three equal symbols give $\log_2 3 = 1.585$ bits, more than the 1.157 of the skewed source.

The binary entropy function

A source of two symbols with probabilities p and $1 - p$ has the **binary entropy function**.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

BINARY ENTROPY

$$H_b(p) = -p \log_2 p - (1-p) \log_2 (1-p)$$

It is symmetric about $p = \frac{1}{2}$, where $H_b = 1$ bit. It is 0 only at $p = 0$ and $p = 1$.

The top of the curve is flat: at $p = \frac{1}{2}$, $H_b = 1$ bit, and it falls slowly near the top. At $p = 0.11$ the two terms are $-0.11 \log_2 0.11 = 0.350$ and $-0.89 \log_2 0.89 = 0.150$. So $H_b(0.11) = 0.500$ bit.

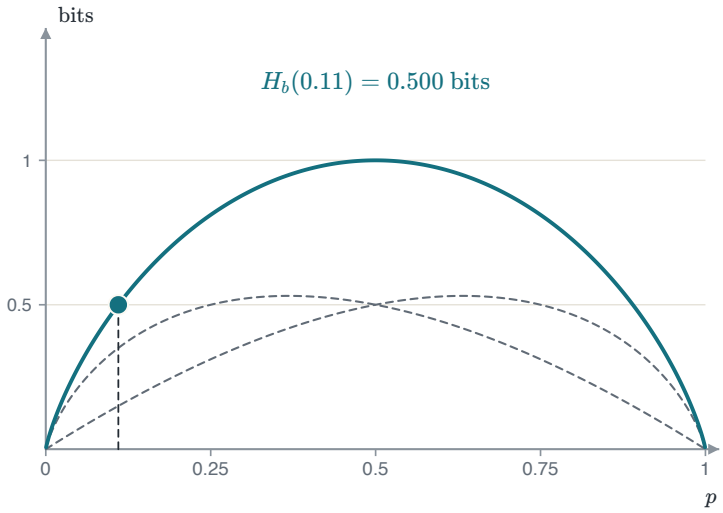


FIGURE 6.4 The binary entropy function (solid) and its two terms (dashed), shown at $p = 0.11$. The top is flat near $p = \frac{1}{2}$.

A **binary symmetric source** emits equally likely, independent bits. Each bit carries one bit of information, and no lossless code can shorten the stream.

A sampled source produces symbols at a fixed rate. Its **information rate** is the entropy of a sample times the number of samples a second.

EXAMPLE 6.1 — THE INFORMATION RATE OF A SOURCE

GIVEN — A source band-limited to $W = 3$ kHz is sampled at the Nyquist rate. Each sample takes one of four levels with probabilities $0.4, 0.3, 0.2, 0.1$.

FIND — The information rate R in bits a second.

METHOD — The rate is bits a sample times samples a second, $R = H(S)\, f_s$. The Nyquist rate of Chapter 1 is $f_s = 2W = 6000$ samples a second.

SOLUTION — $H(S) = -\sum_k p_k \log_2 p_k = 0.529 + 0.521 + 0.464 + 0.332 = 1.846$ bits a sample. Then $R = 1.846 \times 6000 = 11\,079$ b/s.

CHECK — Four levels carry at most $\log_2 4 = 2$ bits a sample, or $12\,000$ b/s. The skewed levels carry less, as the entropy bound requires.

COMMON ERROR

Multiply by the sample rate $2W$, not by the bandwidth W. Using 3000 samples a second gives half the rate, 5539 b/s.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

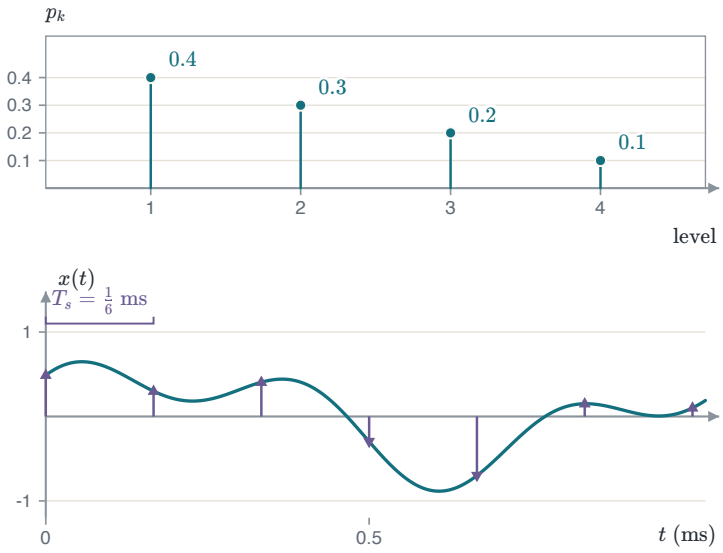


FIGURE 6.5 Top: the four levels of Example 6.1 and their probabilities. Bottom: a source band-limited to 3 kHz, sampled every $T_s = \frac{1}{6}$ ms, which is 6000 samples a second.

Extended sources

A coder can also take the symbols in blocks of n. Each block is one symbol of a new source, the **n-th extension** S^n, whose alphabet has K^n symbols.

The entropy of a block follows from the additive property. Write the entropy of a pair, split the logarithm of the product, and sum out the other symbol.

ENTROPY OF A PAIR

$$\begin{aligned} H(S^2) &= -\sum_{i,j} p_i p_j \log_2 (p_i p_j) \\ &= -\sum_{i,j} p_i p_j \left(\log_2 p_i + \log_2 p_j\right) \\ &= -\sum_{i} p_i \log_2 p_i \sum_{j} p_j - \sum_{j} p_j \log_2 p_j \sum_{i} p_i \\ &= H(S) + H(S) \end{aligned}$$

Each inner sum of probabilities is 1. Repeating the step for n symbols gives the general rule.

EXTENSION

$$H(S^n) = n\, H(S)$$

The symbols of a memoryless source are independent, so their information adds. For $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$ the nine pair probabilities are $0.49, 0.14, 0.07, 0.14, 0.04, 0.02, 0.07, 0.02, 0.01$. Summed the long way they give $H(S^2) = 2.3136 = 2 \times 1.1568$ bits. Triples give $H(S^3) = 3 \times 1.1568 = 3.470$ bits.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

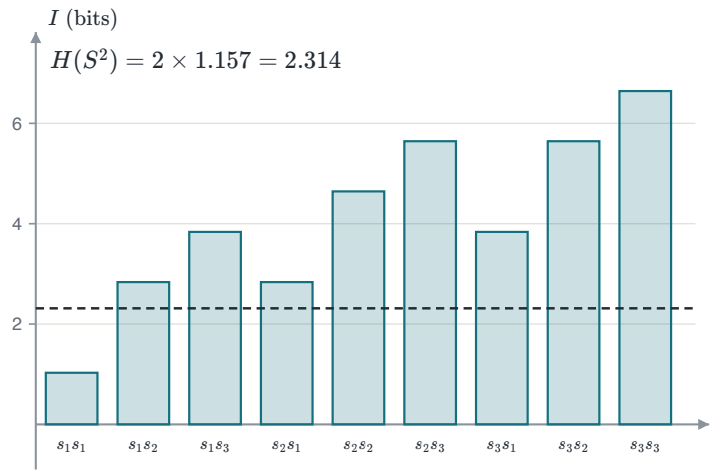


FIGURE 6.6 The bits each pair of S^2 carries, for the source $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$. A pair carries the sum of its two symbols' bits, so the average (dashed) doubles to 2.314.

> ⚠ MEMORY
>
> The rule needs a memoryless source. With memory, as in English where q is followed by u, a block carries less than $nH(S)$. Compressors live on that surplus.

Entropy around us

To find the entropy of real data, count how often each symbol occurs, then apply $H = -\sum_k p_k \log_2 p_k$. Four everyday sources:

- The 24 symbols of a short speech, letters and space, by frequency. $H = -\sum_k p_k \log_2 p_k = 3.97$ bits a symbol, against $\log_2 24 = 4.58$.
- A fair die carries $\log_2 6 = 2.585$ bits a throw. A die loaded to show six half the time carries $H = 2.161$ bits.
- A scanned text line, 8 pixels a millimetre, is 90% white. As independent pixels it carries $H_b(0.1) = 0.469$ bit a pixel, not 1.
- A drawn 64×64 grey image, 8 levels. Its histogram gives $H = 2.42$ bits a pixel, below $\log_2 8 = 3$.

> ✓ UNEVEN IS CHEAPER
>
> Each source here sits below $\log_2 K$. The gap is what a variable-length code can save.

> ⚠ MEMORY
>
> Letters and pixels depend on their neighbours. The entropy with memory is lower still, about 1.3 bits a letter for English.

6.2 The limits of compression

Code length

A **source encoder** maps each symbol s_k to a string of bits, its **codeword**, of length l_k. Common symbols should get short codewords and rare symbols long ones.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

AVERAGE LENGTH AND EFFICIENCY

$$\bar{L} = \sum_{k=1}^{K} p_k l_k, \qquad \eta = \frac{H(S)}{\bar{L}} \leq 1$$

The code for $\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{8}, \frac{1}{8}$ with lengths $1, 2, 3, 3$ has $\bar{L} = \frac{1}{2}(1) + \frac{1}{4}(2) + \frac{1}{8}(3) + \frac{1}{8}(3) = 1.75$. That equals H, so $\eta = 1$.

In this code each length equals the information of its symbol. The figure sets the two side by side.

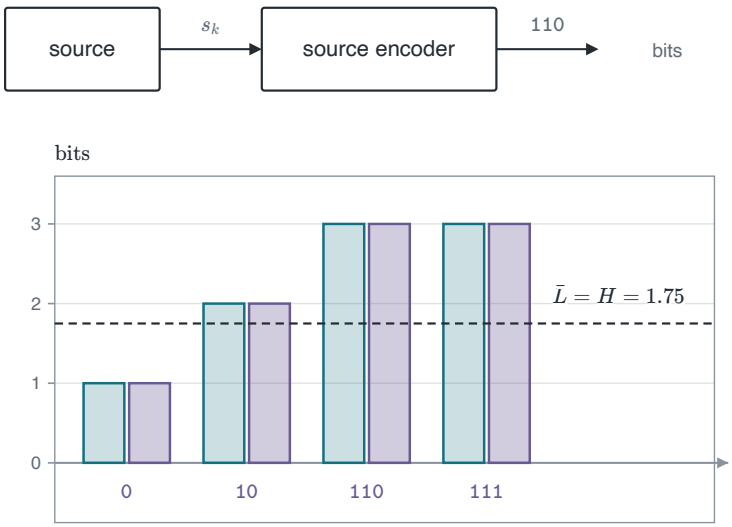


FIGURE 6.7 The source encoder maps each symbol to a codeword. For $\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{8}, \frac{1}{8}$ each code length (right bar) equals the information of its symbol (left bar).

SOURCE CODING THEOREM

Every uniquely decodable code has $\bar{L} \geq H(S)$. The entropy is the fewest bits a symbol that a lossless code can reach.

English shows how far a simple code can sit from this limit. With its memory, English carries about 1.3 bits a letter. A letter-by-letter code needs 4.22 bits, so $\eta = 1.3/4.22 = 0.31$.

Typical sequences

Long sequences show where the limit comes from. Take n bits from a binary source with $P(1) = p$. A long sequence has about np ones and $n(1-p)$ zeros.

The probability of such a sequence follows from these counts. Take its logarithm and divide by $-n$.

PROBABILITY OF A TYPICAL SEQUENCE

$$\begin{aligned} P(\mathbf{x}) &= p^{np}(1-p)^{n(1-p)} \\ -\tfrac{1}{n}\log_2 P(\mathbf{x}) &= -p\log_2 p - (1-p)\log_2(1-p) = H \\ P(\mathbf{x}) &= 2^{-nH} \end{aligned}$$

All such sequences have nearly the same probability, 2^{-nH}. They are the **typical sequences**.

A sequence counts as typical when its value of $-\frac{1}{n}\log_2 P$ lies within ϵ of H. For large n the typical sequences hold almost all the probability. Their probabilities then add to about one, so there are about 2^{nH} of them.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

THE TYPICAL SET

$$P(\mathbf{x}) \approx 2^{-nH}, \qquad |A| \approx 2^{nH} \text{ of } 2^n \text{ sequences}$$

The rest are rare. With $p = 0.2$, $H = 0.722$. At $n = 100$ there are about $2^{100 \times 0.722} = 2^{72.2}$ typical sequences, a tiny fraction of the 2^{100}.

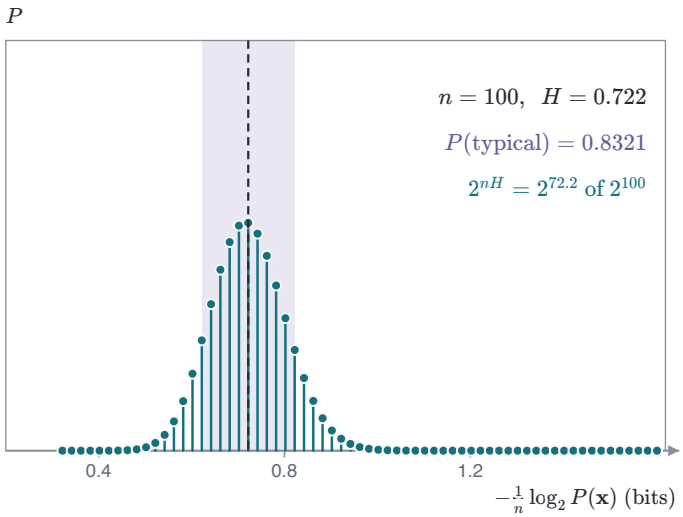


FIGURE 6.8 Every sequence of n bits with $P(1) = 0.2$, placed at its value of $-\frac{1}{n}\log_2 P$ with its probability, shown at $n = 100$. The probability gathers in the band $H \pm 0.1$ (shaded).

⚠ UNIFORM SOURCE

At $p = \frac{1}{2}$, $H = 1$ and every one of the 2^n sequences is typical. There is nothing to compress.

The source coding theorem

A code can give each typical sequence a number, its index, and give up on the rare rest. About nH bits name a typical sequence, which is H bits a symbol. The chance of meeting a rare sequence falls to zero as n grows.

SOURCE CODING THEOREM

$$R > H: \ P_{\text{error}} \to 0, \qquad R < H: \ P_{\text{error}} \not\to 0$$

A code of R bits a symbol can be made reliable when R exceeds H, and never when R falls below it. A source with $H = 0.5$ bit a symbol, in blocks of $n = 1000$, needs about $nH = 500$ bits a block to name its 2^{500} typical blocks.

Ten bits show the count in full. Take $p = 0.2$ and $\epsilon = 0.1$, so the band runs from 0.622 to 0.822. A sequence on the edge of the band counts as typical.

THE TYPICAL SEQUENCES OF TEN BITS

$$k = 2: \quad -\tfrac{1}{10}\log_2\left(0.2^2\, 0.8^8\right) = 0.722$$

$$k = 1: \ 0.522, \qquad k = 3: \ 0.922$$

Here k is the number of ones. Only the sequences with two ones fall inside the band. There are $\binom{10}{2} = 45$ of them, each of probability $0.2^2\, 0.8^8 = 0.00671$. Together they hold $45 \times 0.00671 = 0.3020$ of the probability. An index of 6 bits names them, since $2^6 = 64 \geq 45$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

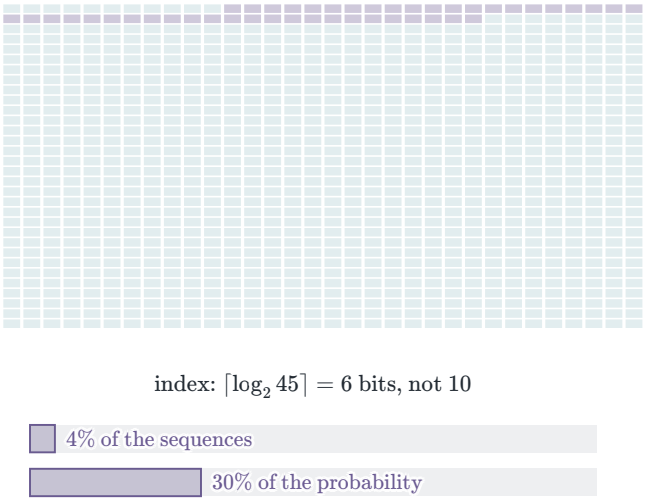


FIGURE 6.9 All 1024 sequences of ten bits with $P(1) = 0.2$, in order of their number of ones, shown at the last step. The 45 typical ones are 4% of the sequences, hold 30% of the probability and take a 6-bit index.

The share held by the typical set grows with n.

TABLE 6.1 Probability held by the typical set, for $p = 0.2$ and $\epsilon = 0.1$.

n	$P(\text{typical})$
10	30%
100	83%
1000	99.99%

Prefix codes

Short codewords help only if the receiver can split the bit stream back into codewords. A code is **uniquely decodable** when every bit string of the code comes from one symbol string only.

A **prefix code** is one in which no codeword starts another. The decoder names a symbol as soon as its last bit arrives, so a prefix code is also called **instantaneous**.

TABLE 6.2 Three codes for the same four symbols.

SYMBOL	CODE I	CODE II	CODE III
s_1	0	0	0
s_2	1	10	01
s_3	00	110	011
s_4	11	111	0111

Code I is not uniquely decodable: 00 is s_3 or $s_1 s_1$. Code II is a prefix code. It splits the bits 0101100111 as 0 10 110 0 111, which is $s_1 s_2 s_3 s_1 s_4$.

Code III is uniquely decodable, because every codeword starts with 0. It is not instantaneous. After 01 the decoder must wait: a 1 next means a longer word, and a 0 means s_2. The same bits read as 01 011 0 0111, which is $s_2 s_3 s_1 s_4$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

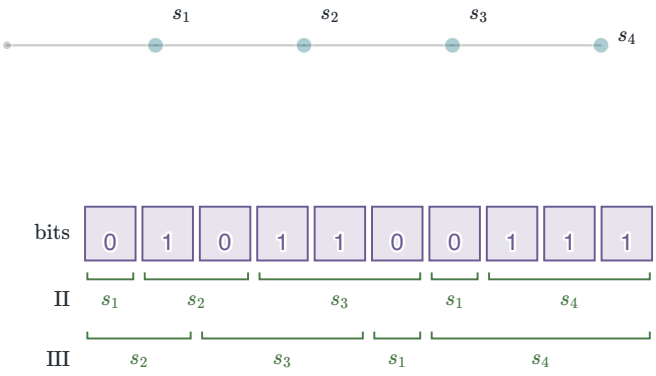


FIGURE 6.10 The three codes drawn as trees, shown at the last step. The tree of Code III is faint, and the bits 0101100111 are read with Codes II and III. In Code III each codeword lies on the path to the next.

The Kraft inequality

Codeword lengths can be tested before the codewords are chosen. A codeword of length l owns the fraction 2^{-l} of the unit interval: all long bit strings that start with it. In a prefix code these fractions do not overlap, so they add to at most one.

KRAFT INEQUALITY

$$\sum_{k=1}^{K} 2^{-l_k} \leq 1$$

A prefix code with lengths l_k exists exactly when the sum is at most one.

KRAFT SUMS OF THE THREE CODES

$$\begin{aligned} \text{I} &: \tfrac{1}{2}+\tfrac{1}{2}+\tfrac{1}{4}+\tfrac{1}{4} = 1.5 \\ \text{II} &: \tfrac{1}{2}+\tfrac{1}{4}+\tfrac{1}{8}+\tfrac{1}{8} = 1 \\ \text{III} &: \tfrac{1}{2}+\tfrac{1}{4}+\tfrac{1}{8}+\tfrac{1}{16} = 0.9375 \end{aligned}$$

Code I gives $1.5 > 1$, so no prefix code has its lengths. Code II gives exactly 1. Lengths $1, 2, 2, 3$ give $\frac{1}{2}+\frac{1}{4}+\frac{1}{4}+\frac{1}{8} = 1.125 > 1$ and allow no prefix code either.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

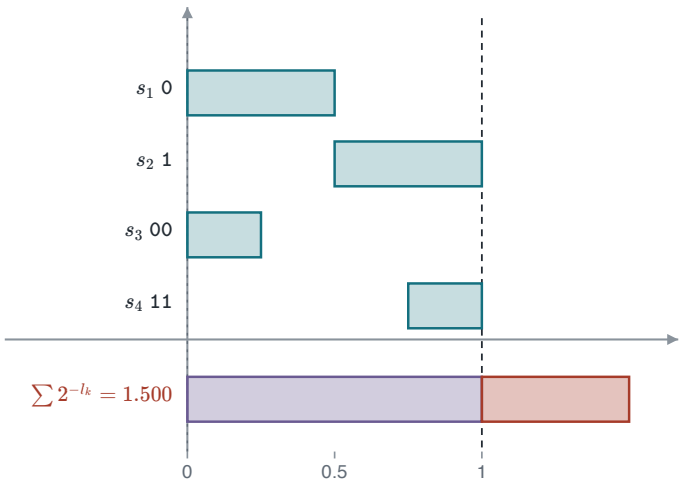


FIGURE 6.11 Each codeword of length l owns 2^{-l} of the unit interval, shown for Code I. Its stretches overlap, and the Kraft sum at the bottom is 1.5, past 1 (red).

> ⚠ LENGTHS, NOT CODEWORDS
>
> Code III passes the test and is still not a prefix code. The inequality tests lengths only. The lengths $1, 2, 3, 4$ of Code III allow the prefix code 0, 10, 110, 1110.

The source-coding bound

The ideal length of a codeword is $-\log_2 p_k$, the information of its symbol. It is rarely a whole number, so round it up.

ROUNDED LENGTHS

$$l_k = \lceil -\log_2 p_k \rceil \implies -\log_2 p_k \le l_k < -\log_2 p_k + 1$$

$$2^{-l_k} \le p_k \implies \sum_k 2^{-l_k} \le \sum_k p_k = 1$$

The second line shows that the rounded lengths pass the Kraft test. So a prefix code with these lengths exists.

Multiply the first line by p_k and sum over k. The left side becomes $H(S)$, and the middle becomes $\bar{L}$.

SOURCE-CODING BOUND

$$H(S) \le \bar{L} < H(S) + 1$$

The rounding adds less than one bit a symbol. If every $p_k = 2^{-l_k}$, the source is **dyadic**. Then no length is rounded, and $\bar{L} = H(S)$.

The rounding bit can be spread over a block. Apply the bound to the extension S^n, whose entropy is $nH(S)$, and divide by n.

BLOCKS OF n SYMBOLS

$$nH(S) \le L_n < nH(S) + 1 \implies H(S) \le \frac{L_n}{n} < H(S) + \frac{1}{n}$$

Blocks of $n = 10$ symbols sit at most $1/10 = 0.1$ bit a symbol above H. The price is the codebook, which grows as K^n. For three symbols that is $3^{10} = 59\,049$ words.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

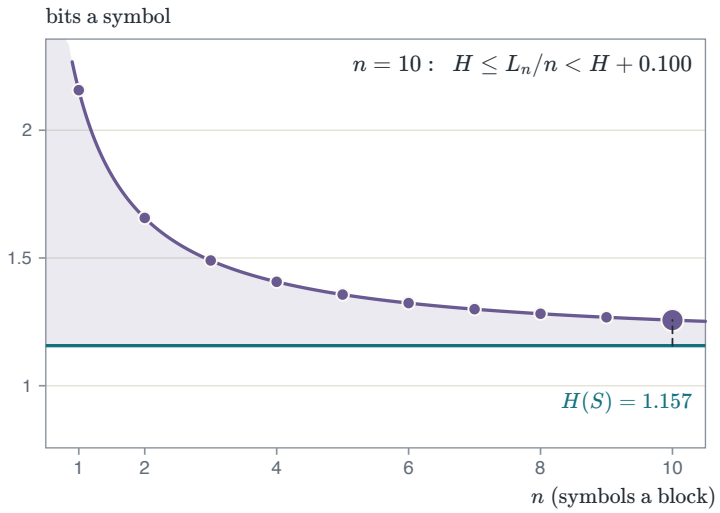


FIGURE 6.12 Bounds on the bits a symbol for blocks of n symbols from $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$, shown at $n = 10$. The gap of $1/n$ above $H(S) = 1.157$ closes as n grows.

Rate and distortion

When some error is allowed, fewer bits suffice. The **rate–distortion function** gives the fewest bits a sample for a mean-square error D.

For a Gaussian source of variance σ^2 the function has a closed form.

GAUSSIAN SOURCE

$$D(R) = \sigma^2\, 2^{-2R} \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad R(D) = \tfrac{1}{2} \log_2 \frac{\sigma^2}{D}$$

One more bit multiplies D by $2^{-2(R+1)}/2^{-2R} = \frac{1}{4}$. In decibels that is $10 \log_{10} 4 = 6.02$ dB a bit, the same rule as the quantizers of Chapter 1.

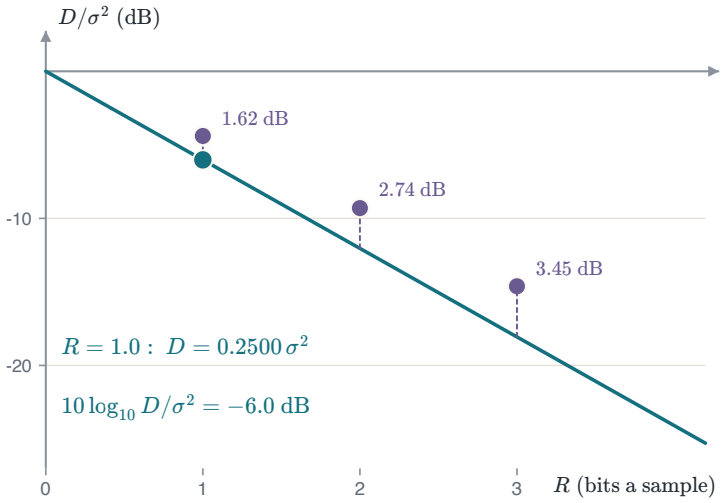


FIGURE 6.13 The least distortion of a Gaussian source at R bits a sample (line), and the Lloyd–Max quantizers of Chapter 1 (dots). Shown at $R = 1$, where $D = 0.25\,\sigma^2$.

⚠ QUANTIZERS

The Lloyd–Max quantizer of Chapter 1 codes one sample at a time. It sits 1.62 dB above $D(R)$ at 1 bit and 2.74 dB above it at 2 bits. Coding blocks of samples closes the gap.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Codes around us

Morse code and UTF-8 give frequent symbols short codewords. That is the idea of every variable-length code. Four everyday codes:

- Morse code gives common letters short signals: e is one dot. Each letter lasts $T = \sum_i t_i + (m-1)$ units, with a dot 1 and a dash 3.
- UTF-8 writes a character in 1 to 4 bytes: 1 for $b \le 7$, else $\lceil (b-1)/5 \rceil$. A lead byte never starts another, so it is a prefix code.
- Telephone country codes: $+1$, $+30$, $+351$, $+971$. No code is the start of another, so a switch knows where the code ends without a separator.
- Braille sets each letter in a cell of six dots, raised or flat: $2^6 = 64$ patterns, 6 bits a letter whatever its frequency.

PREFIX CODES

UTF-8 and the country codes need no separators. A reader knows where each codeword ends.

FIXED LENGTH

Braille spends 6 bits a letter. Without its spaces, the speech in Section 6.1 carries 4.04 bits a letter.

6.3 Huffman and Lempel–Ziv coding

Huffman coding

Huffman coding builds a prefix code by repeated merges.

HUFFMAN ALGORITHM

1. Sort the probabilities.
2. Merge the two smallest into one entry whose probability is their sum. Label the pair 0 and 1, and sort again.
3. At one entry, read each codeword from the last merge back to its symbol.

Apply it to the source $0.4, 0.2, 0.2, 0.1, 0.1$ for $s_1, \dots, s_5$. A merged entry that ties with others is placed above them.

THE MERGES

$$0.1 + 0.1 = 0.2, \qquad 0.2 + 0.2 = 0.4, \qquad 0.4 + 0.2 = 0.6, \qquad 0.6 + 0.4 = 1$$

CODEWORDS

$$\texttt{00},\ \texttt{10},\ \texttt{11},\ \texttt{010},\ \texttt{011}$$

Read back from the last merge, these are the codewords of s_1 to s_5. The two most likely symbols get two bits, the two least likely three.

The lengths are $2, 2, 2, 3, 3$. Weight each by its probability to get $\bar{L}$, then divide H by it.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

AVERAGE LENGTH AND EFFICIENCY

$$\begin{aligned}\bar{L} &= 0.4(2) + 0.2(2) + 0.2(2) + 0.1(3) + 0.1(3) \\ &= 0.8 + 0.4 + 0.4 + 0.3 + 0.3 = 2.2 \text{ bits}\end{aligned}$$

$$\eta = \frac{H(S)}{\bar{L}} = \frac{2.1219}{2.2} = 0.9645$$

The average 2.2 lies above $H = 2.1219$. No prefix code for single symbols has a smaller average length.

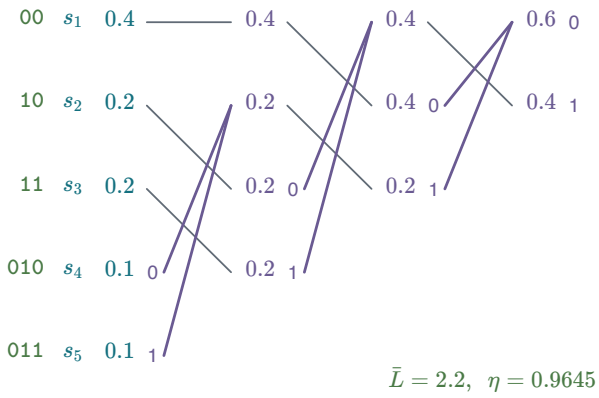


FIGURE 6.14 The Huffman merges for $0.4, 0.2, 0.2, 0.1, 0.1$. Each column merges the two smallest entries of the column before, labelled 0 and 1, and sorts again. Shown at the last step, with the codewords read back at the left.

Ties and variance

A merged entry often ties with other entries of the same probability. It may be placed above them or below them. Both choices give a Huffman code with the same average length.

TWO HUFFMAN CODES FOR $0.4, 0.2, 0.2, 0.1, 0.1$

$$\text{high: } l_k = 2, 2, 2, 3, 3, \qquad \bar{L} = 2.2$$

$$\text{low: } l_k = 1, 2, 3, 4, 4, \qquad \bar{L} = 0.4 + 0.4 + 0.6 + 0.4 + 0.4 = 2.2$$

Placed high, the codewords are $00, 10, 11, 010, 011$. Placed low, they are $1, 01, 000, 0010, 0011$.

The two codes differ in how far the lengths spread around $\bar{L}$. The **variance** of the codeword length measures that spread.

VARIANCE OF THE CODEWORD LENGTH

$$\sigma^2 = \sum_k p_k \left(l_k - \bar{L}\right)^2$$

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma^2_{\text{high}} &= 0.8(0.2)^2 + 0.2(0.8)^2 = 0.032 + 0.128 = 0.16 \\ \sigma^2_{\text{low}} &= 0.4(1.2)^2 + 0.2(0.2)^2 + 0.2(0.8)^2 + 0.2(1.8)^2 \\ &= 0.576 + 0.008 + 0.128 + 0.648 = 1.36\end{aligned}$$

Placing the merged entry high gives the least variance. Lengths near $\bar{L}$ keep the bit rate steady, so a transmitter with a small buffer fills and empties it less.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

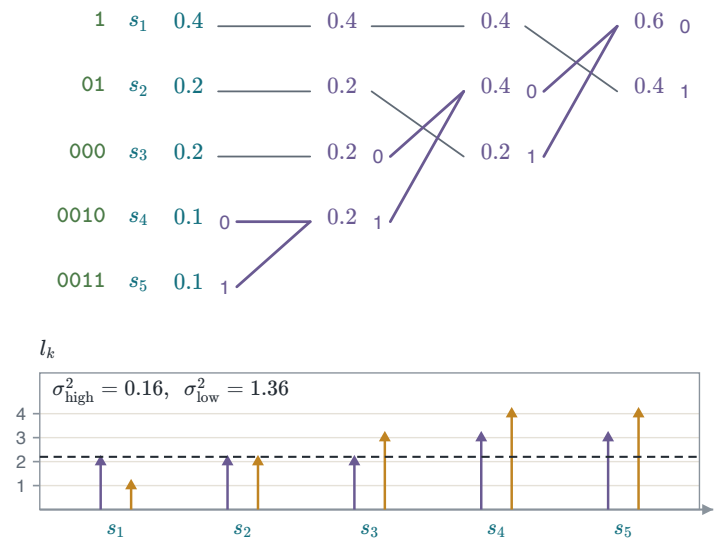


FIGURE 6.15 Top: the merges with ties placed low. Bottom: the codeword lengths of the two codes, ties high (violet) and ties low (amber), against $\bar{L} = 2.2$ (dashed).

Huffman codes for pairs of symbols

Huffman coding of the single symbols $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$ gives the codewords $0, 10, 11$. Their average length is $0.7(1) + 0.2(2) + 0.1(2) = 1.3$ bits, against $H = 1.157$.

Coding blocks spreads the rounding loss. Build a Huffman code for the K^n blocks of n symbols, and divide its average length by n.

TABLE 6.3 Huffman codes for single symbols, pairs and triples of $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$, against $H = 1.1568$.

n	BLOCKS	$\bar{L}_n/n$ (BITS A SYMBOL)	BOUND $H + 1/n$	EFFICIENCY η
1	3	1.3	2.1568	0.8898
2	9	1.165	1.6568	0.9929
3	27	1.1753	1.4901	0.9842

Pairs cost $\bar{L}_2 = 2.33$ bits a pair, or $2.33/2 = 1.165$ bits a symbol. Triples cost 1.1753 bits a symbol, a little more than pairs.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

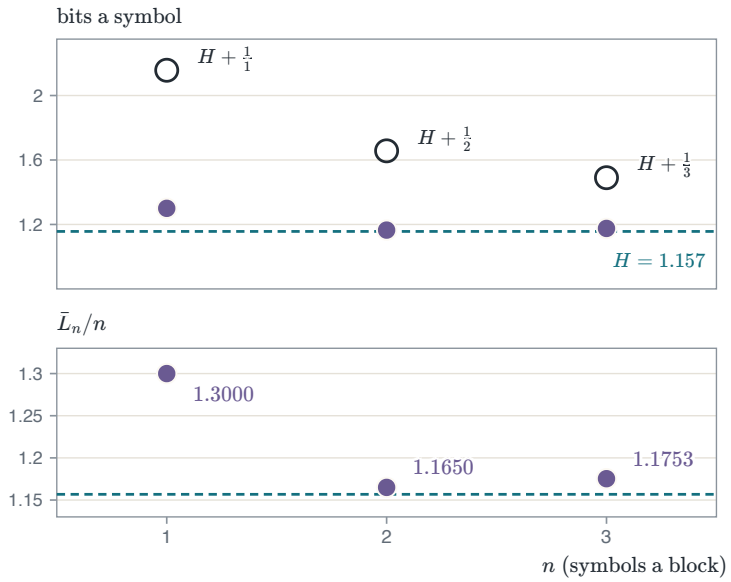


FIGURE 6.16 Huffman codes for single symbols, pairs and triples of $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$. Top: the bound $H + 1/n$ (rings) and the code (dots). Bottom: the code, enlarged.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Expect the bound $H + 1/n$ to fall with n, not the cost of every block code. Triples give 1.1753 bits a symbol, worse than the 1.165 of pairs.

Arithmetic coding

Arithmetic coding codes a whole message at once. It starts with the interval $[0, 1)$. Each symbol keeps the part of the current interval that its probability owns.

Code the message $s_1 s_1 s_2$ from the source $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$. The symbols own the first 70%, the next 20% and the last 10% of each interval.

THE INTERVAL AFTER EACH SYMBOL

$$\begin{aligned} s_1 &: [0, 0.7) \\ s_1 s_1 &: [0, 0.49) \\ s_1 s_1 s_2 &: [0.343, 0.441) \end{aligned}$$

The last symbol keeps the part from 70% to 90% of $[0, 0.49)$: $0.7 \times 0.49 = 0.343$ and $0.9 \times 0.49 = 0.441$.

Each symbol scales the interval by its probability. So the width is the probability of the whole message.

WIDTH

$$w = \prod_i p(s_i) = 0.7 \times 0.7 \times 0.2 = 0.098$$

A binary fraction of l bits inside the interval names it. About $-\log_2 w$ bits are needed, plus one.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TAG

$$l = \lceil -\log_2 w \rceil + 1 = \lceil 3.35 \rceil + 1 = 5 \text{ bits}$$

The tag is $0.01100_2 = 0.375$. Every binary fraction that starts with 0.01100 lies in $[0.375, 0.40625)$, inside $[0.343, 0.441)$. The extra bit is paid once a message.

The tag length follows the width. When the width halves, the tag needs one more bit, because $-\log_2(w/2) = -\log_2 w + 1$.

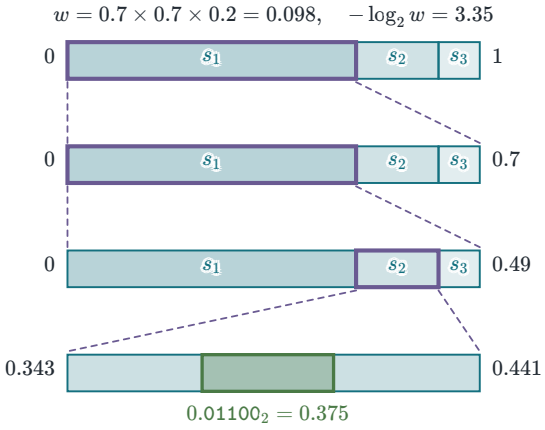


FIGURE 6.17 Arithmetic coding of $s_1 s_1 s_2$ with $0.7, 0.2, 0.1$. Each symbol keeps its share of the current interval. Shown at the last step, where the binary fraction 0.375 names the final interval.

Lempel–Ziv coding

Lempel–Ziv coding builds a dictionary of phrases from the stream itself.

LEMPEL–ZIV PARSING

Read the stream. Cut off the shortest string not yet in the dictionary, and add it as a new entry. Each new phrase is an earlier phrase plus one bit.

Each phrase is sent as a pair. The pointer names the earlier phrase, and one more bit carries the new bit. The decoder builds the same dictionary from the pairs.

PHRASE CODE

$$(\text{pointer},\ \text{new bit}): \quad 010 \to (4, 0)$$

Parse the 18-bit stream 000101110010100101. The dictionary starts with the empty phrase as entry 0. The table lists the eight phrases and the pair sent for each.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

TABLE 6.4 Lempel–Ziv parsing of the stream 000101110010100101.

ENTRY i	PHRASE	PAIR SENT	BITS $\lceil \log_2 i \rceil + 1$
1	0	$(0, 0)$	1
2	00	$(1, 0)$	2
3	1	$(0, 1)$	3
4	01	$(1, 1)$	3
5	11	$(3, 1)$	4
6	001	$(2, 1)$	4
7	010	$(4, 0)$	4
8	0101	$(7, 1)$	4

Phrase 7, 010, is phrase 4 plus a 0, so it is sent as $(4, 0)$. The stream then goes on 0101. That is entry 7 plus a 1, a new phrase, sent as $(7, 1)$.

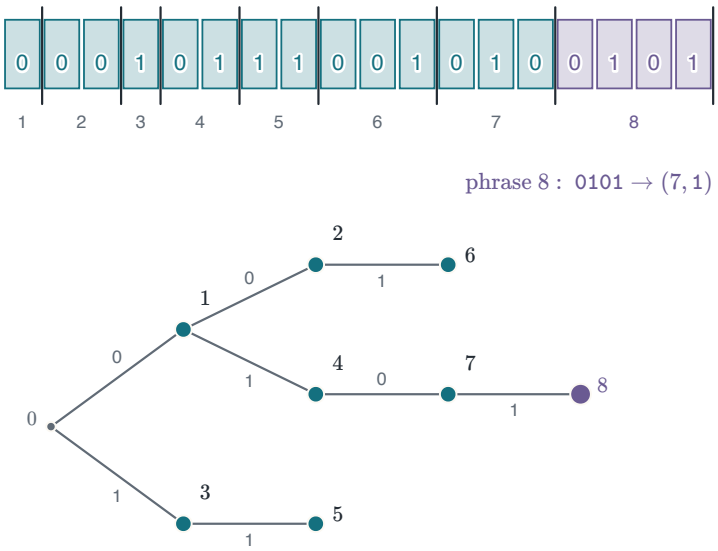


FIGURE 6.18 The 18-bit stream parsed into phrases, shown after the eighth phrase. Each new phrase is an earlier phrase plus one bit, so the dictionary grows as a tree.

Phrase i can point to any of the i entries 0 to $i - 1$, so its pointer needs $\lceil \log_2 i \rceil$ bits. The last column of the table adds to $1 + 2 + 3 + 3 + 4 + 4 + 4 + 4 = 25$ bits.

> ⚠ SHORT STREAMS
>
> With a 3-bit pointer and one new bit, eight phrases take 32 bits for 18. A pointer of $\lceil \log_2 i \rceil$ bits for phrase i takes 25.

Lempel–Ziv on a long stream

Lempel–Ziv is a **universal** code: it is told nothing about the source, and it learns the frequent strings from the stream itself. On a long stream the phrases grow long, and each pointer stands for many source bits.

For c phrases the cost is a sum over the phrases.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

COST OF c PHRASES

$$L = \sum_{i=1}^{c} \left(\lceil \log_2 i \rceil + 1 \right) \text{ bits}$$

Take a binary source with $P(1) = 0.1$, so $H_b(0.1) = 0.469$ bit a symbol. On one random stream the cost is 0.689 bits a source bit after 10^3 bits and 0.557 after 10^6.

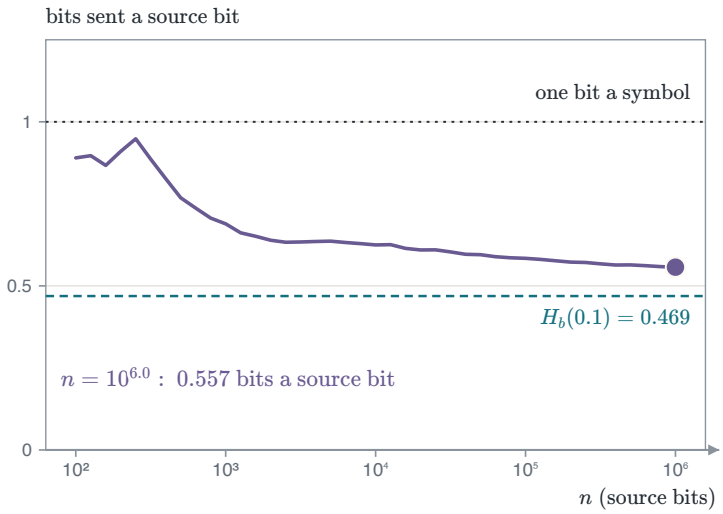


FIGURE 6.19 Lempel–Ziv on one random stream from a binary source with $P(1) = 0.1$: the bits sent a source bit against the stream length, and $H_b(0.1)$ (dashed). Shown at $n = 10^6$.

⚠ SLOW APPROACH

The cost falls toward H only as the phrases grow long, and it never falls below H. Any code for single binary symbols costs 1 bit a symbol here.

Compression around us

Each format below first turns the data into something with low entropy: copies, differences, zeros or runs.

- ZIP and gzip use DEFLATE: LZ77 copies, then Huffman codes. $\ell(i)$ is the longest earlier copy of the text from character i.
- PNG filters each row first: $d[n] = x[n] - x[n-1]$ takes 2.11 bits a pixel against 5.00. DEFLATE then codes $d[n]$.
- JPEG takes the DCT of each 8×8 block and quantizes it. Here 9 of the 64 values c_k are nonzero. The runs of zeros are Huffman-coded.
- A fax line of $\sum_i \ell_i = 1728$ pixels is sent as run lengths ℓ_i, white and black in turn, each Huffman-coded.

✓ THEN HUFFMAN

A Huffman code, or a close cousin, then spends bits by frequency.

⚠ LOSSY AND LOSSLESS

ZIP, PNG and fax lose nothing. JPEG throws information away in its quantizer before any coding.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

6.4 Channels and mutual information

The discrete memoryless channel

A **discrete memoryless channel** takes an input symbol x_j and returns an output symbol y_k with probability $p(y_k \mid x_j)$. Memoryless means each use ignores the others.

The transition probabilities form the **channel matrix**, with one row for each input.

CHANNEL MATRIX

$$\mathbf{P} = \begin{bmatrix} p(y_0 \mid x_0) & p(y_1 \mid x_0) \\ p(y_0 \mid x_1) & p(y_1 \mid x_1) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.8 & 0.2 \\ 0.3 & 0.7 \end{bmatrix}$$

Row j is the output distribution of input x_j, so it sums to one: $0.8 + 0.2 = 0.3 + 0.7 = 1$. The columns need not sum to one. Here they give 1.1 and 0.9.

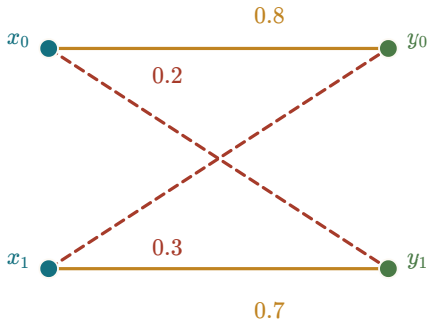


FIGURE 6.20 The channel above as a diagram. Each input has a line to each output it can reach, labelled with the probability of that move. Amber lines keep the symbol, and red lines change it.

Input and output distributions

The channel fixes $p(y \mid x)$. The transmitter chooses the **input distribution** $p(x)$. Together they give the joint and the output distributions.

JOINT AND OUTPUT DISTRIBUTIONS

$$p(x_j, y_k) = p(y_k \mid x_j)\, p(x_j)$$

$$p(y_k) = \sum_j p(y_k \mid x_j)\, p(x_j)$$

The output probability adds the joint probabilities of every path that ends at y_k.

With $p(x_0) = 0.75$, the output y_0 comes from x_0 with probability 0.6 and from x_1 with probability 0.075. Add the two paths.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

OUTPUT DISTRIBUTION FOR $p(x_0) = 0.75$

$$\begin{aligned} p(y_0) &= 0.8 \times 0.75 + 0.3 \times 0.25 \\ &= 0.6 + 0.075 = 0.675 \\ p(y_1) &= 1 - 0.675 = 0.325 \end{aligned}$$

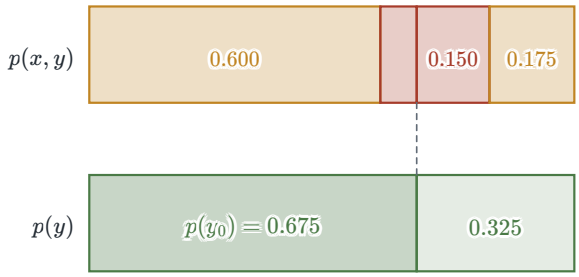


FIGURE 6.21 The four joint probabilities of the channel $0.8/0.2$, $0.3/0.7$, drawn to width: kept (amber) and moved (red). Below, the output distribution they add to (green), shown at $p(x_0) = 0.75$.

The binary symmetric channel

The **binary symmetric channel** (BSC) has two inputs and two outputs. Each bit arrives flipped with probability p, the **crossover probability**, and intact with probability $1 - p$, whatever its value.

BINARY SYMMETRIC CHANNEL

$$\mathbf{P} = \begin{bmatrix} 1-p & p \\ p & 1-p \end{bmatrix}$$

The matched-filter receiver of Chapter 4, deciding each BPSK bit of Chapter 5, hands on a BSC. Its crossover is the BPSK bit error. Here $Q(x)$ is the Gaussian tail.

BSC FROM HARD-DECISION BPSK

$$p = Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$$

$$\begin{aligned} E_b/N_0 = 4\ \text{dB} &= 10^{0.4} = 2.512 \\ p = Q\left(\sqrt{2 \times 2.512}\right) &= Q(2.241) = 0.0125 \end{aligned}$$

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

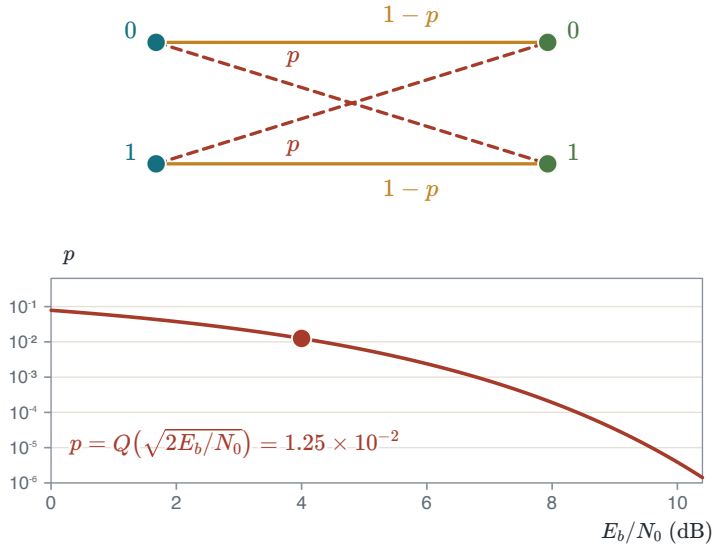


FIGURE 6.22 Top: the binary symmetric channel. Bottom: its crossover when BPSK is decided bit by bit, shown at $E_b/N_0 = 4$ dB, where $p = 0.0125$.

> ⚠ HARD DECISIONS
>
> Deciding each bit throws away how sure the receiver was. The gallery at the end of Section 6.5 plots the capacity left after that decision.

Joint entropy and the chain rule

The **joint entropy** of two variables is the entropy of the pair, treated as one symbol.

JOINT ENTROPY

$$H(X,Y) = -\sum_{j,k} p(x_j, y_k)\log_2 p(x_j, y_k)$$

The uncertainty about Y left once X is known is the conditional entropy $H(Y \mid X) = -\sum_{j,k} p(x_j, y_k)\log_2 p(y_k \mid x_j)$. The joint probability splits as $p(x,y) = p(x)\,p(y \mid x)$. Its logarithm is a sum, and averaging each term gives the **chain rule**.

CHAIN RULE

$$\begin{aligned} H(X,Y) &= -\sum_{j,k} p(x_j, y_k)\left[\log_2 p(x_j) + \log_2 p(y_k \mid x_j)\right] \\ &= H(X) + H(Y \mid X) \end{aligned}$$

$$H(X,Y) = H(X) + H(Y \mid X) = H(Y) + H(X \mid Y)$$

Learn X first, then what is left of Y. The second form follows the same way with the roles of X and Y swapped.

Take the joint pmf $p(x_0, y_0) = p(x_1, y_1) = 0.4$ and $p(x_0, y_1) = p(x_1, y_0) = 0.1$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CHAIN RULE FOR ONE PMF

$$H(X,Y) = -2(0.4)\log_2 0.4 - 2(0.1)\log_2 0.1 = 1.7219$$

$$H(X) = 1, \qquad H(Y \mid X) = H_b(0.2) = 0.7219$$

Each input has probability 0.5, so $H(X) = 1$. Given either input, Y agrees with probability $0.4/0.5 = 0.8$, so $H(Y \mid X) = H_b(0.2)$. The two parts add to 1.7219, as the chain rule says.

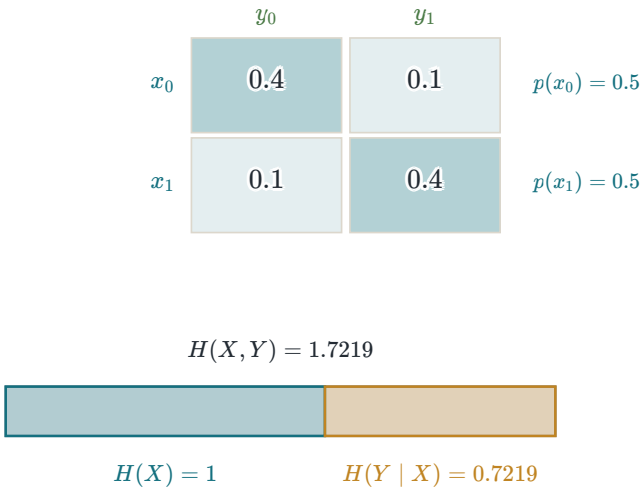


FIGURE 6.23 The joint pmf as tiles, and its joint entropy as a bar, shown at the last step: $H(X)$ fills part of the bar, and $H(Y \mid X)$ fills the rest.

Conditional entropy

The receiver sees Y and wants X. The **conditional entropy** $H(X \mid Y)$ is the uncertainty about the input left after the output is seen, averaged over the outputs.

CONDITIONAL ENTROPY

$$H(X \mid Y) = \sum_k p(y_k)\, H(X \mid Y = y_k)$$

Return to the channel $0.8/0.2$, $0.3/0.7$ with $p(x_0) = 0.75$. Bayes' rule gives the input probabilities after each output.

AFTER EACH OUTPUT

$$P(x_0 \mid y_0) = \frac{0.8 \times 0.75}{0.675} = 0.889, \qquad H_b(0.889) = 0.503$$

$$P(x_0 \mid y_1) = \frac{0.2 \times 0.75}{0.325} = 0.462, \qquad H_b(0.462) = 0.996$$

$$H(X \mid Y) = 0.675(0.503) + 0.325(0.996) = 0.663$$

Before the output, $H(X) = H_b(0.75) = 0.811$ bit. Output y_0 removes much of the doubt. Output y_1 leaves the input almost a coin toss.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

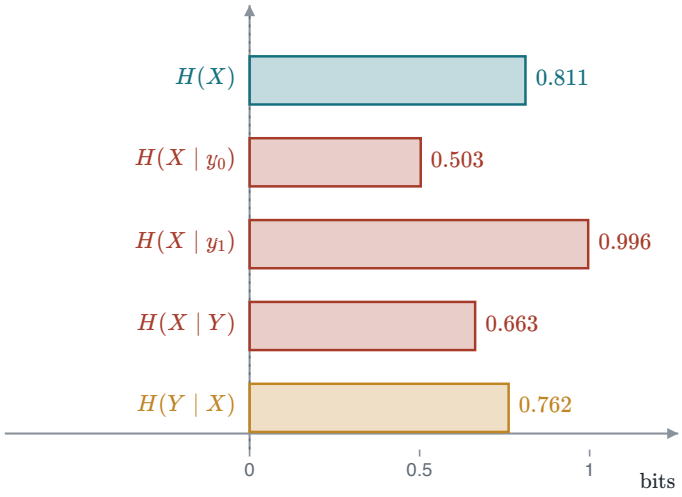


FIGURE 6.24 The channel $0.8/0.2$, $0.3/0.7$ with $p(x_0) = 0.75$: the uncertainty about X before the output, after each output, their average, and the other conditional entropy $H(Y \mid X)$.

⊗ COMMON ERROR

Keep $H(X \mid Y)$ apart from $H(Y \mid X)$. Here $H(Y \mid X) = 0.75H_b(0.2) + 0.25H_b(0.3) = 0.762$, but $H(X \mid Y) = 0.663$.

In a BSC with equally likely inputs, either output leaves the input wrong with probability p. So $H(X \mid Y) = H_b(p)$. At $p = 0.1$ that is $H_b(0.1) = 0.469$ bit.

Mutual information

Mutual information is the uncertainty about the input that the output removes. It is the uncertainty before the output, less the uncertainty after it.

MUTUAL INFORMATION

$$I(X;Y) = H(X) - H(X \mid Y)$$

For a BSC with equal inputs, $H(X) = 1$ and $H(X \mid Y) = H_b(p)$. Substitute both.

BSC WITH EQUAL INPUTS

$$I(X;Y) = 1 - H_b(p)$$

At $p = 0$ the full bit gets through. At $p = \frac{1}{2}$ the output is a coin toss and $I = 0$. At $p = 0.1$, $I = 1 - 0.469 = 0.531$ bit a use.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

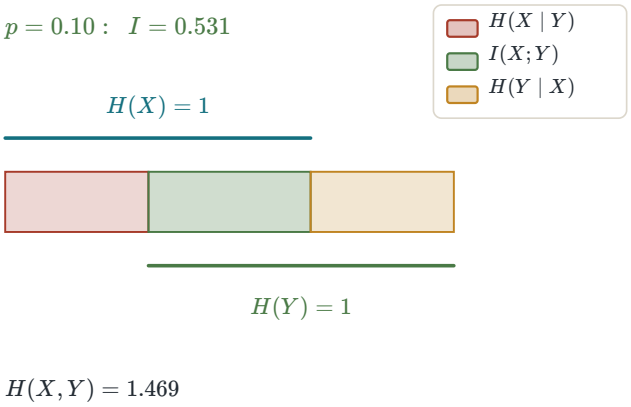


FIGURE 6.25 A BSC with equal inputs, shown at $p = 0.1$. The bar is $H(X,Y)$, the line above it $H(X)$ and the line below it $H(Y)$. Their overlap is $I(X;Y)$.

Properties of mutual information

Mutual information is symmetric. It follows from Bayes' rule: $p(x,y)$ is the same read either way. The chain rule gives $H(X \mid Y) = H(X,Y) - H(Y)$ and $H(Y \mid X) = H(X,Y) - H(X)$. Substitute either one into the definition.

SYMMETRY AND THE JOINT ENTROPY

$$I(X;Y) = H(X) - H(X \mid Y) = H(Y) - H(Y \mid X) = I(Y;X)$$

$$I(X;Y) = H(X) + H(Y) - H(X,Y) \geq 0$$

Adding $H(X)$ and $H(Y)$ counts the shared part twice, so the joint entropy is subtracted once.

A BSC with $p = 0.25$ and equal inputs has $H(X) = H(Y) = 1$ and $H(X,Y) = 1.811$. So $I(X;Y) = 1 + 1 - 1.811 = 0.189$ bit.

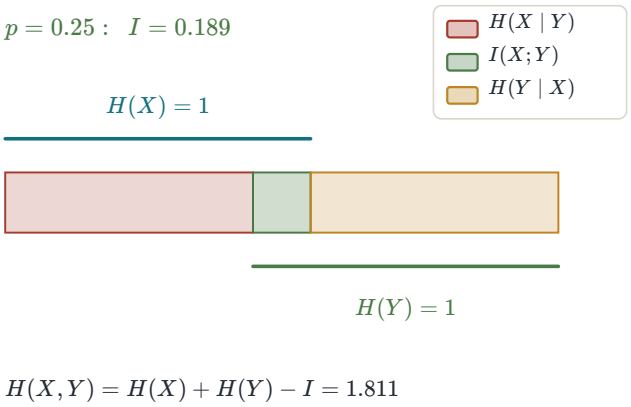


FIGURE 6.26 The bars for a BSC with $p = 0.25$ and equal inputs. The shared middle is the same whether it is read from X or from Y.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

NEVER NEGATIVE

Seeing Y never adds to the uncertainty about X on average: $H(X \mid Y) \leq H(X)$. Equality holds when X and Y are independent. Then nothing is shared, and $I(X;Y) = 0$.

Information around us

In each case below, $I = H(X) - H(X \mid Y)$ is how much the observation lowers the uncertainty.

- A forecast: rain 30% of days, forecast on 80% of rainy days and 10% of dry ones. $I(W;F) = 0.348$ of $H(W) = 0.881$ bits.
- A test with 99% sensitivity and a 5% false-positive rate. For a condition in 1% of people, $I(D;T) = 0.041$ bit a test.
- A BPSK receiver that decides each bit. With equal bits $I = 1 - H_b(p)$ and $p = Q\big(\sqrt{2E/N_0}\big)$: 0.903 bit at 4 dB.
- An 8-level quantizer of step 0.5σ on a Gaussian sample. Its output is fixed by the input, so $I(X;Q) = H(Q) = 2.888$ bits.

ACCURATE IS NOT INFORMATIVE

A good test of a rare condition says little on average, because it almost always reads negative.

DETERMINISTIC OUTPUT

When Y is a function of X, $H(Y \mid X) = 0$ and $I(X;Y) = H(Y)$.

6.5 Channel capacity

Channel capacity

Mutual information depends on the channel and on the input distribution. The channel fixes $p(y \mid x)$, and the transmitter picks the input distribution. The choice that lets the most through gives the **capacity**.

CHANNEL CAPACITY

$$C = \max_{p(x)} I(X;Y) \quad \text{bits per use}$$

$I(X;Y)$ depends on the input. C does not: the maximum has removed it, so C is a property of the channel alone.

The BSC is symmetric in its two inputs. So $I(X;Y)$ is symmetric about $q = p(x_0) = \frac{1}{2}$, and its peak sits there, with $C = 0.531$ at $p = 0.1$. The Z-channel of Example 6.2 is not symmetric. Its peak sits at $q = 0.6$, with $C = 0.322$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

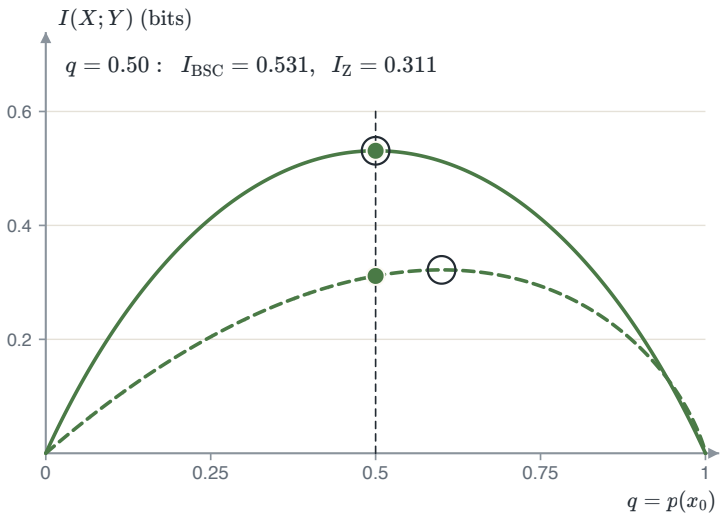


FIGURE 6.27 Mutual information against the input distribution, for a BSC with $p = 0.1$ (solid) and the Z-channel (dashed), shown at $q = \frac{1}{2}$. The ring on each peak is its capacity.

Capacity of the binary symmetric channel

Write the mutual information from the output side and bound $H(Y)$.

CAPACITY OF THE BSC

$$\begin{aligned} I(X;Y) &= H(Y) - H(Y \mid X) \\ &= H(Y) - H_b(p) \\ &\le 1 - H_b(p) \end{aligned}$$

$$C = 1 - H_b(p)$$

Whatever the input, each output is wrong with probability p, so $H(Y \mid X) = H_b(p)$. A binary output has $H(Y) \le 1$. Equal inputs give equal outputs and make $H(Y) = 1$.

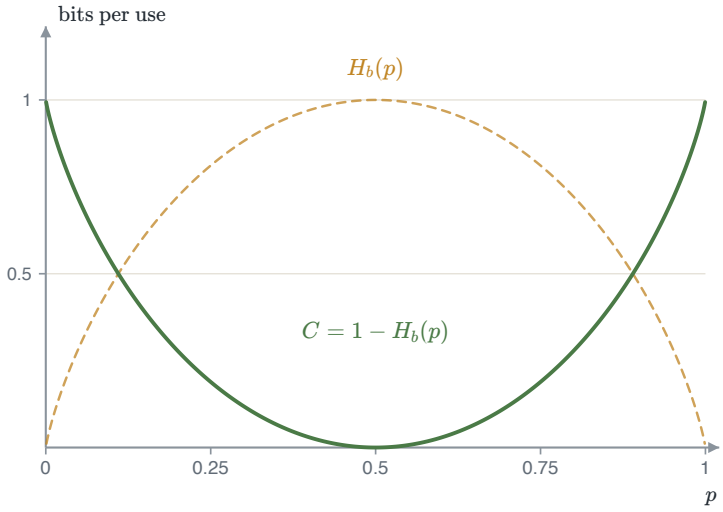


FIGURE 6.28 The capacity $C = 1 - H_b(p)$ of the binary symmetric channel (solid) against its crossover p, over $H_b(p)$ (dashed). It is 0 at $p = \frac{1}{2}$.

The capacity is 0 at $p = \frac{1}{2}$, where the output ignores the input. At $p = 1$ every bit flips, the receiver flips it back, and $C = 1$. At $p = 0.11$, $H_b = 0.500$ and $C = 0.500$ bit a use.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The binary erasure channel

The **binary erasure channel** (BEC) never flips a bit. Each bit arrives intact with probability $1-\epsilon$, or as a flagged erasure e with probability ϵ.

An intact bit leaves no doubt about the input. An erasure leaves the input as uncertain as before. So $H(X \mid Y) = \epsilon H(X)$, and the mutual information follows.

CAPACITY OF THE BEC

$$I(X;Y) = H(X) - \epsilon H(X) = (1-\epsilon)H(X)$$

$$C = 1 - \epsilon$$

Equal inputs give $H(X) = 1$ and reach the capacity. The bits that arrive are certain, and only the erased fraction is lost. At $\epsilon = 0.1$ the BEC carries 0.9 bit a use, and a BSC with $p = 0.1$ carries 0.531.

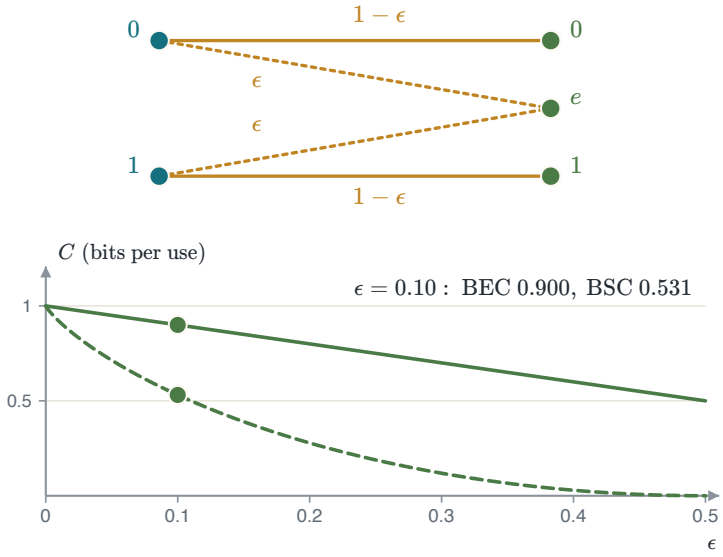


FIGURE 6.29 Top: the binary erasure channel, where a lost bit arrives as e. Bottom: its capacity (solid) against the BSC with $p = \epsilon$ (dashed), shown at $\epsilon = 0.1$.

⚠ FLAGGED AGAINST HIDDEN

The BSC hides its errors among good bits, so it loses $H_b(\epsilon)$ bits a use. That is more than ϵ for $\epsilon < \frac{1}{2}$.

EXAMPLE 6.2 — THE Z-CHANNEL

GIVEN A 0 is always received as 0. A 1 is received as 0 or 1 with probability $\frac{1}{2}$ each. Let $q = P(X = 0)$.

FIND The capacity C and the input distribution that reaches it.

METHOD The channel is not symmetric, so equal inputs need not be best. Write $I(X;Y) = H(Y) - H(Y \mid X)$ as a function of q, and set its derivative to zero.

SOLUTION Only $X = 1$ leaves the output uncertain, with $H_b(\frac{1}{2}) = 1$ bit, so $H(Y \mid X) = 1 - q$. The output is 1 with probability $(1-q)/2$, so $I(q) = H_b\big(\frac{1-q}{2}\big) - (1-q)$. The derivative of $H_b(x)$ is $\log_2 \frac{1-x}{x}$, and $x = \frac{1-q}{2}$ has $\mathrm{d}x/\mathrm{d}q = -\frac{1}{2}$. So $\mathrm{d}I/\mathrm{d}q = 1 - \frac{1}{2}\log_2 \frac{1+q}{1-q}$. Setting it to zero gives $\frac{1+q}{1-q} = 4$, so $q^* = 0.6$. Then $x = 0.2$ and $C = H_b(0.2) - 0.4 = 0.7219 - 0.4 = 0.3219$ bit a use.

CHECK Write $H_b(0.2) = 0.2\log_2 5 + 0.8\log_2 \frac{5}{4} = \log_2 5 - 1.6$. Then $C = \log_2 5 - 2 = \log_2 \frac{5}{4} = 0.3219$, the same value. The best input sends the reliable 0 three times in five.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

COMMON ERROR

Use the maximum over q, not equal inputs. At $q = \frac{1}{2}$, $I = H_b(0.25) - 0.5 = 0.3113$, below C. On an asymmetric channel the best input is not uniform.

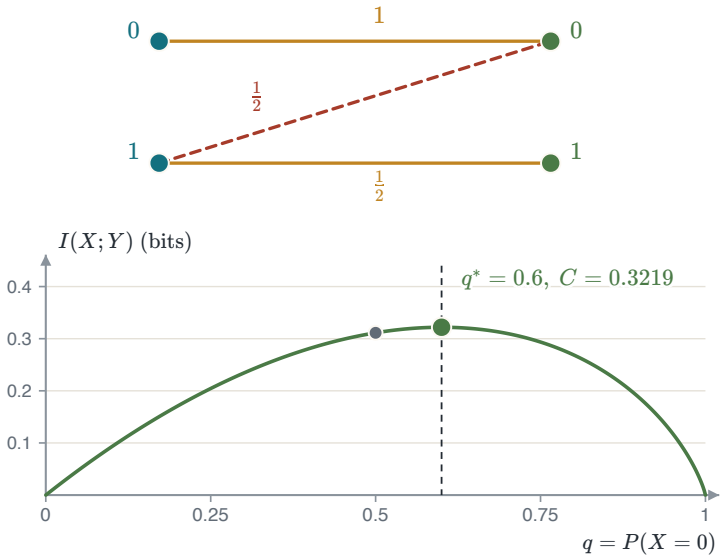


FIGURE 6.30 Top: the Z-channel. A 0 always arrives, and a 1 turns into 0 half the time. Bottom: $I(X;Y)$ against q, with its peak at $q^* = 0.6$ and the value at $q = \frac{1}{2}$ (grey).

EXAMPLE 6.3 — A SYMMETRIC THREE-OUTPUT CHANNEL

GIVEN Three inputs and three outputs. Each row of the channel matrix is a shift of $0.6, 0.2, 0.2$, so each column is too.

FIND The capacity, and the input distribution that reaches it.

METHOD Every row has the same entropy, so $H(Y \mid X) = H(0.6, 0.2, 0.2)$ for any input. Inputs of $\frac{1}{3}$ each make the outputs equal, because every column holds $0.6, 0.2, 0.2$. Then $H(Y) = \log_2 K$, its largest value, and $C = \log_2 K - H(\text{row})$.

SOLUTION $H(0.6, 0.2, 0.2) = 0.442 + 0.464 + 0.464 = 1.371$ bits. So $C = \log_2 3 - 1.371 = 1.585 - 1.371 = 0.2140$ bit a use.

CHECK One bit needs at least $1/0.214 = 4.67$ uses of this channel. The uniform input reaches C, as the symmetry of the rows requires.

COMMON ERROR

Use $\log_2 3 - H(\text{row})$, not $\log_2 3$, for the capacity. The value $\log_2 3 = 1.585$ is the most any three-output channel carries.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

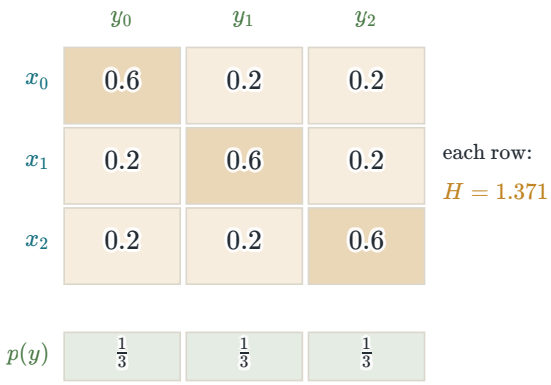


FIGURE 6.31 The channel matrix of Example 6.3 as tiles. Each row is a shift of $0.6, 0.2, 0.2$. Equal inputs give equal outputs, shown in the bottom row.

Reliable transmission over a noisy channel

Capacity also counts the messages a channel keeps apart. Take a channel with four inputs, where each input reaches two of four outputs with probability $\frac{1}{2}$ each. Every output can then come from two inputs.

Use only x_0 and x_2, whose outputs do not overlap. The receiver never confuses them, so the channel carries one bit a use with no errors.

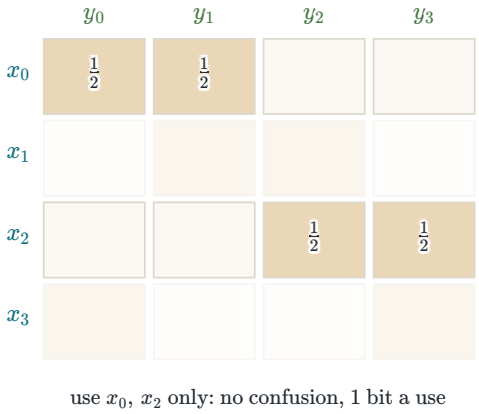


FIGURE 6.32 A four-input channel whose outputs overlap, as tiles. Using only x_0 and x_2 leaves no output that can come from both.

Long blocks do the same for a BSC. A word of n bits almost surely lands among about $2^{nH_b(p)}$ likely outputs, its cloud. Codewords whose clouds do not overlap can be told apart.

COUNTING CODEWORDS

$$M \approx \frac{2^n}{2^{nH_b(p)}} = 2^{n(1-H_b(p))} = 2^{nC}$$

There are 2^n output words in all. So about 2^{nC} codewords fit, which is C bits a use. At $n = 100$ and $p = 0.11$, $C = 0.5$ and about $2^{100 \times 0.5} = 2^{50}$ codewords fit.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

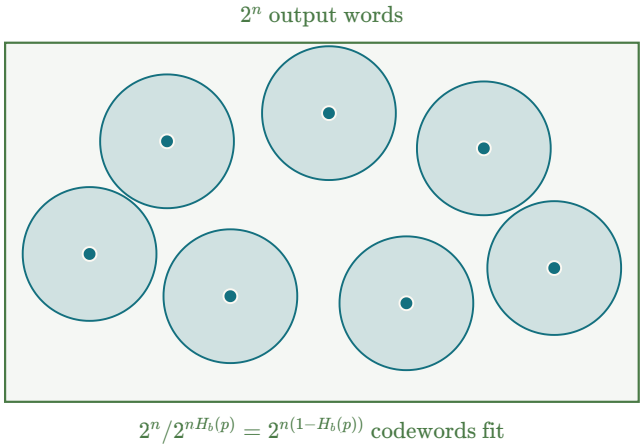


FIGURE 6.33 Long blocks of a BSC: each codeword owns a cloud of about $2^{nH_b(p)}$ likely outputs among the 2^n output words.

Repetition codes

The simplest channel code sends each bit n times, with n odd, and decides by majority. It is a **repetition code** of rate $R = 1/n$. The vote fails when more than half the copies flip.

ERROR OF A REPETITION CODE

$$P_e = \sum_{k > n/2} \binom{n}{k} p^k (1-p)^{n-k}$$

On a BSC with $p = 0.1$, one copy fails with $P_e = 0.1$. Three and five copies need two and three flips to fail.

REPETITION ON A BSC WITH $p = 0.1$

$$\begin{aligned} n = 3: \quad P_e &= 3p^2(1-p) + p^3 \\ &= 0.027 + 0.001 = 0.028 \\ n = 5: \quad P_e &= 10p^3(1-p)^2 + 5p^4(1-p) + p^5 \\ &= 0.0081 + 0.00045 + 0.00001 \approx 0.0086 \end{aligned}$$

At $n = 15$, $P_e = 3.36 \times 10^{-5}$, but the rate has fallen to $1/15$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

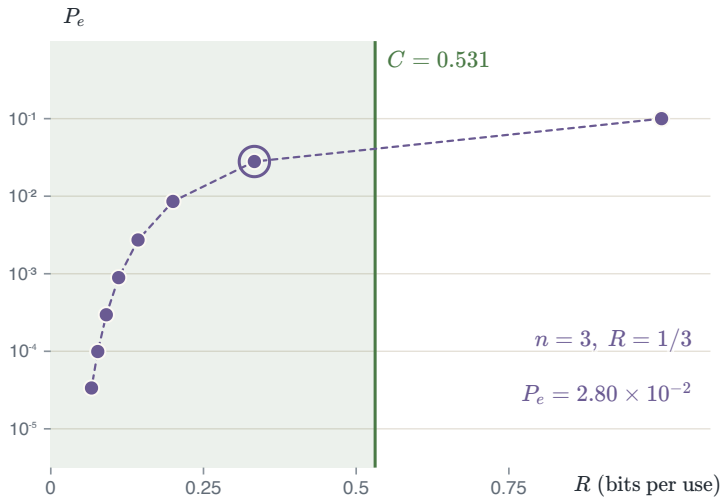


FIGURE 6.34 Repetition codes on a BSC with $p = 0.1$: the error after a majority vote against the rate $1/n$, for $n = 1, 3, \ldots, 15$, with $n = 3$ ringed. The green band marks the rates below C.

⚠ RATE FALLS TOO

Repetition drives the error to zero only as the rate $1/n$ goes to zero. The channel coding theorem promises far better: any rate below $C = 0.531$.

The channel coding theorem

The **channel coding theorem** states which rates can be made reliable. Here R is in bits a channel use.

CHANNEL CODING THEOREM

$$R < C:\ P_e \to 0 \text{ is possible}, \qquad R > C:\ \text{it is not}$$

For $R < C$, codes exist with rate close to C and error as small as asked. They need long blocks, and the theorem does not build them. For $R > C$, no code of any length is reliable.

A code of rate $R = 0.5$ over a BSC needs $1 - H_b(p) > 0.5$. That holds for $p < 0.11$, where $H_b = 0.5$. The repetition codes sit far below the limit, because their rate falls with their error. The theorem says that is unnecessary.

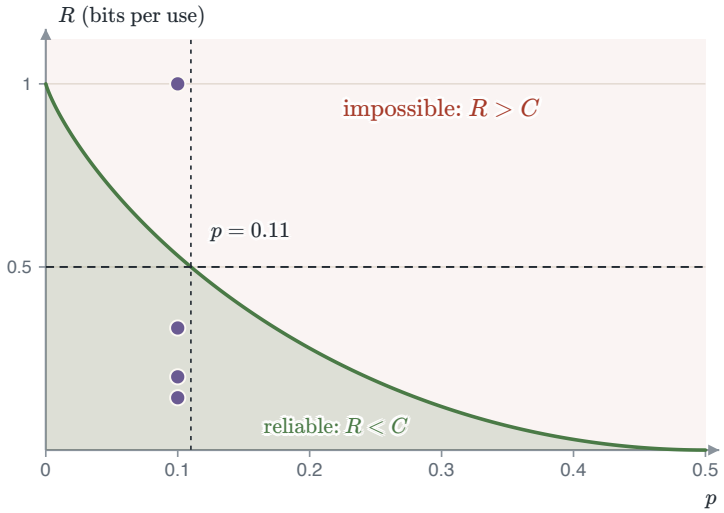


FIGURE 6.35 Over a BSC: rates below $C(p) = 1 - H_b(p)$ can be made reliable, and rates above it cannot. The violet dots are the repetition codes at $p = 0.1$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

A glimpse of codes: the Hamming code

Real codes add structure. A single **parity bit** makes the number of ones in a word even. One error makes it odd, so the error is detected, but its position is not known.

The $(7, 4)$ **Hamming code** sends four data bits and three parity bits, a rate of $4/7$. Each parity bit keeps one group of bits even, drawn as one of three circles. Its 16 codewords differ pairwise in at least $d_{\min} = 3$ places.

ERRORS CORRECTED

$$t = \left\lfloor \frac{d_{\min} - 1}{2} \right\rfloor = \left\lfloor \frac{3 - 1}{2} \right\rfloor = 1$$

A word with one error is still nearer its own codeword than any other. So one error can be corrected.

The bits sit at positions 1 to 7. Check s_1 covers the positions with a 1 in the units place of their binary index: $1, 3, 5, 7$. Check s_2 covers $2, 3, 6, 7$, and check s_4 covers $4, 5, 6, 7$. The failing checks form the **syndrome** $s_4 s_2 s_1$, a binary number that names the flipped position.

Take the codeword 0110011. Bit 5 flips, so 0110111 is received. Recompute each check on the received bits $r_1, \ldots, r_7$.

SYNDROME

$$s_1 = r_1 \oplus r_3 \oplus r_5 \oplus r_7 = 0 \oplus 1 \oplus 1 \oplus 1 = 1$$
$$s_2 = r_2 \oplus r_3 \oplus r_6 \oplus r_7 = 1 \oplus 1 \oplus 1 \oplus 1 = 0$$
$$s_4 = r_4 \oplus r_5 \oplus r_6 \oplus r_7 = 0 \oplus 1 \oplus 1 \oplus 1 = 1$$

The circles for s_1 and s_4 fail, and s_2 holds. So $s_4 s_2 s_1 = 101$, which is 5 in binary. Flipping bit 5 back gives 0110011.

$r = 0110111$ $\qquad$ $s = (s_4 s_2 s_1) = 101 = 5$

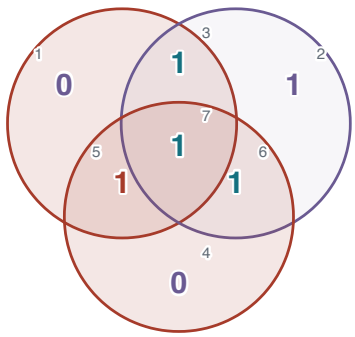


FIGURE 6.36 The received word in the three parity circles, at the syndrome step. The circles of s_1 and s_4 fail (red), and $s_4 s_2 s_1 = 101$ names bit 5.

Sending a source over a channel

A source and a channel can now be joined. Compress the source to $H(U)$ bits a symbol, then code those bits for the channel. Both steps can be made reliable when a channel use carries more than the entropy of the symbol it sends.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

SOURCE OVER A CHANNEL

$$H(U) < C \quad \text{bits per channel use}$$

With R_s symbols a second and R_c channel uses a second, compare $H(U)R_s$ with CR_c.

Take a binary source that emits a 1 with probability 0.1, sent over a BSC once a symbol.

A BINARY SOURCE OVER A BSC

$$H_b(0.1) = 0.469 < 1 - H_b(\epsilon) \iff \epsilon < 0.1206 \text{ or } \epsilon > 0.8794$$

At $\epsilon = 0.2$, $C = 1 - H_b(0.2) = 0.278 < 0.469$, so the link cannot be made reliable.

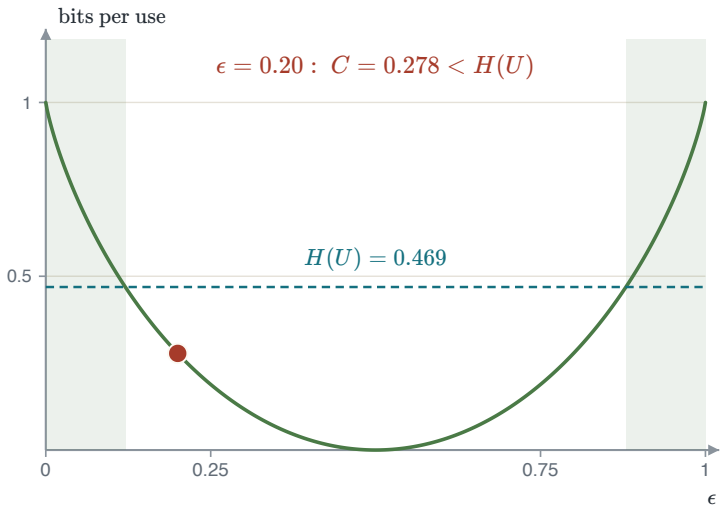


FIGURE 6.37 A binary source with $P(1) = 0.1$ sent over a BSC, one use a symbol, shown at $\epsilon = 0.2$. The green bands mark where $C(\epsilon)$ exceeds $H(U)$.

Capacity around us

Each device below is read as a binary channel with stated numbers. The capacity follows from its matrix.

- A BPSK receiver that decides each bit is a BSC with $p = Q\left(\sqrt{2E/N_0}\right)$, so $C = 1 - H_b(p)$. At 0 dB, $C = 0.603$.
- A network that loses a fraction ϵ of packets, and says which, is an erasure channel: $C = 1 - \epsilon$. At 5% loss, 0.95 of the rate survives.
- A chain of n repeaters, each deciding bits with $p = 0.01$, is one BSC with $p_n = \frac{1}{2}\left(1 - (1-2p)^n\right)$. C falls from 0.919 to 0.559 in 10 hops.
- A memory cell whose charge leaks, so a stored 1 reads as 0 with probability 0.1, is a Z-channel. $C = 0.763$ at $q = 0.54$.

ERASURES ARE CHEAP

A lost packet that is flagged costs ϵ. A flipped bit that is hidden costs $H_b(\epsilon)$, which is more.

HOPS ADD UP

Each decision adds errors, and capacity only falls along a chain.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

6.6 The Gaussian channel

The Gaussian channel

The Gaussian channel adds noise to a real-valued input. The input power is limited to P, and the noise Z is Gaussian with power P_N.

GAUSSIAN CHANNEL

$$Y = X + Z, \qquad Z \sim \mathcal{N}(0, P_N), \qquad \mathrm{E}[X^2] \le P$$

Count the codewords that fit, as for the BSC. Over n uses, a received word lies near its codeword, inside a ball of radius $\sqrt{nP_N}$. All received words lie inside a ball of radius $\sqrt{n(P+P_N)}$. Divide the two volumes.

SPHERE COUNT

$$M \approx \frac{\left(\sqrt{n(P+P_N)}\right)^n}{\left(\sqrt{nP_N}\right)^n} = \left(1 + \frac{P}{P_N}\right)^{n/2}$$

$$C = \frac{1}{n}\log_2 M = \tfrac{1}{2}\log_2\left(1 + \frac{P}{P_N}\right) \quad \text{bits per use}$$

The volume of a ball in n dimensions grows as its radius to the power n, and the constant cancels. At $P/P_N = 15$, $C = \frac{1}{2}\log_2 16 = 2$ bits a use.

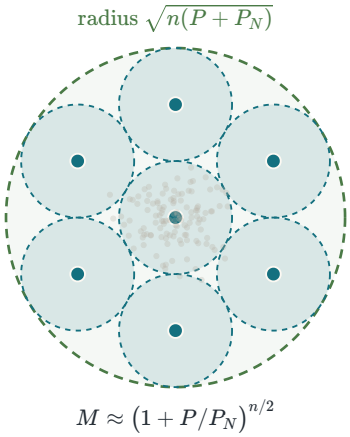


FIGURE 6.38 A received word lands near its codeword, inside a noise disc. All received words lie in a larger disc. The count of noise discs that fit inside is M.

The capacity of the bandlimited channel

A channel of band W carries $2W$ independent samples a second, as in Chapter 1. Each sample is one use of the Gaussian channel. The noise has two-sided density $N_0/2$, so its power in the band is $2W \cdot N_0/2 = N_0 W$.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CAPACITY OF THE BANDLIMITED CHANNEL

$$C = 2W \cdot \tfrac{1}{2}\log_2\!\left(1 + \frac{P}{N_0 W}\right)$$
$$= W \log_2(1 + \mathrm{SNR}) \quad \text{b/s}$$

Here $\mathrm{SNR} = P/N_0 W$ is a ratio, not a value in decibels: 30 dB is 1000. A band of $W = 1$ MHz at $\mathrm{SNR} = 15$ gives $C = 10^6 \log_2 16 = 4$ Mb/s.

At high SNR, $\log_2(1 + \mathrm{SNR}) \approx \log_2 \mathrm{SNR}$. So each doubling of the SNR, or 3 dB, adds one bit a second per hertz.

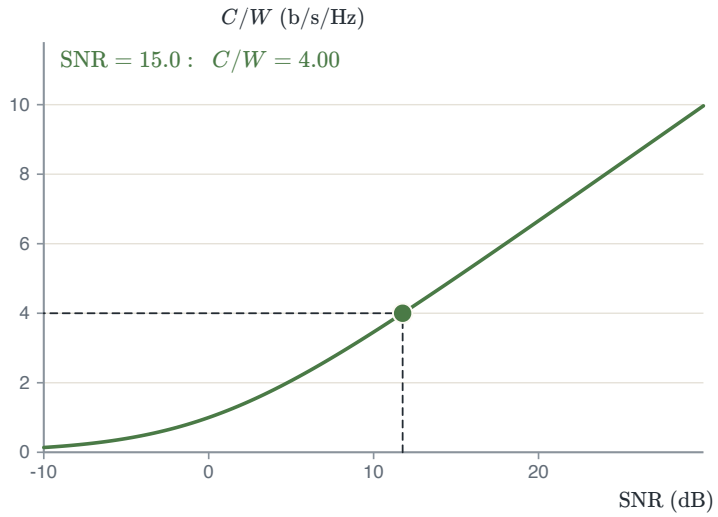


FIGURE 6.39 Capacity per hertz against the SNR in dB, shown at $\mathrm{SNR} = 15$, where $C/W = 4$ b/s/Hz. At high SNR each 3 dB adds one bit a second per hertz.

EXAMPLE 6.4 — A TELEPHONE LINE

GIVEN — A telephone line passes 300 Hz to 3.4 kHz at an SNR of 30 dB.

FIND — The capacity C.

METHOD — The band is $W = 3400 - 300 = 3100$ Hz. The formula $C = W \log_2(1 + \mathrm{SNR})$ takes the SNR as a ratio, so convert it first: $\mathrm{SNR} = 10^{30/10} = 1000$.

SOLUTION — $C = 3100 \log_2(1001) = 3100 \times 9.967 = 30.9$ kb/s.

CHECK — At 30 dB, $\log_2 1001$ is close to 10, so each hertz carries about 10 bits a second. Then 3.1 kHz carries about 31 kb/s.

COMMON ERROR

Use $\mathrm{SNR} = 1000$, not 30, inside the logarithm. With 30 the answer comes out as $3100 \log_2(1 + 30) = 15.4$ kb/s.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

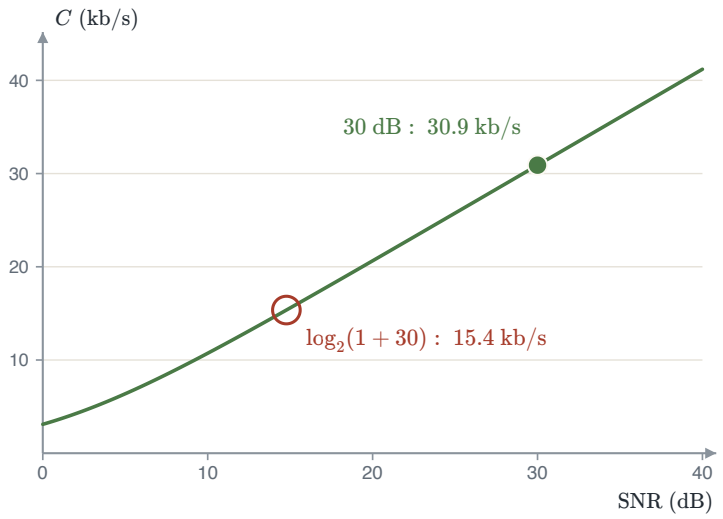


FIGURE 6.40 Capacity of a 3.1 kHz line against its SNR in dB. The dot is the right answer at 30 dB, and the ring is the answer with 30 inside the logarithm.

Capacity against bandwidth

A wider band lets more samples through, but it spreads the same power thinner. The SNR P/N_0W falls as W grows, and the two effects nearly cancel.

For small x, $\ln(1+x) \approx x$, so $\log_2(1+x) \approx x/\ln 2$. Put $x = P/N_0W$ and let W grow.

INFINITE BAND

$$\lim_{W\to\infty} W\log_2\!\left(1+\frac{P}{N_0W}\right) = \lim_{W\to\infty} W\cdot\frac{P}{N_0W\ln 2}$$
$$= \frac{P}{N_0\ln 2} = 1.4427\,\frac{P}{N_0}$$

At a fixed power, capacity levels off however wide the band. At a fixed band it keeps growing with power, but only as the logarithm of the power.

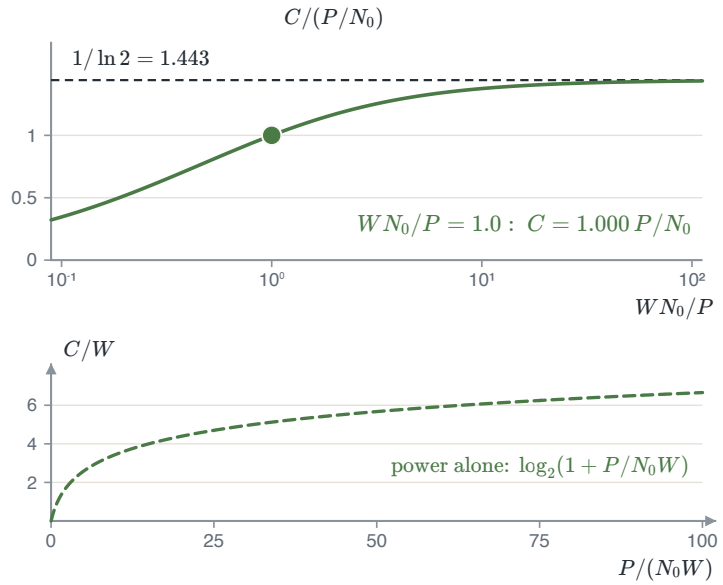


FIGURE 6.41 Top: capacity against bandwidth at a fixed power, levelling off at the dashed line $1.443\,P/N_0$, shown at $WN_0/P = 1$. Bottom: capacity per hertz against power at a fixed band, which keeps rising.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The bandwidth-efficiency plane

The **spectral efficiency** $r = R_b/W$ is the bit rate carried by each hertz of band. The power is energy a bit times bits a second, $P = E_b R_b$. Put both into $R_b < C$.

LEAST E_b/N_0 FOR A SPECTRAL EFFICIENCY

$$R_b < W \log_2\!\left(1 + \frac{E_b R_b}{N_0 W}\right)$$
$$r < \log_2\!\left(1 + r\,\frac{E_b}{N_0}\right)$$
$$\frac{E_b}{N_0} > \frac{2^r - 1}{r}$$

Divide the first line by W to get the second. Raise 2 to the power of each side and solve for E_b/N_0 to get the third. At $r = 2$, $E_b/N_0 > (2^2 - 1)/2 = 1.5$, which is $10 \log_{10} 1.5 = 1.76$ dB.

The curve splits the plane into two regions. Above $r = 1$ the band is scarce, and a link is **bandwidth-limited**. Below it power is scarce, and a link is **power-limited**. No link works to the left of the curve.

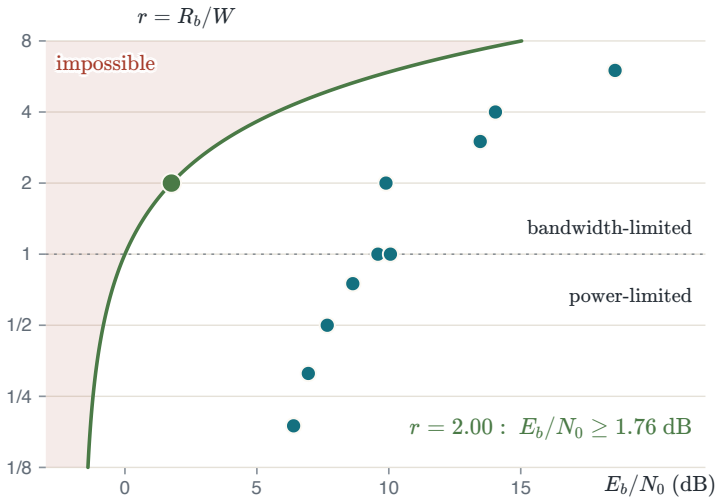


FIGURE 6.42 The least E_b/N_0 for each spectral efficiency r (line), shown at $r = 2$. The cyan dots are the uncoded schemes of Chapter 5 at a symbol error of 10^{-5}.

⚠ THE GAP

Each uncoded scheme of Chapter 5 sits several decibels right of the curve. Channel coding exists to close that gap.

The Shannon limit

Let the spectral efficiency fall to zero, which spends band freely. The bound then falls toward a floor. For small r, $2^r = e^{r \ln 2} \approx 1 + r \ln 2$.

SHANNON LIMIT

$$\frac{E_b}{N_0} > \lim_{r \to 0} \frac{2^r - 1}{r} = \lim_{r \to 0} \frac{r \ln 2}{r}$$
$$= \ln 2 = 0.693 = -1.59 \text{ dB}$$

No code works below -1.59 dB, at any bandwidth. Chapter 5 met the same floor for orthogonal signals as M grows.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Uncoded BPSK needs 9.59 dB for $P_b = 10^{-5}$. Its gap to the limit is $9.59 - (-1.59) = 11.18$ dB. Modern codes come within a fraction of a decibel of the limit.

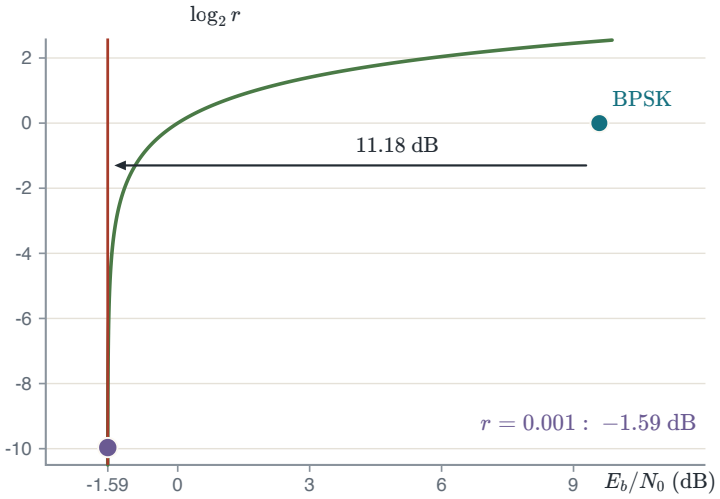


FIGURE 6.43 The bound $(2^r - 1)/r$ as r falls: the point walks down to $\ln 2 = -1.59$ dB. Shown at the last step, with uncoded BPSK at $P_b = 10^{-5}$ placed 11.18 dB to the right.

Water-filling

A total power P must be shared over parallel Gaussian channels with different noise N_i.

PARALLEL CHANNELS

$$C = \sum_i \tfrac{1}{2} \log_2\!\left(1 + \frac{P_i}{N_i}\right), \qquad \sum_i P_i = P$$

The best share fills every channel up to the same level μ. Channels whose noise lies above it get nothing.

WATER-FILLING

$$P_i = \max(0,\ \mu - N_i)$$

With very little total power, the water first covers the lowest floor. So the quietest channel gets it.

Take six channels with noise $0.1, 0.2, 0.4, 0.8, 1.6, 3.2$ and $P = 1$. Guess that three are used, and solve $\sum_i (\mu - N_i) = P$ for μ.

WATER LEVEL AT $P = 1$

$$3\mu - (0.1 + 0.2 + 0.4) = 1 \implies \mu = \frac{1.7}{3} = 0.567$$

$$P_i = \mu - N_i = 0.467,\ 0.367,\ 0.167$$

The level lies below 0.8, the noise of the fourth channel, so three channels are used.

Each used channel has $1 + P_i/N_i = \mu/N_i$. Add the three capacities.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

CAPACITY AT $P = 1$

$$C = \tfrac{1}{2}\log_2 \frac{0.567}{0.1} + \tfrac{1}{2}\log_2 \frac{0.567}{0.2} + \tfrac{1}{2}\log_2 \frac{0.567}{0.4}$$
$$= 1.251 + 0.751 + 0.251 = 2.254 \text{ bits}$$

Equal shares give 1.641 bits.

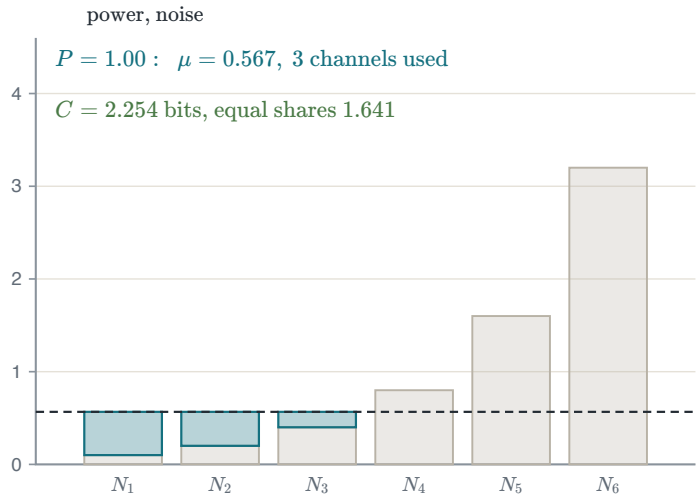


FIGURE 6.44 Six channels with noise 0.1 to 3.2 (grey). Power (cyan) is poured in up to one level μ, shown at $P = 1$.

Shannon's formula around us

$C = W \log_2(1 + P/N_0 W)$ takes a width in hertz and a ratio, never a ratio in dB. Four uses of it:

- A telephone line passes 300 Hz to 3.4 kHz. At an SNR of 30 dB, $C = W \log_2(1 + \text{SNR}) = 30.9$ kb/s.
- A radio channel 20 MHz wide at an assumed SNR of 20 dB: $C = 20 \log_2 101 = 133$ Mb/s.
- A deep-space link with an assumed $P/N_0 = 10^4$ Hz. More band helps less and less: $C \to P/(N_0 \ln 2) = 14.4$ kb/s.
- DSL splits its band into tones 4.3125 kHz apart. With noise rising in frequency, water-filling gives tone k the bits $b_k = \log_2(1 + P_k/N_k)$.

TWO REGIMES

A wide band at low SNR is power-limited. A narrow band at high SNR is bandwidth-limited.

ASSUMED NUMBERS

The SNR and P/N_0 here are assumptions for the example, not a claim about any standard.

6.7 Summary

From a source to a channel

Follow one source through a Huffman code and a BPSK link, and check that it fits the capacity.

The source $0.4, 0.2, 0.2, 0.1, 0.1$ emits $R_s = 1000$ symbols a second. It has $H = 2.122$ bits a symbol. The Huffman code of Section 6.3 spends $\bar{L} = 2.2$, so 2200 b/s leave the encoder.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

The bits go by BPSK at $R_c = 3000$ bits a second and 4 dB, decided bit by bit. That is a BSC with $p = 0.0125$ and $C = 1 - H_b(0.0125) = 0.903$ bit a use.

THE CHECK

$$H\,R_s = 2.122 \times 1000 = 2122 \text{ b/s} \;<\; C\,R_c = 0.903 \times 3000 = 2709 \text{ b/s}$$

A channel code of rate $2200/3000 = 0.733 < C$ exists that makes the link reliable. At $R_c = 2000$ uses a second, $CR_c = 0.903 \times 2000 = 1806 < 2122$ b/s, and the link cannot be made reliable.

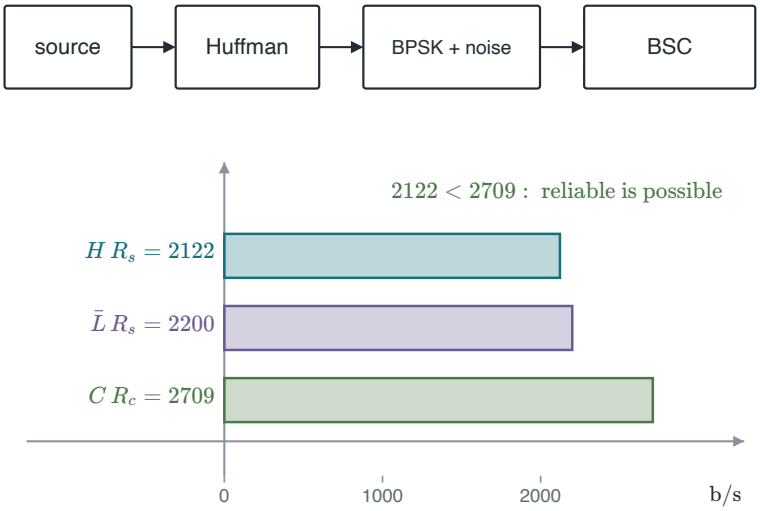


FIGURE 6.45 The source of $0.4, 0.2, 0.2, 0.1, 0.1$ at 1000 symbols a second, a Huffman code, and BPSK at 3000 bits a second and 4 dB. The bars compare the rates.

Quick check

1 Eight equally likely symbols have an entropy of 1 bit, 3 bits or 8 bits?
Answer: 3 bits, since $\log_2 8 = 3$.

2 Codeword lengths $1, 2, 3, 3$ give a Kraft sum of 0.875, 1 or 1.25?
Answer: 1, since $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4} + \frac{1}{8} + \frac{1}{8} = 1$.

3 A Huffman code for a source of entropy H has $\bar{L}$ below H, in $[H, H+1)$, or above $H+1$?
Answer: In $[H, H+1)$. It meets the source-coding bound.

4 For independent X and Y, is $I(X;Y)$ equal to 0, $H(X)$ or $H(X,Y)$?
Answer: 0, since $H(X \mid Y) = H(X)$.

5 A binary erasure channel with $\epsilon = 0.2$ has capacity 0.2, 0.278 or 0.8?
Answer: 0.8, since $C = 1 - \epsilon$.

6 Below which E_b/N_0 can no code be reliable: -1.59 dB, 0 dB or 9.59 dB?
Answer: -1.59 dB, since $\ln 2 = 0.693$, which is -1.59 dB.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

Results of the chapter

TABLE 6.5 Summary of Chapter 6: an introduction to information theory.

QUESTION	RESULT	ANCHOR
How much information does a symbol carry?	$I(s_k) = -\log_2 p_k$ bits: rare symbols carry more.	PS CH12.1.1
What is entropy, and what bounds it?	$H(S) = -\sum_k p_k \log_2 p_k$, with $0 \le H \le \log_2 K$.	PS CH12.1.1
What does an extended source carry?	$H(S^n) = nH(S)$ for a memoryless source.	PS CH12.1.2
What are typical sequences?	About 2^{nH} sequences, each of probability near 2^{-nH}, that hold almost all the probability.	PS CH12.2
When do codeword lengths allow a prefix code?	Exactly when $\sum_k 2^{-l_k} \le 1$.	—
How close can a code get to the entropy?	$H \le \bar{L} < H + 1$, and $H + 1/n$ for blocks of n.	PS CH12.3.1
How is a Huffman code built?	Merge the two least likely entries until one is left, then read each codeword back.	PS CH12.3.1
What does Lempel–Ziv need to know about the source?	Nothing. It parses the stream into new phrases, and its cost falls toward H as the stream grows.	PS CH12.3.2
What is a binary symmetric channel?	Each bit flips with probability p. Hard-decision BPSK gives $p = Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$.	PS CH12.4
What is mutual information?	$I(X;Y) = H(X) - H(X \mid Y)$, symmetric and never negative.	PS CH12.1.3
What is the capacity of a channel?	$C = \max_{p(x)} I(X;Y)$: $1 - H_b(p)$ for the BSC, $1 - \epsilon$ for the erasure channel.	PS CH12.5
What does the channel coding theorem say?	Rates below C can be made reliable. Rates above it cannot.	PS CH12.5
What is the capacity of a bandlimited channel?	$C = W \log_2(1 + P/N_0 W)$ b/s, which levels off at $1.44\, P/N_0$ as W grows.	PS CH12.5.1
What is the Shannon limit?	$E_b/N_0 > \ln 2 = -1.59$ dB. Uncoded BPSK sits 11.2 dB above it.	PS CH12.6

Compress the source to its entropy, then code it for the channel below capacity. The Hamming code of Section 6.5 is a first such channel code.

Projects to try

Four optional projects use the chapter on real text and simulated channels. Each gives an aim, what it practises, a few steps and what to look for.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

AN ENTROPY METER AND A HUFFMAN CODER

Measure the entropy of a text and code it with a Huffman code built from its own counts.

Practises: Letter frequencies as probabilities. Building a Huffman code by repeated merges. Average length against entropy.

1. Count the letters and spaces of a long text.
2. Compute the entropy of one letter.
3. Build a Huffman code and encode the text.
4. Decode it and check that nothing changed.

Look for: the bits a letter sit just above the entropy, and far above the 1.3 bits of English with its memory.

AN LZ78 COMPRESSOR

Compress binary streams with LZ78 and compare the cost with the entropy.

Practises: Parsing a stream into new phrases. A pointer and one new bit a phrase. Why a universal code needs long streams.

1. Draw bits with $P(1) = p$ for several p.
2. Parse each stream and count the phrases.
3. Compute the bits sent a source bit.
4. Plot the cost against the stream length and $H_b(p)$.

Look for: the cost falls slowly toward $H_b(p)$ and never below it.

A BSC SIMULATOR

Send bits over a simulated BSC with repetition codes and a Hamming code.

Practises: Majority voting over copies. Syndrome decoding of one error. Rate against error, next to capacity.

1. Flip random bits with probability p.
2. Code with repetition $n = 1, 3, 5$ and with the $(7, 4)$ Hamming code.
3. Decode and count the bit errors.
4. Plot error against rate with $C = 1 - H_b(p)$.

Look for: the Hamming code gives more rate than repetition at a similar error, and all points sit left of C.

WATER-FILLING ON A LINE

Share power over the tones of a line whose noise rises with frequency.

Practises: Parallel Gaussian channels. The water level found by bisection. Why the noisiest tones get nothing.

1. Choose a noise floor that grows with frequency over 64 tones.
2. Find the water level for a total power by bisection.
3. Compute the bits each tone carries.
4. Compare the total with equal shares as the power changes.

Look for: at low power a few quiet tones carry everything. At high power the shares become nearly equal.

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

APPENDIX

A

Summary of formulas

The results each chapter carries forward, in course order and without derivations.

A.1 The transition from analog to digital — Chapter 1

TABLE A.1 The results of Chapter 1, with $\operatorname{sinc}(x) = \sin(\pi x)/(\pi x)$.

QUESTION	RESULT	SOURCE
What does sampling do to the spectrum?	$G_\delta(f) = f_s \sum_n G(f - n f_s)$: a copy at every multiple of f_s, scaled by f_s.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.1.1
What is the lowest safe sampling rate?	The Nyquist rate $2W$. Below it the copies overlap and alias.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.1.1
What filter turns the samples back into the signal?	An ideal lowpass filter with gain T_s. At $f_s = 2W$ its impulse response is $\operatorname{sinc}(2Wt)$.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.1.1
How is $g(t)$ written in terms of its samples?	$g(t) = \sum_n g(nT_s)\operatorname{sinc}\big(2W(t - nT_s)\big)$, exact at every t.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.1.1
Mid-rise or mid-tread: which has a level at zero?	Mid-tread. Mid-rise has a boundary at zero and outputs $\pm\Delta/2$ there.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.2.1
What is the power of the quantization noise?	$E[Q^2] = \Delta^2/12$, with $\Delta = 2m_{\max}/L$, for a fine quantizer.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.2.1
What does one more bit buy?	6.02 dB: $\mathrm{SQNR} = \alpha + 6.02R$, and $\alpha = 1.76$ dB for a full-scale sinusoid.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.2.1
Why compand?	Small amplitudes are common. Finer steps near zero keep the SQNR steady as the level falls.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.2.1
What bit rate does PCM need?	$R_b = R\, f_s$. Telephone speech: $8(8000) = 64$ kb/s.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.3
Why use a Gray code?	Adjacent levels differ in one bit, so a small decision error costs one bit error.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.3
What bandwidth does PCM need?	$B_T \geq R_b/2$, which is RW at $f_s = 2W$. Each extra bit adds 6.02 dB and W hertz.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.4.1
What do DPCM and delta modulation send?	The difference from a prediction. Delta modulation sends one bit a sample and needs Δf_s above the largest slope.	Ch. 1 · PS CH7.4.2–7.4.3

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

A.2 Baseband transmission of digital signals — Chapter 2

TABLE A.2 The results of Chapter 2.

QUESTION	RESULT	SOURCE
Which filter gives the largest peak SNR?	The matched filter $h(t) = k\,g(T-t)$, or $H(f) = k\,G^*(f)\,e^{-j2\pi fT}$, sampled at $t = T$.	Ch. 2 · PS CH8.3.2
What is that largest peak SNR?	$\eta_{\max} = 2E/N_0$. It depends on the pulse energy E, not on its shape.	Ch. 2 · PS CH8.3.2
Where do the two symbols of polar signalling sit?	At $\pm\sqrt{E_b}$ on the axis of the unit-energy $\psi(t)$, a distance $2\sqrt{E_b}$ apart.	Ch. 2 · PS CH8.2.1
When do the correlator and the matched filter agree?	At $t = T_b$, where both give $\int_0^{T_b} x(t)\,\psi(t)\,dt$, for any shape of ψ.	Ch. 2 · PS CH8.3.1
What noise is left in the demodulator output?	$y = s_m + n$, with n Gaussian of mean 0 and variance $N_0/2$.	Ch. 2 · PS CH8.3.1
Where does the optimal threshold go?	$\lambda_{\text{opt}} = \frac{N_0}{4\sqrt{E_b}} \ln \frac{p_0}{p_1}$, at 0 for equal priors and toward the less likely symbol otherwise.	Ch. 2 · PS CH8.3.3
What is $Q(x)$?	The Gaussian tail $Q(x)$, the chance that a unit Gaussian exceeds x.	Ch. 2 · PS CH8.3.3
What is P_b for polar signalling?	$P_b = Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$ with equal priors and a matched filter.	Ch. 2 · PS CH8.3.3
How much interference does an RC channel add?	A bit m bits back adds $(1-q)q^m$, with $q = e^{-2\pi BT_b}$. The worst case totals q.	Ch. 2 · PS CH10.1.1
When does the eye close?	The opening is $2(1-2q)$. It closes at $BT_b = \ln 2/(2\pi) = 0.110$, and errors then occur without noise.	Ch. 2
What is Nyquist's criterion?	$p(kT_b) = \delta[k]$ exactly when $\sum_n P(f - nR_b) = T_b$. It needs $B_T \geq R_b/2$.	Ch. 2 · PS CH10.3.1
What bandwidth does a raised cosine need?	$B_T = \frac{R_b}{2}(1+\alpha)$. The tails fall as $1/\lvert t\rvert^3$ for $\alpha > 0$.	Ch. 2 · PS CH10.3.1

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

A.3 Geometric representation of signal waveforms — Chapter 3

TABLE A.3 The results of Chapter 3.

QUESTION	RESULT	SOURCE
What is an orthonormal set?	Functions with $\int \psi_j \psi_k \, dt = 1$ for $j = k$ and 0 for $j \neq k$: unit energy, and every pair orthogonal.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1
How is a coordinate computed?	$s_{ij} = \int_0^T s_i(t)\, \psi_j(t)\, dt$, one correlator for each basis function.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1
How is the waveform rebuilt?	$s_i(t) = \sum_{j=1}^{N} s_{ij}\, \psi_j(t)$. The vector $\mathbf{s}_i$ holds the whole waveform.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1
What does the translation preserve?	Inner products: $\int x(t)\, y(t)\, dt = \sum_k x_k y_k$.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1
What is the energy of a signal?	$E_i = \lVert \mathbf{s}_i \rVert^2$, the squared distance from its point to the origin.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1
What is the distance between two signals?	$d_{ik} = \lVert \mathbf{s}_i - \mathbf{s}_k \rVert$, the root of $\int (s_i - s_k)^2\, dt$.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1
Antipodal or orthogonal: which is further apart?	Antipodal, $d = 2\sqrt{E_b}$ against $\sqrt{2E_b}$. Orthogonal needs twice the energy, 3 dB, for the same distance.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.2
When are a cosine and a sine orthogonal?	Over $[0, T]$ when $f_c T$ is a whole number. Scaled by $\sqrt{2/T}$ they are an orthonormal pair.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.6.1
How far apart are the points of M-PSK?	$d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E}\sin(\pi/M)$. All M points lie on the circle of radius $\sqrt{E}$.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.6.1
What is one Gram–Schmidt step?	$g_k = s_k - \sum_{i<k} s_{ki}\psi_i$, then $\psi_k = g_k / \sqrt{E_{g_k}}$. A zero g_k adds no axis.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1
How many axes does a set of M signals need?	$N \leq M$, with $N = M$ only when no signal is a combination of the others.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1
What does another basis change?	Only the coordinates. N, the energies and the distances stay, and so do the receiver and its error probability.	Ch. 3 · PS CH8.1

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

A.4 The optimal receiver in additive white Gaussian noise — Chapter 4

TABLE A.4 The results of Chapter 4.

QUESTION	RESULT	SOURCE
How many bits does one of M waveforms carry?	$k = \log_2 M$, so $R_b = kR_s$ and $T_b = T/k$.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4
What does the correlator bank give?	$\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{s}_i + \mathbf{n}$, with $r_j = \int_0^T r(t)\,\psi_j(t)\,dt$.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.1
When does a matched filter give the same number?	At the sampling time $t = T$. Its impulse response is $\psi_j(T - t)$.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.1
Why can the noise outside the signal space be dropped?	It does not depend on the signal and adds the same $\|n'\|^2$ to every distance.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.1
What are the noise components?	Independent Gaussians with mean 0 and variance $N_0/2$. The cloud is round.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.1
What does MAP maximise?	$P(\mathbf{s}_i)\,f(\mathbf{r} \mid \mathbf{s}_i)$. With equal priors it is ML.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.1
What is ML in Gaussian noise?	Minimum distance. MAP subtracts $N_0 \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i)$ from each squared distance.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.1
What is the correlation metric?	$\mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{s}_i - E_i/2 + \frac{N_0}{2} \ln P(\mathbf{s}_i)$. Keep the largest.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.1
What shape are the decision regions?	Convex polygons cut by bisectors. Unequal priors shift each line toward the less likely point.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.1
What is the binary error probability?	$Q\left(\sqrt{d^2/2N_0}\right)$ for equal priors.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.3.3, 8.4.2
What is the union bound?	$P_e \le \frac{1}{M} \sum_i \sum_{j \ne i} Q\left(\sqrt{d_{ij}^2/2N_0}\right)$. The intelligent bound keeps only faces.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.2
What is the nearest-neighbour form?	$\bar{N}_{\min} Q\left(\sqrt{d_{\min}^2/2N_0}\right)$. Close at high SNR, but not a bound.	Ch. 4 · PS CH8.4.2

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

A.5 Digital modulation methods — Chapter 5

TABLE A.5 The results of Chapter 5.

QUESTION	RESULT	SOURCE
What does a carrier do to the spectrum?	$U(f) = \frac{1}{2}S(f - f_c) + \frac{1}{2}S(f + f_c)$. The band doubles to $2W$ and the energy halves.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.5.1
What does the IQ modulator send?	$s(t) = I\cos(2\pi f_c t) - Q\sin(2\pi f_c t)$: one point of the plane a symbol.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.6, 8.7
How do the binary schemes compare?	BPSK: $Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$. BFSK and BASK: $Q\left(\sqrt{E_b/N_0}\right)$, 3 dB worse.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.3.3, 8.6.1, 9.5
What is the M-PSK neighbour distance?	$d_{\min} = 2\sqrt{E_s}\sin(\pi/M)$, and $P_e \approx 2Q\left(\sqrt{2E_s/N_0}\sin(\pi/M)\right)$.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.6.1, 8.6.3
What do Gray labels buy?	Neighbours differ in one bit, so $P_b \approx P_e/\log_2 M$.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.6.1, 8.6.3
What does DPSK save, and what does it cost?	No carrier phase. $P_b = \frac{1}{2}e^{-E_b/N_0}$, under 1 dB behind BPSK.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.6.4, 8.6.5
What is the M-ASK error?	$\frac{2(M-1)}{M}Q\left(\sqrt{6E_s/((M^2-1)N_0)}\right)$, about 6 dB a doubling.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.5.3
What is the square-QAM error?	$4(1-1/\sqrt{M})\,Q\left(\sqrt{3E_s/((M-1)N_0)}\right)$, with $E_s = (M-1)d^2/6$.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.7.3
How much does QAM save over PSK?	4.20 dB at $M = 16$ and 9.95 dB at $M = 64$.	Ch. 5 · PS CH8.7.3
What do M orthogonal signals give?	$M - 1$ neighbours at $\sqrt{2E_s}$. The E_b/N_0 needed falls as M grows, toward -1.6 dB.	Ch. 5 · PS CH9.1.1, 9.1.2
What does noncoherent BFSK need?	Tones $1/T$ apart and an envelope detector. $P_b = \frac{1}{2}e^{-E_b/2N_0}$.	Ch. 5 · PS CH9.5.2, 9.5.3
What is MSK?	BFSK at $\Delta f = 1/(2T_b)$ with a continuous phase. Its envelope is constant.	Ch. 5 · PS CH9.6.1, 9.6.2
How wide is each family?	PSK and QAM: $R_b/\log_2 M$. Orthogonal: $MR_b/(2\log_2 M)$.	Ch. 5 · PS CH10.2, 9.7
Where does each family sit on the plane?	PAM, PSK and QAM: bandwidth-limited, $r > 1$. Orthogonal: power-limited, $r < 1$.	Ch. 5 · PS CH9.7

© 2026 Hüseyin Uğur Yıldız · huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

A.6 An introduction to information theory — Chapter 6

TABLE A.6 The results of Chapter 6.

QUESTION	RESULT	SOURCE
How much information does a symbol carry?	$I(s_k) = -\log_2 p_k$ bits: rare symbols carry more.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.1.1
What is entropy, and what bounds it?	$H(S) = -\sum_k p_k \log_2 p_k$, with $0 \le H \le \log_2 K$.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.1.1
What does an extended source carry?	$H(S^n) = nH(S)$ for a memoryless source.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.1.2
What are typical sequences?	About 2^{nH} sequences, each of probability near 2^{-nH}, that hold almost all the probability.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.2
When do codeword lengths allow a prefix code?	Exactly when $\sum_k 2^{-l_k} \le 1$.	Ch. 6
How close can a code get to the entropy?	$H \le \bar{L} < H + 1$, and $H + 1/n$ for blocks of n.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.3.1
How is a Huffman code built?	Merge the two least likely entries until one is left, then read each codeword back.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.3.1
What does Lempel–Ziv need to know about the source?	Nothing. It parses the stream into new phrases, and its cost falls toward H as the stream grows.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.3.2
What is a binary symmetric channel?	Each bit flips with probability p. Hard-decision BPSK gives $p = Q\left(\sqrt{2E_b/N_0}\right)$.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.4
What is mutual information?	$I(X;Y) = H(X) - H(X \mid Y)$, symmetric and never negative.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.1.3
What is the capacity of a channel?	$C = \max_{p(x)} I(X;Y)$: $1 - H_b(p)$ for the BSC, $1 - \epsilon$ for the erasure channel.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.5
What does the channel coding theorem say?	Rates below C can be made reliable. Rates above it cannot.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.5
What is the capacity of a bandlimited channel?	$C = W \log_2(1 + P/N_0 W)$ b/s, which levels off at $1.44\,P/N_0$ as W grows.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.5.1
What is the Shannon limit?	$E_b/N_0 > \ln 2 = -1.59$ dB. Uncoded BPSK sits 11.2 dB above it.	Ch. 6 · PS CH12.6



Digital Communications · Lecture Notes

VERSION	DATE	CHANGES
v0	24 September 2026	First edition.

© 2026 huguryildiz.com · Course content: CC BY-NC-SA 4.0